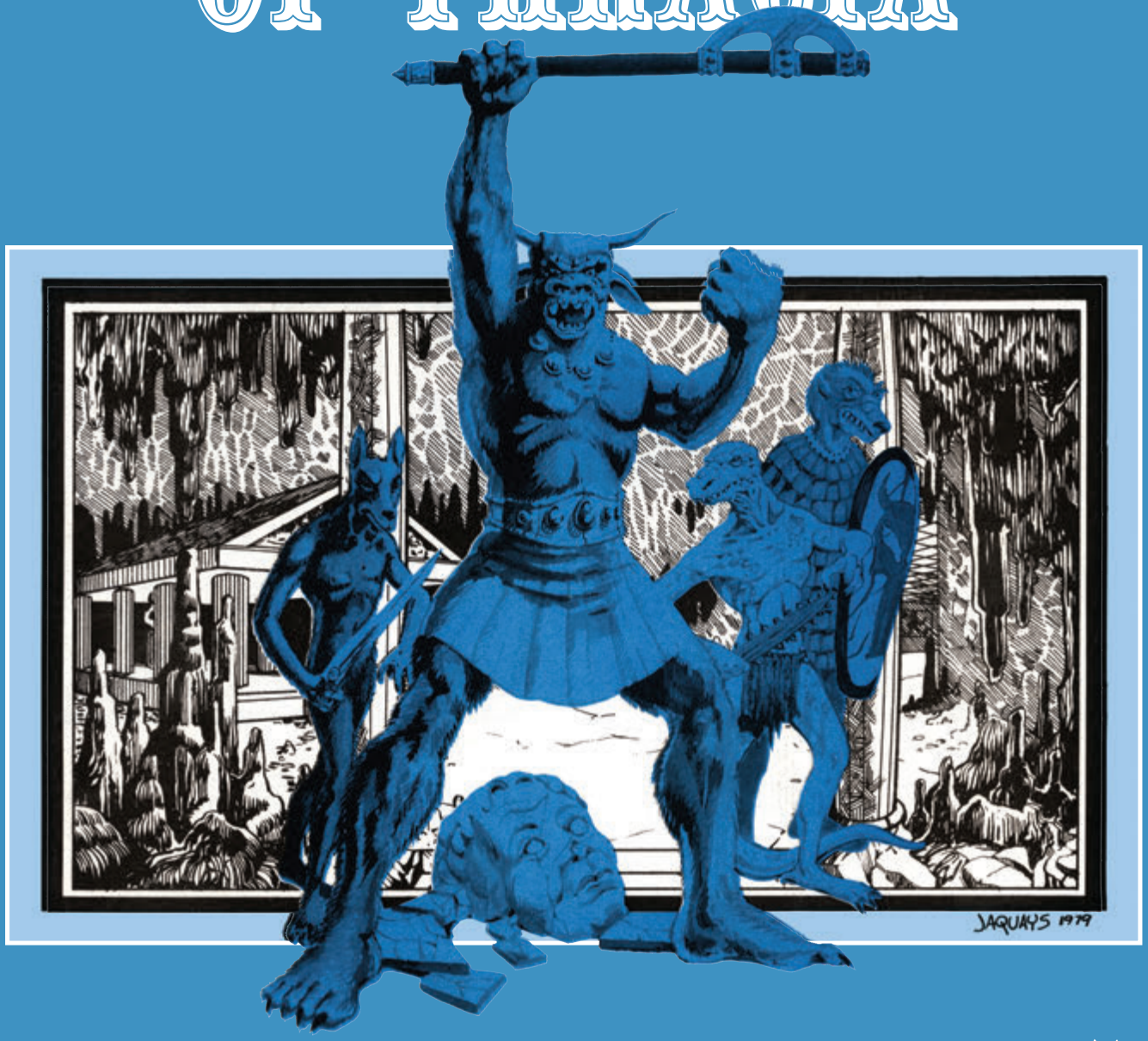
9

ORIGINAL ADVENTURES REINCARNATED

5E

THE CAVERNS OF THRACIA



A FIFTH EDITION CONVERSION & CLASSIC HOMAGE

Includes extensive historical commentary!

By Jennell Jaquays
with a 5E Conversion by Scott Moore

GOODMAN GAMES

THE CAVERNS OF THRACIA

A 5E CONVERSION AND CLASSIC HOMAGE

THE CAVERNS OF THRACIA

Original Adventure by	Jennell Jaquays
Writers	5E Conversion: Scott Moore Level 2A: Bob Brinkman Level 2A 5E Conversion: Chris Doyle
Essays Contributors	Tavis Allison, Kelsey Dionne, Mike Mearls, Kenneth Hite, James Mishler, Scott Moore, Bob Brinkman
Editor	William Fischer
Additional Editor	Tim Wadzinski
Developer	Chris Doyle
Art Direction	Matt Hildebrand
Layout	Vasili Kaliman
Cover Art	Jennell Jaquays
Interior Art	Joe Abboreno, Chris Arneson, Tom Bumgardner, Robbi Burns, Alexandra Coggon, Jason Edwards, Charles Ferguson-Avery, Tom Galambos, Steven Gomez, Kennon James, Davin Kluttz, Doug Kovacs, C. Aaron Kreader, Clifford Kurowski, François Licata, Giovanna Martin, William McAusland, Brad McDevitt, Jesse Mohn, Peter Mullen, Stefan Poag, Colin Richards, Chad Sergesketter, Jason Sholtis, Matt Sutton, Del Teigeler, Brian "Glad" Thomas, Carmin Vance, JV West, Chuck Whelon
Cartographer	Aaron Kreader
Backerkit Winning Team	Team DCC
Playtesters	Nate Garey, Nathan Sheridan, Ethan Kerr, Alison Whitton, Michael Kerr, Steve Whitton, Alan Khinkis
Publisher	Joseph Goodman

Fifth Edition Fantasy" and "Original Adventures Reincarnated" are registered trademarks of Goodman Games LLC.
All rights reserved. First printing. www.goodman-games.com. Printed in China

GOODMAN GAMES

VISIT US ONLINE AT: GOODMAN-GAMES.COM

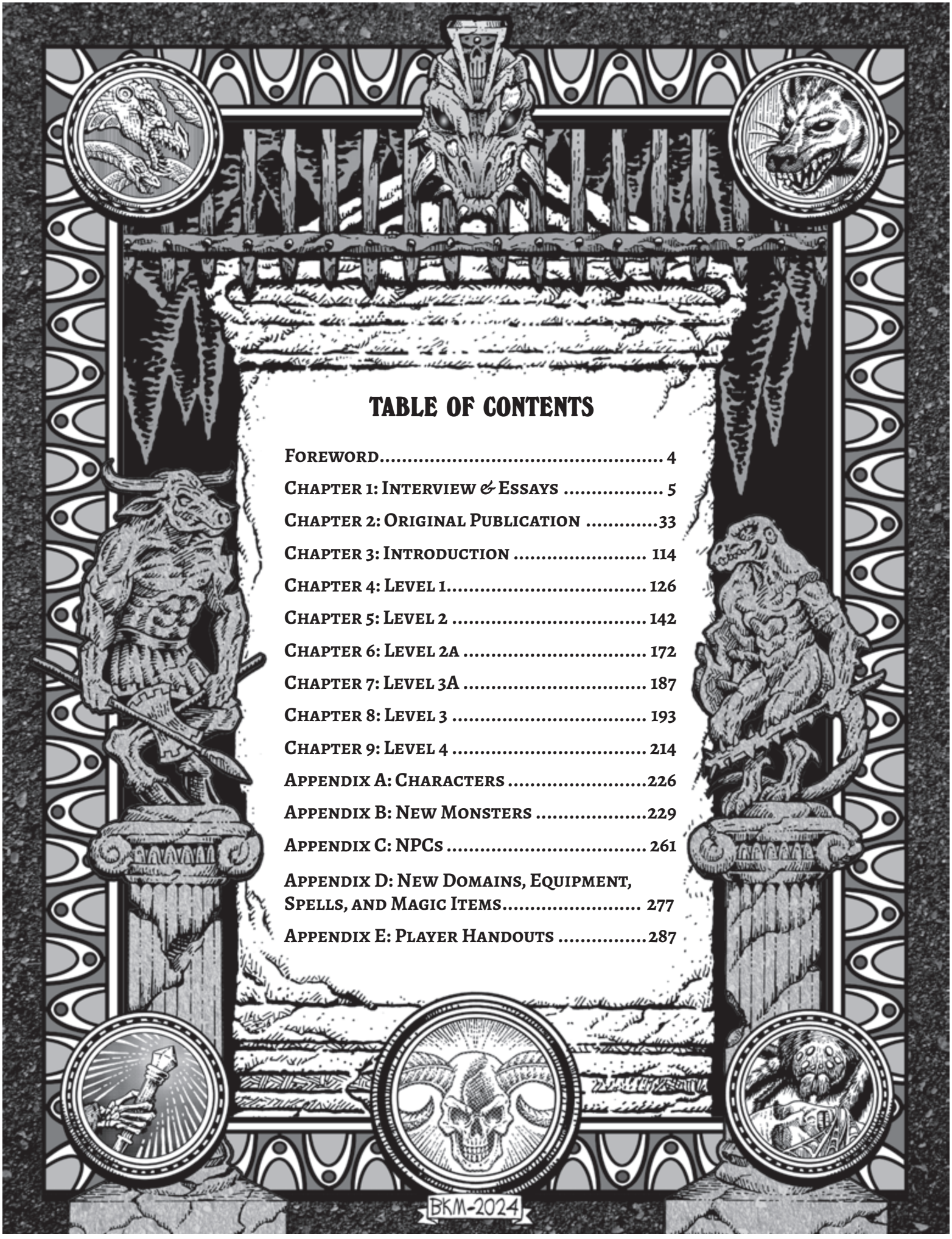


TABLE OF CONTENTS

Foreword..... 4

Chapter 1: Interview & Essays 5

Chapter 2: Original Publication 33

Chapter 3: Introduction 114

Chapter 4: Level 1..... 126

Chapter 5: Level 2 142

Chapter 6: Level 2A 172

Chapter 7: Level 3A 187

Chapter 8: Level 3 193

Chapter 9: Level 4 214

Appendix A: Characters 226

Appendix B: New Monsters 229

Appendix C: NPCs 261

Appendix D: New Domains, Equipment, Spells, and Magic Items..... 277

Appendix E: Player Handouts 287

BKM-2024

FOREWORD

Welcome to *The Caverns of Thracia*, a subterranean realm steeped in history, home to monsters, and the resting place of long-forgotten lore. Here, the crumbling dungeon walls almost sigh with the weight of the ages, the corridors are strewn with the bones of the long-dead, and the shadows contain golden treasures that glimmer in the chthonic gloom, untouched for centuries. Prepare yourselves well because we'll be down in those caverns and dungeon chambers for a long, long time. Perhaps, if we're unlucky, forever.

The Caverns of Thracia is an amazing dungeon as you're about to discover. It mixes history and myth, seasoned with a dash of archeology, and set to simmer in a stewpot forged from sword & sorcery. Few other dungeon adventures feel as real, as lived in, as the dark caves beneath the ruins of Thracia. Players—at least the ones who pay attention—will discover evidence of lost civilizations, ancient gods, and forsaken magic, clues hinting at larger tales going back millennia. If they're smart, they'll use this knowledge to their advantage and live to see the sunlight again.

This isn't to say there's no room for kick-in-the-door-and-roll-for-initiative types. The players will have many opportunities to break out the dice and throw d20s with abandon. A rogues' gallery of foes, from bestial humanoids to the restless dead to demonic powers, stalk these halls, each a formidable foe in their own right. However, combats can be perilous, and an astute party of adventurers knows that it's better to run sometimes than stand and fight—especially given the wide range of power levels possessed by the denizens of the caverns.

You may have experienced *The Caverns of Thracia* before or this might be your first journey down into them. To the former, we say "Welcome back." You're about to encounter a dungeon that will still be familiar, albeit powered by more modern game mechanics. If this is your first trip into the caverns, you've chosen the perfect time to visit. Goodman Games has given its all to bring you a classic dungeon that's bound to entertain, challenge, and perhaps even frustrate, no matter if this is your first or your hundred-and-first role-playing adventure. The task of bringing *The Caverns of Thracia* to your game tables was not an easy one, but it was rewarding. We feel you'll soon agree—assuming you survive your first few encounters with the local residents, that is.

But you bought this adventure to play, not to read us praising it. It's nearly time to break out the character sheets, get out your dice, and call for takeout. The adventure is about to begin. Before we leave you to it, we wanted to say thank you to a few important people.

Firstly, to everyone who helped crowdfund this adventure, you have our most sincere gratitude. We knew this project was bound to be successful, but you blew away all our expectations with your support. Without you, there would be no *The Caverns of Thracia* ready for the game tables of today.

Secondly, none of us would be here without Thracia's original creator, Jennell Jaquays. Her imagination and talent not only gave birth to what you're about to experience, but also inspired countless game designers, hobbyists and professionals alike, to strive for greatness. We here at Goodman Games were immensely saddened by Jennell's passing before this project was completed. We hope her spirit is still out there somewhere, watching and waiting to see how a whole new audience embraces one of her great works. Thanks, Jennell. You remain an inspiration to us all and we miss you dearly.

Now, it's time to strap on your armor, prepare your spells, light your torches and lanterns, and enter… *The Caverns of Thracia.*

— Michael Curtis & Chris Doyle
August 24, 2024

CHAPTER ONE

INTERVIEW & ESSAYS

FROM DRAWING TO A LIFETIME AS A PROFESSIONAL ARTIST AND GAME DESIGNER: JENNELL JAQUAYS

Interview by Tavis Allison

Tavis: Hello.

Jennell: Hey there.

Tavis: I'm glad we got that worked out. So, I have *The Dungeoneer* number one in front of me.

Jennell: As do I.

Tavis: Excellent. So, this was the beginning of your career.

Jennell: It literally…at least in games, was the beginning of my career. I had already been on a path to go into a career in art at that point, but I didn't know exactly what direction it would go.

Tavis: You had been artistically inclined since you were a kid?

Jennell: Oh yeah, I had been drawing since the first time somebody put crayons in front of me. I have specific memories of the Crayola multi-crayon boxes, the colors I loved most, and the ones that made me sick to my stomach.

Tavis: I remember the first time I reached out to you was because I had had a dream. This was probably a couple years after Gary Gygax died. My awareness that my gaming heroes from when I was a kid were slowly dying, was growing, as was the sense of urgency that I should reach out to them while I could. In this dream, I dreamed of visiting your childhood house, and you showed me the drawings that you had on your fridge. So, it's awesome to think that those drawings, those artifacts of your childhood, are still there.

Jennell: I'll be honest here. I don't know if my mom actually put my drawings up on the fridge.

Tavis: So…my dreams can't be expected to be entirely accurate.

Jennell: No, but I do remember as a child—this was maybe when I was in the second or third grade—I was into orcas. I think we called them killer whales back then. I had drawn this entire pod of orcas and cut them out of paper. We stuck them up on the wall individually in the family room. So, I had those orcas there for quite a while.

Tavis: That's awesome. How did you start drawing? What were your inspirations for fantastic images?

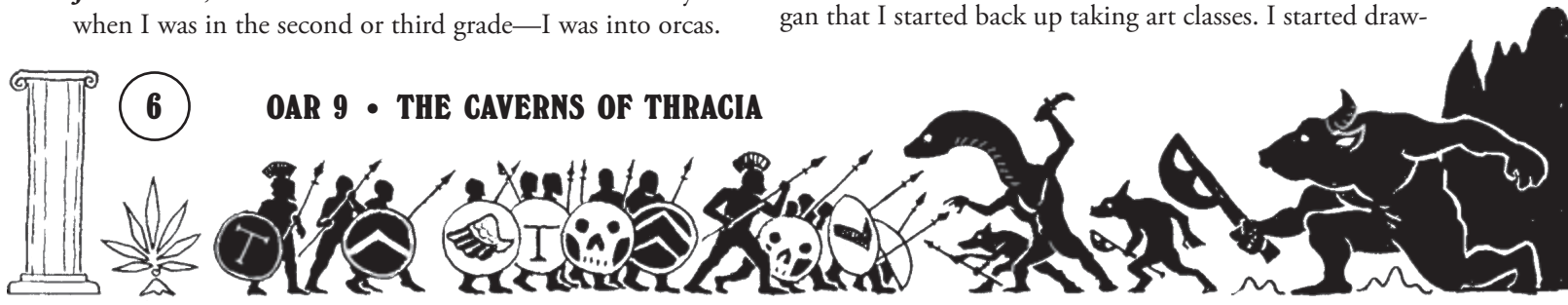
Jennell: I really got started doing, what I'll call fantastic images, through comic books. I enjoyed reading comics from as young as I can remember. My dad read comics. I don't think he collected them, but he would buy *Turok, Son of Stone,* and *Magnus, Robot Fighter*, and, the early sixties version of *Mad Magazine*. So, I was being affected by political satire as early as, say, second grade.

Tavis: That really comes out in your early work. The cover of the first *The Dungeoneer* is a great example of this, in that the expressions are so communicative.

Jennell: Well, I had actually, by that point, been doing my own comic book art, for my own entertainment, from probably as early as the fifth grade. I did a comic book based on the Legion of Superheroes, and it was all with cats. All the heroes were cats and I did a comic book based on them. My brother would tell some stories, and he would draw some comics too. We would bind them all together into a book and make our own comic books that way. All drawn on the back side of photocopy paper that my dad brought home from work. So, I had these comic pages in a bound in a book, with a heavy wood cover.

Tavis: That's amazing!

Jennell: So, that was how I actually started drawing. I wasn't taking art classes that early on. But then I took art in high school, in my first year. It wasn't until I moved to Michigan that I started back up taking art classes. I started draw-



ing comic books again, with one of my friends. He added some stories he was telling, and together we would sketch out, in math class, a comic strip called B'wana Banana. I would do the illustrations and the storyboard panels, and he would write all the text beneath them, and usually they went together. I have pages and pages and pages of those comic strips. Unfortunately, some of them were fairly politically incorrect, so I haven't gone out of my way to share them. So that was really how and where I got started. By the time I drew *The Dungeoneer* cover, I was in the middle of my second year of college as an art student and was already starting to think about doing things at a professional level. I had some things printed by that point but not fantasy work. But, I was learning how to draw for publication.

Tavis: One of the things that I think about a lot is, in the early TSR advertising campaigns, they called *Dungeons & Dragons* "the gateway to adventure". But when *The Dungeoneer* came out, it was only 1976, and that gateway had not been open for very long.

Jennell: I hadn't actually looked at a set of D&D rules until about Thanksgiving of 1975. And, at that point, it wasn't even the full rules, it was just *Greyhawk*. This was like opening a door to things I had always wanted to do as a child. There was a series of stories that *Different Worlds* magazine did later on, in the later 70s, called *My Life and Roleplaying*. I was one of the first contributors to that series. And one of my observations at that point was that as children we had always done role-playing. We were cops, we were robbers, we played house, we played cowboys and Native Americans, we played at being in the Army fighting World War II again. So, we were already role-playing, and we were making things up as we went along, including our interactions. We didn't need rule sets. But, as we got older, as we got into our late teens and twenties, suddenly we needed some kind of structure superimposed on our play, and that's what the *D&D* rules delivered. Suddenly, we were playing those childhood fantasies again, but in a structured environment.

Tavis: And so, when the gateway to adventure opened, you had already had some experience with other kinds of adventures and the comic book you were doing, you had already been working collaboratively.

Jennell: Right. I always found that when I was working back then, I worked better if we bounced ideas off each other. My partner-in-crime then was J. Mark Hendricks. We'd been friends since my junior year of high school. And, that's how we worked together. So here we were in our second year of college together, at the same school. We sort of knew how

each other thought and processed ideas. We were able to bounce ideas back and forth, and we ended up with the idea for this magazine. It was something I always wanted to do. It was my natural first step, and he joined me in that first step. Mark wrote some stuff for it, but I ended up doing most of the game content. Whether or not I was good at it or not, at the time, I ended up doing the game content.

Tavis: With the *Dungeons & Dragons* rules, those three little brown books, a number of the illustrations in those rule books have been shown to be, basically, copied from comic books.

Jennell: Oh yeah, that's right. In fact, I think people have traced back pretty much everything in there to one comic or another, whether it was a Jack Kirby comic, or *Dr. Strange*, or whatever. So yeah, I understand Gygax was very adaptive.

Tavis: And so, did you look at that and think, "I can do better?"

Jennell: Oh, absolutely. I absolutely looked at that and said, "Yeah, I can do better than that." By that point, I was already doing black and white illustrations for Space Gamer magazine. My illustrations weren't great. They were, what I called filler artwork: stuff I dashed off on a piece of sketch paper and sent in to get store credit so I could buy games. But, yeah, I looked at that and said, "Yeah, I can do a lot better than that." And I would say, for the most part, most of the stuff I did was better.

Tavis: Right, it was not a very high bar.

Jennell: See? See? Most of the stuff I did was better.

Tavis: Looking on to *The Dungeoneer*, and looking at the editorial on the publisher's statement, I was struck by your

mentioning Space Gamer magazine. And, that later becomes Games Workshop, right?

Jennell: No, Games Workshop had as their fan level zine the *Owl and Weasel*. And that later became the *White Dwarf*.

Tavis: And it was in *White Dwarf* that you read about *Dungeons & Dragons*?

Jennell: No, it was in *The Space Gamer* magazine. Let me trace back the actual story. I was working as an announcer in our college radio station. I worked the evenings. It was basically my job during college. And one night, my younger brother Bruce called. My brother was the gamer in the family. I enjoyed the games, but he was The Gamer. As such, he subscribed to *The General* from Avalon Hill, and I think he may have subscribed to the Complete Strategist. He played the board games and he really enjoyed the military board games. As far as I know, he still does. Because he was a subscriber to *The General*, Metagaming Concepts sent him a copy of their house magazine, which was called *The Space Gamer*. Now this was 1975, and it was the second issue. There were mostly articles about Metagaming's games, but, there were also a lot of articles and reviews about other people's games. I think one of them may have been written by Michael Stackpole. But, they talked about this game, *Dungeons & Dragons*, in the reviews, and my brother read me these two reviews over the phone. And as I listened, it's one of those things where you can actually recognize a point at which your life just changed. That's how much of a pivot point in my life that that phone call from Bruce was, because, I had found something that I wanted to devote my time and energy to, which was getting these game rules and playing them.

Tavis: And that's been a life-long endeavor for you. You went through that gateway and never came back.

Jennell: I never came back. Except for working for some non-gaming clients over the years, I have been in games since 1975.

Tavis: And, there's so much more territory there now than there used to be. Your work has spanned table-top role-playing games, computer games.

Jennell: Miniatures, digital electronic games. I've had at least some degree of a hand in, just about everything in entertainment gaming over the past 40 years.

Tavis: And some of those companies have gone on to be big businesses. It strikes me that in your editorial, you say that you should maybe write a letter to the guys who published *Dungeons & Dragons*.

Jennell: Remember, this was written by a 19-year-old kid. Let's not put a whole lot of weight on things here.

Tavis: But at the time the, the qualitative distance between your zine and this other little set of similarly sized booklets that were published by people in the next state over doesn't seem that great compared to the behemoths that gaming publishers have become nowadays.

Jennell: Well, it was, literally, a hobby. I mean, it was hobby publishing. Even TSR, with their magazines, were still hobby publishing. The big boys at that time were over on the East Coast. SPI and Avalon Hill were making the slick board games, while the fantasy side was just starting with TSR and Metagaming Concepts. And, out on the West Coast, the big publisher was Chaosium. The rest of us were all hobby level publishers. *Dungeons & Dragons* came in a box, but Chaosium was shipping their work out in poly bags. And poly bags were a legitimate form of distribution back then.

Tavis: Yeah, my copy of *The Dungeoneer* has a mailing label to the Argosy Bookshop in Grand Rapids, Michigan, and it's postmarked June 29, 1976.

Jennell: What…wow. Wow. God, I'd love a picture of that back cover.

Tavis: Yeah, you signed it in 2011. You've seen this copy before.

Jennell: Where I wanted to go with all that was, the way we promoted our zine, is I think we had a couple hundred copies printed up. This is what we could afford. We went to a local quick-print shop. I think it was Instyprint. They were in downtown Jackson, Michigan. I talked with them in advance to find out what they needed for paste-up art. And so, we pasted up a double-size piece of artwork, maybe even a little larger than double-sized, that would eventually become the print master for the first copy of *The Dungeoneer*. Setting up the page folds so that it would print properly, when it was printed, trimmed, and assembled. We went down there and at that time, they had that brown cover stock. We couldn't get exactly what TSR had used, but they had this brown, this tan cover stock. So, we said hey, that looks like *Dungeons & Dragons* rules.

So, that's what our first cover had to be. While we were getting things printed, we went through hobby game magazines, looking for any source that we could find that listed an address of somebody who'd played or sold games. We went through my brother's *General* magazines and *The Space Gamers*, just looking for addresses of people. And then we mailed out 100 free copies to those on our list. I'm guessing

Home of The Dungeoneer. From the late summer of 1976 to January 1978, Jennell produced her fanzine out of this dormitory room. She and J. Mark Hendricks had painted the cinderblock walls to resemble Grecian columns as part of a school- wide painting competition. The college provided the paint, so color choices were limited. They took second place. *Photo credit: © 1976 Dr. David J. Gingrich, PhD*

that Argosy Bookshop, or the game shop there, was one of the ones we sent out with that postmark. So, that copy you have is probably from that early date and is probably a first printing, first mailing. That's how we distributed it the first time. I have two memories from what came back from that first mailing. The first memory is that we got at least one, maybe a couple, letters telling us, chewing us out, for sending them *Dungeons & Dragon*-based material, and that we were basically a pox upon gaming and to never send anything like that to them again.

Tavis: Wow.

Jennell: I know. It was like, "Oh, I sent you something free, and you're yelling at me. And you took the time to yell about it in a letter." And then the other was a check for our first subscription, from Jim Ward.

Tavis: Wow.

Jennell: Yeah, Jim Ward was our first subscriber.

Tavis: And then, he was published in *The Dungeoneer*.

Jennell: Yes, he made some contributions for the magazine, including some gaming content that eventually ended up being canonical D&D.

Tavis: So, you made it big.

Jennell: Oh, yeah, we were big-time.Two college kids from Michigan, doing the big-time. We actually got enough feedback, that we were encouraged to do a next issue. I think by that point we may have actually already been in progress on the next one. I distinctly remember, Merle Davenport running a play test of Merlin's Garden that summer in his apartment for us.

Tavis: And you were a…a player for that one?

Jennell: Yes.

Tavis: Do you remember your characters?

Jennell: No. My memory tends to be more geographically oriented than topical. So, I can tell you exactly where his apartment was, I can tell you that it was on the second floor. I can remember how I would specifically get to that apartment again, but I can't remember much more beyond that. We did finish the adventure from what I remember.

Tavis: It's super difficult to wrap one's head around your early design work. The dungeon that is in the first issue - F'Chelrak's Tomb – is pretty complex. I have to go over and study those maps multiple times to try to get the shape of it into my mind. And I wonder if the way that you remember things geographically is related to the ability that you have to visualize these 3-D spaces.

Jennell: It's entirely possible. I don't necessarily have a direction bump in my head. When I go someplace, if I'm paying attention to how I got there, I know how to get home, and vice versa. That's probably it. I do think in terms of spatial relationships between areas in my life.

Tavis: What do you remember about the first time you played *Dungeons & Dragons*?

Jennell: Okay, there's a story behind that. Back before I got my first copy of the rules, I had this friend at school who'd just broken up with a boyfriend. I saw this as an opportunity to at least date her once. She was cute and fun, and I liked her. So we went out, and she was intrigued by what we were doing on the games front. She told me, "Yeah, I've got this friend back in my hometown, and he's a big deal Gamemaster." And, "He's so big deal that he and Gary Gygax don't even like each other. You know, they'll cross the street to avoid each other." Now, whether this was true, I don't know. But what

I do know is that she arranged for Ron Parlette [Phonetic] to drive up to my college on a Saturday evening and run our first game for us. This was probably in February of 1976. At that time, one of my regular hangouts was the radio station. It was a little house on campus that was separate from the rest of the campus. The only reason people had to be there was because they were working at the radio station. Mark and I worked there. We arranged to have Ron run the game in one of the outer rooms of the radio station while other people were in the back. I think one of us may have actually been working that night. So, Ron ran the game, and I… this I remember…I played a magic user. First level magic user, and I got…I think what happened that night was I was killed by an orc, or paralyzed by a carrion crawler, and died. But it was so vivid and like being there in person, and I was hooked. I never played with Ron again, but now, now we had a sense, that oral tradition sense, of how someone else did it, and we could start running our own games based on that oral tradition.

Tavis: So who were the people you went back and played games with, after that experience, and who were the…. Dungeonmasters?

Jennell: We had a small group of us who played. I was one of the Dungeonmasters. I got into this whole designing spaces thing right away. It was something I did as a child, building cities out of blocks. So this game was like a natural extension of what I did in my childhood. And J. Mark Hendricks, who's one of the other publishers of *The Dungeoneer*, was another Dungeonmaster. I don't think that he played in that first game session, though he was part of the core group afterwards, but Randy Cox was a Dungeonmaster. He was one of the guys in my dorm, and later on, my roommate. And then David…a fellow by the name David Marbry [Phonetic] who in my mind will forever be Lychor the Thunder Wizard, the Black Thunder Wizard. He actually wrote something later for the magazine, but he played this despicable, dark wizard. So that was our core group originally, along with my brother. So, we had this very small group, and then it grew, kind of, by contagion. Somebody would see us playing up in the dorms, and next time around, they'd ask to join. And, a girlfriend, or boyfriend might join the party. So we grew, very slowly that way, and had a core group of about a half a dozen people or more at any given time. And that group pretty much stayed loosely together, though not consistently, but we would play together as a group for the next five or six years, from '76, through '80, until things started breaking up because of outside forces. I moved away and some of the other people involved moved away.

Tavis: And things like the "F'Chelrak's Tomb" came out of the games that you were running during that period?

Jennell : They did. They were based on designs in my notebooks. I do not know, specifically, if I ever ran that adventure at that time. There are some other things, other designs, I had at the time that I know I did write because I had play notes from those sessions. I have play notes in the notes I still have. But the "F'Chelrak's Tomb" adventure was really me grasping for something I could put easily into the magazine. Something small, defined, that could be put in the magazine. Something small, self-contained, that could be broken off and used separately. And so I was looking through one of my notebooks and here was a secret passage dropping down through a crypt in a tomb on one of my game levels. And I went "ding" [Bell sound] and it became this self-contained space. So I separated that out from the original tomb, adapted some of the contents a little bit, fleshed a few things out that weren't in the original notes and drew that now, I guess, memorable map. A map which is, essentially, almost exactly like the map I originally drew in pencil in my lab notebook. And that's where it all started.

Tavis: Yeah, looking at those original notes, one of the elements that you took out looks to have been some Norse mythology.

Jennell: That's entirely possible. When I go looking through my old notes, one of the things I find is there are a lot of cultural references or mythology that just didn't carry through in my later writing.

Tavis: It's kind of like those are the founding blocks for your work. You had a solid-grounding in mythologies. Those were the kind of fantastic worlds and cultures that you could learn about at a younger age.

Jennell: Oh, I was a big fan of mythology. Greek mythology, Norse mythology, even some Native American mythology. I forgot to mention that in the notes, when we were commenting earlier, that I read a lot of mythology as a child. And I have things like a lot of the standard paperback versions of mythology books from back then. The actual names of the books don't come to mind, but pretty much everyone was referring to them at the time. I would pull things out of those while I was writing.

Tavis: What was your first exposure to science fiction and fantasy?

Jennell: Exposure to science fiction and fantasy was probably through television. Remember, I'm a child of the sixties. So things that I watched in the sixties included the Mercury

space launches and the broadcasts for the Gemini program. These were a part of my childhood. And then along with that, and probably growing out of that, was the "Lost in Space" program, which I watched religiously, and then "I Dream of Jeanie" about an astronaut, with a bit of fantasy involved.

So these were a part of my first exposures to actual science fiction. Now, the actual science fiction movies, they scared the living daylights out of me. They were just too scary to watch. But the TV shows were fine. I would watch those and then I would check my library out and there would be juvenile novels. One title that sticks in my mind, and I think it might be an Asimov title, but it was a juvenile novel called *"Runaway Robot"*. The title sticks in my head. And then, as I got older, say around the 5th grade, I started reading Andre Norton, too. A lot of her young adult fiction, and, of course, Robert Heinlein's young adult science fiction. I just chowed-down on that genre. Some of them are my favorite books and I still go back to them. But, that was science fiction.

Fantasy didn't really come along for a while. There were a few books by Edward Eager that were among my favorite novels. He wrote a couple of books that I remember. One was called *"Half Magic"*, about some children who find a magic ring. And the ring is like a wish ring. Except, it only does the wish half as much as the wisher wants it to be. So that's the whole gimmick of the story.

Tavis: It's like a group of kids and each of them gets a different day to try out their wish.

Jennell: Right. The almost immediate sequel, that I enjoyed, was called *"Knight's Castle."* And the basic premise in that one was the kids, the kids from *"Half Magic."*, are now grown up and they become successful adults. They've moved to the big city and the kids, now now adults, are visiting their cousins. And the cousins are well off and have all these amazing toys, including lead soldiers, castles, incredible doll houses. So they sit down and start playing with them. Well, it turns out this magical toy, the one that one of the kids brings with him, is a magic item. And he causes magic to happen, and the toys come to life. The kids shrink down and they have adventures with these living toys. Which, in some way, sounds really awesome, but if you really think about it, what an amazing horror story.

Tavis: That's also sort of *Dungeons and Dragons*esque. And having miniatures that were their own gateway to fantasy worlds.

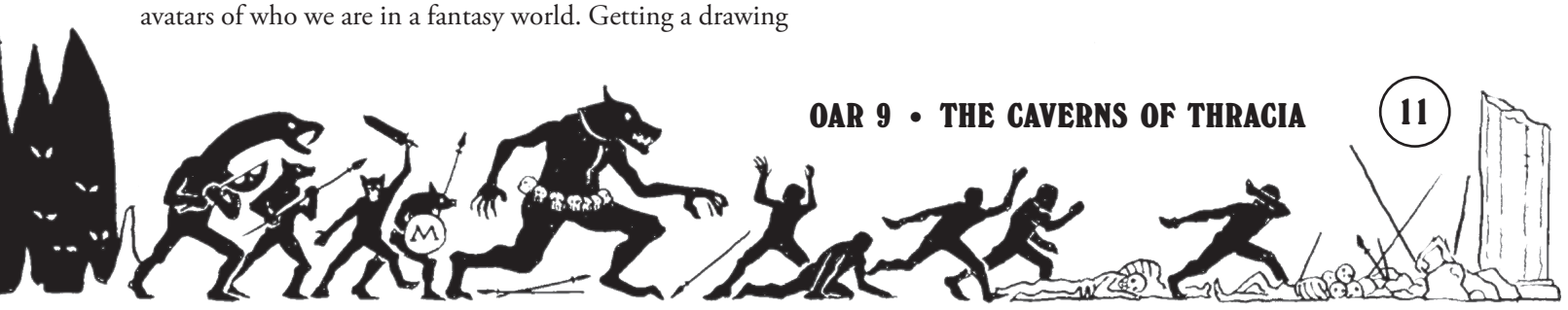
Jennell: Yep, they're the avatars of our dreams. They're the avatars of who we are in a fantasy world. Getting a drawing that depicts the character exactly is a challenge, but mentally going up and through a map that I can draw out on a table, or depict using tiles, is gratifying. You know, I can see this character go thru the adventures and imagine what's going on around them. And also see that I have to move three spaces to reach the troll.

Tavis: Right. And back in the day, you were using miniatures, sometimes, for that kind of visual positioning.

Jennell: Yeah, we did. A lot of times, but we didn't formalize it until later. It was actually after collegeso, I had actually been done with *The Dungeoneer* by this point —when we started using miniatures more in play. The *Runequest* game almost demanded it. That's the game we were playing mostly, at that point. And it was so dependent on more minuscule detail that we started putting miniatures down and counting distance. So I actually made a set of cardboard tiles—and by cardboard, I mean poster board—with grids drawn on them and then covered in a plastic contact shelf paper. So we could piece together dungeons and then roll out the maps. Whiteboard type maps came later. But, we were using miniatures and tiles to determine position, marching order, describe rooms, things like that. Pretty much like how we do it at the North Texas RPG Con now, where, they cover the tables in a big roll out sheet of gridded board and just draw on it. That's what we did later on.

Tavis: And painting miniatures continues to be something that you do. How does miniatures painting relate to the rest of your book? Sort of like commercial art activity and then… where does miniatures painting fit in for you?

Jennell : Well, for me, painting miniatures was another outlet for creativity. One of the things I've found through my career is I always need to be doing something creative. And if, at the point in my career I'm at, my job responsibilities aren't particularly creative, I look for something else to do that's hobby related. So, when I was designing our role playing games, that was both my work and, to some degree, it was my hobby. But I also started painting miniatures as a way to have an artistic expression that was non-commercial. And then later, when I was working in electronic gaming, afterwards at Coleco, painting became my creative outlet, because by the time I was working at Coleco, I ended up being a manager responsible for people, not doing creative design or art anymore. So I started painting miniatures as an outlet. And the bulk of my miniature painting from that time in my life came in a three or four year span while I was at Coleco. [Exhales]



The new few years saw a lot of changes in my life. Kids came along, full time employment ended…twice. I began freelancing, and family responsibilities…having to work, you know, 12 hour days, 7 days a week to make ends meet. So the miniatures and the paints got put away. Everything I was doing from that point forward was creative work, commercially, and it would be that way for the next…God, that was, what 1984? So let's say the next 30 years. [Laughs]

Tavis: [Laughs]

Jennell: And then recently, I've gotten back into freelancing art and design again, and that's work that fills both creative outlets: commercial freelancing and hobby-driven work. I mean, for a lot of people that's fun. For me, that's my work. That's my job. So I want to do something that's not my job that's still creative. And, for me, I said, "okay let me start getting back into collecting miniatures" when I started doing concept work for miniatures manufacturers. Not sculpting the miniatures themselves, but doing drawings that the scupts would be based on. So that was…doing art. That was me doing my work.

Based on that, then, I said, "Okay, well, I would like copies of these miniatures I'm designing." And that led to collecting miniatures again. And I thought, "You know, I really enjoy doing this." And then one of my clients not only gave me some of their miniatures, they gave me a whole set of paints to work with. So I painted. The first thing I did was I painted some of their miniatures up, just to show what their minis looked like. And that got me back into painting and I found, "Boy this is really fun again." So I have…I have intentionally created the separation…a separation between what I do for work, which is art, illustration, design, maps, commercial marketing copy…all this sort of creative work. But then I balance it out by allowing myself the latitude to do it as a hobby. "Okay, my painting miniatures hobby is for me. I am not going to do this professionally. I'm not going to allow people to pay me to do this. This is all for me. This is my hobby." Now, sculpting a few occasionally for work, that's different. But, painting miniatures, it's my fun. So, that's kind of what I do. And right now I'm not even really gaming any more. I'm writing games, but not playing much. So, the miniatures are just a form of creative expression for me.

Game On! After college, Jennell's D&D game group met in the basement of Dr. Mike and Joanne Grebner's home in Jackson, MI. The group was so large, that Merle Davenport and Jennell often co-DM'd the same adventure, running two different groups in it simultaneously. Photo Credit: Unknown

Tavis: Pivoting a little, let's talk about dungeon design.

Jennell: Okay.

Tavis: How do you get started?

Jennell: Back then, I usually would come up with a core idea of something I wanted to express. When I was just a gamer, I would just start drawing maps. You know, stringing interesting shapes together, and placing interesting hallways next to each other. And the characters would just go and explore, and I would fill in spaces with content that I thought would go with it. When I started designing dungeons professionally, even for *The Dungeoneer,* I started to think in terms of end goals and final rooms and encounters. And maybe even a little balance. So I started building spaces more with an idea for an end goal. And my first commercial design, *"Dark Tower",* was entirely about that sort of design intention. I had this idea for the story—it was drawn from Robert Howard's Conan story, *"Red Nails"* —with these two factions trapped inside a citadel for their own reasons. So I put these two factions together, in this case, the Cult of Set and the followers of Mitra, which were drawn from the Conan mythos, unofficially. I pulled it out of *Deities, Demigods and Heroes.* And drew a map where I knew that my end goal was this final encounter in the capstone of the dark tower…the black tower…the Dark Tower. And everything built towards that final conclusion.

I used that same design approach in *The Caverns of Thracia*. I had an idea where I wanted the adventure to end up. I had an idea for a few things I wanted to happen in the middle and then I just drew maps and filled in along the way. *The Book of*

Treasure Maps was much more tightly-focused. I think that was one where Judges Guild asked me to work on an overall theme: "Okay, Bob Bledsaw has this idea for a product and he wants you to do it." I wasn't real crazy about it but they said, "Okay, this is your next assignment." And it was that they wanted a book of short adventures, mini adventures, that were all centered around a player handout of some kind—that's a map—and that was my core idea. The way I generated ideas for that publication is that I sat down in an afternoon at my home office—I was not on site at Judges Guild at that time—and I just spewed out a bunch of ideas that sounded like interesting titles for either stories or adventures. I wrote them all down, and then I went through and, one by one, picked out ones that sounded interesting. You know, that sounded like an adventure. And I wrote a very short focused adventure for those I had picked, based on that setting. And that's where those adventures came from.

And then I had one left after that called *The Hellpits of Night-Fang,* which didn't get used in the original set for "The Book of Treasure Maps" but which then became my first *Runequest* adventure that I wrote for publication, for Judges Guild. So, actually, *Hellpits* was very focused. These adventures were all billed around the idea of a soft key dungeon set in or near a ruined city, where you have a set of ruins and a lot of buildings but nothing in the dungeon was fixed as to its specific geographic location. That was all up to the game master either to do on the fly or in advance.

So, whenever somebody played through any of those adventures that contained mini-setting information—and we're talking *Dark Tower* and *Caverns of Thracia* most specifically, here—that in the setting they may encounter the same things others have encountered, but they're not going to encounter them in the same order. So, the dynamic relationship of the encounters becomes part of the actual way the adventure is designed. And how that plays out with any particular group depends on the interactions between the judge and the players as their characters.

Tavis: You mentioned factions and certainly in *Caverns of Thracia* and in *Dark Tower,* the ways that characters interact with the factions can have varying effects.

Jennell: Right.

Tavis: Those interactions with the factions will turn out very differently, depending on the interactions themselves. Where did that design concpet come from? Was that something that was coming up in your home campaigns, before *The Dungeoneer*?

Jennell: No, not so much. I mean, it did happen to some of my players later on, but they would choose sides. How should I put this…my players didn't always play nice together with each other.

Tavis: They were their own factions.

Jennell: I'm just going to use an anecdote here to demonstrate. There was a cover I did for *Dragon Magazine* years later that was called, "Cryson's Reward." It showed this knight in chain mail being dragged off into the darkness by goblins. And it looks as though he was reaching out for what looked like some kind of magic item. A bottle, maybe, like, he was still focused on that prized magic item. And then in the distance, past some ruins you could see the rest of his party looking around, saying, "Dorothy…Dorothy…Where are you, Dorothy?" So, he had purposefully gone off on his own, separated himself from the others. He had split the party and he was earning his reward for it. Well, that was based on one of the players in my group. And the character name was Cryson.

I have talked about "Lychor" the dark thunder wizard. That was another character we had back then. He would go off and take independent action a few times every game, unbeknown to the rest of the party, because I actually encourage that sort of thing. If somebody wanted to do independent action, they pulled me out of the room and we talked through their actions in a way that the rest of the party didn't know what was going on. And then everything would get back together again. Or they would find a corpse or whatever. So I had that happen a few times, but the actual factions, like in "Dark Tower", that literally grew out of that Robert Howard story *"Red Nails",* were part of the design intention I constructed. That idea of two groups, locked in combat against each other for no reason except that they know they are supposed to hate each other.

Tavis: And so, it appealed to you on a story level but you also have an intuition for what's going to be satisfying in play.

Jennell: Yeah, I think that's luck. [Laughs]

Tavis: [Laughs] I was struck by that design goal. When I first read through *Caverns of Thracia* I had heard, "this is the greatest adventure of all time."

And so I said to myself, "Cool, I'm going to run it for my group." And, reading through it I was questioning how they would ever discover all these secret areas? And then, organically, they discovered the magic sword of Thurster and its ability to detect secret doors, which blew my mind and blew

the party's. They had this experience of thinking, "Wow, every place we've been there're secret doors behind it."

And I had the revelation that " Wow, you knew what you were doing. You placed a thing in the dungeon that's going to unlock these areas that you've designed."

Jennell : There could be a combination of me knowing what I was doing coupled with luck. You know, just thinking that, "oh, that would be an interesting power for this sword to have." And the rest being accidental and evolved from play. There's a word for it. Basically play, using that which you just discover.

I did put things like that in adventures that came out of my campaigns. There're some gems in Dark Tower that are like that. I think the "Soul of Chaos", the "Heart of Law" and the "Mind of Balance" are what they were called. When you actually look at those magic items, they're artifact level and they're horrific. What they literally force players to do is very interesting. As far as the secret doors goes, my enjoyment of fantasy, particularly fantasy fiction, were stories that began with a discovery. You know, something where the players bump into something unexpected or unknown. And they say, "Well, we could go on this way or we could look behind…what's behind door number one, there." And, door number one was often a rabbit hole that took players in other directions. It may connect back with the original but there was always something beyond that which was worth making the choice.

This is something I've discovered more recently. I was running an adventure I set up using *Swords & Wizardry* rules. And in it, a lot of the characters had the ability to discover secret doors. And what I found out was that it was actually giving too much weight to choices behind secret doors. So instead of people finding these places by their choices, they kind of bumped into them and were aware of them. And so, literally, they would say, "Okay, there's probably something down that way. We'll follow that way." And in the process, they would completely ignore the main path that I had written out. So the design intention I had made impacted the choices they made during play.

So that was a discovery I made and after the playout, I actually went back into the adventure and, since it was something I'm eventually going to publish, I completely changed the dungeon, to de-emphasize the secret door aspect.

Tavis: Based on the experience of how it turned out in play.

Jennell: Two different groups, played it the same way during playtesting.

The Young Royal. Jennell worked with Merle Davenport's aunt to create this costume for a high school Halloween party. *Photo credit: Janet Jaquays*

Tavis: Thinking about books where you know there's a secret door or a gateway to the other world…the wardrobe in the *Narnia* stories comes to mind.

Jennell: Yeah, that was something I didn't encounter until I was an older teenager, when I was in high school. So, that was a discovery made by the friends I made when I moved to Michigan. Before that, I wasn't even aware of Narnia. But it is this whole idea of this world through a magic door.

Tavis: Yes, exactly. Let's talk about the back cover. On the back cover, there's a drawing or a photo of Ye Editor. What's the story there?

Jennell: In high school, my friends and I were into *Narnia* and we went to a high school Halloween party, each dressed up as a Narnia character. And this was my Prince Tirian character. He's one of the characters in one of the last *Narnia* books. But my friends co-opted the best costume parts. My friends had these really cool costumes made with shiny metal fabric that looked like chain mail. But there wasn't enough for me so I ended up using long underwear dyed gray. [Laughs]

So I had this costume and I probably had my brother take a picture of me with a Polaroid. And that was it. So that was the picture of me in my tunic with two wooden swords that I had made. I say wood, but they don't look like wood in the picture. And because I didn't want to pay money to have a photograph screened, I did a photocopy of the original photograph and then made a high contrast inking over a kind of a low contrast photograph. And it printed like that. So I was actually doing some of that for the school newspaper at the same time. Taking photographs and turning them into black and white art.

Tavis: And then, in a later issue of *The Dungeoneer*, there's a picture of the whole adventuring party facing off against a hydra.

Jennell: Oh. Yeah. Did that actually make into *The Dungeoneer*?

Tavis: It's in the compilation of *The Dungeoneer*, at least.

Jennell: Okay, well, that was our game group in college. Near the end of my time in college, we went out behind one of the buildings of the college and the yearbook photographer, who happened to be one of my friends, took a picture of us all lined up like we're fighting a monster. And then he went back inside and, using one of my Grenadier hydra miniatures, he took a picture of that hydra against an all white backdrop and then he merged the two images in the dark room.

We pooled enough money to buy a little ad in the back of our yearbook. And that was the advertisement was for The Fantastic Dungeoning Society.

Tavis: Did you get a lot of players from that ad?

Jennell: No. [Laughs]

Tavis: [Laughs]

Jennell: Well most of the school knew we were the weirdoes already.

Tavis: And so, *Dungeons & Dragons* was on the fringe from the beginning?

Jennell: Yeah, on the fringe. I went to a very small, mostly conservative, Christian college in Michigan. We had a lot of students at the school who were into fantasy, mainstream fantasy, including Tolkien and Narnia. But the fantasy gaming thing was new. Getting folks together to play and talk about fighting monsters and what we did as characters—you know, this whole first person point-of-view, being in the game—was kind of strange to other people. So, we ended up having a core group that gamed together. We used to play in the upstairs lobby of one of the dorms. We were open about what we did, when we could find an undisturbed place to play. It would be afterwards, after we all graduated, that we would start playing at other people's homes.

Tavis: So when you came to Judges Guild, you brought with you, not only experience with design and illustration, but also the knowledge of how to use a lot of those same layout techniques that they used at Judges Guild.

Jennell: Right. Because I had done all the layout for *The Dungeoneer*, I had developed those skills. Once we got into it and the magazine was going, I was the only one with actual production graphic skills. I actually got college credit for that work.

Tavis: [Laughs]

Jennell: Well, it became one of my outside activities, a hobby pursuit, that was beneficial to my academic pursuits. I was taking print making classes during the summer, graphic arts classes during the summer, so one of my art courses ended up with me spending a lot of time working on these magazines, putting them together graphically. And my professor says, "Yeah, what we took into account was your time and learning with the magazine. We counted what you were working on there, towards your grade." And, I ended up receiving an award through the school for my diverse involvement in the humanities. [Laughs]

Tavis: Well, I think *D&D* is remarkable for how many kinds of creative endeavor you can plug into it.

Jennell: Yes, agreed. By the time I was done, I knew how to do the layout. One of the things I studied while this was all going on, one of the things that fascinated me in college, was the color separation process that was used for printing pages with four colors for comic books. So I made a study of that and figured out how to do it on the cheap, by myself. When I went to work for Judges Guild, I was the one who brought them into color printing and came up with a bunch of different ways to get there.

I also take responsibility for the fact that it really did depend on whose hands were doing the color, for how things turned out in the printing process.

Tavis: You mentioned, *The Hellpits of NightFang* a minute ago.

I remember you ran a game, I think it was at North Texas, where, afterwards, you showed us the map. And parts of it had come from *Hellpits* and parts of it had come from other adventures.

Jennell: Right. One of the things I ended up doing when I started playing *Dungeons & Dragons* and then transitioned to playing *Runequest* full time, was I started cannibalizing a lot of my older work. I would take bits and pieces from *Book of Treasure Maps*, like the "Lone Tower", and that became a tower up in the village above "Dark Tower." And then an interesting way to get into the "Dark Tower" was to go through the sink holes of "Hellpits of NightFang." So I used and re-used those. I converted maybe most of the first and second level of Dark Tower to use the *Runequest* rules. So I had people being able to go through these separate adventures as discreet elements of a final adventure. And, to be honest, I still do stuff like that now. Not necessarily take other people's work but I take my own work and build off of it. I've got some projects going right now that are based on maps that I did back in the '70s but never used for anything. And they've become the foundation for new adventures.

Tavis: Hm.

Jennell: But I add and subtract and combine with other ideas to, to bring them up to what I'm working towards. You know, I went and read that little article somebody wrote called "Jaquaying the Dungeon." So I would know…

So I would know how to make my dungeons better. [Laughs] Because I never figured any of that out. [Laughs] I just did it.

Tavis: Yeah, it's remarkable what you've designed. Like I said, things that seem to me like design brilliance, you chuck them up to being lucky.

Jennell: I feel that way. [Laughs]

I feel that way a lot. I got lucky and I said, "Oh, this looks interesting." And I ran with it.

Tavis: And then when you're sort of remixing a map, the things you're using, you're choosing elements from your own earlier work, maybe because you know them well? They're sort of already in your toolkit?

Jennell: One, I'm lazy. I'll go back through earlier works and say, "Okay, this is an interesting set of relationships between rooms and spaces, or this is an interesting concept for an encounter here." And I never did anything else with it. You know, it didn't appear in any of my published maps. So I would adapt that. I would match the scales to the other things and it would become the core. It's become the core element of one of my levels. I don't know exactly what I'm doing with it, yet, but on paper it looks really great. [Laughs]

Tavis: [Laughs]

Jennell: And for a good map, that's a part of it. You're inspired by the shapes, you're inspired by how you move through it visually. And this is actually in a map that is one of the few levels from the one I'm working on that is actually a flat map. I almost have none of those (flat maps) in my games. But this one was inspired, it had another interesting feature in it, either a lava pool or a boiling water pool, something. It just kind of asked to be made into a big, flat map. But I'll grab bits and pieces…

Tavis: In your campaigns, as a player, did you make maps of the environment? Was that common in your group?

Jennell: We would do a map as we went, as characters. It was just usually one person who got designated as the mapper, and it wasn't always the best artist in the group. It was the person who we kind of trusted to pay the most attention, and put it down on paper. [Laughs]

Tavis: So you have old maps that you designed and then you have old maps that you made of other people's adventuring locales.

Jennell: Right. And they were player maps.

Tavis: Did having complex vertical and 3D spaces pose a challenge for that kind of in-game mapping?

Jennell: Oh, of course. So I do understand that maps like I design do present conceptual challenges to players. But I think it forces people to think differently. One of the things I found out later on when I was doing first person shooter maps for *Quake* by Id Software and beyond, is that we would start our simplest game levels by having everything on the same level. Simple connections, simple movement, everything was obvious. And then you would move up slowly with just a little bit more conceptual difficulty each time, until you finally got to the point where you could expect the player to look up, down, left, right. And then you'd work towards getting them to move through vertical space. And that's how when got an advance point, in the games. But that's not

something that you start people off with. You've got to have the basics down solid first. And I think fantasy role-playing games, that is to say, tabletop games, are much the same way. You start people off in a flat room or flat connection rooms and you don't expect them to start climbing 500 foot vertical shafts until a little further into their play experience.

Tavis: Your body work created an awesome, transformative effect, in play. It's still amazing and brilliant, even now. Your work was leaps ahead of everything else from that period of time.

Jennell: Well, I think it forced people to think in another dimension. And that's one of the things that it did that people weren't used to at that point. We look back, with nostalgia, at what we today call the mega dungeon, and that was foundational. I think Alan Grohe has been running a big *Greyhawk* campaign for many years. He's got this massive dungeon and he adds to it every year, but it's mostly these big, flat geometric maps, which kind of represented the way we did maps back in 1976 through '78. They were just big, sprawling complexes and you could move from room to room and really didn't need to think much beyond, "Do I search the wall for the secret door? Or a trap?" As opposed to, "I open the door and there's a yawning chasm. Do I leap across it or do I climb down it?"

Tavis: Yeah, "and which other parts of the dungeon could I see if I go down a little bit more into this chasm?

Jennell: Right. Now, the interesting thing is, a lot of this was inspired by just the hints that Gary Gygax had in "The First Rules" and in *Greyhawk*, where he was describing some of the things he would put in his dungeons.

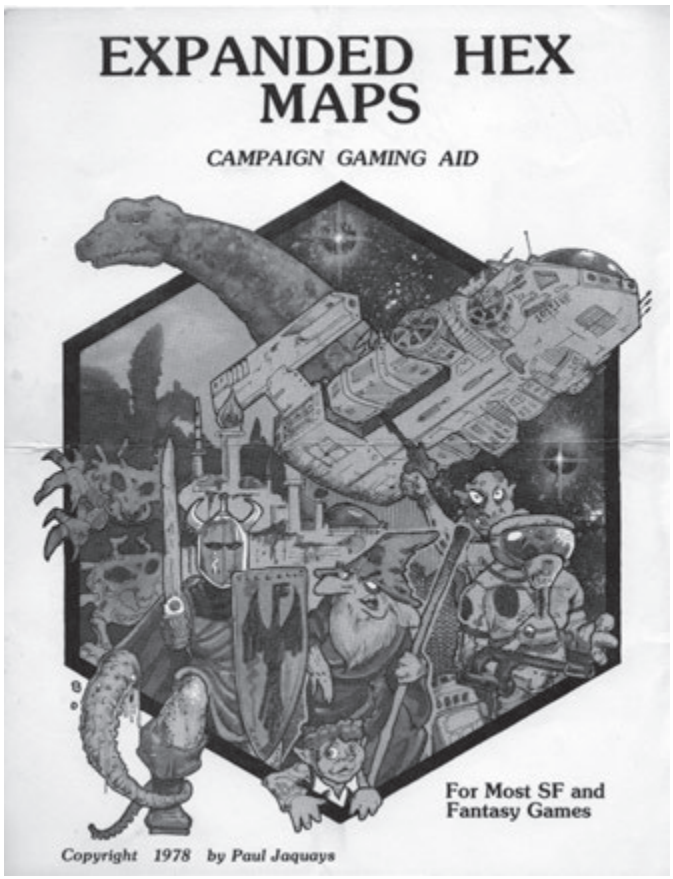
Tavis: I was thinking about that very thing, trying to imagine what it would be like to come at *D&D* fresh.

Tavis: You guys had the actual rules for a little while before somebody showed you that, in fact, they were transmitted by the oral tradition as much as by the written word.

Jennell: Oh, yeah, we were actually doing it wrong, up until Ron ran that first game for us using the official rules.

We were taking the stats in *Chainmail* literally, because there was no real separation point between *Chainmail* and *Dungeons & Dragons*. There was no real understanding of how things worked back then.

Tavis: Yes, the explanation of "Dungeons" in "The Little Brown Books" is almost entirely puzzles with which to confuse mappers.



Expanded Hex Maps. After graduation from college, Jennell worked for Arrowswift printing in Jackson, Michigan. While there, she created a hex map pad that she intended to sell at game conventions. Unfortunately, the print shop lost its walk-in business due to sewer work, and had to let staff go. They gave the printed and padded hex-maps to Jennell as severance. The cover art was later colored by comic colorist Steve Oliff and used as a Different Worlds magazine cover.

Jennell: Which is kind of both an interesting challenge and also totally sucky. [Laughs]

Because if you make things too difficult for people right up front, they don't have fun. You want to ramp up the challenge as they become more confident and skilled. So that they're the ones who start thinking, "Um…ooh…I wonder what she's put behind this door?" And they start talking about it and they say, "Well, it could be this and it could be that." And by the time you're done listening you've changed what's behind the door to make their worst nightmare come true. [Laughs]

Tavis: Right.

Jennell: But when they open the door they're ready for it because they already thought about it.

Tavis: Yeah. And then, if you have a situation where people see too many secret doors, that sort of anticipation goes to waste.

Jennell: It does. And I'm probably guilty of putting in too many secret doors sometimes. So that's the balance you aim for, somewhere between too many and not enough. But there's usually one known entrance into a room. There's a purpose for the room that if you can visualize that, if you can focus on the purpose or you can get that out of the way and then realize, "Wait, somebody got into this room a different way. How'd they manage that?" [Laughs]

Tavis: And then it creates a sort of sensation of deepening complexity, where, a room that you thought you knew, you realize there's another way into it and something familiar becomes strange all over again.

Jennell: Right. And you lose a sense of security because you thought you were in a *cul-de-sac* and suddenly you're in a doorway.

Tavis: Right. Well, I think I've pretty much run through my questions and we're also roughly out of time.

Jennell: Okay. And I think you also have lot of writing in the notes I wrote.

Tavis: Between those two, the interview itself and the notes, I have a bunch of material to pour over.

Jennell: A lot of this material we've been discussing is actually my history and since this book is an historical look back at a period of time for Judges Guild, it is kind of an amazing look back at my own history, too. This is just amazing to me that this is a book that literally focuses on one year of my life.

I mean, it—one year. When we reach back through time to the *The Dungeoneer* and I come forward to do the other things I did, remember that I was at Judges Guild just one year.

So, everything…everything that will be in the book kind of balances on that one year at Judges Guild.

Tavis: Yeah, it's kind of a gateway of its own. You know, looking back through *The Dungeoneer,* to the earlier times, and then also looking thru that same prism at all the work that you've done since, you can see the seeds of that creative brilliance there, from the beginning. That's cool.

Tavis: Did you have any inkling, when you were 20 and in college, did you see that future for yourself?

Jennell: No.

Tavis: [Laughs]

Jennell: When I left school, when I graduated from college, I went to work for a print shop. I was figuring I was going into commercial art, and I ended up going to work at a local print shop. I had already been working for them for about a year, as a part-time contractor. So after graduating, they hired me on full-time, with the intent that I would be growing into the business more. I think they were hoping I would eventually end up running my own print shop under their brand. But, what ended up happening was we got about a month or two months into my work time and the city was doing sewer work in the street that the print shop was on. And they ended up blocking off the street and literally cutting off all the walk in-traffic for the print shop. And all of a sudden, their revenue stream went down. Without income you can't keep staff on hand. So I was let go. And, from that point I started working independently for Martian Metals to fill in gaps. And then Chuck, who was at that point, then at Judges Guild—he had taken the *The Dungeoneer* with him—said, "Hey, would you be interested in coming down and interviewing with Judges Guild for a position with us?" And I was thinking, "Well, I'm not working. This sounds really interesting. I like doing the things they want me to do." So I drove down from Jackson, Michigan to Decatur, Illinois, and by the end of the trip, I was working for Judges Guild. And on the way back, I started thinking through the ideas that would become the *Dark Tower*.

And realizing that there was no way that I was going to move to Decatur. [Laughs]

Tavis: [Laughs]

Jennell: Which is a different story, unto itself.

Tavis: Alright. It's been a pleasure.

Jennell: It has been. Take care Tavis.

Tavis: You too.

BACK TO THE DUNGEON

BY Kelsey Dionne

The Caverns of Thracia is my favorite adventure.

It's hard to choose a favorite adventure, isn't it? There are a lot of things to consider. No single element is enough; an adventure really has to have it all to earn the title of favorite.

Awesome art, of course. And what could grab you more than Jennell Jaquays' cover art featuring a mighty minotaur raising its axe overhead in a challenge?

Amazing cartography, too. The maps in *The Caverns of Thracia* beg you to study them over and over. Level 1 is dotted with chasms, rope bridges, statues, chapels, crypts, a pentagram… the maps put you right into Thracia's crumbling environs filled with e-soteric secrets and dangers.

But cool art and maps are not enough to win that #1 favorite spot. We also have to consider writing and design. What is here, and how does it all fit together?

Jennell executed masterful writing and design in *The Caverns of Thracia*, even at a young age and with very few precedents to follow. Some examples:

- History and architecture that tell a story while also being interactive. Peeling frescos of the ancient past that hide secret doors, a blazing fire statue that also serves as an elevator to lower levels, gemstone eyes on living statues.
- Interesting NPCs in abundance. A sphinx you can talk to, dryads who need help, ancient Thracians stuck in a magical industrial refrigerator.
- Factions. Lizardmen who might offer to share their hunted centipedes on a good reaction roll. They hold an uneasy alliance with the beast men and whisper of their long-lost king, a lich-lizard who is hidden away somewhere inside the caverns…
- Mighty cosmic forces. Cultists whose god of death walks these very halls, to be seen and feared up close instead of ruling from some distant Mount Olympus!

And finally, Thracia has an *it factor* that almost can't be quantified. This *it factor* is the weight of all the adventure's elements combined which creates something greater than the sum of its parts. Thracia feels like a real, living place with immense history, opportunity, and stakes.

All of these things alone could put an adventure like *The Caverns of Thracia* into the top spot as a #1 favorite.

But then we get into the final thing that a favorite adventure cannot have on its own.

An adventure can be a technical and design masterpiece, as Thracia is. But to be a favorite, it also has to have a *personal meaning* that transcends the adventure itself. Maybe it was the first adventure you ever ran, or the game where you met your best friend, or something else.

The Caverns of Thracia does indeed have personal meaning to me. It's my favorite adventure because it brought me back to the dungeon when I had drifted away.

To explain, I'll need to take you back to a time before I ever left the dungeon. A time of halcyon summers, bike riding, and paperback novels with oil paintings of dragons on the covers.

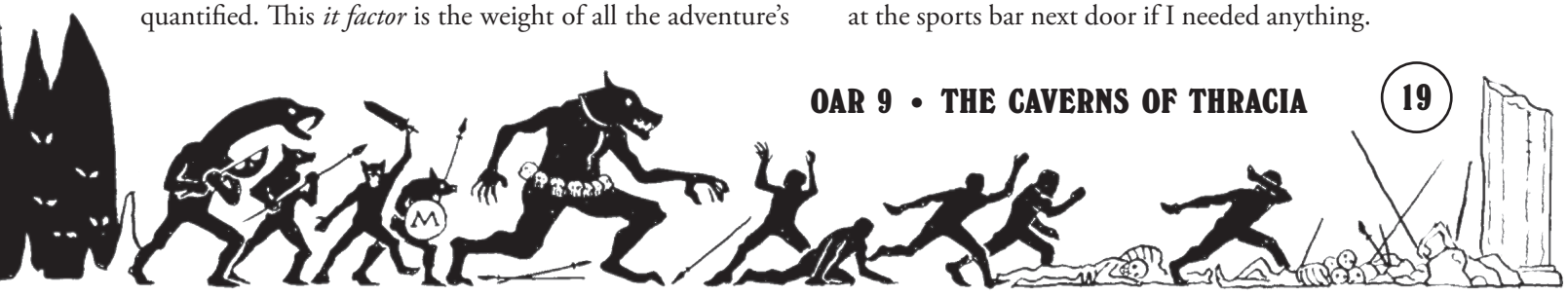
It was the 90s, and I was a middle schooler. Back then, I used to go to the local game store in my hometown to play D&D every Saturday.

I'd get up at the crack of dawn, race through my list of chores, and then beg my parents to drive me to my favorite place on the planet: Merlin's Keep!

Merlin's Keep made my eyes shine and caused my homework to be done and the trash to be taken out before 10 a.m. on a weekend.

My parents took note.

My dad would fire up the truck and drive me into town. Rain, shine, or snow, he'd brave the Wisconsin weather to get me to this place of all-importance. He'd slide a few bucks out of his wallet for me, having learned the pizza-and-soda diet of gamers, and he'd remind me to check in with my grandma at the sports bar next door if I needed anything.



Merlin's, as my friends and I called it, was our haven. You could see the whole space right as you stepped through the front door – two open levels, the upper one upholstered in orange shag carpet and wood panel walls. It was like a 70s movie set, but filled with board games and RPGs.

My friends would be waiting at the table upstairs. Everyone in the store would crow out a greeting, and I'd catapult myself up the steps to dive into a world of adventure.

Our illustrious Dungeon Master, James, ran us through the *City State of the Invincible Overlord* (another Judges Guild icon) and into the dungeons below the city.

We'd fight off ghouls and skeletons, mercilessly loot ancient sarcophagi, and howl with laughter. We were giddy on Mountain Dew, pepperoni slices, and adventure.

Those times are branded on my heart.

As my friends and I grew older, D&D changed, too. The game entered its fourth edition, and the dungeons suddenly seemed a distant memory of the childhood we were so industriously leaving behind.

We went off to college, joined Facebook, and got smart phones. We took tests, unpaid internships, and antacids. We didn't ride bikes anymore. Merlin's had shuttered years prior, replaced by a bakery.

I never quit playing D&D, but I quit going into dungeons.

Now, in our games, we were supposed to embark on the stories in glossy, hardback campaign books. We had to save the world from extraplanar incursions, or something. Quest hook! No more knocking around inside dank tunnels, shouting and laughing about who could grab the magic sword first.

Save the universe and stuff. You hit your quest goal. Level up!

Sometime around 2018, I realized I was missing something in my life.

I began reflecting on our times inside the hallowed halls of Merlin's Keep and the Judges Guild material that fueled those glorious sessions. I knew of a few famous adventures from Judges Guild, especially *The Caverns of Thracia*, but I had never read or played them. This suddenly gave me a lead on figuring out what was missing in my gaming life. I tracked down a copy of Thracia and got reading.

Two days later, I had handwritten pages full of wild scribbles and highlights. Gnolls! Minotaurs! Don't fall off the bridge! Spear traps, god of the dead, teleport pads, down to the river, the sphinx's treasure, the Immortal King… I felt like the kid once again who had just finished her chore list, mind ablaze with dreams of adventure to come.

I was back in the dungeon. I remembered roaring with laughter while jamming pizza down my craw, James bellowing for attack rolls, our cheers of victory, everyone falling into pit traps, our eyes shining with the gleam of gold and jewels… *The Caverns of Thracia* took me back there, and I haven't left it since. These days I'm a dungeon designer, a dungeon player. A person who has remembered something branded on her heart.

So thank you, Jennell, for your incredible life of pulling us into dungeons. Thank you for writing *The Caverns of Thracia*. You have left us a masterclass in the art form you championed.

Turn the page, esteemed reader, and you'll be back in the dungeon, too.

See you down here!

Kelsey Dionne is a new and old-school TTRPG designer who founded The Arcane Library in 2017. Her modernized take on OSR gaming, Shadowdark RPG, launched on Kickstarter in 2023.

THE UNPARALLELED LEGACY OF JENNELL JAQUAYS

by Mike Mearls

I would argue that Jennell Jaquays had a bigger impact on how people actually play TTRPGs than anyone else. Yes, even Gygax and Arneson. Sure, those two came up with the idea of TTRPGs as commercial products that we could buy. That's a huge accomplishment that has affected almost every category of game. But if you look back at the history of TTRPGs, Jennell was the first great adventure designer and, in my opinion, remains at the top of the heap.

Jennell came into TTRPG design with her fanzine, *The Dungeoneer*. It debuted the same month as Dragon magazine. Early adventures like *Steading of the Hill Giant Chief* are fun, but they ask the GM to provide the spice that brings them to life. *Steading* puts pieces into play, but it's up to the GM to draw connections and put all those pieces in motion.

Contrast that with Jennell's work. *Dark Tower* says, "Each time you slay a cultist in this specific chamber, there's a growing chance that Set himself shows up and rampages through the dungeon killing everything in his path. Also, there's a chance that the high-level PCs stumble into this place when it is packed with 0-level, evil cultists. Have fun with that!"

Jaquays was the first designer to understand that the power of TTRPGs lies in giving the players enough rope to hang themselves. She was such a master of adventure design that the industry standard of dungeon mapping is named for her. (More on that later.)

Her adventures are filled with moments that spark delight in a GM's dark heart. Her NPCs are bizarre, funny, and terrifying in equal turns. Her dungeons are filled with moments that make a GM absolutely NEED to run them, just to see exactly how the players dig themselves deep into trouble.

And that's why I say she had a bigger influence than Gygax or Arneson on how we actually play TTRPGs. She understood that the root of play wasn't in managing resources, or matching wits between players and GMs, but in building situations where players and GMs could never really be sure how things would turn out until they played. That's the heart of TTRPGs that she unearthed, and it's the core of the form that sustains it across all games and genres to this day.

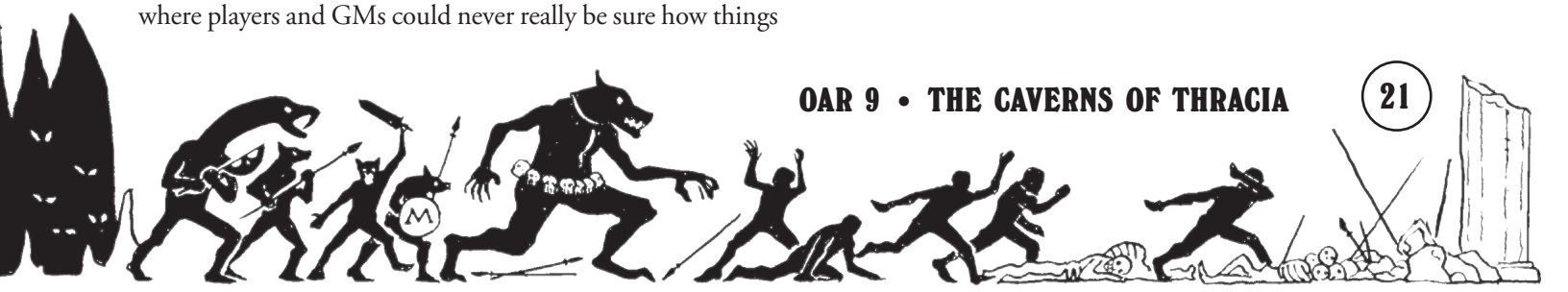
If you republished a Jaquays design today—and thankfully Goodman Games is doing just that—it would rank as some of the best, most original, and most interesting work of the year.

So let's take a look at *The Caverns of Thracia*, Jennell's other masterpiece (next to *Dark Tower*) and the adventure you hold in your hand.

I've been fortunate enough to run both Dark Tower and The Caverns of Thracia at Gary Con. Both times, the adventures ranked among my best con experiences. Thracia is the more accessible of the two, as you can dive into it with low-level adventurers. What makes it so great?

Let's start with the maps. They're so good that the process of building excellent dungeon maps—"Jaquaysing a dungeon"—is named for her. Looking at the maps, you can see why. The maps are easy to parse but filled with interesting nooks and crannies. Gaping chasms in the dungeon promise interesting routes between levels. The water running through level two provides a great, central reference point that makes it distinct from the other levels. The various paths through each level promise a different experience for each group that ventures into the caverns.

But a dungeon map is just a pretty picture unless it has interesting stuff to encounter, and here again Jennell's ability to tap into a heady combination of classic fantasy tropes and gonzo concepts shines through. The first level of the dungeon has my absolute favorite bit of perhaps any fantasy adventure I've read or run.



If you hand me an adventure for 1st-level characters and I see that the first level has stats for a beastie called The Incarnation of Death (yes, with capital letters), then we're in for a wild ride. This terror is accessible to a group that manages to stumble across a secret door or cross a wide chasm. I love that sheer chutzpah of dropping a physical incarnation of Thanatos on the first level of a dungeon made for starting characters.

In my eyes, that approach gets across everything that makes Jennell's work awesome. In other games, dropping The Incarnation of Death that close to a starting area would be frustrating or unfair. But in TTRPGs, where the best play arises from wild circumstances, player creativity, and improvisation, it's an open invitation for a great night of gaming.

Best of all, the Incarnation has a creepy effect that I've never seen elsewhere. It is normally invisible, but a character who drops to 3 hit points or less can see it. I'd be shocked if Jennell didn't come up with that idea while running a game or playtesting this adventure. In my experience it's one of the creepiest moments in a D&D game. It provides a great moment for roleplaying and turns a tense situation into a horrific one.

It's a tragedy that Jennell is no longer with us, but I'm glad that Goodman Games is bringing her work to a new generation of fans. Between her advocacy for trans rights, her role in defining what a good adventure looks like, and her immense artistic talents, she was a role model for everything that is good about TTRPGs. They make us better people by enabling our creativity and letting us become the people we truly want to be. Her work deserves to be shared. If you have any sense, you'll run this adventure for your group and help keep her legacy alive.

Mike Mearls has spent over 25 years designing games. He led the creation of D&D 5th edition, and has also worked on Magic: the Gathering, video games, and other TTRPGs. He thinks Jennell Jaquays is the best adventure designer of all time.

THE START OF "START WITH EARTH"

By Kenneth Hite

At this point men were beginning to develop a civilization comparable to the early Mycenaean or Cretan civilization of this world's past. The art and architecture were almost identical with the above mentioned cultures.

— Jennell Jaquays, The Caverns of Thracia, "A Short History"

In 1979, my game group had been playing Dungeons & Dragons for two years. We had been entombed with horrors and descended into the depths of the earth (but not of Earth, not yet). We had fought giants in their steadings, their glacial rifts, and their halls. And we had marched down endless graph-paper passages populated by wandering monsters, built by the glorious random tables in the back of the brand-new Dungeon Masters Guide.

And then I discovered Thracia. Other designers and critics have talked about its design as a dungeon, its factions of overlapping foes that made navigating the Caverns as delicate and tricky as its teleport rooms. I'm sure I noticed all of that when I ran it, but what really stuck with me, sank its hook into me, was that, in another sense, I didn't have to discover Thracia at all. I already knew about Thracia: I could see it on any map of the Roman Empire, and being fourteen years old and me, I had a lot of maps of the Roman Empire around. A D&D dungeon … on a real-world map?

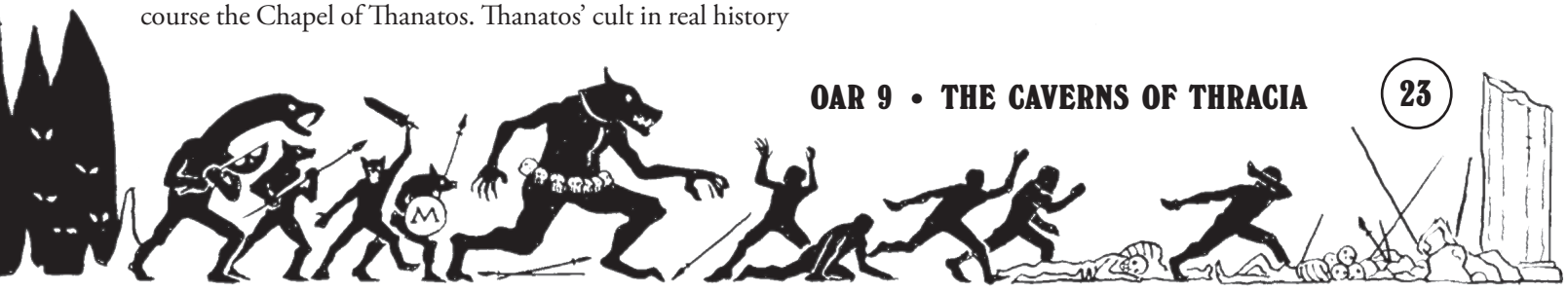
Thracia was, of course, the Roman name for the country called Thrace (or Thrake) by the Greeks. The Greeks named it after its inhabitants, the Thrakes (Thracians, to us), who they also named, probably, after their word for "troublemakers." And that wasn't the only name I found in the Caverns. Thracia's kings Argos II and Agamemnos clearly came from Greek history, with just that decorous "s" at the end of Agamemnon's name to barely disguise it.

The Caverns hold temples of Athena and Zeus, boxes of ancient bronze swords and a gladiatorial arena, and statues of Athena and Apollo as well as the Hellenistic goddess Nike ("imagine the statue 'winged victory' in a heap") and of course the Chapel of Thanatos. Thanatos' cult in real history wasn't much bigger than it was in the dungeon, being attested only in one part of one temple in Sparta and in the city of Gadeira in Spain. But it was real, more real than any village of Hommlet ever could be.

The module feels Greek or at least Greco-Roman, down to the monster list: gnolls, stirges, a living bronze statue of all things, dryads (all with names taken from Greek or Roman myth), the sphinx, harpies, hydra, caryatids, manticores, and the Minotaur King. Sure, there's a wandering gelatinous cube, but it's a gelatinous cube in a Greek dungeon, not a bunch of Greeks in a Greyhawk dungeon. The "dog brothers" seem like intruders on the scene, because their Anglo-Saxon names evoke the module's sense of real centuries of history overlaid onto each other.

This theme appears constantly in the text, embodied by the frozen fighter Epicaste and "near-dead Anteus" from Agamemnos' time "1100 years ago" and reinforced by the near-indecipherable "ancient Thracian language." The flow of warring species, the buried temples on top of dungeons on top of caverns, builds the module's archaeology as you explore it. All this comes from art major Jaquays' studies of art history, and especially of architectural history. "Places had history," she told me in this module before she repeated it to me four decades later, "and you can see that history."

I carried the Caverns' greatest magic away with me, an enchantment for fantasy setting creation that I call "Start With Earth." Although the number of Appendix N entries set on Earth is more than double those set in a pure fantasy realm, nothing had set D&D in Earth (or even a "near-Earth" like Thracia) before. *The Dragon* published articles about history and historical weapons, but had never added gnolls to them. D&D, of course, started with Jack Vance and J.R.R. Tolkien, who set their fantasy worlds in Earth's distant future and distant past, and with Robert E. Howard, who came closest to Jaquays' Thracia with his "Corinthia" and "Cimmeria" and "Pictland" of the Hyborian Age. But nobody at TSR or anywhere else took up the axe where Howard had left it, until



Jennell Jaquays did. She started "Start With Earth." And once she showed me how, so did I.

I had already been using historical floor plans of castles and monasteries as dungeon-drafts, but they existed in the same fantasy no-place that everything else in D&D did. But after visiting Thracia, I took the Hall of Ancient Statuary (41A), set it in a Pueblo ruin near my grandparents' house in New Mexico, and set that ruin in the desert far to the west. Eventually that first dungeon connected up to my campaign's Vezantine (not-quite "Byzantine") Empire, through its mountain-and-desert province on the west, which I named Thrax, after another Greek word for Thracia.

Then I discovered Top Secret and Call of Cthulhu, both of which were set on the actual Earth, and the Vezantine Empire fell not to the orcs or even the Ottomans, but simply disappeared into a pile of notebooks in my closet. A decade later, TSR published the wonderful "green book" Historical Reference Sourcebooks for AD&D 2nd Edition, beginning with David Cook's HR1 Vikings in 1991, with the actual Thrace getting its time on screen in the Ancient Greek HR6 Age of Heroes, by Nicky Rea. In 1994, William Connors did Thanatos one better when he revealed that the Earth (or the "Gothic Earth," at least) was part of Ravenloft in the amazing Masque of the Red Death box set.

In 2001 I reveled in that green-book energy with my own series of seven "Cities of the Ages" articles in *Dragon* #284-292, adding monsters and magic to London and Paris and Novgorod and Edo and Baghdad. It's only now that I re-read Caverns of Thracia for the first time since 1979 that I notice my 2017 sandbox campaign book Qelong (set in a fantastic version of Cambodia) really does echo Jennell's Thracia, from its overlapping armies to its localized monsters to its outlanders with funny Anglo-Saxon names. Twenty years into my full-time RPG design career, and I'd finally found my way back to the caverns where it all started, and where I (and eventually TSR, and everybody else) started to start with Earth.

Kenneth Hite has been designing and writing RPGs professionally since 1991, starting with GURPS Alternate Earths. *His designs since then include* Trail of Cthulhu, Night's Black Agents, *and the fifth edition of* Vampire: the Masquerade. *He was honored to have interviewed Jennell Jaquays in 2023 for his long-running podcast with Robin D. Laws, Ken and Robin Talk About Stuff. He lives in Chicago with his wife Sheila and two cats.*

DOG DAYS IN THE DUNGEON

By James Mishler

This tale of Thracia began long ago and far away, when I was but a youth, and first started playing *Dungeons & Dragons* in 1981. I started with the Moldvay Basic rules and quickly adopted the Known World of the Moldvay/Cook Basic/Expert rules as my home campaign setting.

It was not until I started playing in my high school *Dungeons & Dragons* club that I discovered Judges Guild products and the *Wilderlands*. Our club sponsor, the Anatomy and Physiology teacher Mr. Jim Strange, ran his campaign in the *City State of the Invincible Overlord*. And from my first foray into the city, I was hooked on Judges Guild products.

Judges Guild published many supplements and adventure modules in addition to the *Wilderlands* products. Among these, one of the best adventure modules is *The Caverns of Thracia* by Jennell Jaquays, published in 1979. Being interested not only in fantasy but also in ancient and medieval history, the ancient Greek background of *Thracia* was immediately appealing.

"All characters portrayed within are fictional and any resemblance to anyone living or dead is coincidental. Any resemblance of any monsters herein to any real monsters is coincidental and unexplainable." Thus reads the indicia in *The Caverns of Thracia*.

This is merely the first warning you would get about how truly wild the ride would be.

Another, in the Designer's Notes, was that "The Caverns of Thracia has been designed to accommodate adventurers of the 1st and higher levels. There are some segments of the adventure that will be a pushover for low level groups while one or two areas will send the higher level characters ducking for cover if played correctly."

This designer's note made me feel right at home with Thracia – for, from the first, I mostly enjoyed "realistic" settings, where the world was a mix of all levels of play jumbled together. This is a fantastic way to run a setting, city, or dungeon – provided of course there are plenty of hints that the players might be getting in over their heads. This was the classic Wilderness made into a Dungeon. There is still a distinct overall classic dungeon arrangement of "deeper is more dangerous," but there was a more distinct organic organization to the monsters and dangers. A greater verisimilitude lacking in so many dungeons.

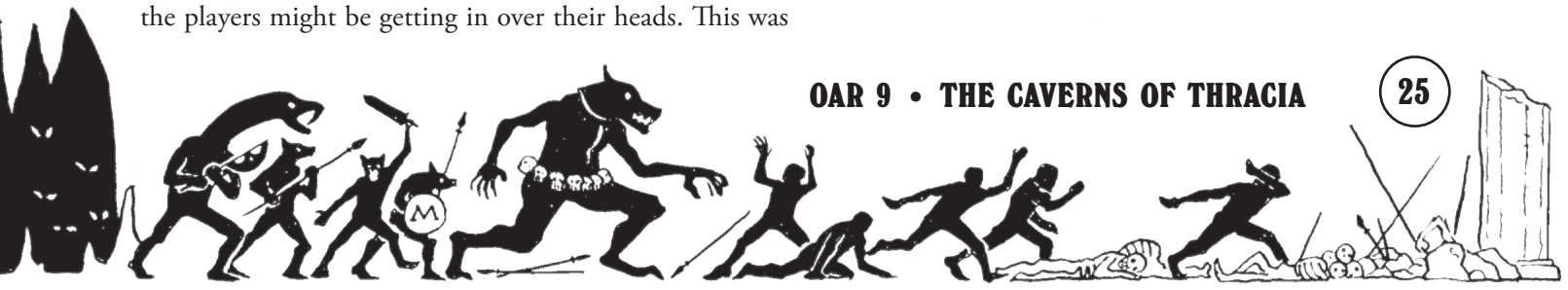
Another element that was drawn, perhaps by chance, perhaps by inspiration, from literary experience, was the relationship of the factions in the dungeon. As Jennell further mentions in her Designer's Notes, "[T]he monsters that are aware of each other in this dungeon are usually working together. The only opposing groups in this game are the humans and the beast men and since they don't frequent the same areas, there is little interaction between them except for constant raiding."

This strikes me as very reminiscent of one of the classic works listed in Appendix N –*Sign of the Labrys* (1963) by Margaret St. Clair. *Sign* takes place in a vast dungeon in which there are a number of factions – sometimes related and allied, sometimes enemies – and yet all of them live together, in relative harmony, even as each strives for dominance. Her other novel mentioned in Appendix N, *The Shadow People* (1969) also depicts a vast underground realm. Together the twain were significant influences on what is termed "Gygaxian Naturalism," as well as the darker, more chaotic nature of the Underworld. I often wonder if Jennell had read these novels and was thereby inspired by her dungeon design.

Whatever their influence, the Caverns of Thracia are vast, filled with ancient ruins, myriad traps, and terrible monsters, especially "beast-men" common to ancient myths and legends – lizard-men, gnolls, minotaurs, and dog-men.

Wait, *dog-men*?

Yes, *dog-men*. Dog-men were actually one of the major races of ancient myth and legend that *Dungeons & Dragons* somehow missed. Known as cynocephali or "dog-heads," they were a mainstay of ancient Egyptian and Greek myths and legends, and also very popular in medieval tales. As was common with such legendary creatures, they were usually placed some-



where beyond the horizon, eventually being found in furthest Asia or Africa.

But they were missed among the myriad monsters of *Dungeons & Dragons*, though we had a similar creature, the gnoll – a hyena-headed race somehow potentially descended from a mix of gnome and troll, or so Lord Dunsany *purportedly* implied. And here they were again, in the Caverns of Thracia, lost for more than a thousand years! No wonder they had been absent from the *Monster Manual*; they were so difficult to find!

Interestingly, the dog-brothers (and dog-sisters) of Thracia exist only through fortuitous happenstance. For, as Jennell noted to James Maliszewski in a 2010 interview on *Grognardia*:

"At some point, *The Caverns of Thracia* was changed from an *AD&D* project to a *D&D* project. I remember the biggest problem from this was that at least one of my beast-men (the Jackalwere) was an *AD&D* creature. Thus, I had to create the Dog Brothers to fill that same role."

This would have significantly changed the adventure, as jackalweres, being lycanthropes, can be harmed only by iron weapons or weapons with a +1 magical enchantment or better. That would make them especially tough in a dungeon where most of the local weapons are made of bronze!

But this also explains why they would serve the minotaurs rather than merely rule in their own name – in *AD&D*, minotaurs, at 6+1 HD, can ignore the non-magical limitations of the jackalweres in physical combat, and would be immune to their sleep gaze attack, which has the same HD limitations as the sleep spell. It is notable that two of the three dog-brother magic-users possess sleep spells.

While I have not yet used jackalweres in place of the dog-brothers, I think it would make for an interesting change of pace, especially for players who are familiar with the classic Thracia as published.

Having been the Forever DM, well, *forever*, most of the anecdotes I have for Thracia deal with the grim dooms dealt to player's characters, rather than my own misadventures.

Thracia is one of those kinds of adventures where the judge does not need to do anything to kill the characters – there is more than enough rope in there for a whole party to hang itself! You can just provide the players with the description, and they happily do themselves in. At least, that's been my experience.

No names are included to protect the guilty.

One of the deadliest factors in Thracia is that which it is best known for – its integrated vertical nature, also known as the "Jaquaysing" of the dungeon. In more than 40 years of running games, I've never known a party that did not have at least one player who insists on using any perceived advantage in exploration of a dungeon, especially traversing areas where wandering monsters might be avoided.

In this, Thracia does not disappoint. The hole in the ground in the surface ruins is a 65-foot fall (6d6+2 damage); the chasms on the 1st level are 50 or 80 feet deep (5d6 or 8d6 damage); the circular shaft in the treasure chamber is 120 feet deep (12d6 damage); and the *pièce de resistance*, the basket hole from level 3 to level 4, is a full drop of 200 feet for 20d6 damage! And these are just the major drops, not including myriad other pit traps.

If there were a hall of fame for death in Thracia, "Death by Splatting" would be at the top of the awards list. Chalk it up to so many thieves having far too much faith in their ability to climb walls, and other party members in their belief in the strength of their rope!

One of my favorite uses (*abuses*?) of the verticality of Thracia has been the descent in the basket from level 3 to level 4. I've always envisioned it as a cage-like open basket… and with harpies in the minotaur's service, that makes for a *lot* of fun! Being that the only way for the players to use the basket is to the split the party, with several characters cranking the basket down, you actually have two targets for the harpies… the victims sitting in the basket and those up top cranking the device, who can be grabbed and dropped down into the caverns for the full 20d6 damage!

Splat!

Following deaths by "rapid descent to the dungeon floor," the traps are some of the more memorable events. There are no less than 53 discrete traps in Thracia, most of them quite deadly, and only a few of the petty annoying sort.

The deadliest – yet easiest to avoid – has to be the skeleton animator in the "Burial Vault." An enchantment that keeps creating 1d4 skeletons per round up to a total of 400 skeletons? It is positively diabolical, as you know the players are going to want to go for the chest deeper in the room… and then get caught between the skeletons and the chasm to the north!

Yellow mold can be found in not one, but two locations in the caverns. When first introduced to new players long ago, this made for an excellent trap – simply describe any object covered by the mold as "appearing to be made of gold," and watch the mad scramble for death. Of course, old salts now rarely fall for that old chestnut, but many of these newer players are not yet so jaded as to carefully prod any "gold" object with a 10-foot pole – if they even bothered to bring one!

"Dibs on the gold skull!" *yoink* "Wait, dust… what kind of *dust*?"

And then there are the new, interesting, hybrid trap-monsters (monster-traps?) the Disembodied Mouths of the "Seemingly Abandoned Treasure Vault" and the "Treasure Trove of the Minotaur King." I never did get the chance to ask Jennell if these were inspired by the lips from the opening of the *Rocky Horror Picture Show*, though that is how I have always imagined them.

"I'm a wild and an untamed thing. I'm a bee with a deadly sting."

A *psychedelic* way to die.

There are also plenty of monstrous ways to die in the Caverns of Thracia. *Beastly* ways, in fact, as most of the monsters are *beast-men*. There are 553 *significant* monsters in the dungeon – not counting general non-combatants, such as dog-brother pups or minotaur calves, nor the 200 some bats, nor 100 baby giant spiders (!!!), nor the *potential* 400 skeletons in the "Burial Crypt." 289 of these significant monsters are adult combatant beast-men, the primary monstrous focus of the dungeons.

Beast-men include lizard-men, gnolls, dog-brothers, and minotaurs. The largest contingent is the 143 gnoll warriors, which make the backbone of the Minotaur King's forces. There are also 79 lizard-men mercenaries, seven dog-brothers, and 11 minotaurs (not including leader types). In D&D terms this is a veritable army of beast-men. And they are an army – though mostly of the chaotic sort, they are well organized and generally united.

Fortunately for the player characters, these are spread out over many of the more than 120 rooms of the dungeon. But no few players underestimate their unity and potential for concerted effort, especially if they have cut their teeth on other classic low-level adventures, where many of the monstrous beings of the dungeon do not work together to defend it.

Be prepared to take prisoners and present the players with one or more opportunities to escape from the beast-men. The Minotaur King forcing the player characters to fight each other to the death in the arena makes for all sorts of opportunities for escape – or for a total party kill!

And then there are hundreds of other monsters, ranging from a giant wolverine and trained bears to a five-headed hydra, a giant gnome, and an immortal lizard-gargoyle lich king! The wild and wooly variety of monsters that can be encountered in Thracia is amazing. There are some monsters that are just purely lethal and apparently exist only as opportunities for the game master to perform encumbrance audits on characters, as they are going to want to be able to run as fast as possible – I'm looking at you, Bronze Incarnation of Death!

Of course, it's hard to run from death itself when he has put the whammy on you with the *paralyzing ray* out of his eye…

Your players will never forget their adventures in *The Caverns of Thracia*. Death lurks behind every turn. In order to earn their forgiveness, you might want to get them a shirt that says, "I died in the Caverns of Thracia and all I got was this awesome T-shirt!"

James got his start with role-playing games with the Moldvay Basic Dungeons & Dragons Boxed Set, which he received for Christmas in 1981. He was hooked on gaming almost instantly and sent in his first authored materials – three monsters, hand-written on lined paper – to TSR in April 1982. He received a very lovely rejection letter later that year. James spent many years working for various game companies in just about every capacity. His crowning achievement was licensing the Wilderlands of High Fantasy from Judges Guild and publishing his own version, the Wilderlands of High Adventure. Today he continues to feed the design beast by publishing bits and bobs for various role-playing games on DriveThruRPG. He lives in Wisconsin with his very, very patient wife and a gold dragon shape-changed into the form of a cat.

LIVING IN THRACIA

By Scott Moore

Back in the early 1980s, those obsessive D&D fans (I'm including myself in this group) came to recognize the names of Arneson, Gygax, Ward, Kuntz, et al. whenever they appeared on gaming products. These were the Original TSR folks; the legendary minds from which all the greatest RPG products were birthed. Sure, there were lots of folks producing great content at other RPG-adjacent companies (I was always excited to find another Bard Games, Judges Guild, or Mayfair Games Role Aids product, either at my local gaming store or Waldenbooks), but it seemed there weren't a lot of names from those companies that stood out to us at the time.

"Jaquays" was one of the notable exceptions. Although her name would eventually appear on products from TSR as well, Jennell wasn't one of the original RPG company's original founders. She got into "the biz" from what *seemed* like a completely different direction at first.

She started off as a just a regular player while in school. Just like the rest of us who were sitting around, tossing dice in the school cafeteria.

Having already created *The Dungeoneer* fanzine while in college, followed by the classic *Dark Tower* and *The Caverns of Thracia* adventures for Judges Guild shortly thereafter, Jennell had carved out a name for herself among those other legendary luminaries of the early TSR days.

In what seemed like no time, Jennell was creating iconic stories and art and had "made it big" (or whatever passed for "big" in our teenage minds). And if Jennell could make the move from player/student to fanzine publisher to published writer and gaming celebrity, well then maybe there was a chance for the rest of us with our notebooks full of creative ideas and homemade modules!

Those early, imaginative gaming products and Jennell's own creative success were some of the first things she did to inspire the fantasy-loving, awkward teenage me in the realms of gaming and creative writing. At the time, I had no idea how much her influence would continue to impact my life, oh, so many decades down the road.

Unlike many other Judges Guild products which have seen numerous revisions and updates over the years (*City State of the Invincible Overlord* and *Dark Tower* are the two big ones that come to mind), *The Caverns of Thracia* had a pretty limited history in that way. The original adventure, published for D&D, was released in 1979 and went through four printings between 1979 and 1981, with a fifth reprinting by Goodman Games in 2016. The only real expansions or revisions to Jennell's original was Clark Peterson's *Return to the Caverns of Thracia*, run as a Gen Con tournament in 2002 and never published (as far as I know…although I'd love to read it if you ever see this, Clark!), followed by a conversion of the original adventure to D&D 3.5 released by Necromancer Games in 2004 (which I spent months on eBay trying to track down a copy of, having missed picking it up during its original release two decades ago).

It's no secret to the usual band of folks I play with that I'm not a big fan of one-shot adventures. It's rare that I make up a new character to play a single session of a game, unless it's a new RPG I want to learn, or a special one-off event being offered at a gaming convention. I've always preferred campaigns to one-shots and, as a result, my favorite adventure modules were always the ones that gave a ton of detail beyond just the encounter areas with monsters. The mystery of the missing homeowners from *In Search of the Unknown*, the incredible detail of the surrounding wilderness from *The Keep on The Borderlands* and *The Isle of Dread*, the suggestion of a spaceship (!) from *Temple of the Frog* and *Expedition to the Barrier Peaks*…a casual read through of any of these adventures generated dozens of other plot seeds. The core encounters of these modules might provide 3-4 sessions of content (and, players hoped, 1 or 2 levels of experience), but the additional history, surrounding environs, and unanswered questions found in them could provide creative GMs with material for well over a year of related excursions.

This was one of the reasons I love *The Caverns of Thracia*.

Warning: if you plan on playing, rather than running, this adventure, you may want to skip the rest of this article for a bit. Consider this your spoiler warning.

If you do nothing else but run the module as it is written, you have six levels to explore (the lost city and five underground levels); enough material to sustain months of campaigning. However, Jennell included "A Short History" which goes back "before man existed," giving GMs plenty of backstory to incorporate into extended adventures. Unlike many early adventures where there were just caves of monsters out to battle the PCs, Jennell gave us details on multiple factions existing within the cavern complex; plenty of opportunity to ally with (or position) one against another or to develop those "enemy of my enemy is my friend" relationships among the various groups. Heck, there was even an evil cult thrown into the mix for good measure!

Geography-wise, the caverns sat under the ruins of an abandoned (?) city, part of which is detailed in the original adventure but certainly a situation ripe for expansion. "The Taverns of Thracia," more than just a fun rhyming pun, provided details on the legends and rumors one could pick up when asking about the city, so there had to be some semblance of civilization nearby. An outcast gnome living by an underground river provided more seeds for further exploration. An outcast from *where*? Where does the river *go*? Where does it come *from*? Any GM looking to make *The Caverns of Thracia* the basis for an ongoing campaign had no shortage of inspirational opportunities available for further development and expansion.

Even years later, in putting together this conversion, I can tell you the Goodman Games design team had a bunch of fun finding (or rediscovering) interesting little "gifts" Jennell had left behind for us to expand upon, some of which included:

- The aforementioned outcast gnome. That means there's got to be more gnomes around somewhere nearby, right?
- "The Mysterious Missing Chamber:" room 102 was left off the original map for level 4, but there was plenty of open space between areas 100 and 104 where we could fit something. Maybe more than just a room. Maybe a whole mini-complex, like Jennell did for the original areas 40, 45, and 53…
- There are two NPCs named Grassus, both of different ages, and on different levels. Obviously, they must be related. I bet they have an interesting story to tell…
- The river on level 2 can also be reached from level 4. There's also a swamp just outside the ruins of the city. I bet there's a way all that water is connected…
- The "closets to other planes" on level 2. There's probably more we could do with these down the road as well. "Lost the magic that once powered it?" Well, I'm sure it's nothing a call to a good arcane repairman couldn't fix…

In converting the adventure, we expanded on a few of the plot hooks and seeds Jennell "gifted" us with. No matter how many we seized upon, invested players are sure to discover plenty of additional hooks worth exploring and following up on. Using the core adventure as a starting point, the GM gets to flesh out the background stories of all the little things the players choose to ask about and explore the meaning of. That's the really fun part of collaborative storytelling and memorable RPG campaigns!

Unfortunately, Jennell passed away a short time ago and I never got to hear her reaction to the Goodman Games' versions of *Dark Tower* and *The Caverns of Thracia*, both of which I had the honor of being involved with. I sincerely hope Jennell would have enjoyed seeing what we did with her classic adventures and enjoyed some of the directions we went in exploring those little "gifts" she left for us. One of the best "gifts" of all, for me, was just being invited to visit and expand this small section of the Jennelliverse that brought so much enjoyment and inspiration to me when I first discovered it all those long decades ago.

I "lived" in Thracia for over 14 months, working on the conversion for 5e and creating supplementary material for it. Some places consider you a resident if you live there at least a year. I'm going to consider myself a resident of Thracia. I hope you and your players join me as fellow residents in a long and enjoyable campaign. Should your characters eventually retire to tell stories of their tales to the next generation of explorers and adventurers, sitting around a tavern table somewhere down the road apiece, be sure to raise a tankard of mead in honor of our founder.

Scott Moore has been playing tabletop RPGs for over 40 years, joining the hobby during the golden age of TSR boxed sets while attending Hutch Tech high school in Buffalo, NY, where he met and eventually married one of his first GMs, Cindy, who is also an RPG writer.

Over the past two decades, Scott has written for the Dungeon World (Fast Forward Entertainment) and Scarred Lands (Sword & Sorcery Studios) campaign settings, and created adventures and content for both the Dave Arneson's Blackmoor MMRPG and the D&D Adventurers League living campaigns, as well as having contributed to many other third-party D&D supplements. Scott has also written or contributed to supplements for the Dungeon Crawl Classics, Four Color, and Pathfinder RPGs.

Scott first became involved with Goodman Games as a playtester back in the early days of Dungeon Crawl Classics (back when they were still in the single digits!). Most recently, Scott contributed conversions and new content to volumes 7-9 of the Original Adventures Reincarnated product line, giving him a chance to experience the nostalgia of revisiting adventures from his early days in gaming.

Originally from Portland, Maine, Scott now resides in Western New York, home to an active gaming community to which he will forever be known as "Cindy Moore's husband." In addition to D&D, Scott still occasionally runs his TSR Marvel Superheroes campaign which has been ongoing since the 1980s.

STANDING ON THE SHOULDERS OF GIANTS

By Bob Brinkman

If I have seen further, it is by standing on the shoulders of giants.

— Sir Isaac Newton

I've spent a number of years now as the self-proclaimed "conversion monkey" of Goodman Games. Having done the conversion for *Crypt of the Devil Lich* and *Dark Tower*, I'll admit that I was feeling a bit burned out. Conversion work can be great, but there is a time when one wishes to work on their own passions, as opposed to those of someone else. That is why, when Michael Curtis first approached me about another conversion project, I was ready to say no. In fact, I didn't just say "no".

"I've been doing conversion work for a while now so, unless you are offering me something like, I dunno, *Caverns of Thracia…"*

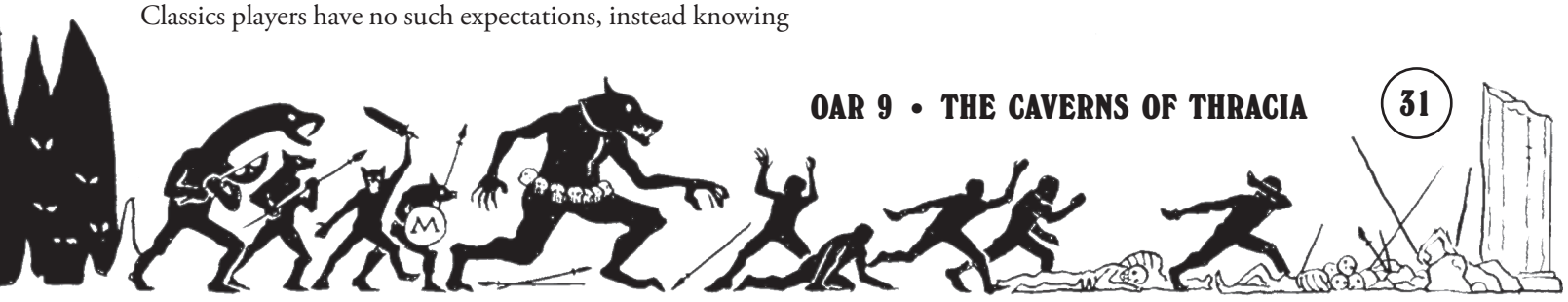
That began my two-year odyssey, deep diving into what I feel is the greatest of Jennell Jaquays' works. What I didn't realize is that it would be singularly different from the conversion work that came before. It would be a wholly unique experience that uplifted the project to new heights.

In the past, my conversion work would begin where the 5E conversion team's work ended. I'd be handed their completed conversion to work from, tweaking text and inserting new stat blocks, while also having a chance to create some original Dungeon Crawl Classics materials. This project was wholly different though, as both myself and my 5E counterpart were handed the task at the same time. For the first time, the DCC version would be built from the ground up, with that system firmly in mind.

Some might wonder why this would make a difference, but I assure you that it can. Dungeons & Dragons 5E has a built-in expectation of balance which, even when not crafted into a conversion, is generally expected by players. Dungeon Crawl Classics players have no such expectations, instead knowing that surviving some adventures will be an uphill struggle which is hopefully capped with a hard-earned victory. This isn't to say that some encounters aren't simple. Key to the conversion is maintaining the feel of the original adventure's theme. If a creature in the adventure already exists for DCC RPG, it is generally just a case of replacing one for the other. Unless the original creature doesn't have special attacks or abilities, there is no need to reinvent the wheel.

While this can lead to some encounters being a bit easier than in the original adventure, in most cases there is little to no difference. The important thing is that Jennell's voice be maintained. The task isn't to make my version of *Caverns of Thracia*, but instead to carry forward Jennell's adventure for new fans. This leaves room for the sorts of things which few modern players have encountered in game play. A trans-dimensional creature which feeds on life energies while resembling an ice-covered door? Don't mind if I do! This is where conversion work begins to get creative.

When there was no existing analog for a creature, it fell to me to create one. That sort of work is sometimes relatively simple, such as when a creature is merely a variant on something already existing but with a few special features. In that way we have creatures such as lizardman fanatics and magma elementals. Other times, however, Jennell was definitely treading new ground with truly unique creations which aren't seen elsewhere, such as the incarnation of Death or the guardian beast. These are moments when the original intent of the creature is as important as how it was originally expressed. The incarnation of Death, for example, is meant to be more than something to be opposed and combatted (one might argue that would be a bad idea), but instead something to inspire disquiet in players and potentially terror in the PCs. Reimagining something like that for modern gaming can be a challenge, and yet is so rewarding at the same time.



Then there is the big challenge, one that will certainly be noticeable in the disparate DCC and D&D editions of *Caverns of Thracia*, the read-aloud text. There simply wasn't such a thing in the original, but it is a feature to which many modern players and judges have grown accustomed. Because the two conversions were created concurrently, so too was the read-aloud text. If you are holding the DCC RPG version, that text was created by myself; if reading the D&D conversion, the text is the work of my esteemed counterpart, Scott Moore. Both of us had the task of drawing upon Jennell's words and her voice and, while certainly differing from one another, the result is two interpretations drawn on the same material. Frankly, I'm quite excited to read the two books side by side and see how our approaches differed.

Of course, there comes a time when we are given the chance to step beyond converting the existing work and have a chance to create new materials to exist alongside the original. It is here where the above quote from Sir Isaac Newton springs to mind. No matter how successful those efforts are, or how much people enjoy them, it is because we were gifted the tremendous head-start of building up from an amazing foundation.

For this project, I was fortunate enough to create a whole new level for the adventure (in keeping with the level numbering traditions of the adventure - Level 2A). This lent an opportunity to draw upon ideas and adventure seeds planted forty-five years ago by Jennell, picking up those threads and turning them into something for a new audience. This is the sort of thing that DMs, GMs, and judges have been doing for their campaigns since the beginning of our hobby so, when doing it for a project like this, it becomes a sacred trust to not be taken lightly. Not only does the new content need to live up to the high standard set by the original, it needs to live up to the expectations of those who have been crafting their own versions for (quite literally) two generations. The key isn't simply creating something new, but doing so in a way where it feels that it was always a part of the project.

I hope that you feel that we succeeded.

Bob Brinkman's work with Goodman Games includes involvement in both DCC Lankhmar and DCC Dying Earth. Additionally, he performed the DCC RPG conversions for both Crypt of the Devil Lich and another Jennell Jaquays creation, Dark Tower. In his "spare" time, Bob is translating an 18th century French volume on demonology for use at the gaming table and is also one of the co-hosts of the Sanctum Secorum podcast. He lives in Indiana with his wife Judge Jen, a library of 6,000+ books, and a pride of four black cats.

CHAPTER TWO

THE CAVERNS OF THRACIA ORIGINAL PUBLICATION

The Caverns of Thracia

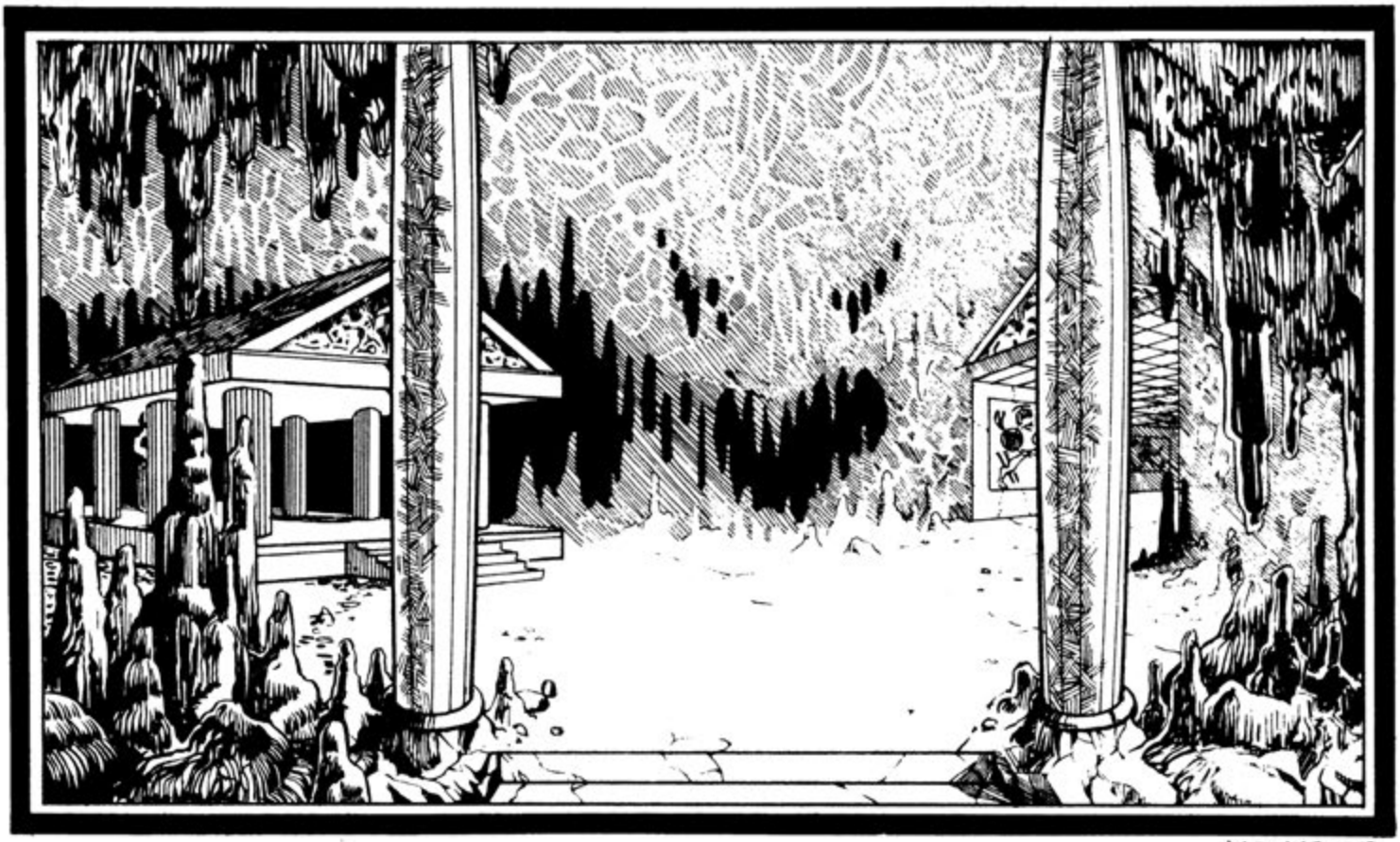
by

Jennell Jaquays

102
*
$6.50

Judges Guild

The Caverns of Thracia



Judges Guild Fantasy Game Aid
and
Role Playing Adventure

written and illustrated
by
Jennell Jaquays

TABLE OF CONTENTS

Forward 5
Designer's Comments 5
Notes for the Judge.....5
A Short History of the Caverns of Thracia 6
Notes on the Thracian Language.....7
Random Encounters Tables and Information 8
Gnoll Patrol Tables 13
Lizard Men Patrol Tables.....14
Taverns of Thracia (Legends & Rumors).....14
The Lost City of Thracia.....16
Level 1 21
Level 2 31
Level 3a.....55
Level 3 62
Level 4 74

MAPS

The Lost City of Thracia.....17
Level 1 22
Level 2 32
Room Complex 40 A–I 42
Room 41B.....42
Room Complex 45 A–I 48
Room Complex 53 A–J 54
Veritical Cross-Section of Caverns.....56
Maps Key 56
Level 3a.....56
Level 3 64-65
Level 4 75

ILLUSTRATIONS

Armored Tribesmen Guards (PJ).....10
Area Around Thracia (PJ + W) 18-20
Incarnation of Death (PJ).....24
G'ruk: Shaman of the Lizard Men (PJ).....34
Giant Spider (KS).....36
Disembodied Mouth & Grasping Guardian (PJ).....40
Grasping Guardian (BB) 59
Old Stone Bridges (level 2) (W) 60-61
Officers of the Guard (PJ).....72

(PJ)=by Paul Jaquays
(KS)=by Kevin Siembieda
(BB)=by Bob Bingham
(W)=old woodcuts

This book was typeset by Penny Gooding and Layout was by Mark Holmer. Both had assists from Chuck Anshell, Bob Bingham and Dave Sering.

Designer's Comments

The Caverns of Thracia has been designed to accommodate adventurers of the 1st and higher levels. There are some segments of the adventure that will be a pushover for low level groups while one or two areas will send the higher level characters ducking for cover if played correctly. As you read through this scenario, and I do recommend reading through it before commencing play, you may notice at times that the designer (self) becomes quite informal. This is intended, since this adventure was not designed to have snob appeal or be the last word in gaming aids. This is now your adventure. I have put down possibilities and probabilities and a few remarks to go with them. It is now up to you to breathe life into the denizens of this scenario. There are no high power artifacts in these caverns and only one creature has very high-power magic use. I would surmise that even a group of fighters could survive in this adventure (although they would definitely miss out on some historical aspects and clues) and haul out a goodly sum of loot. Treasure is purposefully rare (although there are some rather nice ones) and the monsters that are aware of each other in this dungeon are usually working together. The only opposing groups in this game are the humans and the beast men and since they don't frequent the same areas, there is little interaction between them except for constant raiding.

Starting the Adventure: The best place to start any adventure is in a place of familiarity to the characters. Drop a few hints and let the players take it from there asking pertinent questions of the locals and being generally nosey, a pre-requisite for all adventurers. To speed things up, the referee might want to use the section titled, *The Taverns of Thracia*, to randomly assign knowledge to characters.

Notes for the Judge

A) This adventure is not specifically located on the Judges Guild world. It can be, but it is not. Suggested areas for its location would include: A large, misted, off-shore island, possibly once connected via landbridge to the mainland; A ruined city near the edge of a subtropical forest; A ruined city on the edge of a mountain or in large, forsaken hills.

B) I have tried something different in the numbering system used. Instead of renumbering each time a level is changed, I have simply continued with consecutive numbers. Thus, instead of Level 2, Room 23, it is merely Room 50.

C) Some rooms may have to be beefed up or toned down and some of their contents changed altogether if they do not match your world.

D) There are several monsters in this adventure that were created especially for the scenarios presented. They are not to be taken as official D&D monsters, but instead are just local color to foil the rule book memorizers in an adventuring party. Nothing seems to scare someone who knows the rules like something totally unknown.

E) A complete table of random encounters for each level is provided with the adventure. If a wandering monster is indicated, use the chart for that level. If a level does not have a chart, it does not have wandering monsters.

F) Due to the size of this adventure, it is doubtful that it can be played in one sitting.

G) In the **Caverns of Thracia** there exists a religion that may not exist elsewhere. These are the worshippers of Thanatos, the death god or as he is currently called "The Dark One". Clerics in the service of this lawful evil god assume a lawful evil alignment although actual followers need not be of any particular alignment, since death can work through anything. The clerics in the service of this god speak and read in the Thracian language (but not the very ancient language, see history for details). They have the following special abilities: At 4th level they may animate dead as per the spell once per day; at 6th level they may speak with dead as per the spell once per day; at 7th level the may use finger of death once per day as per the spell. These spells are not in addition or extra to their normal number of clerical spells. In addition to the above, the cleric in the service of death may control a number of undead equal to those turned by a good cleric. A cleric may never control more undead than the indicated maximun number of beings that are turnable (2d6 or maximum of 12). A "D" on the chart indicates instant control. A number indicates that the number must be rolled over on 2d8; a "T" indicates control of 1d6 of the undead creatures. Once these creatures are under the control of a cleric of Thanotos, they will obey his or her command until they are destroyed. Undead of 5+ hit dice may make a saving roll once per day of equal to or over the controlling cleric's wisdom +2.

H) Have fun and enjoy yourselves. As real as gaming may seem at times, it's still only a game. Direct any questions, complaints, hate mail, etc. to Paul Jaquays c/o Judges Guild, 1165 N. University Ave., Decatur, IL 62526. If a question or topic is pertinent, the answer may be published in one or both of the magazines put out by Judges Guild.

The Caverns of Thracia
A Short History

This history is not provided to give the players a background on the histroy of the caverns. As far as the players are concerned, the caverns are a part of a lost civilization(s) that disappeared centuries before. Little is known of them except, possibly, its location and a few wild stories (see *The Taverns of Thracia*). Instead, this history is provided to give the referee a historical index of various events that occurred in the development of the cavern societies. It will also include an overview of the cultural development of the early Thracian civilizations.

Before man existed, or possibly before he discovered the benefits and curses of civilization, there existed the reptile race. The reptile race, while not large, had its own centers of civilization, including large cities and underground temple complexes. As man waxed, the reptile race waned, losing much of its arcane civilization and slowly degenerating or regressing into the race of beings that men call "lizard men". A few pockets of more advanced lizard men exist, but they are slowly dwindling as the race dies out. Long before man discovered the caverns, the reptile race was beginning to slip backwards. The Immortal King, the ruler of the tattered remnants of lizard men who still know the ways of sorcery, was near death and had been dying for several centuries. With the coming of man to the area (a new source of food and slaves for the still powerful reptiles) come the death of the Immortal King. But his was not a true death. The dead body remained animated by the creature's spirit. Even in death the Immortal King continued to rule as a lich, entombed in the ancient underground temple. Slowly the reptile race regressed to their present state, but not before they had watched the now plentiful humans discover the caverns and build their own temple and burial complexes. The lizard men at last sealed up the various entrances to their now crumbling great hall and slunk off into the fetid swamps, to return later as mercenaries for the beast kings.

Meanwhile, the humans had discovered the caverns, not realizing that the once feared reptile men (they were merely legendary now and the Immortal King was a bogeyman to scare children) still occupied hidden portions of the caverns. At this point the men were beginning to develop a civilization comparable to the early Mycenaen or Cretan civilizations of this worlds past. The art and architecture were almost

identical with the above mentioned cultures. Eventually they sealed off several of their tomb complexes and began to concentrate on the civilization above ground. Half a millenium later they would construct the temples on second level and 200 years after that they would begin the golden age of Thracian culture.

The actual golden age began with the discovery of an immense cavern, deep below the natural caverns. It was not a natural chamber, but no note was taken of that. About this same time, the Thracian people had begun to use sub-human creaures for slaves, such as the gnolls, minotaurs and dog brothers, who began to carve the underground caverns into a huge garden and palace. During the reign of Argos II the vast work was completed and the underground area became a playground for the Thracian royalty. However, during the reign of Agamemnos, Argos' grandson, the huge number of beast men that laired in the caverns, revolted and took over the palace, wounding the king to the death and causing his gentry to flee. Most never made it to the surface. Those who did inspired either fear or fierceness into persons hearing the tale. The few bands of vengeful citizens that entered the caverns were never seen again.

Thus, did the beast men set themselves up in the underground domain, retaining control of the entire 3rd, 4th and 2nd levels while allowing the 1st level to go untouched. They chose an intelligent minotaur to rule them and then set down to decide what to do with their numerous captives.

Some 150 years later the worship of Thanatos, the death god, was outlawed and the few priests who served death were either tortured to death or were sealed in the chapel of Thanatos on the 1st level.

The first wave of invaders came soon after. On the Sesquicentennial anniversary(150) years of the overthrow of Thanatos, an invading army of barbarians (all non-Thracians are barbarians) was spurred on by descendants of the death worshippers to utterly destroy the city. The lax Thracian army was no match for frenzied barbarians and all but a fraction of the city's population were put to the sword or carried off into slavery. During the destruction, the entrances to the caverns were destroyed and covered with rubble.

The few remaining Thracians attempted to make some kind of reconstruction but less than a quarter century later a second invasion of vicious invaders struck again. Those Thracians who fled into the encrouching jungle survived while the rest died. The few who did escape slipped back into savagery. 200 years later, they rediscovered the caverns and with them they found not only a new/old religion in the worship of the god known only through legend as "The Dark One", but also the beast men.

The beast men by this time had taken over the entire cavern complex (those parts they could easily find without looking hard) and had opened up the caverns to the surface again. With the coming of humans again, they saw entirely new possibilities for food and pleasure. Soon after the caverns were reopened, the reptile race once again sought the location of their legends and in doing so allied themselves with the beast men.

The caverns are now the holy places both for the descendants of the Thracians and for the once powerful reptile race whose degenerated offspring still seek the reason for their existance.

Some Notes About The Thracian Language

The very ancient Thracians had a written language. There are a few instances where it can be found in the caverns. However, between the time of the sealing of the Ancient Thracian tombs and the beginning of the golden age, the Thracian language changed drastically (something like the difference between classical Latin and modern Italian). A character who can read the Thracian language may pick out one word in ten of the Ancient Thracian language.

Random Encounter Tables
(Wandering Monsters)

Random encounters in **The Cavern of Thracia** dungeon complex will be checked for every full turn by rolling a 6 on a d6. After an encounter is determined, the referee should then locate it according to his or her own system of placement. Some of the encounters will be with specific personalities that are already described in the text of the dungeon. A Room number will follow such a listing in the table's below. The encounters marked with an asterisk (*) will be described below. It should be stressed here, that if a "personality" has been killed in its lair or in a previous random encounter it will not appear again on the encounter tables. Conversely, if a "personality" is killed in a random encounter, it will not be found in its lair or location as designated in the text of the dungeon. However, should a creature be only wounded in an encounter, either in its lair or as a wanderer, all subsequent encounters will be with the creature or creatures bearing all wounds sustained and not having the use of any spells previously used (unless there has been sufficent time and/or opportunity for wounds to have been healed and spell regained. If there is a possibility of a creature obtaining healing, it will be indicated).

Because the composition of some groups of wandering monsters would necessitate much flipping back and forth between pages to keep track of individual specifics, it is suggested by the designer that the referee pre-roll several encounters on each level and have them set up and ready to go before the game begins.

The encounter tables below are set up by level with the rooms they encompass in parentheses. Once an encounter has been indicated, determine which level the adventuring group is on and go to the proper table. If there is no table for a particular level or sublevel, then there will be no wandering monster there (and the players breathe a sigh of relief).

Specific encounters on each level will be rolled for with a single d10. With instructions in hand now, have at it!

Level One
(1 - 27B, excluding Room 9 - 13)

1) Gnoll Patrol A*
2) Lizard men Patrol A*
3) 4 Giant Rats*
4) Band of Bold Tribesmen*
5) Gelatinous Cube*
6) Tribesmen Funerary Party (only in Rooms 5 - 27B)
7) 1 - 4 Stirges*
8) Tribes Men Religious Procession (only in Rooms 15 - 27B. If this encounter is indicated religious ceremonies will be going on. See Room 23, Duration: 18 turns).
9) Gnoll Patrol B*
10) Random encounter from level 2 (reroll on level 2)

Level Two
(28 - 53, excluding 37, 39A, 40, 41, 53)

1) Lizard men Patrol B*
2) Gnoll Patrol B*
3) Gnoll Patrol C*
4) 2 - 5 Stirges*
5) 2 Spiders*
6) Ochre Jelly*
7) Band of bold Tribesmen (see level 1 table, No. 4)*
8) Battle between Tribesmen and Lizard men*
9) Living stone statue*
10) Encounter from (roll d10) 1 - 2: 1st level table, 3 - 10: palace table*

Room Complex 40 (A - I): No wandering monsters, until this area is discovered by adventurers. On subsequent adventures, this area may be intruded upon by wandering monsters from the 2nd level encounter table (also see Room Complex 45).

Room 41 (A - B): As per Room Complex 40 above (also see Room Complex 45).

Room Complex 45 (A - I): As per Room Complex 40 above. However, once its location is discovered by adventurers, the monsters will only discover it on a d10 roll of 1 - 2 between adventures or if searching for the location of adventurers who mysteriously disappeared.

Room Complex 53 (A - J): 1 - 2) Special, see below*; 3 - 9) No encounter (small spiders and little insects make scurrying noise); 10) G'ruk, the lizard man Shaman (Room 31)*.

Level Three: The Gardens
(54 - 69)

1) The Dryad Astraea (56)
2) The Dryad Eidothera (60)
3) The Dryad Calliste (58)
4) The Dryad Jocasta (65)
5) Herd of 20 Cattle*
6) Gnoll Patrol D*
7) Troupe of Human slaves*
8) Hydra (Room 70)
9) Encounter from the Level 2 table (reroll on Level 2)
10) Encounter from Level 3: The Palace and Dungeon (reroll on Palace and Dungeon table)

Level Three: The Palace and Level Four: The Dungeons
(70 - 116)

1) Gnoll Patrol E*
2) Lizard men Patrol C*
3) Human Slaves*
4) The Minotaur King and his entorage
5) 2 Minotaur guards*
6) A random Dryad*
7) The leaders of the various Beast Men (Room 83)
8) Lizard men Patrol C*
9) The Clerical Minotaur Cow (Room 111)*
10) Encounter from Level 3: The Gardens (reroll on Garden table)

NOTE I: No. 5, the herd of cattle may be found on the Palace level, but never on the dungeon level.

NOTE II: If a dryad is indicated, ignore Dryad name and treat as a random Dryad and refer to No. 6 of the Palace and Dungeon level table.

Room 117: There will be no wandering monster or encounter in this chamber, but an encounter outside of it will be rolled on the Level 3: Garden tables.

Level Three - A (118 - 126): Any wandering monster indicated on this level will be the wandering Statue of Bronze (see Level 3 - A, Introductory Note).

Random Encounter Descriptions

These are the descriptions and some rationalizations for the various encounters listed above. Some of the encounters will refer to material in the text of the dungeon. Others will refer to additional following tables.

Level One

1) Gnoll Patrol A: see GNOLL PATROL tables below.

2) Lizard men Patrol A: see LIZARD MEN PATROL tables below.

3) 4 Giant Rats: AC:, 7, Move: 12", HD: ½, Damage: bite for 1 - 3 + saving throw vs. poison to avoid contamination with disease. There is a 5% chance that any given rat will be a disease carrier, HP: 1, 3 (x2), 4.

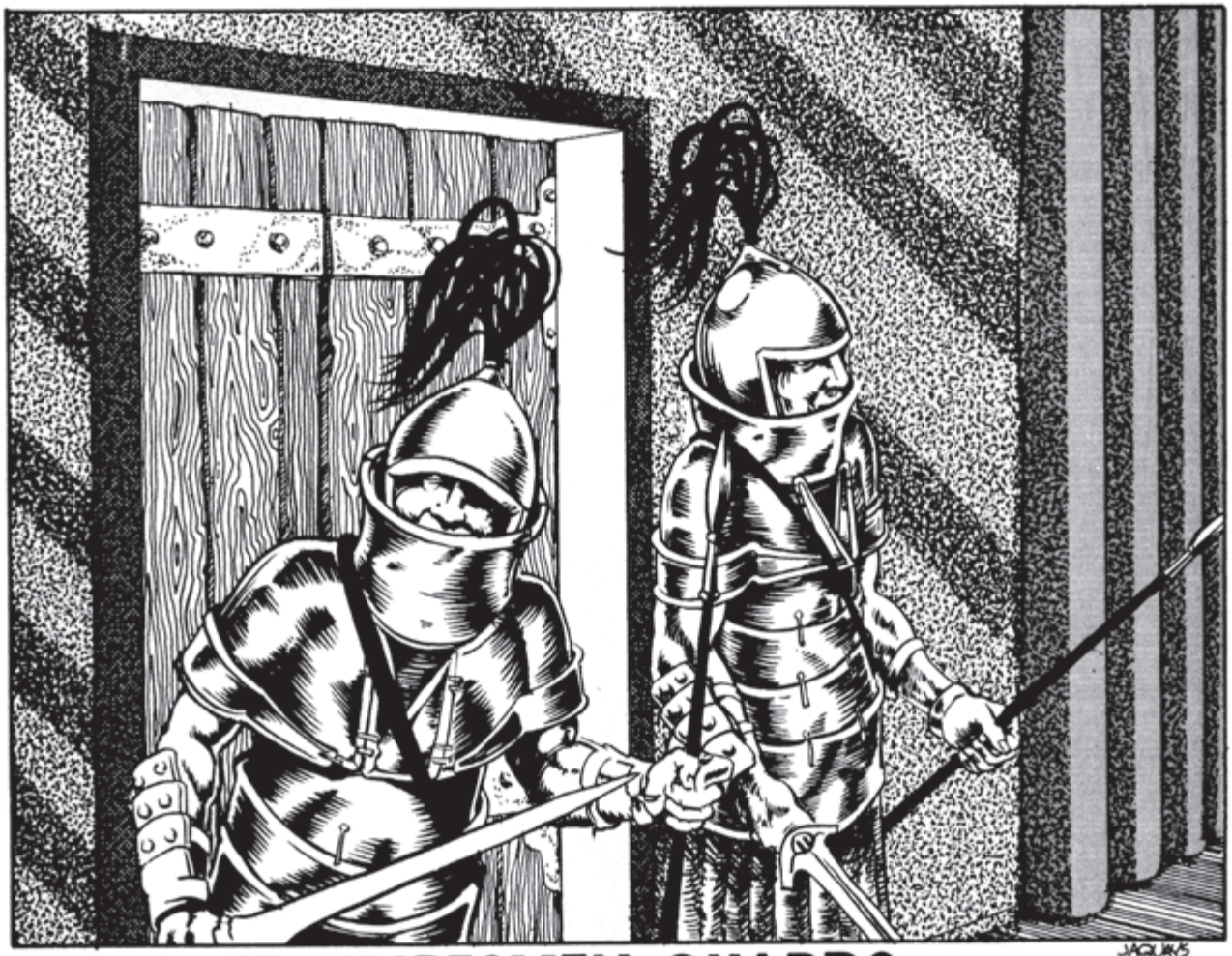
4) Band of Bold Tribesmen: There will be a total of 6 Tribesmen in 1 of 3 bands. Band 1: Led by a 2nd level fighter in platemail (see illustration of armored Tribesmen guards), Align: N, AC: 3, Move, 6", HD: 2, Damage: Spear for 1 - 6 and Broadsword for 1 - 8, HP: 11, STR: 12, DEX: 13. The next character of note is a 4th level Cleric of The Dark One, Align: LE, AC: 6 (Leather and Shield), Move: 12", HD: 24, Damage: Mace for 1 - 6, HP: 12, Spells: *Cure Light Wounds, Cure Light Wounds, Animate 3 Undead* (Skeletons or Zombies). once daily and *Control Undead* of a number equal to the turning ability of a good Cleric (see Designer's Notes for further information).

The rest of the band is made up of 1st level fighters armed with Leather Armor, Shield and Spear. Align: N, AC: 6, Move: 12", HD: 1, Damage: 1 - 6 with Spear, HP: 6, 8, 4, 7. The group will also have split between them the following: Two 50' Coils of Rope, 36 Torches, 5 Bronze Spikes, Rations for 6 men for 4 days, 6 Flagons of Water, 1 Flagon of Weak Wine, 2 Bronze Daggers, a Stone Hammer, a rock on the end of a stick with a *Continual Light* spell on it. The glowing rock has a hood attached to hide the light. It is carried by the Cleric.

Band 2: All 6 of these men are 1st level fighters as above with the same armor and weapons. Hit Points are: 2, 5, 4 (x3), 6. They will have the same extra supplies except for the Wand of Light (glowing rock on a stick). These fellows have been whipped up to a battle frenzy by the Clerics and since they do not fear death, but rather seek it in combat, they will fight like berserkers.

Band 3: This is a group of escaped slaves from the 3rd level. They are AC: 9, Move: 9", HD: ½, Damage: 1 - 2 or by weapon type -1, HP: 2 (4), 1. They are scared for their lives and there is a 60% chance that a Gnoll Patrol will be hot on their heels (2 - 5 melee rounds behind them. See GNOLL PATROL tables below).

5) Gelatinous Cube: AC: 8, Move: 6", HD: 4, Damage: 2 - 8 + save vs. paralyzation or be anesthetized, HP: 24, Immune to *Lightning, Cold, Paralyzation, Fear,* and *Polymorph*. This cube had 34 GP, 10 SP, a Bronze Dagger, a 200 GP Topaz Gem Stone, a Steel ball-bearing (useless, but who knows?), and a marble from Room 89.



ARMORED TRIBESMEN GUARDS

6) Tribesman Funerary Procession: This group will only be in the designated area. If it is indicated as an encounter and the adventuring party is not in the appropriate area, the procession will be located in Room 27B and will remain there for 3 - 18 turns after the encounter is determined. The funeral procession will consist of the same entourage as in the Tribesmen religious ceremony described in Room 23. However, there will be an additional 1 - 12 0 level types. All will be garbed in black robes and the 0 level types will have their faces painted in bright, garish colors. The body is borne by 6 men (0 levels) of 4 Hit Points each. There also will only be four 1st level fighters in plate mail, AC: 3, Move: 6", HD: 1, Damage: Spear for 1 - 6 and Broadsword for 1 - 8, HP: 4, 6, 3, 8; plus one 2nd level fighter in plate mail, AC: 3, Move: 6", HD: 2, Damage: Spear for 1 - 6 and Sword for 1 - 8, HP: 13.

7) 1 - 4 Stirges: AC: 7, Move: 18", HD: 1, Damage: 1 - 3 + 1 - 4 points automatic blood drain per round thereafter, HP: 8, 6, 4 (x2).

9) Gnoll Patrol B: See GNOLL PATROL tables below.

Level Two

1) Lizard Men Patrol B: See LIZARD MEN PATROL tables below.

2) Gnoll Patrol B: See GNOLL PATROL tables below.

3) Gnoll Patrol C: See GNOLL PATROL tables below.

4) 2 - 5 Stirges: AC: 7, Move: 18", HD: 1, Damage: 1 - 3 + 1 - 4 points automatic blood drain per round thereafter, HP: 6, 7, 4, 5, 3.

5) 2 Spiders: AC: 5, Move: 15", HD: 3, Damage: bite for 1 - 4 + save vs. poison or be paralyzed for 11 - 16 (10+1d6) turns. Each additional bit raises number needed to save by 1.

6) Ochre Jelly: AC: 8, Move: 3", HD: 5, Damage: 2 - 12, HP: 24.

8) Battle between Tribesmen and Lizard Men: A battle will be in process between a band of Tribesmen (see Level 1, No. 4, Band 2) and a patrol of Lizard Men (see LIZARD MEN PATROL tables below and randomly determine which group will be in play). One Tribesman and one Lizard man will be dead and at least two members on either side will be minus 1 - 3 Hit Points from wounds. The Tribesmen are outclassed by their reptilian opponents and if unaided, they will all be killed except for the fighter with 2 Hit Ponts who will be taken unconcious back to whichever group the Lizard Men are directly in the service of (see LIZARD MEN PATROL tables).

9) Living Stone Statue: This is an animated stone statue that wanders about the caverns and destroys all living creatures it meeets. It is unintelligent and will fight until destroyed. Once destroyed, however, it will begin to put itself together by regenerating stone out of the surrounding walls and within 3 turns, it will be whole again and begin to stalk the caverns once more. There is a 10% chance each turn that it will randomly teleport to some other place in the caverns. The only way to permanently destroy the statue is to place the head on some non stone - or earth related item, such as a wooden table or to carry it (200 encumbrance points). The statue is AC: 2, Move: 6", HD: 8, Damage: 2 - 12 per round, HP: 32. Unless the head is taken care of, this creature may be encountered more than once.

Room Complex 53

1) Special: Nothing unless Door No. 3 (to the Astral Plane) is opened in Room 53 A. If so, then a Type I Demon will have entered through the door and be prowling around on this level for booty. AC: 0, Move: 12/18", HD: 8, Damage: 2 claws for 1 - 4 each, 2 talons for 1 - 8 each, 1 bite for 1 - 6, HP: 47.

2) Special: Nothing unless the Immortal King in Room 53 E has been disturbed. If so, then it will be that undead creature as it prowls about its former demesne in search of living flesh to devour. This creature can and will leave the Room 53 Complex if the door to Room 53 from 53 A is not spiked shut. It will not attempt to leave through either of the other exits from this level, although it may seek to travel either astrally or ethereally.

10) G'ruk the Lizard Shaman: (see Room 31 for further details on this creature). He will be exploring the sacred area and may be found in any unsealed area except for 53 E.

Level Three: The Gardens

5) Herd of 20 Cattle: AC: 7, Move: 15", HD: 2, Damage: 1 - 4, HP: roll as necessary. This is the Beast Men's on-the-hoof food supply. The herd will be found wandering around the gardens and occasionally will be chased into the palace itself when the hydra is hungry and out stalking prey.

6) Gnoll Patrol D: See GNOLL PATROL Tables below.

7) Troupe of Human Slaves: AC: 9, Move: 9", HD: ½, Damage: 1 - 2 or by weapon type -1, HP: roll as necessary. There are 12 slaves in the troupe and they will be performing various maintenance chores ranging from scrubbing walls to watering trees and/or trimming shrubbery. These slaves, if freed, will join with an adventuring party, but the first time that a Beast Man Commander of any race shows himself, they will be completely cowed and will change sides faster than greased lightning, even to the point of attempting to subdue adventurers. They have a morale of 2d6 which must be rolled under on a d20 every time melee is enjoined, or the freed slaves will run away with a 10% cumulative chance of changing sides each time (Yes, you guessed it! The original gutless wonders).

Level Three: The Palace and Level Four: The Dungeons

1) Gnoll Patrol E: See GNOLL PATROL tables below.

2) Lizard Men Patrol C: See LIZARD MEN PATROL tables below.

3) Human Slaves: Treat this group of slaves as per the Troupe of Human Slaves (Level 3: The Gardens, No. 7) but there will only be 8 slaves.

4) The Minotaur King and his Entourage: This group will be as described in Room 72. There is an additional 45% chance that the king will be accompanied by a second Gnoll patrol (see GNOLL PATROL tables below and determine one randomly). The King may obtain up to 4d8 of healing per day from his grandmother.

5) Two Minotaur Guards: AC: 6, Move: 12", HD: 6, Damage: butt for 2 - 8, bite for 1 - 3 and battle axe for 1 - 12, HP: 28, 36.

6) A Random Dryad: This will be one of the Dryads from the Garden area (No. 56 - 65). Determine which one on the table below, then go to the second table and determine the reason for her being in the palace, since it is basically out of bound to the tree people who will not go there unless physically forced.

Table I
Roll once on a d10)

1) Astraea (56)
2) Briseis (57)
3) Calliste (58)
4) Deianira (59)
5) Eidothera (60)
6) Flora (61)
7) Gaia (62)
8) Hypermnestra (63)
9) Iphigenia (64)
10) Jocasta (65)

Table II
(Roll once on a d20)

1-8) Captive and escorted by two Gnoll guards, AC: 5, Move: 9", HD: 2, Damage: 1 - 10 with two-handed Sword, HP: 14, 4.

9-12) Escaping Captivity. 50% chance of being pursued by 1 - 4 Gnoll guards (see Stats above). HP: 6, 14, 9. 13.

13-14) Subverted to aid of Minotaur King. She will lead adventurers into a trap (*Detect Evil* will reveal her nature).

15-16) She is dying (20% chance that she is already dead). There is a 60% chance that a Gnoll patrol will be standing over her body. Determine composition of patrol on GNOLL PATROL tables below.

17-19) She is in hiding and will attempt to remain hidden, even from adventurers.

20) She is insane and allowed to wander about the palace and grounds. She will bear the marks of torture. Her face is marred beyond all repair.

GNOLL PATROL TABLES

Table I
Patrol Compositon

If the identity of a given Gnoll patrol is not predetermined, roll once on a d6. All patrols are AC: 5, Move: 9", Damage: by weapon type, HD: 2. Hit Points are indicated for each patrol. If a special is indicated, roll on Table III to determine nature of additions to the standard patrol. Weapon type (Table II) must be determined for all Gnoll patrols. Roll once on a d6.

1) (A) 4 Gnolls, HP: 8 (x2), 10, 9.

2) (B) 4 Gnolls + Special, HP: 12, 9, 8 (x2).

3) (C) 6 Gnolls, HP: 10 (x2), 9, 7, 4, 6.

4) (D) 6 Gnolls + Special, HP: 8, 11, 10, 7, 9 (x2).

5) (E) 8 Gnolls, HP: 12 (x2), 8, 11, 13, 9 (x2), 10.

6) (F) 8 Gnolls + Special, HP: 15, 8 (x3), 11 (x2), 9, 10.

Table II
Weapon Type

1) Halberds
2) Halberds
3) Two-Handed Sword
4) Halberds and Longbows
5) Longbows and Morning Stars
6) Battle Axes.

Table III
Special Patrol Members

1) Dog Brother fighter: AC: 6, Move: 12", HD: 4, Damage: Sword for 1 - 8 and/or bite for 1 - 4, HP: 25. He is the Patrol Commander.

2) Dog Brother Magic User: AC: 6, Move: 12", HD: 4, Damage: two Daggers for 1 - 4 each and/or bite for 1 - 4, HP: 27, Spells: (as a 4th level Magic User) *Charm Person (x2), Shield, Sleep, Web (x2).*

3) Minotaur: AC: 6, Move: 12", HD: 6, Damage: butt for 2 - 8, bite for 1 - 3 and/or Battle Axe for 1 - 12, HP: 35.

4) 2 Lizard Men: AC: 4, Move: 6"/12" (swimming), HD: 2+1, Damage: club for 1 - 8 and 4 darts for 1 - 4 each, HP: 9, 7.

5) 1 - 6 Human Captives. These will be Tribesmen slaves who have attempted to escape and are being returned for punishment or possible execution. They are desperate. AC: 9, Move: 9", HD: ½, Damage: 1 - 2 or by weapon type -1, HP: 2 (x2), 3, 4 (x3). If freed, they will willingly serve as slaves to their saviors. They speak Gnollic and some Tribesman.

6) 2 of the Above. Reroll and ignore rolls of 6. Duplications are allowed.

LIZARD MEN PATROL TABLE

All of the patrols listed below are in the service of the Minotaur King with the exception of Patrol A. They are Lizard Tribesmen under the leadership of G'ruk the Shaman of the Lizard People. Their statistics will be listed under A. All other patrols are AC: 4 (armed with Shield), Move: 6"/12" (swimming), HD: 2+1, Damage: club for 1 - 8 and 4 darts for 1 - 4, Hit Points are indicated for each patrol. If a special is indicated, roll of GNOLL PATROL Table III.

1) (A) Lizard men in the service of G'ruk the Shaman. AC: 5, Move: 6"/12", Damage: 2 claws for 1 - 3 each and a bite for 1 - 8, HP: 9, 11, 10, 7. There is a 10% chance that they will be accompanied by the Shaman G'ruk (see Room 31).

2) (B) 6 Lizard Men in the service of the Minotaur King. HP: 12 (x2), 9, 8, 11, 12.

3) (C) 6 Lizard Men in the service of the Minotaur King + a 50% chance of a Special. HP: 17, 15, 8, 11, 14, 10.

4) (D) 6 Lizard Men in the service of the Minotaur King + a Special patrol member. HP: 6, 11 (x2), 10, 12, 9.

The individual patrols are not to be treated as individual characters. A patrol may be rolled up more than once.

The Taverns of Thracia

The use of this section is optional. It provides a set of legends (more like bits and pieces of legends) that can either be assigned to various NPC's in the referee's campaign or to speed up a game, they can be given directly to the players as indicated below. The method is left up to the individual referee. If the system of giving legends directly to the player characters is used, the following mechanics should allow for fair distribution.

Roll once on a d4 on Table One. This will determine the number of information bits known by the character, usually from 0 - 3. Then, go to Table Two and roll a d20 the number of times as indicated on Table One. Write down each character's known pieces of legendry on a separate piece of paper and inform them that they know these things about the future adventure and that they may keep them secret if they wish. Not all the pieces of information are true. Those that are not are suffixed by an "F" in parentheses. The referee is not obligated to inform the player as to the veracity of his information.

Table One
Roll once on a d4

1) 1 piece of information
2) 2 pieces of information
3) 3 pieces of information
4) No pieces of information

Table Two
Roll as indicated above on a d20)

1) The Beast Men are Humans under a curse (F).

2) A collector has expressed interest in obtaining Thracian historical artifacts. He will pay 2d100 (2 - 200) Gold Pieces per intact item brought out.

3) Beware the Yellow Death!

4) Don't trust the trees!

5) The Tribesmen perform Human sacrifice.

6) You have learned to read the Thracian Language (modern). This gives you a one-time 30% chance of reading anything inscribed in that language.

7) Beware the God of Death!

8) The rope bridges are rotted out and unsafe (F).

9) For safety, seek ye the Pool of the Watery Wonders.

10) The Hall of Laughing Skulls leads to riches untold.

11) Be wary of statuary!

12) Deep under the earth there is a sunlit garden and a sparkling palace.

13) Seek aid from the Halfling Hermit.

14) Buried with a dead king is a powerful, but evil Sword.

15) The caverns go no deeper than two levels (F).

16) The leader of the Beast Men hoards vast amounts of wealth (F).

17) A remnant of an ancient pre-Human civilization may yet exist deep in the bowels of the earth.

18) The Beast Men are enslaving Humans.

19) The touch of the Good will destroy Undead (F).

20) You have learned to speak the language of the Tribesmen. You have a 65% chance of speaking clearly to any Tribesman. If the 65% roll is not made, clarity of conversation must be determined on Room 73's Interpretation tables.

Note: The tree symbols on the map represent actual trees. There are many, many more trees in the jungle, but to indicate them all would clutter the map severely. However, on the building foundations themselves, there are no more trees than indicated.

Note II: The surface of the street is cobblestone and is well choked with thick grass, at least waist high.

A) **Entrance to Room 1**: At this point the stairs descend down to level one, Room 1. There is a 60% chance that a Gnoll patrol will be guarding this entrance. (Use GNOLL PATROL Tables in Random Encounter section to randomly determine a patrol). There is an additional 50% chance that half the patrol will be in ambush up in the trees. The stairs come up onto a weathered pedestle that was once the base of a temple. There is rubble lying about on the surface and trees are growing up around the edge of the pedestle and out of cracks in it. The pedestle is 10' higher than the surrounding terrain.

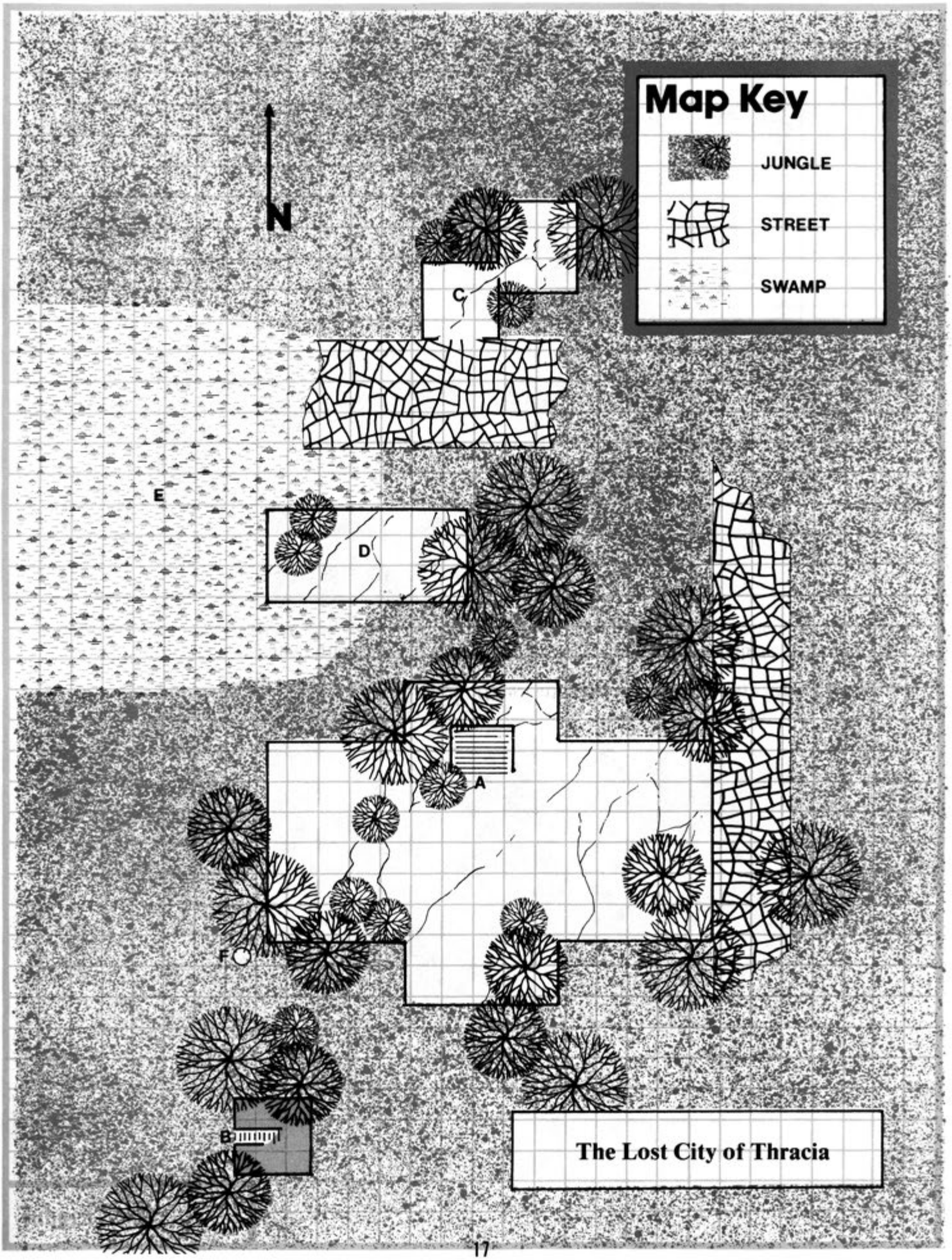
B) **The Tribesmen's Secret Entrance**: This set of stairs leads down to 18 on the first level map. There will be a band of Tribesmen lurking about here (see Random Encounter Tables, Level One, No. 4, "Band of Bold Tribesmen". They will be the equivalent of Band 2, but with the following Hit Points: 8, 6, 5, 4, 7, 9). These characters will definitely attack from ambush.

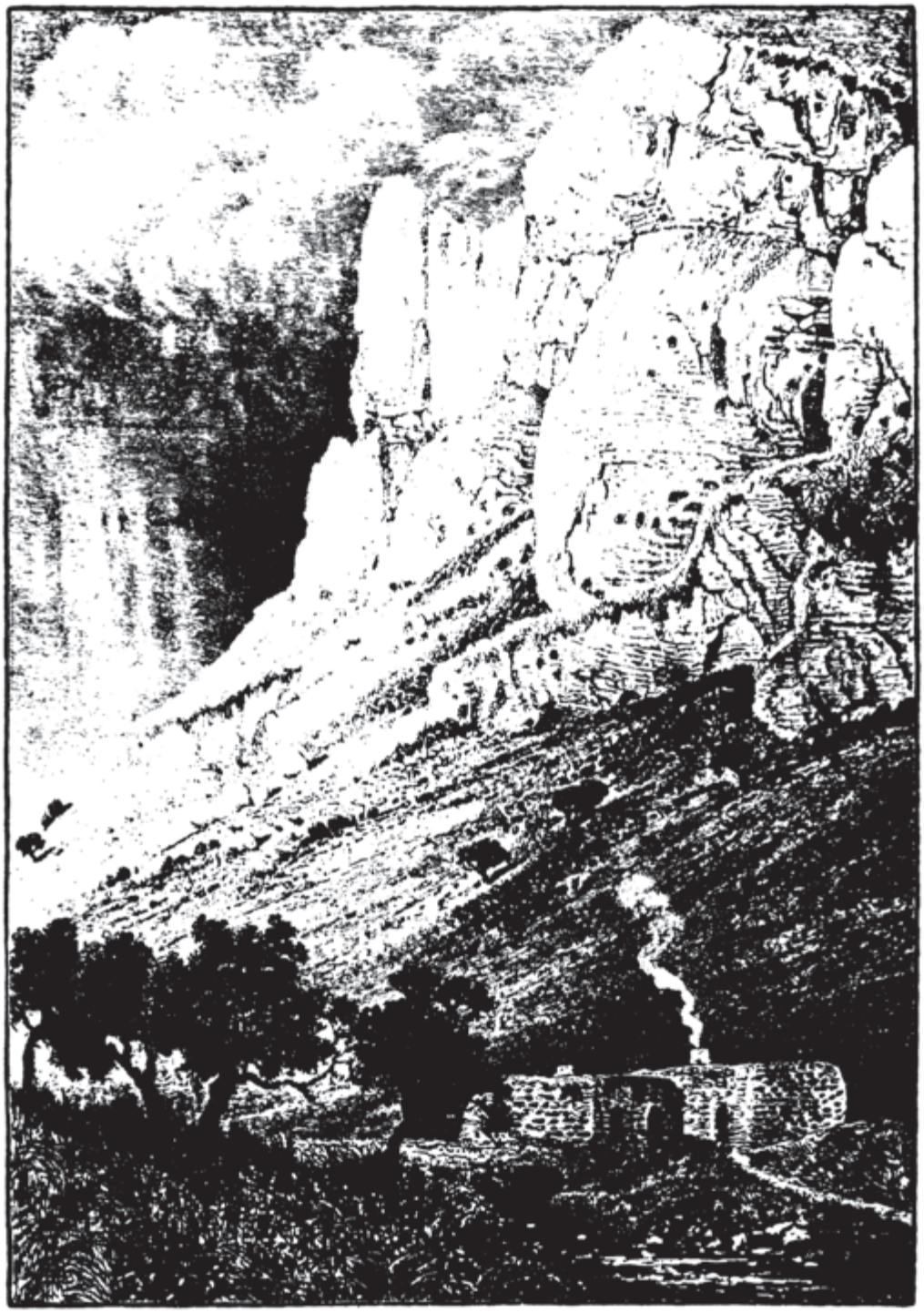
C) **The Remnants of an Ancient Building**: There is little left besides the foundation and a couple of walls. There is a 30% chance of a Random Encounter at this point. Roll on the 2nd level table. A search of the premises will reveal a tablet written in Dwarvish. If a member of the party can read it, it will state that the writer has found the location of the secret entrance into the caverns below. The building described will be "A squat, dark building constructed of black stone". This is the building that houses the Tribesmen's secret entrance (B).

D) **Another Building Foundation**: This one is 5' higher than the surrounding area and juts out into the swamp. Standing at the west end of it will cause the character(s) to be hit by a volley of 4 - 12 darts cast by Lizard Men (see E below).

E) **A Hunting Party**: Slurping quietly about in the swamp is a patrol of Lizard Men (determine a random Lizard Men Patrol on the LIZARD MEN PATROL Tables under the Random Encounter section). If undetected, they will attack with surprise and return to beneath the waters, seeking at all times to ambush without actually joining combat with intruders.

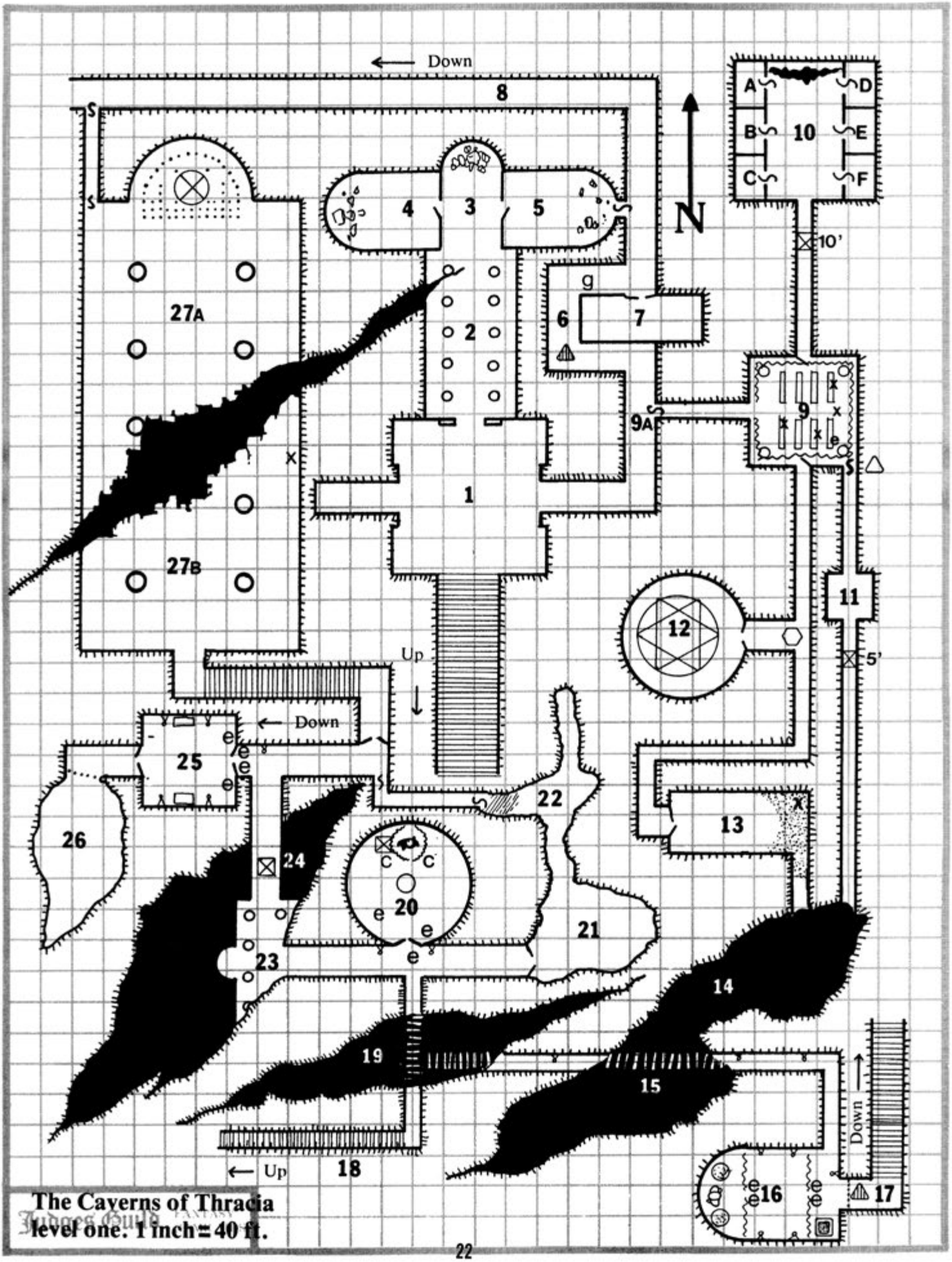
F) **A Hole in the Ground**: This is a 5' diameter hole that lets sunlight down into the cavern below and at high noon is focused directly on the semicircular area of 23. The drop is 65' for 6d6 +2 damage. If the character falling survives and does not hang on there is an additional 20% chance that he or she will slip off and fall an additional 50' to land on the east bank of the river, taking another 4d6 +2 damage.


Map Key
JUNGLE
STREET
SWAMP
N
A
B
C
D
E
F
The Lost City of Thracia



لماذا

Level 1



The Cavern of Thracia
level one. 1 inch = 40 ft.

Judges Guild

Level One

1) **Entry Hall**: The stairs out of this room or down to this room lead to the surface and come out among a pile of ruins. The walls of this room appear to have been painted once in bright colors with scenes of ceremonies and worship, however now they are faded, worn, chipped and discolored with age and wear. The air in the room stinks of bat guano and hanging from the ceiling are several hundred normal bats. The ceiling, which is 30' high, is covered with them. The bats will be mildly irritated by torches but a *Light* spell will send them winging about through the air, severely agitated. The guano on the floor makes it slippery and will require a saving throw on a d20 of under the character's Dexterity +2 per turn spent running through the muck or per round spent fighting in it. Failure to make the throw indicates slipping and falling into the goo (-3 Charisma penalty).

2) **Hall of the Bats**: This is a columned hall that has at least 6 - 8" of bat guano on the floor. The 20' ceiling is literally swarming with normal bats who will become agitated by the presence of light and *Light* spells or bright, directional lanterns will send the critters winging and make vision beyond 5' impossible due to their number. Running or fighting in this room will require a saving throw to be made against slippage (see Room 1 above), however, saving throws will be made at Dexterity -2.

3) **Alcove of the Bats**: This room is exactly like Room 2 as far as bats are concerned (including saving throws). At the north end of the alcove is a pile of rubble that appears to have once been a statue of some sort. If the rubble is dug through (approximately 1 turn) the head can be found. It will be the head of the goddess Athena. The door into Room 5 is ajar and the door to Room 4 is jammed shut so that it is -1 on opening capability. If characters choose to notice, they will find that it appears that trails have been worn through the muck on the floor, leading to both Rooms 4 and 5 and into and through Rooms 2 and 1.

4) **Centipede Chapel**: This room is not full of bat guano. It contains a pile of rubble that appears to once have been a winged, robed, female figure (imagine the statue "winged victory" in a heap). Crawling about the room are 19 centipedes, bright red in color, AC: 9, HD: ¼, Damage: Poison (+4 saving throw), HP: 1 (x9), 2 (x10). There has been a recent struggle in the room. Several additional centipedes lie mashed on the floor (currently being hastily cleaned up by their still living fellows) and some blood has been spilled.

5) **Lizard Men on a Hunting Foray**: 4 Lizard Men are in here, AC: 4, Move: 6", HD: 2 + 1, Damage: club for 1 - 8, HP: 13, 9, 16, 8 (13). Two of the Lizard Men are on guard and ready while the 3rd is seeing to the wounds of the 4th who, though he can fight, is reeling somewhat from the effects of centipede poison. (The 13 reflects the creature's actual hit points before suffering damage from the centipedes.) On the floor is a string of about 12 centipedes with their heads removed. Several are still wriggling, coiling and uncoiling. 2 centepedes have already been cracked open and the meat devoured out of them. The wounded Lizard Man will fight at -1 hit probability.

   Scattered about the floor are the remains of a statue that is shattered beyond any recognition. The secret door at the rear of the room is disguised to look like an ornamental panel.

6) **Spear Trap**: As the location of the "6" is passed on the map, there is a 1 - 4 chance on a d6 that 2 spears will come flying out of the south wall, headed north and hit as if cast by a 7th level fighter. There is a 25% chance that the Gnoll guard, AC: 5, HD: 2, HP: 13, Weapon: Morning Star, will be dozing at point "g". If he hears approaching adventurers, he will slip into Room 7 and the Gnolls in there will have an ambush ready.

7) **Gnoll Guardpost**: This is a guardpost occupied by 6 Gnolls (in addition to the one above) who are in the service of the Minotaur King. AC: 5, Move: 9", HD: 2, HP: 13, 14, 7, 15, 8, 10, Damage: Longbow for 1 - 6, and Battle Axe for 1 - 10. Each Gnoll has 4 SP, and 6 GP on his person.

The Incarnation of Death ROOMS 9A-13.

Rooms 9A through 13:

The Incarnation of Death

Frequency	Very Rare (see below)
Number Appearing	1
Armor Class	2
Move	12"
Hit Dice	4 (20 Hit Points)
% in Lair	Nil
Treasure Type	Nil
Number of Attacks	1
Damage/Attack	Nil
Special Attacks	Energy Drain (see below)
Special Defenses	Invisibility
	May only be hit by Iron Weapons
Magic Resistance	20%
	Plus immune to *Sleep*, *Charm*, and *Hold* spells
Intelligence	Average
Alignment	Lawful Evil
Size	M
Psionic Ability	Nil
Attack/Defence Modes	Nil

In this section, there will be one special wandering monster, The Incarnation of Death. This is a minor, physical manifestation of the death god, Thanatos. The creature appears as a tall, gaunt man in flowing black robes. He has a darkly beautiful face, but appears morbidly sad. He will gesture to severely wounded characters that they should step forward and embrace him.

The Incarnation of Death will only appear to characters who are within 3 Hit Points of death. If a character normally has 3 or less Hit Points, then he or she will also see the Incarnation.

The Incarnation will appear any time that a character reaches 3 or less Hit Points and will only be visible to that character. However, a *Detect Invisible* spell will also reveal the location of the creature.

The presence of the creature will lower (raise the number required to save) the saving throws and morale of all who can see it by 2 points.

Once a living being dies in the presence of the Incarnation, the creature will snatch the soul of the dead one, making any form of *Ressurection* or *Reincarnation* impossible without a *Full Wish*.

If a character, even an unwounded one, willingly embraces the Incarnation of Death, he or she will die (no saving throw) and may not be brought back to life in any way without having a *Wish* of some sort.

Protection from Evil will keep the Incarnation at bay (regardless of caster's level).

Dispel Evil or *Dispel Magic* will end the creature away until the time that an additional living being is brought within 3 Hit Points of death.

The creature is normally *Invisible*, but once attacked it becomes visible. It will drain one energy (life) level when it scores a hit.

9A) **The Gates of Death**: This secret door leads to the ancient chapel of the god, Thanatos (death personified). The door is plastered over and can not be detected unless looked for. Once the plaster is chipped away, an inscription will be visible, written in ancient Thracian. It states: "KNOW YE THAT BEYOND THIS PORTAL LIES THE DEMESNE OF THANATOS, THE CURSED, HATER OF LIFE, GOD OF DEATH. SEEK NOT TO PASS THIS GATE FOR IT LEADS ONLY TO HIS BOSOM. THOSE WHO CHERISH LIFE HAVE SEALED THESE CHAMBERS FOR AN ETERNITY. BE WARNED, THERE IS NO RETURN THROUGH THIS DOOR. ONCE PASSED, IT IS PASSED FOREVER."

Once this door is passed through, adventurers will find themselves in a 30' long hallway, 5' wide. If they look behind them, there will be no door, only hall. The hall itself is magically *dark* (undispelable). No torch, lantern or *light* spell will cast more than a 5' radius of illumination. *Infravision* will be useless. Regardless of which direction the adventureres move (east or west), they will find themselves entering into Room 9 after traversing a distance of 30'. Re-entering the hall from Room 9 will still bring a character back to Room 9 after moving 30'. There is no way back to 9A from 9, at least by physical means.

9) **The Chapel of Thanatos**: This square room is lit, dimly by 4 low incense burners, located at the room's corners. Each gives off an eerie green glow and a thin trail of sweet-smelling vapor. The vapor is a sleep inducing incense. A saving throw must be made against poison or the victim will succumb in 1 - 6 melee rounds after entering the room. Victim will stay asleep for 1 - 6 turns after incense stops burning. Standing directly over a burner and inhaling the concentrated fumes will lower the dice roll of the saving throw by 2 and cause sleep immediately upon failure to make the throw.

The walls are draped from ceiling to floor with black curtains of heavy fabric. Each individual wall is covered by a single piece of cloth. 8 black, marble benches are set in two rows from east to west. The small "x's" represent the locations of seated or kneeling, motionless figures draped in black cowled robes. The figures are long-dead human worshippers of Thanatos. Upon touch they will crumble to dust, leaving behind only a few bones, shreds of black cloth and a silver chain and skull shaped pendant with turquois eyes (value 25 GP). There are 4 figures and 4 pendants. The "e" is another figure that looks like the others. It is a very patient wight, AC: 5, Move: 9", HD: 3, HP: 20, Damage: 1 level energy drain. If touched it will attack with surprise on a 1 - 2 roll of a d6. If left alone it will follow and attempt to attack from behind. The wight wears no jewelry.

The walls behind the drapes are plastered and contain frescoes depicting a dark-robed faceless being (Thanatos) reigning triumphantly over all variety of mortal creatures of all religions. Above and below the frescoes is inscribed over and over "NOTHING ESCAPES DEATH" in the ancient Thracian language.

The north door is made of stone bound with iron. It is locked. The wight has the key to the door in a belt pouch. The key has a death's head at both ends, but it is still recognizably a key.

The south door is *Wizard Locked* as if by a 10th level Magic User. A skull with glowing red eyes is set into the stone of the door. The skull will hiss (*Magic Mouth*) at any who attempt to open the door and say (*Magic Mouth*), "ENTER FOOLS! JOIN ME IN THE BLISS THAT IS THANATOS! BECOME ONE WITH BLESSED DEATH! IT IS IN THE FINAL END THAT FULFILLMENT LIES."

The secret door in the south wall is covered by plaster. The door is locked (again the wight's key will open it, see above). There is a 1 spear trap set to fire on a d6 roll of 1 - 4 directly above the door, as if fired by a 7th level fighter. The trap is triggered by inserting the key in the lock.

10) **Crypt of the Waking Dead**: The hall leading from Room 9 to this room has a pit trap, 10' deep that opens on a 1 - 3 roll of a d6.

The amorphous black blob at the north end of the room is a "scarecrow" made of a large black robe draped over a statue. The statue is 20' tall. A continual magical wind blows outward from the north wall as if cast by a 10th level Magic User. Only by removing the robe from the statue can the wind be stopped or by casting a successful *Dispel Magic*. Protected flames have a 20% chance of being extinguished while all unprotected flames will be blown out immediately upon entering the room. The wind cannot be felt until the room itself is entered.

All the secret doors into Rooms 10 A - F are covered by a layer of plaster. Painted over the locations of each door is a somber, human face, approximately 4' tall.

10A) **Empty Crypt**: Whatever was buried in here has long since crumbled to dust. The tomb contains nothing of value.

10B) **The Living Dead**: 3 Skeletons wait in here. AC: 7, Move: 6", HD: 1, HP: 4 (x2), 8, Damage: 1 - 6. Each skeleton is dressed in shredded black robes and wears turquoise-eyed silver skull pendant around its neck (value 25 GP each). They are weaponless.

10C) **More Living Dead**: 4 Skeletons in here. AC: 7, Move: 6", HD: 1, HP: 2, 3, 4 (x2), Damage: 1 - 6. They are dressed exactly like those in 10B.

10D) **Even More Living Dead**: Another 4 Skeletons guard this crypt. AC: 7, Move: 6", HD: ½, HP: 3, 4, 2 (x2), Damage: 1 - 6. Again they are dressed as those in Room 10B.

10E) **A Second Empty Crypt**: The occupant of this room disintegrated to its primal components years ago. All that remains is a pile of dust and black rags, along with a single skull pendant as described in Room 10B.

10F) **A Not-So-Empty Crypt**: This crypt contains 6 Skeletons in chainmail, armed with Broad Swords, AC: 5, HD: 1, HP: 7, 3, 5, 4 (x2), 6, Damage: 1 - 6.

If the door to this crypt is opened, the doors to all the other crypts will spring or burst open and release any surviving occupants who will immediately begin to attack any intruders. In a locked box against the room's north wall is 200 SP, 40 GP, and a Potion of Levitation in a skull-shaped flask.

11) **Perfectly Preserved Curate**: Placed in a state of *Stasis* is a 5th level Cleric of Thanatos. Macreus, 6th level Cleric of Thanatos, Align: LE, HP: 18, Armor: Chainmail, AC: 5, Weapon: Stone Mace. His regular Clerical spells include the following: *Dark (reverse of Light), Protection from Good, Hold Person, Silence 15' Radius*. Macreus was entombed here at a time 150 years after the downfall of King Agamemnos (see history) when the worship of death was not so popular. However, his followers had found a way to preserve him indefinitely and keep him alive so they could rescue him in the near future when things cooled down a bit for the death worshippers. It seems rather, that Macreus was forgotten and left in *Stasis* for 950 years. Macreus will speak both the language of the Thracians (see Room 37 for translation difficulties) and also the language of the ancient Thracians, being able to read and speak it fluently. He knows of the location of Level 3A and how to get to it. He knows of the sphinx. He is aware of the Room Complex No. 45 and has heard legends of Room Complex 53.

Macreus is guarded by 6 Skeletons, AC: 7, HD: 1, HP: 5, 7 (x2), 6, 8 (x2). Opening the secret door in Room 9 will break the *Stasis* and *Animate* the skeletons. Around the neck of Macreus is a turquois-eyed silver skull pendant (value 25 GP) and at his belt is a pouch containing a *Confusion* (4d8) dust that must be inhaled (10' x 10' cloud). In the south corridor is a 5' deep pit trap (roll under or equal to dexterity score on a d20 or take 1 - 3 points of damage). The trap springs on a d6 roll of 1 - 3. On the floor of the pit is a locked chest containing 800 CP, and 200 SP. There is also a strong but lightweight rope ladder (value 50 GP) that is 50' long. One end of the ladder has two stone balls attached to it that will fit into a pair of re-inforced holes at the end of the corridor, which ends looking out into a cavern. The balls will hold the ladder in place.

12) **Oracular Skulls**: The entry hall to this room is guarded by 2 crossbow traps that will hit as if shot by a 4th level fighter on a d6 roll of 1 - 4. They are aimed at the center of the 10' doors to Room 12. Opening the door will work to trigger the trap.

The floor of the room is set in large, red, ceramic tiles, glazed and very smooth. Inscribed on the floor in glowing green lines is a hexagram, a six-pointed star drawn within a circle. The walls and the hemisphere of the 50' high domed ceiling appear to be a night sky with constellations moving across them. The room is 10 degrees F colder than the hallway (the hall is approximately 55 degrees F).

Floating 15' off the ground in the center of the hexagram is a green, glowing, human skull with ram's horns apparently growing out from it. The skull has living eyes and will watch persons entering the room, and will chuckle ominously. Once the door closes, the skull will say, "SPEAK PETITIONER AND HAVE THY SAY, THAT I MAY ANSWER YE YEA OR NAY." The skull

will then allow everyone present to ask one yes or no question which the referee must answer truthfully. No character may ever ask more than one question, regardless if they return again to the room. Once the question has been asked and answered, the skull will speak again and say, "YOUR QUESTIONS HAVE BEEN ANSWERED AND YE ARE NOW THANATOS' OWN." At that point, a small, white, skull-shaped blemish will appear on the back of the right hand of every character who asked a question. It actually means nothing, except as an identifying mark for a worshipper of Thanatos.

If the skull is attacked it is AC: -2, HD: 5, HP: 31, Damage: 2 *Magic Missiles* per round at up to 2 targets, Move: Fly at 24".

A final note on the skull-shaped blemish. Any character so marked will be visited by the Incarnation of Death when he or she is within 3 Hit Points of dying, regardless of where he or she may be (see *The Incarnation of Death*). The skull may be removed by a combination of *Remove Curse* and *Cure Serious Wounds*.

13) **Moldy Bones**: The door to this room is bolted with a heavy stone bar from the west side. The toned area in this room represents a colony of yellow mold, AC: 9. However, out of that mold will rise 6 Skeletons, AC: 7, Move: 6", HD: 1, HP: 6, 3 (x2), 5 (x2), 4, Damage: 1 - 6. The skeletons appear fuzzy because they are coated with a growth of yellow mold. Striking them will have a 50% chance of releasing a 5' x 5' x 5' cloud of spores. There is an additional 30% chance that instead of releasing the small spore cloud that it will release all its spores at once in a 10' x 10' x 10' cloud. Each skeleton is good for two small clouds or one big cloud of spores. Holy Water will not affect the skeletons until the mold on them is removed.

In a stone box (location marked by the "x") is 200 SP, 40 GP and a Wand that looks like a miniature, skull-headed, obsidian Wand of the demon prince Orcus (value 150 GP). It has a magic value in the hands of an evil character. It will allow them to *Control Undead* as per a Cleric of Thanatos of the same level as themselves (see Designer's Comments).

The hall to the south leads to a cavern and a 50' drop. Note: both this opening and the opening to Room 11 are disguised by walls of *Permanent Illusion* and are visible (normally) from either below or the rope bridge (15).

14) **Upper Reaches**: This is the upper part of the caverns that are mapped on Level 2. From the level of the rope bridge, they descend 50' to the floor below and rise from 10' to 40' upwards. Various stalactites hang from the ceilings. Among the stalactites are a group of 20 huge bats, AC: 4, HD: ½, HP: Roll as necessary, Damage: 1 - 3 (bite), Move: 24". These creatures have a wingspread of approximately 5'. Torches and normal lanterns moving across the rope bridge will dislodge 1 - 2 of them, *Light* spells and bullseye lanterns pointed in their direction will dislodge all 20. If the bats score a hit against a character on the rope bridge, that character must roll less than or equal to his Dexterity +2 on a d20. Only one roll is made. Multiple hits will lower the score needed by 2 per hit. Falling will do 5d6 of damage.

15) **The Rope Bridge**: This is a 40' long bridge of fairly recent construction made of strong hemp ropes woven and tied around closely set planks of wood. At waist height there is a rope hand rail on both sides. The bridge is firmly attached at both ends. It would be the work of but one or two sword chops to effectively sever the bridge, AC: 8, HP: 5 points of damage to each of the two supporting strands. Due to the dampness of the air, the rope bridge will not readily burn unless first liberally doused with oil (3 - 4 flasks).

16) **Sanctuary of the Dark One**: This is a worship hall devoted to Thanatos, but under his recent name of "The Dark One". The chapel is about a century old and is used by the local tribesmen. The room is divided into three parts. The easternmost part contains a ritual purification basin and two guards (described later). The central section is the worship chamber. The westernmost section is the location of a statue of the deity and a pair of iron braziers. This section may only be entered by a Cleric of Thanatos.

Each section is partitioned from the other by a ceiling to floor drapes of heavy black material. Each drape is made of two pieces. The central and eastern section are lit by torches while the statuary nook is lit by the braziers. The 4 "e's" are 4 2nd level fighting men, Align: N, Platemail, AC: 3, Weapons: Spear and Broadsword, HP: 14, 10, 16, 19.

Entry into the statuary nook will result in a *curse* being cast on all intruders (reverse of *remove curse* as if cast by a 12th level Cleric). Only Clerics of Thanatos may safely pass through. The statue is an 8' tall wooden carving of a humanoid in black robes with a skull face. Each eye of the statue is a 200 GP turquoise. Any attempt to liberate these gems will cause the flames in the braziers to explode for 1d8 of damage to all within a 5' radius and to set the nearest curtains on fire. Due to the drying of the braziers, these curtains are tinder dry.

17) **Bars, Visions, Spears and Slides**: The entrance to this area is blocked off by iron bars. They are somewhat rusty. They will bend on a d20 roll of under a characters strength score -10.

To any who fail a saving throw vs magic, it will appear that a comely Dryad is trying to break free from the bars. She seems to be in fear of something and will retreat and cower against the east wall of Room 17.

Once the bars are passed, a spear trap will fire on a 1 - 2 roll of a d6. Two spears will be fired as if by a 4th level fighter, for 2 - 12 points of damage.

The stairs go down to Level 2. There is a 30% chance that when any weight is placed upon the stairs they will form into a slick 45 degree angle slide. Every 5' moved down the stairs adds another 5% to the chance of the stairs becoming a slide. This should be checked every 5'. The odds are that a character will possibly be dumped into the river.

18) **Stairs to the Surface**: This set of stairs goes up to the ruins above. It is the access route of the priests of "The Dark One" when they come to perform their semi-monthly ceremonies here in the holy of holies. Any artificial light coming down this stair will be visible to the guard ("e") posted in front of Room 20. He will then blow a high pitched magical whistle that only the servants of "The Dark One" can hear, thus allowing them to prepare ambushes. This whistle can be heard in Rooms 14 through 26.

19) **A Second Rope Bridge**: This is an approximately 25' long, "T" shaped bridge of fairly recent construction made of strong hemp ropes woven and tied around closely set planks of wood. At waist height, there is a rope hand rail on both sides. The bridge is firmly attached at both ends. The cords attaching the bridge to the rock are AC: 8, HP: 5 for each cord (2). Due to the dampness in the air, the rope will not readily burn unless first liberally doused with oil (4 - 5 flasks).

Hanging amongst the stalactites are 5 huge bats, AC: 4, HD: ½, HP: 3 (x2), 1, 4 (x2), Damage: bite for 1 - 3, Move: 24". These creatures have a wingspread of approximately 5'. Torches and normal lanterns moving along the rope bridge will dislodge 1 - 2 of them, *Light* spells and directional lanterns, if pointed in their direction, will dislodge all 5. If the bats score a hit against a character on the rope bridge, that character must roll less than or equal to his dexterity +2 on a d20. Only one roll is made. Multiple hits will lower the score needed to be under by 2 points per hit. Falling will do 5d6 of damage.

Light moving along this bridge will alert the guard posted at the door to Room 20. See Room 18 above for consequences.

20) **Ritual Hall of Purification**: Posted outside of this room is a 2nd level fighter ("e"), Align: N, Platemail, AC: 3, Weapon: Spear and Broadsword, HP: 15. He has a magical whistle made of bronze that he will blow when intruders are spotted. This whistle will alert all fighters and servants of "The Dark One" in Rooms 14 through 26, who will then prepare ambushes. If the characters have been "branded" by Thanatos in Room 12, they too will be able to hear the whistle.

The room is a purification chamber where the priests of "The Dark One" ceremonial clean themselves before entering into any holy rites. The circle in the room's center is a 5' diameter basin that sets on a 3' tall pillar of skulls. At the north end of the room is a 10' diameter column of black drapery that hangs from the ceiling 20' overhead to the floor. If the two sections of drapes are pulled back all characters viewing the black statue behind it must save vs. paralyzation or be paralyzed for 1 - 6 turns (not rounds). Worshippers of Thanatos (and those wearing his brand) are immune. The two "c's" flanking the statue are a pair of adepts in the service of "The Dark One", 2nd level Clerics, Align: LE, Leather Armor and Shield, AC: 6, Damage: Mace for 1 - 6, HP: 7, 8, spells: *Cure Light Wounds (reverse)*. The 2 "e's" in the room are a pair of fighters in the service of the god. 2nd level fighters, Align: N, Platemail, AC: 3, Weapons: Spear for 1 - 6, and Broadsword for 1 - 8, HP: 13, 14.

The eyes of the statue are a pair of matched citrines worth 150 GP each.

21) **Outer Lair of the Wolverine**: This rough-carved room reeks of animal waste and a skunk-like odor. Any noise, movement, breathing, etc, in here will bring the giant wolverine, AC: 4, HD: 4 + 4, 3 attacks 2 - 5/2 - 5/2 - 8, + musk as per a skunk at rear opponents, HP: 26. The creature also attacks with a +4 hit probability.

Lying about the floor in this room are various Weapons (1 Broadsword, 3 Spears, a Light Crossbow and 10 Quarrels, a Hand Axe, and 2 Daggers), a Helmet (full head, closed) and two or three pieces of Platemail similar to that worn by the guards in Rooms 20 and 16. All the equipment is drenched in wolverine musk and is unusable until well washed and/or aired out for several days.

22) **The Lair of the Giant Wolverine**: This rough-carved chamber reeks so badly that any character entering it must make a saving throw vs. nausea (roll under constitution on a d20) or lose half his or her strength for 1 - 6 turns, effect immediate. The wolverine (see Room 21) will normally (95%) be in this chamber. There is absolutely nothing of value in here (unless one likes garbage, bones and wolverine stench). The concealed door in the west wall is quite visible if the huge pile of garbage (shaded area) is dug away.

23) **The Sacrificial Altar of The Dark One**: There is a 06% chance that a sacrificial ceremony will be going on here. If so, the following personae will be present: an 8th level Patriarch of "The Dark One", Align: LE, Armor: Chainmail, AC: 5, Weapon: Hammer, HP: 36, spells: *Protection from Good, Cause Light Wounds, Hold Person, Silence 15' Radius, Cure Serious Wounds, Sticks to Snakes, Dispel Good, Animate Dead, Speak with Dead, Finger of Death* (see *Gods and Worshippers*); two 4th level Vicars of "The Dark One", Align: LE, Armor: Leather, AC: 7, Weapon: Hammer, HP: 15, 20, spells: *Cure Light Wounds (x2), Hold Person*. Also in attendance are 10 various 0 level types of various ages and sexes who are serving as witnesses, trainees, body servants, etc. (level 0 characters attack as level ½ hit die creatures). Roll hit points (1 - 4) as needed for the 0 levels.

Guarding the ceremony will be an additional 8 fighters in Platemail, 1st level fighters, Align: N, Armor: Platemail, AC: 3, Weapon: Spear and Broadsword, HP: 3 (x2), 8 (x3), 6 (x2), 7. In addition there will be three bound victims who are about to be pushed into the abyss. The victims are naked. Two 0 level young women and a 1st level Elven fighter, HP: 7 (roll stats if necessary).

If there is no sacrificial ceremony in progress there will be 10 huge bats, AC: 4, HD: ½, HP: 4 (x3), 1 (x3), 2, 3 (x3), bite for 1 - 3, Move: 24". Any light in this area will disturb all the bats and they will attack anything that ventures past the pillars and out onto the bridge (24). Any fall from this area into the caverns below will do 5d6 of damage.

24) **Trapdoor**: This is a trap that will open on a d6 roll of 1 - 4 and then remain open until pulled shut again. It will drop victims to the pool below the rapids on the 2nd level (Room 31). The bridge is made of mortarred stone.

25) **Vault of the Cermonial Treasures**: This is the storage place of the cult of "The Dark One"'s holy relics, ceremonial trappings and other things of cultic and worldly value. The 4 "e's", in and outside of the room represent 2nd level fighters that are guarding the loot, Align: N, Armor: Platemail, AC: 3, Weapons: Spear for 1 - 6, Broadsword for 1 - 8, HP: 11, 12, 10, 8, 16, 13. If it appears that the fighting ability of the guards is near equal to any invaders, then the north west guard will pull a lever that will release the 1 black bear from Room 26 (see Room 26 for statistics) who will then join the fracas in 1 round, attacking anything not in the distinctive platemail of the guards.

The room is lit by four torches that flank chests on the north and south walls. Each chest is locked and has a *Curse* (as per the reverse of *Remove Curse*) that has an 8 turn duration. The *Curse* will unfailingly lower the strength of any non-Clerics of "The Dark One" who touch it to 3. This curse will apply only to the 1st character to actually physically touch either of the boxes or their contents, including touching with weapons or lock picks. The north box is empty except that a cloud of sleep gas will be released into the room (save vs. poison) which will put characters not saving to sleep for the number of turns equal to their constitution subtracted from 20. The south box contains the following: a jeweled Mace valued at 200 GP, an Iron Box containing 100 GP, a Leather Bag with five 10 GP Gems, a 200 GP Gem, and a 150 GP Gem. There is also a skull-shaped silver goblet set with gem chips valued at 50 GP and Platinum Box, intricately carved with ancient runes valued at 250 GP (the runes merely state that this box was crafted for his high excellence the King of

Thracia, Argos II). Inside the platinum box is a pair of glass beads that appear to be exact replica's of human eyes. If a character loses one or both of his or her eyes, they can be replaced with these magic eyes which will grant *Infravision* and on a 2 times per day basis, *X-ray Vision*.

26) **The Bear Lair**: In this rough-carved room resides a black bear, AC: 7, HD: 3 + 3, Damage: 1 - 3/ 1 - 3/1 - 6, Hugs for 2 - 8, HP: 24. This bear will attack any characters not in the guards' distinctive Platemail. The bars to its cave are raised and lowered by a lever in Room 25.

27A) **Jets of Flame**: This is the northern half of an immense hall that appears to have been cleft in half by a deep chasm that extends into the walls both east and west. Any character being so unlucky as to fall into this chasm will take 8d6 of damage as they fall 80'. There is a 10% chance that the floor within 1' of the edge will crumble away when weight is placed upon it. It will then require a saving throw on a d20 of under the character's Dexterity -2 to keep from falling in. The secret door in the north wall is disguised in the ornate panel work and can normally be discovered only on a roll of 1 on a d6. The room reeks of decaying flesh.

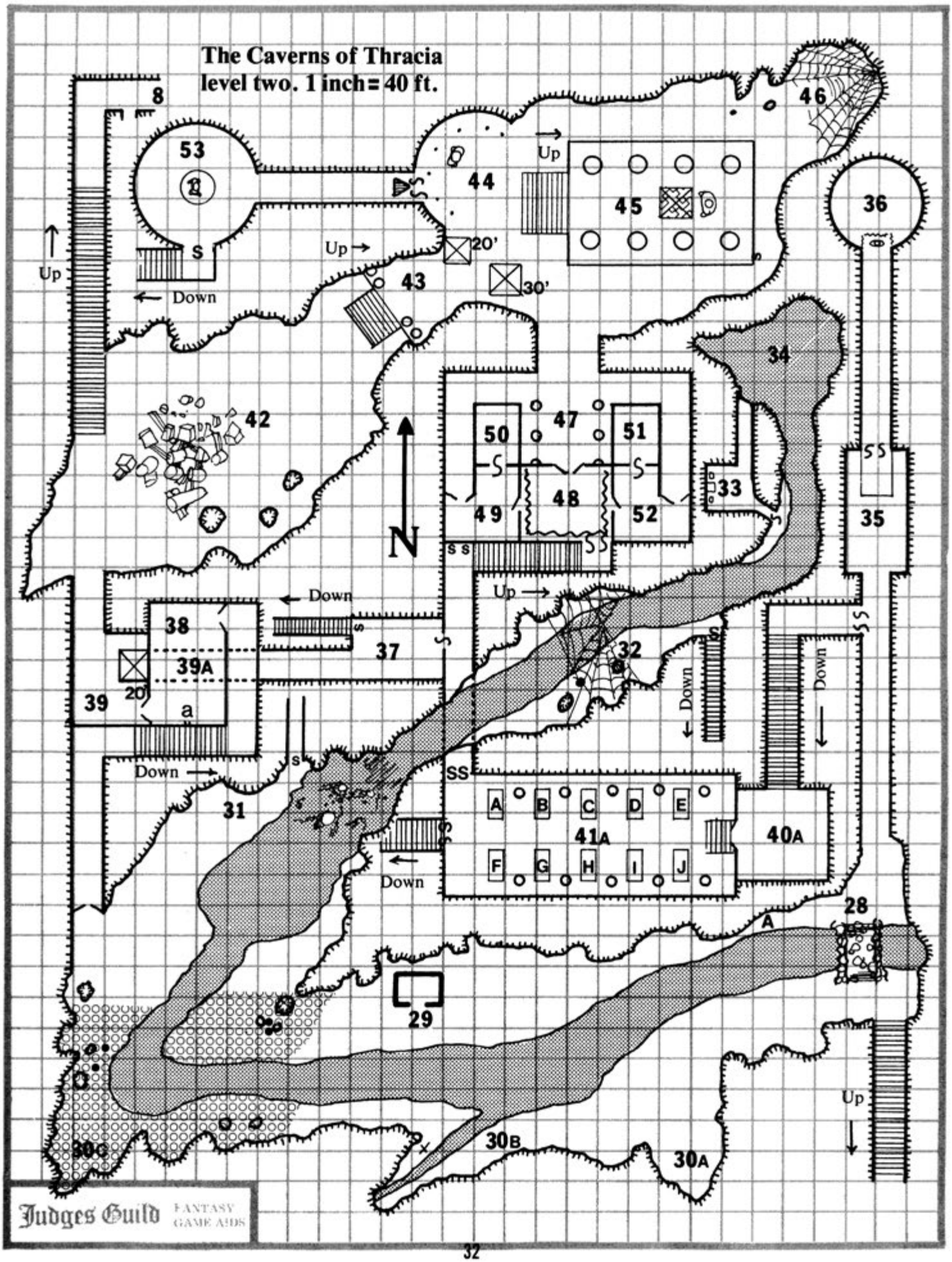
Passing between the two northernmost pillars will effect the following: A melee round later, flame will come spouting out of holes in the floor of the half circle area to the north (The holes are marked by dots on the map). Any character standing over these holes will take 1d6 of fire damage and any items on their person must save against normal fire. Any character remaining over a fire-spout will continue to take 1d6 of damage per round. After 3 rounds of flame (which leaves no smoke since it results from burning gas), a statue of a demon will appear to rise up out of the flames, all the while *Magic Mouth* spells set up a horrible, evil laughing. Flames pour out of the statue's mouth and its eyes glitter and sparkle for they are each a 300 GP gem. After 1 - 6 melee rounds the statue will begin to sink on its platform down to Room 53 on Level 2. After the head of the statue passes the floor level, 2' thick stone panels will seal the shaft closed and the fires will suddenly die out. The walls of the shaft itself are constructed of a slick, oily textured stone. The statue will work but once per week (it takes that long for the gas to recollect).

27B) **The Burial Crypt of the Cult of the Dark One**: The reek of decaying flesh permeates the air here and in 27A. For a further description of this room see above (27A). Lying in ordered rows are rank upon rank of corpses. Most are long decayed and in skeletal form, but many are still fairly fresh, not having been dead more than a few weeks (if you can call that fresh!). Lurking about and feeding on the cadavers is 1 carrion crawler, AC: 3, Move: 12", HD: 3 + 1, Damage: paralysis, 8 attacks, HP: 17. There is a 20% chance that the crawler will be hanging in the chasm. In one of the corpses is a clutch of 20 carrion crawler eggs. If the southernmost pair of columns is approached within 5' or if the columns are passed between or to either side, 1 - 4 skeletons will animate and begin to attack intruders. Each additional melee round 1 - 4 more skeletons will animate as long as there are living intruders to fight, up to a total of 400 skeletons. Skeletons, AC: 7, Move: 12", HD: 1, Damage: 1 - 6, HP: 3.

The "x" along the east wall represents a locked, stone chest. The chest is guarded by a magic trap that will do 2 - 12 points of electric damage to the first character to physically touch the box. The box contains personal possessions and valuables of the local patriarch of "The Dark One". Inside the chest is the following: A map that shows every room and secret passage in the holy of holies area of "The Dark One" (Rooms 14 through 27); a wooden box containing two 50 GP gems, a scroll written in ancient Thracian that tells of the sealed crypt of "The Dark One" (Rooms 9A through 13); and a begemmed statue of Athena, stolen from the palace of the Minotaur King long since, valued at 400 GP. The scroll that hints of the location of the crypt of Thanatos reads as follows:

"Dark God, Death's Head,
Sealed Forever in Ceaseless Mourning.
Captive and Kept From Service to Man,
Lost to Man is the Oracle Wise."

Level 2


The Caverns of Thracia
level two. 1 inch = 40 ft.
8
53
46
Up
44
45
36
Up
20'
Down
43
30'
34
42
47
50
51
33
49
48
52
35
N
Down
Up
38
37
32
39A
20
39
a
Down
Down
Down
31
SS
A
B
C
D
E
41A
40A
F
G
H
I
J
Down
28
29
Up
30C
30B
30A
Judges Guild
FANTASY GAME AIDS

28) **Bridge of the Giant Gnome**: Sitting on the stone bridge is what appears to be a small giant. Instead it is a giant Gnome named Grastic Hammerclay, AC: 6, HD: 5, Move: 12", Damage: 1 - 10, Weapon: Club and Spear, HP: 26. Hammerclay is a freak and was driven from his people years ago. He is severely disturbed and intensely paranoid. He is referred to by theTribesmen (the worshippers of The Dark One) as "The Old Man of the Bridge". The Gnome survives on snared Stirges and crayfish. He would really appreciate being given some real food and would let a party of adventurers pass by him unscathed for a weeks worth of rations. If attacked he can also function as a 4th level Illusionist (see **Strategic Review**, Vol. 1, No. 4) using the following spells: *Phantasmal Forces, Phantasmal Forces, Hypnotism, and Hypnotic Pattern*. In a sack near the wall the Gnome giant has 89 GP, 68 SP, 221 CP, a small gem worth 30 GP, and a large, rusty iron key (see below). He is willing to trade some of his "pretties" for more food. If wounded more than 50%, the Gnome will fling himself into the river and hide under the bridge. If his location is investigated he will whimper out "Go away!" "Leave me alone." or "Everybody hates me." The large, rusty, iron key in Grastic's treasure bag is actually a master key to the cell doors in Rooms 103, 104 and Room 105 A, B, and C.

The passageway leading to the north out of this area is smoothly carved and the floor is inlaid with polished marble tiles.

28A) **Slippery Edge**: This is a narrow ledge leading along the river's edge. At the location of the "A" the floor is extremely slippery, due to water flowing down and across the ledge. If special precautions are not taken, such as roping characters together or driving spikes into the walls, it is possible that the unlucky may plunge into the dark river. Each character passing over the slippery point must roll under their Dexterity -3 on a d20 or fall in the river. Note: On a roll of 20, even special precautions will not prevent falling in. The river is 15 feet deep and has a current of 10 feet per second. Under the surface of the water are jagged rocks and boulders. If characters do fall in, they will be swept downstream to fetch up against a rocky ledge. The trip downstream will inflict 1d8 of damage unless the character can roll under his Dexterity on a d20. If the roll is made only 1d4 of damage will occur. Slipping into the water but being held by rope will only inflict 1 point of damage on a roll of 1 or 2 on 1d6.

29) **Dead Halflings**: This is a run down cottage, constructed of fieldstone and roofed with straw thatch, now moldy and rotting in the high humidity. The floor of the cavern at this point is deeply covered with sand. Thrust into the sand in front of the cottage is a crude Spear. Mounted on the protruding shaft of the Spear is the clean skull of a Lizard Man. Various arcane, but crude symbols are painted on the brow of the skull. It is obviously a warning of some kind. To the Lizard Men who dwell throughout the caverns, this place is taboo. If they discover that it has been tampered with or entered, look out! It's holy war with every Lizard Man fighting at a +1 hit probability to the death (they think it is some how connected with their ancestors). Inside the cottage (which is slightly ransacked and contains evidence that the worshippers of Thanatos were responsible), is a cot and a table and chair. On the cot is the dessicated corpes of a Halfling in long, tattered robes. Lying on the chest of the skeleton is an open scroll. The scroll (written in ancient Thracian, uncomprehensible without *Read Languages* spell, and only a 30% chance of being read by any character with a natural read languages ability), tells of the wonders of King Agamemno's palace and the wonderful gardens that surround it deep within the earth. Various passages will refer to the "Beast Men" who serve the King and of the living trees. On the table is a wax candle that once lit, will act as a *Continual Light* spell until extinguished. It may only be re-lit 6 times. A gust of wind has a 10% chance of dousing the light. Around the neck of the corpse is a fish-shaped silver medallion (value 69 GP) that if taken from the cottage will attract 1 - 3 berserk Lizard Men each round on a d6 roll of 4 - 6. AC: 5, HD: 2+1, Move: 6/12, Damage: 1 - 2/1 - 2/1 - 8, HP: Roll as necessary.

30A) **Stirge Strike**: This area is a natural indentation into the cavern wall. Possibly at some distant time in the past a tributary to the main river may have flowed from this point. Now, however, the niche is occupied by the shards and fragments of several ornate columns and a shattered statue to some now indistinguishable god. Any in-depth search of the area will reveal scattered, half-buried human bones and 1 or 2 weapons (a heavily tarnished and dull Bronze Sword and a Stone Mace). It is doubtful

that this search will be made since the niche is also the dwelling place of a colony of 10 Stirges, AC: 7, Move: 18", HD: 1, Damage: 1 - 3 + Blood Drain of 1 - 4 points each round thereafter up to a maximum of 12 points, HP: 2 (x2), 6, 7 (x2), 8, 4, 1, 5, 3. The Stirges will be well hidden in the rock formations, giving them a 1 - 4 chance of a d6 of surprising the unwary.

30B) **Shallow Stream**: This is a shallow flow of water coming out of the rock wall. It is approximately 5' wide but only inches deep. Lying about the stream are the long-dead bodies of 3 Tribesmen. One appears to have been crushed to death. Strewn about them are 2 Spears and a Shield. In a pouch on the crushed man's body is a soft leather cloth containing four 20 GP turquoise gem stones folded carefully in it. One of the other dead men has a Bronze Dagger with a magic looking rune carved on it (a good luck charm and nothing else). The small "x" located on the west bank of the streamlet marks the location of a Piercer, AC: 3, Move: 1", HD: 2, Damage: 2 - 12, HP: 11. It will drop from the ceiling on any creature passing below it. The Piercer appears as a 3' long stalactite. It is assisted by a pair of Stirges, AC: 7, Move: 18", HD: 1, Damage: 1 - 3 + Blood Drain of 1 - 4 points up to 12 each round thereafter, HP: 1, 5. Again, the Stirges are well hidden, allowing them to attack with surprise on a d6 roll of 1 - 4.

30C) **Lair of the Falling Stalactites**: You will not find the circle pattern in this area on the map key. It indicates the possible locations for a group of Piercers. The black dots mark the location of 4 of the creatures. The remaining 7 should be randomly located by the referee and marked upon the map as to size and placement. 11 Piercers, AC: 3, Move: 1", HD: 1 to 4, Damage: Variable (see below), HP: (by size of hit dice with damage following), 1 HD: 5 (x3), Damage: 1 - 6; 3 HD: 6, 18 (x2), 8, 12, Damage: 3 - 18; 4 HD: 21 (x2), Damage: 4 - 24. Location of Piercers as marked on map: West Bank: 1 HD and 3 HD; East Bank: 1 HD and 4 HD. The Lizard Men usually pass through this area in the water and avoid any problems with the hanging menaces.

31) **The Lizard Encampment**: The west bank of the cavern at this point is the lair of a small tribe of Lizard Men, numbering 15 (there are other members of this tribe but they are not present and are elsewhere in the caverns). This tribe owes it fealty to the Minotaur King. They are presided over by a religious leader, a Shamen, who operates as a 4th level Cleric. He can whip the Lizard Men up to a battle-frenzy (60% chance) giving the creatures +1 hit probability. If he is killed, the Lizard Men will either (1 - 25%) run in terror, (26 - 60%) continue to fight normally, (61 - 85%) continue to fight in battle frenzy at +1 hit probability, or (86 - 00%) go into berserker rage that will cause them to fight at +2 hit probability and damage and also add half again the number of their hit points to their total since they are fighting

G'ruk: Shaman of the Lizardmen

without regards to pain (lowers AC by 3 when fighting as berserker). Lizard Shaman (G'ruk the Fish-finder), AC: 4, Armor: Skin and Shield, Move 6"/12" (swimming), HD: 4, Damage: Mace 1 - 8, spells: *Cause Light Wounds, Cause Fear, Hold Person*. On his person the Shaman has a satchel that contains a Potion of Undead Control, 18 GP, 4 Sacred Rocks (useless), a mummified Human Hand, 6 Teeth of various Creatures, 4 Bags of various Powders (1 is alum, 2 and 3 are useless, 4 is a poison dust that is -1 on saving throw. Failure to save means death while a save indicates taking 1 - 8 points of damage. This is verulent poison! It may be inhaled since the full bag of dust will form a 10' x 10' x 10' cloud, mixed with water and taken internally for up to 5 dosages or smeared on weapons as a paste, 2 applications), a Set of 20 Divining Sticks, 5 or 6 Strips of dried Human Flesh and a Human Jawbone. As a last resort, the Shaman will cast the poison dust as a missile weapon creating a cloud of dust (see above) when it hits. There is a 10% chance that the bag will not burst on impact. The magic potion was obtained from the treasure trove in Room 33. About 5 Lizard Braves died obtaining this one bottle. Since then the Shaman has learned of the legend that requires human blood to obtain the treasure. "Cast the blood of man upon the troubled waters." (False) is how the phrase goes. The Shaman has been waiting for a living human to come his way for some time (the Lizard Men usually only bring back pieces). G'ruk knows of a secret door in the north wall and has a secret Lair in Room 53 H.

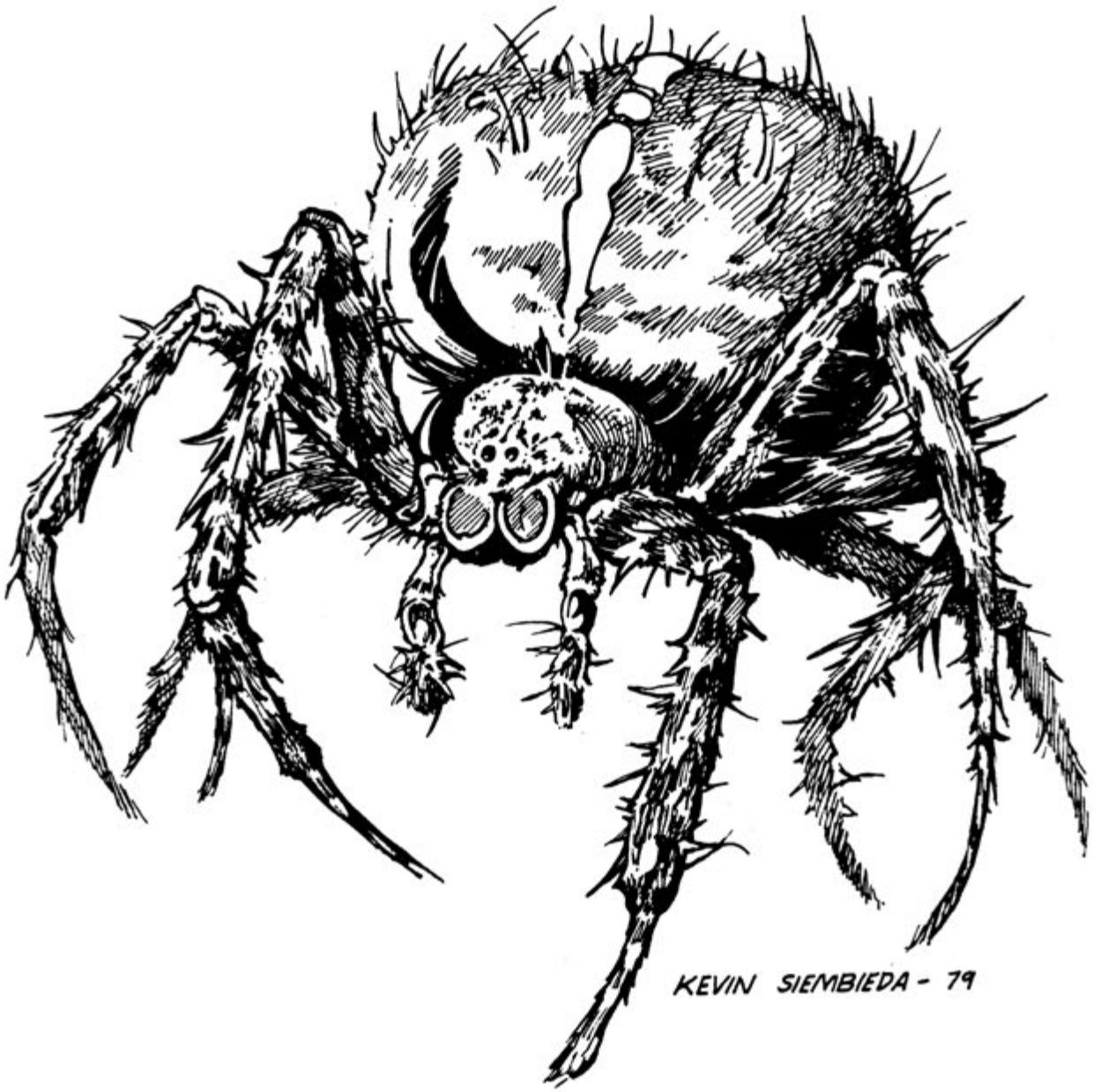
The composition of the rest of the Lizard Band will be as follows: 5 mercenary warriors on leave from the Minotaur's guard, AC: 4, Armor: Skin and Shield, Move: 6"/12" (swimming), HD: 2 + 1, Weapons: Club, Damage: 1 - 8, 4 Darts, Damage: 1 - 4, HP: 12, 8, 15 (x2), 14. These Lizard Men will not turn and run if the Shaman is killed, as they are trained for battle. The 12 hit point Lizard Man has a key to the north door. If any of the humans are captured, there is a 10% chance that one of these Lizard Men will suggest taking one or more captives to the palace of the Minotaur King.

The remaining 9 Lizard Men will be mixed male and female (no difference in statistics), AC: 5, Move: 6"/12" (swimming), HD: 2 + 1, Weapon: claw/claw/bite, Damage: 1 - 3/1 - 3/1 - 8. These are standard issue savage Lizard Men without weapons or extra armor. When encountered for the first time they will be devouring the corpses of several dismembered Tribesmen. There will be 1 - 4 Lizard Men in the water who will be invisible to anyone not looking for them. These Lizard Men will wait until an opportune moment to attack.

The doors to the passage leading north are of heavy oak, covered with moss and bound with weathered bronze. The doors are locked and one of the Lizard mercenaries (see above) has the key.

32) **Spiderweb (And Spider!)**: At this point in the cavern (see map), passage is blocked by an immense spiderweb that is connected to all the walls, ceiling and floor. So dense is it woven that it would take a full turn of chopping to create a single, mansized passage through it. The web will also snare any item floating on the surface of the river. Any creature with 18 or greater strength can break free, if entrapped, in 1 melee round, a 17 strength requires 2 melee rounds, etc. Hidden in a shadowy niche in the cavern ceiling is the giant spider, AC: 4, Move: 3"/12" (in web), HD: 4 + 4, Weapon: Bite, Damage: 2 - 8 + poison, save or die. Near the spider and visible from the cavern floor is a large leathery sack of spider silk containing her foul offspring. Unless cut open, there is a 05% chance that the egg sack will burst open, unleashing a torrent of mouse and rat-sized baby spiders. Most of the youngsters will busy themselves with eating each other, but 10 - 100 will attack something else, adventurers most likely. Each baby spider has 1 - 2 hit points and is AC: 7. They will attack visciously as 1 - 1 hit die creatures and do 1 point of damage + inject a small dose of poison. Each time a character is bitten by one of these little creatures, a save vs. poison must be made. However, due to their small size, the character may take half his constitution and subtract it from the number needed to save. He then must roll over that number or die (probably from an allergic reaction). Each additional time that a character is bitten, the roll must be made, except that the number needed to save increases by one point each time and may even become greater than the original base number if a character is bitten and saves often enough.

One may well ask what a giant spider's lair is doing so close to the lair of the Lizard Men. Well, it's more a case of mutual toleration than anything else. The Lizard Men feed the spider an occasional living Tribesman, and the spider lets them pass beneath her web without interference.


KEVIN SIEMBIEDA - 79

33) **A Seemingly Abandoned Treasure Vault**: This is a dark little vault carved into the stone. The walls are painted with images of huge fanged mouths. It appears that the vault has been entered recently and the dust that has settled on the floor over the ages has been disturbed. There are dark stains along the floor in the hall leading to the north out of the room. The north hall is also slightly damp. The constant gurgling of water can be heard from Room 34. In the vault itself are 3 boxes, 1 large and 2 small. The small box on the right of the large box is open and empty (both small boxes are approximately the same size as shoe boxes). The small box on the left and the large box are both locked and sealed with wax seals. In the small box is a Potion of Invisibility and a +1 Dagger with a solid Garnet hilt and an apparent jewelry value of 1200 GP. The box is protected or more correctly "haunted" by a spectral, disembodied mouthful of sharp teeth. The mouth will bite any hand that is thrust into the box (it is invisible) and then appear for 3 melee rounds, darting in and about biting at will. If not destroyed in the initial encounter the creature will disappear, to reappear 5 - 10 rounds later. It will gain 4 hit points each time it disappears and instead of biting for 1 - 4 points of damage it will bite for 1 - 6. Then, when it appears a third time (with an additional 4 hit points), it will bite for 1 - 8 points of damage and so on. It will continue to attack in this fashion (appearing every 5 - 10 turns and attacking for 1 - 3 melee rounds, then disappearing for another 5 - 10 rounds) until it is destroyed or the treasure it was guarding is discarded.

Disembodied Mouth: AC: 0, Move: 24, HD: Variable, but starts at 3, then goes up 1 each time it reappears, Weapon: Bite, Damage: Variable, starts at 1 - 4, but each time it reappears it goes to the next larger dice size. Once d20 is reached the next attack will be at 1d20 + 1d4, and so on, HP: Variable, but starts at 8 hit points and goes up by 4 hit points each time it reappears.

The Disembodied Mouth is an enchanted creature and may be defended against with *Protection from Evil*. A *Dispel Magic* spell will destroy it, however, it is allowed a saving throw. It can not be *charmed* or *slept*. The creature will attack the first time for three melee rounds and then disappear for 5 - 10 turns, reappearing and attacking for 1 - 3 melee rounds then disappear again and so on. If not destroyed soon, it gets very nasty, very quickly.

The large box is protected in a similar fashion to the small box on its left. It contains a disembodied mouth which will attack in exactly the same fashion as the one in the smaller container. The large box is approximately 3' square and 2' tall. It contains 10 bags with 100 GP each (1000 GP total), a +1 Shield that is decorated with a silver and platinum tracery and studded with 70 carnelians. It has an apparent jewelry value of 170 GP. However this will be reduced by 100 GP each time it is used in melee. There is a non-intelligent +1 Sword and Sheath; a 50 GP silver Mirror; a 900 GP iron Axe, studded with green glass and jade; a 140 GP gold Brooch; and a 100 GP Anklet of solid obsidian with intricate designs inlaid into it in an unknown alloy and electrum.

At this point, most adventurers are ready to relax, having obtained the treasure, however, they have not yet tangled with the real guardian beast (see Room 34). 2 - 7 melee rounds after the large chest is opened, 1 - 2 armored tentacles will come snaking in through the north corridor and begin to attack.

34) **Great Grasping Guardians**: Usually dormant, this creature lies beneath the bubbling waters which are the source of the river. If the treasure in Room 33 is disturbed (see above) then it will begin to attack by sending **The Guardian Beast**, AC: 3, Move: 18", HD: 6, Weapon: Tentacles, Damage: 1 - 8, HP: See Below. The guardian is a variation on the octopus theme. The creature has 6 tentacles, all armored and 50' long. The body of the beast takes 30 hit points and each tentacle takes 20. Tentacles hits may be regenerated at a rate of 3 points per turn if the wounded appendage is withdrawn from combat. Hits to the body can not be regenerated. A single blow of 10+ points of damage will sever that tentacle entirely and it will be immediately withdrawn from melee and will not be used for at least 15 rounds. When a tentacle has taken 20 points of damage it will by automatically withdrawn from the fracas. The body of the creature is always submerged beneath the water. It sees by using the eyes on the ends of its appendages. Blinking an eye does not blind that appendage, but blinding all eyes will functionally blind the beast. The creature attacks by using its crushing tentacles to wrap around victims and crush them to death. Once a victim is latched onto the creature gains an automatic hit of 1 - 8 on subsequent rounds until the victim is freed by destroying the tentacle. To complicate matters, the victim will be dragged at a rate of 20' per round toward the water. A victim may survive underwater without breathing a number of melee rounds equal to his constitution divided by 4 (drop fractions). At that point he or she suffers death by drowning. Also remember

that non-magical armor is incredibly heavy in the water. There is a 50% chance that a victim entrapped by the guardian beast will have his Sword or weapon arm impaired and will be unable to escape unaided. If the creature is slain, it will rise to the surface and slowly float downstream to be trapped in the spider's web (if it still exists). The creature has a single eye that is formed of a huge jelly-like gem stone that will dry and harden and shrink into a 3000 GP diamond.

The bubbling pool that is the source of the river is very, very deep. The water rises up through a pipe or shaft that extends far into the depths of the earth. It can not be traversed by swimming. Up through it, come the escape pods from Level 3 (see Room 117).

35) **Hall of the Sphinx**: The hall leading north between area 28 and Room 35 has an inlaid marble floor of pearly gray stone. The walls are constructed of panels of marble. Each panel is 5' wide and 15' tall. In the center of each panel and about 5' off the ground is a Human skull that is set into the stone. The hall is illumed in dim green light that seems to emmanate from the eyes of the skulls. If any of the skulls are touched, a low chuckling laughter can be heard (*Magic Mouth*). The secret door on the west wall is disguised as a normal section of wall. To open the door, both skulls on the door panels must be pressed simultaneously. There is a 40% chance that either skull will try to bite the hand that is touching it (as 1 hit die monster) for 1 - 2 points of damage. Again the low, chuckling laughter will be audible.

From the hallway, Room 35 appears to be dark and empty. The only distinguishing feature will be the 7' high, 10' x 15' pedestle at the north end of the chamber. The ceiling in this room is 40' high and barrel (circular) vaulted. The walls appear blank. Once the room is entered, the situation changes. A near-blinding column of golden light is shining directly down on the pedestle. None of the light directly touches anthing but the pedestle, but it serves to sufficiently illume the remainder of the room. The walls are decorated with ornate fresco paintings (painted plaster) showing the activities of some unknown gods and heroes. Lying upon the pedestle is a large sphinx, who has obviously been aware of and watching any intruders for quite some time. Sphinx (named Ontussa): AC: -1, Move: 15"/24", HD: 8, Weapons: 2 claws, Damage: 2 - 8/2 - 8, HP: 47, Align: N, Spells (each usable once per day): *Detect Magic, Read Magic, Read Languages, Detect Invisible, Locate Object, Dispel Magic, Clairaudience, Clairvoyance, Remove Curse, Legend Lore*. This sphinx is also a Sage, average in 3 categories (65% chance of answering a question correctly). Whether she is right or not she will provide an answer. Being neutral, she is not in the pay of the Minotaur King. However, she does require that a fee be paid her, even if she does not answer a question. Minimum fee for a question is 100 GP. Minimum fee for entering the room is 10 GP per person. If either fee is not paid she will activate the doors which block the passage to the south and must be treated as *Wizard Locked* doors. The golden light acts as a magic absorbing field also providing *Protection from normal Missiles* and serving to douse all natural fires. If the sphinx is killed by adventurers, she will lay a *Curse* on them with her dying breath that will lower one randomly determined ability (Strength, Intelligence, Wisdom, etc.) by 1 point. This lowering will be permanent and only rectifiable by a *Remove Curse*. Upon the death of the sphinx, the secret doors, up til now invisible (not by spell) will appear. They are locked and at -5% on opening by thieves. The death of the sphinx will not open the south doors. They will remain closed until the sphinx wills them to open or until her blood is smeared upon them.

36) **Intriguing Treasures and Deep Shafts**: The hall leading to this room from Room 35 is normally lit with a magical green light. However, if the sphinx has been killed to obtain passage to this hall, then the walls will glow with a throbbing red light instead of the normal cool green. At the northern end of the hall is a statue of a lion-headed man with glowing orange eyes. He is flanked by red curtains on his left and right and to his rear. If the secret doors from Room 35 are passed through, and the hall entered by more than 10', he will come to life. The lion man is 9' tall, AC: 3, Move: 12", HD: 5, Weapon: Mace, Damage: 2 - 12, HP: 32. Lodged in the chest of the statue creature is a 500 GP gem. If the walls glow green, then the gem merely makes him half immune to edged weapons allowing him to take only half damage from all cuts and thrusts. If the walls glow red, then he has the above ability plus, wherever he walks, the ground, be it stone or earth, in a 5' radius, around him turns to 2' deep mud for 2 melee rounds. The lion man can walk on top of the mud like it was solid earth. This creature is intelligent, but it will also fight to the death. It does not wish to preserve its life so much as it desires to protect that which lies beyond the curtains. If the gem in his chest (a 500 GP diamond) is removed or destroyed it loses all magic powers except that it will allow the bearer a +1 on all saving throws.

If the curtains to Room 36 touch living flesh (not armor or clothing) they will immediately adhere to it (no saving throw) and cannot be removed except by *Dispel Magic*. The curtains may be pulled down but they can not be physically affected (cut, burned, torn, etc.) until the *Dispel Magic* has been cast. There are 3 sections of drapery (east, west and north) and each one will adhere to any living flesh until a *Dispel Magic* has been cast upon it. The height of the curtains is 15'. The width of the side curtains is 8' and the back curtain is 16' wide (specifics are gone into here because someone is certainly going to figure out that these things can be used as weapons or traps).

This is the treasure room of the sphinx. It is lit by dim, amber light. The two most immediately obvious features of the circular room are two holes. One is 10' wide and located in the exact center of the room. It is circular and 120' deep. This smooth-walled shaft leads down to Room 118 on Level 3 A. If a character has bare hands and feet, they will act like suction pads and he may climb down as a thief of the same level. The shaft itself is 70' long with a final drop of 30'. The second hole is circular and 6' in diameter. It is positioned on the north wall of the room. It is 3' from the floor to the bottom edge of the hole. In reality this hole is a portable hole.

In plain sight at the back of the portable hole is a large wooden box. It appears to be attached to the back wall of the hole. This is because there is a gravity orientation in the hole and that no matter which direction the hole faces, the bottom is "down". So strong is this gravitational pull, that anything passing within 5' of the hole opening (directly "over" it only) will be drawn into it as if he were falling (for 1d6 + 1 points of falling damage, save vs. magic applicable). A character with below average strength (or less) will be unable to climb out of the hole unaided by rope or friends. Inside the box are the following: 4000 GP in 100 GP ingots and 2000 SP in coin, an ornate Stone Axe worth 150 GP, a 300 GP Ring of electrum and a 1200 GP heavy platinum Chain. Also a Helm of Telepathy. The box itself is locked. Smashing the lock will fracture the Helm, making it worthless.

37) **Frost Vault**: This room is in a section of the caverns that has not been rediscovered or opened in at least a millenium (1000 years). If approached from the east hall, the door seems to be a part of the blank, stone wall. However, if the wall is felt, the 5' section that is the door will be 20 to 30 degrees (Fahrenheit) colder than the rest of the wall. Each character feeling the wall or touching the wall at that particular point must save against magic or lose 1 energy level. The door is actually a living creature of some foul kind and it has not eaten for a long, long time. The door creature is AC: 2, HD: 4, Damage: Touch Drains One Life Level, HP: 22. It is of the chaotic evil alignment. After the second melee round when it is touched or attacked, the door will start spewing forth a frosty vapor from beneath it that will *charm* any living creature touched by it at +2 saving throw. The charmed creature will then seek to embrace the door until it or the door is destroyed. The vapor cloud will travel at the rate of 10' per melee round up to a distance of 40' in any direction. The vapor, being intensely cold, will negate any *infravision* into or out of its area of effect.

In Room 37 itself, the door creature is invisible or at least appears to be a part of the wall. The room is thickly coated in a layer of frost and snow is 1 - 2' deep about the room and also 10 - 20' up into hallway 39A. Lying frozen on the floor are two bodies. One is a man and the other a woman. They are Thracian fighters. Both are dressed in body-fitting Platemail of odd design and wear plumed helmets. The man is dead, but if the female is taken from the room she will revive. Since she speaks ancient Thracian, of which there is no known surviving tongue (as far as the character's may know). The language of the Tribesmen is a form of ancient Thracian. A Tribesman would be able to basically understand what the fighting woman is saying and vice versa. If the adventurers use a Tribesman interpreter to talk with this woman the following may result:

Determine the intelligence of the interpreter and subtract the score from 14 (a positive remainder indicates a greater difficulty in understanding the language, whereas a negative remainder would indicate an ease of translation). Then, go to the chart below and roll each time a verbal interchange is made between the Tribesman interpreter and the Thracian fighting woman, adding the remainder to the die roll of a d20. Based on the die roll, the referee may determine the outcome of a given conversation.

Interpretation Chart
Roll on a d20

01 - 09	Correct Interpretation, message clear.
10 - 13	Vague Interpretation, message or part of message unclear.
14 - 15	Opposite meaning than intended is recieved.
16	Message comes across as an insult.
17 - 20	Total message is incomprehensible, nothing understood.

Epicaste, Fighting Woman, Align: Lawful Good, Level 3, AC: -2, HD: 3, Armor: +1 magic Plate Armor and non-magic Shield, Weapon: Longsword, HP: 21, STR: 14, INT: 14, WIS: 10, DEX: 17, CON: 16, CHR: 13. Epicaste is a fighting woman in the service of her King, Agamemnos, who has been dead for at least 1100 years. The last thing that she remembers is coming down into this room via the trap door in Room 39 with 3 other soldiers. She and Danaus (the dead man) must have been affected by something in the room. She will vaguely remember a cold mist. Danaus can be found lying in front of the door creature. Epicaste will say that the reason they were down here was that they were investigating the possible hiding places where the Beast Men could be headquartering. There are rumors that they are planning an uprise (unless it is made clear to her that over a millenium has passed since she and her companion were overcome, Epicaste will be adamant that only hours could have gone by since she lost consciousness. Epicaste will know her way through the northern part of the 2nd level (Rooms 31, 38, 39, 39A, 42 - 47), Rooms 1 - 8 of the 1st level, the north wing of the palace on the 3rd level and all of the dungeon on the 4th level. However, she will not know of their present occupants and she will not know of any secret doors (past or present). If any character can speak in the Gnollic tongue (Beast Men), Epicaste may communicate with them as per the interpreting chart. To see if the intent or meaning of a phrase is understood, follow the direction for the chart, the person trying to understand the phrase operating as the interpreter. If no adventurer speaks Thracian, the language of the Tribesmen, or Gnollic, then communication will be possible only via hand signals or a variation of *Read Languages* (Epicaste is 65% capable of writing legibly in her own tongue).

Epicaste's armor will not fit a male character nor will it fit a character taller or shorter than the 5' 2" to 5' 5" height range.

Danaus' armor is not magic but it will fit any character of 13 - 16 Strength and 5' 6" to 5' 9" tall.

38) **Gnoll Guardpost**: Barracked in this room are 8 Gnoll warriors (one will not be in the room for he is standing guard in Room 39). The Gnolls: AC: 5, Move: 9", HD: 2, Weapon and HP: See Below.

Grotch (leader): Two-handed Sword, HP: 15; 9 SP, 7 GP.

Vredd (2nd in command): Two-handed Sword, HP: 15; 6 SP, 8 GP.

Gnoll 1: Morning Star, HP: 8; 7 SP, 5 GP.

Gnoll 2: Two-handed Sword, HP: 12; 2 SP, 4 GP.

Gnoll 3: Battle Axe, HP: 11; 7 SP, 5 GP.

Gnoll 4: Longbow and Battle Axe, HP: 12; 10 SP, 2 GP.

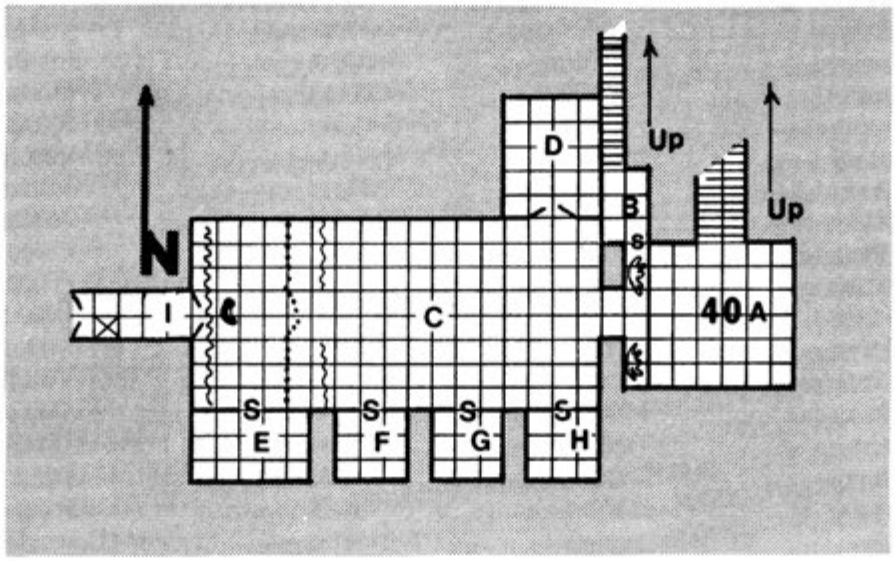
Gnoll 5: Two-handed Sword, HP: 5; 4 SP, 6 GP.

Human slave named **Grassus** (Tribesman): AC: 9, HD: 1, HP: 2.

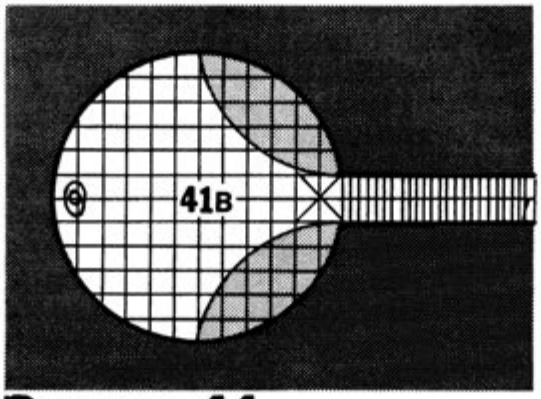
The room is filthy with offal, food scraps, bits of armor, scraps of leather, broken weapons (useless), discarded boxes, broken furniture, shreds of cloth, various nameless disgusting pieces of assorted garbage and a motley collection of disconnected bones. The human slave will be of no assistance to adventurers in combat, since he is rather dull-witted and scared of his masters. He was captured by the Gnolls as a child from his home village almost 30 years ago and speaks only the Gnollic tongue.

The letter "a" in the room represents a spy-hole in the wall looking in on the stairwell. There is a 75% probability that one of the Gnolls will be at this viewport and will see any movement along the stair, thus alerting the rest of the guardpost. The reason for the existance of this post is to keep an eye on the Lizard Men, who are basically trustworthy but somewhat unpredictable due to the presence of the Shaman G'ruk.

If necessary, both doors in this room can be bolted with a heavy oaken bar from the inside.



Room Complex 40A-I



Room 41B

39) **A Lone Guard**: Standing before the double doors to Room 38 is a single Gnoll guard, AC: 5, Move: 9, HD: 2, Weapon: Sword, HP: 9. He is standing in one of the few places in the room that is not covered with heaps of garbage (some of the garbage piles are 1000 years old!). The floor itself is covered with at least a full foot of ancient compressed garbage. If the floor is sounded for hollow spaces, the 10' square trap door marked by the large "x" on the floor will be evident. However, the large pile of garbage that covers that area must first be moved. There will be nothing of value in the garbage heaps. Reward any characters who diligently search the piles though with 1 - 6 SP and 1 - 10 CP.

39A) **A Chillsome Hall**: It is a 20' drop from Room 39 to the level of this hallway. The hall itself is much colder than the rest of the dungeon since it leads into the frozen Room 37. The last 10 to 20' of the hall going east are covered with 1 - 2' of snowy frost. Where the walls are not covered by frost, very archaic almost crude wall paintings will be evident. They were created by the people who first discovered the caverns and dug much of the crypts in this area. The more advanced civilization that created King Agamemnos' underground palace developed out of this culture. The statuary in Room 41 will show the signs of being from the same period.

40A) **A Chamber of Skeletons**: The secret doors in the hall leading to Room 35 open up on a short hall ending in a set of roughly carved stairs leading further in to the depths of the earth. The room they enter has a ceiling 35' in height. The blank stone walls are lined with human skeletons. Each 5' section of wall contains 1 skeleton (total of 20): AC: 7, Move: 6", HD: 1, Damage: 1 - 6, HP: 4. The eyes of the skeletons glow with an eerie orange light.

A special note about the stair leading down to this room. The stairwell is filled with the ancient, but still strong, webs of a long dead giant spider, whose husk can still be found about 30' down the stair. Passage down the stair can only be effected by somehow removing the webs. Fire is the simplest method.

The west wall of the room contains a locked, 10' wide door on the floor level and also another locked 10' wide door 20' above the floor (which goes to 40 C). However this upper door is *Illusioned* to appear as blank wall. This door has a 5' wide ledge in front of it that runs the width of the room. Flanking the door on the left and right are a pair of stone gargoyles. These statues can not be chipped, broken or knocked out of place. The north wall of the ledge is a secret doo (to 40 B). (Room 40 and 41 are split level on level 2.)

The doors on the lower level are magicked so that anyone attempting to open them will be bitten by a variation of the *Magic Mouth* spell. Instead of an illusionary mouth appearing and speaking, a mouth filled with very sharp teeth will appear at the exact location that is being touched by the opener and bite for 1 - 4 points of damage (saving throw vs. magic applicable). This will occur a total of 4 times. *Dispel Magic* will remove the mouth permanently.

40B) **Guardian of Singular Combat**: The single fighting man in this room will never be surprised. He appears to be garbed from head to toe in cunningly crafted Platemail. His face is hidden by a visor. The guardian is armed with Sword and Shield. He will fight at a minimum level of 4th or as a fighter 2 levels higher than his opponent. Guardian: AC: 2, Move: 9", HD: 4+, Damage: 1 - 8, HP: 25. The guardian will mentally say to any who enter: "I am the guardian. To pass me, I must be defeated and destroyed. Choose your champion." The guardian will not attack until a single champion has been determined from intruding adventurers. If he is attacked enmasse, then the first adventurer to cross swords with him or hit him with a spell (or join combat in any manner) will be his opponent. At that point he is impervious to all attacks or attempts at hindrace by any other being. Any further attempt at touching or attacking the guardian will pass through him as if he were smoke or immaterial. The same will go for his opponent. Once locked in combat with the guardian, it is to the death. If the guardian is defeated by the adventurer, he then collapses into a pile of jumbled and rusting armor. His sword, however, remains bright and shiny since it will now function as a +1 magic blade. If the adventurer half the hit points he has lost and make the challenge again (see above). If at any point, the adventurers leave the room without defeating the guardian, the guardian will immediately regain all lost hit points. The door opposite the one entered will close with a *Wizard Lock* until the guardian dies.

40C) **The Throne Hall**: This large, unlit hall is draped at the western end. A 10' wide opening is in the 1st pair of drapes, but the curtains behind the throne are unbroken and run from ceiling to floor and wall to wall. A wall of bars with a 10' wide door in the center will prevent intruders from approaching the throne. The gate in the bars is locked and -15% on picking due to some complicated inner workings. The bars are of iron and extremely thick.

The throne itself, though somewhat crudely constructed and decorated with monster faces and strange runic symbols (even a *Read Languages* spell will make no sense of them), is apparently gold-plated (value 5000 GP). If the throne is sat in, the sitter must make a -2 saving throw vs. magic or have his alignment immediately change to chaotic evil. This change will only be apparent to the character affected. Any attempt to touch the throne other than sitting in it will paralyze the toucher (as per a ghoul touch, but this also includes Elves) until *Dispel Magic* or until the victim is touched by a lawful good character. When a victim is paralyzed, a glistening wetness will appear on the north wall that will form into an ochre jelly in 3 melee rounds and drop to the floor, immediately heading for the throne area and any victims. Ochre Jelly: AC: 8, Move: 3", HD: 5, Damage: 2 - 12, HP: 30.

If the question of "What happens when a lawfully good aligned character touches the throne?" arises, the answer is that, instead of just paralyzing the victim it will also deal out alignment shock as per a magic sword, doing 2 - 12 points of damage. A maximum of 24 points of damage will be dealt out. At that point the chair will lose its ability to paralyze, change alignment and do shock damage. However, it will also then change to worthless lead (weight, 500 encumbrance points).

Behind the curtains at the west end of the hall are a pair of stone doors, each carved with the face of a beneficent looking man.

40D) **The Crypt of the Mummy**: The door to this room is locked and also closed with 2 heavy bars of strong oak. On the lock is a wax seal bearing the signet of a dead king of ancient Thracia (at least 2000 years old). Extending 10' out from the north wall is a 5' wide, 3' tall stone crypt. It is featureless and has a hingeless stone lid (a 5' x 10' stone slab). Touching the crypt with anything (hand, weapon, pole, rock, etc.) will cause the slab to explode for 1 - 3 points of automatic damage to all characters within 5' of the crypt. A tall, gaunt figure will spring up, armed with a black sword. The being is a mummified, ancient king of Thracia, doomed by his evil life to live forever. AC: 3, Move: 6", HD: 5 + 1, Damage: 1 - 12 + Level Drain or 1 - 12 + Rotting Disease (see below), HP: 26. The mummy is armed with the magic sword "Thirster" (see below) and there is a 50% chance each round of combat that he will use it to attack with instead of just clawing. The sword is in his right hand. **Thirster**: This chaotic evil sword has no pluses, but instead it drains one energy level each time it hits in addition to normal sword damage. The sword has an Intelligence of 12 and an Ego of 8, speaks Chaotic, Red Dragon and Troll, detects gems, good and sloping passages, locates secret doors and endow the bearer with *ESP*. The sword may communicate telepathically with its bearer as well as speak in audible words. Thirster also has an idiosyncracy of being afraid of Undead creatures. While this problem does not affect the sword directly, the phobia will be passed on to the bearer. In the presence of Undead a control roll must be made (if the bearer is not controlled by the sword already) and 4 points must be added to the sword's ego. If the control is made by the sword, the bearer will either go berserk until restrained (50% chance) or passively withdraw and go into shock until the situation is removed.

The bottom of the crypt is covered with 2000 GP and near the north end of the crypt is a bone scroll case. In the case is a scroll containing a single spell, *Limited Wish*. In a bottle near the south end of the crypt is a potion of longevity.

40E) **A Burial Vault**: Buried in ancient times, the occupants of this chamber have not "fed" for millenia. Two wights haunt this room with their honor guard of 6 skeletons. Wights, AC: 5, Move: 9", HD: 3, Damage: Level Drain, HP: 16, 17. Skeletons, AC: 6, (armed with Shield), Move: 6", Damage: 1 - 6, Weapon: Sword, HP: 1, 4 (x3), 7, 3. The room will be "deathly quiet" until the door is opened.

40F) **A Second Burial Vault**: This vault contains a moldering, dead skeleton. However, after the room is entered, the body will animate, sit up and turn to face any intruders. It will speak in a very ancient tongue (only a *Read Languages* spell that has been previously cast will allow any understanding). It will say: "Long have I lain here, storing up my hatred for those who have entombed my brethren. Now they shall be unleashed on those who have wronged them!" The skeleton will then rise from its

bier and begin to walk toward the door. It will not attempt to attack any being. If it is not obstructed it will tap the doors to crypts E, G, and H, releasing the Undead in there. The released Undead will then begin to attack anything in sight. Once they have defeated any living creatures, they will begin an organized assault on living creatures in the caverns. If the skeleton from this crypt is not destroyed, he can convert any dead creature (recent) into a zombie or any long dead creature into a skeleton. If this skeleton is destroyed there is a 75% chance that his imbuing spirit will be transferred to any available dead body within 200'. Skeleton: AC: 7, Move: 6", HD: 4, Damage: 1 - 6, HP: 30, Turns as a Spectre. Any Undead encountered by this creature will immediately follow it.

40G) **Another Burial Vault**: Locked in this vault are a pair of Dopplegangers who will hide in the shadows until a chance to reveal themselves is possible. Dopplegangers: AC: 5, Move: 9", HD: 4, Damage: 1 - 12, HP: 20, 23. Note that Dopplegangers are not Undead. At the south end of the room in the center of the wall, sitting on the floor, is a chest with a transparent crystal top. Visible in the top (which is about 3" thick) is a sword. The crystal is unbreakable and can only be removed from the sword by *Dispel Magic*. The sword is a -2 Cursed Sword, chaotic evil in alignment. Inside the chest itself, 3000 GP will be visible. They will cover the entire bottom of the chest. In a secret compartment, accessable from the left side of the chest will be a Potion of Speed, a Potion of Diminuation and a Clerical Scroll containing *Protection from Evil, 10' Radius and Sticks to Snakes.* The latch to this secret compartment is guarded by a cross bow trap that will fire directly beside the chest (which is immoveable, by the way) at the location that one must be in to work the latch and open the secret compartment.

40H) **Yes, You Guessed It! Still Another Burial Vault**: However, this vault is empty. There is no body or any other item in this room. The only distinguishing feature in the room is a line of writing carved into the east wall, ledgible from 5' or closer (i.e., the room must be entered to read the writing). The writing is in very ancient Thracian and readable only via *Read Languages*. It says: "I have been waiting for you." If the message is said out loud or if the adventurers remain in the room more than 2 melee rounds, each adventurer will hear clearly in his mind the following: "Ahhh. . . .it's been a long time! I have been waiting for you to come. . .ha ha ha ha ha!" At that point the door will *Wizard Lock* shut. If at least 3 spikes have been set to keep the door openable, it will take a full melee round for the door to close. A character of 18+ Strength may hold the door for 1 - 2 melee rounds. Nothing will happen to those characters sealed into the room except that they must find some way of escape before they die of suffocation or starvation. The door opens inward.

40I) **Wily Water Trap**: This is a trap of the nasty variety. But, it is not without a possible escape route. The room appears to be a short corridor, leading from Room 40 C to some other chamber. However, the doors at the west end leads not to another room, but to doom and destruction. Touching those doors will seal the doors at the east end with a *Wizard Lock*. Opening the west doors will release water from the river through a metal grate behind the doors. The force of the water will thrust the doors open and make them totally unclosable, except by a human or creature with 18 (00) Strength or better and then it will only allow a 15% chance of doing so. An attempt to close will take 3 melee rounds and the room will fill to the ceiling in 5. The ceiling is 10' high and in this ceiling, at the location marked by the "x" on the map is a 5' square opening. This opening is a vertical shaft or chimney that leads upwards to the 1st level. From the ceiling of 40 I to the floor of Room 20 (see map Level 1, spot marked with "x" in Room 20), the distance is 70'. There are no handholds in the shaft except those that would be findable by a trained thief.

41A) **Hall of Ancient Statuary**: From the east, a set of stairs descend 10' down into this room. The ceiling is 25' high. The chamber is illumined by 10 glowing pillars that give off an eerie yellow-green light that seems to flicker almost like torchlight. Every 5 melee rounds the light will go out for 1 - 5 melee rounds, then flash into activity again like 10 giant strobes. This will blind any characters not making a saving roll against paralyzation for 1 - 2 melee rounds and eliminate the ability to see in the dark for 1 - 6 turns. Every so often a low rumble can be heard in this room. Moving about will set off noises that sound like traps being released or monsters moving about.

The rectangles marked with letters represent 6' tall pedestles, upon which sit a variety of statuary, carved from several kinds of stone.

A) Sphinx - carved of porphyry (volcanic). Eyes are huge quartz spheres valued at 200 GP each.

B) Hydra, 8-headed - carved of black marble (not full sized). Eyes are of amber. Each eye valued at 25 GP.

C) Minotaur - carved of soft soapstone. The statue has jade eyes valued at 400 GP each.

D) Dryad - carved of black basalt. Eyes are small citrines valued at 50 GP each.

E) Griffon - carved of glistening white marble. Eyes are fire opals, valued at 350 GP each.

F) Manicore - carved of black marble. Eyes are a pair of red tourmalines valued at 200 GP each.

G) Harpy - carved of green marble. Eyes are brilliant cut green emeralds valued at 400 GP each.

H) Hippogriff - carved of black lava. Pupils of the eyes are small periodots valued at 50 GP each.

I) Satyr (man with goat legs and goat horns) - carved of pink granite. Eyes are a ruby set on a diamond. Total value of each eye is 1000 GP.

J) Centaur - carved of white marble. Eyes are aquamarines valued at 300 GP each.

The statuary seem to be unguarded, but. . .for every 10 GP worth of gems pried out of the eyes of any statue there will be a 1% chance of summoning the guardian of the hall. This chance is cumulative and must be checked each time a new gem is pried loose (each gem will require 1 - 2 melee rounds of time to release it intact from its setting. Thus when the 100% mark is reached (1000 GP worth of gems) the guardian will appear regardless (see Room 41 B for guardian's statistics). In two melee rounds after the guardian has been summoned it will appear, bursting through the secret doors in the west wall. The creature appears as an 8' tall black statue of a regal appearing man wearing a black crown and having flaming eyes and mouth. He will attack and pursue any being possessing the stolen gemstone eyes.

The secret doors in the north wall, when searched for, will appear to be part of the wall. The secret doors in the west wall will be undetectable unless a *Detect Magic* is placed on that wall or a magical light (other than that already in the room) is shone upon them. At that point they will show a glowing out line with palm shaped areas glowing 4' off the ground in the center of each door. The doors will open by pressing an open hand to each glowing palm.

41B) **Audience Chamber of the Stone King**: The stair down to this room descends 40' from Room 41 A. It is lit by a blue violet light that tends to cause drowsiness (save vs. magic or be - 1 hit probability and armor class for 10 melee rounds). At the base of the stairs is a large circular chamber that is lit by walls that seem to burn with a cold, violet fire. Flanking the base of the stairs is a pair of placid pools of water. Every so often the pools will gurgle and a ripple will move across the surface. There is nothing down there, but who wants to test it and find out?

At the west end of the chamber is a large statue. It is standing stock still. The thing is actually the guardian of Room 41 A and if it is destroyed there or has even entered that room, it will not be down in here. The statue appears as a black man, 8' tall and of regal bearing, wearing a crown set with three large, violet gems, valued at 500 GP each. The statue's eyes and mouth burn with orange flame. He is AC: 1, Move: 9", HD: 11, HP: 50. The guardian can not be hit by non-magic weapons since only weapons of +1 or better will affect it. Edged weapons will do half damage. Lightning will do full damage and magic fire will regenerate hits upon the monster equal to the damage that it would normally do. Non-magic fire and no spells except *Rock to Mud, Stone to Flesh, and Disintegrate* will affect this monster. It will attack once per round for 2 - 12 points of damage with its fists and every other round it will spew forth a blast of fire from its eyes and mouth that will do 3 dice of damage (3 - 18 points, saving throw applicable) to all creatures in a 10' wide by 20' long cone in front of it. The statue can not be pushed over as every step is firmly rooted to the ground.

It will not attack if its room is entered. However, if the gem-eyes of the statues in Room 41 A

are removed (see above) or if an attempt to remove the gems from its crown is made or if the statue is attacked, it will begin to attack. This creature can detect the presence of the gems from Room 41 A at any distance and will pursue and destroy any being possessing those gems to the ends of the earth.

While in this room (41 B) the stone king may cause the trap door in front of the stair to drop away leaving a 10' wide gap of open water (20' deep) between the room and the stairway, but he will not do so if he has not yet been animated.

42) **Rubble-filled Caverns**: This is a large cavern with a stone floor. It is fairly dry and there are stalactite and stalagmite formations along the south wall only. The stair to the north leads up to Level 1. The floor of the cave is littered near the center with debris from Room 27 on the 1st level. There is a large chasm in the ceiling that connects with that room on the level above. While there are no dangerous monsters in this chamber per sec, inhabiting the rubble pile is a colony of rats. If the rubble pile is entered, they will begin to squeal and shriek. Any noise in this cavern or any light will alert the attention of guards located at 43.

43) **Guardpoints and Pit Traps**: A short stair at this point goes upward approximately 10'. In amongst the pillars are 4 Gnoll guards, each armed with Longbows and Halberds. Gnolls: AC: 5, Move: 9", HD: 2, Damage: 1 - 6 with Bow, 1 - 10 with Halberd, HP: 14, 5, 10, 11. These guards will be alerted and ready by any noise or light in cavern 42 or from the east cavern.

The two pit traps are very well disguised and only a Dwarf or a Thief would be able to distinguish that they exist (if he were looking for them). The shallower pit (20') is a normal pit. However, its bottom is filled with sharpened stakes. The pit will do 4d6 of damage to whoever falls in. This pit is of recent make and will open on a d6 roll of 1 - 3 every time it is crossed. Once the pit opens it then snaps shut again. However, its presences will then be detectable since the sand on the floor of this cavern will have been disturbed. The 30' deep pit is extremely ancient and its location is unknown to current dungeon inhabitants. Though locked shut for 2000 years, a portion of the mechanism has corroded through allowing the trapdoor to function once again. It will only open a d10 roll of 1 and when it does it will make a good deal of noise as it swiftly creaks open and snaps shut again (the mechanism hasn't been oiled in a couple of millenia or so). Instead of being a straight shaft, the pit becomes a slide, sending victims shooting southward into room "C" of Room Complex 45. No damage will be taken by the fall. Once opened the trap door will close, jamming and wedging shut for eternity as the mechanism snaps. A percentage roll of 90%+ by a character of 18 (00) Strength can force it open though, although any tool used for leverage will snap after a few moments.

44) **Statue of a Long Forgotten God**: This cavern was once the shrine area of many a now forgotten god and godling of the ancient Thracian race. In this alcove is a fairly intact sculpture of a fair-looking young man. The pearly-white marble has been weathered and stained by the passage of time and water. The head is somewhat worn away by constant erosion and stalactites hang off the chin and arms. Written in ancient Thracian is the following, "Oh Apollo, blessed healer, touch me and make me whole." If this phrase is spoken while touching the statue, a *Cure Light Wounds* spell will be cast upon the beseecher. This will only work 1 - 4 times before the ancient magic is exhausted. The walls of the alcove are of rough-carved rock with two marble bas- relief panels of acts of the god set into the living rock. One east and the other north. The east panel is actually a secret door. If the door is open, a pair of Spears will spring forth to impale the opener, being thrown as if fired by a 7th level fighting man.

45) **The Temple of Athena . . .Or. . .The Temple of the Descension**: A set of stairs leads upwards 10' to a massive temple (Greek design) with heavy doric pillars. The base of the temple is carved with high relief sculpture panels with scenes depicting the Thracian dieties in combat with demons and sea monsters. On the east wall of the temple's base is a secret door, disguised as a carved panel. It opens up on a narrow stair that leads down to Room Complex 45 A.

At the east end of the temple is a tall statue (10') of a regal woman in long loose, greek style clothing. She bears a Shield and Spear and wears a Helm. The 10' square area before the statue (marked with an "x" on the map) is a *Teleportation* pad. Standing on it for 1 melee round will activate it and send those upon the square to area 54 on the 3rd Level map (see 89 if a special marble is possessed).

Guarding this strategic location is a squad of 8 Gnolls, AC: 5, Move: 9", HD: 2, Damage: 1 - 6 with Longbow, 1 - 10 with Halberd, HP: 7 (x3), 8, 10 (x2), 9, 12. Each Gnoll will have 11 SP and 2 GP on his person. Any light or noise in the cavern will alert the Gnolls, who will hide amongst the pillars and wait until an ambush presents itself. If outnumbered or taking heavy losses, the Gnolls will retreat to the teleportation pad and seek to create another ambush on the 3rd Level with reinforcements to be found there.

Room Complex 45 A - I

45A) **Weapon Storage Vault**: This room is filled with about a dozen large, sealed, wooden boxes. The boxes are all in remarkably good shape.

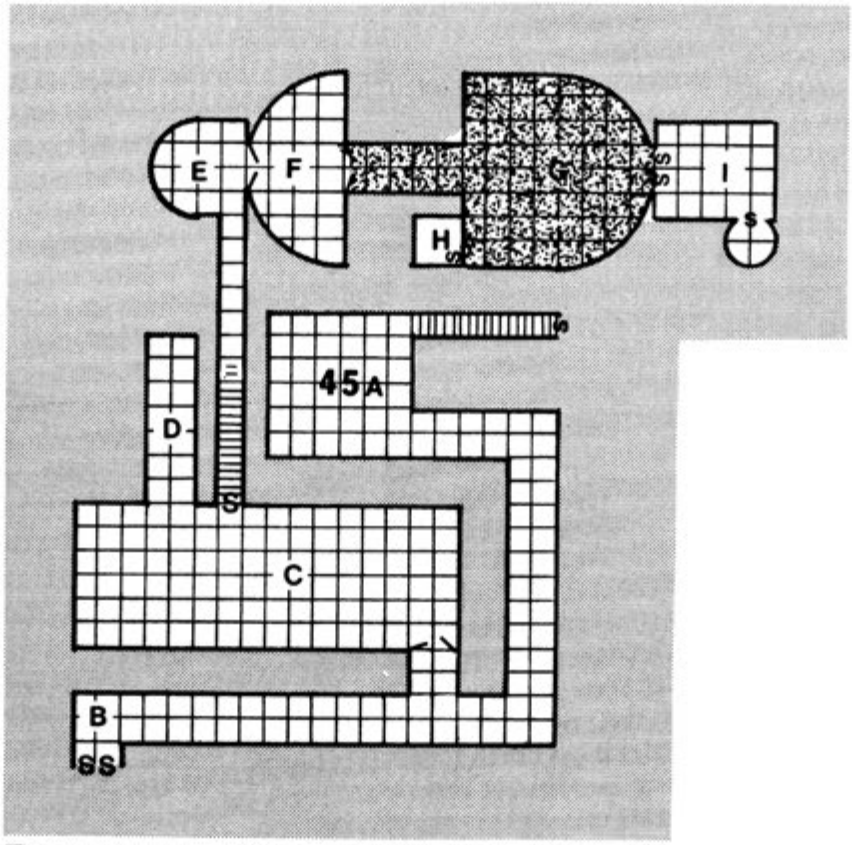
Box 1) Wrapped in oil-soaked cloth are 20 Bronze Swords. These swords are half-again as heavy as an iron sword and after 3 hits are scored with them, they will be -1 hit probability until resharpened.

Box 2) Wrapped in oil-soaked cloth are 30 Spears.

Box 3) Carefully wrapped up in oil-soaked cloth is a suit of Plate Armor of archaic design. Without modification, it will fit a Human of 11 - 14 Strength and 5' 2" to 5' 5" in height. The armor is +1.

Box 4) This box is open and the contents have rusted and tarnished. It contains 30 Spears. It is 40% likely the pile of them will collapse into debris if handled.

Box 5) Wrapped in oil cloth are 60 Crossbow Quarrels.



Room Complex 45A-I

Box 6, 7, 8) In these boxes are the components of a special mechanism that will throw 6 Crossbow quarrels per round for a total of 6 rounds before having to be reloaded. There are no assembly instructions and the parts, although well protected, are incomprehensible. A fighting man will have a percentage chance equal to his Intelligence score -10 x 5. If the fighting man has access to a knowledgeable Sage, his chance of constructing the machine properly will go up by 20%. If it is known how to assemble the machine, it will take a minimum of 2 turns to put it together properly. If the machine is put together and carried (weight of 1000 GP + Quarrels) it will take the averaged Dexterity of all characters doing the assembling subtracted from 20 in melee rounds to put the thing in working order and capable of firing on the next melee round. If a fighter is trying to put the machine together for the first time, subtract his Intelligence from 25 and the resultant number will be the number of hours required to puzzle the thing together (if he or she can do it at all). An improperly constructed machine will not work at all. Treat as Light Crossbow for accuracy.

Box 9) Another box of carefully wrapped Crossbow Quarrels, 60 in number.

Box 10) 4 circular Shields with the head of a bull emblazoned on them in green paint.

Box 11) Another box of wrapped Crossbow Quarrels, 60 in number.

Box 12) This box is differently constructed from all the rest. Completely unfamiliar writing, alien to every type of writing that the adventurers may have seen til now is emblazoned on the box. It will look very much like Chinese characters, but you don't have to tell the players this. If read by the use of a *Read Languages* spell, it will say "Wing Tu, weapon-maker for his excellency the undying Emporer." Inside, preserved by some strange magic are some very odd weapons. Created from high grade steel are 10 star-shaped items with sharpened edges (shuriken). If the use of these is learned they will operate as throwing Daggers and do 1 - 4 points of damage each, being non-magically +1 due to the high grade of the metal used. There are a pair of black sticks, 12" long and joined by 4" of chain (nunchaku). If the use of these is learned, they will work as morning stars and do 1 - 8 points of damage. However, if a character is not already trained in the use of the Morning Star, there is a 80% chance that any concerted use of them will do 1 - 2 points of damage to the character concerned. There is also a 40" long Sword of strange design with an extremely light and sharp blade. It will be +1 and non-magical due to the quality of craftmanship and the high grade of steel used. The oddest item in the box are 20 tubes constructed of some type of heavy parchment and mounted on short, thin sticks (sky rockets). If lit (fuse sticks out the end with the stick) they will shoot off with a range of 500' and explode in a flash of bright, sparkling colors. If used as weapons, they will have the range of a short bow, but at -5 to hit. There is a 30% chance that they will explode on contact with a target for 1-6 points of damage, blinding the victim for 1-4 melee rounds in the process. If they do not explode, damage is negligible (as if they glanced off).

45B) **Doors to the Hidden Tombs** These doors are not secret from this side. Written on the door in Ancient Thracian is the following inscription; "It is not given that man should interrupt the sleep of his ancestors. Do not transgress beyond this point." These doors will not yield even to magic.

45C) **Demesne of the Minotaur Lizard:** A large reptilian creature has been in a sort of stasis-like trance for some centuries now. Originally placed as a guard for the secret door in the north wall, it was forgotten long ago. The spell placed on it is such that if the room is entered, it will awaken and attack. Once it has defeated and devoured its victims it will fall back into the stasis again. Minotaur Lizard: AC: 3, Move: 9", HD: 8, Damage: Bite: 4-32, Claw: 2-20, Claw: 2-20, HP:46. The secret door in the north wall is further guarded by two spells. The first is a *Polymorph Other* spell. The first creature to touch the door with the intention of opening it must make a saving throw vs magic or be polymorphed into a house cat. The second one to touch the door will be hit with a *Magic Missile* spell of 7th level. Thereafter the door will be safe to open, except that it is *Wizard Locked*.

45D) **Slippery Slide from the Trap Above**: This is the slide that comes from the 30' deep trap described in area 43. The slide is so designed that no actual damage is done in the drop. The slide is steep, but the Minotaur Lizard can climb it. The trap door cannot be opened or sprung from beneath.

45E) **A Sealed-Off Retreat**: This was the route taken by the last human survivors of the beast-men revolution that captured the palace of King Agamemnos over 1000 years ago. The room is scorched and blasted as if a fireball had been set off in there and had set the remainder of the contents of the room on fire. The door to room 45F is barred from the other side and will be -2 on opening.

45F) **Chamber of Forgotten Finery**: The walls of this room are covered with ornate stylized paintings of magic and sorcery. Various statues of kings and queens and goddesses line the east wall (these are real statues, honest, no tricks!). The stone doors to room 45G seem to have a sort of yellowish powder around the edges It is really dried up yellow mold. (It does no damage but should serve as a hint).

45G) **Court of Foul Fungus**: If the door to this room is forced open (from either end) a 10' x 10' x 10' cloud of spores will be knocked loose from the gigantic yellow mold colony that has spawned in this chamber. Any character breathing the spores must save vs poison or die. The only way to destroy this mass of putrid plant is to burn it. Physically disturbing the mold will send up a cloud os spores in the area affected. This room was once a well-equipped magical laboratory. However, now all that remains of the great lab are shattered shards of glassware and approximately 300gp worth of small gems used in experiments along with 100gp of gold wire and 50gp of silver wire.
Both doors in this room would normally be hidden behind secret panels in the once-rich woodwork that lined this room. However, the mold has long since destroyed the wood and now covers the walls and ceiling, hiding any traces of possible doors.

45H) **An Empowering Globe**: In the center of this small chamber is a stone table upon which sits a glass globe that glows with a golden light. On a bookshelf against the north wall are several scroll cases, totalling 5. Each one has a different color wax seal on the case.

Red Seal: The seal on this scroll case is whole and unbroken. On the scroll is an inventory of magic items stored on the shelves. (The shelves are now empty.) The scroll is written in the Thracian language of the same period as King Agamemnos and the revolution.

Black Seal: This unopened scroll is written in the ancient Thracian language that predates the time period of Agamemnos by about 1000 years. It describes the wondrous statues in room 41A, telling of their jeweled eyes. It does not mention any type of guardian, though.

Blue Seal: This scroll has *explosive runes* written on it.

Green Seal: This scroll is enscribed with four magic spells of the third level, *Fire Ball, Dispell Magic, Invisibility 10' Radius, Infravision. A Read Magic* spell will be required to read this scroll.

Gold Seal: This seal is broken and has been resealed several times. It is a maintenance log on the globe and describes its functions.

The golden globe is the source of power for the teleportation system between levels 2 and 3. If it is destroyed, the system will no longer function and any creature on the second level will be trapped until an alternate method of transportation is devised or discovered. Casting a *Dispel Magic* on the item will negate its powers for 3 turns. If the globe is broken, it will require a *Teleportation* spell and a *Permanent* spell to repair it, not to mention a new glass globe. Shattering the globe will destroy it. It is fragile and any hit will do the job. If the globe is removed from the room the teleportation unit will cease to function. The globe is 8" in diameter and is hollow.

45I) **The Last Stronghold**: It was in this room that the remnants of King Agamemnos' court and guard made their escape and that their dead and mortally wounded were left. If Epicaste from room 37 is with a group of adventurers, she will be able to identify several of the corpses as friends and aquaintences of hers. One of the bodies in the room is not completely dead yet. Powerful magic was used to keep the near-dead Anteus, a soldier in the King's Guard, alive or partially alive for 1100 years. Anteus appears as a tall (6') man in plate armor and shield (+1 plate) bearing a two-handed sword. In addition, he has a +2 dexterity bonus. AC:-1, Move: 9", HD: 7, Damage: 1-10 +2 (for strength), HP: 41. His vocal chords have atrophied and he has lost the power of speech. If any can speak the language of the tribesman or the Thracian tongue then he might be made to understand peaceful

intentions (See room 37 for translation charts). If he is not immediately made to understand that the adventurers are not servants of the beast-men, he will attack. The small, circular room on the south wall of this room is actually a shaft that leads from room 36 to 118 (see room 36). From this point, it is 60' up to the floor of room 36 and 40' down to the ceiling of room 118 and an additional 20' beyond that to the floor. Falling from this point will do 6D6 of damage.

46) **Giant Spider**: AC: 4, Move: 3"/12" (in web), HD: 4 +4, Damage: Bite 2-8 + save vs poison or die, HP: 28. Once per round this spider may also, shoot a strand of web at the victim. If the victim is hit he must make a saving throw of under his strength -4 on a D20. Treat each level of extraordinary strength as a seperate strength point.

47) **A Deteriorated Outer Sanctuary**: The once brilliant paint is peeling off the low relief sculptures of inter-deity combat that line every wall in the temple area. The place does not appear to be in any kind of use, however, if the adventurers entering this room are determined to be enemies of the gnolls (an almost 100% certain possibility), they will suddenly be rained upon by 4 crossbow bolts coming from the east and west walls. The missiles are fired by gnolls (2 hit dice creatures) from light crossbows at short range. The bolts are fired out of arrow ports that have been cunningly and almost invisibly carved into the sculptured walls. Each of the four crossbows will fire once each round. The ports are not large enough for a flask of oil to be thrown through and, also, can be closed from the inside, if necessary.

48) **A Draped Inner Sanctuary**: This room reeks of long occupancy by members of the ursine race, i.e it's a bear lair. Lairing in this room are two trained war bears. They are brown bears with special fighting training so that they attack with a +1 and will fight to the death. AC: 6, Move: 12", HD 5 2 claws at 1-6 each, bite for 1-8 and on paw hits of 17+ a hug for 2-12 additional points, HP 36, 44. The two bears will be assisted in winning battles by their trainers, 3 gnolls: AC: 5, Move: 9", HD 2, Damage: 1-6 with longbow and 1-8 with morning star, HP: 11, 14, 13. Each of the gnolls have 3sp and 6gp on their persons.

49) **Gnoll Barracks**: This is the actual lair of the gnolls in this section. There are sleeping provisions for 12 gnolls. Because they always have a guard posted, and being bloodthirsty creatures, they will always be ready for combat at a moment's notice. There will always be 3 armed gnolls in this room, AC: 5, Move: 9", HD: 2, Weapons: battle axe for 1-8 points of damage. Each of these gnolls will have 3sp and 1 gp on its person.

50) **A Converted Crypt**: This is an additional living space for the gnolls and for the most part it is filled with junk and litter. In this room will be the gnolls who fire the crossbows from the west wall into room 47. There are three of them. Each is armed with a light crossbow and a battle ax. If the door to this room is breached they will fire off their crossbows into the enemy and charge with their weapons. AC: 5, Move: 9", HD: 2, Damage: crossbow 1-6, battle ax 1-8, HP 12, 8, 11. Each of these gnolls will have 2sp and 4gp on his person.

51) **Another Converted Crypt**: This room will be exactly like room 50 except that the gnolls have the following: HP: 15 (he is the commander), 13, 9.

52) **This is the barracks of an allied troup of mercenary lizard men.** They are under the command of the gnoll in room 51, but if things get rough they will break for it. 6 lizard men: AC: 4 (skin and shield), Move: 6"/12" (swimming), HD: 2 +1, weapons: club for 1-8 damage and 4 darts each for 1-4, HP 8, 8, 7, 7, 11, 10. These lizard men will attempt to get back to their tribe. One of the lizards has recently discovered secret doors in the south wall of room 48 and there is a 40% chance that if that avenue of escape is possible they will use it. The 10HP lizard man speaks the common tongue and may offer to ransom himself and the other lizard men with tales of great treasure (room 33) and directions on how to reach it. He won't necessarily reveal any of the guardian creatures or traps unless magically forced to.

53) **The Rising Demon Image**: This is the sculpture of a demon that rises up in flames into room 27A. Its location is unknown to the locals. The statue is carved of black granite and has borne the ravages of time with a great deal of grace. Its eyes are large, 300gp, faceted amber gemstones. Its mouth is hollow and an odor of methane is detectable from it. An odd quirk about this statue is that it will always turn and face (rotate in place) a good cleric, regardless of where he or she stands in the room. If there is more than one in the room, it will face the one of highest level. To the south of the room are a pair of hidden 10' wide doors. They are covered over with plaster and faded frescoes are painted into the plaster, itself. To get at the door, the plaster must be chipped away. Behind the doors are stairs that lead downward. This complex is old; older than the Ancient Thracian tomb complexes of rooms 37-41. Their use was ended soon after the coming of the ancient Thracians. Some say that this is the remnant of an ancient race of civilized lizard men. No one can be certain, except that humans are not portrayed in any but the more recent frescoes and then only as sacrifices of lizard-headed men. The stairs are crumbly and deep with dust and fallen rubble. No plaster remains on the walls. The ceiling of the stairwell is covered with stalactites and the floor with stalagmites. In places they have grown together and almost blocked the passage. The dust on the floor is undisturbed.

Room Complex 53 A-J

53A) **The Grand Temple of the Reptile Race**: This vast hall was once the worship place for hundreds of highly intelligent lizard men who worshipped a supposedly immortal giant king. The floor is thick with dust, undisturbed except for a path that leads from the door of room 53G to the steps of the altar, where it seems that a creature of some kind has kneeled several times. This cavernous hall has long since fallen into ruin, time and moisture doing their work well. The ceiling is covered with stalactites that form occassional pillars as they meet with stalagmites thrusting up from the floor. The northwest corner has caved-in and it seems that many other places in the walls are weakening, also. Along each wall are a series of 4 doors. Along the east wall, the door to the south end of room 53F is sealed shut by the random formation of stalagmite pillars in front of it. The doors are great stone constructions, 10' wide and 15' tall. there is a 25% chance that any given set of doors will open freely (without great effort). If a door is stuck, it will be -2 on opening check for each door as it is encountered. On the west wall there are 4 doors, but they do not lead to places on this, the prime material plane.

Door 1 leads to the Ethereal Plane. The door is wizard locked.

Door 2 is blocked by stalagmite pillars and cannot be opened. Besides, it has lost the magic that once powered it.

Door 3 leads to a small 10' square room. That room is an extension of this plane into the astral plane. There a character may astrally leave his body without requiring the necessary spell. Players will be able to sense their astral selves' ease of movement as though their astral bodies were continually flowing in and out of their prime material bodies. This door is wizard locked.

Door 4 is, also, blocked by stalagmite columns. It, too, has lost the magic that once powered it and leads nowhere but into a stone wall.

The stairs at the south end of the room lead upward 10' to a ceremonial podium flanked by rotted tatters of an ancient tapestry, ruined beyond recognition. All that remains of the altar furniture is a crumbling marble podium and that, too, will tumble to marble dust if touched. In the south wall there are a pair of doors that are hidden from view by what remains of the drapes. Touching the curtains will powder them and the doors will be revealed.

53B) **A Ceremonial Chamber with a View**: The original function of this chamber will be forever lost. But it can be determined that it was used to keep an eye on encroaching Humans during the waning of the Reptile race. The secret doors in the east wall are only secret to occupants of Room 41 B (see 41 B for that room's contents). The 10' x 10' portal in the wall is 25' above the level of Room 41 B's floor. The walls of this room are covered with flaking plaster. Visible will be a few faded images of Reptile Men in jeweled robes and at least one picture of a gigantic winged Lizard Man. One valve of the south doors will be eternally jammed closed.

53C) **Urns and Ashes**: This small room is filled with shards of pottery and a few small, unbroken ceramic urns. The quality of the pottery is excellent and the 4 surviving pieces would be valued at 1000 GP each if taken to the right buyer (someone who is very interested in ancient, prehuman history). The urns seem to contain ashes of some sort. The secret door in the north wall is disguised by a glaze of stalactite material that has formed over it and hidden the edges of the door.

53D) **A Preliminary Crypt**: Two piles of dust and debris flank the north door in this room. They are in actuality a pair of skeletal Lizard warriors who will spring to life if the room is entered, forming up right out of the dust. These Undead do not fear Human Clerics in the least, due to the special evil magic rings that they wear. Skeletal Lizard Men: AC: 5, Move: 6", HD: 6, Damage: 1 - 10, HP: 32 each. *Protection from Evil* will keep these creatures at bay for 6 melee rounds and then they will actually shatter the spell with some sort of counter magic. When they are killed, they return to dust, as do their rings.

53E) **The Sepulcher of the Immortal King**: This room is just as decayed and decrepit as the rest of the complex. However, sitting on a pedestle at the east end of the room is what appears to be a giant, mummified, dessicated cross between a gargoyle and a Lizard Man. If it stood, the creature would be 10' tall with huge, parchment like bat wings springing from its scaly but withered back. The monster sits amongst its pile of treasure, unmoving and dead. If the room is entered the monster will slowly shift its head to face the intruders and it will be immediately apparent that its eyes are glowing malevolently. The monster is an incredibly ancient Lich: AC: 3, Move: 6", HD: 12, Damage: 2 claws for 1 - 8 each, and a bite for 1 - 12, HP: 57, spells: *Charm Person, Hold Portal, Magic Missile (x2), Protection form Good, ESP, Invisibility, Levitate, Web, Wizard Lock, Dispel Magic, Fireball, Haste Spell, Slow Spell, Confusion (x2), Fear, Polymorph Others, Teleport (x2), Conjure Elemental, Cloud Kill, Death Spell, Invisible Stalker, Anti-Magic Shell, Delayed Blast Fireball.*

His first probable action will be to *Teleport* to the altar in Room 53 A and summon an earth elemental to do his fighting for him. If the Rings in Room 53 D have been destroyed, he will be alerted and the spell will have been cast and he will be fading out. It is also probable that he will cast a *Haste Spell* upon himself to make sure that he can react faster than his opponents. Note that *Haste* does not increase the speed of spell casting. The Immortal King will avoid placing himself in any danger. Piled about the pedestle upon which the Immortal King sits are 5000 SP and 16,000 GP in loose piles, a lawful Red Dragon slaying Sword +2, a Potion of Fire Resistance and a Wand of Paralyzation.

The west end of the room opens into a 10' wide corridor that has been sealed off due to cave in.

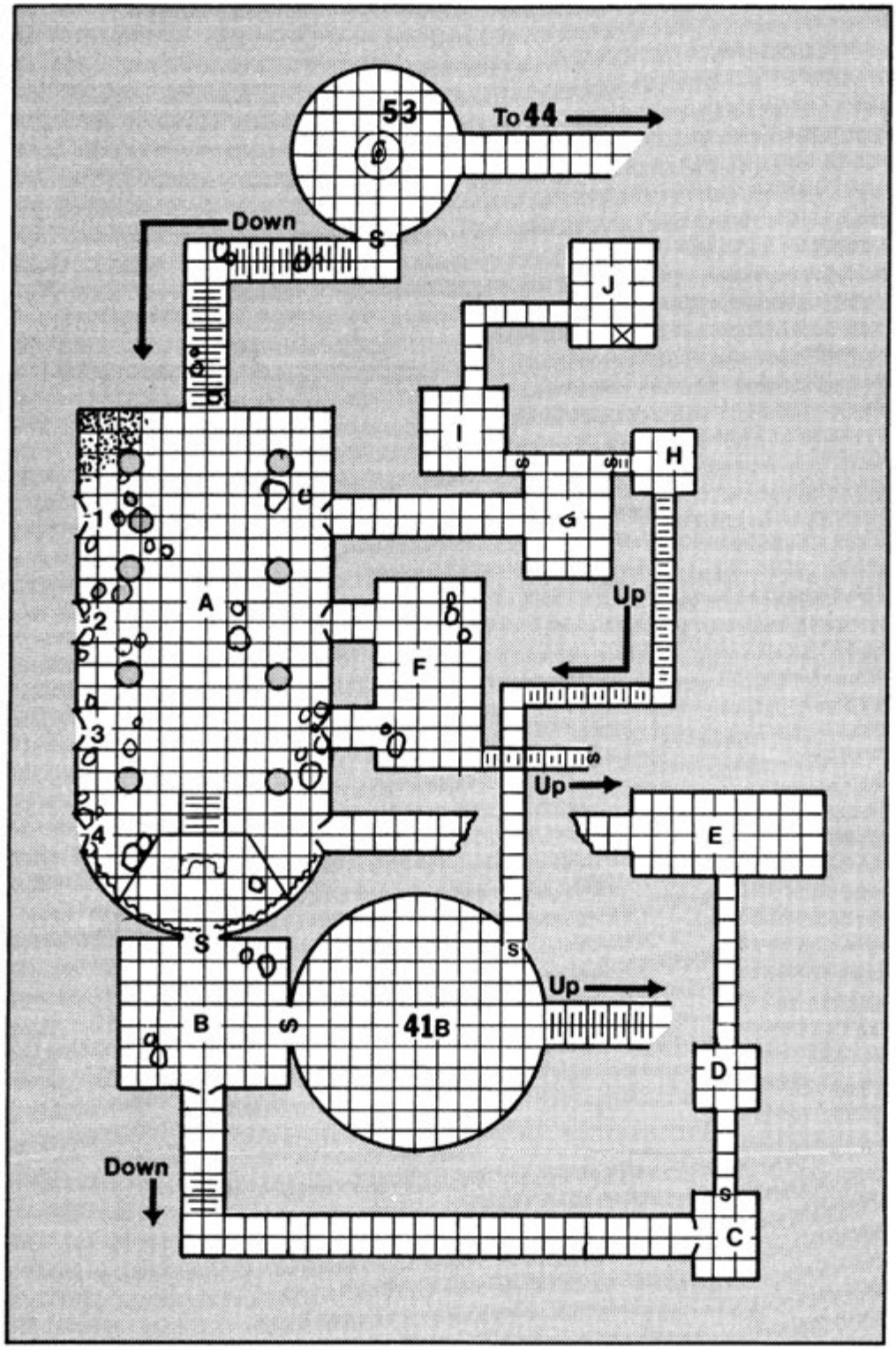
53F) **Another Room of Unidentifiable Purpose**: What this room once may have been is now unknown. The ceiling is covered with stalactites and the floor is littered with stalagmites, some of them blocking passage in the room. The narrow stair at the south end of the room leads upwards 25' to Room 37. The door into that room is both secret and covered by ice making it detectable by 1 less point on a d6 (instead of an Elf locating the door on a d6 roll of 1 - 4 he will only be able to find it on a roll of 1 - 3).

53G) **A Makeshift Chapel**: The footprints in the dust lead to this room. Upon entering the room, it will be immediately noticable that the dust on the floor has been swept away. The room looks as if someone or something has been maintaining it to some extent. There is not debris on the floor and it appears that a crude, man-shaped stick figure has been drawn in Ochre on the south wall. The figure seems to have wings and a tail. The chapel has been created and kept clean by the Shaman G'ruk of the Lizard Men in Room 31. He and only he has discovered the secret door in the north wall of their lair area. He has devoted this area to his private and secretive worship of the Immortal King, not knowing that it actually still lives.

53H) **Secret Lair of the Lizard Men Shaman**: There is a 20% chance that G'ruk, Shaman of the Lizard people will be in this, his private lair (if he has already been killed in Room 31, then he will have 0% chance of appearing here). There is a pile of sleeping rags in one corner and a bag containing several strips of dried Human meat along with some glass beads and a few sharpened stone implements. There is nothing of real value in here. The stair to the south goes up a total of 75' and eventually joins up with Room 31.

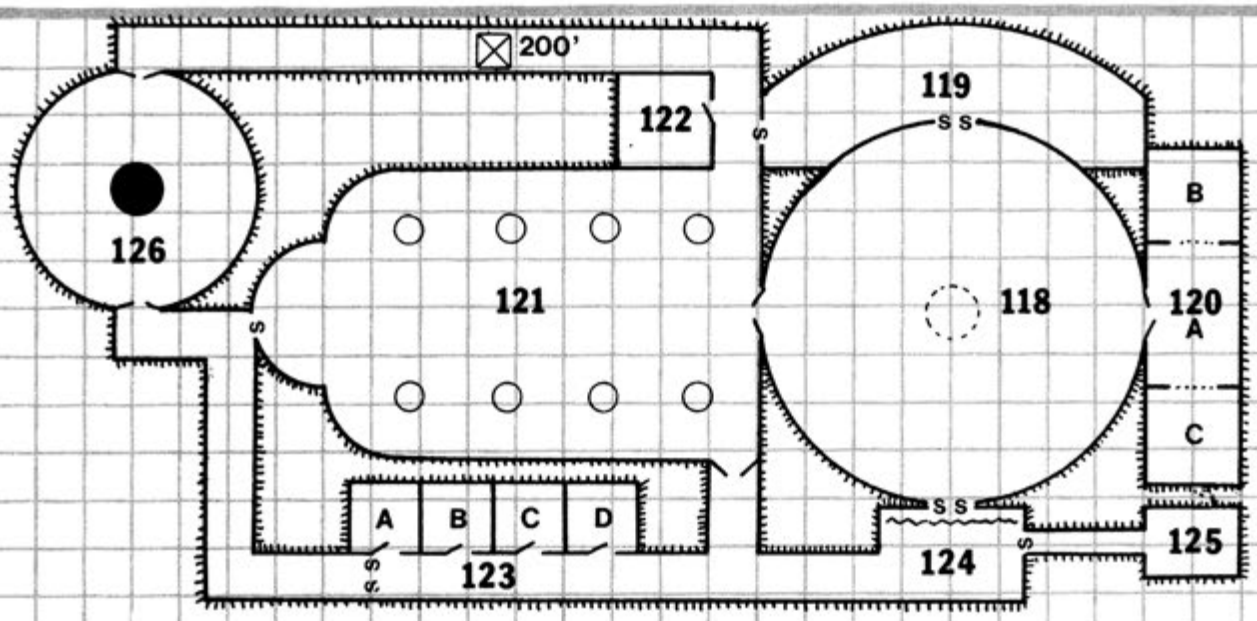
53I) **A Sealed Room**: This room is sealed off from Room 53 G. Its walls and contents are fairly intact. The walls show scenes of a ritualistic sacrifice of a Human victim and several Lizard Man victims by a group of gowned Lizard Priests. In the background, there is a hazy image of the ever present Immortal King, a tall winged Lizard Man wearing a silver crown. On a table in the center of the room (more like a 3' cube of granite) is a golden mask designed to fit a Lizard Man. It has a demonic countenance. The mask is valued at 2000 GP.

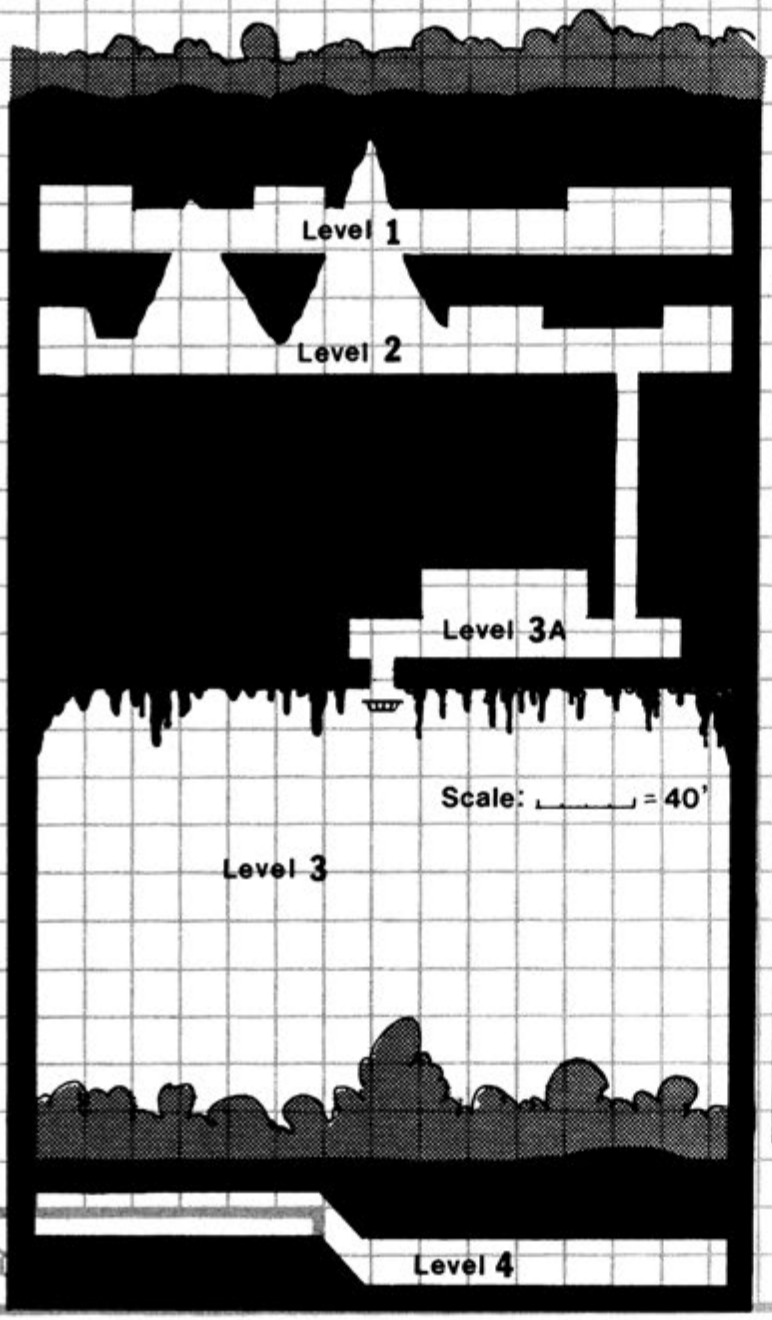
53J) **The Secret Sacrificial Shaft of the Lizard Priests**: The frescoes in this room are intact also and show images of a giant winged Lizard Man (the Immortal King) devouring huge numbers of Humans, Lizard Men and Dinosaurs. Along the south wall, there is a 5' square shaft for the sacrifice of living victims. The shaft is 45' long but it opens up on the 3rd level for an additional drop of 200' (2d6 of damage).



Room Complex 53 A-J

Level 3a





ABOVE: **The Caverns of Thracia** LEVEL 3A

Map Key

tree

door

secret door S S

spear trap: one spear

spear trap: two spears

spear trap: three spears

crossbow trap

water

drapery

pit trap or shaft 20'

rope and plank bridge

bars

statue

The Caverns of Thracia cross-section

Level Three A

Introductory Note: There is one and only one wandering monster on this level. It is an 8' tall animated bronze statue, cast in the likeness of the god, Thanatos, appearing as a solid version of the Incarnation of Death, AC: 2, Move: 6", HD: 8, Damage: 2 - 16, HP: 36. In addition to its normal damage, the creature shoots off a paralysis ray from its eye every round. The effective range of the ray is 60' and it is 10' wide. Any living being hit by the ray must save vs. paralysis or be immobilized for a number of turns equal to his or her constitution subtracted from 20. The statue will attempt to destroy any living being on this level. It can be encountered in any room or in any hallway.

Note: This entire level was once a temple and worship area devoted to the god Thanatos. Because of this, images of Thanatos (see Rooms 9A - 13) will appear in this entire room complex.

118) **Great Audience hall**: This room appears to have been a meeting hall of some kind. The shaft from Room 36 comes down in the center of the 20' high ceiling. Located directly below the opening is what appears to be an ancient firepit. The floor is blackened and there is evidence of charcoal around the area. Surrounding the firepit area are dozens of wooden benches in various states of falling apart from age or dry rot. In the north and south walls are secret doors that are cleverly disguised to look like part of the wall. In the east and west walls are great bronze doors, 20' tall and carved with strange runes (meaningless even with *Read Languages*).

119) **A Private Gallery**: This room is sort of the "royal opera box". The south wall of this room (facing Room 118) is transparent from this side, but opaque from Room 118. The walls are carved ornately with flowers and geometric designs. The walls are also painted in brilliant, but restful colors. Instead of rotted wooden benches, there are several ornate marble couches and seats, covered with cushions that will powder to dust if touched. There is nothing of other than historical value in here.

120A) **A Holding Area**: This room contains a marble table and two or three marble chairs. They are decorated with carving and worn gilding. Several rolls of blank parchment lie about on the desk and there is a robed skeleton sprawled over the desk with a sword thrust through the ribs and sticking out the back. Around the neck of the long dead corpse is a silver skull on a silver chain. The skull has turquoise eyes and is worth 25 GP. If the figure is touched it will crumble to dust.

120B) **A Long Past Slaughter**: Lying about this cell are 21 long dead corpses of men and women in strange, but rich clothing. Each corpse will have a silver skull pendant with turquoise eyes (value 25 GP). These were all worshippers of Thanatos who sought death rather than capture by the Beast Men. They were all put to death by the man at the table who then fell on his sword. There will also be 30 pieces of random jewelry in the room, on the corpses, valued at a total of 5000 GP. The cell door is locked.

120C) **A Cruel Death by Starvation**: Although the noblemen and women who worshipped Thanatos were given honorable deaths, their servants, who were most likely not worshippers of the death god, were left to die of starvation, locked in this cell. Because of this, their souls were not completely freed from the mortal plane when their bodies expired. Locked in this room are 3 Wights, 6 Skeletons. wights: AC: 5, Move: 9", HD: 3, Damage: 1 Level Energy Drain, HP: 13, 11, 17. Skeletons: AC: 7, Move: 6", HD: 1, Damage: 1 - 6, HP: 3, 1, 6, 2, 8 (x2). If they sense any living beings in Room 120 A or B, they will animate and come out of hiding and cause the bars to burst outward, doing 1 - 4 points of damage to any living thing within 10' of them. The Undead will then begin to attack with blind fury all the living creatures they can find.

121) **Sanctuary of the God of Death**: The walls of this large, pillared hall are lined with jet black stone. The walls, the ceiling, the floors, the pillars, all are intensely black. Add to this a permanent *Darkness* spell throughout the chamber and you will have the the temple of Thanatos. The entire room has also been permanently *Silenced* by magic. Where there would normally be a statue, there is none, for the statue wanders the entire level, seeking to destroy intruders (it actually make no distinction between Beast Men and Humans. After all, an intruder is an intruder). Lying about on the floor of this room are the corpses of 5 Gnolls. They have been dead for at least a millenium. If their bones are touched, they will crumble to dust.

122) **The Robing Room**: In this chamber will be found the crumbling remains of the priests of Thanatos' ceremonial vestments in a chest (locked, with a poison pin containing a poison that paralyzes, but does not kill. So potent is this poison that it is -2 saving throw and its effect is immediate. There is a 25% chance the victim will appear dead.) Inside the box is a golden Helm studed with black sapphires that is worth 3000 GP and a ceremonial Dagger with a carved platinum hilt valued at 1200 GP. The various robes and ritual costumes are all decayed with age and will be valueless. There is a body of a man in the robes of a priest lying near the door. Around his neck is the silver skull with turquoise eyes (25 GP). The front of his robes seem to have been slashed open and several ribs are broken. Lying next to the box containing the jewelry is the body of a Gnoll. If the box is touched a loud moaning will be heard and the dead body of the priest will seem to stand up and then collapse as if the animating spirit has left it. A Spectre will then form and attack. Spectre: AC: 2, Move: 15"/30", HD: 6, Damage: 1 - 8 and 2 Levels of Energy Drain, HP: 29.

Trap in North Hall: This pit will open up on a d6 roll of 1 - 2. The drop is 200' down to the third Level.

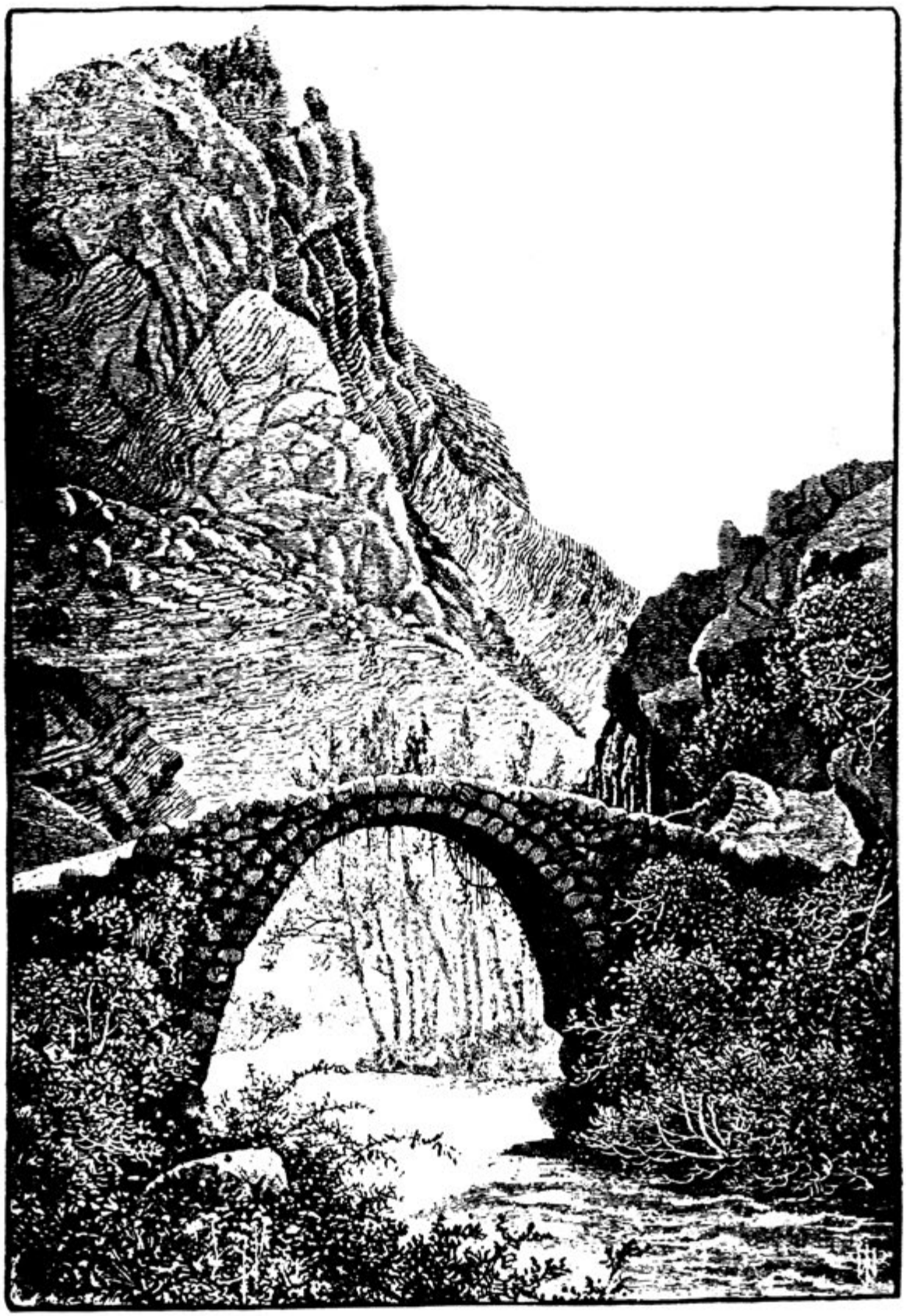
123) **Cells of the Unholy Brothers**: These rooms were a series of Clerical cells. Each one contains 4 rotted cots, a table of marble with a wash basin set on top of it, 3 or 4 candle sconces set into the walls and a few rotted articles of clothing. Room C has occupants.

123C) **The Shadow Knows**: Set in the middle of the floor of this chamber are 3 Human skulls with gem-like eyes. Kneeling around this arrangement are the corpses of 12 men in ragged clerical robes. Each corpse will have a silver skull with turquoise eyes hanging about its neck (value 25 GP). If the room is entered, 6 shadows will rise up out of the skull arrangement and attack, AC: 7, Move: 9", HD: 2 + 2, Damage: 1 - 4 plus Drain of 1 Strength Point, HP: 12, 7, 13, 15, 9, 11. The gems in the skulls eyes are worth a total of 3000 GP. If the gem eyes are removed from the skulls, the shadows will disappear. Each removed eye will remove one shadow.

124) **Prayer Chapel**: This is a small chapel devoted to meditation and repose. The secret door in the north wall is hidden behind some remarkably intact drapes. These drapes can be used to form one suit of light-weight clothing that act as Chainmail (AC: 5) but will not impede movement. The secret door in the east wall is plastered over and hidden. Only by removing the plaster can the door be opened.

125) **The Crypt of King Agamemnos**: King Agamemnos was sorely wounded in the escape from the Beast Men. He died subsequently and was interred in a wing of the prayer chapel. His subjects then either found some other means of escape or committed suicide. The body of the King is laid out in state with him in his kingly apparel. Scattered about the floor is 550 GP, 1000 SP, a couple of Gold Rings (50 GP each), and a small Sceptre worth 1000 GP. Upon the King's skeletal head is a gold Circlet with a single diamond worth 2500 GP. A swiftly carved marble plaque (it looks like the back of a marble serving tray) states in Thracian: "Here lies Agamemnos, King of Thracia and noble servant of the gods, cut down by the arrow of a slave beast."

126) **Crank and Cradle**: This room houses the mechanism made of polished bronze that was magically preserved to prevent rust and corrosion. It consists of a manually operated crank, a set of strange roller apparatus (pulleys) and iron cables that attach to the drum that the crank rotates, go up to the ceiling and then down through a hole in the floor to disappear in the wisps of mist floating in up out of the hole. This machinery is what raises and lowers a sort of elevator basket from this level to the next. It is also operated by a magical device from Level 4 Room 112. The basket or elevator can not be seen through the hole since it is hidden by cloud-like mist. There is light coming up through the hole. It is much brighter than magical light, but not quite so bright as a sunny day. A ladder extends down into the hole. If it is descended, the character will find himself in a bronze cage with a crank like apparatus. The crank is used to lower the cage on the steel ropes. When lowered to Level 3 it will end up a little north west of Tree 60. The cage will be visible to all guards posted on the 3rd level and it is an almost sure thing that they will have an ambush ready.



Level 3

Level Three

This level is the palace and garden that once belonged to the Thracian King, Agamemnos. This whole level, at least the "outdoors" part of it, is lit by an intensely powerful light that almost, but not quite, equals sunlight. There is a thin layer of cloud near the ceiling that covers the stalactites and any activity that may occur up there. The only known access to this level is via the teleportation pads located at Number 54 near the east end of the gardens and Room 89 in the palace. The garden is patrolled by Gnolls and Lizard Men who will attempt to capture anyone they find. In the east end of the garden there will be numerous Dryads. They are deathly afraid of the Beast Men and will do nothing to aid any group of adventurers, even if it may mean defeat of the Minotaur and his minions.

54) **Teleportation Pad**: This circular area is rimmed by low trees that bear fruit continually. The fruit are fist-sized strawberries. They are quite nutritious and will serve as both water and rations. They do not keep well, however, and must be eaten within 1 day of picking or they go mushy and rot. 6 Gnolls will be on guard here. One or two will be plucking and eating fruit while the rest are on guard. They will be in the shade of the trees so that they will be somewhat covered and camoflaged. Each Gnoll is armed with a Longbow and a Halberd. AC: 5, Move: 9", HD: 2, Damage: 1 - 6 with Bow, 1 - 10 with Halberd, HP: 13, 7, 8, 5, 10, 9. The teleportation pad is activated by standing on the 10' square section at the center of the pad for one full melee round. Any being standing in that area will be teleported to the pad in Temple 45 on the 2nd level.

55) **Transparent Tower of Water**: This item is a complete mystery to the occupants of this level. It is apparently a 10' diameter transparent tube containing sparkling, bubbling water that seems to rise 200' from the floor of the garden up to the ceiling of the great cavern. It is assumed that this is the source of the river. This tube goes through Room 117 down below the surface of the garden and rises up to Room or Chamber 34 on the 2nd level. The tube itself is AC: -8 and any given section must take 100 hit points for it to be cracked.

56 - 65) **The Dryads**: Each Dryad will be individually described, but to save time and space, the consistent statistics will be listed here and can be referred back to when necessary. AC: 5, Move: 12", HD: 2, Damage: 1 - 4, HP: see below. These Dryads will not willingly go further than 240' from their trees (6" on the map). Each Dryad has unlimited use of a +2 *Charm Person* spell (the +2 is in the Dryad's favor). The Dryads will not *Charm* or fight the Gnolls normally, as their uprooting and destruction has been threatened if they cause any trouble.

56) **Astraea**: Her tree is an Oak. HP: 13.

57) **Briseis**: Her tree is an Ash. HP: 12.

58) **Calliste**: Her tree is an Elm. HP: 14.

59) **Deianira**: Her tree is an Oak. HP: 6.

60) **Eidothera**: Her tree is a Maple. HP: 14.

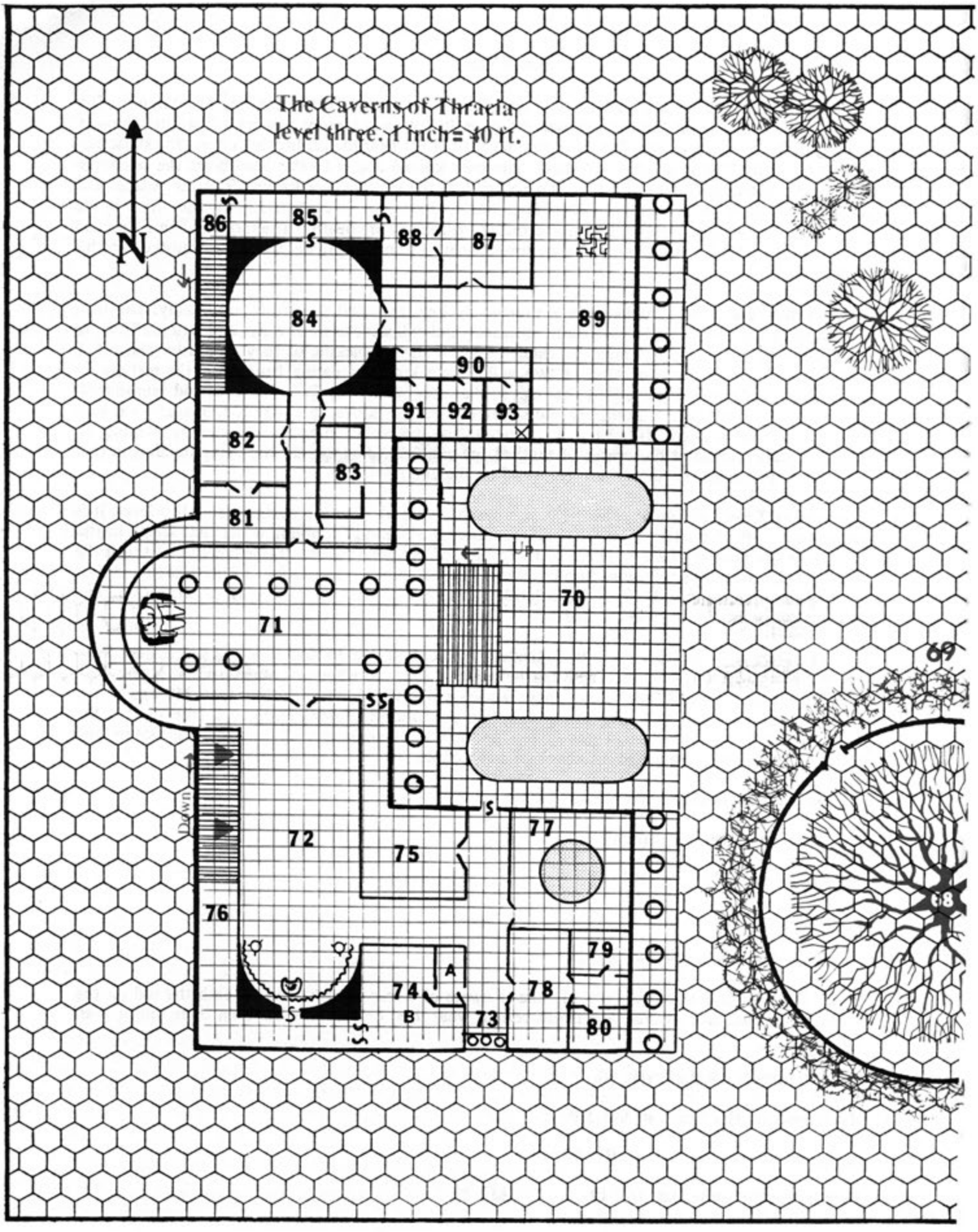
61) **Flora**: Her tree is a Hickory. HP: 15. She is aware of a trap door hidden beneath the sod on the south side of her tree's trunk. She is not certain what it is, only that it has been there longer than she has.

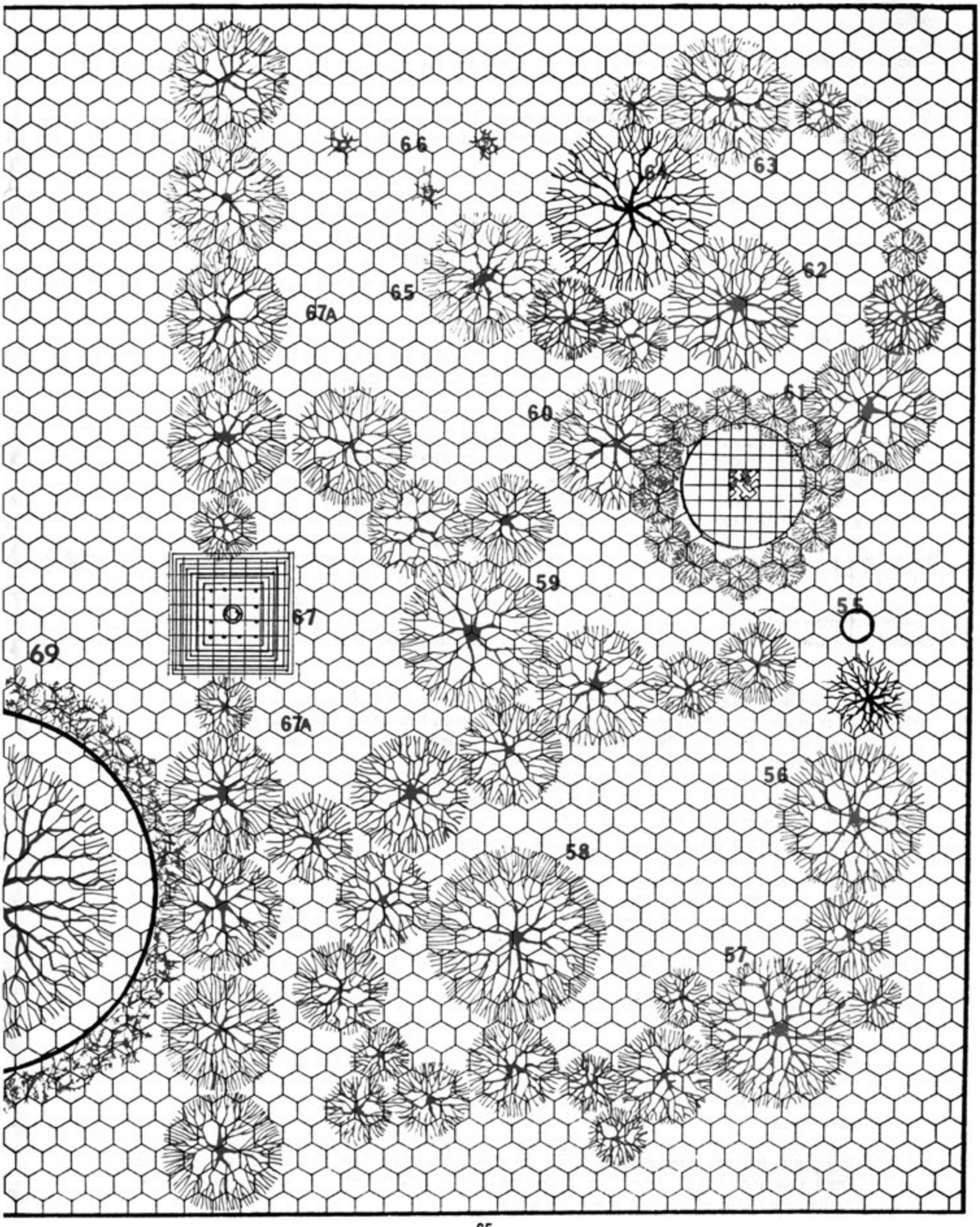
62) **Gaia**: Her tree is a Walnut. HP: 10.

63) **Hypermnestra**: Her tree is an Ash. HP: 7.

64) **Iphigenia**: Her tree is a Willow. HP: 12.

65) **Jocasta**: Her tree is an Oak. HP: 12.


The Caverns of Thraela
level three. 1 inch = 40 ft.
N
86
85
88
87
84
89
90
91
92
93
82
83
81
71
70
69
55
72
75
77
76
79
74
A
B
78
73
80
68
Down
Up


66
63
64
62
65
67A
61
60
59
67
55
69
67A
56
58
57

66) **The Stumps of Lost Trees**: Recently the Minotaur King has been removing trees to fuel the boilers in the cellars beneath his palace. The supply of wood from the surface has dwindled lately (the Tribesmen are flexing their muscles and refusing to pay tribute to the Minotaur King). Several of the removed trees were Dryad-containing trees. Their loss is mourned and if this information is used as a verbal weapon, the Dryad's aid might be gained against the minions of the Minotaur.

67) **Chapel of the Wondrous Well**: This small, Greek-looking temple is flanked on all sides by a 10' stair, that rises vertically only 5'. It is roofed over and in its center is a 5' diameter well that may seem to contain water. Climbing more than 10 ' down into the well will teleport the character doing so to the center of Room 3 on the 1st level. However, this will work effectively for a total of 4 characters. After that there is a 5% cumulative chance that it will not work each time it is used. If it ever stops functioning, it will cease to function forever. This chapel is the only safe passage through the tree wall (67 A) and is guarded by a Minotaur, 5 Gnolls and 2 Lizard Men. Minotaur: AC: 6, Move: 12", HD: 6, Damage: Butt for 2 - 8, Bite for 1 - 3 and Halberd for 1 - 10, HP: 31. 5 Gnolls: AC: 5, Move: 9", HD: 2, Damage: Longbow for 1 - 6, Battle Axe for 1 - 8, HP: 8, 12 (x2), 14, 15. Lizard Men: AC: 4, Move: 6", HD: 2 + 1, Damage: Club for 1 - 8, 4 Darts for 1 - 4 each, HP: 10, 6. One of the Gnolls will be posted in the clump of trees near the teleportation pad and will report back to the guard group at the chapel.

67A) **Aroused and Evil Trees**: This row of trees were planted and trained by the Shamen, G'ruk, to act as a vicious fence to keep out unwanted intruders. The trees will allow cows, Minotaurs, Lizard Men and Gnolls to pass freely beneath them. But, if a Human approaches within 50' of them, they will lower a network of branches that will act like a barrier of thorns to any character trying to cut his way through. Trees: AC: 5, HD: 6, Damage: 3 attacks per turn at 1 - 8, HP: 33, 24 (x2), 37, 16, 21, 46, 27, 23, 26 (ten trees total). To cut a path through the thorn fence of the trees, a total of 40 hit points must be done to the fence. This will create an approximately man-sized tunnel, 15' long through the thorny barrier. This damage does not count as damage done against the trees themselves. To kill the trees, the trunks must first be reached. At least 20 hit points must be done to the thorn barrier that even surrounds the tree trunks. The thorns are AC: 7. The sap of these trees are fire-resistant and has a healing quality. If it is allowed to flow onto a wound. it will heal 1 - 8 points of damage per character.

68) **The Ancient Oak**: This walled in oak tree existed from the time of King Agamemnos over 1100 years ago. It houses an ancient and wise Dryad named Kore. She appears as a middle-aged, yet attractive woman. From the vantage point of the air or from the steps of the chapel (67) she can often be seen sunning herself between patches of shade on the lawn surrounding her tree. In fact, she will often couch her head on the scaly hide of the Golden Lizard that guards her tree. The lizard is not very intelligent and it will not distinguish between friend or foe. It has kept her safe for a millenium now, but both it and the Dryad are slowly dying. Even now his scales are losing their shine and her tree is becoming patchy with bare spots amongst the branches. Lizard: AC: 3, Move: 9", HD: 15, Damage: Bite for 4 - 24, 2 Claws for 2 - 12 each, HP: 59. The lizard has been permanently endowed with *Protection from normal Missiles*. Kore, the Dryad: AC: 5, Move: 12", HD: 2, Damage: 1 - 4, spells: *+2 Charm Person*. She knows her way about in the south wing of the palace and can give directions concerning the north wing. She has never been into the tunnels beneath and knows nothing of them. Not even hearsay. Because she is not a threat, the Beast Men have left her alone. But lately, the Minotaur King and his lieutenants have been eyeing her tree for the wood value.

69) **Jailers for a Noble Tree**: Surrounding the tree is a 12' tall stone wall that is topped with spikes and large pieces of broken glass. The sharpened spikes point outward. There is a gate to the northwest that is hidden by the brambles that guard the enclosure. The brambles are AC: 4 (tough!!) and require 50 hit points of damage to be given before a man-sized hole or passage can be cut through them. When cut, these brambles exude sickly smelling vapor that will cause sleep if a saving throw vs. poison is not made. Sleep will last for a number of turns equal to the character's constitution subtracted from 20. If a character falls asleep in a path cut through the brambles and is left there, the brambles will regenerate 2 hit points every melee round (they grow back swiftly) and if they regenerate back half the damage taken they will begin to absorb 1 life level every two melee rounds from a sleeping victim, who if he awakens will have to cut him or herself free of brambles. Fire will do damage to the plants, but it will not spread.

Guarding against aerial attack are 5 Harpies. They will sit on the southeastern roof of the palace and watch with malevolent little eyes as adventurers sneak by. If an assault is made on the hedge, they will swoop down, harrassing and attempting to *Charm* and lead victims away to be devoured. If an attempt to reach the Dryad is made through the air, the Harpies will immediately attack to kill. AC: 7, Move: 6"/15", Damage: 2 Claws for 1 - 3 each, and a Sword for 1 - 6, HP: 15 (x2), 11, 9, 19.

The Palace of the Minotaur King: This gleaming marble structure appears very Greek in design with a gabled roof, ionic columns and sculpture filled pediments. Although most of the original furnishings of the palace are long gone from continual use, the building itself remains structurally sound. The Rulers of this place have not allowed their subjects to deface the rooms and statuary.

70) **The Courtyard**: The courtyard of the palace is tiled with large, white marble panels. The two pools of water that flank the stairs going up into the palace itself are 10' deep and the water in them is 100 degrees Fahrenheit. The level of the floor of the palace itself is 10' higher than the level of the courtyard. Guarding the courtyard is a 5-headed Hydra, AC: 5, Move: 12", HD: 5, Damage: 5 Bites at 1 - 6 each, HP: 35. If wounded badly, the creature will try to escape into the temple area and raise an incredibly loud hissing and honking noise to draw reinforcements, which will come in the form of a group of wandering monsters from the Palace Encounter Table (if the encounter rolled is not one that would normally come to the aid of an embattled Hydra, the creature will have to finish its battle unaided. Embedded between the eyes of each head is a 100 GP sapphire.

71) **Temple Hall of the God, Zeus**: The stonework in this hall is ornately carved and richly decorated with scenes of battle, magic and the lives of the gods. Behind the statue on the west wall are a pair of crossed thunderbolts. The statue at the west end of the hall is of the god, Zeus. It appears as a bearded, muscular man clutching a pair of crossed thunderbolts in his right hand. If the statue is approached within 20', the sounds of thunder can be heard as if from a distance. The throne upon which the statue sits appears to be constructed of solid gold. It is not and is merely gilt marble (the gilding is worth over 1000 GP though). If the statue is touched, the toucher will recieve a mild, harmless, but tingly electric shock. The doors in the north wall seem to be constructed of solid gold, as do the doors in the south wall. Actually they are gilt wood. The secret doors in the south wall are disguised as relief sculpture panels.

72) **Throne Room of the Minotaur King**: This ornate room is where the Minotaur King holds his occasional court. The floor is carpeted, but the carpet is very worn and threadbare in places, with the marble floor showing through. The walls are decorated with alternating panels of low relief sculpture and panels of intricately wrought paintings of hunts, ceremonies, banquets, and orgies. The throne is large and crudely sculpted out of black stone with little or no decoration. It is, however, large enough to support the Minotaur's huge frame. The draperies on the walls behind the throne part in the middle and are woven of very tough fabric. They are a bit brittle with age though. The braziers to the right and left of the throne are wrought of iron and are quite rusty. They are usually lit and produce a dim light with little smoke. They are the only light in the room. There is a 30% chance that the first time the room is entered the Minotaur will be holding court and will have a squad of Gnolls present and one of his lieutenants, the Dog Brothers in attendance.

Stronghoen, The Minotaur King: AC: 6, Move: 12", HD: 8, Damage: 1 Butt for 2 - 12, 1 Bite for 1 - 6, Battle Axe for 2 - 16, HP: 50. This Minotaur is the descendant of a long line of Minotaurs who have consistantly produced intelligent offspring. It is suspected that his ancestors were magically altered in some way. Not only does this monster function as a powerful fighter, but he may also throw magic as a 6th level Magician with the following spells available: *Charm Person (x2), Shield, Sleep, Invisibility, Wizard Lock, Fireball, Haste* (these spells may be changed at the descretion of the referee).

The Gnoll squad is made up of 6 Gnolls armed with two-handed Swords. Three of the Gnolls will have Longbows. AC: 5, Move: 9", HD: 2, Damage: 1 - 6 with Longbow, 1 - 10 with Two-handed Sword, HP: 8 (x2), 9, 10, 14, 11. Each Gnoll will have 7 SP and 6 GP on his person.

Dog Brothers: These are crew of intelligent, man-like dogs. They act as guides and overseers for the rapacious Gnolls. These dog-men will rarely be seen out side of the palace level or its dungeon complex. If they are encountered, it will be as a commander of a Gnoll guard squad. The

Dog Brother, Bitterbark, AC: 6, Move: 12", HD: 4, Damage: Bite for 1 - 4 or by weapon type, in this case, a Sword for 1 - 8, Align: Neutral, HP: 17. Often a Dog Brother may operate solely as a Magic User, never going beyond the 5th level of expertise.

If the court is attacked, the Minotaur King and the Dog Brother will stick around long enough to ascertain the direction the battle is going and then if in danger leave by the quickest route available.

73) **The Singing Caryatids**: Three Caryatids (columns that are carved as sculptures, in this case as three beautiful nude women) support the lintel over this window. The caryatids are 8' tall and carved from white marble. From the floor to the ledge upon which they stand, the distance is 3'. From the outside lawn, the distance is 13'. If these sculptures are touched in any way, they will begin to sing beautifully, but loudly. This action will definitely draw the attention of any being in the southern wing of the palace. The singing also has the function that it acts as a *Hold Person* spell on any creature hearing it for the first time. However, a being listening to it may save as two levels higher. The singing will last 1 full turn and the *Hold* spell will last the entire duration. There is no way to stop the singing until it is finished, save destroying the statuary.

74A) **Storeroom Clerk's Office**: Seated at a desk in the north end of this room is a little man, about 40 - 50 years old named Grassus, AC: 9, Move: 12", HD: 1, Damage: Dagger for 1 - 4, HP: 7, STR: 13, INT: 13, WIS: 16, DEX: 12, CON: 14, CHR: 15. He can converse in the tongue of the Tribesmen, Gnollic, Minotaur and can read a smattering of the Thracian language (he can not speak it though). Grassus is the clerk in charge of The Minotaur King's food stores. He is a trusted slave and he prefers his position with the Beast Men to any possibility of freedom. Given the chance, he will escape and betray any intruders to his masters. If the room is entered, he will be going over the list of stores, written in Thracian, since the Tribesmen have no written language and the Beast Men's tongues are not suited to clerkly material. There will be 2 Gnolls in this room engaged in idle conversation and armed with Swords. AC: 5, Move: 9", HD: 2, Damage: 1 - 8 with Sword, HP: 13, 8. If attacked they will yell for help to come from Room 74 B.

74B) **Storeroom**: This is the palace's food warehouse. The walls are lined with shelves that are packed with urns, amphorae and boxes containing various foodstuffs. Items included will be: grain, wine, olive oil, dried meat (beef and Human), hard cakes, honey, nuts, flour, wild rice, spices, salt, dried fruit (apples and pears) and onions. The secret doors will be visible if the pile of boxes containing dried figs is moved. Guarding this room and supervising the Human slaves who are taking inventory are a patrol of 6 Gnolls, AC: 5, Move: 9", HD: 2, Damage: Morning Stars for 1 - 8, HP: 11 (x2), 9, 8, 5, 14, and a Dog Brother named Wuffletree, AC: 6, Move: 12", HD: 4, Damage: Bite for 1 - 4 plus 2 Daggers for 1 - 4 each, HP: 13, spells: *Charm Person, Detect Magic, Hold Portal, Sleep, Phantasmal Forces, Pyrotechnics, Haste Spell*. Wuffletree values his hide in the extreme and if faced with a with certain death (or even the possibility of death), he will surrender or flee.

75) **Lair of the Minotaur King**: This is the chamber that the King of the Beast Men calls home. It is high ceilinged and lit both by sky-lights and by the fire that 3 Minotauresses, paragons of bovine beauty, are tending upon which turns a spit containing the roasted carcass of a Human female. Running about the room will be 2 small Minotaur calves, butting and playing. There is a 10% chance that the Minotaur King will be in here (see Room 72). Minotaur Females: AC: 6, Move: 12", HD: 5, Damage: Butt for 2 - 8, Bite for 1 - 3 and/or Carving Knife for 1 - 6, HP: 29, 28, 20. The largest of the Minotaur Cows is the mother of the two calves and will fight berserkly (+2 hit probability and +10 hit points). The smallest Cow has a fairly high intelligence and has been taught to function as a 2nd level Magic User, using *Charm Person (x2)*. The Minotaur Calves will attack immediately anything Human that does not resemble a slave and even then, they will roughhouse that person. The calves are only semi-intelligent and are always hungry. Calves: AC: 6, Move: 9", HD: 3, Damage: Butt for 1 - 6 points of damage and Bite for 1 - 2, HP: 13 (x2).

The room is furnished with several stone benches draped with furs. One of the benches is actually a chest containing 1000 GP, and a Potion of Heroism.

The "secret doors" to the temple are not secret from this side. However, they are trapped. If the stone face in the center of the right hand door is not spun so that it is upside down when the door is opened, a hail of large rocks will be dropped on top of victims for 4 - 24 points of damage each (no saving throw).

76) **Stairway into the Dungeons**: This stair leads down into the dungeons and lower recess of the palace itself. Since the Beast Men took over, the stair has been rigged with a pair of traps firing 3 Spears each (see Room 76 on Level 4 Map). These traps are maintained regularly and were set up to keep slaves from escaping this way or from bothering the Manticores in Room 94. The traps will be fired off horizontally to hit chest high at the point marked on the map. They will hit as if thrown by a heavy Crossbow being fired by an 8th level fighter. Any, repeat, any noise in this stair will alert the manticores to the presents of visitors. The manticores will then prepare an ambush if the correct password is not spoken. (Determine password in effect below.)

Passwords

1) The Rocks Bleed Black Blood
2) Speak the Spell
3) Lost Lairs of the Lizard King
4) Dead Men Tell No Tales
5) Kill the Humans
6) Thanatos is Dead

If the password is spoken, the Manticores will judge the speaker to be alright. The commander of each patrol of all the different species will know the password.

77) **Pool of Watery Wonders**: While this is not a magic pool, in and of itself, it can be used to work magical wonders. The pool was originally a bath and is still heated from below. The water is 120 degrees Fahrenheit and the room is filled with water vapor. The floor is tiled with glazed ceramic and set in various aquatic designs portraying fish, nymphs sea gods and sea monsters. Occasionally it is still used for this purpose by the Minotaur Cows in Room 75. It has a second purpose, much more arcane though. Located at the 4 cardinal points of the compass (N, E, S, W) are 4 white, marble bowls mounted on 3' tall pillars of black marble. The bowls are empty, but there is writing in magic on the rim of each bowl. The bowls are magic devices, using the water from the pools to power them. The Minotaur King knows the function of them, but he has never used any of them. If necessary to protect his domain, he will. The Dog Brother, Wuffletree, has used all functions of the pool (including bathing) except for its *Conjure Elemental* power.

North Bowl: This bowl's writing describes the process for summoning a water elemental. The process requires filling the bowl with water from the pool and speaking the proper ritual. The process will summon in one turn a 12 die water elemental that will use all the water in the pool to form itself. AC: 2, Move: 6", HD: 12, Damage: 3 - 30, HP: 53. It is immune to non-magic weapons.

East Bowl: The writing on this bowl describes a process by which the person casting the listed spell may cause the bowl to operate as a *Locate Object* spell of unlimited range (unlimited as far as the dungeon is concerned, it will not work on anything outside of the caverns). Once the water is magicked, a needle or pointer will seem to appear on the surface of the liquid and point in the direction of the desired object, even pointing up or down. The bowl is designed so that the water may be poured off into a different vessel and thus become portable. Once the item is found, the water vaporizes (doing 1 - 3 points of damage to who ever is holding the bowl or container, unless they are protected from heat damage). Spell will last 1 - 6 hours.

South Bowl: This bowl will function as a special clairvoyance spell when properly magicked. It will reveal any desired location within the caverns of Thracia. It will reveal up to 4 separate locations (if a random room is asked for or if no specific room is desired, roll on a d100 and check the room indicated). The room desired will appear in the large pool.

West Bowl: This bowl is the teleportation bowl. It specifies that for it to work, the south bowl must first be activated and a destination determined (you see, it only works inside the caverns and provides a one-way trip). Then the east bowl must be brought into function and the locate object power brought to bear on the room depicted on the pool. At this point the teleportation unit is primed and the image in the pool will disappear. As long as there is water in the three bowls and the pool it will stay primed. There is a cord on the underside of the west bowl that will open up a drain in the bottom of the vessel. Once pulled the bowl will drain in 1 melee round. The teleport is activated by jumping into the 4' deep pool. The jumper will then arrive, slightly damp, at the predetermined site. If neither the clairvoyance bowl, nor the locate bowl is used then a random destination will be determined and those entering the pool will be sent there. However, there will be an error factor of 1 - 10 involved. See below.

A roll on the percentile die of 01 - 50% indicates that teleportees reached their destination with an error factor of no more than 1 - 6" too high, incurring no damage as they land, only a lack

of initiative if placed in a problem situation (subtract 1 point from initiative roll for each inch that a teleportee lands too high). A roll of 51 - 90% indicates that the teleportees came in 1 - 20' too high and a resultant drop will do damage equal to 1d6 per 10' of fall. Also, victims may lose a chance for an initiative roll (this is up to the referee) if they are dropped into a situation requiring such a roll to be made.

A roll of 91 - 00% indicates that the victim has come in too low by 1 - 10'. This could have several possible results (mostly instant death) and it should be up to the referee to determine those results on the situation involved.

The only escape from death when a limb or limbs are partially entrapped is by immediate severance of the trapped member, but this should be up to the referee.

Back to the bowls. Removing them will destroy their power.

A water elemental may be sent through the teleport by setting up the teleport and then creating the elemental who will then be sent to the desired location, emptying the pool of all water. This is one way in which the Minotaur King might wreak revenge on intruders. Set up the locate so that it shows the offending party, whereever he, she or they are, and send the elemental through to them, maintaining control by viewing the scene in the clairvoyance bowl. The water in the pool will refill in three turns.

78) **Weapons Room of the Dog Brothers**: This is a once ornate room that has ratty drapes that hang from the ceiling down to about 10' from the floor. The drapes are torn and ragged (what remains of them) and all color has either faded from them or is covered by dense soot. The ceiling and upper walls are also coated with a thick layer of carbon black. The room is lit by light filtering in from the skylights in the ceiling and from the campfire in the south end of the room. Several shields of tribesmen make hang from the walls and in the northeast corner is a pile of weapons containing a stone mace, a bronze sword, a morning star, a two-handed sword (broken at the hilt, it is in two pieces) and a spiked ball off of another morning star. Two lizard men will be practicing with weapons while a third looks on. Lizard men: AC: 4, Move 6", HD: 2 +1, Damage: club for 1-8, 4 darts at 104 each, HP: 11, 13, 10. The heavy wooded doors on the east wall are barred from the other side to prevent entry.

79) **Lush Lair of a Dog Brother**: The short hall connecting rooms 79 & 80 is dark except for a flickering candle stuck in a sconce at the east end of the corridor. The door to room 79 is ornately carved with images of goddesses and concubines. The room itself is illumed by a pair of candles that glow with continual light. If other portions of the palace are grim and devoid of finery, then here it must all be collected. Rich, bright tapestries hang on the walls, depicting the goddess of love and her paramours. The floor is covered with a deep luxurius carpet of brilliant color. The east end of the room is deep with cushion and furs. A low table at the west end is set with artfully cut crystal ware. There are ripe fruits set out and on the table is a huge roast of beef, seemingly simmering with juices. The table is magic. It will conjure up enough food to feed eight people daily. The food will always be different from day to day and it will be rich and tasty. (*Create Food* spells were never like this!!) The table is delicate. If dropped it will splinter and break. Its weight, at most, is no more than 250gp and it is 3' x 3' x 2½'. There is a 25% chance that it will still function, but that the food it produces will be foul tasting or foul looking and have a 40% chance of being poisonous.

Two female dog brothers named Spittletongue and Sniffletail (dog sisters in this case) will be in this chamber. One will be eating at the table, the other will be giving suck to a litter of 6 pups. AC: 6, Move 12", HD: 4, Damage: bite for 1-4 +1 dagger for 1-4, HP: 18, 18. The pups are AC: 9, HD: ½, HP: 5, 5, 5, 5, 5, 5.

80) **A Second Lush Lair**: This room is much the same as room 79. The door into it is carved with scenes of passion. The room itself is hung with ornate draperies, sewn and stitched artfully with gold and silver thread. The floor is thickly carpeted and cushions lie about everywhere. There is a tray of food on the floor containing 4 goblets of wine, a huge portion of roast beef and several spice cakes. A dog brother, Wark, AC: 6, Move: 12", HD: 4, Damage: sword for 1-8 and bite for 1-4, HP: 20, is being entertained by a trio of comely (to another dog brother) young dog sisters, Flashtail, Prettyclaws and Pinkfang, AC: 6, Move: 12", Damage: bite for 1-4, HD: 4, HP: 26,19, 25. There is a chest against the north wall covered by furs containing 8000cp and 2000gp.

81) **A Gnollic Guardpoint**: Ever watchfull at this point are a squad of 6 gnolls, AC: 5, Move 9", HD: 2, Damage: two-handed swords for 1-10, HP: 9, 8, 7, 10, 10, 6. The air in this room, besides being

permeated with the odor of raunchy gnoll, smells heavily of cooked food. Each gnoll will have 4sp & 2 gp on his person. A fracas in here will draw wary minotaurs from room 82.

82) **Kitchen**: This steamy, warm room is the kitchen for the bulk of the troops living in the palace. The food cooked here is neither eye-appealing nor taste-tempting. It all looks like a grey mush with greasy lumps floating in it. If it can be gagged down, it will serve as rations. The stuff will, also, keep for up to a week, then it will begin to get moldy (which actually seems to improve the taste, even though eating it then will cause botulism–a form of food poisoning). Tending the kitchen are 6 human slaves. The slaves have never known any other life than living in the palace. They speak the language of tribesmen and gnollic. They are AC: 9, Move: 9", HD: ½, Damage: 1-2 or by weapon type, HP 1, 2, 4, 4, 3, 3. They are as follows: 2 attractive young females, a male child, an old woman and a young man. These particular slaves sleep here at night (a dimming of the overhead lights). They will be scared out of their wits by intruders. Guarding the slaves and the kitchen from invasions of hungry residents are a pair of minotaurs aptly named Moos and Hornni, AC: 5 (skin & shield), Move: 12", HD: 6, Damage: Butt for 2-8, bite for 1-3 or battle ax for 1-10, HP: 35, 31. These boys do not fight in silence and will moo for all they're worth while fighting. This will begin to draw at least one party of wandering monsters and should draw all troops within 50' into the fray.

83) **Office of the Guard**: This is the cheif guardroom and in it will be the commanders of the various beast-men, discussing placement of guards, expansion of patrols and procurement of more slaves and supplies. Gradsh, commander of the gnolls, AC: 5, Move: 9", HD: 2, Damage: two-handed sword for 1-10, HP: 16, Bullick, chief of the minotaurs and second in command only to the minotaur king (also his oldest son), AC: 6, Move: 9", HD: 6, Damage: battle ax for 1-12, HP: 43. Barkbite, hetman of the dogbrothers, AC: 4, Move: 12", HD: 4, Damage: sword for 1-8 and/or bite for 1-4, HP: 30. Hssssdk, warleader of the lizard men mercenaries, AC: 4, Move: 6"/12"(swimming), HD: 2 +1, Damage: sawtoothed club for 2-9, 4 darts for 1-4 each, HP: 16.

There will be a gnoll guard, AC: 5, Move 9", HD: 2, Damage: halberd for 1-10, HP: 11, 14 at each of the doors to the hall. They will be inside the 83 area (the halls, not the room) with their backs against the east wall, facing west, very alert.

In this room will be a locked case containing the valuables of the commanders The case will contain 4000cp and 2000gp, in small bags of 100 coins each. There will be crude maps of the dungeon complex known to the beast-men rolled up on a desk. The maps will include portions of the first, second, third and forth levels, but no secret areas or sublevels will be indicated.

84) **Beam of Blasting Light**: This room is a large dome, 50' in diameter and 40' from floor to peak. Although there is no hole in the ceiling, there appears to be a shaft of sunlight coming out of the ceiling. The light forms a 10' diameter circle on the floor, directly in front of the secret door. The sound of light sizzling can be heard. Chained in the center of the floor and spread-eagled, face up, is a 4th level tribesman cleric named Holoste. He was captured by a lizard men patrol and was the only member of his band not to be torn apart and eaten. He is AC: 9, Align: LE, Move: 12", HD: 4, damage: by weapon type, HP: 21, Spells: *Cure Light Wounds, Protection from Good, Find Traps.* His group was caught on level 2 in room 31. The shaft of light is slowly moving down the wall and has reached the floor, moving at a rate of 5' per turn. In three turns the light will be falling on Holoste. The light does 8D6 of damage every round. The light causes intense heat. A saving throw vs dragon breath will save the victim from half the damage. There will be 3 gnoll cubs waiting for Holoste to die (see room 87).

85) **An . . . Empty Room**: Yes! In every dungeon complex there has to be at least one. A room with nothing interesting in it. A space to rest momentarily from pursuit. A place no monster would think to look. This is one of those places. Except for a giant pair of baleful, glowing amber-colored eyes on the north wall and secret doors hidden in the east, west, and south walls, disguised as unadorned marble panels, there is nothing here. Did I mention that the eyes radiate a definite feeling of evil and seem to chill the very soul? Well, they do. Any character staying in this room more than 3 melee rounds must save vs magic or he will think he is being paralyzed (a delusion).

86) **Hall of Harrowing Hands**: (Actually this is a stairway. but stair isn't aliterative with hands) When this room is entered, the walls will seem to sprout hands on long arms. The hands will be the temperature of rock but will be fairly soft. All they will do is feel anything passing through them. The walls on both the east and west sides of the stair will sprout hands for a distance of 20' down the stairway.

Officers of the Guard

The hands are harmless unless they are attacked (AC: 8, Move: 0, HD: ½, Damage: attack as 4 hit dice monsters for 1-4 each, HP: 2 (x 70)). Each 10' section of wall will contain 10 hands. The arms telescope and can reach 6' out into the stairwell. Fire will not harm the hands, but a fireball will paralyze them for 1-4 melee rounds. Once the hands have been irritated, they will not calm down for 12 turns and will try to attack anything trying to pass through at that time. (2-8 will attack each person each round.) They will continue to remain agitated for 2 hours after every encounter in which they are damaged or attacked.

87) **Habitat of Gnoll Females and Cubs**: Whatever this room may have served for before, it is now the home for 20 female gnolls, AC: 7, Move: 9", HD: 2, Damage: 1-8 or by weapon type, HP: roll as necessary. These females gnolls will normally not attack if the room is entered. Nor will they get upset if a cub is killed. However, if the females themselves are attacked of intruders begin a wholesale slaughter of the young, they will attack and fight to the death. Along with the females are 35 cubs that are from a few weeks old to almost a year old. The gnoll matures quickly and within four and a half years they are full grown and capable of reproducing. The cubs are AC: 7, Move: 8", HD: ½, Damage: bite for 1-3, HP: roll as necessary. Roll a D6 to determine size. A 1-3 indicates hit dice are D4s. A 4-5 indicate full D8s and a roll of 6 indicates an almost full-grown youngster who ought to be in military training with 1 +1 hit dice.

88) **The Inner Habitat**: These are the older gnoll matrons whose wisdom rules this small tribe. gnoll males only know how to bully and fight, so the females must control the society, allowint the males to think they are in control and making the decisions. There are 6 old gnoll females in here, AC: 7, Move: 6", HD: 2, Damage: bite for 1-3, HP: 12, 11, 2, 9, 14, 8. They will have 3 or 4 young cubs, HD: ½ in the room with them. In a box in the NE corner (an old gnoll is sitting on it) are 1000 gp and 5 small semi-precious stones–4 100gp ambers and 1 50gp turquois.

89) **Temple of Teleportation**: This is yet another temple area in the palace. The 10' square patterned area on the map represents a 3rd teleportation pad that will take troops directly to the pad in room 54. In baskets to either side of the pad are small glass marbles. If one of these marbles is carried on the pad and the pad in room 45 is activated, the teleportee will be transported to room 45 instead of room 54. For safety's sake, none of the troops garrisoned on the first and second levels carry these marbles. Guarding this area are 4 warrior minotaurs, AC: 6, Move: 12", HD: 6, Damage: butt for 2-8, bite for 1-3 or battle ax for 1-10, HP: 32, 25, 23, 34. The upper reaches of the walls are decorated with friezes of titanic battles between beast-headed men and heroic gods and goddesses. Located at the north and south ends of the room are piles of rubble that appear to have once been statues.

90) **Connecting Hall**: This short hall connects the three gnollic warrior barracks together. There is a 50% chance that a single guard will be on duty here at all times. AC: 5, Move: 9", HD: 2, Damage: 1-6 with crossbow and 1-8 with morning-star, HP: 11.

91-93) **The Barracks of the Gnoll Guards**: These three rooms house the warlike male gnolls of the tribe. Each room quarters approximately 20 gnolls (patrols are in and out so often that it is never certain where a specific gnoll will be at a given time. They just sleep here when off duty on this level. Because of the transient nature of the occupants, there will be no treasure in this room, except what is on the person of the individual creatures. Each room will have from 6-11 occupants in it at all times. Gnolls are AC: 5, Move: 9", HD: 2, Damage: 1-8 or by weapon type, HP: roll as necessary. At least 60% of the room's occupants will be asleep. The remainder will be eating and gambling for personal stakes. Each gnoll will have from 1-12sp and 1-8gp. In the southeast corner of room 93 is a 5' square secret trapdoor on the floor. It opens on a 5' square shaft with stone walls and rungs set into the stone. It goes downward 70' to room 115. This trapdoor is hidden from view by a pile of ratty sleeping rags.

Level 4

LEVEL FOUR

94) **The Manticores**: These are the two manticores mentioned in stairway 76. If any noise is made while while descending the stair, the manticores will be alerted and will wait for a password (see 76) to be spoken. If the word is not spoken or is incorrect, they will attack, surprising on a D6 roll of 1-4, with volleys of spikes. The manticores are AC: 4, Move: 12"/18", HD: 6 +1, Damage: 2 claws for 1-3 each and bite for 1-8 and 24 spikes for 1-6 each, HP: 41, 38.

The ceiling of the room is 30' high and the walls are decorated with flaking wall paintings of sumptuous banquets and expansive gardens. There are a few rotting wood couches strewn about the room and some shattered marble slabs may have been tables. This was once a banquet hall. Leaning up against the north wall are 6 heavy ceramic urns. Each contains approximately 660 gold pieces. At the bottom of urns 1 and 5 are potion bottles. Number 1 is a potion of Hill Giant control while number 5 if polymorph self. In urn 6 is a +2 chaotic evil sword with a dark blue blade.

95) **A Vacant Chamber**: The walls of the rrom are carved with bas-relief friezes of men fighting beasts of all sorts. Both doors out of (or into) this room are locked. If entered from the south or east there is a 25% chance that 1 or both manticores from room 94 will be in here.

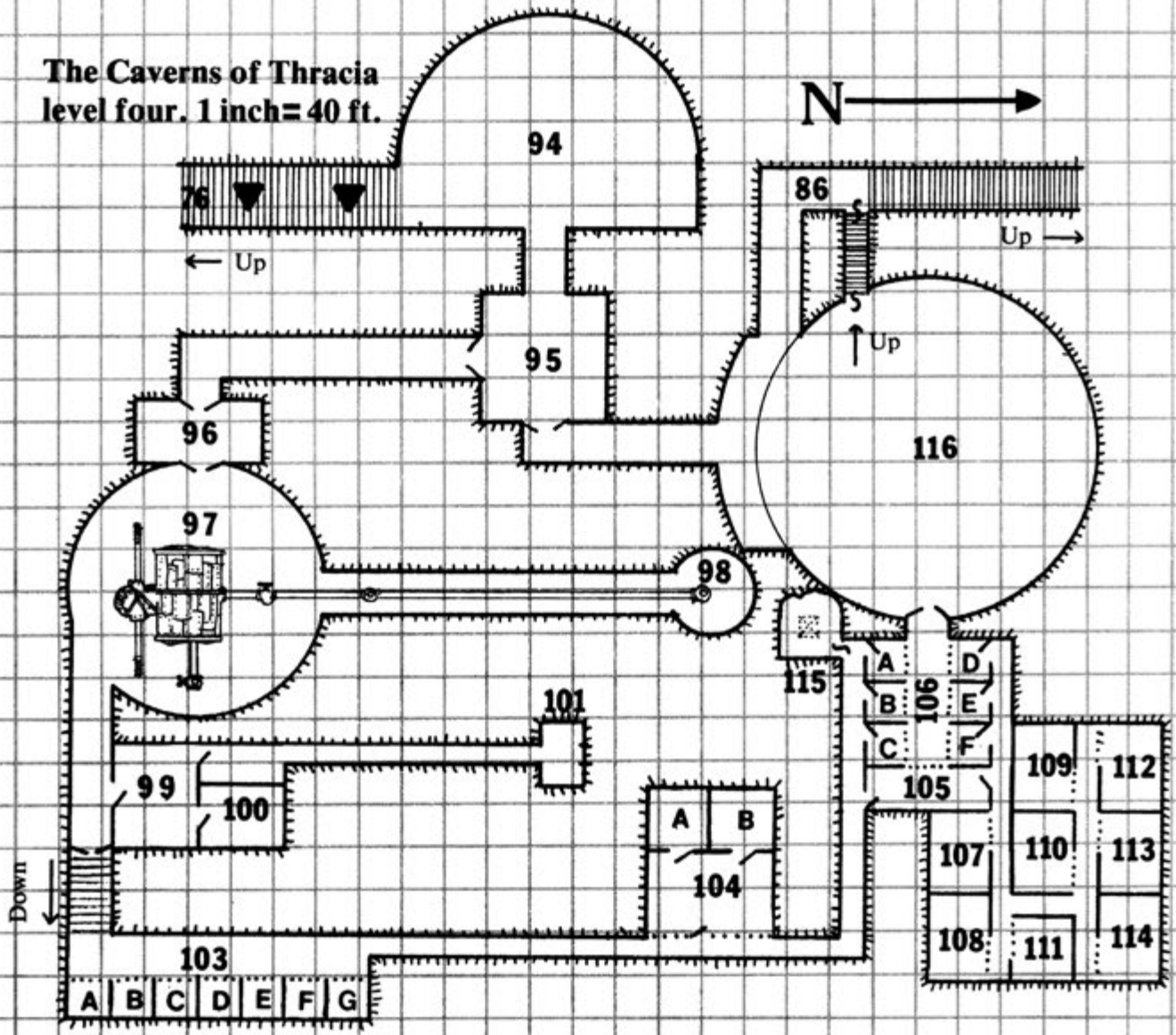
96) **A Lizard Men Guardpost**: There will be 4 lizard men, AC: 4, Move: 6", HD: 2+1, Damage: club for 1-8 4 darts for 1-4 each, HP: 8, 10, 11, 14. The heavy oak doors into this room are barred from the inside and will be -2 on breaking down. If more than one assault is made on a door, there will be 8 extra lizard men from room 97 waiting to do battle.

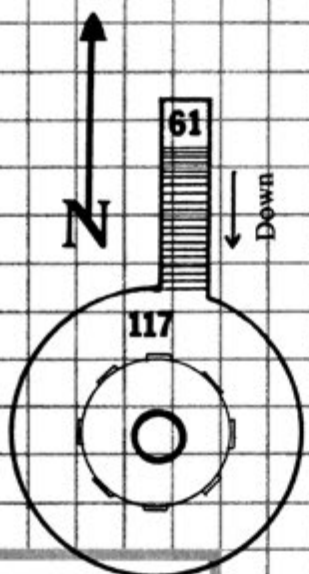
97) **The Bilious Boiler Room**: This is the source of the hot water in the various pools and basins on this level of the Palace. The boiler is a huge bronze contraption that is fired by wood placed in a firebox beneath it. The room is full of smoke and steam. Working the great pump bellows are 10 slaves while another 2 slaves feed wood into the firebox. Pipes lead up to the pools and are controlled by two large valves. Guarding this room are 10 lizard men, AC: 4, Move: 6", HD: 2 +1, Damage: clubs for 1-8 and 4 darts for 104 each, HP: 7, 7, 7, 7, 11, 6, 4, 5, 9, 13. If these lizard men go into combat with intruders, at least 2 will always stay guard on to prevent any escape of the slaves. The slaves are all male and in pretty sorry shape, AC: 9, Move: 9", HD: ½, Damage: by weapon type only, HP: roll as necessary. The boiler is AC: 3 and it will require 25 hit points at any given location to puncture it. If the water is spilled out, it will do at least 1D8 of damage to any creature it touches (heat damage) for 2 melee rounds thereafter.

98) **The Guard at the Pipe**: A single lizard man guards this pipe from damage and inspects for possible leaks. While it is not smokey down at this point, it is still steamy (the lizard men enjoy that). The lizard man is AC:4, Move: 6", HD: 2 +1, Damage: club for 1-8 and 4 darts for 1-4 each, HP: 11.

99) **Barracks of the Lizard Men Mercenaries**: At any given time there will be 3-12 lizard men in this chamber, resting and devouring various disgusting foodstuffs. If surprized it will take them at least a full melee round to arm themselves. The lizard men are AC: 5 (they will not have shields immediately handy), Move: 6", HD: 2 +1, Damage: 2 claws for 1-3 each and a bite for 1-8 or club for 1-8, HP: roll as necessary.

100) **Shrine of the Ancient Ones and Treasure Vault**: This is the worship area of the lizard mercenaries. It is a form of ancestor worship. Over the centuries, the lizards have discovered various treasures and items that are both valuable and related to the ancient lizard culture that once existed. A simple stone carving of a lizard man is set up on a short piece of marble pillar and has flayed human skin draped over it. The eyes are mismatched, though. The left eye is a 1000gp peridot and the right eye is a 5000gp sapphire. Elsewhere on the carving there is a 500 gp jade stone and a 10gp amber chip.


The Caverns of Thracia
level four. 1 inch= 40 ft.
N
94
76
Up
86
Up
Up
95
96
116
97
98
115
A
B
C
D
E
F
106
101
99
100
105
109
112
A
B
104
107
110
113
Down
103
108
111
114
A
B
C
D
E
F
G


N
61
Down
117

On a tray in front of the small altar there rests two potions and a rolled scroll of some ancient, tough skin (possibly dinosaur hide). One of the potions is human control and the other invisibilty. The scroll has a curse on it and will polymorph the opener into a small, extinct reptile, AC: 6, Move: 12", HD: 1, Damage bite for 1-3, HP: 7 and unintelligent. A saving throw against magic is applicable. To read the scroll a *Read Languages* spell is necessary. It is a map that will lead to the location of the grand temple of the reptile race. It will only show the location of the door into the area from 53 and will, also, reveal the entrance to that chamber.

This shrine is guarded by a pair of fanatic lizard men, AC: 4, Move: 6", HD: 2 +1, Damage: club for 1-8 and 4 darts for 1-4 each, HP: 8, 8. Both lizardmen know the function of the human control potion and will attempt to drink it if they are attacked. They do not know the function of the other potion, but are aware that the map is a great artifact, even though they do not know what it is. Stealing the shrine or its gems will cause every lizard man mercenary to desert his post and come looking for the thieves. Within 15 turns of the theft, they will have used the pool in room 77 through the help of one of the dog brothers, and from 5-25 lizard men will teleport directly to the location of the gems and fight like berserkers to the death to regain their holy object. This will continue once every 4 turns until a total of 60 lizard men have been killed or the shrine and its valuables are returned.

101) **Green Slime Garderobe**: A garderobe is a medieval version of indoor plumbing. This room and 30' of the connecting hallway are coated in a thick, juicy layer of green slime (harmless). On the north wall of the room itself, in the center of that wall, it appears that there may be a door. There is not a door, it just looks like there might be one.

102) **The Mysterious Missing Chamber**: Look as you might you will not find this room on the map. It never was there and exists only in the mind of the designer, who refuses to admit that he may have made an oversight when numbering his creation and doesn't feel like sticking the number "102" somewhere on the map and letting it go like that.

103) **The Cells of the Tribesman Slaves**: All the tribesmen will be AC: 9, Move: 9", HD: ½, Damage: by weapon type only, HP: roll as necessary. During the "Daylight" hours, there will only be 1-2 slaves in each cell and they will be older ones. At night, all slaves will be in. They are taken to their various jobs around the palace up through room 97 over to stair 76 and into the throne room. Old slaves, useless to their masters, are left behind to take care of the cells.

A. 5 slaves: 3 men, two women
B. 4 slaves: 1 man, 2 old women, 1 girl
C. 5 slaves: 3 men, 1 woman, 1 boy
D. 4 slaves: 1 man, 3 old women
E. 5 slaves: 2 men, 2 women, 1 old man
F. 6 slaves: 1 man, 3 women, 1 old woman, 1 boy
G. 5 slaves: 2 women, 1 old man, 1 boy, 1 girl

104) **The Torture Chamber**: Although this area is not normally used, captured adventurers will be brought here and placed into 104A. The door is solid oak and locked. All possessions will be placed in 104B except for items of obvious value which the gnolls and dog brother in charge of this area will place in room 115. The room contains various archaic modes of torture. Very few of them will be as sophisticated as current contraptions but they will do the job. If a character is indeed tortured (a 40% chance if they carried any valuables on them or spoke cryptically to their captors or if part of the intruder party got away) a mode of torture will be selected that will reduce a characteristic by 1 point for each full turn the torture is applied. Use this chart to determine the characteristic in a random manner: 1=Strength; 2=Intelligence; 3=Wisdom; 4=Dexterity; 5= Constitution; 6=Charisma; 7=2 characteristics will be affected, reroll; 8=1 will be affected, but twice as fast, reroll. The application of *Cure Serious Wounds* will heal 1-2 points of damage but may only be done once and to only 1 characteristic affected, when more than one is. A characteristic that is damaged will naturally heal back 1 point (in a month) but all other loss to that characteristic is permanent unless healed as above. A limited wish would, also, remove damage taken. Thus, if a character was tortured and lost 3 points of intelligence and 4 points oc charisma, he would heal back 1 point of each in one month's time and a cure critical wounds could reduce the damage further to one of the characteristics by an additional 1-2 points. Note: If Constitution is reduced below 3, the character will die. Characters should be informed each turn that they are tortured that they have lost a certain amount of points. Each time a character is tortured, the affected characteristic should be determined anew.

This room is run by Dog Brother Fangfriend, AC: 6, Move: 12", HD: 4, Damage: Sword for 1-8 or Bite for 1-4, HP: 21; and three Gnolls, AC: 5, Move: 9", HD: 2, Damage: Halberds for 1-10, HP: 6, 11, 8. They know of their secret treasure secreted away in Room 115. If they are tortured or threatened with loss of life, they might reveal the location of the treasure.

105) **An Abandoned Guard Room**: This room is devoid of contents, but it appears to have been once used as a guard room. On the west wall, to the south of the bars, there is a series of three levers. Pulling down on one of them will raise the bars in one of the left set of cells for Room 106. The lever that is farthest south of the bars will open gate A and so on. To the north of the bars on the same wall there is another set of 4 levers. The lever that is farthest north from the bars is down already and it will be visible that the gate in Room 106D is up. The lever closest to the bars will open the gate into Room 116 from Room 106.

106) **Gladiatorial Cells**: In these cells the combatants in ancient gladiatorial contests were held. Now they are empty except for small rats and spiders. The floor is covered with ancient straw. The gates are all down except for Room D which is up. The doors to Room 116 are closed. The cell gates are controlled by levers in Room 105.

107-114) **Ancient Animal Holding Cells**: These barred rooms were once used to keep the animals for gladiatorial combat. Various types of creatures were once kept in these rooms, but none now remain. Only three of these rooms contain anything at all and they are listed below:

108) **Minotaur Lair I**: In this cell are a Minotaur Cow and her 2 Calves. The Cow is AC: 6, Move: 12", HD: 5, Damage: Butt for 2-8, Bite for 1-3 or Mace for 1-8, HP:26. The two Calves are AC: 6, Move: 9", HD: ½, Damage: nil, HP: 3, 3. The Calves are only a week or so old. There are 600 GP in a wooden chest against the south wall.

111) **Minotaur Lair II**: This lair also contains a Minotaur Cow, however, she is older and past child bearing. She has above average intelligence for a Minotaur. Her name is Bova, AC:7, Move: 6", HD: 5, Damage: Butt for 2-5, Bite for 1-2, no weapon, Align: CN. She speaks Gnollic, Minotaur and Tribesman. The old lady is partially blind and if attacked she will not try to defend herself. Her grandson is the Minotaur King.

112) **The Treasure Trove of the Minotaur King**: In this room there will always be a large Minotaur and a magic-using Dog Brother, guarding the King's treasure. The Minotaur, Thundahuuf, AC: 6, Move: 12", HD: 6, Damage: Battle Axe for 1-12, Butt for 2-8, and Bite for 1-3, HP: 40. The Dog Brother, Woofworth, AC: 6, Move: 12", HD: 4, Damage: Bite for 1-4 or two Daggers for 1-4 each, HP: 19, spells: *Charm Person (x 3), Magic Missile, Web (x 2), Haste*. The treasure consists of a large box of stone containing 2000 SP and 5000 GP. Buried under the coins is a locked iron box of ingenious design and ornately wrought, studded with 4 diamonds and valued at 4000 GP. This box may be opened, but doing so will release a creature exactly like the one guarding the chests in Room 33 (see 33 for details on the Disembodied Mouth) Inside the iron box is the following: a Ring of Contrariness, a Marble Elephant (the miscellaneous magic item), a Sword Sheath formed of thin plates of citrine valued at 1700 GP and a set of gold, solver and pink coral Beads worth 2900 GP. High, on an apparently empty shelf in the southeast corner of the room, is an invisible box. Not even the Minotaur King and his minions suspect its presence. Inside the box are two items, a glowing, green glass globe and a strange contraption made of brass that appears to be a box with a hand pointing upward on its top and a hand crank on its side. The glass globe is the powering element for the teleporter in Room 89. If it is broken or taken out of the palace, the glow will fade and the teleporter will cease to function, neither sending nor recieving. The brass box is a summoning agent for the basket that lower from Room 126. By turning the crank and pointing the hand skyward, a small, magical electric force will be generated which will cause the basket to descend to the floor of the 3rd level. The crank must be turned continuously until the basket reaches the ground. It will only work outside of the palace. It will take approximately 1 full turn for the basket to descend and at least a melee round for it to be visible below the mists which blanket the ceiling of the cavern. These two items were hidden here by the last remaining Humans in the palace when the Beasts took over 1100 years ago.

115) **Torturers Treasure**: This small, roughly carved room has a chimney of shaft leading up from its low (6') ceiling to Room 93. Buried under a tile in the floor and covered with dirt is the treasure that the torturers in Room 104 have extorted from their victims. The treasure consists of 200 SP, a Silver Amulet worth 50 GP and a Cloak woven of mithril thread/wire and studded with bloodstones valued at 2300 GP.

116) **An Ancient Arena**: This large room has a sand covered floor. The distance from floor to ceiling is 40'. The open section along the south wall originally housed ornate box seats and elegant draperies. All that remains are a few shattered statues and some ratty shreds of faded fabric. The distance from the sand floor of the arena to the balcony is 20'. There is a 25% chance that a band of Lizard Men will be in here practicing with swords. If so there will be 6 Lizard Men, AC: 4, Move: 6, HD: 2 + 1, Damage: 1 - 8 with Sword, HP: 9 (x3), 13, 11 (x2). The Lizard Men will be at -1 hit probability because of unfamiliarity with their weapons.

117) **The Lost Escape Tubes**: This is another secret device whose purpose and knowledge of existance was lost in the Beast Man coup over 1100 years previous. Located under the roots of Tree 61 is a rusted bronze trap door. It is covered by several inches of sod and dirt. If the dirt is moved, a 5' square, verdigrised bronze door will be visible. This must be pried open to reveal a 10' drop to a 10' square room with a stair leading down out of the south side. The stair opens up on a large circular room with a 30' ceiling. There will be roots hanging down from the ceiling. The prepossessing item in the room though, is a polished bronze dome in the center of the room. It is 30' in diameter. Rising up from the center of the dome is a 10' diameter transparent pillar that seems to be filled with gurgling water, rising upward. Located at 8 points about the circumference of the dome are openings with hinged doors on them. If these doors are climbed into and sealed from the inside, it will form eight small can-like containers which will then be released into the rising water and be carried up to the 2nd level to rise up in Area 34 and float down stream. If passage is not stopped by the spiderweb at 32, it definately will be stopped by the bridge at 28. This whole complex was designed as a last resort escape route but was never used.

This ends the description of the rooms, chamber, caverns and traps of **The Caverns of Thracia**.

Happy Adventuring! Paul Jaquays

TREASURE VAULT

Judges Guild

37	FIRST FANTASY CAMPAIGN	$7.98
46	WILDERLANDS HEX SHEETS	$3.00
66	SEA STEEDS & WAVE RIDERS	$6.50
68	WAR CRY	$4.00
69	FLOTILLA ONE	$5.00
96	TREASURY OF ARCHAIC NAMES	$4.95
104	CASTLE BOOK II	$3.00
240	THE FANTASY CARTOGRAPHER'S FIELD BOOK	$3.98
360	LASER TANK	$1.50
410	THE ASTROGATORS CHART BOOK	$3.98
440	TEMPLE BOOK I	$3.00
530	RAVENSCRAG	$10.00
550	THE FIELD GUIDE TO ENCOUNTERS	$12.00
680	TOWER OF INDOMITABLE CIRCUMSTANCE	$4.98
690	MASTERS OF MIND	$7.98
700	RESTORMEL	$5.98

APPROVED FOR USE WITH D&D tm

2	DUNGEON TAC CARDS	$3.95
14	READY REF BOOK	$2.99
27	TEGEL MANOR	$4.50
28	JUDGES SHIELD	$1.98
34	MODRON	$3.50
36	CHARACTER CHRONICLE CARDS	$1.98
47	CAMPAIGN HEXAGON SYSTEM	$2.50
48	WILDERLANDS OF HIGH FANTASY	$8.50
52	THIEVES OF BADABASKOR	$3.00
55	GENCON IX DUNGEON	$3.50
59	VILLAGE BOOK I	$2.75
60	CASTLE BOOK I	$2.75
61	ISLAND BOOK I	$2.75
62	CITY STATE OF THE INVINCIBLE OVERLORD	$8.00
63	CITADEL OF FIRE	$3.00
67	FANTASTIC WILDERLANDS BEYONDE	$8.00
71	FRONTIER FORTS OF KELNORE	$3.00
76	DRAGON CROWN	$1.75
80	OF SKULLS AND SCRAPFAGGOT GREEN	$4.50
92	WILDERLANDS OF THE MAGIC REALM	$8.50
93	UNDER THE STORM GIANT'S CASTLE	$3.00
95	SURVIVAL OF THE FITTEST	$3.50
102	CAVERNS OF THRACIA	$6.50
104	VILLAGE BOOK II	$3.00
108	VERBOSH	$6.50
111	MINES OF CUSTALCON	$3.95
113	BOOK OF TREASURE MAPS	$3.95
118	SWORD OF HOPE	$3.00
119	TOWER OF ULISSION	$3.00
150	CITY STATE OF THE WORLD EMPEROR	$12.00
270	SPIES OF LIGHTELF	$4.95
300	WILDERLANDS OF THE FANTASTIC REACHES	$8.50
320	BOOK OF TREASURE MAPS II	$3.95
420	UNKNOWN GODS	$6.00

APPROVED FOR USE WITH AD&D tm

87	CHARACTER CODEX	$4.50
88	DARKTOWER	$5.50
109	OPERATION OGRE	$3.25
114	MALTESE CLUE	$4.00
117	TEMPLE OF RA ACCURSED BY SET	$2.00
124	ESCAPE FROM ASTIGAR'S LAIR	$2.00
190	THE TREASURE VAULTS OF LINDORAN	$4.00
210	INFERNO	$5.98
260	PORTALS OF TORSH	$3.98
460	BOOK OF RUINS	$4.00
560	PORTALS OF IRONTOOTH	$3.98
570	THE QUEST FOR LARA'S TOWER	$3.00
630	DRAGON'S HALL	$3.50
650	TRIAL BY FIRE	$4.00
660	ZIENTECK	$3.50
670	HOUSE ON HANGMAN'S HILL	$3.95
680	TOWER OF INDOMITABLE CIRCUMSTANCE	$4.98
750	THE ILLHIEDRIN BOOK	$3.95

APPROVED FOR USE WITH TRAVELLER tm

75	TRAVELLER REFEREE SCREEN	$2.50
78	TRAVELLER LOG BOOK	$3.50
89	STARSHIP & SPACECRAFT FOR TRAVELLER	$5.50
105	DRA'K'NE STATION	$4.95
330	TANCRED	$5.98
340	LEY SECTOR	$4.98
350	DARTHANON QUEEN	$3.50
480	50 STARBASES	$5.98
490	GLIMMERDRIFT REACHES	$4.98
500	DOOM OF THE SINGING STAR	$11.98
520	NAVIGATOR'S STARCHARTS	$4.98
590	CRUCIS MARGIN	$5.98
640	GHOSTRING	$5.98
710	AMYCUS PROBE	$5.98
720	ROGUE MOON OF SPINSTORME	$5.98

APPROVED FOR USE WITH RUNEQUEST GATEWAY tm

107	BROKEN TREE INN	$4.00
116	THE HELLPITS OF NIGHTFANG	$3.00
170	RUNEQUEST SHIELD	$2.50
220	LEGENDARY DUCK TOWER	$5.98
310	CITY OF LEI TABOR	$7.98
380	DUCK POND	$5.98

APPROVED FOR USE WITH CHIVALRY & SORCERY tm

250	C & S SHIELD	$3.00

APPROVED FOR USE WITH TUNNELS & TROLLS tm

400	THE TOUGHEST DUNGEON IN THE WORLD	$4.00

APPROVED FOR USE WITH SUPERHERO 2044 tm

430	HAZARD	$2.00

APPROVED FOR USE WITH EMPIRE OF THE PETAL THRONE tm

540	NIGHTMARE MAZE OF JIGRESH	$2.00

APPROVED FOR USE WITH VILLIANS & VIGILANTES tm

580	BREAK IN AT THREE KILOMETER ISLAND	$3.00

PEGASUS
$3.00 per Issue

THE DUNGEONEER JOURNAL
Back Issues Available
$2.80 per Issue

THE JUDGES GUILD JOURNAL
Back Issues Available
$2.80 per Issue

THE DUNGEONEER
Back Issues Available
$2.80 per Issue

73	THE DUNGEONEER COMPENDIUM OF 1 - 6	$2.50

Are these other fine products available from your Dealer?
If not, ask why and have him contact us for full details.
Judges Guild, Incorporated, R. R. 8, Box 9, 1221 N. Sunnyside Road, Decatur, IL. 62522

The Caverns of Thracia

They Have Been Waiting.

For over a thousand years the things that lurk beneath the waters, skulk in the darkness and lie hungrily in dank crypts have been patient, while all around them men and monsters bicker amongst themselves, bold enough to traverse the dark caverns' depths, but afraid or perhaps wise enough to leave the forgotten vaults and hidden passages alone.

And still, *they* wait, undisturbed. *They* are waiting for you!

Judges Guild

5E CONVERSION OF THE CAVERNS OF THRACIA

CHAPTER THREE
INTRODUCTION

ORIGINAL DESIGNER'S COMMENTS

The Caverns of Thracia has been designed to accommodate adventurers of the 1st and higher levels. There are some segments of the adventure that will be a pushover for low level groups while one or two areas will send the higher-level characters ducking for cover if played correctly. As you read through this scenario, and I do recommend reading through it before commencing play, you may notice at times that the designer (self) becomes quite informal. This is intended, since this adventure was not designe to have snob appeal or be the last word in gaming aids. This is now your adventure. I have put down possibilities and probabilities and a few remarks to go with them. It is now up to you to breathe life into the denizens of this scenario. There are no high-power artifacts in these caverns and only one creature has very high-power magic use. I would surmise that even a group of fighters could survive in this adventure (although they would definitely miss out on some historical aspects and clues) and haul out a goodly sum of loot. Treasure is purposefully rare (although there are some rather nice ones) and the monsters that are aware of each other in this dungeon are usually working together. The only opposing groups in this game are the humans and the beast men and since they don't frequent the same areas, there is little interaction between them except for constant raiding.

Starting the Adventure: The best place to start any adventure is in a place of familiarity to the characters. Drop a few hints and let the players take it from there asking pertinent questions of the locals and being generally nosey, a pre-requisite for all adventurers. To speed things up, the referee might want to use the section titled The Taverns of Thracia to randomly assign knowledge to characters.

NOTES FOR THE GAME MASTER

Originally designed for characters of "1st and higher levels," *The Caverns of Thracia* features a range of denizens distributed across its many levels. Because of this, the Game Master should feel free to "tweak" any encounters they see fit to better align with the player characters' current experience levels. Several encounters contained within are intended to challenge characters. Wise players should know when their characters should stand and fight or run. A handful of tribal warriors on Level 1 should not result in a TPK. Repeatedly delving into the ruins and retreating for rest (or finding someplace "safe" inside the ruins to hole up) is perfectly acceptable as, due to its length, the adventure is intended to take many sessions to play and should take at least several days, in game, to complete.

This fifth edition conversion has been designed for a party of four to six 1st-level characters. A good mix of character classes, including at least two fighter-types, an arcane spellcaster, and a divine spellcaster would be ideal. A ranger or druid would be particularly helpful to aid in overcoming the wilderness sections of this adventure.

Players who do not already have characters can use the pregenerated characters located in appendix A. If the party has few members or is lacking some of the typical classes for a balanced team, the GM may allow NPC retainers to strengthen the party. The GM is also encouraged to adjust the challenge of the encounters based on the relative power of the characters and the skill of the players to provide a fair and exciting adventure. The end of this chapter includes notes and details on how to adjust encounters into suitable challenges.

Sometimes a new player will want to join the party, or a player will need to replace a character who has been killed. The pre-generated characters (See appendix A) can be used for this, or the player can create a level-appropriate character on their own. It's up to the GM to decide how to incorporate new characters into the game, using player suggestions as a starting point.

This is a long-term adventure, designed to be completed over several sessions of play. Successful characters will probably reach the 7th level of experience (or higher) by the time they finish Level 4. See the table below for suggested character levels according to the level of the dungeon.

SUGGESTED CHARACTER LEVELS

Chapter	Description	Suggested PC Levels
Chapter 4	Level 1	1st Level
Chapter 5	Level 2	2nd Level
Chapter 6	Level 2A	4th Level
Chapter 7	Level 3A	5th Level
Chapter 8	Level 3	4th Level
Chapter 9	Level 4	6th Level

This adventure was not designed to fit a specific location and, as such, can be easily dropped into any campaign world. The adventure can be set in any of the following locations:

- A misty island, possibly once connected to the mainland via a land bridge
- A ruined city near the edge of a subtropical forest
- A ruined city nestled in the foothills of a forsaken mountain range
- A lost valley deep within a mountain range
- The far side of a vast expanse of once-fertile desert
- Deep in an ancient jungle or forest where even elves rarely tread

Monsters **bolded** in the text are a cue directing the GM to look up their full statistics in the core rulebook. There are several new and unusual creatures introduced in this adventure, as well as several Nonplayer Characters (NPCs). Full statistics for these new monsters and NPCs are presented in the appropriate appendices. Be sure to read their descriptions in the appendix before running the adventure. In the words of the original author, "nothing seems to scare someone who knows the rules like something totally unknown."

FOLLOWERS OF THANATOS (THE DARK ONE)

There exists, in the caverns below Thracia, a religion that might not exist elsewhere. The devotees of this faith worship The Dark One and form a splinter cult that evolved from the ancient worship of Thanatos, one of the many gods of death. The two faiths share many of the same tenets and imagery, although the name "Thanatos" has fallen out of use among the current residents of the caverns.

The Dark One is a lawful evil god whose only domain is that of death. Clerics in the service of The Dark One share their god's alignment, although mundane followers may be any alignment, since death touches all. Clerics in the service

ABBREVIATIONS

The following abbreviations are utilized throughout the text of this adventure:

hp = hit points
AC = Armor Class
DC = Difficulty Class
XP = experience points
pp = platinum piece(s)
gp = gold piece(s)
ep = electrum piece(s)
sp = silver piece(s)
cp = copper piece(s)
NPC = nonplayer character
LG = lawful good
CG = chaotic good
NG = neutral good
LN = lawful neutral
N = neutral
CN = chaotic neutral
LE = lawful evil
CE = chaotic evil
NE = neutral evil
GM = Game Master

of The Dark One speak and read Modern Thracian (but not Ancient Thracian; see Languages below for details).

Clerics of The Dark One have access to the Mortality domain (see appendix D).

DESIGNING APPROPRIATELY CHALLENGING ENCOUNTERS

The Caverns of Thracia is designed for characters of 1st through 7th level. Adventures designed in the late 70's and early 80's didn't rely on rules systems to balance encounters. Thus, the encounters presented herein vary in challenge rating and might need to be modified based on the number of characters and their level of experience. There are four categories of encounter difficulty: Easy, Medium, Hard, and Deadly. The XP value of all the monsters or NPCs is used to calculate the difficulty of the encounter. Most encounters should be Easy or Medium, with Hard and Deadly encounters reserved for set pieces, sub-bosses, or even boss battles. In a dungeon setting such as the various levels of *The Caverns of Thracia*, a balanced, well-equipped party of adventurers with average luck can typically handle six to eight Medium or Hard encounters before requiring a long rest.

If the characters get in over their heads with a particular encounter, encourage them to flee. Alternatively, the noise generated by a given encounter might attract a wandering monster (or a member of one of the various other factions), who blunders into the fray and swings the odds in the characters' favor. This tactic should be used sparingly and will likely leave the characters owing the faction some type of debt, or at least a favor. The GM should be prepared to turn this occurrence into a full-blown social interaction encounter that drives the campaign forward.

The Total XP Budget table summarizes the experience budgets for a typical party of four to six characters of 1st through 6th level. The experience budgets are categorized by encounter difficulty (Easy, Medium, Hard, and Deadly).

TOTAL XP BUDGET

	AVERAGE PARTY LEVEL	EASY	MEDIUM	HARD	DEADLY
4 Characters	1st	100	200	300	400
	2nd	200	400	600	800
	3rd	300	600	900	1,600
	4th	500	1,000	1,500	2,000
	5th	1,000	2,000	3,000	4,400
	6th	1,200	2,400	3,600	5,600
5 Characters	1st	125	250	375	500
	2nd	250	500	750	1,000
	3rd	375	750	1,125	2,000
	4th	625	1,250	1,875	2,500
	5th	1,250	2,500	3,750	5,500
	6th	1,500	3,000	4,50	7,000
6 Characters	1st	150	300	450	600
	2nd	300	600	900	1,200
	3rd	450	900	1,350	2,400
	4th	750	1,500	2,250	3,000
	5th	1,500	3,000	4,500	6,600
	6th	1,800	3,600	5,400	8,400

TOTAL XP BUDGET

To use the Total XP Budget table, first determine the number of characters in the party, including any NPCs (on the left-hand side of the table). Next, determine their average level; the table has XP budgets for levels 1 through 6, although the GM can expand the table to include higher levels (or more characters) as needed. Then cross-reference the XP budgets for the different encounter difficulties.

For example, if the party includes a 4th-level wizard, a 5th-level rogue, a 3rd-level fighter, a 4th-level cleric, and a 4th-level ranger, there would be five characters averaging 4th level. An Easy encounter for this group would be 625 equivalent XP, while a Deadly encounter would be 2,500 equivalent XP.

XP MULTIPLIERS

# of Monsters Encountered	XP Multiplier
1	× 1
2	× 1.5
3-6	× 2
7-10	× 2.5
11-14	× 3
15+	× 4

To determine an encounter's difficulty, add up the XP of all the enemy creatures and then adjust the amount by using the multiplier on the XP Multipliers table. Monster XP values are based on challenge rating (CR) and are included in the monster or NPC stat blocks. For example, a water weird (CR 3; 700 XP) would be an Easy encounter for our example party. But three ogres (CR 2; 450 XP each) would be a Deadly encounter for our five 4th-level characters (3 × 450 = 1,350 × 2 = 2,700 equivalent XP). Note that this calculation is the equivalent XP for the encounter. The characters

are only awarded the actual experience points (in this case, 1,350 XP) for defeating this group of monsters. The GM has the option to award bonus experience points for overcoming traps and tricks, or for particularly savvy roleplaying with key NPCs. This will likely come into play if the characters forge alliances with any of the factions or attempt to pit them against each other. Awarding bonus experience points increases the characters' power and allows them to face the deadlier challenges of the lower dungeon levels. The Bonus XP Awards table summarizes the recommended XP award ranges based on character level.

BONUS XP AWARDS

Character Level	XP Award
1st-3rd	25 to 50
4th-6th	50 to 100
7th-10th	100 to 250

GM'S BACKGROUND

HISTORY OF THE CAVERNS OF THRACIA

This history is provided to give the GM information about the origins of the caverns' various societies. It also includes an overview of the cultural development of the early Thracian civilization. This information is provided exclusively for the GM's reference. All the characters know for certain is that the caverns are a part of a lost civilization that disappeared centuries ago. The other tales they have heard about the place are nothing but wild stories (see The Taverns of Thracia, below).

Before humans existed, or possibly before they discovered the benefits and curses of civilization, there existed the reptile race. While not large in population, the reptile race had its own centers of civilization, including cities and underground temples. As humans waxed, the reptile race waned, forgetting

much of its arcane wisdom and slowly degenerating into the race of beings that humans now call lizardfolk. A few pockets of more advanced lizardfolk exist, but their numbers are dwindling as that race dies out.

Long before humans discovered the caverns beneath Thracia, the reptile race was already beginning to slip backwards. The Immortal King, ruler of the tattered remnants of lizardfolk who still knew the ways of magic, had been dying over the span of several centuries. With the coming of humans to the region, the Immortal King finally passed. But his was not a true death. The creature's corpse remained animated by his spirit. Even in death, the Immortal King continued his rule as a lich entombed in the ancient underground temple. Slowly, the reptile race regressed to their present state, but not before they had watched the now plentiful humans discover the caverns and build their own society upon and within its ruins. The lizardfolk eventually sealed off the entrances to their crumbling great hall and slunk off into the fetid swamps of the surrounding region, returning much later only to serve as mercenaries for the beast kings.

Meanwhile, humans discovered the caverns, not realizing that the once feared reptilefolk still occupied hidden portions of the caverns. At this point, the reptilefolk had become only a legend among the humans, with the Immortal King serving as a bogeyman to frighten children into behaving. Humans were beginning to develop a civilization comparable to the early Mycenean or Cretan civilizations of our past, with art and architecture almost identical to these cultures. Eventually, they sealed off many of their underground tomb complexes and began to concentrate on the civilization above ground. Half a millennium later, they would construct the temples on the second level of the ruins.

The golden age of Thracian culture began two centuries later with the discovery of an immense cavern deep below the natural caverns. It was not a natural chamber, but no heed was given to that. During this time, the Thracian people began to use dogfolk, gnolls, and minotaurs as laborers. These monstrous races constructed a huge garden and palace in this underground cavern. The vast work was completed during the reign of Thracian King Argos II. Shortly thereafter, the underground area became a playground for Thracian royalty. During the reign of King Agamemnos, son of Argos II, the beastfolk that laired in the caverns revolted and captured the palace, killing the king and forcing his gentry to flee. Most never made it to the surface. Those who did inspired either fear or fierceness among those hearing the tale. However, the few bands of vengeful citizens that entered the caverns were never seen again.

The beastfolk claimed the underground domain, securing control of the entire second, third, and fourth levels while allowing the first level to go untouched. They elected an intelligent minotaur to rule over them.

A century-and-a-half later, the worship of Thanatos, god of death, was outlawed among the remnants of the Thracian people. The few priests who served him were either killed or sealed in the chapel of Thanatos on the first level.

On the sesquicentennial anniversary (150 years) of the overthrow of Thanatos' influence, a barbarian army (Thracians consider all non-Thracians to be "barbarians") spurred on by the descendants of Thanatos's followers invaded the city. The lax Thracian army was no match for the frenzied barbarians, and all but a fraction of the city's population was either put to the sword or carried off into slavery. During the destruction, the entrances to the caverns were destroyed and covered with rubble.

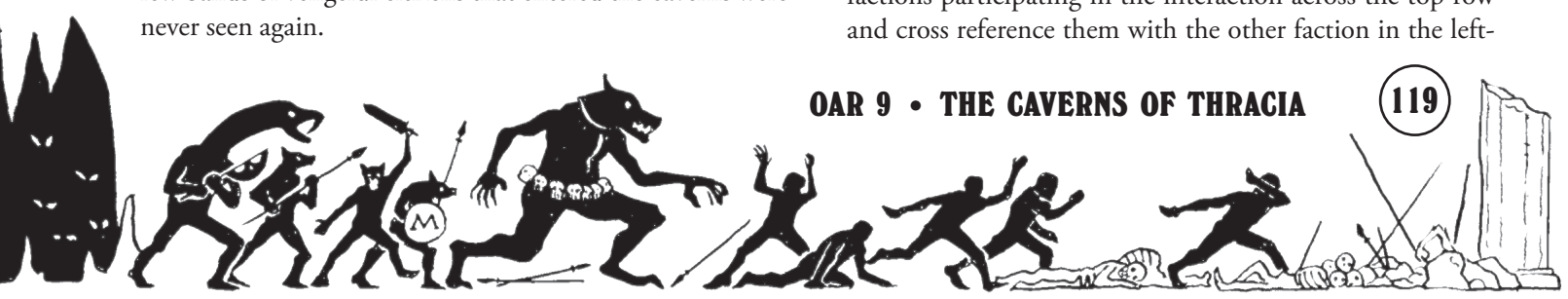
The few remaining Thracians attempted reconstruction, but a second invasion occurred less than a quarter-century later. The few Thracians who fled into the encroaching jungle survived and slipped back into savagery. Two centuries later, they rediscovered the caverns and the beastfolk, as well as a new/old religion in the worship of Thanatos, now referred to as The Dark One.

By this time, the beastfolk had conquered the entire cavern complex (or at least those areas they could discover without looking too hard) and reopened the caverns to the surface. With the return of the humans, the beastfolk saw an opportunity for new sources of food and labor. Soon after the caverns were reopened, the lizardfolk once again sought out the source of their legends and allied themselves with the beastfolk.

The caverns are now the holy places for both the descendants of the Thracians and the once powerful reptilians, who still seek the reason for their existence.

THE FACTIONS OF THRACIA

The diverse factions of creatures living in the caverns have developed a complex social structure. It is easy to lose track of how members of the different factions might initially react to each other, how they communicate, and even if they can communicate. The table and explanations below are meant to serve as a quick reference should members of these different factions interact with each other. Simply find one of the factions participating in the interaction across the top row and cross reference them with the other faction in the left-



	Tribal Warriors	Followers of The Dark One	Lizardfolk	Beastfolk (Dogfolk, Gnolls, Minotaurs)	Dryads
Tribal Warriors	Friendly (Tribal Thracian)	Friendly or Hostile (Tribal Thracian)	Hostile	Hostile	Indifferent
Followers of The Dark One	Friendly or Hostile (Tribal Thracian)	Friendly (Modern Thracian)	Hostile	Hostile	Indifferent
Lizardfolk	Hostile	Hostile	Friendly (Draconic)	Friendly (Gnoll)	Hostile
Beastfolk (Dogfolk, Gnolls, Minotaurs)	Hostile	Hostile	Friendly (Gnoll)	Friendly (Gnoll)	Hostile
Dryads	Indifferent	Indifferent	Hostile	Hostile	Friendly (Sylvan)

most column. The intersection of the two gives their initial starting attitude towards each other (see the core rulebook), as well as the first language (in parentheses) they attempt to communicate in, when applicable.

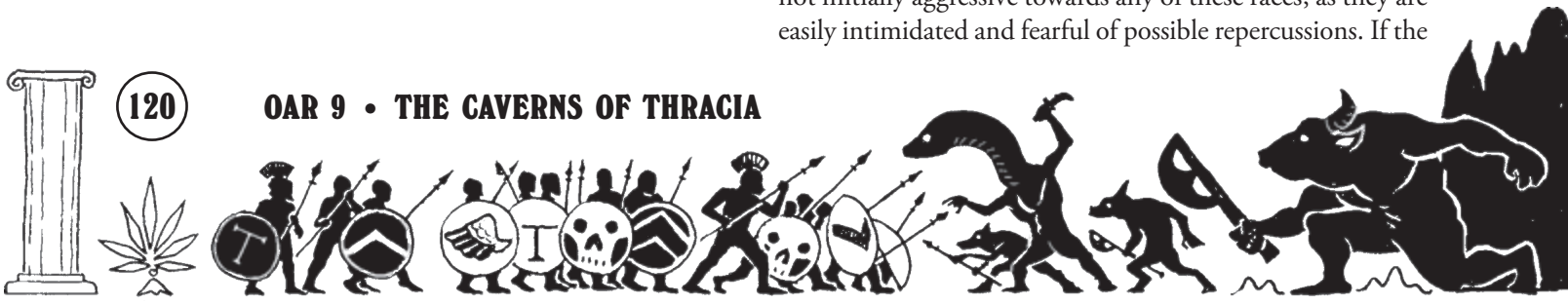
Tribal Warriors: Most of the still-independent tribal warriors living in the upper levels of the caverns and the surrounding land view lizardfolk and beastfolk as monsters. Dryads are seen as magical creatures or embodiments of nature; not necessarily enemies, but creatures to be cautious around. Most tribal warriors are unaware of the dryads living on Level 3. Tribal Thracian is the preferred language of these people. Not all tribal warriors are followers of The Dark One and it is not always easy to tell which humans are followers and which are not. Initial reactions between tribal warriors and followers of The Dark One might be friendly, as the latter's connection with the cult may not be realized. If their membership in the cult is revealed, however, the initial reaction becomes hostile, as the tribal warriors know the cultists regularly sacrifice humans to their god.

Followers of The Dark One: These cultists are looked down upon by nearly everyone else in the caverns. Beastfolk and lizardfolk see the followers of The Dark One as no different from tribal warriors. That is, they are simply humans to be subjugated. Dryads are unsure and wary of humans in general and, if their connection to the god of death is revealed, the dryads want nothing to do with them. If the followers of The Dark One conceal their membership in the cult, they might be able to get along with tribal warriors (in fact, there are many cultists living secretly among the tribal warriors now). If their involvement with the cult is revealed, however, non-cultist humans see them as outsiders, due to their worship of death and rumors of them kidnapping and sacrificing other tribal warriors to their dark god. In addition to speaking Tribal Thracian, the cultists also know Modern Thracian and use this as their primary tongue when communicating with each other.

Lizardfolk: The lizardfolk and their ancestors were settlers of the caverns long before the first humans arrived. Although many of them now live in the swamp west of the caverns, they see the humans as invasive pests. They are united with the beastfolk in their dislike of humans, albeit for different reasons. The lizardfolk are hostile (but not necessarily immediately violent) towards fey or humanoids other than beastfolk they encounter. Although Draconic is the lizardfolk's primary language, very few of the beastfolk speak it. If a lizardfolk realizes the specific beastfolk they are addressing doesn't not speak Draconic, they attempt to communicate in very broken Gnoll.

Beastfolk: The beastfolk races (dogfolk, gnolls, and minotaurs) see humans and dryads as beneath them, existing only to serve whatever purpose the beastfolk assign to them. Among the beastfolk, minotaurs currently enjoy a slightly higher status than the other species, as one of their own is the current king. Gnolls are next highest in the beastfolk social hierarchy and work to keep the dogfolk in line and to make sure their lizardfolk allies do not overstep themselves. Gnoll has become the default language spoken among most of the beastfolk. Many of the humans that the beastfolk typically interact with are slaves who have managed to learn the Gnoll equivalent of simple commands and curse words.

Dryads: The dryads on Level Three have had little to no interaction with tribal warriors or followers of The Dark One, except to occasionally see one as a slave of the beastfolk. To the dryads, these humans are an unknown quantity. The dryads despise the beastfolk for cutting down trees and invading their forest, and they feel the same towards lizardfolk, due to their association with the beast men. The dryads are not initially aggressive towards any of these races, as they are easily intimidated and fearful of possible repercussions. If the



opportunity to speak with a human presents itself, dryads are most likely to try and communicate in Elvish, as they know it is more commonly spoken among humans than Sylvan.

LANGUAGES

There are three new human languages introduced in this adventure. Ancient Thracian is the original written and spoken tongue of the Thracian people. Although now considered a dead language, many examples of it can still be found throughout the caverns. Between the time of the sealing of the ancient Thracian tombs and the beginning of the golden age, however, the Thracian language evolved drastically. Tribal Thracian and Modern Thracian are both current languages that developed independently from the same common source, Ancient Thracian. As a result, there are certain noticeable similarities between the three languages. It is similar to how modern speakers of Spanish or Italian might occasionally understand a phrase or the general meaning behind something expressed in the opposite language, as well as in the common source language, Latin.

As a result, characters that read, write, or speak any one of these languages can attempt to interpret something written or heard in either of the other two languages by making an Intelligence check and consulting the Interpretation Table below. Characters with the Linguist feat have advantage on this check. A notable exception here is for those who only speak Trial Thracian. Tribal Thracian is an oral language only, with no written component. It is possible for someone who knows only Tribal Thracian to interpret something they overhear in Ancient or Modern Thracian, but they have no ability to translate a written sample of either language.

Modern Thracian should be treated as an alternative human language and can be selected by characters who get to choose additional languages.

If you believe your players might become frustrated by their inability to effectively communicate with the denizens of the caverns, you could always provide another way for them to deal with it. The characters could discover a *helm of comprehending languages* in the ruins before they begin their descent into the caverns. Perhaps a friendly merchant offers them the opportunity to purchase *spell scrolls* of *comprehend languages* for 75 gp and *spell scrolls* of *tongues* for 300 gp while they shop for supplies before the start of the adventure. You could even choose to replace references to Modern Thracian with Common and make Ancient Thracian and Tribal Thracian easier for characters to translate.

The beastfolk referenced in this adventure (dogfolk, gnolls, and minotaurs) speak Gnoll as a common language, although the minotaurs prefer to communicate with each other in Abyssal. The relatively recent alliance with the lizardfolk has caused a slight problem, as only their leader, G'ruk the Fish-finder (see appendix C) is fluent in Abyssal, Draconic, and Gnoll. Although not part of the original adventure, to make things easier the GM might grant all lizardfolk in the adventure the ability to speak at least some Gnoll.

INTERPRETATION TABLE

Intelligence Check Result	Result
Up to 4	Message is totally incomprehensible, nothing understood
5	Message comes across as an insult
6-7	Opposite meaning than intended is received
8-11	Vague interpretation, message or part of message unclear
12+	Correct interpretation, message clearly understood

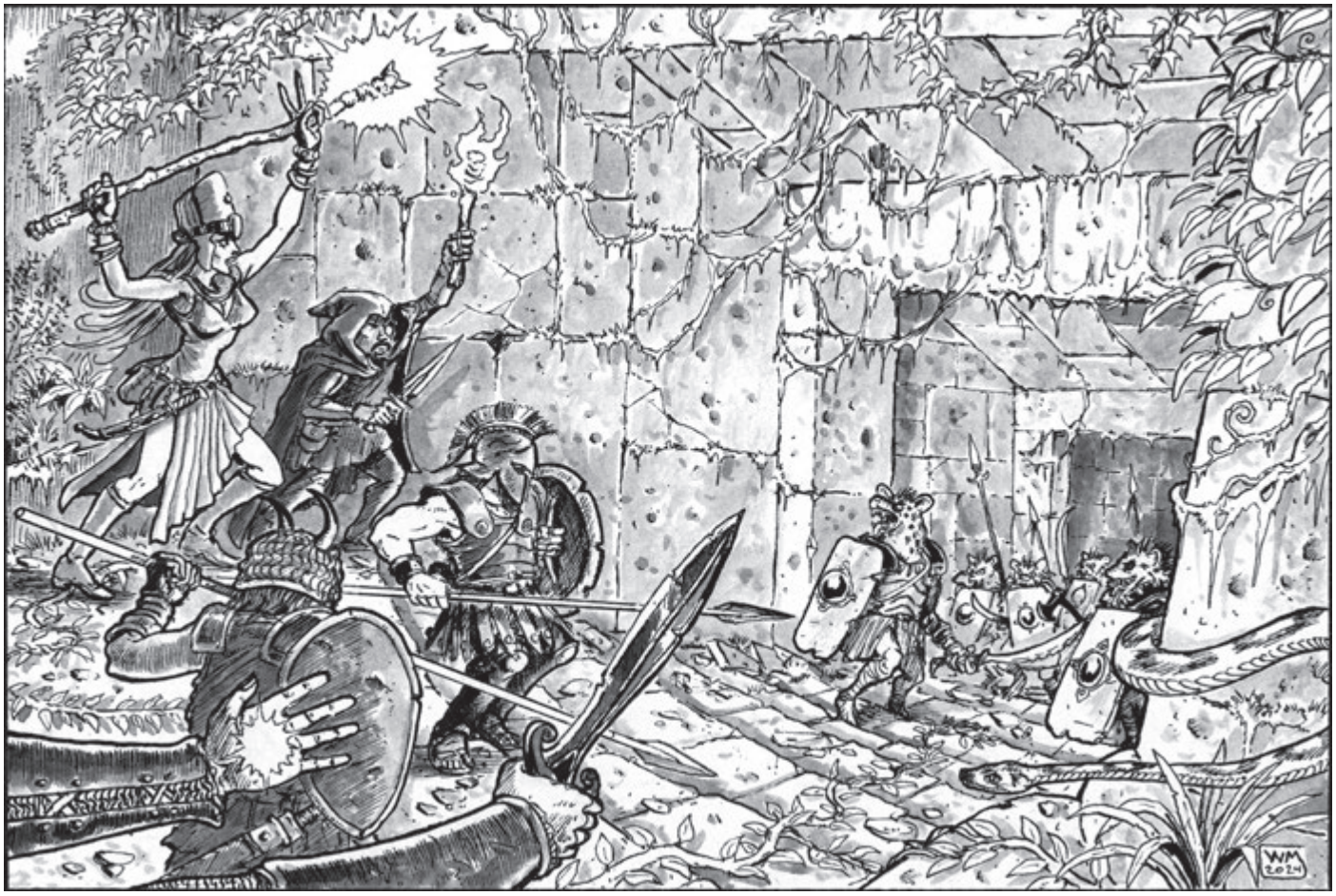
THE TAVERNS OF THRACIA

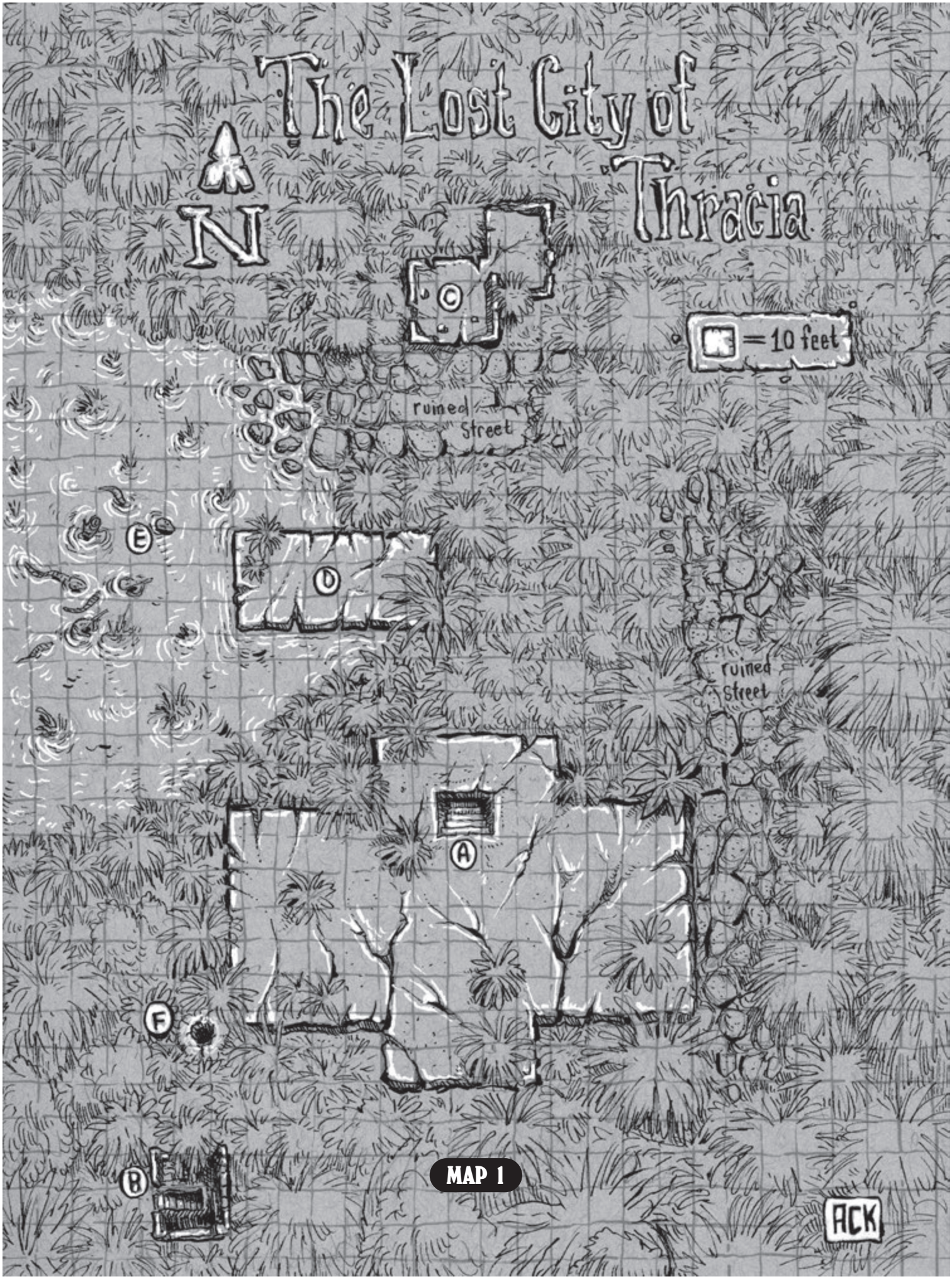
The characters can hear the following rumors and legends from various NPCs in the GM's ongoing campaign or learn them directly while doing their own research in libraries, inns, or taverns.

If a character decides to research on their own, roll 1d4-1 to determine the number of rumors they learn. You can modify this roll as you see fit, based on the outcome of any Intelligence (History) or Charisma-based skill checks the characters perform while researching. For each rumor a character obtains, roll 1d20 on the Rumors table below. It is suggested that you write down each character's rumors on a separate piece of paper, distribute them to the players, and inform them these are the rumors their characters learned and that they may share all, some, or none of the information with the other characters. Not all the pieces of information are true. False rumors are followed by "(F)" on the table. The GM should not feel obligated to confirm the veracity of any rumor for the players.

RUMORS

d20	Rumor
1	The beastfolk are humans under a curse. (F)
2	A collector has expressed interest in obtaining T hracian historical artifacts. He will pay 2d100 gp per intact item recovered .
3	Beware the Yellow Death!
4	Don't trust the trees!
5	The tribal warriors perform human sacrifice.
6	You have (partially) learned to read the Modern Thracian language. You have a 30 percent chance of being able to read anything written in that language.
7	Beware the God of Death!
8	The rope bridges are rotted out and unsafe. (F)
9	For safety, seek ye the Pool of the Watery Wonders.
10	The Hall of Laughing Skulls leads to riches untold.
11	Be wary of statuary!
12	Deep under the earth there is a sunlit garden and a sparkling palace.
13	Seek aid from the halfling hermit.
14	Buried with a dead king is a powerful but evil sword.
15	The caverns go no deeper than two levels. (F)
16	The leader of the beastfolk hoards vast amounts of wealth. (F)
17	A remnant of an ancient pre-human civilization may yet exist deep in the bowels of the earth.
18	The beastfolk are enslaving humans.
19	The touch of the good will destroy undead. (F)
20	You have learned to speak (but not read) the Tribal Thracian language. You have a 65 percent chance of speaking clearly to any warrior. If you fail the roll, the clarity of the conversation must be determined by making an Intelligence check and consulting the Interpretation Table in the Languages section.




The Lost City of Thracia
N
= 10 feet
ruined Street
ruined Street
A
B
C
D
E
F
MAP 1
ACK

ADVENTURE HOOKS

This adventure begins with the characters' arrival in the ruined city of Thracia. It's up to the GM to decide why the characters traveled here. Several suggestions for involving the characters are presented below.

- Using an ancient map discovered during one of their previous adventures, the characters learn the location of the long-abandoned city of Thracia.
- A group of svirfneblin hire the party to find Grastic Hammerclay, a missing family member who abandoned his clan and may have headed to the ruins of Thracia (Grastic is in area 2-1).
- An eccentric researcher hires the party to retrieve items of interest from the ruins. These items might include samples of Ancient Thracian writing, live lizardfolk, or the magic longsword *Thirster* (see area 2-17D) .
- A trade caravan carrying an important shipment of electrum ore has missed its expected arrival time by several days. Those awaiting the shipment hire the characters to find out what happened (the survivors of the caravan are in area 1-23).
- A desperate treant seeks out a party of adventurers to help free a group of dryads from their monstrous oppressors (the dryads reside on the eastern side of Level 3).
- If the party has previously played through *OAR #7: The Dark Tower*, see the Connecting Adventures sidebar near area 2-23C for additional suggestions on linking these adventures.

Quest: Weaken the cult of the Dark One and the alliance of beastfolk by defeating their leadership. Defeating the two adepts, two vicars, and the patriarch of the Dark One in this adventure shatters the faith of the remaining cult members and effectively destroys the cult among the Thracians. Deposing Stronghoen, the minotaur king, foments unrest among the beastfolk, as many of the gnolls turn on each other in their attempts to seize the throne. After a bloody civil war, the beastfolk alliance is severely strained due to the reduction of numbers, the abandonment of the alliance by the lizardfolk, and the dogfolk's declining confidence in the gnolls.

THE LOST CITY OF THRACIA

GENERAL FEATURES

The surface area around the entrance to the caverns is depicted on **Map 1**.

Trees. The tree symbols on **Map 1** represent actual trees, but this area is a dense forest and indicating all the trees would severely clutter the map. On the building foundations themselves, however, there are no more trees than indicated on the map.

Street. The surface of the cobblestone street is choked with thick grass at least two-and-a-half feet high.

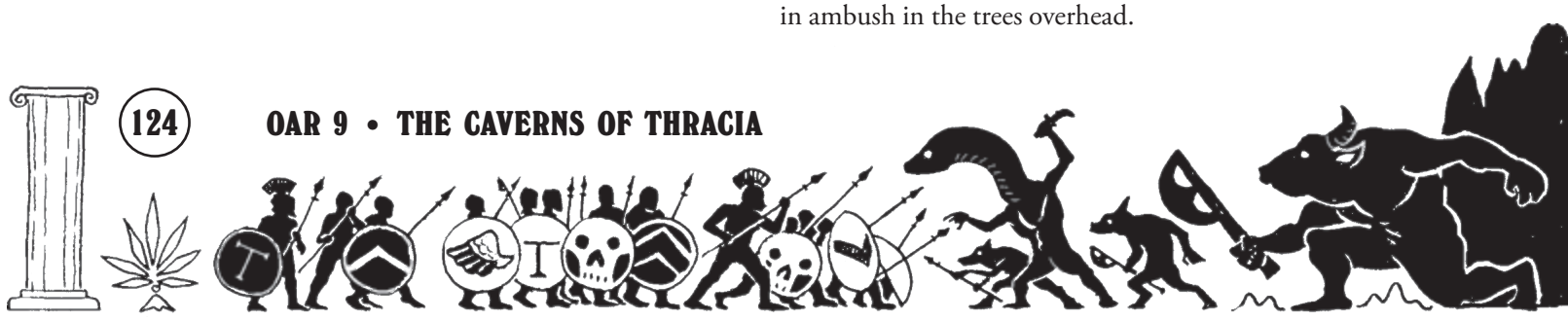
What's With All the Darts?

In converting the original *Caverns of Thracia* to fifth edition, care was taken to add weapon statistics for many of the weapons issued to creatures in the original adventure, regardless of whether those are the preferred weapons of the current versions of those creatures. As a result, for example, you'll find plenty of lizardfolk armed with darts rather than javelins, as well as gnolls carrying weapons other than spears and longbows. As the GM, you can ignore these variant weapons and use standard monster stat blocks, including weapons, if you find that easier when running the adventure. The alternative weapons are intended to preserve the flavor of the original adventure and do not significantly impact the challenge rating of the individual encounters.

AREA A – ENTRANCE TO AREA 1-1

The remains of this building seem to be the largest structure still in existence at this site. Inside, a 20-foot-wide staircase atop a weathered and cracked 10-foot-tall platform descends underground, heading north. The rubble strewn about, as well as the numerous tree roots growing through the cracks in the stone, attest to the structure's age.

The weathered platform was once the base of a temple. The stairs descend to area 1-1 on Level 1 (see **Map 2**). There is a 60 percent chance that a patrol of **gnolls** guards this entrance (use the Gnoll Patrol Tables in the Level 1 Wandering Monster section to randomly determine the patrol). There is an additional 50 percent chance that half the patrol waits in ambush in the trees overhead.



AREA B – THE WARRIORS' SECRET ENTRANCE

This squat, square building constructed of black stone is partially obscured by trees. An opening on the western face leads to a stairway that descends beneath the structure.

These stairs lead down to area 1-18 on **Map 2**. Waiting to ambush the characters are six **berserkers** with the following adjustments:

- The berserkers wear leather armor and carry shields (AC 14).
- Their alignment is neutral.
- They speak Tribal Thracian.
- The band has the following extra supplies distributed among them: two 50-foot coils of hempen rope, 36 torches, five bronze spikes, 24 days' rations, six filled waterskins, one waterskin filled with weak wine, two bronze daggers, and a stone hammer.
- They are armed only with spears:

Spear: *Melee or Ranged Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft. or range 20/60 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 6 (1d6 + 3) piercing damage, or 7 (1d8 + 3) piercing damage if used with two hands to make a melee attack.

AREA C – THE REMNANT OF AN ANCIENT BUILDING

The remains of a foundation and a few standing walls are all that is left of the structure that once stood here. Nearby is evidence of a partially buried cobblestone street.

A character who makes a successful DC 10 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check while searching the area uncovers a tablet written in Dwarvish (see player handout 1). The tablet reveals that the author discovered the location of the entrance into the caverns below in a nearby building. The building described is "a squat, dark building constructed of black stone," which matches the structure in Area B. There is a 3 in 10 chance that the characters encounter a wandering monster at this location. If this occurs, use the Level 2 Wandering Monster table to determine the encounter.

AREA D – ANOTHER BUILDING FOUNDATION

All that remains of this structure is a crumbling foundation that rises roughly five feet above ground level. The western edge of the foundation is slowly being reclaimed by the surrounding swamp.

Unless they have been dealt with already, the lizardfolk in Area E hurl a volley of darts as the characters explore the western end of the foundation.

AREA E – A HUNTING PARTY

The ruins of the city descend into the swamp at this point, as a narrow arm of the swamp connects to a larger area of wetlands to the west.

A patrol of **lizardfolk** (determine the patrol makeup by rolling randomly on the Lizardfolk Patrol Table found in the Level 2 Wandering Monsters section) moves quietly through the swamp. If undetected, the lizardfolk ambush the characters by hurling a volley of darts and then diving beneath the water, actively avoiding direct combat. They search for a natural mudslide entrance to the lower ruins (Level 2A, area 2A-10A).

AREA F – A HOLE IN THE GROUND

A 5-foot-diameter shaft descends a great distance into complete darkness.

At noon, the sunlight passing down this hole shines directly onto the semicircular section of area 1-23. The drop is around 65 feet, and a fall into the hole would result in 6d6 bludgeoning damage. A character that falls in the hole can attempt a DC 10 Dexterity saving throw to catch themselves on the edge of area 1-23. On a failed save, the character falls another 50 feet, taking an additional 5d6 bludgeoning damage and landing prone on the east bank of the river between areas 2-6 and 2-7.

CHAPTER FOUR

LEVEL 1

GENERAL FEATURES

Level 1 is fully depicted on **Map 2**.

Ceilings and Walls. The ceilings of rooms and passages on Level 1 are 20 feet high unless otherwise specified in the room description. The ceilings and walls are smooth, worked stone and carved from bedrock. Climbing an interior wall requires a successful DC 18 Strength (Athletics) check.

Doors. Unless otherwise specified, doors are made of wood reinforced with iron bands (AC 17, 27 hp, immunity to piercing, poison, and psychic damage) and are unlocked. Locked doors require a successful DC 15 Dexterity check with thieves' tools to open.

Illumination. Areas 1-1, 1-18, and 1-23 are dimly lit by illumination from outside (unless the area is visited at night). Areas further in are in darkness unless a source of illumination is specified in the room's description.

Level Connections. Dungeon Level 1 is closest to the surface and is heavily frequented by gnolls, lizardfolk, and the neighboring tribes. There are three entrances to the dungeon from the surface. These include:

- The stairs from area A connect to area 1-1.
- The stairs from area B connect to area 1-18.
- The hole in the ground at area F descends into area 1-23.

There is also access to Dungeon Level 1 from deeper within the complex.

- The pool in area 3-14 teleports those entering deeper than 10 feet to area 1-3.
- The stairs from area 2-1 lead to area 1-17
- The stairs from area 2-20 lead to area 1-8
- The shaft in area 1-20 leads to area 2-17I

The Incarnation of Death

In addition to the wandering monsters listed here, a special wandering monster, **The Incarnation of Death** (see appendix C), wanders the areas from 1-9A to 1-13. See the creature's description in the appendix for details on when it appears.

WANDERING MONSTERS

Every 10 minutes the characters spend exploring this level (not counting areas 1-9 through 1-13), there is a 1 in 6 chance of a random encounter. Roll 1d10 and consult the table below.

d10	Encounter
1	Gnoll patrol A
2	Lizardfolk patrol A
3	Giant rats
4	Band of tribal warriors
5	Gelatinous cube
6	Tribal warrior funerary procession (only in areas 1-5 through 1-27B)
7	Stirges
8	Tribal warrior religious procession (only in area 1-15 through 1-27B)
9	Gnoll patrol B
10	Random encounter from Level 2 (reroll on Level 2 Wandering Monsters table)

LEVEL 1 WANDERING MONSTER DESCRIPTIONS

Gnoll Patrol A. See Gnoll Patrol Tables, below.

Lizardfolk Patrol A. A group of six **lizardfolk** in the service of G'ruk, a lizardfolk shaman, patrol the area. None of these

lizardfolk carry shields (AC 13), heavy clubs, or javelins. There is a 10 percent chance that **G'ruk the Fish-finder, Lizardfolk Shaman** (see appendix C) accompanies them.

Giant Rats. A group of four **giant rats** skitter through the area, attacking anyone they encounter.

A Band of Tribal Warriors. Three bands of tribal warriors wander around Level 1. Each band consists of six individuals as follows:

Band 1: This band is led by an **armored tribal guard** (see appendix B). The next character of note is a **priest** of The Dark One, with the following changes:

- They wear leather armor and carry a shield (AC 13).
- Their alignment is lawful evil.
- They speak Modern Thracian and Tribal Thracian.
- Replace *spirit guardians* with *animate dead* in their Spellcasting trait.
- The priest can control undead, as detailed in the Mortality domain section in appendix D. Any affected undead creature acts as if it were created by an *animate dead* spell cast by the priest. This effect lasts for 24 hours or until the priest (or one of their allies) does anything harmful to the undead creature.
- They carry a *wand of light* (see appendix D).

The remaining four members of the band are **guards** with the following adjustments.

- They wear leather armor and carry shields (AC 14).
- Their alignment is neutral.
- They speak Tribal Thracian.

The band has the following extra supplies distributed among them: two 50-foot coils of hempen rope, 36 torches, five bronze spikes, 24 days' rations, six filled waterskins, one waterskin filled with weak wine, two bronze daggers, and a stone hammer.

Band 2: All six of these warriors have been whipped into a battle frenzy by their clerics and do not fear death, but rather seek it in combat. They are **berserkers** with the following adjustments:

- The berserkers wear leather armor and carry shields (AC 14).
- They have the same extra supplies as Band 1 (see above).
- Their alignment is neutral.
- They speak Tribal Thracian.
- They are armed only with spears:

Spear: *Melee or Ranged Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft. or range 20/60 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d6 + 3) piercing damage, or 7 (1d8 + 3) piercing damage if used with two hands to make a melee attack.

Band 3: This is a group of escaped slaves (treat as **commoners** who speak Tribal Thracian and some Gnoll) from Level 3. They are scared for their lives, and there is a 60 percent chance that a Gnoll Patrol (see below) is 1d4 + 1 rounds behind them.

Gelatinous Cube. The **gelatinous cube** that wanders this area contains a bronze dagger, a single steel ball bearing, a marble from area 3-12, a topaz worth 200 gp, and 10 sp.

Tribal Warrior Funerary Procession. This group is encountered only in one of the designated areas. If the characters are not in an appropriate area when this encounter is rolled, the procession is in area 1-27B and remains there for 3d6 × 10 minutes after the encounter is triggered. The funerary procession consists of the same entourage as in area 1-23 but with an additional 1d12 **commoners** fluent in Modern Thracian and Tribal Thracian. All are garbed in black robes, and the commoners have their faces painted in bright, garish colors. The deceased is borne by six commoners. They are accompanied by an **armored tribal guard** (see appendix B) and four **guards** with the following adjustments:

- They wear plate armor (AC 18).
- Their alignment is neutral.
- They speak Modern Thracian and Tribal Thracian.
- In addition to spears, they are armed with longswords:

Longsword: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 5 (1d8 + 1) slashing damage, or 6 (1d10 + 1) slashing damage if used with two hands.

Stirges. A flock of 1d4 **stirges** are hungry and attack anyone they encounter.

Tribal Warrior Religious Procession. If this encounter is rolled, the religious procession continues for three hours. See area 1-23.

Gnoll Patrol B. See Gnoll Patrol Tables, below.

GNOLL PATROL TABLES

If the identity of a given gnoll patrol is not predetermined (i.e., gnoll patrol A, B, C, D, E, or F), roll a 1d6 and consult the Gnoll Party Composition table. Weapon type must be determined for all gnoll patrols by rolling a 1d6 and consulting the Weapon Type table. When applicable, these selections replace the spear and longbow in the standard gnoll stat block. Finally, if a "Special" is indicated in the party composition, roll 1d6 and consult the Special Patrol Members table, below.

GNOLL PARTY COMPOSITION

d6	Gnoll Patrol	Party Composition
1	A	Four gnolls
2	B	Four gnolls plus Special*
3	C	Six gnolls
4	D	Six gnolls plus Special*
5	E	Eight gnolls
6	F	Eight gnolls plus Special*

* Roll 1d6 on the Special Patrol Members table, below.

WEAPON TYPE

d6	Weapon Type
1-2	Halberd (+4 to hit, reach 10 ft., 7 (1d10 + 2) slashing damage)
3	Greatsword (+4 to hit, 9 (2d6 + 2) slashing damage)
4	Halberd (+4 to hit, reach 10 ft., 7 (1d10 + 2) slashing damage) and Longbow (as detailed in stat block)
5	Morningstar (+4 to hit, 6 (1d8 + 2) piercing damage) and Longbow (as detailed in stat block)
6	Battleaxe (+4 to hit, 6 (1d8 + 2) slashing damage or 7 (1d10 + 2) slashing damage if used with two hands)

SPECIAL PATROL MEMBERS

d6	Special Patrol Members
1	One **gnoll pack lord**
2	One **dogfolk wizard** (see appendix B)
3	One **minotaur**
4	Two **lizardfolk** with four darts (+4 to hit, range 20/60 ft., 1d4 + 2 piercing damage) instead of javelins
5	1d6 **tribal warriors** who attempted to escape and are being returned for punishment. They are desperate and, if freed, willingly assist the characters. They do not carry spears and speak Gnoll and some Tribal Thracian.
6	Two of the above. Reroll and ignore rolls of 6. Duplications are allowed.

So Many Bats

Areas 1-1 through 1-3 are populated by a multitude of bats. These creatures are intended to serve as more of an obstacle or inconvenience for the characters rather than a group of creatures to engage in combat. GMs who wish to provide a combat encounter in these areas can use the stat block for a **swarm of bats,** even though these are normal creatures and not the result of "some sinister or unwholesome influence" as swarms are typically explained as being.

AREA 1-1 – ENTRY HALL

A 20-foot-wide stairway descends from the surface ruins approximately 65 feet into a 50-foot-square room with a 30-foot-high ceiling. The walls of this room appear to have once been painted in bright colors with scenes of ceremonies and worship, but they are now faded, worn, chipped, and discolored with age. The air in the room stinks of guano. Ten-foot-wide passages in the center of the northern, eastern, and western walls lead out of the room.

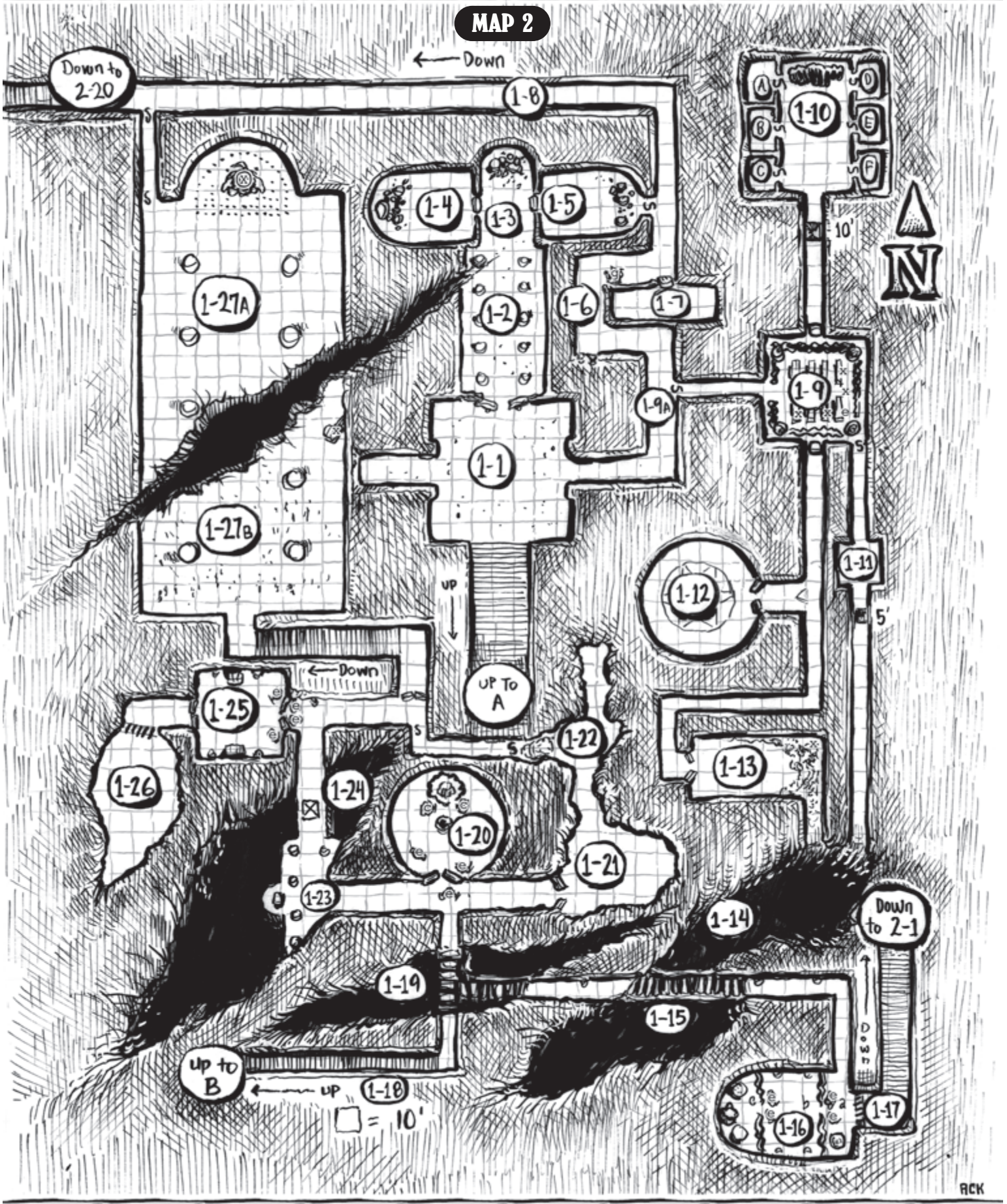
Hanging from the ceiling are several hundred **bats**. Torches mildly irritate the bats, while a *light* cantrip or any bright, directional lantern sends the animals winging and reduces visibility for all creatures in this area to 5 feet.

The guano makes the floor slippery. A creature that ends its turn standing on the floor must make a successful DC 14 Dexterity saving throw. On a failed save, the creature falls prone and makes Charisma ability checks with disadvantage until they can wash off the filth.

AREA 1-2 – HALL OF THE BATS

This 30-foot-wide hallway has five stone columns on both the eastern and western sides running along the corridor's 55-foot length. At the northern end of the hall, the passage narrows to about 20 feet before continuing north. The entire floor of this chamber is covered in at least 6 inches of bat guano. The ceiling here is approximately 20 feet high.

Like area 1-1, the ceiling of this chamber is literally swarming with **bats**. Torches mildly irritate the bats, while a *light* cantrip


MAP 2
Down to 2-20
Down
1-8
1-10
A
B
C
D
E
F
10'
N
1-4
1-3
1-5
1-27A
1-2
1-6
1-7
1-9
1-9A
1-1
1-27B
1-11
1-12
5'
UP
Down
UP To A
1-25
1-22
1-13
1-26
1-24
1-20
1-21
1-23
Down to 2-1
1-14
1-19
1-15
up to B
up
1-18
= 10'
Door
1-17
1-16
ACK

or any bright, directional lantern sends the animals winging and reduces visibility for all creatures in this area to 5 feet.

The guano makes the floor slippery. A creature that ends its turn standing on the floor must make a successful DC 14 Dexterity saving throw. On a failed save, the creature falls prone and makes Charisma ability checks with disadvantage until they can wash off the filth.

AREA 1-3 – ALCOVE OF THE BATS

This 20-foot-wide alcove extends the corridor to the south by an additional 35 feet and ends at a curved wall. At the north end of the alcove lies a pile of stone rubble that may once have been a statue of some sort. A pair of doors stand in both the eastern and western walls, with the eastern door resting slightly ajar. Like the corridor to the south, the entire floor of this area is covered to a depth of several inches in bat guano.

The door to area 1-4 is jammed shut and requires a successful DC 16 Strength (Athletics) check to force open.

A character who makes a successful DC 10 Wisdom (Survival) check notices a trail through the muck on the floor. The trail heads towards both areas 1-4 and 1-5 from area 1-2. The tracks were left by the lizardfolk currently in area 1-5.

If the characters spend 10 minutes digging through the rubble at the north end of the hall, they find a life-size head of a woman carved from marble. A character who makes a successful DC 10 Intelligence (Religion) check identifies the woman as Athena, the lawful good goddess of wisdom and civilization.

Like areas 1-1 and 1-2, the ceiling of this chamber is literally swarming with **bats**. Torches mildly irritate the bats, while a *light* cantrip or any bright, directional lantern sends the animals winging and reduces visibility for all creatures in this area to 5 feet.

The guano makes the floor slippery. A creature that ends its turn standing on the floor must make a successful DC 14 Dexterity saving throw. On a failed save, the creature falls prone and makes Charisma ability checks with disadvantage until they can wash off the filth.

Development. Characters who climb into the well in area 3-14 may be teleported to the center of this area.

AREA 1-4 – CENTIPEDE CHAPEL

This 40-by-30-foot room appears to have served as a chapel at one time. The remains of a statue depicting a winged, robed, female humanoid lie near the western wall, now reduced to rubble. Fresh blood and the mashed carcasses of several unusually large centipedes are scattered about the space. A dozen or more centipedes—still very much alive—scrabble along the walls and floor.

A group of 19 **giant centipedes**, bright red in color, feast upon the remains of their brethren, who died during a recent struggle in the room.

AREA 1-5 – LIZARDFOLK ON A HUNTING FORAY

Two reptilian humanoids armed with clubs watch the door as a third tends to the wounds of their injured companions. The remains of a dozen beheaded giant centipedes writhe about on the floor amid shattered bits of unrecognizable statuary.

The four reptilian creatures are **lizardfolk**. The injured one currently has a total of 8 hit points, due to being attacked by a giant centipede a short time ago. The headless corpses of the giant centipedes on the floor are harmless but mildly disturbing, as the dead creatures still twitch. Two of the centipedes have already been cracked open and their meat consumed.

The secret door on the eastern side of the room is disguised to look like an ornamental panel and can be discovered with a successful DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check.

AREA 1-6 – SPEAR TRAP

A 90-degree bend in this corridor's run leads to an approximately 30-foot-long section that abruptly changes direction again at the far end.

Two spear traps hidden in the southern wall are set to fire at creatures traversing this corridor. A character who searches the corridor's southern wall and makes a successful DC 15 Wisdom (Perception) check notices two small holes obscured by cobwebs and a thin veneer of plaster. A character who searches the floor and makes a successful DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation) check discovers a pressure plate in the floor near the midpoint of the bend.

The traps can be disabled by filling the holes in the wall with sealing wax, soap, iron spikes, or some other object. Alternatively, a character can jam the pressure plate with pitons or spikes by making a successful DC 15 Dexterity check using thieves' tools. If the trap isn't disabled, roll a d6 the first time a creature steps on the pressure plate. On a result of 1–4, two spears fire from the holes to strike the nearest creature directly north of them (+3 to hit, range 20/60 ft., 1d6 piercing damage).

Gnoll Guard. A gnoll stands watch at the point marked on the map, but there is a 25 percent chance that the gnoll is asleep when the characters arrive. The characters can sneak past the sleeping gnoll by succeeding on a group DC 10 Dexterity (Stealth) check. Otherwise, the gnoll hears the party approach and slips into area 1-7 to alert the gnolls stationed there. The guard is a **gnoll** armed with a morningstar (+4 to hit, reach 5 ft., 1d8 + 2 piercing damage). The gnoll is aware of the spear trap and can avoid setting it off while traveling the hallway.

Development. If the characters disabled the trap, the gnoll guard and any gnolls left alive in area 1-7 discover their handiwork and reset the trap 1d6 + 4 minutes after the characters leave the area.

AREA 1-7 – GNOLL GUARD POST

This storage area is filled with various crates and barrels, stacked high and leaving little available floor space to maneuver around inside.

Six **gnolls** (in addition to the one in area 1-6) occupy this guard post. The gnolls serve Stronghoen, the minotaur king. They wield battleaxes instead of spears (+4 to hit; 1d8 + 2 slashing damage, or 1d10 + 2 slashing damage if used with two hands).

Treasure. Each gnoll carries 1d8 sp and 1d12 gp.

Development. If the guard in area 1-6 alerts the gnolls, they ambush the characters as they enter the room.

AREA 1-8 – THE WAYDOWN

This long, 10-foot-wide passageway slopes gradually downward into darkness. No doors or adjoining passages seem to connect to the passage for as far as you can see.

Characters that pass within 10 feet of the secret door on the southern wall of the passage can detect it with a successful DC 15 Wisdom (Perception) check. The main hallway continues past the secret door and eventually turns south, leading to a flight of stairs that descends to area 2-20.

AREA 1-9A – THE GATES OF DEATH

The secret door leading to area 1-9 has been plastered over. Discovering the door requires a successful DC 20 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check. Chipping away the plaster reveals an inscription on the door, written in Ancient Thracian:

> *KNOW YE THAT BEYOND THIS PORTAL LIES THE DEMESNE OF THANATOS, THE CURSED, HATER OF LIFE, GOD OF DEATH. SEEK NOT TO PASS THIS GATE FOR IT LEADS ONLY TO HIS BOSOM. THOSE WHO CHERISH LIFE HAVE SEALED THESE CHAMBERS FOR AN ETERNITY. BE WARNED, THERE IS NO RETURN THROUGH THIS DOOR. ONCE PASSED, IT IS PASSED FOREVER.*

A copy of this inscription can be found in **player handout 2**. The door leads to an ancient chapel consecrated to Thanatos, the god of death. If the characters open the door, read or paraphrase the following:

With the secret door open, the narrow, 5-foot-wide passage on the other side seems to lead eastward into complete darkness. Your light sources fail to penetrate more than a few feet into the darkness, and even those of you with darkvision are unable to see where the passage leads.

The 30-foot-long, 5-foot-wide corridor beyond the secret door is filled with magical darkness that reduces the illumination radius of all light sources (even magical ones) to 5 feet. Even darkvision fails to penetrate the darkness. Regardless of which direction the characters travel, they find themselves in area 1-9 after moving 30 feet. Even a character that tries to reenter the hall from area 1-9 eventually finds themself back in area 1-9. There is no direct way to travel to area 1-9A from area 1-9.

AREA 1-9 – THE CHAPEL OF THANATOS

The walls of this 40-by-40-foot square room are draped from floor to ceiling with heavy, black curtains. Eight black marble benches are set in two rows from east to west across the chamber. Four incense burners, one in each corner of the room, fill the chamber with dim light. The burners cast an eerie green glow as thin wisps of sweet-smelling smoke slowly rise from them. Five figures in black cloaks sit or kneel motionlessly around the room.

Four of the figures are long-dead human worshippers of Thanatos. Their bodies crumble to dust if touched, each leaving behind nothing but a few bones, shreds of black cloth, and a silver chain and pendant (see Treasure, below). One of the figures looks like the others but is a very patient **wight**. The wight attacks the first character who touches or otherwise interacts with it. A character who makes a successful Wisdom (Perception) check contested by the wight's Dexterity (Stealth) is not surprised by the attack. If left alone, the creature stealthily trails the characters and attacks from behind. Unlike the other corpses, the wight wears no jewelry.

The smoke drifting from the burners is a sleep-inducing incense. 1d6 rounds after entering the room, each character must make a successful DC 15 Constitution saving throw or fall unconscious for 1d6 × 10 minutes, until they take damage, or until another creature takes an action to shake them awake. A character who stands directly over an incense burner and inhales the concentrated fumes must make the saving throw immediately, and they have disadvantage on the save. If the burners are extinguished, the smoke disperses after 1d6 × 10 minutes.

The walls behind the drapes are plastered with frescoes depicting a faceless being in dark robes (Thanatos) reigning triumphantly over a variety of mortal creatures. Inscribed above and below the frescoes are the words "*NOTHING ESCAPES DEATH*" in Ancient Thracian.

The northern door is locked and made of stone reinforced with iron (AC 18, 22 hp, immunity to poison, psychic, and slashing damage). Picking the lock requires thieves' tools and a successful DC 17 Dexterity check. The wight carries the key to the lock in a belt pouch. The key has a skull symbol at both ends, but it is still recognizable as a key.

The southern door is similar to the one to the north but is warded with an *arcane lock* spell, increasing the DC to pick the lock to DC 27. A skull with glowing red eyes is set into the stone of the door. If anyone attempts to open the door, the skull hisses in a language recognizable by at least most of the characters, via a modified *magic mouth* spell:

> *"ENTER FOOLS! JOIN ME IN THE BLISS THAT IS THANATOS! BECOME ONE WITH BLESSED DEATH! IT IS IN THE FINAL END THAT FULFILLMENT LIES."*

The secret door in the south wall is plastered over and requires a successful DC 19 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check to discover. The door is locked and has the same statistics as the northern door and is openable by the same key. Above the door is a spear trap set to fire when a key is inserted into the lock. Discovering the trap requires a successful DC 17 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check. A character can disarm the trap by making a successful DC 17 Dexterity check using thieves'

tools. If not disarmed, the spear fires at the first person to insert a key in the lock (+5 to hit, 1d8 + 2 piercing damage). The spear trap does not get reset.

Approximately 35 feet past the northern door, in the hallway leading to area 1-10, there is a covered pit trap. A character who makes a successful DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check notices the false floor that covers the trap. If the pit is not detected, there is a 50 percent chance it opens when weight is applied to that section of floor. If it opens, each character in the first two ranks of the marching order must make a successful DC 15 Dexterity saving throw or fall into the 10-foot-deep pit, taking 1d6 bludgeoning damage. Characters who succeed on the save by 5 or more can choose to jump to the opposite side of the pit. The bottom of the pit contains the desiccated remains of two humanoid adventurers. Any useful equipment they carried has long since succumbed to time. The cover to the trap does not reset once the trap is sprung.

Treasure. Each of the four corpses wears a silver chain with a skull-shaped pendant with turquoise eyes. The pendants are worth 25 gp each.

AREA 1-10 – CRYPT OF THE WALKING DEAD

An unmoving figure stands against the back wall of this room, its arms outstretched. Clad entirely in black robes, the figure stands approximately 20 feet tall.

The cloaked figure is a harmless statue of a male humanoid draped in an oversized black robe. As the characters enter the room, a magical wind begins to blow from the northern wall. Removing the statue's robe stops the wind, as does a successful *dispel magic spell* (DC 15). The wind has a 20 percent chance of extinguishing protected flames (such as those within a lantern); unprotected flames (such as a torch) are blown out immediately upon being brought into the room.

The secret doors into areas 1-10A through 1-10F are covered with plaster. A character who makes a successful DC 16 Wisdom (Perception) check notices that some of the plaster has broken away in these areas. A character who makes a successful DC 18 Intelligence (Investigation) check recognizes that the plaster on the walls was added sometime after the original construction of this area, possibly to cover some long-hidden feature of the walls. Dwarves and characters proficient with mason's tools have advantage on this check. A somber human face, approximately 4 feet tall, is painted on the wall above each door.

AREA 1-10A – EMPTY CRYPT

Whatever was sealed up in this chamber crumbled to dust long ago. Nothing of value remains.

AREA 1-10B – THE LIVING DEAD

Three skeletons in shredded black robes and wearing silver chains around their necks move to attack as soon as you enter this room.

The **skeletons** are weaponless and attack with unarmed strikes instead of shortswords and shortbows (+4 to hit, 1 bludgeoning damage).

Treasure. Each of the three skeletons wears a silver chain with a skull-shaped pendant with turquoise eyes. The pendants are worth 25 gp each.

AREA 1-10C – MORE LIVING DEAD

Four dusty skeletons clad in decaying scraps of black robes and wearing silver chains around their necks rush you as you enter the room.

The **skeletons** are weaponless and attack with unarmed strikes instead of shortswords and shortbows (+4 to hit, 1 bludgeoning damage).

Treasure. Each of the four skeletons wears a silver chain with a skull-shaped pendant with turquoise eyes. The pendants are worth 25 gp each.

AREA 1-10D – EVEN MORE LIVING DEAD

Four skeletons in rotted scraps of black robes and wearing silver chains around their necks move towards you menacingly as you peer into the room.

The **skeletons** are weaponless and attack with unarmed strikes instead of shortswords and shortbows (+4 to hit, 1 bludgeoning damage).

Treasure. Each of the four corpses wears a silver chain with a skull-shaped pendant with turquoise eyes. The pendants are worth 25 gp each.

AREA 1-10E – A SECOND EMPTY CRYPT

The previous occupant of this room disintegrated into its primal components years ago. All that remains is a pile of dust and black rags, along with a single shiny trinket lying among the debris.

Treasure. A single skull-shaped pendant with turquoise eyes lies amid the refuse in this room. It is worth 25 gp.

AREA 1-10F – A NOT SO-EMPTY CRYPT

Six skeletons wearing chain mail and armed with longswords move forward to engage your group as you open the door.

When the door to this crypt is opened, the doors to all the other crypts (areas 1-10A through 1-10E) burst open and release any surviving occupants. The **skeletons** immediately move to attack the characters.

The six skeletons in this room wear chain mail (AC 16) and are armed with longswords rather than shortswords and shortbows (+4 to hit; 1d8 slashing damage, or 1d10 slashing damage if used with two hands).

Treasure. A locked box against the north wall contains 200 sp, 40 gp, and a *potion of levitation* (see appendix D) in a skull-shaped flask. The characters can open the box with a successful DC 15 Dexterity check with thieves' tools or by breaking it open (AC 19, 10 hp, immunity to necrotic, psychic, and poison damage).

AREA 1-11 – PERFECTLY PRESERVED CURATE

This small, square chamber connects to corridors exiting through the north and south walls. Inside the chamber, a man in priestly robes stands surrounded by a group of armed, skeletal warriors.

Macreus, Cleric of Thanatos (see appendix C) has been in magical stasis in this room for nearly 950 years. Six **skeleton** guards surround him. Once the characters open the secret door on the south wall of area 1-9 that leads to this chamber, the magical stasis ends, Macreus awakes, and the skeletons animate. (In the unlikely event the characters enter the room from the south, Macreus and the skeletons remain in stasis until the secret door opens.)

Macreus knows of the gynosphinx in area 2-11, is aware of room complex 2-23, has heard legends of room complex 2-53, and knows how to reach Level 3A via area 2-12.

Ten feet past the southern exit from this room, in the hallway leading to area 1-14, is a concealed 5-foot-deep pit trap. A character who makes a successful DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check in the hallway notices the section of false floor that covers the trap. If the characters do not discover the pit, there is a 50 percent chance it opens when weight is applied to that section of floor. If it opens, each character in the first two ranks of the marching order must make a successful DC 15 Dexterity saving throw or fall into the pit, taking 1d3 bludgeoning damage. Characters who succeed on the saving throw by 5 or more can choose to jump to the opposite side of the pit. The bottom of the pit contains a thick layer of greasy dust and a locked chest (see Treasure). The cover to this trap resets once the trap is sprung unless something (such as a strategically placed piton or spike) prevents it from doing so.

The southern hallway past the pit trap leads to the upper reaches of a cavern (area 1-14). However, the end of the hallway is covered by a permanent illusion that conceals the chasm beyond. A creature that falls into the chasm plummets 50 feet, taking 5d6 bludgeoning damage and landing prone in area 2-28. The illusion works in only one direction; the opening to this hallway can be clearly seen from the rope bridge in area 1-15.

Treasure. Around his neck, Macreus wears a pendant shaped like a skull with turquoise eyes on a silver chain (worth 25 gp). Unless he uses it during the encounter with the characters, Macreus also has a single use of *dust of confusion* (see appendix D) in a belt pouch.

At the bottom of the pit is a locked chest. A character with thieves' tools can pick the lock with a successful DC 15 Dexterity check. The chest contains 800 cp, 200 sp, and a strong but lightweight rope ladder (worth 50 gp). The ladder is 50 feet long, and one end has two stone balls attached to it. The balls fit a pair of reinforced holes at the end of the corridor overlooking the cavern. When secured in this manner, the ladder can be used to descend 50 feet to the northern side of area 2-1.

AREA 1-12 – ORACULAR SKULLS

Two crossbow traps hidden in the hallway fire at the doors to this room if they are opened. Characters can discover the holes from which the bolts fire with a successful DC 15 Wisdom (Perception) check. A character who makes a successful DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation) check deduces that opening the door sets off the trap. The characters can disable the trap by filling the holes with sealing wax, soap, iron spikes, or some other material or by making a successful DC 20 Dexterity check with thieves' tools. If the trap is not disabled, roll a d6 as the doors are opened. On a result of 1-4, two bolts fire at the character opening the door (+3 to hit, 1d10 piercing damage).

When the characters open the doors, read or paraphrase the following:

The walls and the hemisphere of this room's 50-foot-high domed ceiling appear to be a night sky with constellations slowly moving across them. The floor is set with red, glazed ceramic tiles, making the floor very smooth. Inscribed in the center of the room in glowing green lines is a hexagram, a six-pointed star drawn within a circle. In the center of the hexagram, floating 15 feet above the floor, is a glowing green human skull with ram's horns growing from its sides. The skull's eyes are still set within it. It gazes directly at you and chuckles ominously.

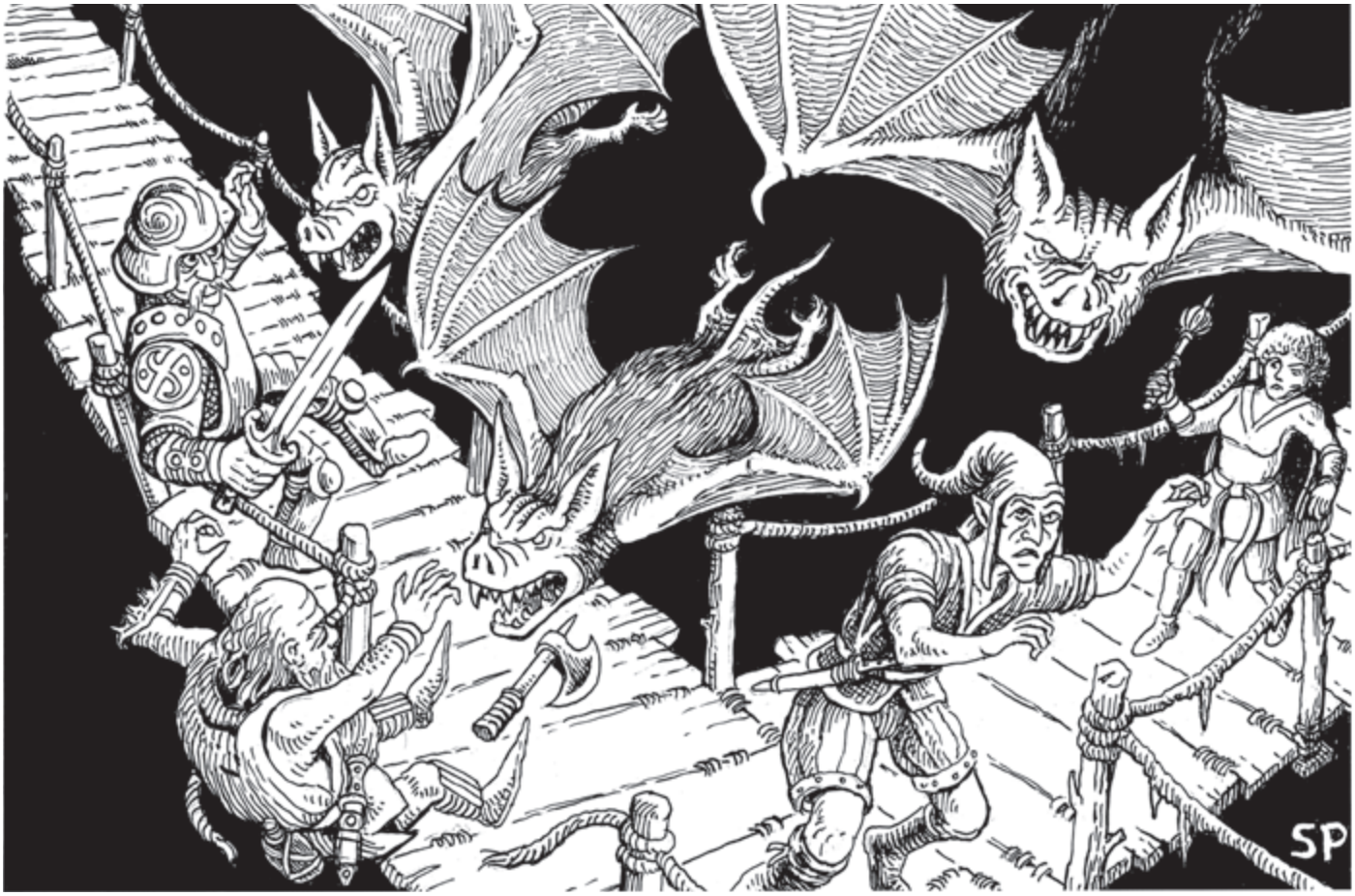
Once the characters enter the room, the **oracular skull** (see appendix B) speaks in Common: "*SPEAK PETITIONER AND HAVE THY SAY, THAT I MAY ANSWER YE YEA OR NAY*." The skull allows everyone present to ask one yes or no question, which it will answer truthfully. Each character can ask only one question, even if they leave and reenter the room. Once the party's questions have been answered, the skull says: "*YOUR QUESTIONS HAVE BEEN ANSWERED AND YE ARE NOW THANATOS'S OWN*." At that point, a white, skull-shaped blemish appears on the back of the right hand of any character who asked a question. The mark identifies the character (likely against their wishes) as a worshiper of Thanatos.

Development. A character marked with a skull-shaped blemish is visited by the **Incarnation of Death** (see appendix C) whenever they drop to 3 hit points or fewer, regardless of where they might be. If both a *remove curse* spell and a *cure wounds* spell cast at 4th level or higher is cast on the character, their blemish disappears. Otherwise, the blemish is permanent.

AREA 1-13 – MOLDY BONES

A double door leading to a chamber in the east is held shut by a heavy stone bar.

The shaded area in the east side of this room represents six colonies of **yellow mold**, each of which covers a **skeleton**. The skeletons appear fuzzy due to their moldy coating. Each time a skeleton is hit by an attack, there is a 50 percent chance it releases a cloud of spores in a 5-foot radius. There is an additional 30 percent chance that it instead releases all its spores at once, creating a 10-foot- radius cloud. Each skeleton can release up to two 5-foot-radius clouds or one 10-foot-radius cloud. Holy water does not damage the skeletons until the yellow mold on them is removed (by fire or sunlight, for example). A creature in the cloud when the spores are released must succeed on a DC 15 Constitution saving throw



or take 11 (2d10) poison damage and become poisoned for 1 minute. While poisoned in this way, the creature takes 5 (1d10) poison damage at the start of each of its turns. The creature can repeat the saving throw at the end of each of its turns, ending the effect on itself on a successful save.

The southern hallway leads to the upper reaches of a cavern (area 1-14). However, the end of the hallway is covered by a permanent illusion that conceals the chasm beyond. A creature that falls into the chasm plummets 50 feet, taking 5d6 bludgeoning damage and landing prone in area 2-28A. The illusion works in only one direction; the opening to this hallway can be clearly seen from the rope bridge in area 1-15.

Treasure. In the northeast corner of the room, there is a stone box containing 200 sp, 40 gp, and a *miniature wand of the demon prince Orcus* (see appendix D).

AREA 1-14 – UPPER REACHES

This area is the upper part of the caverns mapped on Level 2. From the level of the rope bridge in area 1-15, the caverns descend 50 feet and rise from 10 to 40 feet above the level of the bridge. Stalactites of various lengths hang from the ceiling.

Among the stalactites are 20 **giant bats**. Torches and normal lanterns on the rope bridge in area 1-15 rouse two of them, while magical light (such as the *light* cantrip) and bullseye lanterns pointed at the ceiling bring all 20 down for a flurry of attacks.

A character hit by an attack while on the bridge must succeed on a DC 10 Dexterity saving throw or fall off the bridge. The DC of the save increases by 2 each time that character is hit in the same round. A character that falls from the bridge takes 17 (5d6) bludgeoning damage and lands prone somewhere between areas 2-4 and 2-5.

AREA 1-15 – THE ROPE BRIDGE

The chasm here is spanned from east to west by a 40-foot-long bridge of seemingly recent construction. The bridge consists of hemp rope tightly woven with planks of wood. Waist-high rope handrails line the sides of the bridge.

Two ropes secure the bridge at each of its end points. Each rope has AC 11, 5 hp, and immunity to poison and psychic damage. Due to the dampness in the air, the ropes also have immunity to fire damage unless liberally doused with a minimum of three flasks of oil.

AREA 1-16 – SANCTUARY OF THE DARK ONE

This room is partitioned by heavy black drapes from floor to ceiling, creating an artificial wall to the west. A square-shaped wash basin stands in the southeast corner of the area. Another passage leads north out of the room.

This chapel devoted to Thanatos, under his recent name of The Dark One, is about a century old and is used by the local tribal warriors. The room is divided into three sections by walls of curtains, each consisting of two drapes.

Area A. The easternmost section is lit by a torch in a sconce on the eastern wall and contains a ritual purification basin and is guarded by two **armored tribal guards** (see appendix B). In addition to Tribal Thracian, these guards speak Modern Thracian.

Area B. The central section is reserved for worship. Several torches mounted in sconces on the walls illuminate the area. Two additional **armored tribal guards** (see appendix B) serve as sentries at the positions. These guards can also speak Modern Thracian.

Area C. The westernmost section contains a pair of lit iron braziers and an 8-foot-tall wooden statue of a humanoid draped in black robes. The statue's face is carved to resemble a skull and bears eyes made of turquoise. Characters who succeed on a DC 20 Intelligence (Religion) check recognize the statue as a depiction of Thanatos. Only clerics of Thanatos can enter this section of the room safely. Anyone else must make a successful DC 16 Wisdom saving throw or become cursed for 1 minute. While cursed, whenever the target takes damage, they take an additional 1d8 necrotic damage.

Treasure. Each of the statue's turquoise eyes is worth 200 gp. Removing either eye causes the flames in the braziers to explode. Each creature within 5 feet of a brazier when it explodes must make a DC 15 Dexterity saving throw or take 4 (1d8) fire damage. Flammable objects in the area that aren't being worn or carried (such as the curtains) are ignited by the blast.

AREA 1-17 – BARS, VISIONS, SPEARS, AND SLIDES

The eastern end of this corridor is blocked by a set of rusty iron bars.

Creatures that approach the bars from the west must make a DC 14 Wisdom saving throw. On a failure, the target sees an illusion of a comely dryad futilely trying to bend the bars. The dryad seems to be in fear of something and cowers against the east wall of area 1-17 if the characters try to interact with her. Bending the bars wide enough to squeeze through them requires a successful DC 17 Strength check. The illusion of the dryad disappears if the characters touch or attack her.

Two spear traps hidden in the walls east of the bars are set fire at creatures traversing the corridor. A creature that searches the walls and makes a successful DC 15 Wisdom (Perception) check notices two small holes obscured by cobwebs and a thin veneer of plaster. A character who searches the floor and makes a successful DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation) check discovers a pressure plate directly east of the bars. The traps can be disabled by filling the holes on the wall with sealing wax, soap, iron spikes, or some other object. Alternatively, a character can jam the pressure plate with pitons or spikes by making a successful DC 15 Dexterity check using thieves' tools. If the trap is not disabled, roll a d6 the first time a creature steps on the pressure plate. On a result of 1–2, two spears fire from the holes to strike the creature (+2 to hit, 1d6 piercing damage).

The stairs descend to the southeast corner of Level 2, just south of area 2-1. If any weight is placed on the stairs, there is a 30 percent chance the stairs collapse into a slide sloped to a 45-degree angle. Every 5 feet the characters move down the stairs, the chance of a collapse increases by 5 percent. Repeat the roll every 5 feet the characters move. If the slide is triggered, each creature on the stairs must make a DC 15 Dexterity saving throw. On a failure, the creature tumbles down the slide, landing prone in the river near area 2-1. A character can jam the stairs with pitons or spikes by making a successful DC 15 Dexterity check using thieves' tools.

AREA 1-18 – STAIRS TO THE SURFACE

This set of stairs leads to area B on the surface. Priests of The Dark One use the stairs when they perform their semi-monthly ceremonies here in the "holy of holies" (areas 1-14 through 1-27B).

Development. Light sources on the stairs are visible to the guard positioned outside area 1-20. If the guard notices a light, they blow a high-pitched, magical whistle that only servants of The Dark One (or those marked with a skull-shaped blemish from area 1-12) can hear. If alerted to intruders, followers of The Dark One in areas 1-14 through 1-26 prepare an ambush.

AREA 1-19 – A SECOND ROPE BRIDGE

The chasm here is crossed by a T-shaped bridge of relatively new construction. The bridge is approximately 25 feet long and consists of hemp rope woven with close-set planks of wood. Waist-high rope handrails line the sides of the bridge. One section of the bridge runs north to south, while another stretches east to west.

Two ropes secure the bridge at each of its end points. Each rope has AC 11, 5 hp, and immunity to poison and psychic damage. Due to the dampness in the air, the ropes also have immunity to fire damage unless liberally doused with a minimum of three flasks of oil.

Hanging amongst the stalactites on the ceiling are five **giant bats**. Torches and normal lanterns on the bridge rouse two of them, while magical light (such as the *light* cantrip) and bullseye lanterns pointed at the ceiling bring all five. A character hit by an attack while on the bridge must succeed on a Dexterity saving throw or fall off the bridge. The DC of the save increases by 2 each time that character is hit in the same round. A character that falls from the bridge takes 17 (5d6) bludgeoning damage and lands prone just south of area 2-3.

Development. Light sources on the bridge also alert the guard posted at the door to area 1-20. If the guard notices a light, they blow a high-pitched, magical whistle that only servants of The Dark One (or those marked with a skull-shaped blemish from area 1-12) can hear. If alerted to intruders, followers of The Dark One in areas 1-14 through 1-26 prepare an ambush.

AREA 1-20 – RITUAL HALL OF PURIFICATION

GM Note. Posted outside this room is an **armored tribal guard** (see appendix B; this guard also speaks Modern Thracian). The guard blows a magical bronze whistle if they spot intruders. The whistle produces a high-pitched sound that only servants of The Dark One can hear. Characters "branded" by Thanatos in area 1-12 can also hear the whistle. Followers of The Dark One in areas 1-14 through 1-26 prepare ambushes if they hear the whistle.

When the characters enter the room, read or paraphrase the following:

This 40-foot-diameter chamber clearly has some ritual purpose. In the center of the room sits a 3-foot-tall pillar of skulls, atop which rests a 5-foot-diameter basin of what appears to be water. At the north end of the room, a 10-foot-diameter column of black drapery stretches from the 20-foot-high ceiling to the floor. There is a 5-foot-square shaft in the floor to the west of the drapery.

The room is a purification chamber where the priests of The Dark One ceremonially clean themselves before entering any holy rites. Pulling back the drapes to the north reveals a statue depicting Thanatos as a winged male human. Creatures who see the statue must succeed on a DC 12 Constitution saving throw or become paralyzed for 1d6 × 10 minutes. Worshippers of Thanatos (including creatures bearing a skull-blemish from area 1-12) automatically succeed on the save. Flanking the statue are a pair of **adepts of The Dark One** (see appendix B). Just inside the room are a pair of **armored tribal guards** (see appendix B; these guards also speak Modern Thracian).

The shaft in the floor beside the statue descends 70 feet to area 2-17I. The shaft has no handholds and requires a successful DC 20 Strength (Athletics) check to climb.

Treasure. The eyes of the statue are matched citrines worth 150 gp each.

AREA 1-21 – OUTER LAIR OF THE WOLVERINE

This rough-hewn cavern reeks of animal waste and a strong skunk-like odor.

Talking or movement in this chamber attracts the **giant wolverine** (see appendix B) from area 1-22. The characters can avoid alerting the wolverine by succeeding on a group DC 15 Dexterity (Stealth) check.

Treasure. Lying about on the floor are various weapons (one greatsword, three spears, a light crossbow, 10 crossbow bolts, a handaxe, and two daggers), a helmet, and three pieces of plate armor. The plate armor is not enough for a complete suit but is similar to that worn by the guards in areas 1-16 and 1-20. All the equipment is saturated with wolverine musk. The weapons are in good condition but are unusable until they are well washed and aired out for several days.

AREA 1-22 – THE LAIR OF THE GIANT WOLVERINE

This rough-carved earth and stone chamber reeks so intensely of nauseating animal musk that your eyes begin to tear and your noses begin to run.

A creature that enters this chamber must succeed on a DC 12 Constitution saving throw or become poisoned by the stench. The target remains poisoned until they have left the room for 1 minute. The **giant wolverine** that claims this room as its lair attacks intruders, unless it was already encountered in area 1-21.

The concealed door in the west wall is easily revealed if the huge pile of debris (marked as the shaded area on the map) is excavated, a process that takes roughly 1 hour.

AREA 1-23 – THE SACRIFICIAL ALTAR OF THE DARK ONE

This 20-by-40-foot outcropping perches precariously above a dark chasm that stretches from the west to the north. To the east, a passage leads back to solid ground. To the north, a narrow stone bridge reaches approximately 20 feet across the chasm to a second passage. A semicircle extends from the west edge of the outcropping; a shaft is set into the ceiling directly above this semicircle.

When the characters arrive, there is a 60 percent chance that a sacrificial ceremony is about to take place. In this case, a **patriarch of The Dark One** (see appendix B), two **vicars of The Dark One** (see appendix B), and 10 **commoners** (noncombatants of various ages serving as witnesses, trainees, and servants; all fluent in Tribal Thracian and Modern Thracian) are present in this area.

In addition, eight **ceremonial guards** (see appendix B) oversee the ceremony. The guards' alignment is neutral, and they all speak Tribal Thracian and Modern Thracian. Finally, there are three non-combatant prisoners (one male and two females) who are bound and about to be pushed into the abyss. The two females are **commoners**, and the male is an elven **guard** with AC 11 due to his lack of armor. All three prisoners speak Common (the guard also speaks Elvish) and have no weapons or armor. The prisoners are all that remains of an electrum ore trader's caravan that made the mistake of camping near the surface ruins several nights ago.

If the sacrificial ceremony isn't taking place, there are 10 **giant bats** in this chamber. Any light in the area disturbs the bats, causing them to attack any creature that ventures onto the bridge leading to area 1-24. Creatures that fall from this area take 17 (5d6) bludgeoning damage and land prone on the east bank of the river between areas 2-6 and 2-7.

At noon, sunlight shines down the shaft directly onto the semicircular section of the platform. The shaft leads 65 feet up to the surface, opening into area F.

AREA 1-24 – TRAPDOOR

A 20-foot-long, 10-foot-wide bridge of mortared stone extends across a deep chasm to a passage on the other side. The roar of rushing water can be heard from somewhere deep below.

There is a trapdoor on the bridge. Spotting the trapdoor requires a successful DC 20 (Wisdom) Perception check. If a creature steps onto the area indicated on the map, roll 1d6. On a result of 1-4, the trapdoor opens. A creature that triggers the trapdoor must make a DC 17 Dexterity saving throw. On a failed save, the creature plummets into the cavern below, taking 17 (5d6) bludgeoning damage and landing prone in the water just east of area 2-7. Once triggered, the trapdoor remains open until pulled shut again.

AREA 1-25 – VAULT OF THE CEREMONIAL TREASURES

This 30-foot-square room has a second set of double doors directly across from those you entered from. Two chests, one against the north wall and one against the south, are each flanked by a pair of lit torches in sconces on the walls.

This chamber serves as a storage vault for the cult of The Dark One. It contains holy relics and other ceremonial trappings. Four **armored tribal guards** (see appendix B) stand at the east end of the room. The guards are under orders to protect the cult's valuables. If it appears they're not strong enough to handle intruders on their own, one of the guards pulls a lever to release the **black bear** from area 1-26. The bear joins the fray 1 round later, attacking anyone not wearing the guards' distinctive plate armor.

The room is lit by four torches that flank the chests on the north and south walls. Each chest is locked and warded with a magical trap. Only clerics of The Dark One can handle the chests safely. Anyone else must make a successful DC 16 Wisdom saving throw or become cursed for 1 minute. While cursed, the target makes Strength ability checks and saving throws with disadvantage. The curse triggers only the first time a creature physically touches either chest (including touching it with weapons or thieves' tools). Picking a chest's lock requires a DC 15 Dexterity check using thieves' tools.

The northern chest is empty except for a cloud of sleeping gas. Each creature in the room when the gas is released must make a DC 13 Constitution saving throw or fall unconscious for 1 minute. Constructs and undead automatically succeed on the save. The effect ends early if the target takes damage or another creature uses an action to shake the target awake.

Treasure. The southern chest contains a jewel-encrusted mace (worth 200 gp), an iron box containing 100 gp, and a leather sack containing five eye agates of different colors (worth 10 gp each), a large piece of amber (worth 150 gp), and a small alexandrite (200 gp). There is also a skull-shaped silver goblet set with gem chips (worth 50 gp) and a platinum box intricately carved with ancient runes (worth 250 gp). The runes state this box was crafted for his high excellence, the King of Thracia, Argos II. Inside the platinum box is a pair of *eye balls* (see appendix D).

AREA 1-26 – THE BEAR LAIR

This roughly carved, oddly-shaped cavern extends 50 feet into complete darkness. Fragments of bone, picked clean of flesh, lie strewn across the ground. The smell of filth and decay hangs in the air.

A **black bear** resides in this cavern. The bear attacks any creature not wearing the tribal guards' distinctive plate armor. The bars to the bear's cave can be raised and lowered by a lever in area 1-25.

AREA 1-27A – JETS OF FLAME

This area is the northern half of an immense hall, more than 100 feet long, that has been cleft in half by a chasm extending into the east and west walls. The chamber reeks of decaying flesh.

There is a 10 percent chance that the floor immediately adjacent to the chasm's edge crumbles if any weight is placed upon it. A creature unlucky enough to be standing on the edge when it crumbles must succeed on a DC 17 Dexterity saving throw. On a failed save, the creature falls 80 feet into the chasm, taking 28 (8d6) bludgeoning damage and landing prone in area 2-20.

The secret door in the north wall is disguised by the ornate panel work but can be discovered with a successful DC 17 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check.

Six seconds after a creature passes between the two northernmost pillars, flames erupt from holes in the floor of the semicircular alcove to the north (the holes are indicated by dots on the map). A creature standing in a space containing the holes takes 3 (1d6) fire damage. Flammable items in these areas that aren't being worn or carried are ignited by the flames. While the flames remain, a creature that enters or starts its turn in a space containing the flames takes 3 (1d6) fire damage.

After 30 seconds, a statue of a demon rises from the flames, laughing with a horrible, evil voice (courtesy of a *magic mouth* spell). Flames pour out of the statue's mouth as its eyes glitter and sparkle. After another 30 seconds, the statue sinks back down to area 2-31. Once the head of the statue passes floor level, 2-foot-thick stone panels seal the shaft closed, and the fires die out. The walls of the shaft down to area 2-31 are constructed of a slick, oily-textured stone.

Treasure. The eyes of the statue are a pair of unusually large, faceted amber gemstones worth 300 gp each.

Development. The statue functions only once every 7 days, as it takes that long for the gas fueling the flames to

collect. Since the flames are the result of burning gas, the fire is smokeless.

AREA 1-27B – THE DEATH CRYPT OF THE CULT OF THE DARK ONE

The reek of decaying flesh permeates the air here. Lying in ordered rows on the floor here are row upon row of neatly piled corpses. Many of the corpses are desiccated or skeletal and seem to have been here for quite some time. Others are clearly more recent.

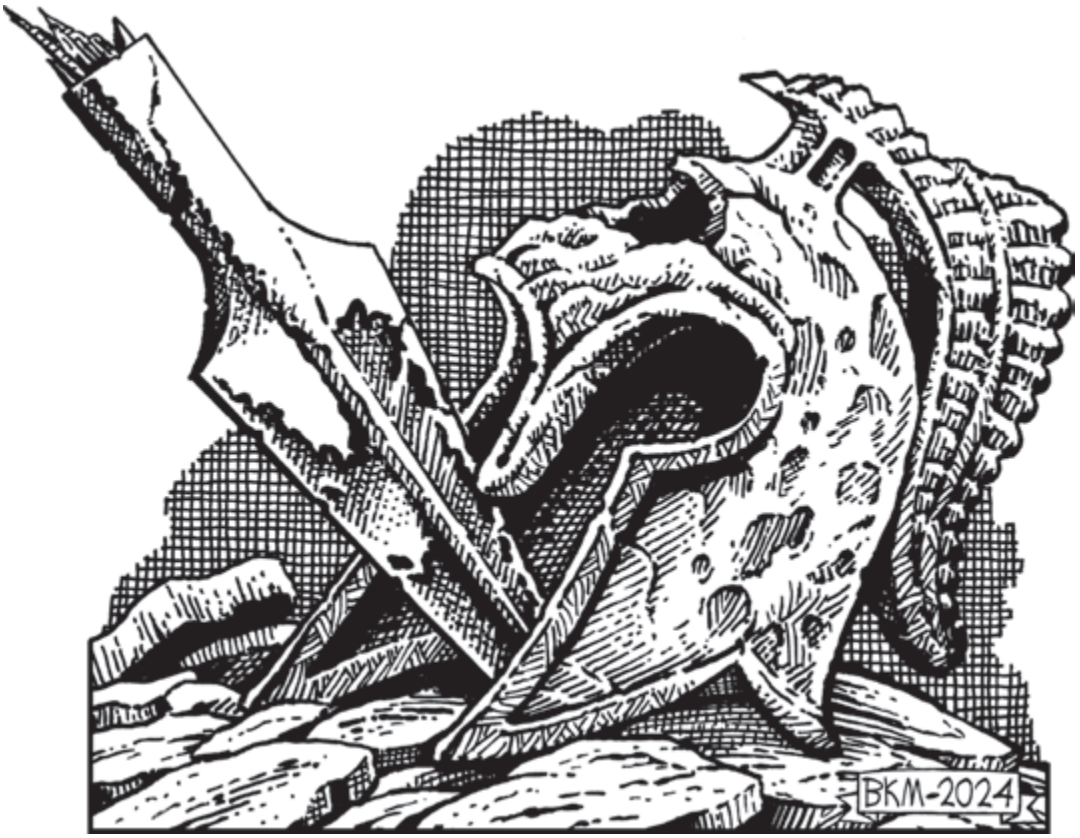
A **cadaver crawler** (see appendix B) feeds on the corpses. When the characters arrive, there is a 20 percent chance the crawler is lurking in the chasm. A clutch of 20 cadaver crawler eggs lies hidden inside one of the recent corpses.

If a creature other than the cadaver crawler approaches within 10 feet of the southernmost pair of columns, 1d4 corpses animate as **skeletons** and attack the intruders. If there are intruders to fight, an additional 1d4 **skeletons** animate each round thereafter, up to a total of 400 skeletons.

As depicted on the map, there is a locked stone chest along the east wall. The first creature to touch the chest triggers a magical trap and must succeed on a DC 15 Dexterity saving throw or take 7 (2d6) lightning damage. Picking the chest's lock requires a successful DC 15 Dexterity check with thieves' tools. The chest contains the personal effects of the local patriarch of The Dark One (see area 1-23).

Treasure. Inside the chest is a small wooden box containing two moonstones (worth 50 gp); a gem-encrusted statue of Athena (worth 400 gp), stolen long ago from the palace of the minotaur king on Level 3; a map showing every room and secret passage in the "holy of holies" area of The Dark One (areas 1-14 through 1-27B; see **player handout 3**); and a scroll written in Ancient Thracian that describes the sealed crypt of The Dark One (areas 1-9A through 1-13; see **player handout 4**). The scroll that hints of the location of Thanatos's crypt reads as follows:

Dark God, Death's Head,
Sealed Forever in Ceaseless Mourning.
Captive and Kept From Service to Man,
Lost to Man is the Oracle Wise.



CHAPTER FIVE

LEVEL 2

GENERAL FEATURES

Level 2 is fully depicted on **Maps 3-7**.

Ceilings and Walls (Internal). The ceilings inside the finished areas of this level are 20 feet high unless otherwise specified in the room description. The finished ceilings and walls are smooth, worked stone and carved out of the bedrock. Climbing a wall requires a successful DC 18 Strength (Athletics) check.

Ceilings and Walls (Caverns). The ceilings in the northern caverns on this level (areas 2-20 through 2-24) rise to 100 feet overhead. The southern caverns (areas 2-1 through 2-10) reach a maximum elevation of 70 feet. The cavern walls gradually slope inwards at an angle inconvenient for climbing and require a successful DC 24 Strength (Athletics) check to scale. The DC increases by 1 for every 20 feet above the cavern floor.

Doors. Unless otherwise specified, the doors on this level are unlocked and made either of stone (AC 17, 30 hp, damage threshold 5 hit points, immunity to piercing, poison, and psychic damage) or wood reinforced with bronze or iron bands (AC 15, 18 hp, immunity to poison, and psychic damage). Locked doors require a successful DC 15 Dexterity check with thieves' tools to open.

Illumination. This far underground, all areas are in darkness unless a source of illumination is specified in the room's description.

Level Connections. There are multiple entrances to this level from above. These include:

- The stairs from area 1-8 connect to area 2-20.
- Chasm in the hall from area 1-27 opens above area 2-20.
- The rope bridge in areas 1-14 and 1-15 and the bridge in area 1-24 are above areas 2-1 through 2-7.
- The shaft in area 1-20 leads to the area 2-17I.
- The stairs from area 1-17 connect to area 2-1.
- The trapdoor in area 1-24 opens up above area 2-7.
- The waterfall in area 2-1 leads to area 2A-1.
- There is a shaft in area 2-4 that leads to area 2A-3.
- The waterfall in area 2-5 descends to area 2A-5.

There is also access to Dungeon Level 3 from deeper within the complex. There are several access points to level 2A:

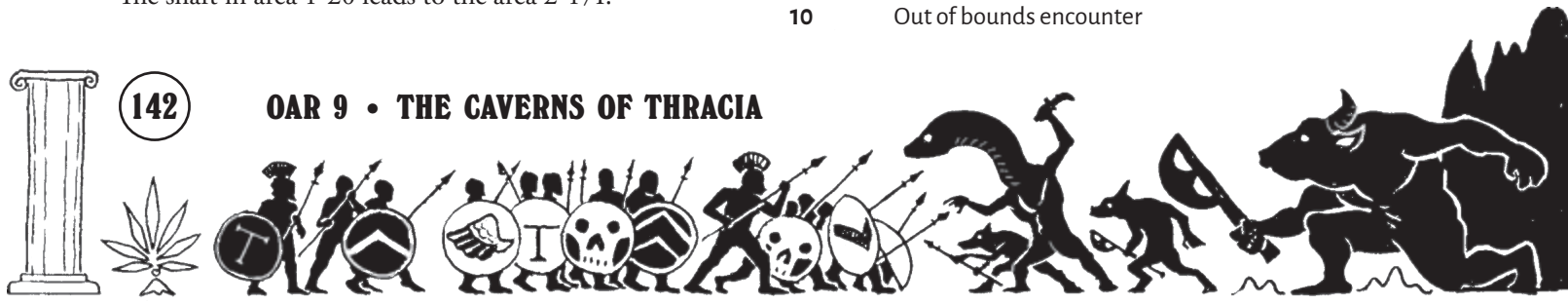
- The teleport pad in area 2-23 leads to area 3-1 (see area 3-36 if a "special marble" is possessed).
- The shaft in area 2-31J leads to the ceiling of Level 3.
- The shaft in area 2-12 leads down through area 2-23I and continues down to the ceiling of area 3A-1.

WANDERING MONSTERS

Every 10 minutes the characters spend wandering this level (excluding areas 2-13, 2-16 through 2-19, and 2-31), there is a 1 in 6 chance of a wandering encounter. Roll a 1d10 and consult the table below. Note the special circumstances for encounters in areas 2-17 through 2-19, 2-23, and 2-31 under the Special Encounters section, below).

LEVEL 2

d10	Encounter
1	Lizardfolk patrol B
2	Gnoll patrol B
3	Gnoll patrol C
4	Stirges
5	Giant spiders
6	Ochre jelly
7	Band of tribal warriors
8	Battle between tribal warriors and lizardfolk
9	Animated stone statue
10	Out of bounds encounter



LEVEL 2 WANDERING MONSTER DESCRIPTIONS

Animated Stone Statue. An **animated stone statue** (see appendix B) wanders the caverns and attacks living creatures it encounters. Until the characters defeat it, the statue may be encountered more than once.

Band of Tribal Warriors. Three bands of tribal warriors wander this level, just like on Level 1. Each band consists of six individuals as follows:

Band 1: This band is led by an **armored tribal guard** (see appendix B). The next character of note is a **priest** of The Dark One, with the following changes:

- They wear leather armor and carry a shield (AC 13).
- Their alignment is Lawful Evil.
- They speak Modern Thracian and Tribal Thracian.
- Replace *spirit guardians* with *animate dead* in their Spellcasting trait.
- The priest can control undead, as detailed in the Mortality domain in appendix D. Any affected undead creature acts as if it were created by an *animate dead* spell cast by the priest. This effect lasts for 24 hours or until the priest (or one of their allies) does anything harmful to the undead creature.
- They carry a *wand of light* (see appendix D).

The remaining four members of the band are **guards** with the following adjustments:

- They wear leather armor and carry shields (AC 14).
- Their alignment is Neutral.
- They speak Tribal Thracian.

The band has the following extra supplies distributed among them: two 50-foot coils of hempen rope, 36 torches, five bronze spikes, 24 days' rations, six filled waterskins, one waterskin filled with weak wine, two bronze daggers, and a stone hammer.

Band 2: All six of these warriors have been whipped into a battle frenzy by their clerics and do not fear death, but rather seek it in combat. They are **berserkers** with the following adjustments:

- The berserkers wear leather armor and carry shields (AC 14).
- They have the same extra supplies as Band 1 (see above) except for the *wand of light*.
- Their alignment is Neutral.
- They speak Tribal Thracian.
- They are armed only with spears:

Spear: *Melee or Ranged Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft. or range 20/60 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d6 + 3) piercing damage, or 7 (1d8 + 3) piercing damage if used with two hands to make a melee attack.

Band 3: This is a group of escaped slaves (treat as **commoners** who speak Tribal Thracian and some Gnoll) from Level 3. They are scared for their lives, and there is a 60 percent chance that a Gnoll Patrol (see below) is 1d4 + 1 rounds behind them.

Battle Between Tribal Warriors and Lizardfolk. A battle is in progress between a patrol of **lizardfolk** (determine the patrol randomly using the Lizardfolk Patrol Table, below) and a band of six tribal warriors. Treat the warriors as **berserkers** with the following adjustments:

- The berserkers wear leather armor and carry shields (AC 14).
- They have the following extra supplies distributed among them: two 50-foot coils of hempen rope, 36 torches, five bronze spikes, 24 days' rations, six filled waterskins, one waterskin filled with weak wine, two bronze daggers, and a stone hammer.
- Their alignment is Neutral.
- They speak Tribal Thracian.
- They are armed only with spears:

Spear: *Melee or Ranged Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft. or range 20/60 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d6 + 3) piercing damage, or 7 (1d8 + 3) piercing damage if used with two hands to make a melee attack.

The lizardfolk have the upper hand when the characters arrive. One berserker and one lizardfolk are already dead. Two of the berserkers have lost half their hit points, while a pair of lizardfolk have only superficial wounds. Unless the characters assist the berserkers, the lizardfolk prevail, dragging one unconscious tribal warrior back to whatever group the lizardfolk serve.

Giant Spiders. Two **giant spiders** detect the characters and see them as a potential meal.

Gnoll Patrol B. See Gnoll Patrol Tables, under Level 1 Wandering Monsters.

Gnoll Patrol C. See Gnoll Patrol Tables, under Level 1 Wandering Monsters.

Lizardfolk Patrol B. A group of six **lizardfolk** in the service of the minotaur king patrols the area.

Ochre Jelly. An **ochre jelly** creeps slowly down the corridor, exploring its surroundings. It leaves the hallway behind it stripped clean of any debris that may have accumulated there.

Out of Bounds Encounter. Roll a d10. On a roll of 1 or 2, use a random encounter from the Level 1 Wandering Monsters table. On any other result, use a random encounter from the Level 3: The Palace Wandering Monsters table.

Stirges. A flock of 1d4 + 1 **stirges** are hungry and attack anyone they encounter.

SPECIAL ENCOUNTERS

Areas 2-17 through 2-19. No wandering monsters are encountered during the adventurers' initial exploration of these areas. On subsequent forays, use the Level 2 Wandering Monsters table to determine random encounters in the area.

Area 2-23. No wandering monsters are encountered during the adventurers' initial exploration of these areas. On subsequent forays, roll a d10. On a roll of 1 or 2, a random encounter from the Level 2 Wandering Monsters table has discovered the area.

Area 2-31. Roll a d10 and consult the Area 2-31 Wandering Monsters table.

AREA 2-31 WANDERING MONSTERS

d10	Encounter
1	Possible demon
2	Possible undead
3-9	Scurrying sounds
10	Lizardfolk shaman

AREA 2-31 WANDERING MONSTER DESCRIPTIONS

Lizardfolk Shaman. G'ruk the Fish-finder, Lizardfolk Shaman (see appendix C) explores the area alone.

Possible Demon. If the characters open door 3 in area 2-31A, a **vrock** wanders here from the Astral Plane and searches the level for valuables.

Possible Undead. If the characters disturb **The Immortal King** (see appendix C) in area 2-31E, it now prowls about the complex, searching for living flesh to devour. It leaves the area 2-31 complex unless the door to area 2-31 from 2-31A is secured (by iron spikes, *arcane lock*, etc.). It doesn't leave through either of the other exits from this level, although it might decide to travel through the Astral or Ethereal Plane.

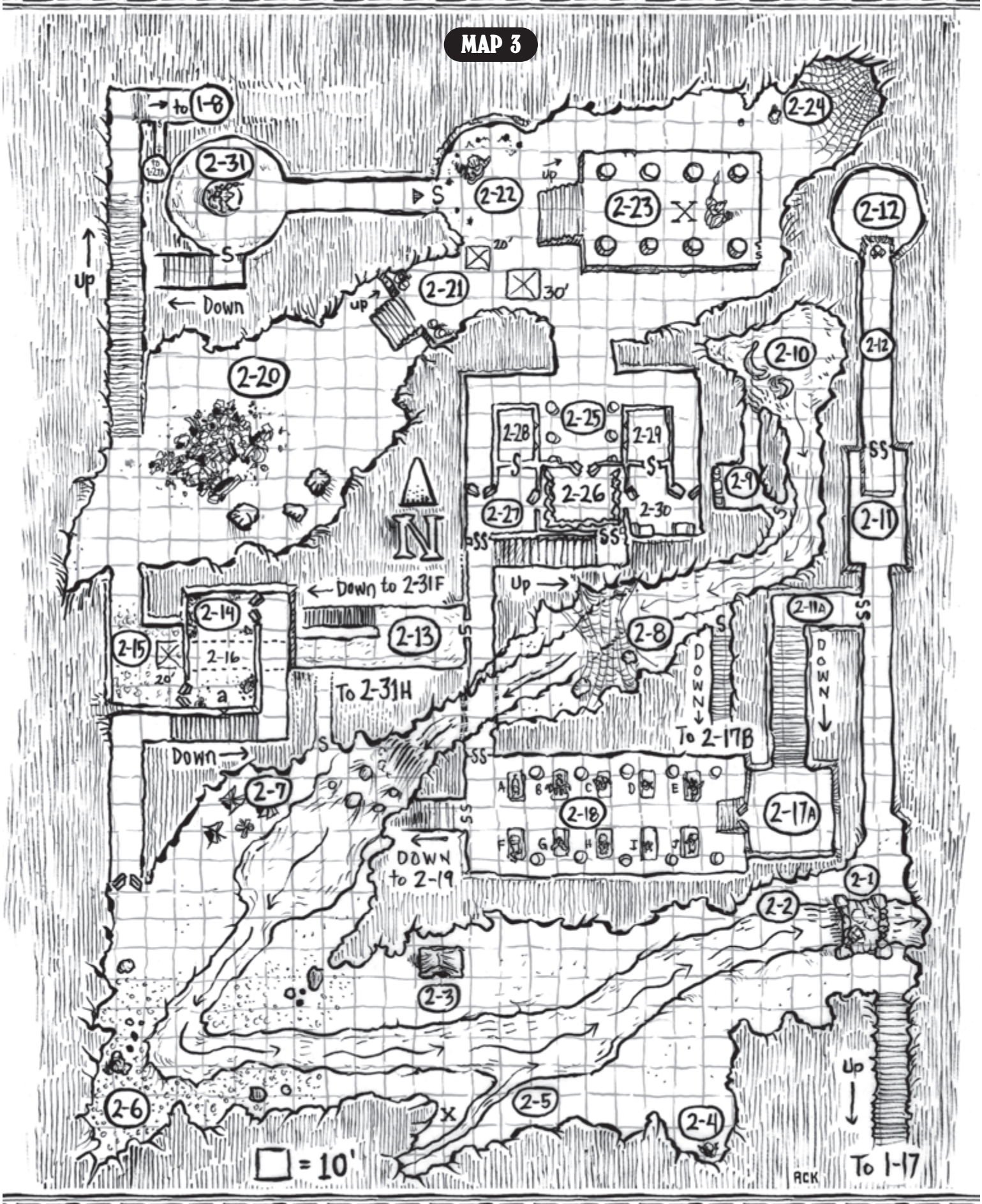
Scurrying Sounds. A noticeable scurrying sound, like that of many insects or spiders, is heard in the area, but the sound's origin is impossible to pinpoint.

LIZARDFOLK PATROL TABLES

If the identity of a given lizardfolk patrol is not predetermined (i.e., lizardfolk patrol A, B, C, or D), roll a 1d4 and consult the Lizardfolk Patrol Composition table, below. The lizardfolk have the following modifications:

- Lizardfolk in Patrol A do not carry shields (AC 13), heavy clubs, or javelins.
- Lizardfolk in Patrols B–D do not carry javelins, but do carry four darts each (+4 to hit, range 20/60 ft., 1d4 + 2 piercing damage).

These patrols are not intended to represent specific individuals (except for G'ruk the lizardfolk shaman), so it is permissible for the same party to be rolled multiple times. Finally, if "Special" is indicated in the patrol composition, roll 1d6 and consult the Special Patrol Members table, below.


MAP 3
to 1-8
2-24
2-31
2-22
2-23
2-12
2-21
2-20
2-10
2-25
2-28
2-29
2-26
2-27
2-30
2-9
2-11
2-14
2-15
2-16
2-13
2-8
2-11A
2-7
2-18
2-17A
2-1
2-2
2-3
2-6
2-5
2-4
Up
Down
Down to 2-31F
To 2-31H
DOWN to 2-17B
DOWN to 2-19
20'
30'
= 10'
To 1-17
ACK

LIZARDFOLK PATROL COMPOSITION

d4	Lizardfolk Patrol	Party Composition
1	A	Six **lizardfolk** in the service of G'ruk the lizardfolk shaman; there is a 10 percent chance they are accompanied by **G'ruk the Fish-finder, Lizardfolk Shaman** (appendix C)
2	B	Six **lizardfolk** in the service of the minotaur king
3	C	Six **lizardfolk** in the service of the minotaur king plus 50 percent chance of a Special*
4	D	Six **lizardfolk** in the service of the minotaur king plus Special*

* Roll 1d6 on the Special Patrol Members table, below

SPECIAL PATROL MEMBERS

d6	Special Patrol Members
1	One **gnoll pack lord** commands the patrol. Instead of a glaive and longbow, it wields a longsword (+5 to hit; 1d8 + 2 slashing damage, or 1d10 + 3 slashing damage if used with two hands).
2	One **dogfolk wizard** (see appendix B)
3	One **minotaur**
4	Two **lizardfolk** with four darts (+4 to hit, range 20/60 ft., 1d4 + 2 piercing damage) instead of javelins.
5	1d6 **tribal warriors** who attempted to escape and are being returned for punishment. They are desperate and, if freed, willingly assist the characters. They do not carry spears and speak Gnoll and some Common.
6	Two of the above. Reroll and ignore rolls of 6. Duplications are allowed.

AREA 2-1 – BRIDGE OF THE GIANT GNOME

A stone bridge approximately 15 feet long stretches north to south above an underground river. An oddly proportioned man resembling a squat giant sits on the bridge, starting contemplatively into the water below.

The creature on the bridge is a giant deep gnome (svirfneblin) named **Grastic Hammerclay** (see appendix C). Hammerclay's people drove him out years ago due to his size. He is severely disturbed and intensely paranoid. The followers of

The Dark One know him as "The Old Man of the Bridge" and try to avoid him.

Hammerclay survives on crayfish (some monstrous) and stirges he snares. He would appreciate real food and lets the characters pass unscathed for a week's worth of rations. He is willing to trade some of his "pretties" (see Treasure) for more food. If Hammerclay drops to 26 hit points or fewer, he dives into the river and hides beneath the bridge, whimpering "Go away! Leave me alone! Everybody hates me!" in Gnomish.

The north passageway out of this area is carved smooth, its floor inlaid with polished marble tiles. The cavern and the river continue to the west (upstream). The waterfall to the east leads to area 2A-1.

Treasure. Grastic keeps 221 cp, 68 sp, 89 gp, a small chrysoprase (worth 30 gp), and a rusty iron key in a sack near the cavern's wall. The key unlocks the cells in areas 4-9 and 4-10.

AREA 2-2 – SLIPPERY EDGE

Water splashes along this narrow ledge over the northern bank of the river. Travel over the next section of ledge seems dangerous.

This narrow ledge skirts past the river's northern edge. The ground here is extremely slippery due to water flowing across the ledge. Unless the characters take special precautions, such as roping characters together or driving spikes into the walls, it is possible someone might plunge into the dark river. A creature that walks over the slippery point must succeed on a DC 17 Dexterity (Acrobatics) check or fall in the river.

The river is 15 feet deep along this section, and the current has a speed of 10 feet per second (60 feet per round). In addition, jagged rocks hide beneath the water's surface. Characters who fall into the river take 4 (1d8) bludgeoning damage, or half as much damage on a successful DC 12 Dexterity saving throw. They are then swept downstream (to the east) where they can catch themselves on a rocky ledge.

AREA 2-3 – DEAD HALFLINGS

This small, unkempt cottage is constructed of field stone and roofed with straw thatch that is rotting in the high humidity of the cavern. The ground around the cottage is loose sand. A spear stuck in the ground before the cottage supports a lizardfolk skull entirely stripped clean of flesh.

The lizardfolk who dwell throughout the caverns avoid the cottage at all costs, believing it to be connected to their ancestors in some way. A character who investigates the skull notices a line of crude arcane symbols painted across its brow. A character who makes a successful DC 10 Intelligence (Arcana or Investigation) check deduces that the symbols serve as a warning of some kind.

The interior of the cottage has been obviously ransacked. A character who makes a successful DC 10 Intelligence (Investigation) check gathers enough evidence to determine that worshippers of Thanatos were responsible.

The cottage's furnishings include a cot, a table, and a chair. The desiccated corpse of a halfling wearing long, tattered robes is on the cot. On the halfling's chest rests a scroll, written in Ancient Thracian, extolling the wonders of King Agamemnos' palace deep within the earth, as well as the beautiful gardens that surround the structure. The scroll also makes vague references to "the beastfolk who serve the king" and "the living trees." See **player handout 5**.

Treasure. On the table is a *reusable candle* (see appendix D) with six uses remaining. Around the neck of the corpse is a silver, fish-shaped medallion (worth 69 gp). If the characters remove it from the cottage, there is a 50 percent chance every 10 minutes that the medallion attracts 1d3 **lizardfolk**.

Developments. If the lizardfolk of the caverns discover that this site has been violated (such as by the characters entering and taking the fish-shaped medallion; see Treasure), their heightened aggression grants them a +1 bonus to attack rolls against the party.

AREA 2-4 – STIRGE STRIKE

This natural passage to the south extends only a short distance from the main cavern before ending in a collection of rocky debris and the remnants of ancient, worked stone.

This natural indentation in the cavern wall is all that remains of a tributary of the main river that flowed through here long ago. A search of the area reveals the shattered fragments of several ornate columns and a statue to some now indistinguishable god. A shaft behind the statue leads to area 2A-3. Characters who succeed on a DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check also discover half-buried human bones, a dull and heavily tarnished bronze sword, and a stone mace.

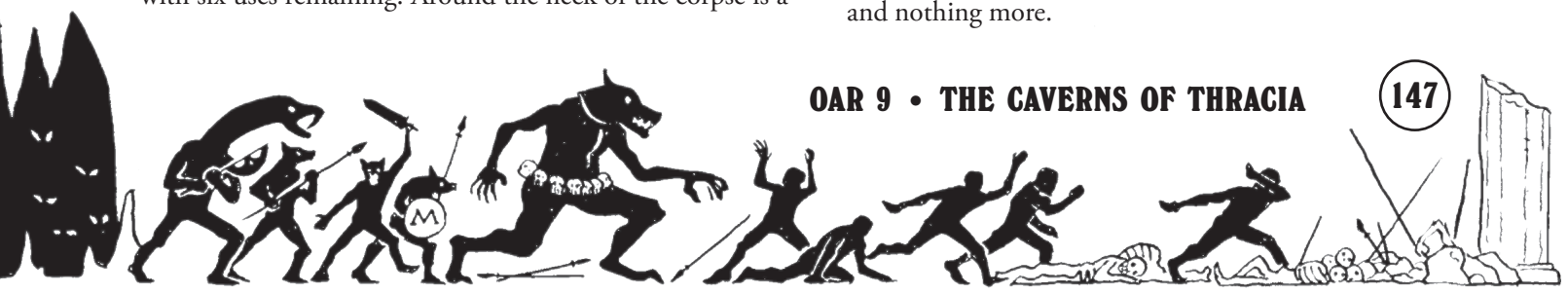
Ten **stirges** hide among the rock formations. Due to their unusual coloring, the stirges have advantage on Dexterity (Stealth) checks to hide in the cavern.

AREA 2-5 – SHALLOW STREAM

A shallow flow of water emerges from the cavern's southern wall and runs northeast to join the river. The stream is approximately 5 feet wide but appears to be only a few inches deep. Three dead humans lie in the stream, one of them crushed horribly.

Lying in the stream are the long-dead bodies of three tribal warriors. One appears to have been crushed to death. Strewn about them are two spears and a shield. The "X" on the western shore of the stream marks the location of a 3-foot-long **piercer** that drops from the 40-foot-high ceiling if any creature passes beneath it. In addition, two **stirges** hide near the ceiling and attack creatures that approach this area. Like those in area 2-4, these stirges have advantage on Dexterity (Stealth) checks to hide in the cavern. The waterfall to the west leads to area 2A-5.

Treasure. In a pouch on the body of the crushed warrior are four turquoise gems (worth 20 gp each) folded in a piece of soft leather. Another warrior carries a bronze dagger with an arcane rune carved into it. This dagger is a good luck charm and nothing more.



AREA 2-6 – LAIR OF THE FALLING STALACTITES

The underground river flows into this area from the northeast before taking a sharp turn and heading east. Several boulders and stalagmites dot the landscape, while a strikingly out-of-place set of heavy oak double doors stand in the cavern wall to the north. The doors are covered in moss and bound with weathered bronze.

Eleven **piercers** hang 40 feet above the shaded region of the map. Four of the piercers are located above the black dots on the map, while the remaining seven can be placed randomly throughout the area. The lizardfolk usually pass through this area in the water, as the piercers will not drop into the river.

The double doors are locked. One of the lizardfolk in area 2-7 carries the key. Without the key, a character using thieves' tools can pick the lock with a successful DC 15 Dexterity check. The doors can also be smashed (AC 15, 20 hp, immunity to poison, and psychic damage).

AREA 2-7 – THE LIZARD ENCAMPMENT

An encampment of at least a dozen humanoids has been established a short distance from the northwestern shore of the river. The cavern here echoes with the sounds of the rapids to the east.

The encampment is the lair of 18 **lizardfolk** and their leader, **G'ruk the Fish-finder, Lizardfolk Shaman** (see appendix C). There are other members of this tribe, loyal to the minotaur king, elsewhere in the caverns. Here is a breakdown of these lizardfolk:

- Five of the lizardfolk, on leave from the minotaur king's service, are armed with four darts each instead of javelins (+4 to hit, range 20/60 ft., 1d4 + 2 piercing damage). One of these lizardfolk carries a key to the double doors north of area 2-6.
- Nine of them are unarmed (no heavy club, javelin, or spiked shield; AC 13) and currently feed on the dismembered corpses of several tribal warriors.
- An additional four hide in the water. These four lizardfolk have advantage on Dexterity (Stealth) checks to hide and wait for an opportune moment to attack.

G'ruk carries a magic potion (see Treasure) from area 2-9. Five lizardfolk died obtaining this single vial. Since then, G'ruk has learned of a legend featuring the phrase "cast the blood of man upon the troubled waters," which he (incorrectly) interprets as a demand for human blood to be sacrificed to gain safe access to area 2-9. G'ruk has been looking for a living human to test the legend for some time, but the other lizardfolk usually bring back only pieces of the tribal warriors they defeat.

The secret door northeast of this area leads to G'ruk's hidden lair in area 2-31H. Without G'ruk's help, the door requires a successful DC 18 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check to find.

If G'ruk is killed, roll 1d100 and consult the following table to determine the reaction of the remaining lizardfolk.

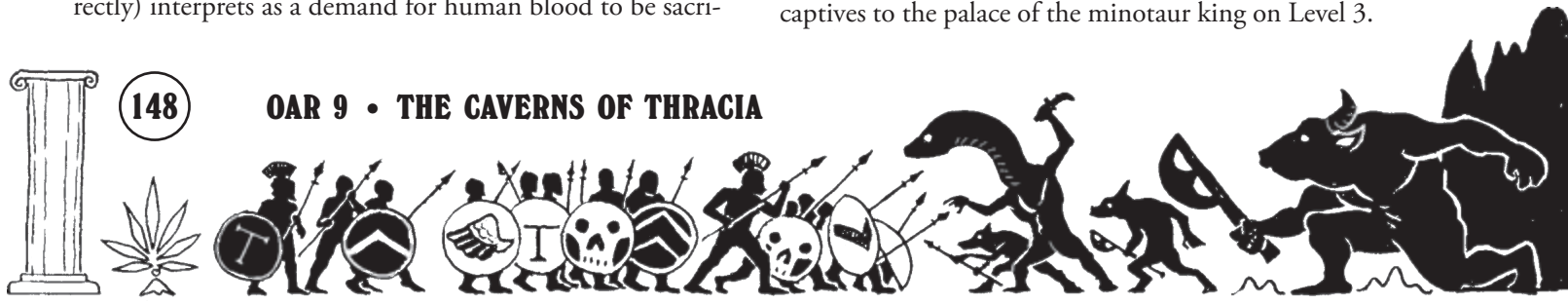
d100	Reaction
01-25	The lizardfolk are frightened and run away, except for the five lizardfolk armed with darts, as they are trained for battle.
26-60	The lizardfolk continue to fight normally.
61-85	The lizardfolk fight with a battle frenzy (+1 to hit).
86-00	The lizardfolk fight recklessly. At the start of its turn, each lizardfolk can gain advantage on all melee weapon attack rolls it makes during that turn, but attack rolls against it have advantage until the start of its next turn

Treasure. G'ruk carries a satchel that contains 18 gp and a *potion of mind control* (undead) (see appendix D), as well as four "sacred" rocks, a mummified human hand, six teeth from various creatures, a set of 20 divining sticks, six strips of dried human flesh, and a human jawbone (all useless). The satchel also contains four pouches filled with various powders. The contents of the four pouches are alum, dust, sand, and poison dust. Mixing the poison dust with water generates up to five doses of basic poison. The poison dust can also be hurled as an attack (see sidebar).

Poison Dust as a Weapon

As an action, a creature can throw the pouch of poison dust at a point it can see within 20 feet. Upon impact, the pouch bursts and creates a cloud of poison dust in a 10-foot radius. Each creature caught in the dust when the pouch explodes takes 9 (2d8) poison damage, or half as much damage with a successful DC 14 Constitution saving throw.

Development. If the lizardfolk capture any humans, there is a 10 percent chance one of them suggests taking the captives to the palace of the minotaur king on Level 3.



AREA 2-8 – SPIDERWEB (AND SPIDER!)

At this point in the cavern, an immense spiderweb completely spans the river.

A creature that enters the area of the webs or that starts its turn inside the webs must make a DC 15 Dexterity saving throw or become restrained. A creature restrained by the webs can use its action to make a DC 15 Strength check, freeing itself on a success. The web snares items or creatures floating on the river, but creatures who swim beneath the surface can bypass the webs safely. Otherwise, clearing a path through the webs (using fire or slashing weapons, for example) requires 10 minutes of work.

A **giant spider** hides in a shadowy niche in the ceiling. Near the giant spider (and easily visible from the cavern floor) is a leathery sack of spider eggs. Dealing damage to the sack unleashes a torrent of baby giant spiders. If released, most of the young busy themselves with eating each other, but 1d10 **swarms of spiders** move to attack the characters.

The giant spider has developed a symbiotic relationship with the lizardfolk of the area. The lizardfolk feed the spider an occasional tribal warrior, and in return the spider lets them pass beneath her web without interference.

Characters who examine the southern wall east of the spiderweb and make a successful DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check discover a secret door. The door leads to area 2-17B.

AREA 2-9 – A SEEMINGLY ABANDONED TREASURE VAULT

This dark, 15-foot-square vault features images of huge, fanged mouths painted on the walls. The dust that has settled on the floor over the ages appears to have been recently disturbed. Dark stains on the floor lead to the damp hall heading north out of the room. Down the hall, the sounds of gurgling water can be heard.

One large chest and two smaller boxes sit against the vault's western wall. The small box to the right of the chest is open and empty, while both the box on the left and the chest are sealed with wax.

A character who scrapes away the wax discovers that the chest and smaller box are both locked. Picking either lock requires a successful DC 15 Dexterity check with thieves' tools.

The smaller sealed box is protected (haunted?) by a **disembodied mouth** (see appendix B). The invisible mouth bites creatures who reach into the box. If not destroyed during the initial encounter, the mouth disappears after 3 rounds, reappearing 1d6 + 4 rounds later to resume the attack. The mouth repeats this cycle until destroyed or until the treasure it guarded is abandoned.

The chest is approximately 3 feet square and 2 feet tall. It also contains a **disembodied mouth**, which attacks in the same manner as the one in the smaller container.

Treasure. The small box contains a *potion of invisibility* and a *+1 dagger* with a solid garnet hilt (worth 1,200 gp). The chest holds ten bags, each filled with 100 gp (1,000 gp total), as well as a *+1 longsword*, a silver mirror (worth 50 gp), an anklet of solid obsidian with intricate inlaid designs in electrum and an unknown alloy (worth 100 gp), a gold brooch (worth 140 gp), and an iron axe studded with green glass and jade worth 900 gp. The chest also contains a *+1 shield* decorated with silver and platinum tracery and studded with 70 carnelians (worth 170 gp). The first time the shield is used in combat, its value is reduced to 70 gp, as the gems break off and shatter.

Development. 1d6 + 1 rounds after the large chest is opened, 1d2 armored tentacles from the **grasping guardian** (see appendix B) in area 2-10 snake into the room through the north corridor and attack.

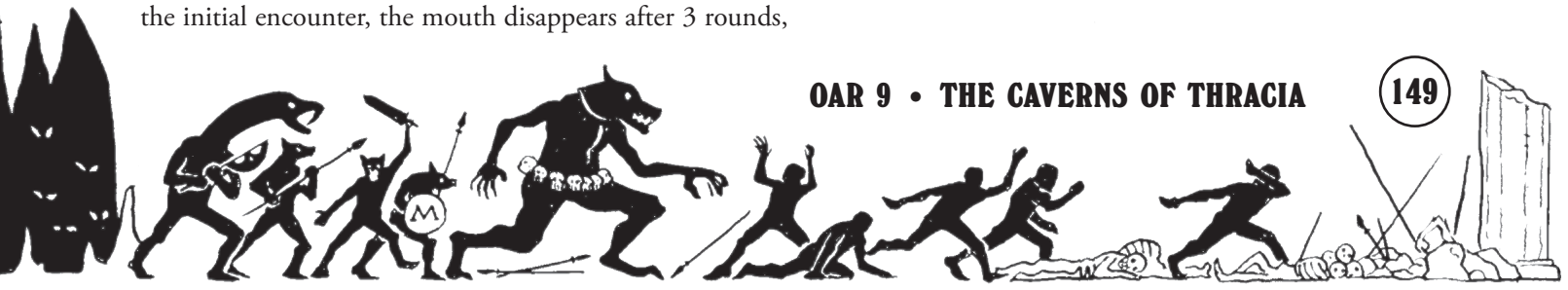
AREA 2-10 – GREAT GRASPING GUARDIANS

This cavern seems to be the source of the underground river, as water bubbles up from somewhere below the surface of the pool that fills this roughly 40-foot-wide cavern.

A **grasping guardian** (see appendix B) lies beneath the bubbling waters. The guardian is usually dormant, but if the treasure in area 2-9 is disturbed it reaches into that area with its tentacles. The creature's body remains submerged even while its tentacles attack. Creatures pulled into the water begin to suffocate. The bodies of creatures slain by the guardian eventually float downstream and might become ensnared in the giant spider's web in area 2-8.

Treasure. If removed and allowed to dry, the grasping guardian's single gelatinous eye shrinks and hardens into a diamond (worth 3,000 gp).

Development. The source of the bubbling pool is very, very deep. The water rises to this level through a shaft that extends far into the depths of the earth. The characters can't swim down the shaft from this direction, but the escape pods in area 4-23 travel up the shaft and might deposit their occupants here.



AREA 2-11 – HALL OF THE SPHINX

GM Note. Before the characters enter this area, read or paraphrase the following:

The corridor extends another 10 feet before opening into a wider hall. Just before the entrance, the corridor's east and west walls are decorated with 5-foot-wide, 15-foot-tall panels of gray marble. An image of a human skull is carved into the center of each panel. Pale, green light emanates from the eyes of the skulls, illuminating the corridor. The chamber past the skulls appears empty except for a 7-foot-high platform on the northern wall.

Touching either skull triggers a low chuckling laughter created by a *magic mouth* spell. The secret door on the western wall just south of skulls requires a successful DC 20 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check to notice. To open the door, both skulls must be touched simultaneously. If touched in this way, there is a 40 percent chance that either skull bites the creature touching it (+3 to hit, 1d2 piercing damage).

If the characters enter the main hall, a near-blinding column of golden light appears above the platform, illuminating the chamber and revealing ornate frescoes of unknown gods and heroes on the walls. Nonmagical flames brought into the area of the column of golden light are immediately extinguished; in addition, creatures standing on the illuminated platform gain the benefits of a *protection from normal missiles* spell (see appendix D).

Lounging on the platform itself is Ontussa, a sphinx, who has obviously been observing the characters for some time. Treat Ontussa as a **gynosphinx** with the following changes:

- Her alignment is Neutral.
- Replace her Spellcasting trait with the following:

Spellcasting: Ontussa is a 9th-level spellcaster. Her spellcasting ability is Intelligence (spell save DC 16, +8 to hit with spell attacks). Ontussa requires no material components to cast her spells. She has the following wizard spells prepared:

Cantrips (at will): *mage hand, minor illusion, prestidigitation*

1st level (4 slots): *comprehend languages, detect magic, identify*

2nd level (3 slots): *locate object, see invisibility, suggestion*

3rd level (3 slots): *clairvoyance, dispel magic, remove curse*

4th level (3 slots): *banishment, greater invisibility*

5th level (1 slot): *legend lore*

- She has the following trait:

Dying Curse: When Ontussa dies, she utters a curse with her dying breath. Each creature of Ontussa's choice within 60 feet of her becomes cursed. While cursed in this way, one of the creature's ability scores (determined randomly) is reduced by 1. The curse is permanent until a *remove curse* spell ends it.

Ontussa considers herself something of a sage and happily answers the adventurers' questions…for a price. Ontussa demands 100 gp per question asked or 10 gp per character if the party asks no questions. Ontussa always answers questions, even if she doesn't know the answer. If the party refuses to pay her, Ontussa magically seals the secret doors leading to area 2-11A, increasing the DC to open them to 28.

Development. The secret doors on the north wall are invisible until Ontussa dies. Once visible, a character who makes a successful DC 18 Dexterity check with thieves' tools can pick the lock to open them. Smearing Ontussa's blood on the doors to area 2-11A negates the sphinx's magical seal.

AREA 2-11A – THE WAY DOWN

These roughly carved stairs lead down and to the south. Thick spider webs, visible from the dust they have managed to collect, choke the stairwell.

The webs are those of a long-dead giant spider, whose desiccated husk can be found about 30 feet down the stairs. A creature that enters the area of the webs or that starts its turn inside the webs must make a DC 15 Dexterity saving throw or become restrained. A creature restrained by the webs can use its action to make a DC 15 Strength check, freeing itself on a success. The webs are flammable. Any 5-foot cube of webs exposed to fire burns away in 1 round. The characters can also hack through the webs; each 5-foot cube of webs has AC 10, 5 hp, and immunity to bludgeoning, poison, and psychic damage.

The secret doors to the east are not hidden when viewed from this side.

AREA 2-12 – INTRIGUING TREASURES AND DEEP SHAFTS

This 10-foot-wide hallway is approximately 70 feet long. At the northern end stands a 9-foot-tall statue of a lion-headed man with glowing orange eyes. Thick, red curtains surrounding the statue make it seem as if it stands in a velvet-lined alcove.

This hall is normally lit with a magical, cool green light, but upon Ontussa's death, the walls glow with a throbbing red

light instead. If the characters proceed more than 10 feet down the hall, the statue of the **lion man** (see appendix B) animates and attacks. The lion man is programmed to guard the area that lies beyond the curtains with its very existence.

Magical Diamond. Lodged in the center of the lion man's chest is a magical diamond. While in the lion man's chest, the diamond grants the construct resistance to piercing and slashing damage. In addition, while the walls of the hallway flash red, the floor around the lion man magically transforms into 2-foot-deep mud. Whenever the lion man enters a space, the ground in that space turns to mud until the end of the lion man's next turn, at which point it transforms back into the stone.

While transformed to mud, the ground is difficult terrain. In addition, a creature attempting to move out of a space filled with mud must make a successful DC 10 Strength (Athletics) check or become restrained. A creature restrained in the mud can use an action to repeat the Strength (Athletics) check, freeing itself on a success. A creature in the mud when the ground solidifies becomes trapped in the hardened stone until the stone is chipped away (AC 11, 4 hp, immunity to poison and psychic damage). The lion man walks on the mud as if it were solid stone and is immune to this effect.

When the lion man dies, the diamond in its chest can be removed, at which point it transforms into a *gem of resistance* (see appendix D).

Curtains. The curtains that separate the lion man from the circular area are each 15 feet tall. The east and west curtains are each 8 feet wide, while the northern curtain is 15 feet wide. A creature that touches a curtain magically adheres to the fabric and is restrained (no saving throw allowed). The curtains are immune to all damage and can't be affected (cut, burned, pulled down, etc.) in any way. A *dispel magic* spell cast on a curtain frees any creatures stuck to it and transforms that curtain into mundane, nonmagical fabric.

Another Way to Resist

If the characters don't have access to *dispel magic*, consider the curtain effect can be ended with a successful DC 13 Strength saving throw. If the target fails, the save can be repeated at the end of its turn, ending the effect with a success.

Two Holes. The circular area beyond the curtains is Ontussa's treasure room. A dim, amber light illuminates the space. The area's most obvious features are two large holes. In the center of the room is a 10-foot-diameter, 100-foot-deep shaft that leads to the ceiling of area 3A-1. A creature that falls into the shaft takes 12d6 bludgeoning damage from the entire 120-foot drop. The walls of the shaft are smooth and require a successful DC 20 Strength (Athletics) check to climb. However, a creature that uses their bare hands and feet to climb discovers that their extremities act like suction pads while inside the shaft, granting them a climb speed equal to their walking speed.

The second hole is a 6-foot-diameter circle positioned about 3 feet up the chamber's north wall. This hole is actually a *portable hole*. A large wooden box sits in plain sight at the back of the hole. The box appears to be attached to the back wall of the hole. Because of the gravity orientation in the hole, no matter which direction the hole faces, the opening is "up" and the bottom is "down." The gravitational pull inside the hole is so strong that anything passing within 5 feet of the hole (directly "over" it, from the hole's perspective) falls 10 feet "sideways" (from others' perspective) into the hole and takes 1d6 bludgeoning damage. Without rope, climbing out of the hole requires a successful DC 22 Strength (Athletics) check.

Treasure. The gem lodged in the statue's chest is a *gem of resistance* (see appendix D). The wooden box inside the *portable hole* is locked and requires a successful DC 15 Dexterity check with thieves' tools to open. The box contains 2,000 sp, 40 gold ingots worth 100 gp each (4,000 gp total), an ornate stone axe (worth 150 gp), an electrum ring (worth 300 gp), a heavy platinum chain necklace (worth 1,200 gp), and a *helm of telepathy*. Characters who smash the box to bypass its lock inadvertently damage the helm, rendering it useless.

AREA 2-13 – FROST VAULT

GM Note. If approached from the hallway to the east, the secret door seems to be a part of the blank, stone wall. However, characters who touch the wall discover a 5-foot stretch that is 20 to 30 degrees Fahrenheit (11 to 17 degrees Celsius) colder than the surrounding stone. This section of wall is actually a **living door** (see appendix B), a foul creature that has not eaten for a long, long time. A creature that touches the cold section of wall triggers the door's You Brought It On Yourself trait. The door then attacks, using its Frosty Vapor Cloud two rounds after combat begins.

When the characters enter the area, read or paraphrase the following:

This room is intensely colder than it has any reason to be. Ice crystals cover the walls, and your breath forms white clouds when you exhale. The bodies of two individuals in plate armor, a man and a woman, lie frozen on the floor.

From inside the room, the living door also resembles a section of blank wall and behaves as described above. A roughly 2-inch-deep layer of frost and snow covers the floor in the room, as well as the first 20 feet or so of the western hallway. The bodies of two Thracian fighters, one male and one female, lie frozen on the floor. Both are clad in fitted plate armor and wear plumed helmets of odd design. The man, named Danus, is already dead, but the woman, named **Epicaste** (see appendix C), revives if her body is removed from the room. Epicaste speaks only Ancient Thracian and Gnoll; if necessary, refer to the Languages section in the introduction if the characters attempt to communicate with her.

The secret door on the western wall leads to area 2-31F. Locating the door requires a successful DC 20 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check. The door is covered with a layer of ice that must be chipped away (AC 13, 5 hp, immunity to cold, necrotic, poison, and psychic damage) that must be chipped away before the door can be opened.

Treasure. Danus wears a suit of nonmagical plate armor, while Epicaste wears a suit of *+1 plate armor*. Both suits of armor are custom made and must be resized for a new owner.

AREA 2-14 – GNOLL GUARDPOST

This 25-by-40-foot room is filthy with offal, scraps of food, bits of armor, broken weapons, discarded boxes, broken furniture, shreds of cloth and leather, and a motley collection of bones. Despite the garbage, the area appears to serve as a barracks for a group of hyena-headed humanoids, several of whom are present in the room. Sets of double doors stand in the northeast and southwest corners of the chamber.

This room serves as the barracks for nine creatures, eight of which are currently in the room. The ninth inhabitant is the gnoll currently stationed in area 2-15. Due to the debris that fills the room, the ground inside the chamber is considered difficult terrain for creatures other than the gnolls and Ben-Grassus, who have become accustomed to moving through the trash. Both sets of double doors can be fortified with a heavy oak bar from the inside.

The chamber occupants include:

- Grotch, the leader, a **gnoll pack lord** armed with a greatsword (+5 to hit, 2d6 + 3 slashing damage) instead of a glaive and longbow
- Vredd, the second in command, a **gnoll** armed with a greatsword (+4 to hit, 2d6 + 2 slashing damage) instead of a shield, spear, and longbow (AC 13)
- A **gnoll** armed with a morningstar (+4 to hit, 1d8 + 2 piercing damage) instead of a spear and longbow
- A **gnoll** armed with a battleaxe (+4 to hit; 1d8 + 2 slashing damage, or 1d10 + 2 slashing damage if used with two hands) instead of a spear and longbow
- Two **gnolls** armed with greatswords (+4 to hit, 2d6 + 2 slashing damage) instead of shields, spears, and longbows (AC 13)
- A **gnoll** armed with a battleaxe (+4 to hit; 1d8 + 2 slashing damage, or 1d10 + 2 slashing damage if used with two hands) instead of a spear
- Ben-Grassus, an unarmed human **commoner** who speaks only Gnoll

The gnolls kidnapped Ben-Grassus from his village almost 30 years ago. He provides no assistance in combat, since he is rather dim-witted and scared of his masters.

The letter "A" on the map represents a spy hole that looks out onto the stairwell to the south. If there is movement on the stairs, there is a 75 percent chance that one of the gnolls alerts the rest of the guard post. The gnolls use this post to keep an eye on the lizardfolk, who are somewhat unpredictable under the leadership of their shaman, G'ruk.

Treasure. The seven gnolls carry a total of 45 sp and 37 gp among them.

The Unfortunate Fate of the Grassus Family

In the original *Caverns of Thracia* module, there were two human NPCs named Grassus. At first glance, one might assume the same NPC appeared in two locations. Notes on their apparent ages, languages known, and status among the beastfolk, however, varied drastically between their descriptions. The more senior Grassus (who is between 40 and 50 years old and seems content with his station as a clerk) appears in area 3-21A. (The senior Grassus's statistics can be found in appendix C.) The Grassus mentioned in area 2-14 serves as a slave, speaks only Gnoll, and might be two decades younger than the other Grassus.

Using some "artistic liberty," I decided to change the Grassus in area 2-14 to "Ben-Grassus," with the implication that he may be the son of the elder Grassus. Although the elder Grassus is content in his position, his loyalties to the beastfolk might shift if he discovers that the beastfolk have enslaved his missing son for the past three decades without his knowledge.

AREA 2-15 – A LONE GUARD

Compressed garbage covers the floor of this chamber to a depth of at least a foot. A hyena-headed humanoid armed with a longsword stands before a set of double doors in the southeast corner, in an area relatively free of trash. The figure snarls menacingly as you approach.

The figure is a **gnoll** armed with a longsword (+4 to hit; 1d8 + 2 slashing damage, or 1d10 +2 slashing damage if used with two hands) rather than a spear and longbow. He stands before the entrance to area 2-14, which is one of the few places in the room not covered with garbage, some of which is 1,000 years old! The ground in this area is considered difficult terrain for all creatures except the gnoll, who has become accustomed to moving through the debris.

A character who sounds the floor for hollow spaces and succeeds on a DC 18 Intelligence (Investigation) check discovers the 10-foot-square trapdoor marked on the map. The trash in this area must be cleared away before the trapdoor can be opened. Once opened, the trapdoor reveals a 20-foot shaft that descends to area 2-16.

Treasure. Characters who spend at least 10 minutes diligently searching the piles of trash are rewarded with 1d10 cp and 1d6 sp.

AREA 2-16 – A CHILLSOME HALL

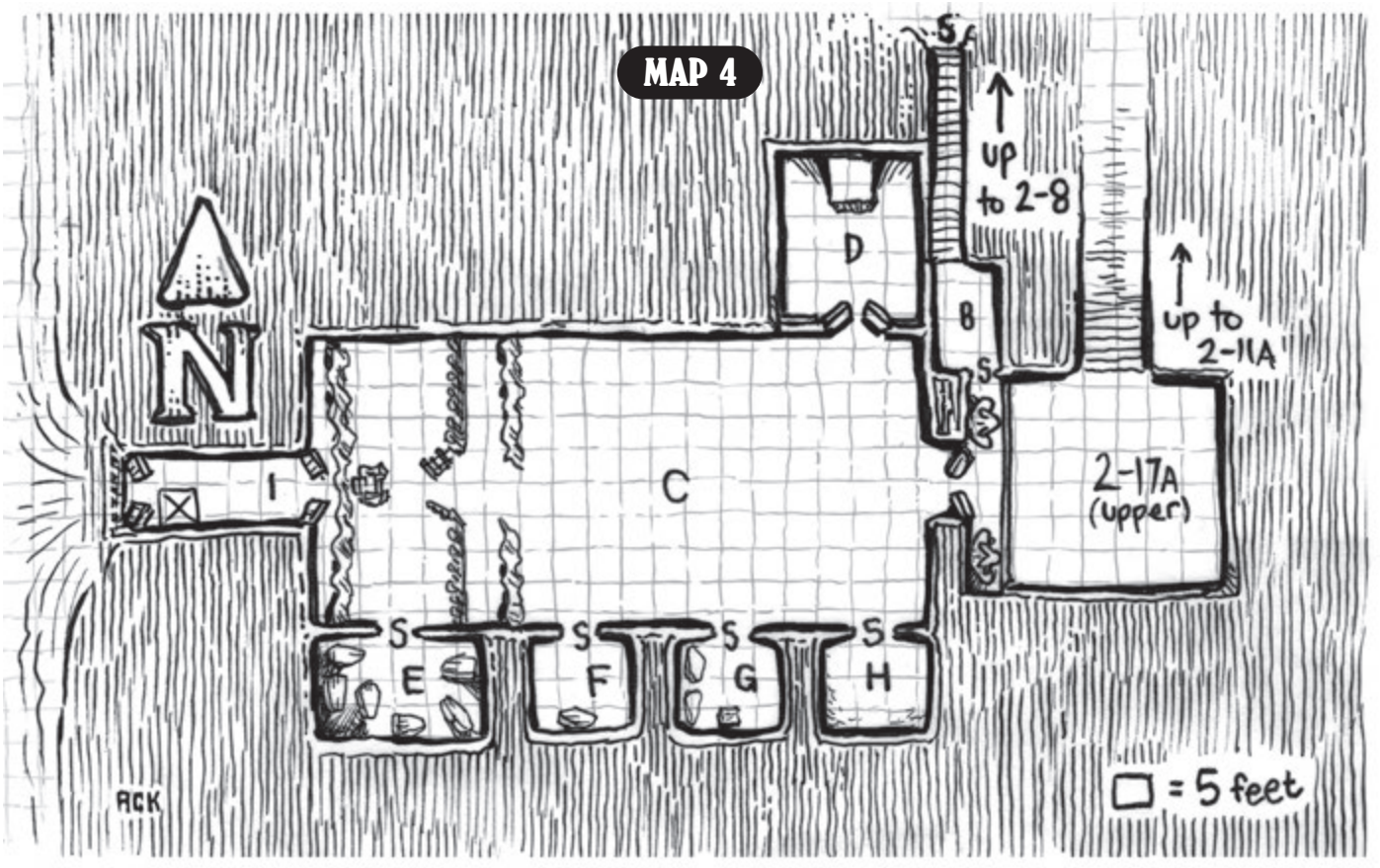
This dark, 10-foot-wide hallway is noticeably colder than expected. The corridor runs east-to-west, with the temperature dropping considerably towards the east. Crude, archaic paintings depicting humanoids engaged in various mundane activities decorate the walls.

Several inches of snowy frost cover the last 10 feet of the approach to area 2-13. The wall paintings were created by the people who first discovered the caverns and excavated many of the crypts in this area. The more advanced civilization that created King Agamemnos's underground palace developed from this culture. The statuary in area 2-18 date from the same period.

At the western end of the corridor, a trapdoor in the ceiling opens into area 2-15.

AREA 2-17A – A CHAMBER OF SKELETONS

The ceiling of this 30-foot-square room soars 35 feet above your heads. Human skeletons stand against the walls, completely



circling the room except for the entrance to the stairs to the north and a massive door on the western wall. The skeletons' eye sockets glow with an eerie orange light. A narrow ledge spans the western wall, roughly 20 feet above floor level.

See **Map 4** for areas 2-17A through 2-17I. A **skeleton** stands in each 5-foot-space around the room's perimeter (for a total of 18 skeletons). The skeletons attack living creatures that enter the room.

The 10-foot-wide door on the western wall is locked and requires a successful DC 15 Dexterity check with thieves' tools to open. A pair of stone gargoyles perch on the frame of the door to either side. Though inanimate, the gargoyles are strangely immune to all damage.

An identical door 20 feet directly above the lower one leads to area 2-17C, but a magical illusion conceals its presence. A successful *dispel magic* (DC 17) spell cast on this section of the wall dispels the illusion and reveals the door. Otherwise, a creature standing on the ledge can discover the door with a successful DC 10 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check. Like the door beneath it, the upper door is locked and requires a successful DC 15 Dexterity check with thieves' tools to open.

If a creature touches the lower door, an illusory mouth filled with sharp teeth appears on the surface of the door and bites the triggering creature, dealing 2 (1d4) piercing damage, or half as much damage on a successful DC 10 Dexterity saving throw. The illusory mouth appears up to four times before the enchantment fades. A *dispel magic* spell cast on the door removes the mouth permanently.

A secret door to the north leads to area 2-17B. Discovering the door requires a successful DC 16 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check.

AREA 2-17B — GUARDIAN OF SINGULAR COMBAT

In this small, 10-by-15-foot room stands a man dressed head to toe in finely crafted plate armor. He carries a shield and a longsword. His face is hidden behind his armor's visor. Without uttering a sound, the man speaks words into your mind. "I am the guardian. To pass me, I must be defeated and destroyed. Choose your champion."

The **guardian** (see appendix B) can't be surprised and doesn't attack until a single champion has been selected from among

the characters. If the characters do not choose a champion, the first character to attack the guardian becomes its opponent. At that point, the guardian becomes immune to all damage or effects from other creatures, which pass through its form as if it were immaterial smoke. For the duration of the encounter, the same is true for the champion. (A spell cast on the champion by one of their companions, for example, has no effect.) Once combat with the guardian begins, it is to the death. If the guardian is victorious, it magically regains hit points equal to half the damage it has taken and makes the challenge again to the remaining characters.

Neither of the secret doors in this room (the northern one leading to area 2-8 and the southern one leading to area 2-17A) are hidden from this side. Once combat with the guardian begins, both doors magically lock. Once locked, forcing open a door requires a successful DC 20 Strength check.

Treasure. If defeated, the guardian collapses into a pile of rusted armor. The guardian's sword, however, remains bright and shiny and now functions as a *+1 longsword*.

Development. If the adventurers leave the room without defeating the guardian, the guardian immediately regains any lost hit points.

AREA 2-17C – THE THRONE HALL

A pair of heavy curtains obscures the western section of this great, unlit hall. A 10-foot opening between the curtains would allow one to see further into the chamber, should they wish to approach.

A wall of thick iron bars with a 10-foot-wide gate in the center prevents intruders from approaching a gold-plated throne near the western wall. The gate in the bars is locked and requires a successful DC 18 Dexterity check with thieves' tools to open. The bars have AC 19, 27 hp, and immunity to poison and psychic damage.

The throne is decorated with monstrous faces and meaningless runic symbols. A creature that sits in the throne must make a DC 17 Wisdom saving throw. On a failed save, the creature's alignment is permanently changed to Chaotic Evil. A creature that merely touches the throne must instead make a DC 10 Constitution saving throw. On a failed save, the creature becomes paralyzed until a *dispel magic* spell or simi-

lar magic removes the effect. A Lawful Good creature that fails the save also takes 7 (2d6) psychic damage. Once a total of 24 psychic damage has been dealt in this way, the throne loses all magical properties, its gold plating disappears, and it becomes a worthless, nonmagical lead chair.

If the throne paralyzes a creature, a glistening wetness (an **ochre jelly**) appears on the northern wall and approaches the throne, focusing its attacks on the paralyzed creature.

A set of unbroken curtains run from floor to ceiling behind the throne. A pair of stone doors, each carved with the face of a beneficent looking man, stand behind curtains. Each of the four secret doors on the southern wall require a successful DC 17 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check to discover.

Treasure. Characters who manage to remove the throne from the chamber without touching it can sell the object for 5,000 gp.

AREA 2-17D – THE CRYPT OF THE MUMMY

A wax seal bearing some once-important signet covers the lock to this door. In addition, two heavy oak beams bar the door from this side. Apparently, someone wanted to make very sure that nothing entered—or escaped—the chamber beyond.

The wax seal on the lock bears the signet of a dead king of ancient Thracia and is at least 2,000 years old. Once the oak beams are removed and the wax seal scraped away, a character can pick the lock with a successful DC 15 Dexterity check with thieves' tools.

Inside the room, a 5-foot-wide, 3-foot-tall stone sarcophagus extends roughly 10 feet out from the north wall. The sarcophagus is featureless except for a stone lid. If a living creature touches the sarcophagus, the lid explodes, dealing 1 (1d3) piercing damage to each creature within 5 feet of it. A tall, gaunt **mummy** armed with a black sword then springs up from inside the sarcophagus and attacks. The mummy is an ancient king of Thracia, cursed to live forever due to his evil deeds. The mummy wields a magic longsword named *Thirster* (see appendix D) and alternates between Rotting Fist attacks and attacking with *Thirster:*

Thirster: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 1d8 + 3 slashing damage, or 1d10 + 3 slashing damage if used with two hands, plus 2d6 necrotic damage. If the target is a creature that isn't a construct or undead, it must succeed on a DC 13 Constitution saving throw or its hit point maximum is reduced by the amount of necrotic damage taken. This reduction lasts until the target finishes a long rest. The target dies if this effect reduces its hit point maximum to 0.

Treasure. Characters who defeat the mummy can claim *Thirster*. Lining the bottom of the sarcophagus are 2,000 gp in loose coins, a bone scroll case containing a *spell scroll* of *limited wish* (see appendix D), and a *potion of longevity*.

Another Way to Overcome Paralysis

If the characters do not have access to *dispel magic*, you can allow a paralyzed creature to repeat the Constitution saving throw on the end of each of its turns, ending the effect on itself on a success.

AREA 2-17E – A BURIAL VAULT

This 15-by-25-foot chamber contains two large, ornate sarcophagi. Six smaller, less formal, coffins surround them. The room seems deathly quiet.

Interred millennia ago, the occupants of this chamber have not been disturbed in ages. Two **wights** lie in the sarcophagi, while their honor guard of six **skeletons** occupy the coffins. The skeletons carry shields instead of shortbows (AC 15). If the characters disturb the sarcophagi or the coffins, all the undead rise from their resting places and attack.

AREA 2-17F – A SECOND BURIAL VAULT

This 15-foot-square vault contains a single, moldering skeleton resting atop a wooden bier. After a moment, the skeleton sits up, faces you and surprisingly, begins to speak…

The creature on the slab is a **skeletal commander** (see appendix B). In Ancient Thracian, the commander says, "Long have I lain here, storing up my hatred for those who have entombed my brethren. Now they shall be unleashed on those who have wronged them!" The commander then rises from the bier and walks toward the door. Unless the characters intervene, the commander moves to tap the doors to crypts 2-17E, 2-17G, and 2-17H (in that order). Any undead creatures in those areas rise to attack any living creatures they encounter in the immediate vicinity. The undead then begin an organized assault on living creatures elsewhere in the caverns.

AREA 2-17G – ANOTHER BURIAL VAULT

This 15-by-15-foot vault contains several sarcophagi. A large chest with a transparent crystal lid sits against the southern wall.

Two **doppelgangers** locked in this vault hide in the shadows until an opportune moment to reveal themselves arises. Sitting on the floor near the middle of the south wall is a chest with a lid made of solid, 3-inch-thick crystal. A sword, visible through the transparent crystal, lies at the bottom of the chest. The chest is immovable and the crystal unbreakable; however, if a *dispel magic* spell is cast on the chest, the lid disappears, allowing the sword to be removed.

Treasure. The sword inside the chest is a *-2 cursed longsword* (see appendix D). The chest also contains 3,000 gp. A character who makes a successful DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check discovers a hidden compartment accessible from the left side of the chest. The latch to this compartment is guarded by a crossbow trap that fires directly at the location one must be at to release the latch and open the compartment (+4 to hit, 1d6 piercing damage). Noticing the trap requires a successful DC 20 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check. Disabling the trap requires a successful DC 18 Dexterity check with thieves' tools. The hidden compartment contains a *potion of diminution,* a *potion of speed*, and *spell scrolls* of *magic circle* and *sticks to snakes* (see appendix D).

AREA 2-17H — YES, YOU GUESSED IT! STILL ANOTHER BURIAL VAULT

This 15-by-15-foot burial vault is empty except for a line of writing carved into the eastern wall.

Characters must stand within 5 feet of the eastern wall to read the carvings, which are written in Ancient Thracian. The writing reads, "I have been waiting for you." If the message is spoken aloud or if the adventurers remain in the room for more than a few moments, a disembodied voice speaks in the mind of each character: "Ahhh…it's been a long time! I have been waiting for you to come…ha ha ha ha ha!" At this point, the door to the room slams shut and magically seals. If the characters have prepared to keep the door open (such as jamming it with iron spikes), the door takes a round to close. Alternatively, a character can hold the door open by using an action with a successful a DC 20 Strength check.

Nothing happens to characters trapped inside the room, but they must find some way to escape before they die of starvation. Once closed, the door requires a DC 25 Strength check to force open. The door can also be destroyed (AC 17, 60 hp, damage threshold 20, immunity to cold, fire, necrotic, piercing, poison, psychic, and slashing damage).

AREA 2-17I – WILY WATER TRAP

This 10-foot-wide, 25-foot-long corridor ends at a pair of double doors to the west. There is a 5-foot-square opening in the ceiling approximately 20 feet down the hallway.

The ceiling of this hallway is 10 feet high, and there is a 5-foot-square shaft in the ceiling at the point marked "X" on the map. The shaft leads 70 feet upwards to area 1-20. The shaft has no handholds and requires a successful DC 20 Strength (Athletics) check to climb.

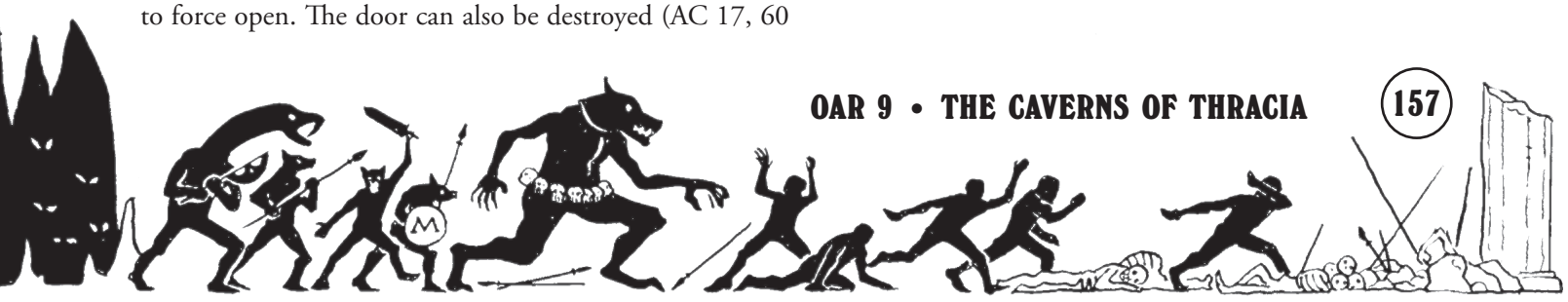
Touching the doors at the western end of the corridor causes the doors at the eastern end to magically close and seal. Opening the western doors releases water from the river through a metal grate behind the doors. The force of the water thrusts the doors open; closing them again requires a successful DC 21 Strength (Athletics) check. Unless the doors are closed, the room completely fills with water in 5 rounds. The eastern doors require a DC 25 Strength check to force open. The doors can also be destroyed (AC 17, 60 hp, damage threshold 20, immunity to cold, fire, necrotic, piercing, poison, psychic, and slashing damage).

AREA 2-18 – HALL OF ANCIENT STATUARY

This hall is nearly 100 feet long and contains two rows of five statues each. Each statue stands upon its own 6-foot-tall pedestal. Ten glowing pillars illuminate the chamber, casting an eerie, yellow-green light that seems to flicker like torchlight. The room's ceiling is 25 feet high.

A set of stairs on the east end of the chamber descend 10 feet into the room. Once each minute, the light cast by the pillars abruptly fades; 30 seconds later, the pillars flash into activity again like giant strobe lights. Creatures in the room when the pillars reactivate must make a DC 10 Constitution saving throw. On a failed save, the creature is blinded for 1 minute. Creatures with darkvision that fail the save also lose that trait for 1d6 × 10 minutes. Moving about the room triggers illusory noises that sound like traps being sprung or monsters on the prowl, and every so often, a low rumble can be heard throughout the space.

The rectangles marked with letters on the map represent the 6-foot-tall pedestals, upon which stand various statues, each bearing gemstone eyes and carved from a different type of stone.



LOCATION	STATUE	MATERIAL	EYES
A	Sphinx	Porphyry (volcanic)	Two quartz (200 gp each)
B	Hydra (8 heads)	Black marble	Two amber (25 gp each)
C	Minotaur	Soapstone	Two jade (400 gp each)
D	Dryad	Black basalt	Two citrines (50 gp each)
E	Griffon	White marble	Two fire opals (350 gp each)
F	Manticore	Black marble	Two red tourmalines (200 gp each)
G	Harpy	Green marble	Two green emeralds (400 gp each)
H	Hippogriff	Black lava	Two peridots (50 gp each)
I	Satyr	Pink granite	Two rubies set on diamonds (1,000 gp each)
J	Centaur	White marble	Two aquamarines (300 gp each)

Prying a single gemstone from a statue requires an action. The statues appear unguarded, but for every 10 gp worth of gems pried out of the statues, there is a cumulative 1 percent chance that the hall's guardian, the **Stone King** (see appendix C), bursts through the secret doors in the western wall. Make the check each time a gem is pried loose.

If the Stone King appears, read or paraphrase the following:

Suddenly, an 8-foot-tall statue of a male human bursts into the room. The figure has a regal bearing and appears to be carved from a single block of jet or onyx. Orange flames flicker from the statue's eyes and mouth, and the black crown upon its head is set with three large, violet gems.

The Stone King attacks any creature possessing a stolen gemstone. The Stone King can sense the location of any stolen gemstone and relentlessly pursues thieves throughout the caverns and beyond.

The secret doors in the northeast corner of the room blend into the architecture and require a successful DC 20 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check to discover. The secret doors in the western wall are undetectable by mundane means. However, if observed with a *detect magic* spell, or if a magical light is cast upon the doors, the image of two glowing handprints appear in the center of each door, roughly 4 feet above floor level. A creature that places their palms against the handprints can push open the doors.

AREA 2-19 – AUDIENCE CHAMBER OF THE STONE KING

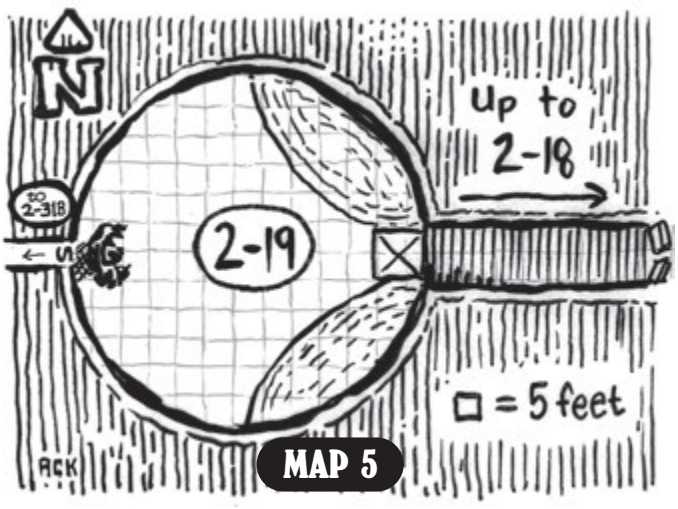
GM Note. This room is depicted in **Map 5**. Unless they previously encountered the Stone King in area 2-18, when the characters arrive an 8-foot-tall statue of a regal male human stands at the far end of the chamber. Adjust the following read-aloud text accordingly:

A 40-foot-long stairway descends into this 60-foot-diameter chamber. Placid pools of water flank the bottom of the stairs. Every so often, the pools gurgle, sending a subtle ripple across their surface. The chamber's walls seem to burn with a cold, violet fire.

The violet fire on the walls induces drowsiness. A creature that starts its turn inside the chamber must make a DC 17 Wisdom saving throw. On a failed save, the creature has disadvantage on ability checks and saving throws until the start of their next turn. On a success, the creature is immune to this effect for 1 minute. Despite the gurgling and rippling of the water, nothing hides beneath the pools.

The statue of the regal human is a construct known as the **Stone King** (see appendix C). The Stone King remains motionless unless the characters remove the gemstone eyes of the statues in area 2-18, remove the gems from the Stone King's crown, or attack the Stone King itself. The Stone King can sense the location of any stolen gemstone and relentlessly pursues thieves throughout the caverns and beyond.

Trap Door. A trap door in the floor immediately west of the stairs conceals a 10-foot-square, 20-foot-deep pit. Discovering the trap door requires a successful DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check. The trap door only opens if the Stone King uses one of its lair actions to open it.



Secret Door. A secret door is set in the chamber's western wall, 25 feet above floor level. The doors can't be spotted from the ground, but a character who climbs or flies to that height can spot the doors with a successful DC 20 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check. The doors lead to area 2-31B.

Treasure. Three large, violet alexandrite gems (worth 500 gp each) are mounted in the Stone King's crown.

AREA 2-20 – RUBBLE-FILLED CAVERNS

This cavern is over 100 feet wide and soars nearly that far overhead. A heap of broken rubble occupies the center of the space. Stalagmites and stalactites dot the southern end of the cavern. A passage of worked stone extends from the cavern to the south. Two stairways also lead out of the cavern, one to the north and one to the northeast.

This area is the bottom of the chasm in areas 1-27A and 1-27B; the rubble in the center of the cavern comes from those areas. A **swarm of rats** hides amid the rubble. If the rubble is disturbed, the rats squeal and attack. Bright light or loud noise in this area alerts the guards in area 2-21.

The staircase to the north leads to area 1-8, and the one in the northeast leads to area 2-21. The passage to the south leads to area 2-15.

AREA 2-21 – GUARDPOINTS AND PIT TRAPS

A short stairway rises about 10 feet to a landing flanked by four marble columns. Beyond the columns, the space opens into a much larger cavern. A mix of fine sand and loose pebbles

covers the ground, a stark contrast to the rubble-filled area to the southwest.

Gnoll Guards. Four **gnoll** guards, each armed with a halberd (+4 to hit, reach 10 ft., 1d10 + 2 slashing damage) instead of a spear and shield (AC 13), hide among the pillars at the top of the stairs. Noise or light from area 2-20 or from the cavern to the east alerts the guards.

Pit Traps. Two pit traps are concealed beneath the sand to the northeast of the landing. The pits are well disguised and each requires a successful DC 22 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check to spot. Characters with the Stonecunning trait have advantage on the check.

The smaller pit is filled with sharpened spikes. A creature that steps onto the trap must make a DC 12 Dexterity saving throw to avoid falling in. A creature that falls into the pit takes 2d6 bludgeoning damage from the 20-foot drop and an additional 2d10 piercing damage from the spikes. Once triggered, the pit's lid automatically closes, although thereafter its location is obvious, due to the disturbance in the sand around it.

The larger pit is much older, and the dungeon's current inhabitants are oblivious to its presence. Though it has been locked shut for 2,000 years, a portion of the trap's mechanism has recently corroded, allowing the trapdoor to function once again. A creature that steps onto the trap must make a DC 5 Dexterity saving throw to avoid falling in. On a successful save, the trap's lid remains shut, as the mechanism hasn't been oiled for hundreds of years. On a failure, the lid slowly creaks open before closing 1 round later, making a good deal of noise in the process. As opposed to the smaller trap to the northwest, this pit opens into a slide that sends victims southward into area 2-23D. Creatures who tumble down the slide take no damage from the journey. Once the trap's lid recloses, the mechanism that powers it jams. A creature can temporarily lift the lid with a successful DC 23 Strength check, but any object used to brace it open (short of an *immovable rod*) inevitably snaps after a few moments.

AREA 2-22 – STATUE OF A LONG-FORGOTTEN GOD

A pearly-white marble sculpture of a fair-looking male human stands in this semicircular alcove. Though more or less intact, the statue's head has been worn away by constant erosion, and stalactites hang off his chin and arms. A plaque is set into the statue's base.

This cavern was once a shrine to several now-forgotten gods and godlings of the ancient Thracian people. The plaque at the base of the statue reads in Ancient Thracian: "Oh Apollo, blessed healer, touch me and make me whole." A creature that speaks this prayer aloud while touching the statue magically regains 1d8 hit points. Each time a creature regains hit points in this way, roll a d4. On a 1, the statue's ancient magic is permanently exhausted.

To the west and north of the statue, two marble bas-reliefs depict Apollo's various heroic deeds. A character who makes a successful DC 16 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check notices that the western relief is actually a secret door. If the door is opened, a pair of spears spring forth to impale the triggering creature (+4 to hit, 1d6 + 4 piercing damage). Detecting the trap before the door is opened requires a successful DC 16 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check. A character using thieves' tools can disable the trap with a successful DC 15 Dexterity check.

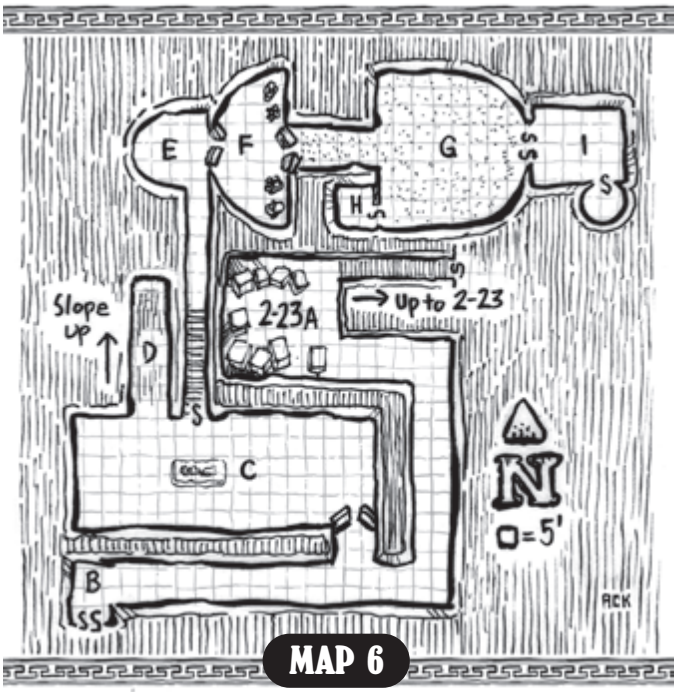
AREA 2-23 – THE TEMPLE OF ATHENA OR THE TEMPLE OF DESCENSION

A 20-foot-wide staircase leads up to a massive temple of classical design. Heavy Doric columns support the temple's roof. The base of the temple is carved with high-relief panels depicting scenes of, presumably, Thracian deities in combat with demons and sea monsters. A 10-foot-tall statue of a regal woman wearing a peplos, a loose himation, and a helm stands at the east end of the temple. The statue bears a shield and spear.

The 10-foot-square area before the statue is a teleportation pad. A creature that steps on the ground in this area is teleported to area 3-1. A character carrying a special marble from area 3-36 is teleported to that area instead.

A squad of eight **gnolls** armed with halberds (+4 to hit, reach 10 ft., 1d10 + 2 slashing damage) instead of spears guards this strategic location. Light or noise in the cavern alerts the gnolls, who hide among the pillars and wait until an opportunity to ambush the intruders presents itself. If outnumbered or if they take heavy losses, the gnolls retreat to the teleportation pad and gather reinforcements on Level 3 to prepare another ambush.

A secret door in the base of the temple's southeast corner is disguised as a carved panel. Noticing the panel requires a successful DC 17 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check. The door opens onto a narrow landing with a staircase leading down to area 2-23A. See **Map 6** for areas 2-23A through 2-23I.



MAP 6

Treasure. Each gnoll carries 3d6 sp and 1d4 gp.

AREA 2-23A – WEAPON STORAGE VAULT

This 30-foot-square room is filled with a dozen large, sealed wooden crates. There are two exits from this room, one in the northeast corner and one in the southeast corner.

The boxes are in remarkably good shape. If the characters open a box, roll 1d12 and consult the table below.

d12	Contents
1	Wrapped in oil-soaked cloth are 20 bronze longwords. These swords weigh half as much as regular longswords (1.5 pounds instead of 3 pounds) but after three hits they impose a -1 penalty to attack rolls until the blade is resharpened using smith's tools or a whetstone during a short rest.
2	30 spears wrapped in oil-soaked cloth.
3	A suit of *+1 plate armor*, carefully wrapped in oil-soaked cloth.
4	This box is open and contains 30 rusted and tarnished spears. There is a 40 percent chance that the spears crumble into dust if handled.
5	60 crossbow bolts wrapped in oilcloth.
6-8	Boxes 6, 7, and 8 contain the components of a special siege weapon, a repeating ballista (see appendix D).
9	60 crossbow bolts wrapped in oilcloth.
10	Four circular shields with the head of a bull emblazoned on them in green paint.
11	60 crossbow bolts wrapped in oilcloth.
12	Box of imports (see below).

Box of Imports. Box 12 is constructed differently from the others. Completely unfamiliar logographic writing is stamped onto the box. If read via a *comprehend languages* spell or similar magic, the writing translates as: "Wing Tu, weapon-maker for his excellency the Undying Emperor." Inside the box, preserved by some strange magic, is a collection of ancient weapons.

Quantity	Name	Description
10	Masterwork shuriken	Created from high grade steel, shuriken are star-shaped items with sharpened edges. Treat shuriken as darts. See appendix D for information about masterwork weapons.
1	Nunchaku	A pair of 12-inch-long black sticks joined by 4 inches of chain. If a creature that isn't proficient with martial weapons makes an attack with the nunchaku and rolls a 1 on the attack roll, the creature inflicts 1 (1d2) bludgeoning damage to itself. Nunchaku are otherwise treated as flails.
1	Masterwork nodachi	A 40-inch-long sword of strange design with an extremely light and sharp blade. Treat a nodachi as a longsword, but it does 1d10 slashing damage if used with one hand, and 1d12 slashing damage if used with two hands. See appendix D for information about masterwork weapons.
20	Skyrockets	A tube constructed of some type of heavy parchment and mounted on a short, thin stick. See appendix D for information about skyrockets.

Connecting Adventures

The creature in area 2-23C is intended to be a unique, reptilian monstrosity. The original *Caverns of Thracia* adventure did not provide much background on the origin of this bizarre creature.

If you have run, or plan to run, ***OAR #7: Dark Tower***, an easy way to connect these adventures is to replace the minotaur lizard with a Lesser Son of Set from OAR #7. This encounter might serve as the characters' introduction to the cult of Set and lead into *Dark Tower*. Alternatively, it could make an interesting follow up to *Dark Tower*, as the heroes discover the cult of Set was more widespread than originally believed.

Here are a few other plot seeds you might use to connect these two adventures:

- The lizardfolk in this adventure secretly belong to a cult of Set under the leadership of their shaman, G'ruk. Perhaps they search for the very creature trapped in this room.
- A traitor within the cult of The Dark One intentionally leads that cult to its destruction to gain Set's favor. The traitor knows one of Set's lesser sons exists somewhere within the caverns.
- Doors 1 through 4 in area 2-31A lead to other planes. Perhaps one (or more) of them lead to the hiding place of one of the Chosen Sons of Set.
- There is a partially submerged temple to Set in the swamp west of the caverns. The underground river that flows through Level 2 eventually emerges at this temple's doorstep.
- Ontussa, the gynosphinx in area 2-11, is aware of the minotaur lizard in area 2-23C. She might request that the characters dispatch the creature, saying *"The time is fast approaching that the children of Set will look to secure their positions in his hierarchy, as the god's time of weakness is almost upon us." Ontussa refuses to go into further detail, claiming that "the time is not yet right for you to learn more than this."* If pressed, Ontussa reveals that one of her many siblings watches over another of Set's children, as well as the cultists that support him, not far from a hamlet known as Thinis. If the characters seek out this place, Ontussa is sure more of their destiny will be revealed to them.

AREA 2-23B – DOORS TO THE HIDDEN TOMBS

A pair of large double doors mark the end of this passage. An ancient inscription is etched across both doors.

Written on the doors in Ancient Thracian is the following inscription: "*It is not given that man should interrupt the sleep of his ancestors. Do not transgress beyond this point*." Unless the GM wishes to expand this section of the dungeons further, nothing short of the will of the gods themselves can open these doors.

AREA 2-23C – DEMESNE OF THE MINOTAUR LIZARD

A horrible amalgamation of reptile, human, and cow lies unconscious or dead on a stone slab in the center of this large but otherwise empty 30-by-80-foot room. A set of double doors stands in the southeast corner of the room, while a passage on the north wall seems to be the bottom of a very steep slide.

The reptilian creature is a **minotaur lizard** (see appendix B) that has been in a slab-like trance for several centuries. Originally, the lizard guarded the secret door in the north wall, but the creature was forgotten long ago. Shortly after the characters enter the room, the lizard awakens and immediately attacks the intruders. If the lizard defeats the characters, it returns to its slumber after devouring their bodies.

A character who makes a successful DC 17 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check discovers a secret door in the north wall. The first creature to touch the door with the intention of opening it must succeed at a DC 16 Wisdom saving throw or be magically transformed into a **cat**. This transformation is permanent until a *greater restoration* spell or similar effect returns the creature to its true form. The second creature to touch the door is targeted by a barrage of arcane missiles and takes 31 (9d4 + 9) force damage. Thereafter, the door can be opened safely.

AREA 2-23D – SLIPPERY SLIDE FROM THE TRAP ABOVE

A long, steep slide deposits you, somewhat unceremoniously, at the northern edge of a large room.

The slide is the end of the pit trap described in area 2-21. Although quite steep, the minotaur lizard in area 2-23C can climb it, as can characters who make a successful DC 21 Strength (Athletics) check. However, the trap door at the top of the slide can't be opened from this direction.

AREA 2-23E – A SEALED-OFF RETREAT

The walls of this room are scorched and blasted as if by an explosion.

This was the route taken by the last human survivors of the beastfolk revolution that captured the palace of King Agamemnos over 1,000 years ago. Nothing of value remains in the room. The stone doors leading to area 2-23F on the eastern wall are barred on the opposite side and must be destroyed if the characters wish to enter from this area. The doors have AC 19, 27 hp, and immunity to piercing, poison, and psychic damage. To the south, an open passage leads to the stairway to area 2-23C.

AREA 2-23F – CHAMBER OF FORGOTTEN FINERY

The walls of this semicircular room are covered with stylized paintings of magic and sorcery. Statues of kings, queens, gods, and goddesses line the eastern wall. Double doors stand in both the eastern and western walls.

The statues are harmless and depict figures long lost to time. The edges of the stone doors on the eastern wall are dusted with a yellow mold. The mold is harmless but foreshadows what lies beyond the doors in area 2-23G.

Depending on how the characters entered the room, the doors to the west are barred from this side, while the eastern doors are barred from area 2-23G. While barred, the doors have AC 19, 27 hit points, and immunity to piercing, poison, and psychic damage.

AREA 2-23G – COURT OF FOUL FUNGUS

Every surface in this area is covered with a dry, golden fungus.

If the door to this room is forced open (from either area 2-23F or 2-23I), the gigantic **yellow mold** colony that has spawned in this chamber releases a 10-foot cube of spores directly in front of the door. The only way to destroy the mold is with exposure to sunlight or fire. Physically disturbing the mold (walking on it, attempting to physically attack it, searching through it, etc.) sends up another 10-foot cloud of spores.

A creature in the area of a cloud when the spores are released must succeed on a DC 15 Constitution saving throw or take 11 (2d10) poison damage and become poisoned for 1 minute. While poisoned in this way, the creature takes 5 (1d10) poison damage at the start of each of its turns. The creature can repeat the saving throw at the end of each of its turns, ending the effect on itself on a successful save.

This room was once a well-equipped magical laboratory, but now all that remains are shards of glassware and the few valuables described under Treasure, below. The secret doors are hidden beneath the yellow mold and require a successful DC 20 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check to spot. Depending on how the characters entered the room, the doors to the west may remain barred from this side.

Treasure. The only items of value in this former lab are some small gems used in experiments (worth 300 gp total), a coil of gold wire (worth 100 gp), and a coil of silver wire (worth 50 gp).

AREA 2-23H – AN EMPOWERING GLOBE

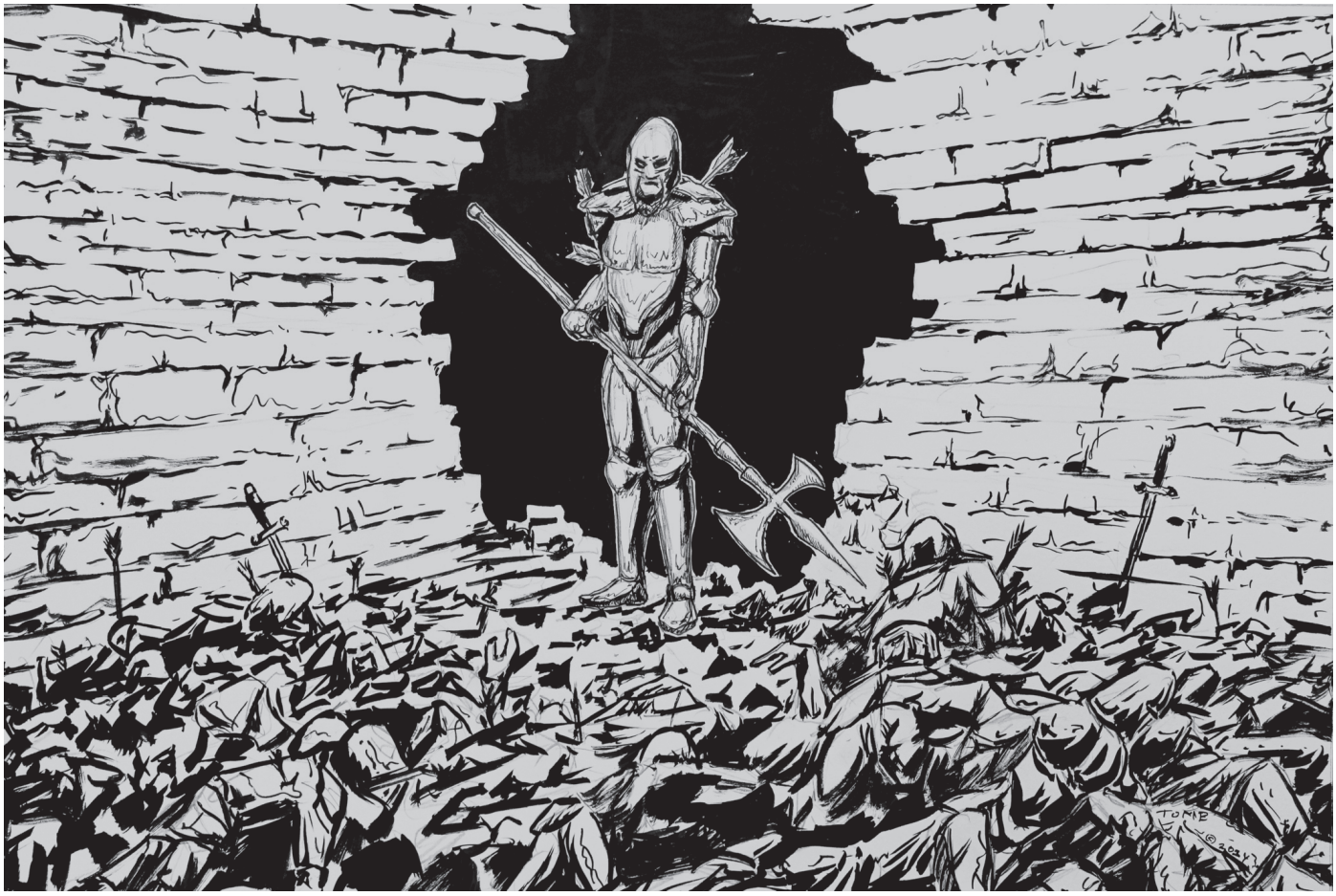
In the center of this small, square chamber is a stone table, upon which rests an 8-inch-diameter glass globe radiating a golden light. On a bookshelf against the northern wall are five scroll cases, each sealed with a different color wax.

The contents of the scroll cases are as follows.

Red Seal. The seal on this scroll case is whole and unbroken. Written on the scroll in Modern Thracian is an inventory of the magic items once stored on the shelves of this room, all of which are now empty. The scroll dates from the same period as King Agamemnos and the beastfolk revolution.

Black Seal. The scroll in this unopened case is written in the Ancient Thracian language. It predates the period of King Agamemnos by about 1,000 years and describes the wondrous statues in area 2-18, carefully noting their jeweled eyes. The scroll fails to mention any type of guardian, however.

Blue Seal. This scroll case is protected by a *glyph of warding*. The glyph is nearly invisible and requires a successful DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation) check to notice. Opening the scroll case triggers the glyph. Each creature in a 20-foot-radius sphere when the glyph is triggered takes 5d8 damage, or half as much damage on a successful DC 15 Dexterity



saving throw. The GM can select the damage type dealt by the explosion (acid, cold, fire, lightning, or thunder).

Green Seal. This scroll case contains *spell scrolls* of *darkvision*, *dispel magic*, *fireball*, and *invisibility 10-foot radius* (see appendix D).

Gold Seal. The seal on this case has been broken and resealed several times. The scroll inside serves as the globe's maintenance log and describes its functions (see **player handout 6**).

The golden globe is the power source for the teleportation system between Levels 2 and 3 (areas 2-23, 3-1, and 3-36). If the globe is destroyed (AC 13, 2 hp, immunity to poison and psychic damage), the system no longer functions and any creature on Level 2 is trapped until an alternate method of transportation is devised or discovered. A new glass globe, a casting of the *teleport* spell, and the additional expenditure of an 8th-level spell slot are required to create a replacement. Casting *dispel magic* on the globe suppresses the teleportation system for 30 minutes. If the globe is removed from the room, the teleportation system ceases to function until the globe is replaced.

AREA 2-23I – THE LAST STRONGHOLD

The floor of this rectangular room is littered with the corpses of numerous human warriors, who apparently made their last stand in this chamber. Or maybe they aren't all corpses yet…one of them just moved.

It was through this room that the remnants of King Agamemnos's court made their escape. The dead and mortally wounded were left behind. If Epicaste from area 2-13 accompanies the adventurers, she can identify several of the corpses as former friends and acquaintances.

One of the bodies in the room is still alive. Powerful magic has kept **Anteus** (see appendix C), a soldier in the King's Guard, clinging to life for nearly 1,100 years. Anteus's vocal cords have atrophied over the years and he has lost the power of speech. If any characters can speak Tribal Thracian or Modern Thracian, Anteus might be able to understand them (see Languages, in the adventure introduction). Unless he is made to understand that the adventurers are not allies of the beastfolk, Anteus attacks.

Discovering the secret door in the southeast corner of this room requires a successful DC 17 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check. The door opens onto a circular shaft that connects area 2-12 to area 3A-1. From this point, it is 60 feet up to the floor of area 2-12 and 60 feet down to the floor of area 3A-1. Characters who fall from this area take 6d6 bludgeoning damage. The walls of the shaft are smooth and require a successful DC 20 Strength (Athletics) check to climb. However, a creature that uses their bare hands and feet to climb discovers that their extremities act like suction pads while inside the shaft, granting them a climb speed equal to their walking speed.

Treasure. Anteus wears a suit of *+1 plate armor* and carries a shield.

AREA 2-24 – GIANT SPIDER

The northeast corner of this cavern is thick with webbing.

A **giant spider** resides in this corner of the cavern. The other creatures on this level know to avoid this area.

AREA 2-25 – A DETERIORATED OUTER SANCTUARY

Low-relief sculptures of warring deities decorate the walls of the 30-foot-square temple. Two rows of columns, one to the east and one to the west, line the sides of the area. Judging from the peeling paint that covers the sculptures, the place has sat vacant for some time. Passages to the north, east, and west lead out of this area, while a double door stands in the middle of the southern wall.

Four **gnolls** in areas 2-28 and 2-29 fire light crossbows through arrow slits in the eastern and western walls on any creature in this chamber they do not recognize. The arrow slits have been cunningly carved into the sculptured walls and require a successful DC 20 Wisdom (Perception) check to spot, even after the firing starts. The ports are only a few inches wide and can be closed from the inside, if necessary.

AREA 2-26 – A DRAPED INNER SANCTUARY

Heavy curtains cover the east, west, and south walls of this 30-foot-square room. The area reeks of some strong, animal scent, and large piles of scat dot the floor.

Two trained **war bears** (see appendix B) and their three **gnoll** trainers occupy the room. The gnolls are armed with morningstars (+4 to hit, 1d8 + 2 piercing damage) instead of spears. The set of double doors is hidden behind the curtain in the southeastern corner of the room. The doors require a successful DC 19 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check to spot.

Treasure. Each of the gnolls carries 1d6 sp and 1d12 gp.

AREA 2-27 – GNOLL BARRACKS

This room has been converted into a makeshift barracks, with bedding areas for a dozen creatures seemingly cobbled together from various materials scavenged from elsewhere in the caverns.

Three bloodthirsty **gnolls** occupy this room. The gnolls wield battleaxes (+4 to hit; 1d8 + 2 slashing damage, or 1d10 + 2 slashing damage if used with two hands) instead of spears and longbows.

Noticing the secret doors in the north wall of this chamber requires a successful DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check. The gnolls know the location of the secret doors.

Treasure. Each of the gnolls carries 1d6 sp and 1d2 gp.

AREA 2-28 – A CONVERTED CRYPT

It appears some effort has been made to convert this 15-by-20-foot space into squalid living quarters. The floor is littered with junk and rubbish.

The three **gnolls** in this room fire crossbows through a pair of arrow slits in the eastern wall at anyone in area 2-15 they don't recognize. Instead of spears and longbows, the gnolls wield battleaxes (+4 to hit; 1d8 + 2 slashing damage, or 1d10 + 2 slashing damage if used with two hands) and light crossbows (+3 to hit, range 80/320 ft., 1d8 + 1 piercing damage).

Treasure. Each of the gnolls carries 1d4 sp and 1d8 gp.

AREA 2-29 – ANOTHER CONVERTED CRYPT

This room is essentially the same as area 2-28, except the arrow slits looking out into area 2-25 are on the west wall rather than the east. Three **gnolls** occupy this room. Two of the **gnolls** are identical to those in area 2-28, while the third is a **gnoll pack lord** armed a battleaxe (+5 to hit; 1d8 + 3 slashing damage, or 1d10 + 3 slashing damage if used with two hands) and a light crossbow (+4 to hit, range 80/320 ft., 1d8 + 2 piercing damage) instead of a glaive and longbow. The gnoll pack lord can use the battleaxe and light crossbow as part of its Multiattack action.

Treasure. Each of the gnolls in this room carries 1d4 sp and 1d8 gp.

AREA 2-30 – LIZARDFOLK BARRACKS

This room seems to serve as a makeshift barracks, with a half-dozen "beds" of whatever material could be scavenged heaped into piles on the floor.

The six **lizardfolk** stationed in this room are under the command of the gnoll pack lord in area 2-29. Instead of javelins, each lizardfolk carries four darts (+4 to hit, range 20/60 ft., 1d4 + 2 piercing damage). Each of the lizardfolk can speak broken Gnoll in addition to Draconic, and one of the lizardfolk also speaks Common. The one that speaks Common may offer to ransom himself and the other lizardfolk with tales of the great treasure hidden in area 2-9, although he won't reveal anything about the creatures or traps that protect the treasure, unless magically compelled to do so.

Noticing the secret doors in the north wall of this chamber requires a successful DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check. The gnolls and lizardfolk know the location of the secret doors.

Development. If things go badly for them, they abandon their post and retreat to their tribe in area 2-7. One of the lizardfolk has recently discovered the secret doors in the southeast corner of area 2-26, and there is a 40 percent chance they use this avenue of escape, if possible.

AREA 2-31 – THE RISING DEMON IMAGE

A black granite statue of a demon with amber eyes dominates the middle of this 40-foot-diameter chamber. An odd smell, like that of rotten eggs but just barely perceptible, permeates the space.

The demon is the statue that rises in flames into area 1-27A. Its existence is unknown to the denizens of the caverns. The statue is in excellent shape, despite the passage of time. Characters who make a successful DC 18 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check can pinpoint the statue's hollow mouth as the source of the odd smell (methane). Disturbingly, the statue magically rotates in place to face any good-aligned cleric in the room. If more than one such cleric occupies the room, the statue faces the one of the highest level.

Faded plaster frescoes conceal a 10-foot-wide secret door in the southern wall. Detecting the door requires a successful DC 20 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check. Before the door can be opened, the plaster covering it must be chipped away. Behind the door, a set of crumbling stairs descends to the west. Covered with centuries of dust and rubble, the stairs are treated as difficult terrain. Stalactites hang from the ceiling, and stalagmites dot the stairs and landing. In several places, the speleothems have grown together and nearly block the passage, possibly forcing Medium and larger creatures to squeeze in order to proceed.

Treasure. The eyes of the demon statue are a pair of unusually large faceted amber gemstones worth 300 gp each.

AREA 2-31A – THE GRAND TEMPLE OF THE REPTILE RACE

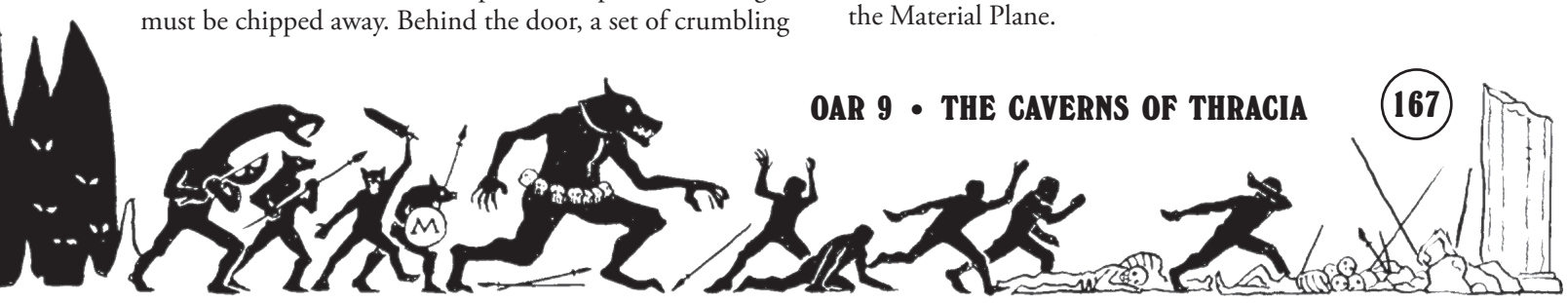
GM Note. Areas 2-31A through 2-31J are quite old; older, in fact, than the ancient Thracian tombs in areas 2-13 through 2-19. Their use ended soon after the arrival of the ancient Thracians. Curiously, humans are not portrayed in any but the most recent frescoes, and then only as sacrifices of the reptile-headed creatures that once occupied the complex. **Map 7** depicts areas 2-31A through 2-31AJ.

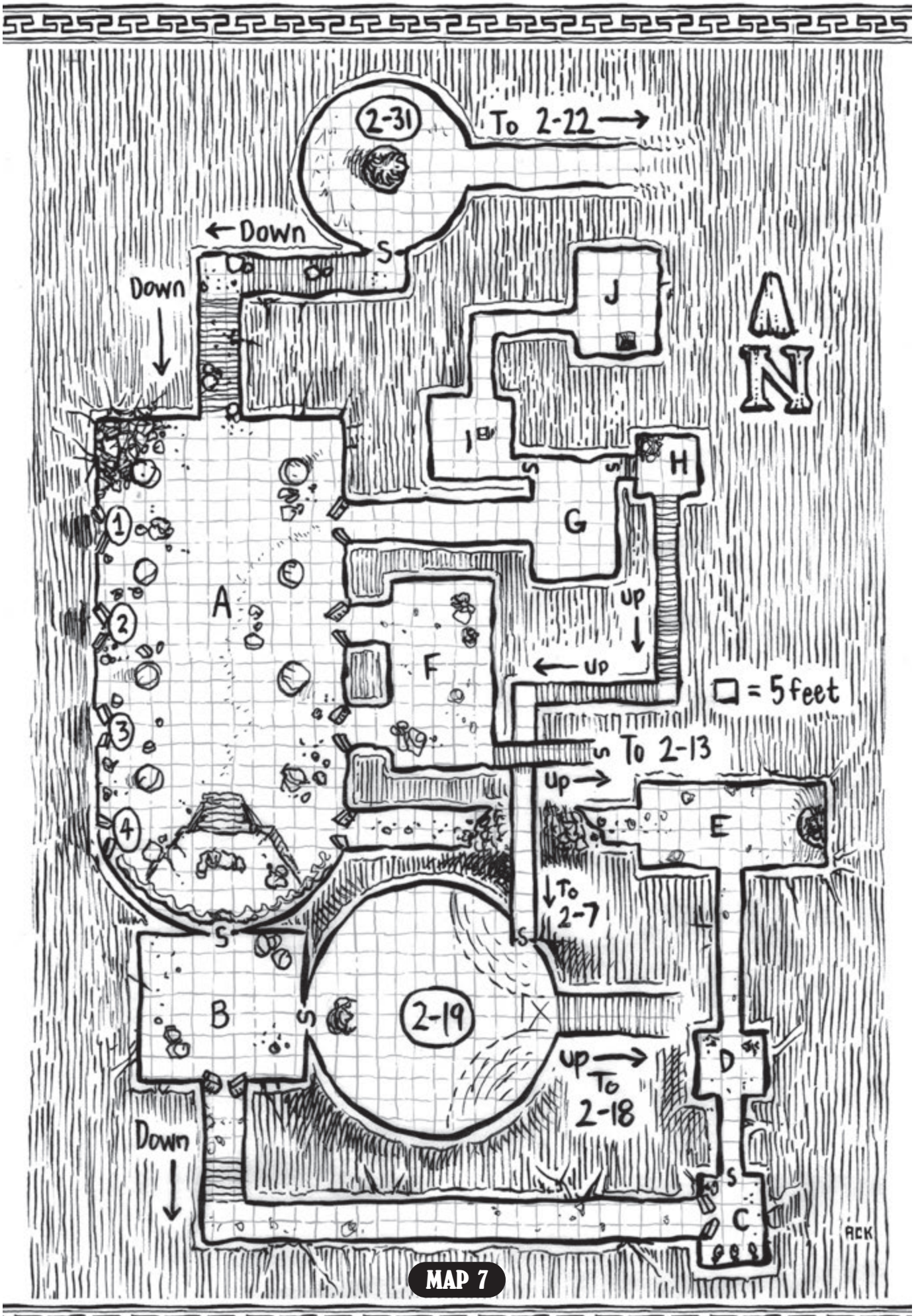
At one time, this vast hall might have been a throne room or temple, but it has long since fallen into ruin. Dust covers the floor throughout the chamber, and the ceiling bristles with stalactites that occasionally meet the stalagmites rising from the floor. The hall's northwest corner has collapsed, and it seems that the walls are buckling in several other places as well. A stairway serves as the northern entrance of the room, while a raised altar fills the chamber's southern end. Eight columns, four to the east and four to the west, run along the length of the hall. Between each pair of columns stands a door.

Hundreds of highly intelligent lizardfolk once used this vast hall to worship their immortal giant king. A character who makes a successful DC 12 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception or Survival) check spots a path through the dust and rubble leading from the door to area 2-31G to the steps of the raised altar, where it seems that a creature of some kind has repeatedly kneeled.

The doors along the east wall are great stone constructions, each 10 feet wide and 15 feet tall. There is a 25 percent chance each door opens freely. Otherwise, the doors are struck and require a DC 25 Strength check to force open. The door to the southern end of room 2-31F is blocked by a formation of stalagmites, which must be destroyed before the door can be accessed. The stalagmites have AC 15, 25 hp, and immunity to poison and psychic damage.

The four doors on the west wall are similar in appearance to their eastern counterparts, but they do not lead to places on the Material Plane.




2-31
To 2-22
Down
Down
S
J
N
I
H
G
1
2
3
4
A
F
up
up
□ = 5 feet
To 2-13
up
E
To 2-7
S
S
B
2-19
up
To 2-18
D
Down
S
C
ACK

MAP 7

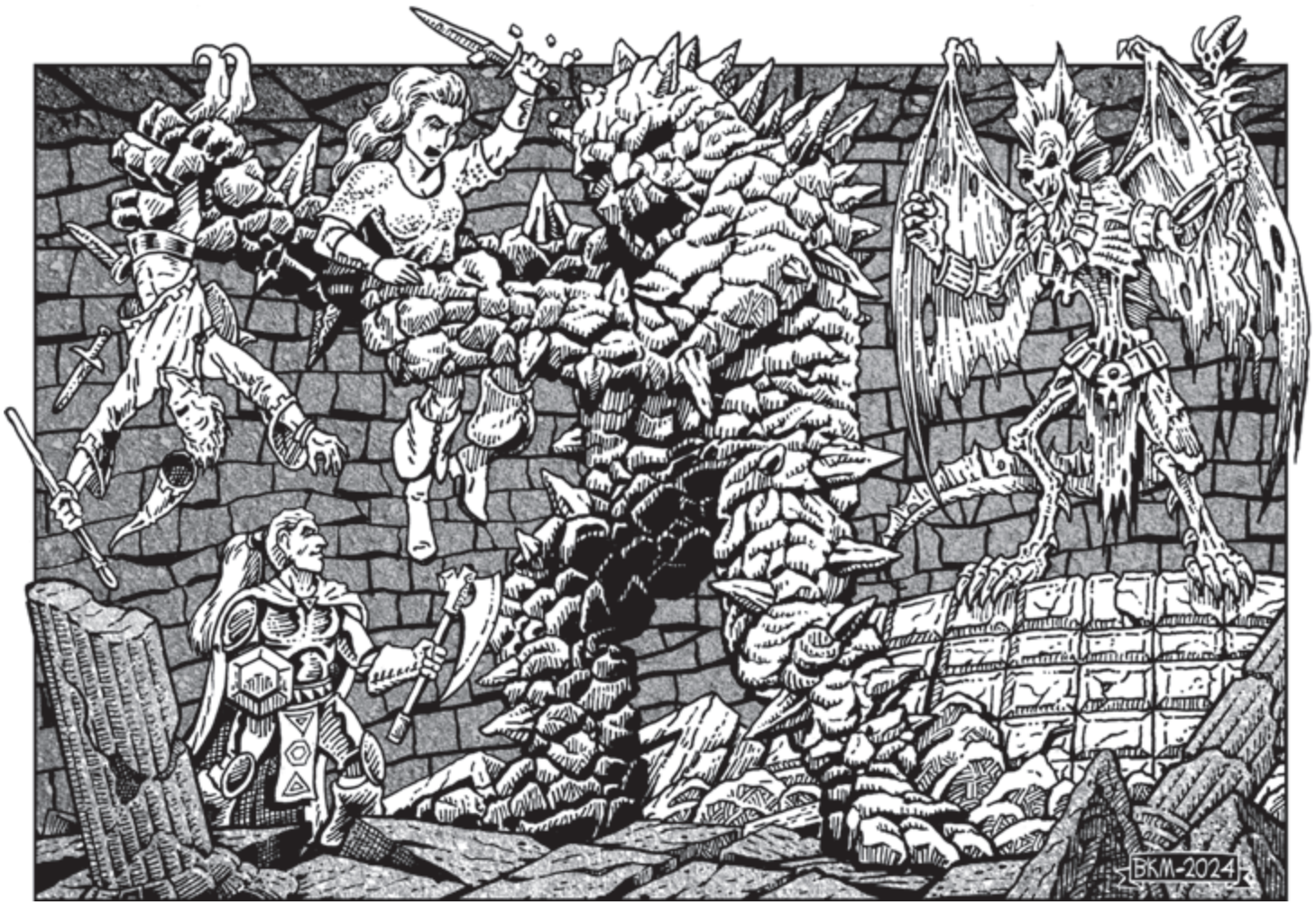
- Door 1 leads to the Ethereal Plane. This door is enchanted with an *arcane lock*. Forcing open the door requires a successful DC 35 Strength check (or DC 25 if the *arcane lock* is dispelled).
- Doors 2 and 4 are blocked by stalagmites and can't be accessed until the stalagmites are chipped away (AC 15, 25 hp, and immunity to poison and psychic damage). The magic that once powered the doors has faded; if opened, they reveal nothing but a blank stone wall behind them.
- Door 3 is enchanted with an *arcane lock*. Forcing open the door requires a successful DC 35 Strength check (or DC 25 if the *arcane lock* is dispelled). The door opens into a 10-foot-square room that exists on the Astral Plane. Creatures in this room feel as if their astral bodies continually flow in and out of their material forms. While inside the room, a creature can cast *astral projection*, targeting themselves only, without material components.

The stairs at the south end of the room ascend 10 feet to a ceremonial altar flanked by rotting tapestries ruined beyond recognition. All that remains of the altar is a crumbling marble podium that collapses into dust if touched. A set of double doors is hidden behind the tapestries. If touched, the tapestries disintegrate, revealing the doors beyond.

AREA 2-31B – A CEREMONIAL CHAMBER WITH A VIEW

Flaking plaster covers the walls of this 35-by-45-foot room. Images of reptile people dressed in jeweled robes worshiping a gigantic, winged creature are still discernible amongst the faded frescoes.

As the original reptile race waned, this chamber was used to keep an eye on the encroaching humans. The secret doors in the northern and eastern walls are visible from this side. The eastern doors open 25 feet above the floor level of area 2-19. One of the double doors on the southern wall is permanently jammed shut, but the other opens without effort.



AREA 2-31C – URNS AND ASHES

This 15-by-20-foot room is filled with shards of pottery and a few unbroken ceramic urns. An enormous stalactite encompasses part of the room's northern wall.

The secret door in the north wall is hidden behind the mineral glaze of the massive stalactite and requires a successful DC 18 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check to locate.

Treasure. The urns contain nothing but ashes. That said, the quality of the pottery is excellent and each of the four surviving pieces is worth 1,000 gp to the right buyer (a sage or someone interested in ancient history, for example).

AREA 2-31D – A PRELIMINARY CRYPT

A 5-foot-wide hallway exits through the southern wall of the 15-foot-square room. Mounds of debris flank a closed door on the northern wall.

A pair of **lizardfolk skeletons** (see appendix B) rise from the debris as soon as the characters enter the room. Each of the skeletons wears a *ring of protection from turning* (see appendix D).

Development. When reduced to 0 hit points, the lizardfolk skeletons (along with their magical rings) return to dust.

AREA 2-31E – THE SEPULCHER OF THE IMMORTAL KING

This 45-by-20-foot chamber is as decrepit as the rest of this complex of passages. A stone pedestal stands against the eastern wall. Perched atop the pedestal is the mummified form of what appears to be a cross between a lizardfolk and a gargoyle, a set of parchment-thin, bat-like wings sprouting from its hunched, scaly back. Piled on the floor around the pedestal are thousands of gold and silver coins, perhaps left as a sacrifice or tribute long ago.

The mummified corpse is **The Immortal King** (see appendix C), a 10-foot-tall, incredibly ancient lich. Once the characters enter the room, the King slowly shifts its head to face the intruders. At the same time, the creature's eyes flare with a malevolent glow.

The western side of this room opens into a 10-foot-wide corridor that runs a short distance before being sealed off by a cave-in.

Treasure. Piled about the Immortal King's pedestal is 5,000 sp, 16,000 gp, a *dragon slayer longsword*, a *potion of fire resistance*, and a *wand of paralysis*.

AREA 2-31F – ANOTHER ROOM OF UNIDENTIFIABLE PURPOSE

The original purpose of this rubble-strewn room is indiscernible. Stalactites and stalagmites grow from the ceiling and floor.

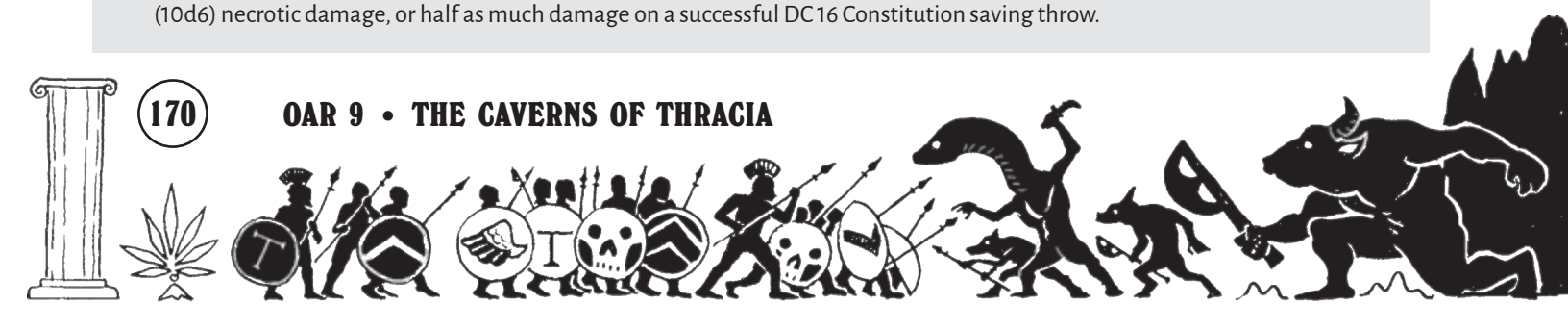
The Immortal King's Tactics

The Immortal King does his best to avoid placing himself in direct danger. If combat begins, his first action will likely be to cast *teleport*, arriving near the altar in area 2-31A. He then casts *conjure elemental* to summon an **earth elemental** to do his fighting for him. The Immortal King senses if the magical rings in area 2-31D are destroyed and teleports away just as adventurers arrive in this room. Alternatively, he might cast *haste* upon himself to ensure he can react faster than his opponents.

If the GM wishes (especially if the characters are not having sufficient difficulty dealing with the lich), the Immortal King can use the following Lair Actions.

LAIR ACTIONS. When fighting inside the sepulcher, the Immortal King can take a lair action to cause one of the following effects on initiative count 20 (losing initiative ties). The Immortal King can't use the same effect two rounds in a row.

- The Immortal King rolls a d6 and regains a spell slot of that level or lower. If he does not have any expended slots of that level or lower, nothing happens.
- The Immortal King targets one creature he can see within 20 feet and forms a temporary psychic link with it. Whenever the Immortal King takes damage, the target must make a DC 16 Wisdom saving throw. On a failed save, the Immortal King takes half damage and the target takes the remaining damage. This effect lasts until initiative count 20 on the next round, until the target moves more than 20 feet away from the Immortal King, or until the Immortal King or the target leaves this room.
- The Immortal King calls forth a wave of necrotic energy and directs it at one target he can see within 50 feet. The target takes 35 (10d6) necrotic damage, or half as much damage on a successful DC 16 Constitution saving throw.



Due to the stalactites and stalagmites, the floor within this room is difficult terrain. The narrow stairs in the southeast corner of the room lead up 25 feet to area 2-13.

The secret door leading into that area is covered by ice and requires a successful DC 20 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) to locate from this side.

AREA 2-31G – A MAKESHIFT CHAPEL

Footprints in the dust lead into this room. However, the floor of the 20-by-30-foot room itself seems to have been recently swept free of dust. A crude, humanoid-shaped stick figure with wings and a tail has been drawn in ochre on the southern wall.

G'ruk the Fish-finder, Lizardfolk Shaman (see appendix C) created this makeshift chapel after he discovered the secret door northeast of the lizardfolk encampment in area 2-7. He devoted the area to his private worship of the Immortal King, entirely unaware that the creature still exists.

Each of the secret doors in the northern part of this room can be discovered with a successful DC 16 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check.

AREA 2-31H – SECRET LAIR OF THE LIZARDFOLK SHAMAN

This 15-foot-square chamber seems to be a private living area. A makeshift bed of rags and a small sack occupies one corner of the room.

There is a 20 percent chance that **G'ruk the Fish-finder, Lizardfolk Shaman** (see appendix C) is here when the characters arrive. The small sack contains several strips of dried human meat, a handful of worthless glass beads, and a few sharpened stone implements. The stairs to the south ascend 75 feet, eventually joining up with area 2-7.

AREA 2-31I – A SEALED ROOM

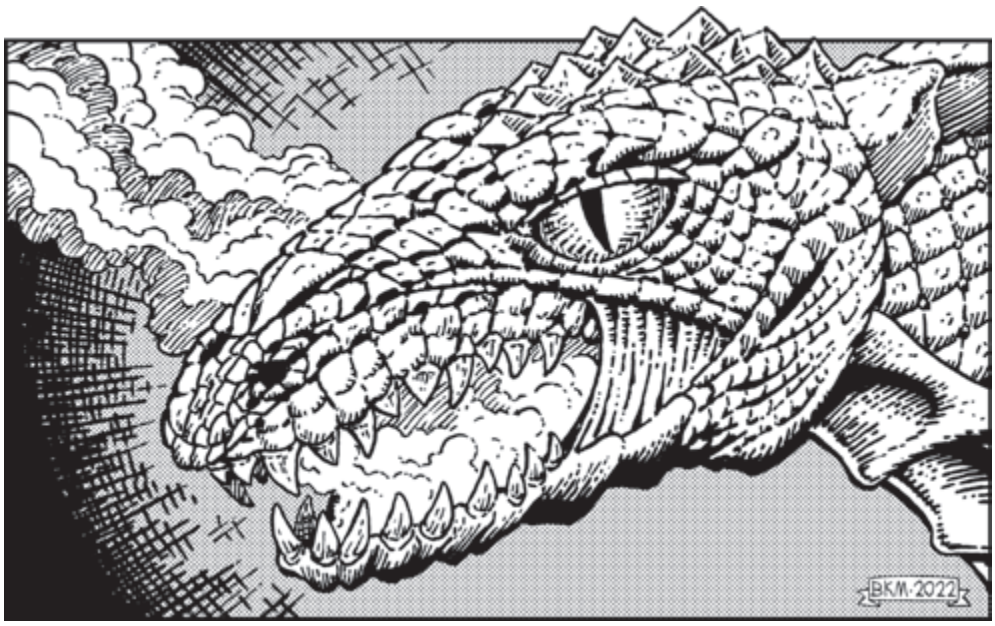
Apparently, this 20-foot-square room has been sealed off from the chamber to the east for quite some time, as its walls and contents remain intact. Frescoes depict a human and several lizardfolk being ritually sacrificed by a group of robed lizardfolk priests. The image of a winged reptile creature wearing a silver crown looms large above the scenes. In the center of the room, a golden mask with a demonic countenance rests atop a 3-foot cube of granite. Two passages, one to the southeast and one to the north, are the only exits from the room.

Treasure. The mask is designed to fit the facial features of a lizardfolk. It is worth 2,000 gp.

AREA 2-31J – THE SECRET SACRIFICIAL SHAFT OF THE LIZARD PRIESTS

Frescoes in this 20-by-25-foot room depict a giant, winged lizardfolk devouring huge numbers of humans, lizardfolk, and dinosaurs. The only other exit from the room seems to be a 5-foot-square shaft in the floor against the south wall.

The winged lizardfolk depicted in the frescoes is the Immortal King from area 2-23E. The shaft in the floor descends 40 feet before opening onto the 200-foot-high ceiling of Level 3. A creature that stumbles into the shaft takes 20d6 bludgeoning damage from the fall.



CHAPTER SIX

LEVEL 2A

This sub-level is depicted on **Maps 8** and **9**.

GENERAL FEATURES

Construction. Corridors are 10 feet high, unless otherwise noted. Individual room ceilings vary by description. As depicted on the map, walls are either natural cave walls or ancient worked stone. Both types of walls have numerous handholds and imperfections and can be climbed with a successful DC 15 Strength (Athletics) check.

Doors. A standard wooden door in the dungeon has AC 15 and 20 hit points. Unless noted in the individual room description, a locked door requires thieves' tools and a successful DC 18 Dexterity check to unlock or a successful DC 20 Strength check to break down.

Ambient Temperature. The air here is warmer than the levels above and below, and the finished stone floors are noticeably warm to the touch. A sub-floor system of pipes runs throughout this level, heating the rooms and making them more comfortable than the standard 50 degrees Fahrenheit one would expect at this depth. Because of this warmer temperature, the elite lizardfolk mercenaries have claimed this level as their own.

Secret Doors. Locating a secret door requires a successful Wisdom (Perception) check against the DC stated in the room description.

Level Connections: There are multiple entrances to this level. These include:

- A mud-filled sinkhole from near area E descends to area 2A-10
- A subterranean waterfall in area 2-1 drops down into area 2A-1
- A cave passage from area 2-4 descends to area 2A-3
- A waterfall behind the wall of area 2-5 descends to area 2A-5
- The teleport pad in area 2A-9F connects with Oceanus, a distant island.

WANDERING MONSTERS

The Caverns of Thracia makes extensive use of wandering monsters. Every 10 minutes the characters spend exploring Level 2A, there is a 1 in 6 chance of a wandering encounter. Should a result indicate an encounter that could not possibly be encountered in the current location, no encounter occurs. No random encounters take place in area 2A-15. Roll a 1d8 to determine the encounter.

d8	Result
1	Lizardfolk patrol A
2	Lizardfolk patrol B
3	Giant alligator snapping turtle
4	Stirges
5	Young lizardfolk
6	Elite lizardfolk mercenaries
7	Holleran and elite lizardfolk mercenaries
8	-Random encounter from Level 2

LEVEL 2A WANDERING MONSTER DESCRIPTIONS

Giant Alligator Snapping Turtle. The **giant alligator snapping turtle** (see appendix B) that lairs in area 2A-7 occasionally moves around to hunt. It uses its aquatic camouflage to ambush potential prey. Once it grabs hold of something, it does not let go. Once its prey stops struggling, the turtle retreats to its lair to consume its meal. This encounter only occurs in areas 2A-1 through area 2A-8. If this result is indicated in another section of the dungeon, roll again.

Holleran. Holleran, the **lizardfolk king** that resides in area 2A-5, moves about with 2d4 + 1 **elite lizardfolk** mercenaries (see appendix B) from areas 2A-12. They could be out and

about training in tactics or returning from a surface raid. They don't immediately attack the characters but remain wary while Holleran interacts with them.

Lizardfolk Mercenaries. This band of 1d4 + 1 **elite lizardfolk** mercenaries (see appendix B) serve Holleran, the lizard king who resides in area 2A-5. The group is normally encountered in area 2A-12 (adjust as needed), but is running some errand for Holleran. The lizardfolk begin the encounter indifferent towards the party, but they are eager to put all their combat training to the test, especially if they outnumber the characters.

Lizardfolk Patrol A. This patrol of six **lizardfolk** serve G'ruk the lizardfolk shaman. These lizardfolk do not carry shields (AC 13), heavy clubs, or javelins. There is a 10 percent chance **G'ruk the Fish-finder, Lizardfolk Shaman** (appendix C) accompanies them.

Lizardfolk Patrol B. This patrol of six **lizardfolk** serve King Stronghoen, the minotaur king. Instead of javelins, each lizardfolk carries four darts (+4 to hit, range 20/60 ft., 1d4 + 2 piercing damage).

Stirges. These flying pests infest this level. The stirges primarily roost in area 2A-1 but occasionally flocks of 1d4 + 2 **stirges** are encountered away from their main lair as they search for a meal.

Young Lizardfolk. A group of 1d4+2 young **lizardfolk** explore this level as a rite of passage. They are unarmed and lack shields (AC 13), relying on bite attacks and their wits to survive. If they outnumber the characters, they attack.

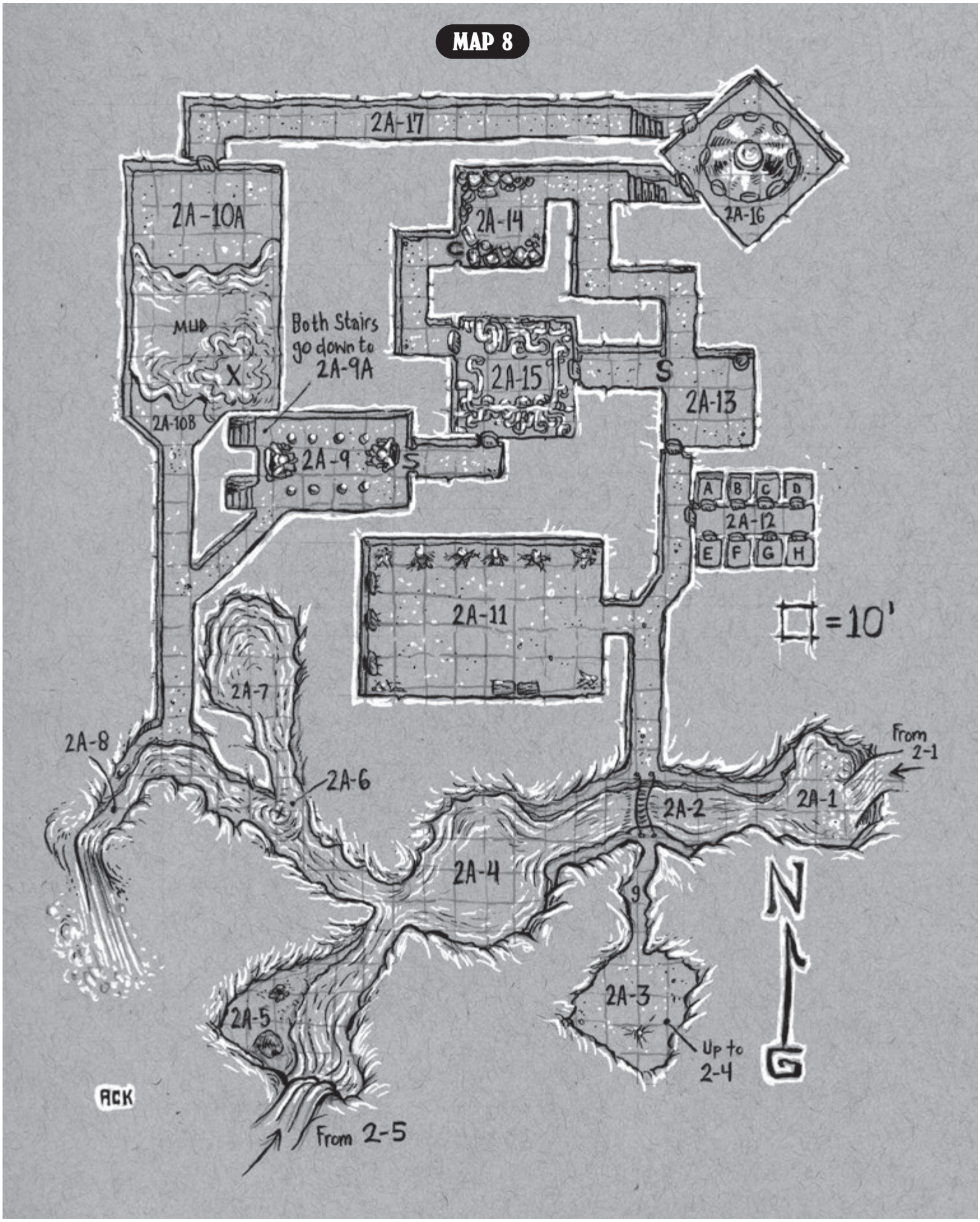
KEY TO DUNGEON LEVEL 2A

AREA 2A-1 – A LIGHTLESS POOL

A waterfall roars within this stone chamber, its cold spray filling the air with mist. The dark waters flow westward from the chamber.

A narrow ledge runs along the northern wall of this cave. The rock is slick with spray, and a creature that moves more than half its speed along the ledge must make a DC 13 Dexterity check to avoid slipping and falling into the river.

MAP 8


2A-17
2A-16
2A-10A
2A-14
MUD
X
Both Stairs go down to 2A-9A
2A-15
2A-13
2A-10B
2A-9
A B C D
2A-12
E F G H
2A-11
=10'
2A-7
2A-8
2A-6
From 2-1
2A-2
2A-1
2A-4
N
2A-3
2A-5
Up to 2-4
From 2-5
ACK

Aquatic Adventuring

As a handy reference to the GM, here is a summary of the rules that come into play when adventuring in aquatic environments.

Swimming. A creature without a swimming speed must spend an additional 1 foot of movement for each 1 foot of swimming. In other words, its speed is halved while swimming. In rough water, a creature must succeed on a DC 10 Strength (Athletics) check to make progress. A creature that swims for 1 hour must make a successful DC 10 Constitution saving throw or suffer a level of exhaustion.

A creature submerged in water has resistance to fire damage.

Visibility. Visibility under water is based on the clarity of the water and the amount of available light. With bright light, a creature can see up to 60 feet in clear water. With dim light, a creature can see only 30 feet. Murky water reduces visibility to 10 feet.

Drowning. A creature can hold its breath for a number of minutes equal to 1 + its Constitution modifier (minimum 30 seconds). When a creature runs out of breath, it can survive for a number of rounds equal to its Constitution modifier (minimum 1 round). At the start of its next turn, it drops to 0 hit points and is dying, and it can't regain hit points or be stabilized until it can breathe again.

Attacks. Attacks made by creatures without a swimming speed are less effective underwater. Melee weapon attacks are made with disadvantage unless the weapon is a dagger, javelin, shortsword, spear, or trident. Ranged weapon attacks automatically miss a target beyond the weapon's normal range. Even against a target within normal range, the attack roll has disadvantage unless the weapon is a crossbow, a net, or a weapon that is thrown like a javelin (including a spear, trident, or dart).

The following rules are optional, but recommended.

Hampered Movement. While submerged in water, a creature without a swim speed has disadvantage on Dexterity checks, Dexterity saving throws, and initiative rolls.

Spellcasting. Creatures that can't breathe water can't cast spells while fully underwater. Casting a spell while treading water, requires a successful DC 10 Constitution saving throw in calm water, or a DC 15 Constitution saving throw in rough water.

Hypothermia. Creatures submerged in the cold water must make a successful DC 10 Constitution saving throw at the end of each of its turns or take 1d6 cold damage. A creature that leaves the water after taking this cold damage suffers two levels of exhaustion until it spends 10 minutes in a warm location and dry clothing.

The river is 10 feet deep and flows westward at a rate of 50 feet per round. Jagged rocks and boulders are hidden beneath the water's choppy surface. A creature that falls into the water is swept downstream towards 2A-4 and takes 1d8 bludgeoning damage and 1d8 slashing damage, or half as much damage on a successful DC 13 Dexterity saving throw.

A colony of 20 **stirges** roosts in the dark upper recesses of the cave. They attack warm-blooded creatures in waves of 2d4 each round. The source of the waterfall is area 2-1.

AREA 2A-2 – ROPE BRIDGE

A crudely formed rope bridge spans the river here, connecting a passageway to the north and a dry streambed to the south. Whitewater to the east of the bridge violently throws up spray that has left the ropes dark with damp and rot. The dilapidated rope and plank bridge sags, with the center of the bridge mere feet above the surface of the water.

The lizardfolk, having discovered the dried sinkhole to the south, built this bridge to allow for further exploration and expansion. The poorly maintained bridge is crafted from what planks of wood and lengths of rope the lizardfolk have been able to scavenge. The rope is rotting in several places, and two planks have broken and dangle above the water.

The bridge is The bridge is 5 feet wide and about 20 feet long, and it is anchored at both ends. Untying one end takes one creature four rounds, although two working in concert can accomplish the task in half the time. The bridge can also be severed by dealing it at least 8 slashing damage. Without extensive repairs, the bridge can't support more than a single Medium creature at once. Additional weight causes the entire structure to collapse into the water.

The bridge is unstable and swings if crossed with haste. Creeping across the bridge at a rate of 5 feet per round requires no check. A creature that moves across the bridge at a faster rate must make a DC 15 Dexterity check, with disadvantage if the creature is moving at full speed. On a failed check, the bridge collapses, and tangles around the creature as it plunges into the water.

While tangled in the bridge, the creature is restrained. A restrained creature takes 1d6 bludgeoning and 1d6 slashing damage each round as they are swept downriver at a rate of 100 feet per round. The creature can use an action to make a DC 16 Strength (Athletics) or Dexterity (Acrobatics) check,

freeing themselves on a success. Upon reaching area 2A-4, a creature wearing heavy armor sinks into the depths, while lesser encumbered creatures continue downstream.

AREA 2A-3 – DRY SINKHOLE

The uneven ground here bears witness to centuries of falling water before its source receded and the chamber dried up. Handholds have been chiseled into the south wall. In the center of the room are the remnants of a cookfire, not more than a few hours old. The bones of fish and small game litter the floor.

Up the Wall. The upper portion of this cavern connects to area 2-4. Climbing the 50-foot walls requires a successful DC 14 Strength (Athletics) check. If the handholds are used, the check is made at advantage.

Four **lizardfolk** stand watch over the bridge to the north (see area 2A-2) to prevent the inhabitants of this level from invading their territory above. When the heroes arrive, three of the lizardfolk rest in this room, while the fourth stands guard at point "g." Instead of javelins, the lizardfolk carry 4 darts each (+4 to hit, range 20/60 ft., 1d4 + 2 piercing damage).

Developments. If attacked from the north, one of the lizardfolk retreats up the wall to summon reinforcements. He returns with 2d4 + 2 additional lizardfolk after 1d3 + 3 rounds.

AREA 2A-4 – ENDLESS DEPTHS

This natural cavern forms a nearly perfect circle roughly 40 feet in diameter. A raft is beached upon a narrow ledge against the northeastern arc of the cavern. The cavern is silent, save for rushing echoes of waterfalls from both the east and west.

The waters here are, quite literally, impossibly deep. Luckily, the widening of the cavern slows the river's flow. Creatures can swim across the pool without needing to make a check, unless they are encumbered, in which case they must make a successful DC 15 Strength (Athletics) check to avoid sinking. Due to the pool's divine connection to the Elemental Plane of Water, creatures that sink into the waters here might descend forever without ever reaching bottom.

AREA 2A-5 – HERMITAGE

GM Note. There is a 50 percent chance Holleran is present when the characters arrive.

Water flows down from above, creating a pool that flows northeast to join the main river. A stony shoreline rises above the waterline to the west, upon which sits a crude, mud-daub structure. The entrance to the hut is obscured by a curtain of dried water plants. A stone firepit has been constructed nearby.

The **lizard king** Holleran resides in this cavern. If present when the characters arrive, he begins the encounter indifferent and seeks to parley. At first, Holleran pretends to speak only local languages, until he is certain the characters have something worth discussing. If the characters catch his interest, Holleran tells them when Thracia fell, he was the last of the human priests to escape from the temple (area 2A-9) but was unable to make his way to the surface. Trapped, the lizardfolk soon captured him and subjected him to ancient rites that transformed him into a massive lizardfolk untouchable by the passage of time. The lizardfolk hoped he would lead them in a war against the outside world, but much to their disappointment, he refused. Instead, he retreated to this isolated cave and made it his home.

Holleran's story is false. In truth, Holleran is the leader of a group of elite lizardfolk mercenaries who are quartered in area 2A-12. He is merely trying to determine if the characters pose a threat to lizardfolk. If attacked, Holleran zealously defends his home but is otherwise quite gracious to visitors. He could even be convinced to accompany the party on their journey. He has become very familiar with the area over the years and can guide the characters to any location on Levels 2 or 2A, although he will not reveal the existence of area 2A-15 unless completely necessary.

Water trickles into this cavern from area 2-5. Without the use of magic, the characters can discover this route only by breaking through the wall. The pool is about 10 feet deep and flows slowly toward area 2A-6.

Hut. The interior of the hut is simply furnished with a crude table and chair and a pile of moldering straw that serves as a bed. A heavy crossbow leans against one wall. Handing on a peg nearby is an animal-hide quiver holding 22 bolts.

Treasure. Buried beneath the straw is a pouch containing 100 ancient Thracian coins (worth 300 gp) and a small statue depicting a creature with the lower body of a lobster and the torso, arms, and head of a man. The statue depicts Triton, the Deep Sea King (see area 2A-9E).

AREA 2A-6 – WHIRLPOOL

Over the eons, the water here has cut its way through the stone, leaving behind no bank on which to land. A frothy whirlpool churns near the tunnel's northern wall. Beyond the vortex, the roar of a waterfall can be heard from the west.

Anything that comes within 5 feet of the whirlpool, marked with an "x" on the map, is pulled beneath the water. A creature can attempt a DC 18 Strength (Athletics) check to escape the vortex. Otherwise, after three rounds the creature is pulled into the deepwater cave in area 2A-7. Securing a piton to the tunnel's wall requires a successful DC 14 Strength check. Creatures that avoid the whirlpool are swept along with the current towards area 2A-8.

AREA 2A-7 – DEEPWATER CAVE

A dim violet light radiates from somewhere above, but the glow fails to illuminate this otherwise dark, submerged cavern.

The light from above is faint and prevents the party from making out much in the way of detail. If the characters have another source of light, such as the glow of a magical weapon, continue:

A slow current from the southeast carries the river's detritus into the cavern. At the bottom of the cave, the detritus settles into a rich, black muck, within which the remnants of ancient weapons can be seen.

A **giant alligator snapping turtle** (see appendix B) hides beneath the muck. It uses its aquatic camouflage to hide, allowing the characters to approach before attacking. Once the turtle gets a victim in its maw, it maintains its grip until the creature stops struggling, then attacks another creature. A creature can "play dead" by making a successful DC 12 Wisdom (Animal Handling) check, tricking the turtle into releasing it early.

AREA 2A-8 – END OF THE LINE

The river carves through this cavern before forming into a roaring waterfall to the south. To the north, a battered raft rests on a ledge that opens into a hallway of worked stone.

Each round a creature spends in the water, it must make a DC 15 Strength (Athletics) check to avoid being carried over the waterfall. If the party is on a raft or similar vehicle, a character proficient with water vehicles can add their proficiency bonus to the check.

Ledge. The ledge is slick with moisture and biofilm. A creature must make a successful DC 14 Dexterity check to pull itself out of the water onto the ledge.

Waterfall. The waterfall plummets 100 feet into a shallow, rocky pool, which in turn feeds the network of pipes on Level 4. A creature carried over the falls takes 10d6 bludgeoning damage. Climbing back up to the cavern requires a DC 17 Strength (Athletics) check.

AREA 2A-9 – THE LOST TEMPLE OF THRACIA

Twin statues sit on either side of this pillar-lined room, their unblinking gazes forever staring at one another. Each statue depicts a titan seated on a throne of coral, leaning forward as if about to rise to its feet. The walls are painted with images of curling tendrils of seaweed rising from the seafloor. Shimmering blue light dances across the ceiling, furthering heightening the impression that the entire room is submerged deep underwater. The light is more than a mere painter's folly, however, as true light filters from above. On either side of the western statue, a set of stairs descends into darkness.

This was the last of the temples to be evacuated during the barbarian invasion that presaged the fall of Thracia. Though the Thracians held some other deities in greater esteem than the sea-god Poseidon, it was to him they uttered prayers to strengthen sea-going trade and protect Thracian vessels.

The stairs flanking the western statue descend to a temple complex (area 2A-9A through 2A-9K; depicted on **Map 9**). Multiple traps in this chamber prevent the desecration of that sub-level.

East Statue. A 4-foot-high secret door is concealed behind the eastern statue. A character who succeeds on a DC 20 Wisdom (Perception) check notices the secret door, as well as a real seashell set into the seafloor painting on the eastern wall. Though the seashell seems to be a method for opening the secret door, a character who succeeds on the Perception check by 5 or more deduces that it is a trigger for a trap. Pressing the shell causes the statue to slam backwards against the wall. Creatures between the statue and the wall when the trap triggers take 21 (6d6) bludgeoning damage, or half as much damage with a successful DC 17 Dexterity saving throw.

Opening the secret door by use of the shell is not possible. However, a character who makes a successful DC 22 Intelligence (Investigation) check notices a piece of red glass set into the wall. Reflecting the blue light from the ceiling onto the glass turns the glass black, causing the secret door to open. Shining normal light upon the glass has no effect. With a successful DC 15 Intelligence check, a character can deduce that activating the glass has something to do with color. Characters proficient with artisan's tools can add their proficiency bonus to the check.

West Statue. The statue on the west guards the stairs going down, although the trap here is far simpler than its counterpart on the eastern wall. At the top of each set of stairs is a pressure plate. Noticing a pressure plate requires a successful DC 22 Wisdom (Perception) check. A character with thieves' tools can disarm a pressure plate by making a successful DC 14 Dexterity check. Stepping on either plate causes the statue's arms to lash out, slamming into anyone standing at the top of the stairs. The statue attacks with a +8 bonus to hit. A creature hit by the statue takes 11 (2d10) bludgeoning damage and must make a successful DC 15 Dexterity saving throw or be knocked down the stairs. A creature that tumbles down the stairs takes an additional 14 (4d6) bludgeoning damage and lands prone at the base of the stairs in area 2A-9A.

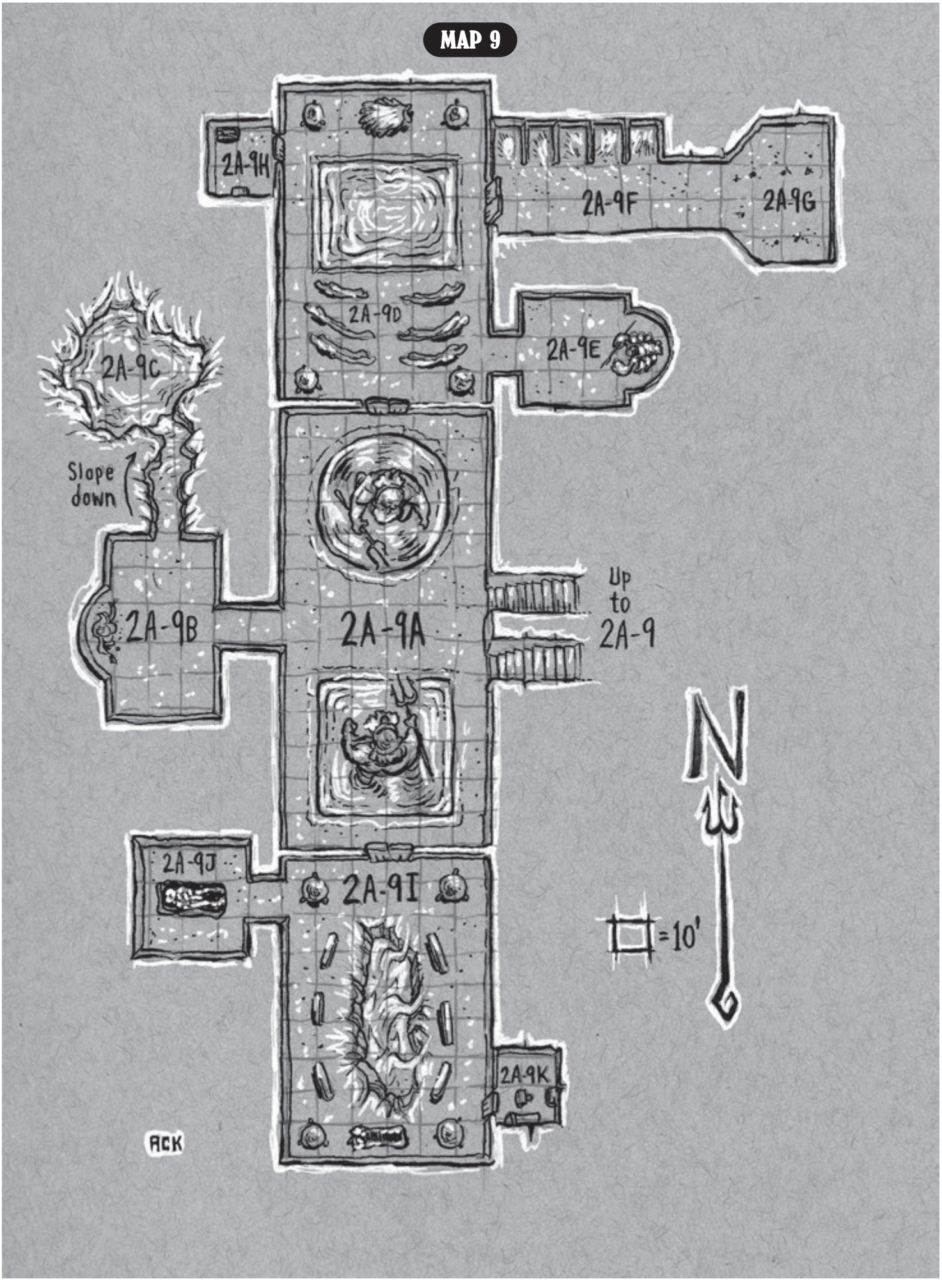
The Final Trap. If either of the above traps are triggered, the room's final defense activates. A volley of darts fire from the decorative pillars, dealing 20 (8d4) piercing damage to each creature in the room, or half as much damage with a successful DC 15 Dexterity saving throw. A creature knocked down the stairs by the western statue is safe from this trap. A character who succeeds on a DC 24 Wisdom (Perception) check while inspecting the pillars notices the trap. Unless the characters somehow encapsulate each pillar with a physical barrier (such as a *wall of stone* or *wall of force*), this trap can't be disarmed.

AREA 2A-9A – THE CELLA OF THE SEA-GOD

Two towering statues dominate this room. Each statue depicts a similar, well-muscled, bearded figure with long hair held back by a tainia. Each statue holds a trident and rises from a pool of glowing water. The statue to the north is 20 feet tall and is made of bronze covered in verdigris. The statue depicts the subject from the waist up, his trident held with its tines pointed towards the ceiling 40 feet above. The statue to the south is chiseled from a massive block of marble. Standing 20 feet in height, the colossus into the stone plinth on which he stands. This statue casts a faint, orangish glow.

The ceiling here is 40 feet overhead. Characters proficient in Religion immediately recognize both the significance of this chamber and the two depictions of the sea god Poseidon.

MAP 9


2A-9H
2A-9F
2A-9G
2A-9D
2A-9E
2A-9C
Slope down
2A-9B
2A-9A
Up to 2A-9
2A-9J
2A-9I
2A-9K
N
=10'
ACK

North Pool and Statue. The pool to the north is 10-feet deep. The bronze statue does not stand on the bottom of the pool; instead, its base is formed to depict wavelike shapes.

South Pool and Statue. The south pool is also 10-feet deep. The statue's marble plinth rests on the bottom of the pool. The statue is warm to the touch.

AREA 2A-9B – SHRINE OF THE SEA QUEEN

The air here is cool, and moisture beads off the carved marble walls. Positioned within an alcove in the west wall is a statue of a woman of unearthly beauty clad in flowing garments. Around her feet lie offerings of shells, flowers, and pearls. Oddly, the flowers show no sign of wilting.

A character who makes a successful DC 20 Intelligence (Religion) check recognizes that this shrine is dedicated to Amphitrite, the Sea Queen. Diopatre, a **naiad shellsinger** (see appendix B), maintains the shrine and is ready to protect it against interlopers (see area 2A-9C).

If a character leaves an offering of at least 100 gp at the shrine, Diopatre embraces the pious character and grants them the **blessing of Amphitrite** (see sidebar). If the party offers 500 gp or more, she also uses Song of Healing on the group.

Should anyone dare desecrate the shrine, the naiad uses Song of Summoning to call forth her sisters, a group of 1d4 +1 **naiads** (see appendix B). The fey attack, using Fey Charm to send charmed targets to area 2A-9C. Once there, the naiads employ Water's Embrace. Meanwhile, Diopatre uses Song of Soothing or Song of Healing to aid her sisters.

A Blessing Bestowed

Blessing of Amphitrite. For the next 1d6 hours, you gain the benefits of a *bless* spell and a *shield of faith* spell.

Treasure. Among the offerings are five pearls (worth 150 gp each). A character who makes a successful DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation or Nature) check recognizes that the shells are unusual and rare. A character with a background related to sailing or the sea can add twice their proficiency bonus to this check. Collectively, the shells might be worth up to 300 gp to the right buyer.

Development. If the characters make appreciable noise here, Diopatre arrives from area 2A-9C in 1d4 rounds to investigate.

AREA 2A-9C – CAVE OF THE SEA NYMPH

A naturally formed passage slopes down to this cave. The air here is humid and carries the salty tang of seawater. Waves gently lap the passage near the entrance. The passage drops off into deeper water after 10 feet or so.

This chamber is home to Diopatre, a **naiad shellsinger** (see appendix B). Diopatre oversees the maintenance of the shrine to Amphitrite (area 2A-9B) and is particularly in tune with the goings on there. As a gift from the Sea Queen, Diopatre has the following additional action:

Song of Summoning (1/Day): The naiad shellsinger sings a melody to summon fish or naiad allies. The shellsinger magically calls either 1 or 2 **reef sharks** or 1 **swarm of quippers**, provided the shellsinger is in a body of water. Alternatively, she can summon 1d4 + 1 **naiads** (see appendix B). The called creatures arrive in 1d4 rounds, acting as allies of the shellsinger and obeying her spoken commands. The beasts or fey remain for 1 hour, until the shellsinger dies, or until the shellsinger dismisses them as a bonus action.

The water here is spring-fed and laden with minerals that give it a saline quality. The water is a few inches deep at the cavern entrance and gradually increases to 15 feet deep near the north wall.

AREA 2A-9D – TEMPLE OF THE SEA-KING

GM Note. The guardian in this chamber might be too powerful for characters of level 7 or lower to defeat in combat, especially if they lack magical weapons. However, the guardian is bound to the pool and can't reach more than 10 feet from the

Optional Rule: Disabling Traps

Some players might balk at not being able to disable the statue and pillar traps in this chamber. If your play style dictates this preference, use the following suggested methods to disable each trap.

East Statue. A character can jam the statue's arms by making a successful DC 22 Dexterity check using thieves' tools.

Pillars. Each pillar trap can be disabled by jamming its firing mechanism. Doing so requires a minute of work and a successful DC 16 Dexterity check using thieves' tools. A failure on this check triggers all the pillars. For each pillar disabled, reduce the amount of damage the trap deals by 2 (1d4). If four or more pillars are disabled, creatures have advantage on the saving throw against the trap.

pool's edges. If the characters leave the treasure alone, they can escape this deadly encounter.

This immense chamber is suffused with blue light rising from carved coral basins in the corners of the room. A similarly glowing pool occupies the northern half of the chamber. Peeling murals of aquatic life decorate the column-lined walls, giving the chamber a truly aquatic atmosphere. Benches carved from coral extend from the entrance towards the pool, behind which stands an altar made from the shell of some Brobdingnagian bivalve.

A character who makes a successful DC 17 Intelligence (Religion) check recognizes that this magnificent chamber is a temple to Poseidon, the Sea King. The braziers are filled with pure, fresh water (about 2 gallons) that is magically replenished each day at dawn. Each brazier is enchanted with a blue *continual flame* spell and weighs 50 pounds.

Altar. Prying open the shell that makes up the altar requires a successful DC 24 Strength check. If a character uses a sturdy metal object (such as a crowbar) to open the shell, reduce the DC to 19. On a failed check, however, the metal object snaps, destroying it.

An **elder water elemental** (see appendix B) bound to the pool guards the altar (and the treasure it contains). It observes the characters from within the pool, only emerging to attack if a character attempts to open the altar. It uses its Whelm action to grapple a target and pull them into the pool.

Treasure. Inside the altar are the temple's treasures: 10,000 cp, 2,000 sp, 50 gold ingots (worth 100 gp each), a collection of 33 assorted pearls ranging from seed pearls to pearls the size of a dwarf's fist (worth 3,000 gp in total), as well as a perfectly preserved altar cloth spun from golden thread (worth 600 gp).

AREA 2A-9E – SHRINE OF THE DEEP SEA KING

A short hallway is all that divides this shrine from the main temple to the west. A statue rests in a deep alcove in the east wall. The monstrous figure has the lower body of a lobster and the torso, arms, and head of a man extending from where the crustacean's head would normally be. While most of the statue is covered in a greenish-blue patina, its "flesh" bears a pattern of tiny scales akin to sharkskin, while its shoulders are blanketed with startlingly white barnacles. In its hands is a trident, held as if ready for use in battle. A large conch horn hangs freely at its side. At the base of the statue are the dried remains of fish and seaweed, with a single blue pearl sitting in the heart of the offerings.

A character who makes a successful DC 20 Intelligence (Religion) check recognizes that this shrine is dedicated to Triton, the Deep Sea King.

The blue pearl is enchanted. While holding it, a creature can cast *divination*. When cast through the pearl, the spell allows the caster to speak with Triton himself. Once the pearl has been used to cast *divination*, it can't do so again for 7 days.

It has been centuries since the pearl was last used. If a creature uses the pearl in this area, Triton transforms the statue into a flesh-and-blood **avatar of Triton** (see appendix B) to question the one who dared disturb him. Should the god realize that his shrine was robbed, Triton attacks in his borrowed form and attempts to retake the stolen pearl. Only fast talking, or perhaps a hefty donation of pearls, averts the god's wrath.

Development. If Triton regains possession of the pearl, he crushes it to dust, preventing other non-believers from disturbing him in the future.

AREA 2A-9F – SACRIFICIAL STABLES

Five empty stalls line the north wall of this seemingly out-of-place stable. The air carries an ethereal whiff of equestrian odors, and within the stalls lie remnants of desiccated manure and rotted hay.

Once used to hold sacrificial horses, the stable now sits empty.

AREA 2A-9G – TELEPORTER

This room is utterly empty, save for a few dried pieces of manure. The stone floor is marred by the passage of countless hooves.

This chamber once received sacrificial horses from the temple of Poseidon on Oceanus. An archway on the east wall serves as a magic portal linking the two locations, but it has been centuries since its last use. Activating the portal from this side requires a special token carried by the priest of the Sea King in area 2A-9H.

Development. At the GM's discretion, entering the room while in possession of the token might activate the portal, allowing the characters to travel far from Thracia.

AREA 2A-9H – PRIEST'S CHAMBER

This once opulent room has long since fallen into decay. A bed with a rotting straw mattress and rotting frame sits against the north wall. A desk and rickety looking chair sit in the middle of the room, while a wardrobe is centered along the south wall.

The wardrobe holds the decomposing remains of the robes worn by the priest who once occupied this chamber. Buried beneath a pile of rotting garments is an iron lockbox. The desk holds nothing of note, and the chair is nondescript.

Iron Box. The box is locked and trapped with a poisoned needle. Noticing the needle requires a successful DC 18 Wisdom (Perception) check. The needle can be disabled with a successful DC 20 Dexterity check using thieves' tools. A creature that triggers the trap or fails to disable the trap takes 1 piercing damage and must make a successful DC 17 Constitution saving throw or take 44 (8d10) poison damage. Picking the rusty lock requires thieves' tools and a successful DC 25 Dexterity check to open. Alternatively, the box can be broken open with weapon blows (AC 17, 20 hit points, immunity to poison and psychic damage).

Moldy Mattress. Disturbing the remains of the bed releases a cloud of dangerous spores in a 10-foot radius. A creature that starts its turn in the cloud must make a successful DC 15 Constitution saving throw or become poisoned for 1d6 hours. Creatures that don't need to breathe automatically succeed on this save. The cloud of spores disperses after 10 minutes.

Treasure. Hidden inside the spore-laden straw mattress is a rotting leather pouch containing 130 gp. Inside the iron box are six pearls (worth 75 gp each), a ritual knife inset with abalone (worth 85 gp), and a headband with a strange-looking coin stitched into the cloth. The headband was the priest's tainia and is inset with the token required to activate the teleporter in area 2A-9G).

AREA 2A-9I – TEMPLE OF THE EARTHSHAKER

GM Note. The guardian in this chamber might be too powerful for characters of level 7 or lower to defeat in combat, especially if they lack several magical weapons. However, the guardian is bound to the pit and can only reach 10 feet beyond the pit. If the characters do not disturb the guardian, they can avoid this deadly encounter.

The air here is suffused with a reddish-orange glow, giving it the appearance of a volcanic underworld. The light is cast by four braziers, each styled as a volcanic vents, as well by a gaping chasm in the floor, through which sulfuric fumes rise. The chamber's walls are hewn from the surrounding stone, and stone benches line the east and west sides of the pit. On the south end of the temple rests a massive altar carved from a single block of black marble.

East Door. The eastern door (leading to area K) is locked and requires a successful DC 22 Dexterity check using thieves' tools to open. Opening the door awakens the guardian in the pit.

Pit. An **elder fire elemental** (see appendix B) lurks in the pit's fiery depths. Bound to protect the temple's former high priest, the guardian rises to attack anyone who attempts to enter its master's chamber (area 2A-9K). Each time the elemental makes an attack, the flames inside the pit flare, dealing 1d6 fire damage to every creature in the room

The pit is 10 feet deep and is filled with magical flames. A creature that enters the pit or that starts its turn inside the pit takes 21 (6d6) fire damage. Climbing out of the pit requires a successful DC 12 Strength (Athletics) check.

Development. The skeletal cyclops in area 2A-9J joins the fray after 1d3 rounds, using its brute strength to shove characters into the reach of the elemental, or perhaps into the pit itself.

AREA 2A-135J – TOMB OF THE CYCLOPS

The skeletal remains of a massive cyclopean creature dominate this chamber. Once standing 14 feet tall, the skeleton now lies atop a bier of black marble. The creature's arms are crossed over its chest, its skeletal fingers still clutching a massive club. An orb carved from ruby rests inside the creature's single dead eye socket.

One of Poseidon's many children was laid to rest in this chamber centuries ago. If the elder fire elemental in area 2A-9I is disturbed, the creature animates into a **skeletal cyclops** (see appendix B), rising to aid the temple's guardian in destroying the interlopers.

While the skeleton is animated, the ruby orb floats in its eye socket and blazes with a hellish glow. If its eye is destroyed (AC 20, 25 hit points, immunity to fire, poison, and psychic damage), the skeletal cyclops has disadvantage on attack rolls, ability checks, and saving throws.

Treasure. Unless destroyed during the combat with the skeletal cyclops, the ruby eye is worth 1,500 gp.

AREA 2A-9K – PRIEST'S CHAMBER

The chiseled stone furnishings of this room are sparse and utilitarian. A table and stool sit in the center of the room. A heavy wardrobe dominates the southern wall. Against the eastern wall, a decaying humanoid form rests atop a sleeping pallet carved from granite.

Before he died, the last remaining priest of Poseidon ordered the guardian in area 2A-9I to attack anyone who would disturb his eternal rest. His final order still intact, the elder fire elemental attacks anyone who attempts to enter this room.

Desk. A quill, a pot of dried ink, a prayer missal, and a stack of handwritten notes rest atop the desk. Both the book and the notes are written in Ancient Thracian. The missal functions as a divine spell focus. A cleric of Poseidon who uses the missal in this way gains a +3 bonus to spell attack rolls and spell save DCs. However, if a creature succeeds on a saving throw against the cleric's spell, the missal crumbles into dust. The handwritten papers, if deciphered, contain a final account of the priest, who refused to abandon the temple even after Thracia fell. Among the pages is a hand-drawn map depicting Level 2A and denoting all its entrances and exits (see **Player Handout 9**).

Treasure. The wardrobe holds the tattered remnants of the priest's raiment, including his tainia, which is inset with a piece of black marble. Leaning against the inside of the wardrobe is a trident, *Earthshaker* (see appendix D).

AREA 2A-10A – MUDROOM NORTH

The south side of this room is blocked by a curtain of burbling mud, which presumably flows into the chamber from the swamps above. A foul stench from the mud fills the air. Half buried in the mud are a pair of skeletal reptilian forms, their flesh long since having rotted away.

The area filled with the mud (indicated on the map) is considered difficult terrain.

As a rite of passage, the local lizardfolk enter the temple by "swimming" down the mud flow. Locating the mud's entry point (a crack in the ceiling marked "X" on the map) requires a successful DC 15 Wisdom (Perception) check. From the surface, entering the chamber via the mud slide is relatively simple, but reaching the surface from this location requires a successful DC 15 Strength (Athletics) check. Traveling in this direction leads to the surface, area E.

Stuck in the mud are the remains of a pair of lizardfolk who died during their rite of passage. Cursed to undeath, these two **soulless** (see appendix B) stir to wakefulness as the characters enter the room, rising the mud with a sickening "plop." Their lower bodies, having been preserved in the mud, are still covered in decaying flesh, while their upper halves are skeletal. The soulless fight until destroyed.

AREA 2A-10B – MUDROOM SOUTH

A curtain of dark, burbling mud separates this area from the north half of the chamber. The stench from the mud is nearly overwhelming.

The mud-filled area (indicated on the map) is considered difficult terrain. Locating the mud's entry point (a crack in the ceiling marked "X" on the map) requires a successful DC 15 Wisdom (Perception) check. From the surface, entering the chamber via the mud slide is relatively simple, but reaching the surface from this location requires a successful DC 15 Strength (Athletics) check. Traveling in this direction leads to the surface, area E.

Development. Holleran (area 2A-5) is familiar with this area and knows its secrets.

AREA 2A-11 – TRAINING GROUNDS

GM Note. A group of 2d4 **elite lizardfolk** (see appendix B) are always here, taking part in drills to hone their skills. There is a 10 percent chance that Holleran (see area 2A-5) is also here observing the session.

Whatever purpose this room once served, it has long since been converted into a training ground. Straw-filled dummies are scattered about, while shields hanging on the west wall serve as crude archery targets. Instead of orderly weapon racks, an assortment of melee and ranged weapons are heaped in each corner. Two crates are stacked against the southern wall.

A group of elite lizardfolk mercenaries use this chamber as a training ground. The lizardfolk are not immediately hostile. Rather, they regard the characters as new sparring partners. Characters who go along with this ruse can attempt a DC 15 Charisma (Deception or Persuasion) check to befriend the lizardfolk.

The shields on the wall are battered and in poor shape. Each shatter if the creature using it takes even a single point of damage, becoming useless. Along the south wall are two crates. One holds 44 arrows, while the other has 83 crossbow bolts.

Weapon Piles. Each corner of the room is filled with a pile of assorted weapons.

- NE Corner: three maces, two greatclubs, five spears
- SE Corner: two longbows, one heavy crossbow, four light crossbows
- SW Corner: three greatclubs, four longswords, seven javelins
- NW Corner: six spears, four maces, one morningstar, two shortswords

AREA 2A-12 – BARRACKS

This narrow, 40-foot-long hallway is lined with wooden doors to the north and south. The doors are heavily scarred, as if having suffered from repeated weapon strikes.

This barracks is home to a group of lizardfolk mercenaries led by their commander Holleran (see area 2A-5). When the characters arrive, 2d12 **elite lizardfolk** (see appendix B) rest inside the barracks. The mercenaries do not immediately attack a group that seems well-organized or relatively capable—they would rather kill for money than for sport. However, they become hostile if attacked or otherwise disrespected.

Each 10-foot-square room contains four reed hammocks and four battered foot lockers.

Treasure. Each individual room holds the scant personal belongings of the mercenaries: shell necklaces, feathered wristbands, and 4d20 gp in various pouches and pockets inside the foot lockers. Hidden inside one of the hammocks in barrack D are three freshwater pearls (worth 150 gp each). Locating the pearls requires a successful DC 17 Wisdom (Perception) check.

AREA 2A-13 – GUARD POST

Flickering torches light this square room. A table and several squat chairs sit in the center of the space, while a barrel of water stands in one corner. A label suspended by a leather cord hangs from the side of the barrel. A crude straw-filled mannequin dangles from a rope attached to the ceiling in the northwest corner of the room. On the floor are long strips of what might be white fabric.

Three **elite lizardfolk** (see appendix B) are stationed here. They believe that they are guarding the route to the barracks, but Holleran has secretly placed them here to guard the secret door leading to area 2A-15. One of the lizardfolk is shedding and has been pulling long strips of his skin off and tossing them onto the floor, much to the disgust of his companions.

The guards turn away strangers who arrive from the north, immediately raising an alarm if refused.

Secret Door. The secret door is concealed behind the mannequin and requires a successful DC 20 Wisdom (Perception) check to locate. A successful DC 18 Intelligence (Investigation) check locates the door's trigger, a loose flagstone. Otherwise, the door needs to be forced open with a successful DC 20 Strength (Athletics) check, although this likely attracts a wandering monster. The door opens into a 4-foot-high crawlway that ends in a small hatch. The hatch leads to area 2A-15.

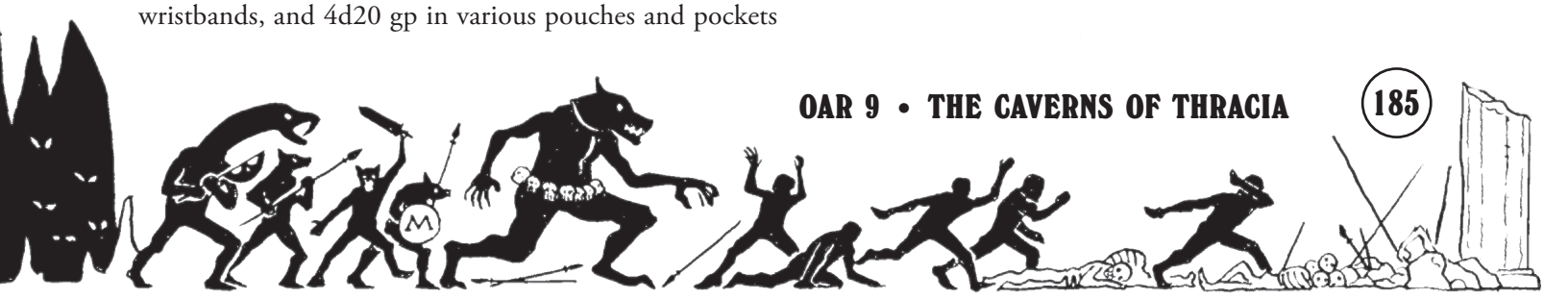
Developments. If the alarm is raised, the elite lizardfolk stationed in area 2A-12 hasten to this chamber, arriving in 3 rounds.

AREA 2A-14 – SUPPLY ROOM

GM Note. When the characters arrive, there is a 50 percent chance that a single **elite lizardfolk** (see appendix B) is here furtively gorging himself on the room's contents.

This room is stacked floor to ceiling with barrels and crates, all coated in dried mud. The air is filled with the scents of spices, the vinegar crispness of aged wine, and more.

The lizardfolk store their supply of plundered foodstuffs here. Although the mercenaries supposedly share the supplies equally, individuals are not above sneaking in to steal a bite for themselves. There are enough rations here, as well as wine,



ale, and water, to last the mercenaries for a year, should the need arise.

Secret Door. The stacks of supplies obscure the door to area 2A-15. Noticing the door behind the supplies requires a successful DC 15 Wisdom (Perception) check. If the characters move all the provisions away from the wall (a process that takes about 10 minutes), they automatically discover the door. The door opens into a 4-foot-high hallway to the west.

AREA 2A-15 – CONTROL ROOM

Unless the characters have encountered him elsewhere, there is a 10 percent chance that **Holleran** (see area 2A-5) is here when the party arrives.

This room is filled with a sea of metal pipes glistening with moisture. Many of the pipes have small handwheels attached to them, and there is a central column from which all the pipes radiate. The temperature inside the chamber is noticeably hotter than in the adjoining crawlway, reminding you of the hot, humid air of the jungle above ground.

Due to the profusion of pipes that fill the chamber, the entire area is difficult terrain. In addition, a creature moving through the chamber must make a DC 14 Dexterity (Acrobatics) check at the end of each of its turns. On a failure, the creature is scalded by one of the pipes and takes 1d6 fire damage.

The water in the pipes wends its way here from area 4-4 before being sent out through the sub-floor heating system of this level. Turning off the flow of water requires closing the handwheel valves and flipping levers in the proper sequence. This sequence requires 10 minutes and a successful DC 22 Intelligence (Investigation) check to deduce. If the heating system is shut down, the level gradually cools at a rate of 1 degree Fahrenheit per hour, until the temperature reaches 50 degrees after 24 hours.

Holleran uses this chamber as his secret retreat, one that he views as a perk of his status as the leader of the lizardfolk. The other lizardfolk are unaware of the existence of the chamber, and Holleran hopes to keep it that way, as he does not want to share his sanctuary with anyone else. Beside the central column is a pile of straw where Holleran beds down while basking in the tropical climate.

AREA 2A-16 – THE LOST ESCAPE TUBES

The stairs descend to a massive bronze door sealed with a handwheel. A room in the form of a 40-foot cube can be seen through a crystal-plated opening set into the door. At the heart of the room is a polished bronze dome, 30 feet in diameter. A crystal pillar filled with water rises from the top of the dome. More bronze doors are set into the base of the dome.

Around the dome are eight bronze doors, each of which opens into a can-like cylinder large enough to fit a single Medium creature. If sealed from the inside, the canister is released into the water and carried upwards through the crystal pillar to the Level 2, rising to area 2-10 before floating downstream. Unless caught in the spiderweb at area 2-8, the cannister eventually lodges itself beneath the bridge at area 2-1. The cannisters were designed as a last-resort escape from the temple, but most were never launched (see Southwest Door below). The water that fills the escape tubes is taken from area 4-23 and passes through area 3-2 below.

Southwest Door. The southwest cannister was launched long ago. The door to the cannister is sealed shut by means of a handwheel on the inside of the door and can't be opened from the outside by any mundane means. While it is possible that magic could be used to breach the door, doing so would be disastrous, as the water from above would instantly reverse course and eventually flood this floor. The consequences of such a disaster have been left for the GM to decide.

AREA 2A-17 – HAUNTED HALLWAY

A hallway stretches before you, its far end extending beyond your line of sight. A momentary breeze stirs the air as the gloom ahead of you seems to grow nearer.

The spectral wind causes torches and lanterns to flicker and wholly extinguishes candles. Otherwise, the breeze is simply unnerving.

The presence of living creatures in the hallway draws the ire of four shades, the undead spirits of those slain while trying to escape to area 2A-16. The shades wait for their victims to reach the midway point of the hallway before plunging the area into magical darkness, rising through the floor, and attacking from all sides.

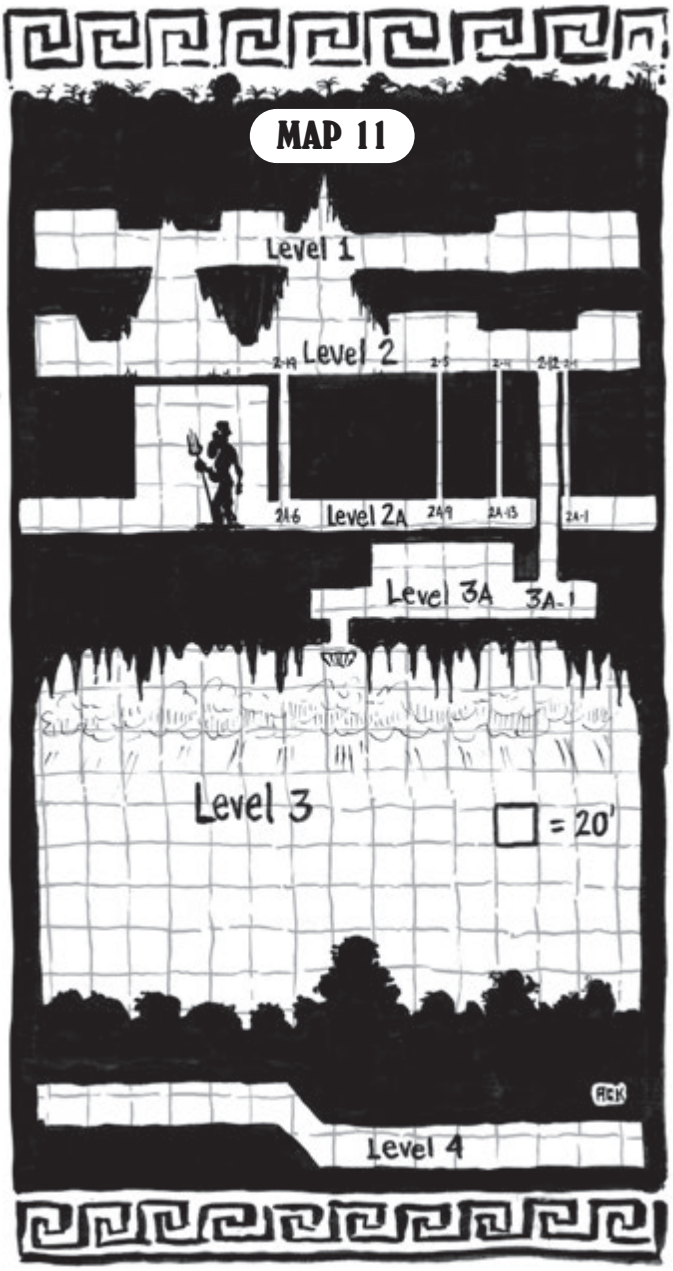
A shade is a **shadow** with the following changes, which increases its CR to 1 (200 XP):

- The shade has 36 (8d8) hit points.
- It has the following additional action:

Enveloping Darkness (1/Day): The shade casts *darkness* (no concentration required). The shade can see normally in this darkness. While inside the darkness, the shade's AC increases to 15.

CHAPTER SEVEN

LEVEL 3A

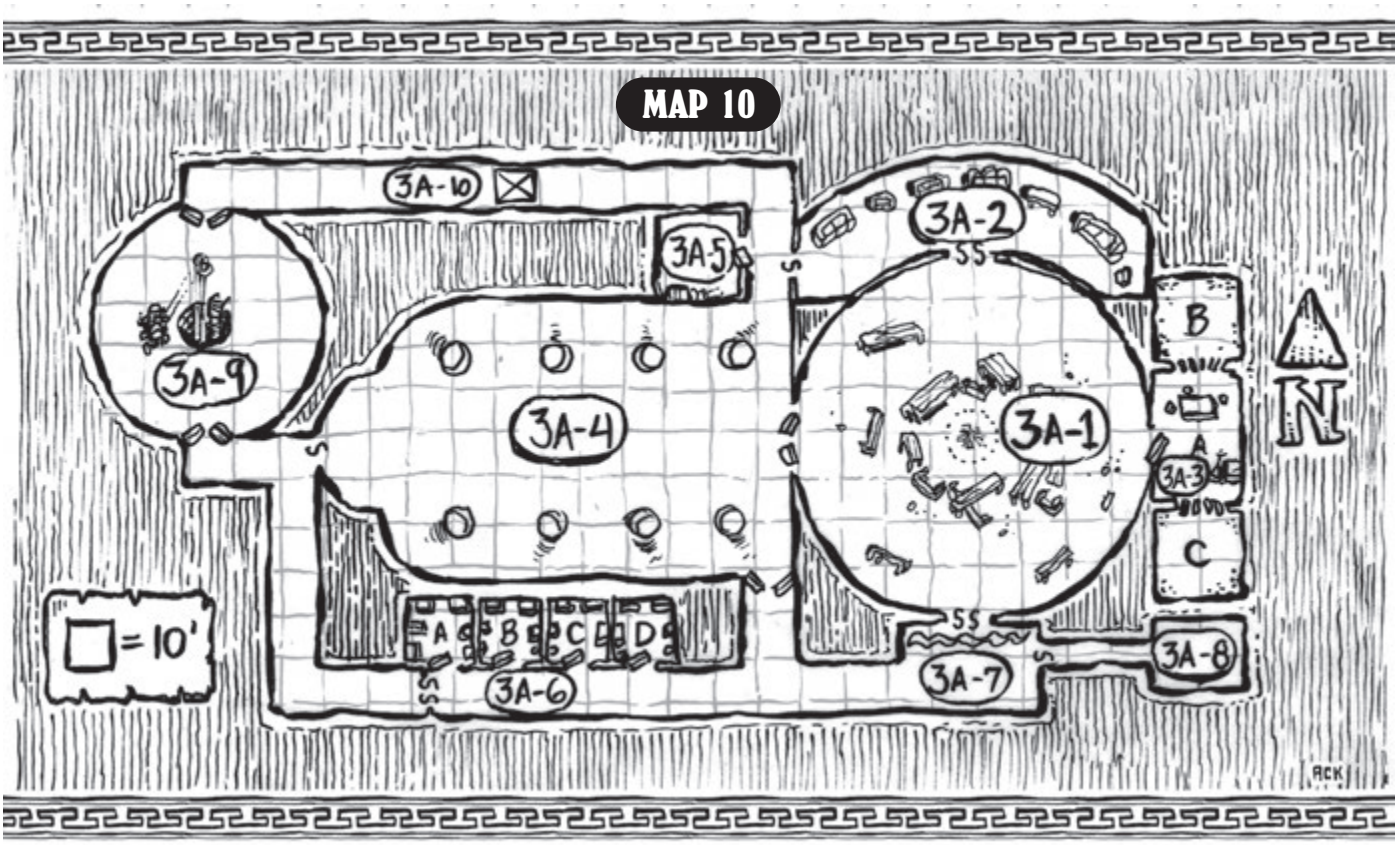


GENERAL FEATURES

Level 3A is fully depicted on **Map 10**. **Map 11** is a side view of the Caverns.

Ceilings and Walls. The ceilings inside the rooms and passages on Level 3A are approximately 20 feet high, except in area 3A-4, where they are 40 feet high. The ceilings and walls are smooth, worked stone and carved from bedrock. Climbing an interior wall requires a successful DC 18 Strength (Athletics) check.

Doors. Unless otherwise specified, doors are made of wood reinforced with iron bands (AC 17, 27 hp, immunity to piercing, poison, and psychic damage) and are unlocked.



Locked doors require a successful DC 15 Dexterity check with thieves' tools to open.

Illumination. This far underground, all areas are in darkness unless a source of illumination is specified in the room's description.

Level Connection. There is one entrance to this level from above:

- The shaft from area 2-12 descends into area 3A-1.

There are also two connections to Level 3, below:

- The elevator in area 3A-9 descends to area 3-7
- The pit trap in area 3A-10 leads to area 3-9

WANDERING MONSTERS

Only a single monster wanders this level. An **animated bronze statue** (see appendix B) cast in the likeness of the **Incarnation of Death** (see appendix C) wanders the corridors and rooms, attacking any living creatures it encounters. The statue was originally installed in the western alcove of area 3A-4 before being animated and tasked with guarding this level from intruders. Unfortunately, the statue designates any creature it encounters to be an "intruder." When the characters first visit this level, roll 1d10 to randomly determine which area the statue starts in.

AREA 3A-1 – GREAT AUDIENCE HALL

This cylindrical, 160-foot-diameter room appears to have once been used as a meeting hall. A 20-foot-diameter shaft in the center of the chamber's 20-foot-high ceiling is positioned directly above the remains of an ancient firepit. The floor surrounding the pit is blackened, and the remains of charcoal are still evident. Dozens of wooden benches in various states of collapse and dry rot surround the fire pit. There are doors to the east and west.

The shaft in the ceiling leads to area 2-12. The eastern and western walls both sport a pair of great bronze doors that rise to the ceiling, with baroque but meaningless runes carved into their lower halves.

The secret doors to the north and south are cleverly disguised to look like part of the wall. Each can be discovered with a successful DC 16 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check.

AREA 3A-2 – A PRIVATE GALLERY

This semicircular room is furnished with ornate marble couches and cushioned seats. The chamber's southern wall is clear as glass and overlooks a large meeting room to the south. The remaining walls are carved with ornate floral and geometric designs and painted with brilliant, but pleasant, colors.

This room once served as a "royal opera box" and overlooks the meeting hall in area 3A-1. The room's southern wall is transparent from this side but opaque when viewed from area 3A-1. Due to their great age, the lush cushions on the furniture crumble to dust if touched.

AREA 3A-3A – A HOLDING AREA

This room contains a marble table and three marble chairs decorated with intricate carvings and worn gilding. Several rolls of parchment rest on the table beside the skeletal remains of a robed figure. A sword pierces the figure's ribs and exits out its back.

The door to this cell is closed but unlocked. The skeleton is a former follower of Thanatos who chose death over the possibility of being captured by the gnolls. If touched, the skeleton crumbles into dust.

Treasure. The skeleton wears a silver skull pendant with turquoise eyes (worth 25 gp). The rolls of parchment are blank and in good condition, if somewhat dusty. There are 1d10 + 10 rolls in total, each worth 1 sp.

AREA 3A-3B – A LONG PAST SLAUGHTER

GM Note. The door to this cell is locked and requires a successful DC 15 Dexterity check with thieves' tools to open.

The skeletons of nearly two dozen humanoids lie about this cell. The robes the skeletons wear were clearly quite fashionable at one time, but they are now long out of style.

The skeletons are former worshippers of Thanatos who preferred death over being captured by the gnolls. They were killed by the man whose skeleton rests in area 3A-3A before he took his own life. There are 21 skeletons in total.

Treasure. Each skeleton wears a silver skull pendant with turquoise eyes (worth 25 gp). There are also 30 various pieces of jewelry (worth 5,000 gp total) among the corpses.

AREA 3A-3C – A CRUEL DEATH BY STARVATION

GM Note. The lock on the door of this cell has been damaged over time. It requires a successful DC 11 Dexterity check with thieves' tools to unlock.

Over a half dozen corpses lie about the floor of this cell. Most are skeletons but a few still have bleached skin stretched taut across their bones. Broken bows and rusted swords are strewn amongst the bodies. Tick marks scratched into the wall just inside the cell imply at least one of its former occupants kept a count of some kind.

The nobles who worshiped Thanatos were given honorable deaths, but their servants, who were typically not worshippers of the death god, were left locked in this cell to die of starvation. As a result, their souls were not freed from the mortal plane upon death.

Six **skeletons** and three **wights** are locked inside the cell. Their bows and swords are worthless in combat; instead, the skeletons attack with improvised melee weapons (+4 to hit, 1d6 bludgeoning damage) while the wights make Life Drain attacks. If they sense living creatures in areas 3A-3A or 3A-3B, they burst through the bars of their cell in a pack, inflicting 2 (1d4) points of bludgeoning damage to each creature within 10 feet of the bars. They then attack any living creatures they encounter.

AREA 3A-4 – SANCTUARY OF THE GOD OF DEATH

This area is black. Black, black. The darkness swallows the sounds of your footsteps, and no light reflects from any surface. It is like staring into the void. There is nothingness.

All surfaces in this pillared temple of Thanatos are covered with jet black stone. In addition, permanent *darkness* and *silence* spells have been cast throughout the chamber. Removing either effect requires a successful casting of *dispel magic* (DC 19).

The western alcove of this chamber originally held a statue of Thanatos, which later became the animated guardian that still wanders the level seeking to destroy intruders (see Wandering Monsters). Discovering the secret door on the western wall requires a successful DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check, but unless the *darkness* effect is dispelled, the check to discover the door is made with disadvantage. The skeletons of five hyena-headed humanoids (gnolls) lie scattered about the chamber. The gnolls have been dead for at least a millennium and crumble to dust if touched.

AREA 3A-5 – THE ROBING ROOM

This 40-foot-square room appears to have been used as a storage area. A human skeleton in religious robes rests just beyond the doorway. At the back of the room, the bones of a hyena-headed humanoid lie jumbled in a heap beside a large chest.

The chest is locked and trapped with a poison needle. The trap requires a successful DC 17 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check to notice and a successful DC 15 Dexterity check with thieves' tools to disable. If the trap is not disabled, a creature that attempts to pick the lock must make a DC 15 Constitution saving throw or be poisoned for 1d10 minutes. While poisoned, the creature is also paralyzed. The effects of the poison are so swift that anyone who witnesses the trap may believe the triggering creature instantly dropped dead, although a character who makes a successful DC 15 Wisdom (Medicine or Perception) check can confirm that the victim still lives. The chest's lock requires a successful DC 17 Dexterity check with thieves' tools to open. Inside the chest are the worthless, crumbling remains of the priests of Thanatos's ceremonial vestments, among other items (see Treasure).

As soon as a living creature touches the chest, the bones of the dead priest by the door moan loudly, attempt to stand up, and then collapse as the animating spirit leaves it. A **specter** then forms above the bones and attacks any creatures in the room. A character who examines the priest's body discovers the front of his robes were slashed open and several of his ribs were broken.

Treasure. In addition to the crumbling vestments, the chest contains a ceremonial dagger with a carved platinum hilt (worth 1,200 gp) and a golden helm studded with sapphires (worth 3,000 gp). The dead priest wears a silver skull pendant with turquoise eyes (worth 25 gp).

AREA 3A-6A THROUGH 3A-6D – CELLS OF THE UNHOLY BROTHERS

GM Note. These four areas (A-D) share the same basic description. None of the rooms contain anything of interest, except area 3A-6C.

This room appears to have been a dormitory. The 30-foot-square space contains four rotted cots, a marble table with a wash basin set atop it, several candle sconces set into the walls, and a few rotted articles of clothing.

AREA 3A-6C — THE SHADOW KNOWS

Three human skulls with yellow, gem-like eyes rest in the center of this chamber. Kneeling around the skulls are a dozen skeletons dressed in ragged clerical robes.

If the characters enter the room, six **shadows** rise from the kneeling skeletons and attack. As an action, a character using a pointed object (such as a dagger or an iron spike) can pry a gem from one of the skulls' eye sockets. Removing a gem causes one of the shadows to disappear. There are six gems in total (one for each shadow).

Treasure. Each of the 12 corpses wears a silver skull pendant with turquoise eyes (worth 25 gp each). The gems in the skulls' eye sockets are topaz (worth 500 gp each).

AREA 3A-7 – PRAYER CHAPEL

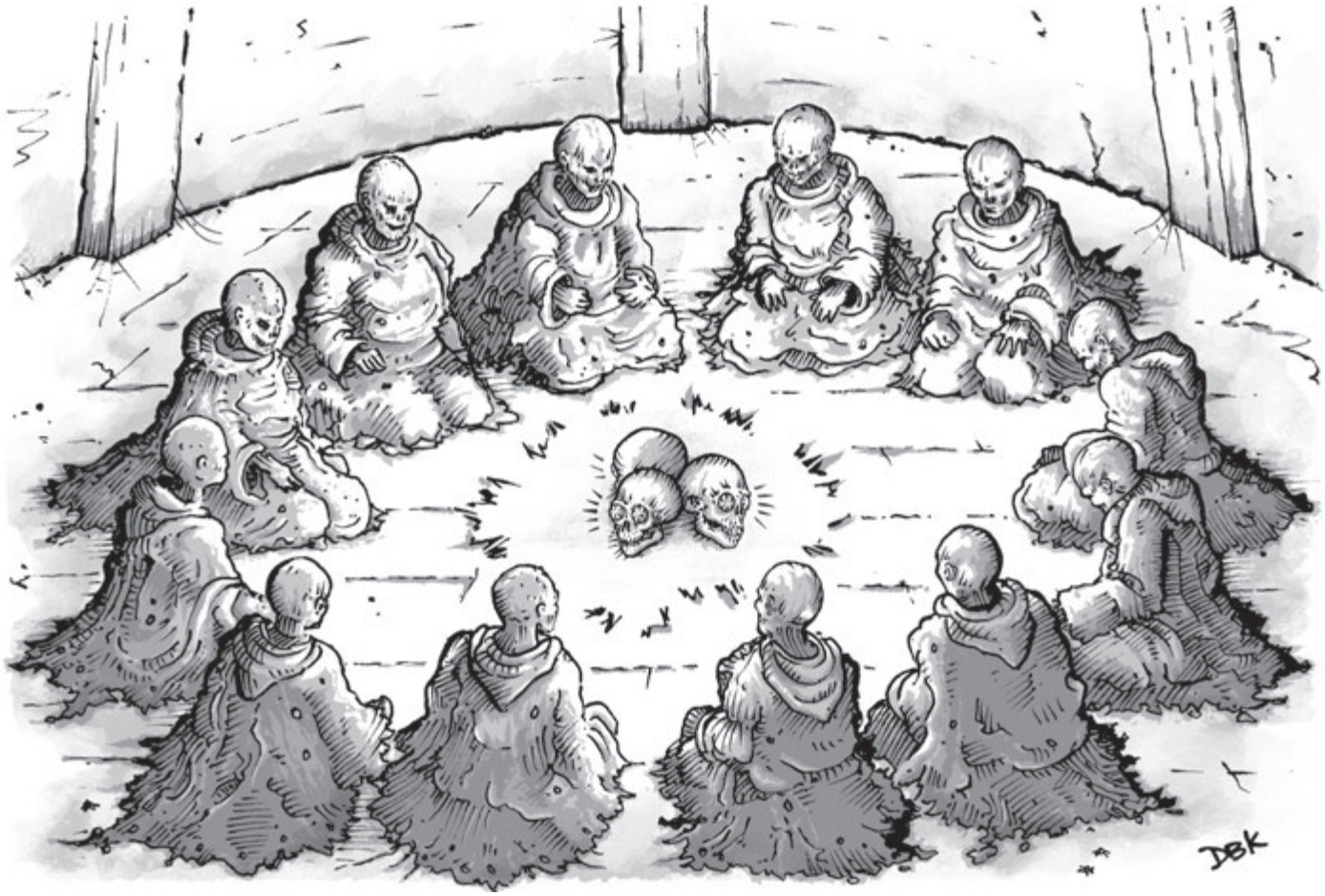
This room appears to have been a small chapel devoted to meditation and repose. An altar and kneeler are positioned in front of a curtain made of interlocking metal rings along the north wall. A thick layer of dust covers the altar and the simple prickets and candle nubs that remain.

The secret doors in the northern wall are hidden behind a remarkably intact set of chainmail drapes. Discovering the doors requires a successful DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check. The secret door in the east wall is plastered over and requires a successful DC 20 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) to discover. The plaster covering the door must be chipped away before the door can be opened.

Treasure. With 8 hours of work and a set of smith's tools, the drapes along the northern wall can be assembled into a chain shirt (worth 50 gp).

AREA 3A-8 – THE CRYPT OF KING AGAMEMNOS

In this 60-by-80-foot chamber, a skeletal form clad in the garb of royalty and wearing a simple crown lies in repose atop a marble slab. A plaque set near the body displays what appears to be a hastily carved verse. Numerous coins and other items lie strewn across the floor.



The bones on the slab are all that remains of King Agamemnos, who was sorely wounded during his escape from the beastfolk. When he died, Agamemnos was interred in a wing of the prayer chapel. His surviving subjects then either escaped the caverns or committed suicide. Upon closer inspection, the plaque beside the slab is revealed to be a repurposed serving tray.

Hastily carved into the plaque (in Modern Thracian) are the words:

"*Here lies Agamemnos, King of Thracia and noble servant of the gods, cut down by the arrow of a slave beast.*"

Treasure. Scattered about the floor are 1,000 sp, 550 gp, two gold rings (worth 50 gp each), and a small scepter worth 1,000 gp. Agamemnos's crown is a gold circlet set with a single diamond (worth 2,500 gp).

AREA 3A-9 – CRANK AND CRADLE

This room houses a mechanism of polished bronze consisting of a manually operated crank, a set of strange rollers, and iron cables attached to a drum. The cables reach up through the ceiling and then down into a glowing shaft in the floor. A ladder also descends into the shaft, from which a thick, cloudy mist rises.

The mechanism in this room is part of the elevator system that allows travel between this level and Level 3. It has been magically preserved to prevent rust and corrosion. The elevator can also be operated by a magical device found in area 4-18. The cloud-like mist rising from the shaft conceals the elevator cage, despite the bright light emanating from the hole. A creature that descends the ladder eventually reaches the elevator cage. Turning a crank inside the cage raises or lowers the elevator on the iron cables. When lowered to Level 3, the elevator arrives just northwest of area 3-7.

Development. The elevator cage is visible to all guards posted on Level 3. As the cage descends, the guards prepare to ambush unexpected arrivals.

AREA 3A-10 – THE LONG HALL

This corridor runs over 200 feet from east to west. Double doors stand at the corridor's western end. To the east, the corridor turns south.

There is a 15-foot-square pit trap in the floor partway down the hall. Noticing the trap requires a successful DC 12 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check. Jamming the trap's lid with spikes or pitons requires a successful DC 15 Dexterity check using thieves' tools. If a creature steps on the trap, roll 1d6. On a 1-2, the trap's lid swings open, and the triggering creature must make a DC 16 Dexterity saving throw. On a failed save, the creature plummets 200 feet down to Level 3, taking 20d6 bludgeoning damage from the fall and landing prone just east of area 3-9. Once sprung, the trap does not reset.

CHAPTER EIGHT

LEVEL 3

GENERAL FEATURES

GM Note. This level is divided into two sections, a garden and a palace. Both sections are detailed below, with different General Features and Wandering Monsters for each section.

AREAS 3-1 – 3-16 THE GARDENS OF THE THRACIAN KING

This area is entirely lit by an intensely powerful glow from above. A thin layer of clouds hides the chamber's ceiling, which must soar at least 150 feet overhead. A massive garden with several ancient trees dominates the eastern half of the chamber. To the west, a palace towers above a clearing just past the gardens and forest.

GENERAL FEATURES (GARDENS)

The gardens on Level 3 are fully depicted on **Map 12**.

Gardens. The gardens and palace on this level once belonged to the Thracian king, Agamemnos. A layer of cloud cover conceals the stalactites on the cavern's roof, as well as any activity that occurs there, from creatures below. The garden is regularly patrolled by **gnolls** and **lizardfolk**, who attempt to capture any adventurers they discover. Several **hamadryads** live in the gardens to the east (areas 3-3 through 3-12). The dryads are deathly afraid of the beastfolk but generally refuse to aid adventurers they encounter, even if it might mean the defeat of the minotaur king and his minions.

Illumination. The area outside the palace is brightly lit by an intense magical light similar, but not equivalent, to sunlight. The light emanates from the chamber's ceiling.

Teleportation Pads. This level can be accessed via the teleportation pads located in area 3-1 near the east end of the gardens and area 3-36 inside the palace. Utilizing these pads, characters can arrive from, and escape to, a similar teleportation pad in area 2-23.

Hamadryads. While travelers have long referred to all such tree spirits as "dryads," the wisest sages understand that dryads are bound specifically to oak trees. Spirits of other trees exist, differing in name, form, and abilities. Like their oak-dwelling sisters, other types of hamadryads are tree-bound, reclusive, and wield powerful woodland magic. The heartwood of a hamadryad's tree can be used to craft a magic item (as indicated in the encounter key).

Level Connections. There are numerous entrances and exits from this level.

- The teleport pad in area 3-1 connects with area 2-23 (if "special marbles" are carried).
- The sacrificial pit in area 2-31J opens up above area 3-15.
- The teleport pad in 3-36 connects to area 3-1 (unless "special marbles" are carried, in which case it connects to area 2-23).

And there is access to Level Four:

- The hatch in area 3-8 leads to area 4-23.
- The well in area 3-14 teleports climbers to area 1-3.
- The stairs in area 3-23 lead to area 4-1.
- The stairs in area 3-33 lead to area 4-22.

WANDERING MONSTERS (GARDENS)

Every 10 minutes the characters wander the gardens, there is a 1 in 6 chance of a wandering encounter. Roll a 1d10 and consult the Level 3: The Gardens table below.

LEVEL 3: THE GARDENS (AREAS 3-1 THROUGH 3-16)

d10	Encounter
1	The hamadryad Astraea
2	The hamadryad Eidothera
3	The hamadryad Calliste
4	The hamadryad Jocasta
5	Herd of cattle
6	Gnoll patrol D
7	Troupe of human slaves
8	Hydra
9	Random encounter from Level 2 (reroll on Level 2 Wandering Monsters table)
10	Random encounter from Level 3: The Palace (reroll on Level 3: The Palace Wandering Monsters table)

LEVEL 3: THE GARDENS WANDERING MONSTER DESCRIPTIONS

Gnoll Patrol D. A party of six **gnolls** and one special patrol member patrol the area for intruders or escaped slaves. See the Gnoll Patrol Tables in the Level 1 Wandering Monsters section.

The Hamadryads. One of the **hamadryads** (see appropriate encounter area) has decided to wander the gardens, straying from their favored tree. The various dryads are from area 3-3 (Astraea), area 3-7 (Eidothera), area 3-5 (Calliste), and area 3-12 (Jocasta). If encountered anywhere outside the gardens, roll 1d20 on the Hamadryad Purpose Table to explain why they are here.

Herd of Cattle. This herd of 20 cattle (treat as **camels**) is part of the beastfolk's food supply. The herd typically grazes in the gardens but they are occasionally chased into the palace when the hydra is out hunting. The cattle may be encountered in the gardens or the palace but are never found in the dungeons on Level 4.

Hydra. The **hydra** from area 3-17 hunts for its next meal in the gardens.

Troupe of Human Slaves. A dozen **commoners** scrub walls, water trees, or trim shrubbery. They join the characters if freed, but the first time they encounter a beastfolk commander (of any race), they must succeed on a Wisdom saving throw contested by the commander's Charisma (Intimidation) check or immediately change sides and fall under the commander's sway. The slaves speak Tribal Thracian and some Gnoll.

HAMADRYAD PURPOSE TABLE

If a hamadryad is indicated as a Wandering Monster on this level, roll 1d20 and consult the following table to determine the reason for the encounter.

d20	Reason For Being In The Dungeon
1-8	The hamadryad is a captive escorted by two **gnolls**. The gnolls do not carry shields (AC 13), spears, or longbows. They are instead armed with longswords, which they wield with two hands (+4 to hit, 1d10 + 2 slashing damage).
9-12	The hamadryad is attempting to escape captivity. There is a 50 percent chance that 1d4 **gnolls** pursue her.
13-14	The hamadryad now serves the minotaur king and leads the adventurers into a trap.
15-16	The hamadryad is dying (80 percent chance) or is already dead (20 percent chance). There is a 60 percent chance that a gnoll patrol stands over her body. Determine the gnoll patrol randomly by using the Gnoll Patrol Tables from the Level 1 Wandering Monsters section.
17-19	The hamadryad is hiding and attempts to remain unseen, even from the adventurers.
20	The hamadryad is insane and allowed to freely wander about. She bears the marks of torture; her face is marred by scars.

AREA 3-1 – TELEPORTATION PAD

A 10-foot-square arrangement of tiles sits in the center of this 40-foot-diameter clearing ringed by a stand of low trees. The trees bear fist-sized red fruits that resemble strawberries. Several humanoids within the cover of the trees harvest the unusual fruit.

The fruits have the appearance and taste of oversized strawberries. They are quite nutritious, with a single fruit provid-

ing enough food and water to sustain a Medium creature for one day. The fruit does not keep well, however, and must be consumed within 24 hours of being picked or it becomes mushy and rots. Six **gnolls** are on guard here; four of them are partially concealed within the shade of the trees and require a successful Wisdom (Perception) check contested by the gnolls' Dexterity (Stealth) to spot. The remaining two gnolls harvest fruit from the trees. Instead of spears, all the gnolls wield halberds (+4 to hit, reach 10 ft., 1d10 +2 slashing damage).

A creature that steps into the tiled section in the center of the clearing teleports to the pad in area 2-23.

Development. When the characters first arrive in this area, one of the gnolls from the chapel (area 3-14) is posted just beyond the tree line around the teleportation pad. If the gnoll hears combat from the direction of the pad, it reports the disturbance to the guards back at the chapel.

AREA 3-2 – TRANSPARENT TOWER OF WATER

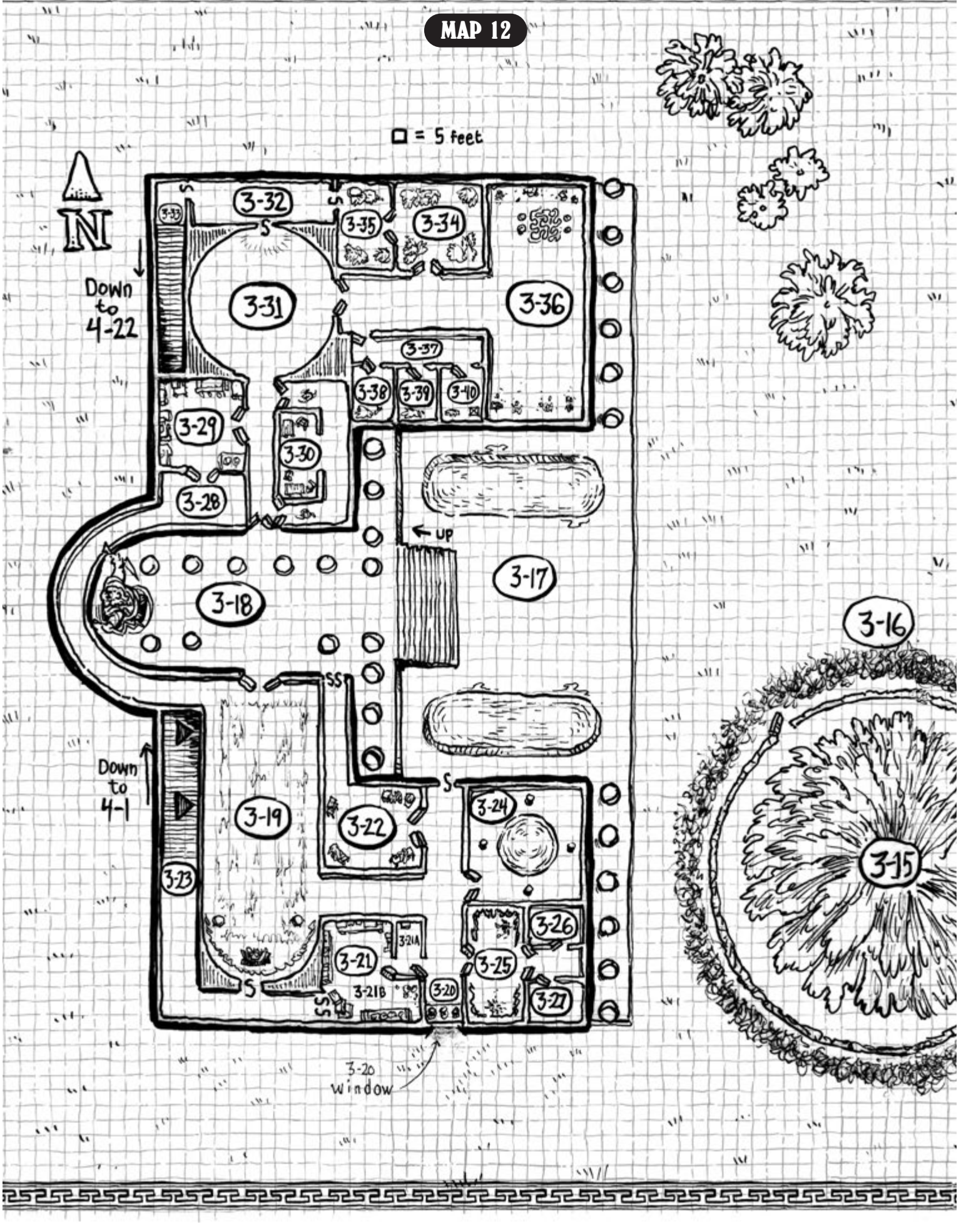
A 10-foot-diameter tube of transparent glass stretches from the ground to the ceiling nearly 200 feet above. The tube appears to contain sparkling, bubbling water.

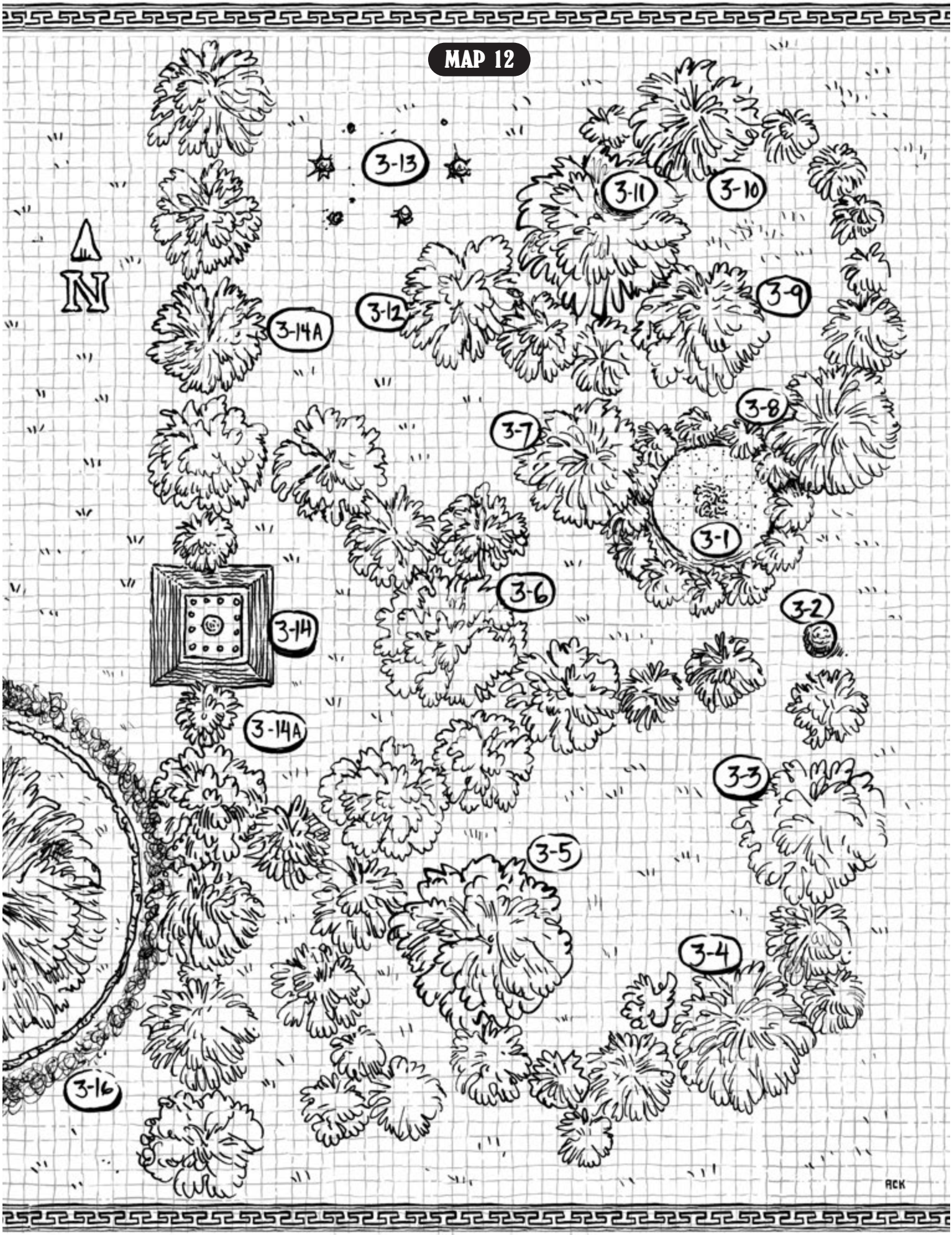
The tube is a complete mystery to the occupants of this level, though they assume it to be the source of the river found on Level 2. The tube passes through area 4-23 below the garden and rises to area 2-10. The tube has AC 28, 100 hp, and immunity to poison and psychic damage. What happens if the tube is destroyed has been left for the GM to decide.

AREAS 3-3 TO 3-12 – THE HAMADRYADS

A massive tree, its canopy nearly 40 feet in diameter, provides pleasant shade from the mysterious artificial sun overhead.

A character who makes a successful DC 8 Intelligence (Nature) check can identify the general type of tree at each location (oak, ash, elm, etc.). A character who succeeds the


MAP 12
□ = 5 feet
N
Down to 4-22
Down to 4-1
UP
3-15
3-16
3-17
3-18
3-19
3-20
3-20 Window
3-21
3-21A
3-21B
3-22
3-23
3-24
3-25
3-26
3-27
3-28
3-29
3-30
3-31
3-32
3-33
3-34
3-35
3-36
3-37
3-38
3-39
3-40


MAP 12
N
3-13
3-11
3-10
3-12
3-9
3-14A
3-8
3-7
3-1
3-6
3-2
3-14
3-14A
3-3
3-5
3-4
3-16
ACK

check by 5 or more can identify the specific type of tree (blue oak, white ash, slippery elm, etc.).

Each of these hardwood trees is the home of a single hamadryad. The hamadryads do not charm or attack gnolls or other beastfolk, as the beastfolk have threatened to uproot their trees if the hamadryads cause any trouble. The hamadryads react negatively to characters who harvest something off their trees or otherwise injure them. Visitors who gather fallen branches, fruit, or seeds from the ground, however, do not bother them. The hamadryads refuse to travel more than 240 feet from their favored trees. Additional details on individual hamadryads and their trees are found below.

AREA 3-3 – OAK TREE

This 70-foot-tall oak tree is home to the hamadryad Astraea. This forest spirit is the eldest of the three dryads of the outer woods and appears as an elderly woman with matronly mannerisms. She tends to refer to other creatures as "grandchild" and worries greatly about the safety of such young and frail creatures. If angered, her tongue is as brutal as her attacks, as she unleashes a withering torrent of scorn at her foes.

Fallen leaves with rounded lobes and large acorns with fuzzy caps litter the ground beneath her tree.

Astraea is a **dryad**, with the following changes:

- Increase the DC to resist her Fey Charm to DC 16.
- The heartwood of her tree can be used to craft a *+1 quarterstaff*.

AREA 3-4 – ASH TREE

This towering ash tree stands 120 feet tall and is home to the daskolite hamadryad Briseis. The hamadryad is stern but not unkind, rapidly slipping into the affectations of a scholar, sage, or tutor during their interactions. Briseis's knowledge is near endless, but she is loath to give answers that she feels questioners are not ready for. Her preference of offerings are tales of the travels of her supplicants, often requiring 10 minutes or more to impart.

On the ground under the tree, single-winged samara keys litter the ground. The leaves on this tree are noticeably darker on the top as compared to the underside. Unlike most trees found in the gardens, smaller branches grow in matched pairs from a center limb, rather than individually.

Briseis is a **dryad**, with the following changes:

- She has 31 hit points (7d8).
- Increase the DC to resist her Fey Charm to DC 16.
- Replace her Innate Spellcasting trait with the following:

Innate Spellcasting: The dryad's innate spellcasting ability is Charisma (spell save DC 14). The dryad can innately cast the following spells, requiring no material components:

At will: *druidcraft, detect evil and good, detect magic, detect thoughts*

1/day each: *barkskin, bestow curse, shillelagh*

- She has the following additional traits:

Fey Knowledge: The dryad is a font of knowledge, wisdom, and education. She can correctly answer any question of fact put to her, no matter how obscure. Such a gift generally requires a great offering or sacrifice in support of the dryad and the surrounding forest, with the value of the required gift increasing with the obscurity of the knowledge.

Fey Linguist: The dryad can speak, read, and understand all languages, and can communicate with plants and beasts as if they shared a language.

- Finally, the heartwood of her tree can be used to craft a wooden *luck charm* (see appendix D).

AREA 3-5 – THE SLIPPERY ELM TREE

This 60-foot-tall slippery elm is home to the ptelean hamadryad Calliste. Calliste is rather stand-offish and surly. She bears scars from several attempts the gnolls made to remove her from the forest. She doesn't trust strangers and wishes nothing more than to be left alone.

The surface of the jagged-edged, asymmetrical leaves on Calliste's tree have the coarse feeling of sandpaper, while the undersides are surprisingly smooth. Small clusters of pink and orange flowers grow on many of the branches.

Calliste is a **dryad**, with the following changes:

- She has 18 hit points (4d8).
- Increase the DC to resist her Fey Charm to DC 16.
- Replace her Innate Spellcasting trait with the following:

Innate Spellcasting: The dryad's innate spellcasting ability is Charisma (spell save DC 14). The dryad can innately cast the following spells, requiring no material components:

At will: *druidcraft, mending*

1/day each: *barkskin, calm emotions, shillelagh*

- She has the following additional reaction:

Fey Perfumery: When the dryad takes damage, she releases a foul stench in a 20-foot radius to ward off her attackers. Each creature in that area must make a DC 14 Constitution saving throw. On a failed save, the creature is poisoned for 1 minute as its eyes water and uncontrollable coughs wrack its body. While poisoned in this way, the creature also has disadvantage on saving throws.

- Finally, the heartwood of her tree oozes enchanted sap that can be used to craft five *potions of healing*. A creature that consumes one of these potions always regains the maximum number of hit points (10 hp).

AREA 3-6 – PIN OAK TREE

This 65-foot-tall pin tall oak tree is home to the hamadryad Deianira. A motherly figure, Deianira regards herself as the protector of this wood. Her flesh is marked by scars left by gnoll attackers, and a dozen gnoll skulls rest beneath the roots of her tree. Braided into her hair are several gnoll finger-bones, serving as a warning to those who would seek to harm the trees. Gnolls have come to avoid Deianira and her tree, making this likely the safest area in the forest.

On the ground under the tree, acorns and skinny leaves with pointed lobes litter the ground.

Deianira is a **dryad**, with the following changes:

- Increase the DC to resist her Fey Charm to DC 16.
- The heartwood of her tree can be used to craft a *+1 quarterstaff.*

AREA 3-7 — BOXELDER MAPLE TREE

This 50-foot boxelder maple is home to the heldreichiad hamadryad Eidothera. Eidothera wears regal clothing and a wreath of fiery autumnal maple leaves. Her friendly and welcoming behavior belies her duplicitous nature. The hamadryad made a deal with the gnolls to preserve her tree, and informs them of anything (or anyone) she sees.

Unusual for a maple, the leaves of this tree are in three segmented "leaflets" that connect back to a central stem. Dual-winged samara "helicopters" litter the ground under the tree, while others cling to several low branches. Unlike most trees found in the gardens, this tree's smaller branches grow in matched pairs from a center limb, rather than individually.

Eidothera is a **dryad**, with the following changes:

- She has 13 hit points (3d8).
- Increase the DC to resist her Fey Charm to DC 16.
- Replace her Innate Spellcasting trait with the following:

Innate Spellcasting: The dryad's innate spellcasting ability is Charisma (spell save DC 14). The dryad can innately cast the following spells, requiring no material components:

At will: *druidcraft, color spray, enlarge/reduce*

1/day each: *barkskin, enhance ability, shillelagh*

- She has the following additional trait:

Fey Adhesion: A creature that hits the dryad with a melee attack while within 5 feet of her becomes affixed to the dryad's sticky skin. While affixed to the dryad, the creature is restrained. As an action, a creature can attempt a DC 14 Strength check, freeing themselves on a success. A creature can automatically succeed on the Strength check by dealing themselves 1 damage, forcibly breaking the bond and leaving some of their skin behind.

- Finally, the heartwood of her tree can be used to craft a *wand of binding*.

AREA 3-8 – PECAN HICKORY TREE

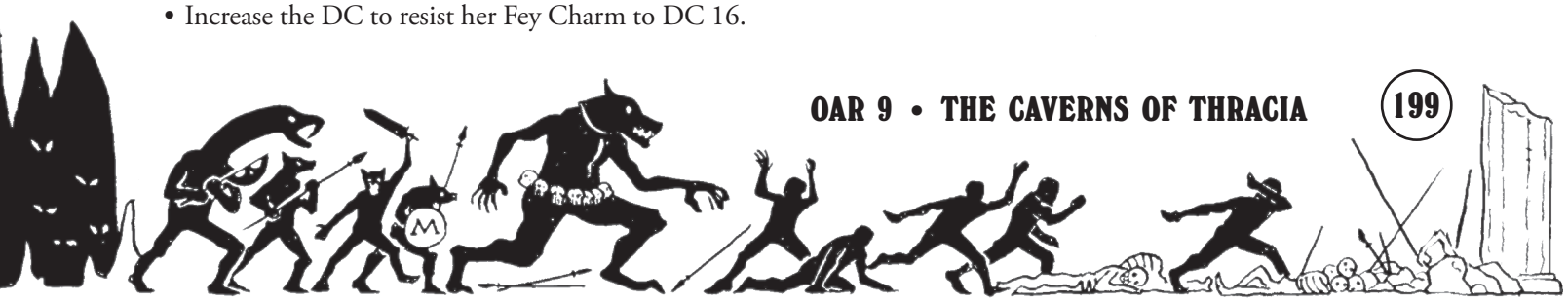
This 65-foot-tall pecan tall hickory tree is home to the laconiad hamadryad Flora. Flora's deep green skin is marked with only the faintest of scars, as the gnolls have barely been able to mark her skin with their weapons. She has no fear for her well-being, although she keeps a low profile to aid her sister hamadryads and to avoid drawing the ire of the gnolls.

Clusters of small, yellow-green fruit can be seen among branches of Flora's tree. Several pieces of the fruit, oddly split into still-connected quarters, lie on the ground under the tree.

Beneath the roots on the south side of Flora's tree is a rusted bronze hatch covered by several inches of sod and dirt. Flora is aware of the hatch but does not know where it leads. A character who searches in this area and makes a successful DC 14 Intelligence (Investigation or Nature) or Wisdom (Perception or Survival) check discovers something hard hidden beneath the dirt. Clearing the dirt reveals the hatch. The hatch is stuck but a character who makes a successful DC 14 Strength (Athletics) check can pry it open, revealing a 10-foot drop into a 10-foot-square room with stairs to the south. The stairs lead into area 4-23.

Flora is a **dryad**, with the following changes:

- Increase the DC to resist her Fey Charm to DC 16.
- Replace her Innate Spellcasting trait with the following:



Innate Spellcasting: The dryad's innate spellcasting ability is Charisma (spell save DC 14). The dryad can innately cast the following spells, requiring no material components:

At will: *druidcraft, fog cloud, suggestion*

1/day each: *barkskin, lesser restoration, shillelagh*

- She has the following additional traits:

Fey Insight: As a bonus action, the dryad can study one creature she can see within 30 feet of her, attempting to fully understand its actions and motivations. The target must make a DC 15 Wisdom saving throw. On a failed save, the target has disadvantage on attack rolls against the dryad, and the dryad has advantage on attack rolls against the target. The effect lasts 12 hours or until the dryad uses this trait to study another target.

Finally, the heartwood of her tree can be used to craft a *wand of binding*.

AREA 3-9 – WALNUT TREE

This walnut tree soars to a height of 120 feet and is home to a **caryatid hamadryad** (see appendix B) named Gaia. The hamadryad appears as a 7-foot-tall warrior wielding a club and holding her shield defensively. There have been a number of gnoll incursions into her territory recently, and while she knows a battle against the gnolls would inevitably favor her aggressors, Gaia is ready to fight to defend herself should they return.

AREA 3-10 – BLACK ASH TREE

This ash tree stands 100 feet tall and is home to the daskolite hamadryad Hypermnestra. Blustery and boastful, Hypermnestra would have visitors believe that she alone protects the entirety of the woods through her efforts. Those wishing to question her must make offerings of defense of the trees, with questions answered in keeping with the value of the sworn protection. Those who betray their oath of protection find themselves forgetting the knowledge imparted to them, as Hypermnestra's curse takes many forms.

On the ground under the tree, single-winged samara keys litter the ground. Unlike most trees in the gardens, the tree's smaller branches grow in matched pairs from a center limb, rather than individually.

Hypermnestra is a **dryad**, with the following changes:

- She has 31 hit points (7d8).
- Increase the DC to resist her Fey Charm to DC 16.
- Replace her Innate Spellcasting trait with the following:

Innate Spellcasting: The dryad's innate spellcasting ability is Charisma (spell save DC 14). The dryad can innately cast the following spells, requiring no material components

At will: *druidcraft, detect evil and good, detect magic, detect thoughts*

1/day each: *barkskin, bestow curse, shillelagh*

- She has the following additional traits:

Fey Knowledge: The dryad is a font of knowledge, wisdom, and education. She can correctly answer any question of fact put to her, no matter how obscure. Such a gift generally requires a great offering or sacrifice in support of the dryad and the surrounding forest, with the value of the required gift increasing with the obscurity of the knowledge.

Fey Linguist: The dryad can speak, read, and understand all languages, and can communicate with plants and beasts as if they shared a language.

- Finally, the heartwood of her tree can be used to craft a wooden *luck charm* (see appendix D).

AREA 3-11 – WEEPING WILLOW TREE

This sprawling weeping willow is 40 feet tall with an equal spread. Within it dwells the helician hamadryad Iphigenia. Slender and agile, Iphigenia is utterly without fear—so long as she believes her tree will not be wholly destroyed. She is unbothered by the threats of the gnolls, as she has already planted a cutting from her tree in preparation for the day when they set fire to her home to destroy her. Her expression is one of "I know something you don't," and her attitude mirrors that which she is confronted with. Kindness or cruelty, she meets like with like.

The branches of the tree droop nearly to the ground, as if unable to support the weight of the tree's leaves.

Iphigenia is a **dryad**, with the following changes:

- Increase the DC to resist her Fey Charm to DC 16.
- Replace her Innate Spellcasting trait with the following:

Innate Spellcasting: The dryad's innate spellcasting ability is Charisma (spell save DC 14, +6 to hit with spell attacks). The dryad can innately cast the following spells, requiring no material components:

At will: *druidcraft, ray of enfeeblement, thorn whip*

3/day each: *calm emotions, detect evil and good*

1/day each: *dispel magic, shillelagh, slow*

- She has the following additional traits:

Fey Rejuvenation: If the dryad dies, she reforms in 30 days, provided she has a host willow. Even a cutting from the host willow suffices, although in this case the dryad does not reform until her willow matures. The dryad appears with all its hit points within 5 feet of her willow.

Regeneration: The dryad regains 5 hit points at the start of her turn if she has at least 1 hit point.

- Finally, the heartwood of her tree can be used to craft a *+2 wand of the war mage*.

AREA 3-12 – WHITE OAK

This 50-foot-tall white oak tree is home to the hamadryad Jocasta. Jocasta appears as a young maiden with an innocent disposition. She is no fool, however, and merely uses her youthful appearance to fool others into underestimating her. If approached kindly, she is cheerful and helpful. If mistreated or addressed rudely, she appears utterly oblivious to such things, while cheerfully giving misinformation that could lead to disaster or death.

On the ground under the tree, acorns and fallen leaves with rounded lobes litter the ground.

Jocasta is a **dryad**, with the following changes:

- Increase the DC to resist her Fey Charm to DC 16.
- The heartwood of her tree can be used to craft a *+1 quarterstaff.*

AREA 3-13 – THE STUMPS OF LOST TREES

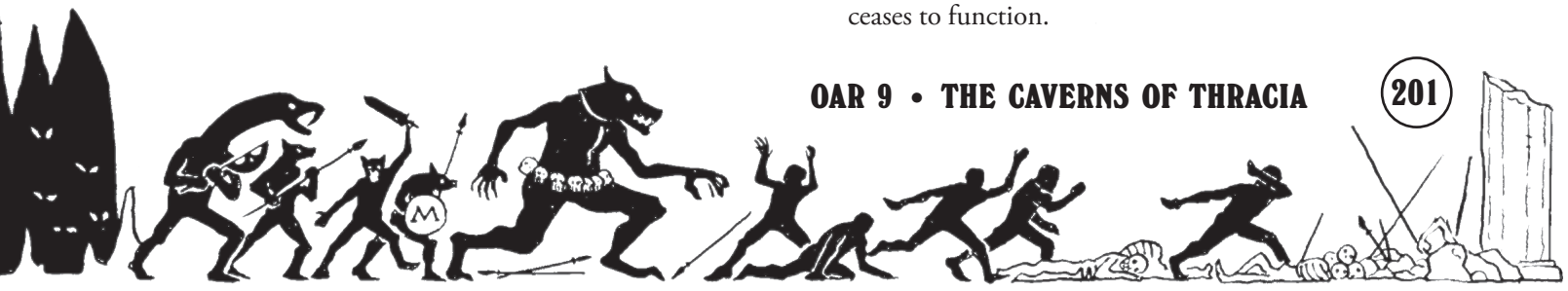
Recent, but incomplete, efforts have been made to create a clearing in this area. The crudely chopped stumps of several large hardwood trees are all that remain.

When the tribal warriors refused to pay him tribute, cutting off his supply of wood from the surface, the minotaur king ordered this area to be logged to gather fuel for the boilers in the cellars beneath his palace. Several of the felled trees were home to dryads, whose loss is now mourned by the remaining dryads in the gardens. If the characters explain that the minotaur king is behind the recent logging, the dryads might provide aid against the minions of the minotaur. Grant characters who share this knowledge a +10 bonus to Charisma (Persuasion) checks made to influence the dryads.

AREA 3-14 – CHAPEL OF THE WONDROUS WELL

This columned temple is flanked on all sides by stairs, which rise 5 feet vertically over a span of 10 feet. In the center of the temple stands a round, 5-foot-diameter pedestal.

Characters who reach the top of the stairs realize the pedestal is a 20-foot-deep well. Climbing the interior of the well requires a successful DC 15 Strength (Athletics) check. However, a creature that climbs more than 10 feet down the well is teleported to the center of area 1-3. The teleportation effect only works reliably for the first five creatures that enter the well. After that, there is a cumulative 5 percent chance per use that the teleportation effect permanently ceases to function.



This chapel is the only safe path through the tree wall (area 3-14A) and is guarded by a **minotaur**, five **gnolls**, and two **lizardfolk**. The minotaur carries a halberd instead of a greataxe (+6 to hit, reach 10 ft., 2d10 + 4 slashing damage). The gnolls carry battleaxes instead of spears (+4 to hit; 1d8 + 2 slashing damage, or 1d10 + 2 slashing damage if used with two hands). The lizardfolk each carry four darts instead of javelins and spiked shields (+4 to hit, range 20/60 ft., 1d4 + 2 piercing damage; AC 13).

Development. If the gnoll posted near the teleportation pad (area 3-1) reported a disturbance, the beastfolk stand ready for the party's arrival.

AREA 3-14A – AROUSED AND EVIL TREES

As you approach this row of trees, dozens of thick, knobbed branches covered in long, needle-like thorns descend from the canopy overhead.

This row of 10 **border trees** (see appendix B) attacks all creatures other than cows, gnolls, or lizardfolk that approach within 50 feet. The border trees block the movement of all other creatures, effectively creating a solid wall between the gardens and the palace to the west. The trees are 20 feet tall, so flying creatures can soar above the tree wall safely. Killing a border tree creates a 5-foot-wide, 20-foot-long path through the thorny barrier.

AREA 3-15 – THE ANCIENT OAK

The single, massive tree towers above the stone wall that surrounds it. The tree's canopy is nearly 100 feet in diameter, and its truck is so wide that several human-size creatures would struggle to reach their arms around it.

A character who makes a successful DC 8 Intelligence (Nature) check identifies the tree as an oak. A character who succeeds on the check by 5 or more identifies it specifically as a red oak. The tree has grown here since the time of King Agamemnos, nearly 1,100 years ago. It houses an ancient and wise dryad named Kore.

Kore is a **dryad**, with the following changes:

- Increase the DC to resist her Fey Charm to DC 16.

Modifying Minotaurs

In the original ***Caverns of Thracia***, minotaurs wielded a variety of weapons, such as battleaxes and halberds, instead of the greataxe they are normally associated with. While many of those weapon substitutions have been made here purely for historical consistency, the GM should feel free to ignore these variant weapons and keep the greataxe included as part of the standard minotaur stat block. Doing so has no significant impact on the adventure.

In addition, the original adventure gave minotaurs a bite attack and a butt attack, which have been replaced in the current version of the game by the minotaur's Gore attack. If you wish to use the bite and butt attacks instead, replace the minotaur's Gore attack with the following:

Bite: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d3 + 4) piercing damage.

Butt: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. ***Hit:*** 9 (2d4 + 4) bludgeoning damage.

If you make this replacement and decide to keep the minotaur's Charge trait, replace the word "gore" with "butt" in the trait's wording.

One other suggested modification, for the sake of making things easier on the GM, is to rule that all minotaurs in the caverns speak Draconic and Gnoll in addition to Abyssal, as this allows them to communicate with their beastfolk allies. Minotaurs responsible for overseeing tribal warriors (such as those in area 3-29) might speak Tribal Thracian as well.

- The heartwood of her tree can be used to craft a *+1 quarterstaff*.

Kore appears as an attractive middle-aged woman. From the vantage point of the air or from the steps of the chapel (area 3-14), she can often be seen sunning herself between patches of shade on the lawn surrounding her tree, couching her head on the scaly hide of the **golden lizard** (see appendix B) that guards her tree. The lizard is not very intelligent, but it has kept Kore safe for a millennium. Unfortunately, the lizard, the dryad, and her tree are now all slowly dying. The lizard's scales are losing their shine, and Kore's tree has several bare spots amongst its branches. Kore's lizard has a permanent *protection from normal missiles* spell (see appendix D) cast upon it.

Kore knows her way about the south wing of the palace and can give directions concerning the north wing. She has never been into the tunnels beneath the palace and knows nothing about them. Until recently, the beastfolk have left Kore and her pet alone, as they do not believe either of them to be a threat. Lately, however, the minotaur king and his lieutenants have begun to consider what an excellent source of wood her ancient tree could provide.

Development. If the characters attempt to enter this area from the air, the harpies from area 3-16 spot them and attack.

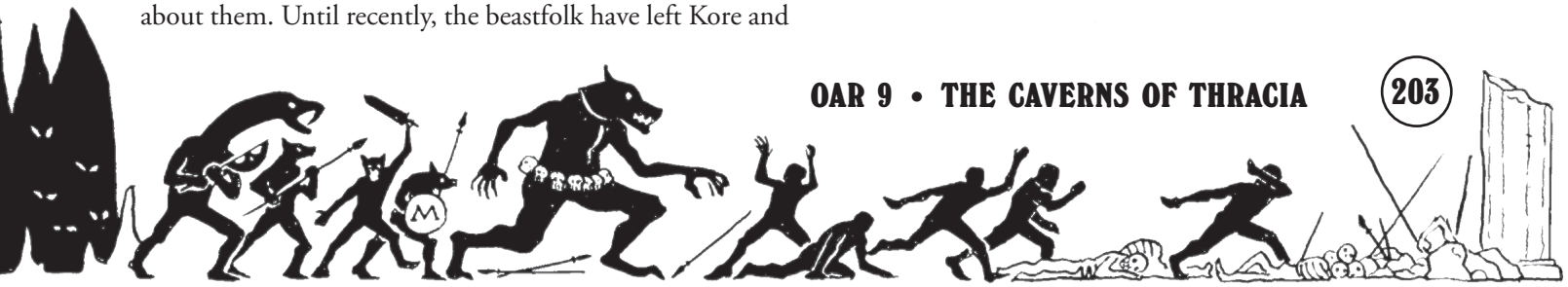
AREA 3-16 — JAILERS FOR A NOBLE TREE

A 12-foot-high stone wall encircles a circular area approximately 120 feet in diameter. Metal spikes and outward-facing shards of glass top the wall, seemingly to discourage anyone from climbing over it from the outside. Thick briars and brambles surround the wall at ground level.

The brambles surrounding the enclosure conceal a gate set into the northwest arc of the wall. Each 5-foot-cube of brambles has AC 16, 50 hp, and immunity to poison and psychic damage. Fire damages the brambles normally but does not spread. If the brambles take piercing or slashing damage, they exude a sickly smell that forces creatures within 5 feet to succeed at a DC 14 Constitution saving throw or fall unconscious for 10 minutes. Reducing a section of the brambles to 0 hit points creates a hole large enough for a Medium or smaller creature to pass through. However, the brambles regrow at a rate of 2 hit points per round. Once a section of cleared brambles regains 25 hit points, a creature in that space takes 4 (1d8) necrotic damage at the start of each of its turns and is restrained. A restrained creature can free themselves by using an action to make a successful DC 15 Strength (Athletics) or Dexterity (Acrobatics) check.

Five **harpies** perched atop the southeastern wall of the palace (near areas 3-24 through 3-27) guard this area. If the characters try to clear the brambles, the harpies use their Luring Song to lead characters away and devour them. If the characters attempt to enter area 3-15 from the air, the harpies swoop down and attack. Instead of clubs, each harpy is armed with a longsword (+3 to hit; 1d8 + 1 slashing damage, or 1d10 + 1 slashing damage if used with two hands).

Scaling the wall requires a successful DC 12 Strength (Athletics) check. However, a creature that climbs over the top of the wall must make a DC 15 Dexterity saving throw or take 7 (2d6) piercing damage from the spikes and shards of glass that top the wall.



AREAS 3-17 THROUGH 3-40 – THE PALACE OF THE MINOTAUR KING

This gleaming marble structure features a gabled roof, Ionic columns, and sculpture-filled pediments.

Although most of the palace's original furnishings are long gone, the building itself remains structurally sound. The rulers of this place have forbidden their subjects to deface the rooms and statuary.

GENERAL FEATURES (PALACE)

The palace on Level 3 is fully depicted on **Map 12**.

Ceilings and Walls. The ceilings inside the palace are 20 feet high unless otherwise specified in the room description. The palace's ceilings and walls are smooth, worked stone and require a successful DC 18 Strength (Athletics) check to climb.

Doors. Unless otherwise specified, doors inside the palace are made of wood reinforced with iron bands (AC 17, 27 hp, immunity to piercing, poison, and psychic damage) and are unlocked. Locked doors require a successful DC 15 Dexterity check with thieves' tools to open.

Illumination. The interior of the palace is dark unless a source of illumination is specified in the room's description.

Teleportation Pads. This level can be accessed via the teleportation pads located in area 3-1 near the east end of the gardens and area 3-36 in the palace. Utilizing these pads, characters can arrive from, and escape to, a similar teleportation pad in area 2-23.

WANDERING MONSTERS (PALACE)

Every 10 minutes the characters wander the palace, there is a 1 in 6 chance of a wandering encounter. Roll a 1d10 and consult the Level 3: The Palace table below.

LEVEL 3: THE PALACE (AREAS 3-17 THROUGH 3-40)

d10	Encounter
1	Gnoll patrol E
2	Lizardfolk patrol C
3	Human slaves
4	Minotaur king and his entourage
5	Minotaur guards
6	Hamadryad
7	Leaders of the beastfolk
8	Lizardfolk patrol C
9	Clerical minotaur cow
10	Random encounter from Level 3: The Gardens (reroll on Level 3: The Gardens Wandering Monsters table)

LEVEL 3: THE PALACE WANDERING MONSTER DESCRIPTIONS

Clerical Minotaur Cow. Bova, Minotaur Cleric (see appendix C and area 4-17), explores the dungeons.

Gnoll Patrol E. A party of eight **gnolls** patrol the area for intruders or escaped slaves. See the Gnoll Patrol Tables in the Level 1 Wandering Monsters section.

Hamadryad. Randomly select one of the **hamadryads** from areas 3-3 through 3-12 (roll 1d10) and then roll 1d20 on the Hamadryad Purpose Table to explain why they are encountered inside the palace.

Human Slaves. A troupe of eight **commoners** scrub walls, water trees, or trim shrubbery. They join the characters if freed, but the first time they encounter a beastfolk commander (of any race), they must succeed on a Wisdom saving throw contested by the commander's Charisma (Intimidation) check or immediately change sides and fall under the commander's sway. The slaves speak Tribal Thracian and some Gnoll.

Leaders of the Beastfolk. See area 3-30B for a description of this group.

Lizardfolk Patrol C. A patrol of six **lizardfolk** wanders the palace. There is a 50 percent chance a special patrol member accompanies them (see the Lizardfolk Patrol Tables in the Level 2 Wandering Monsters section).

Minotaur Guards. A pair of **minotaurs** patrol the area looking for anyone or anything that seems out of place.

Minotaur King and His Entourage. This group is fully described in area 3-19. There is a 45 percent chance that the king is accompanied by a second gnoll patrol (see the Gnoll Patrol Tables in the Level 1 Wandering Monsters section). If encountered multiple times, keep in mind that the king's grandmother, Bova (see appendix C and area 4-17), might cast *cure wounds* to heal any wounds the king has suffered.

AREA 3-17 – THE COURTYARD

The palace's courtyard is set with large, white marble tiles. The two pools of water flank the stairs that lead up to the palace proper.

The water in the pools is around 100 degrees Fahrenheit (38 degrees Celsius). The level of the palace floor is 10 feet higher than the courtyard.

A **hydra** guards the courtyard. If reduced to less than half its hit points (or if it loses more than half its heads), the hydra retreats into the temple, hissing and roaring to draw reinforcements. Determine these reinforcements by rolling on the Level 3: The Palace Wandering Monster table.

Treasure. Embedded between the eyes of each of the hydra's heads is a sapphire worth 100 gp.

AREA 3-18 – TEMPLE HALL OF THE GOD ZEUS

The stonework of this great hall is ornately carved and richly decorated with scenes of battle, magic-, and the lives of the gods. At the western end of the hall, a massive statue of a bearded, muscular man clutching a pair of crossed thunderbolts in his right hand sits upon a golden throne. A pair of crossed thunderbolts are carved into the curved wall behind the statue. Double doors made of gold are set into the northern and southern walls.

Characters who make a successful DC 10 Intelligence (History or Religion) check recognize the statue as a depiction of the god Zeus. If a creature approaches within 20 feet of the statue, the sounds of rolling thunder can be heard in the distance. A creature that touches the statue receives a harmless electric shock.

The northern and southern doors are gilded wood. A third set of double doors in the southern wall are disguised as relief sculpture panels and can be discovered on a successful DC 18 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check.

Treasure. The throne upon which the statue sits is gilt marble. Characters that take the time to strip the gilt from the throne can gather 1,000 gp worth of gold dust.

AREA 3-19 – THRONE ROOM OF THE MINOTAUR KING

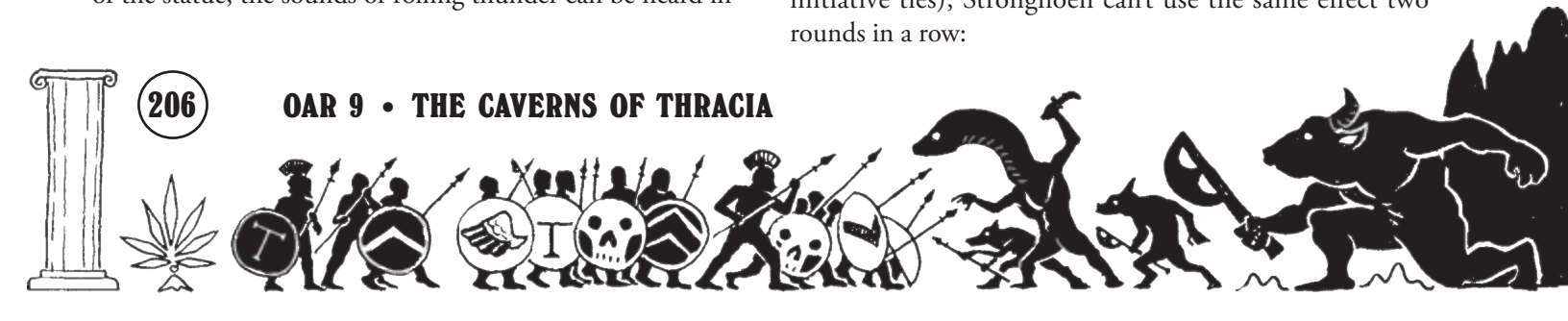
This ornately decorated throne room, 40-feet wide and over 100 feet long, appears to be badly in need of upkeep. The floor is carpeted, but worn and threadbare patches reveal the marble floor underneath. The walls are decorated with chipped and fading panels of low relief sculpture and intricately wrought paintings depicting hunts, ceremonies, banquets, and orgies. An oversized throne of crudely sculpted black stone sits in an alcove in the southern end of the chamber. The draperies on the wall behind the throne appear to be brittle with age. A pair of rusty braziers flank the throne, casting dim light throughout the chamber, along with a fine, greasy gray smoke.

Stronghoen, The Minotaur King (see appendix C), occasionally holds court in this chamber. The first time the characters visit this area, there is a 30 percent chance that Stronghoen is holding court with a group of six **gnolls** and Bitterbark, a **dogfolk** lieutenant (see appendix B), in attendance. Three of the gnolls are armed only with longbows (no spears). The other three are armed with longswords instead of longbows and spears (+4 to hit, 1d8 +2 slashing damage, or 1d10 +2 slashing damage if used with two hands). None of the gnolls carry shields (AC 13).

If attacked, Stronghoen and Bitterbark stick around long enough to ascertain how the battle is going. If it does not look good for their forces, they leave by the quickest route available.

The draperies on the southern wall part in the center. A character who searches behind the draperies and makes a successful DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check discovers a hidden door.

Lair Actions. When fighting inside his throne room, Stronghoen, The Minotaur King, can take a lair action to cause one of the following effects on initiative count 20 (losing initiative ties); Stronghoen can't use the same effect two rounds in a row:



- The fires in the braziers are immediately extinguished, plunging the room into darkness.
- The smoke from the braziers irritates the lungs of non-beastfolk. Each non-beastfolk creature in the throne room must make a DC 12 Constitution saving throw. On a failed save, the creature has disadvantage on the next attack roll or ability check it makes before the end of its next turn.
- Until initiative count 20 of the following round, each beastfolk in the throne room can pinpoint the location of non-beastfolk creatures within 120 feet.
- Each non-beastfolk creature in the throne room must make a DC 15 Wisdom saving throw or be affected as if by a *confusion* spell. The effect lasts until initiative count 20 of the following round.
- One creature Stronghoen can see must make a DC 15 Intelligence saving throw or be affected as if by a *maze* spell. The effect lasts until initiative count 20 on the next round.

If Stronghoen dies, all of the effects (excluding the extinguished braziers) immediately cease.

Treasure. Each gnoll carries 2d8 sp and 2d6 gp.

AREA 3-20 – THE SINGING CARYATIDS

At the southern end of this hallway, three 8-foot-tall, white marble statues of beautiful female humans stand on a ledge 3 feet above the floor. The statues support a lintel over a window overlooking the lawn outside.

The statues are **caryatid columns** (see appendix B). If touched, the statues begin to sing loud and beautifully, drawing the attention of any creatures in the southern wing of the palace. A non-beastfolk creature that hears the singing must make a DC 13 Wisdom saving throw. On a failed save, the target is paralyzed for as long as the columns continue singing. On a success, the target is immune to the singing for 24 hours. The columns continue singing for 1 minute and do not attack while they are singing.

AREA 3-21A – STOREROOM CLERK'S OFFICE

Seated at a desk in the north end of this 10-by-20-foot room is a little man, roughly 40 to 50 years old, reviewing stacks of paperwork. Two gnolls stand idly by, seemingly lost in conversation. There is a second door on the opposite side of the room.

Grassus, Storeroom Clerk (see appendix C), is in charge of the minotaur king's food stores. He is a trusted slave and prefers his position with the beastfolk to any possibility of freedom. If "freed," he inevitably betrays his liberators to his masters. Currently, Grassus is reviewing the list of stores, which are written in Modern Thracian (since the tribal warriors have no written language and the languages of the beastfolk are not suited to clerical tasks).

The two **gnolls** are armed with longswords instead of spears or longbows (+4 to hit; 1d8 +2 slashing damage, or 1d10 +2 slashing damage if used with two hands). If attacked, the gnolls call for help from area 3-21B.

AREA 3-21B – STOREROOM

This L-shaped room appears to be a stockroom. The walls are filled with shelves containing various urns, amphorae, and boxes. A group of humans seems to be inventorying the room's contents while six gnolls and a dogfolk wearing robes look on.

This is the palace's food warehouse. The containers on the shelves are filled with various foodstuffs, including grain, wine, olive oil, dried meat (beef and human), hard cakes, honey, nuts, flour, wild rice, spices, salt, dried fruit (apples and pears), and onions.

Five humans (treat as unarmed **commoners** who speak Gnoll and Tribal Thracian) inventory the contents of the room under the supervision of six **gnolls** armed with morningstars instead of spears and longbows (+4 to hit, 1d8 + 2 piercing damage) and a **dogfolk wizard** (see appendix B) named Wuffletree. Wuffletree is cowardly and surrenders or flees as soon as he thinks his life may be in danger.

In the room's southwest corner, a pair of double doors are hidden behind a pile of boxes containing dried figs. Characters who move the boxes or make a successful DC 14 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check while searching the room discover the doors.

AREA 3-22 – LAIR OF THE MINOTAUR KING

This 30-foot-square room appears to be very well-kept living quarters. Several pieces of stone furniture, many covered in fine furs, have been arranged around the edges of the room. The area is brightly lit by a combination of skylights set into the chamber's high ceiling and by a fire tended to by a trio of minotaurs in the center of the space. A medium humanoid, long past the point of saving, rotates on a spit over the fire. Two minotaur calves butt heads playfully on the far side of the room.

Stronghoen, the King of the Beastfolk, calls this chamber home. Three female minotaurs, all paragons of bovine beauty, tend the fire over which the roasted carcass of a female human turns. Two of the **minotaurs** are armed with carving knives (+6 to hit, 1d4 + 4 piercing or slashing damage) instead of greataxes. The third minotaur, the smallest of the three, is a **minotaur enchanter** (see appendix B). There is a 10 percent chance that **Stronghoen, The Minotaur King** (see appendix C and area 3-19), is also here.

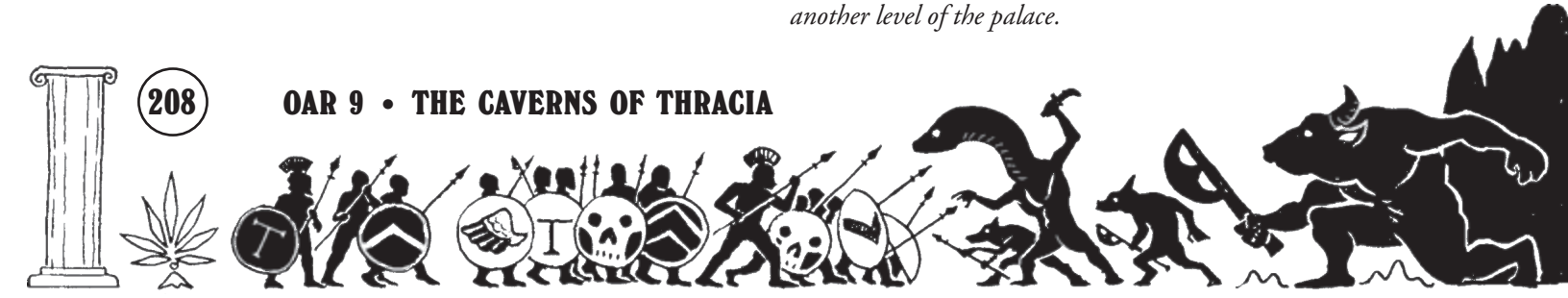
The two noncombatant minotaur calves immediately begin roughhousing with anyone who looks even vaguely human. The calves' "attacks" deal no damage; they are merely playing aggressively. The calves are only semi-intelligent and are always hungry. The largest of the three minotaurs is the mother of the calves and always uses her Reckless trait when protecting her young.

The secret doors at the end of the hallway to the north are visible from this side, but they are trapped. Unless the stone face in the center of the right-hand door is spun so that it is upside down when the door opens, a barrage of rocks drops from a trapdoor hidden in the ceiling. Each creature in the 10-foot-square area directly south of the doors when the rocks fall takes 14 (4d6) bludgeoning damage, or half as much damage with a successful DC 15 Dexterity saving throw. A character who makes a successful DC 19 Wisdom (Perception) check notices the trap before it is sprung. A character who makes a successful DC 21 Intelligence (Investigation) check can identify the trap's trigger, allowing them to bypass the trap without springing it.

Treasure. One of the stone benches serves a dual purpose as a storage chest. It contains 1,000 gp and a *potion of heroism*.

AREA 3-23 – STAIRWAY INTO THE DUNGEONS

This 15-foot-wide stone stairway leads down to the north, presumably descending deep enough that it will take you to another level of the palace.



The stairway leads to the dungeons beneath the palace. When the beastfolk took over the palace, they rigged the stairs with a pair of spear traps. The traps were set to keep slaves from escaping or bothering the manticores in area 4-1 and are regularly maintained.

A character that searches the walls of the stairway and makes a successful DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check discovers three holes in the wall obscured by a thin veneer of plaster. A character that searches the floor and makes a successful DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check discovers a cleverly hidden pressure plate. Each trap can be disabled by filling the holes on the wall with sealing wax, soap, an iron spike, or a similar item. Alternatively, a character can jam the pressure plate into position with pitons or spikes by making a successful DC 15 Dexterity check with thieves' tools.

A Medium or larger creature that steps into the areas indicated on **Map 12** or **Map 13** triggers the trap. If a trap is triggered, three spears fire horizontally across the stairs (+3 to hit, 1d10 piercing damage).

Developments. Noise in the stairway alerts the manticores in area 4-1. If alerted to intruders, the manticores prepare an ambush and attack any creatures that do not speak the correct passphrase before entering area 4-1. Determine the current passphrase by rolling 1d6 on the table below.

d6	Passphrase
1	The Rocks Bleed Black Blood
2	Speak the Spell
3	Lost Lairs of the Lizard King
4	Dead Men Tell No Tales
5	Kill the Humans
6	Thanatos is Dead

If they hear the correct passphrase, the manticores leave the speaker and their companions alone. The commander of each beastfolk patrol know the current passphrase.

AREA 3-24 – POOL OF WATERY WONDERS

This 40-foot-square room contains a 20-foot-diameter pool of water in its center. Judging from the steam that fills the air, the temperature of the pool is unexpectedly warm. The room's floor is covered with glazed ceramic tiles arranged in mosaics depicting fish, nymphs, sea gods, and sea monsters. At each of the cardinal points around the pool stands a 3-foot-high black marble pillar supporting an empty white marble bowl.

The pool is heated from below, ensuring a constant water temperature of 120 degrees Fahrenheit (49 degrees Celsius). The female minotaurs in area 3-22 occasionally use this area as a bath.

While the pool itself is not magical, the white marble bowls can be used to create several magical effects. Each of the bowls on pillars has arcane writing along its rim. Interpreting the writing requires a successful DC 15 Intelligence (Arcana) check. The minotaur king knows how the bowls function but has never used any of them. He does so only if he needs to protect his domain. Wuffletree, the **dogfolk wizard** (see appendix B) from area 3-21B, has used the eastern, western, and southern bowls. Any attempt to remove a bowl from the pillar upon which it rests permanently destroys the bowl's magical power. Once a bowl has been used, it can't be used again for 24 hours.

North Bowl: This bowl's writing describes a ritual for summoning a water elemental. The ritual requires filling the bowl with water from the pool and speaking the arcane words written on the rim. Doing so allows one creature involved in the ritual to cast the *conjure elemental* spell. When cast in this way, the spell summons a **water elemental** that has immunity (not just resistance) to bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing damage from nonmagical attacks.

East Bowl: This bowl's ritual allows a creature to cast the *locate object* spell. When cast in this way, the spell does not have the normal 1,000-foot range; instead, it can be used to locate any object in the caverns. In addition, the spell's duration changes to 1d6 hours. Once water from the pool has been added to the bowl, a glowing needle appears on the surface of the water and points in the direction of the designated object (pointing up or down, if necessary). Once the spell is cast, the bowl is designed such that the water can be poured into a different vessel, making the effect portable. When the spell ends, the water vaporizes into steam. A creature carrying the water when it vaporizes is scalded and takes 1 (1d3) fire damage.

South Bowl: This bowl's ritual allows a creature to cast the *clairvoyance* spell. When cast in this way, the spell does not have the normal 1-mile range; instead, any location within the caverns can be observed. In addition, the caster can observe up to four different locations before the spell's duration ends. When the ritual is complete, an image of the location being observed appears in the central pool. If the caster does not specify a location to observe, the bowl reveals a random room from Level 1, 2, or 3, or an area from 4-1 to 4-7.

West Bowl: This bowl's ritual creates a teleportation effect. To complete the ritual, first the southern bowl must be activated to select a destination, then the eastern bowl must be activated to locate the room depicted in the pool. At this point, the teleportation effect is considered "readied" and the image in the pool disappears. The effect remains readied as long as water remains in the pool and all three bowls. There is a cord on the underside of the west bowl that, when pulled, opens a drain in the bottom of the bowl. The bowl drains completely in 6 seconds. A creature that jumps into the central pool before the bowl drains teleports to the predetermined location, arriving slightly damp. If neither the southern or eastern bowl are activated before the western bowl is drained, the teleportation effect still functions, but it deposits anyone that jumps into the pool at a random destination (as determined by the southern bowl).

Each time a creature teleports in this way, roll 1d100. On a result of 1-50, the creature arrives at their destination 1d6 inches above the ground. The creature takes no damage from the fall but might suffer disadvantage on their initiative roll if they arrive in the middle of a combat. On a result of 51-90, the creature arrives 1d20 + 10 feet above the ground, taking falling damage as appropriate. On a result of 91-100, the creature arrives 1d10 feet below the ground. This result could produce a variety of undesirable outcomes and has been left for the GM to arbitrate.

It is possible to send the water elemental summoned via the northern bowl to another location by activating the southern, eastern, western, and northern bowls (in that specific order) to select a destination, ready the teleportation effect, summon the water elemental, and direct it to the teleport pool. Doing so completely empties the central pool. The minotaur king might use the bowls in this manner to attack intruders from a distance.

Development. Once emptied, the water in the pool refills after 30 minutes.

AREA 3-25 – WEAPONS ROOM OF THE DOGFOLK

Torn and faded drapes, each covered with the accumulated soot of many campfires, hang from the ceiling around the perimeter of this room. Shields likely once belonging to various tribal warriors hang on the walls. A pile of weapons lies in the northeast corner. Sets of wooden double doors on the eastern and western walls allow passage through the chamber. The room is illuminated by dim light coming in from the stained skylights above and a small campfire in the southern end of the room. Several reptilian humanoids notice your arrival.

The pile of weapons contains a stone mace, a bronze sword, a morningstar, a greatsword (snapped at the hit and unrepairable), and a spiked ball broken from another morningstar. When the characters arrive, two **lizardfolk** practice with weapons while a third looks on. The lizardfolk each carry four darts instead of javelins and spiked shields (+4 to hit, range 20/60 ft., 1d4 + 2 piercing damage; AC 13).

The wooden doors on the east wall are barred from the other side to prevent entry. The doors have AC 15, 27 hp, and immunity to piercing, poison, and psychic damage. The short hall beyond them contains two doors, one to the north and one to the south, both carved with images of goddesses, concubines, and scenes of passion. A single candle flickering in a sconce at the far end of the hall dimly illuminates this space.

AREA 3-26 – LUSH LAIR OF A DOGFOLK

If other areas of the palace are grim and devoid of finery, then it must have all been collected here. Colorfully vivid tapestries depicting the goddess of love and her paramours hang on the walls. A deep, luxurious carpet covers the floor, and the eastern side of the room is piled high with cushions and furs. A dog-like humanoid sits at a low table on the western side of the room, near a second dogfolk tending to a litter of a half-dozen pups. The table is set with artfully cut crystal ware, ripe fruits, and a huge beef roast simmering with juices. A pair of candles illuminates the chamber.

Two female **dogfolk** named Spittletongue and Sniffletail share this chamber with a litter of six noncombatant dogfolk pups. Spittletongue enjoys a meal at a *dining table* (see appendix D) while Sniffletail cares for the pups.

Treasure. In addition to the *dining table*, the room's tapestries, cushions, furs, and crystal ware could be sold for a total of 50 gp. The two candles each have a *continual flame* spell cast upon them.

AREA 3-27 – A SECOND LUSH LAIR

This room is thickly carpeted and decorated with ornate draperies. Cushions for reclining lie about everywhere. Four dog-like humanoids surround a tray of food set on the floor.

When the characters arrive, four **dogfolk** (Wark and his three sisters Flashtail, Prettyclaws, and Pinkfang) share a meal, enjoying each other's company. None of the sisters carry

longswords. The tray of food consists of a huge portion of beef, four goblets of wine, and several spice cakes.

Treasure. The room's three draperies are stitched with fine silver and gold thread and are worth 100 gp each. An unlocked chest covered with furs sits against the north wall. It contains 8,000 cp and 2,000 gp.

AREA 3-28 – A GNOLLIC GUARDPOINT

A half dozen gnolls armed with longswords are stationed at this guard post. Their stench all but overpowers the hint of cooked food that lingers in the air.

Six **gnolls** armed with longswords instead of spears and longbows (+4 to hit; 1d8 + 2 slashing damage, or 1d10 + 2 slashing damage if used with two hands) are stationed in this room. The gnolls do not carry shields (AC 13). The sounds of battle in this room draw the minotaurs from area 3-29.

Treasure. Each gnoll carries 1d8 sp and 1d4 gp.

AREA 3-29 – KITCHEN

This spacious 30-foot-square room serves as a kitchen and is noticeably warmer than the other areas in the palace. A half dozen human cooks are busy preparing food while a pair of minotaur guards watches over them. Fixtures on the ceiling fill the chamber with bright light. Double doors stand in the eastern and southern walls.

This kitchen serves the bulk of the troops living in the palace. The food cooked here is neither eye-appealing nor taste-tempting. Rather, it looks like a gray mush with greasy lumps floating in it. If a character manages to choke it down (by making a successful DC 18 Constitution saving throw), a bowlful of the mush serves as a day's rations. The mush lasts for up to 7 days before becoming moldy, a transformation that improves the taste but causes food poisoning unless the creature that eats it succeeds on a DC 20 Constitution saving throw. On a failed save, the creature is poisoned for 7 days.

The six human **commoners** (two female youths, a male child, an old woman, and a young man) who tend the kitchen have never known any life other than serving in the palace and are terrified of intruders. They speak Gnoll and carry no weapons. The commoners sleep here at night, covering the fixtures on the ceiling to block the *continual flame* spells that illuminate the room. A pair of **minotaurs** named Moos and Horrni oversee the commoners and protect the kitchen from invasions by hungry palace residents. The minotaurs are armed with battleaxes (+6 to hit; 2d8 + 4 slashing damage, or 2d10 + 4 slashing damage if used with two hands) and shields (AC 16) instead of greataxes. They moo loudly when engaged in combat, drawing the attention of one wandering monster and all other forces within 50 feet of the kitchen.

AREA 3-30A – THE GUARDS' GUARDS

The double doors open to reveal a gnoll guard armed with a halberd. Behind the gnoll, the corridor turns 90 degrees and out of sight.

Two **gnoll** guards armed with halberds (+4 to hit, reach 10 ft., 1d10 + 2 slashing damage) instead of longbows and spears are stationed in this area, one at each end of the hall. The guards stand with their backs against the eastern wall, facing the double doors to the west.

AREA 3-30B – OFFICE OF THE GUARD

This 15-by-30-foot room seems to be a conference room. Beastfolk of various types stand around an array of tables and desks, conversing with one another.

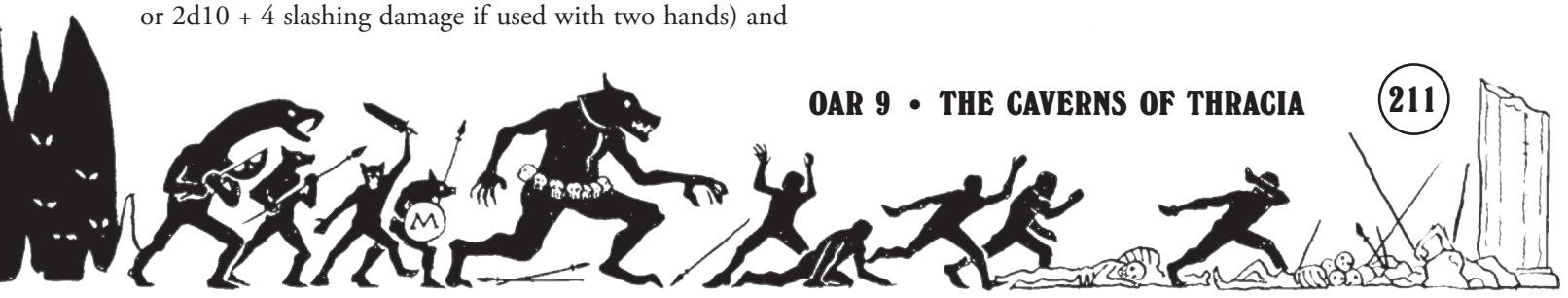
This area serves as the palace's chief guardroom, where the commanders of the various beastfolk discuss the placement of guards, the expansion of patrols, and the procurement of additional slaves and supplies. Gradsh, a **gnoll pack lord** armed with a longsword (+5 to hit; 1d8 + 3 slashing damage, or 1d10 +3 slashing damage if used with two hands) instead of a glaive and longbow commands the gnolls. The **minotaur** Bullick is the chief of the minotaurs and second in command only to his eldest son, Stronghoen, the minotaur king. The **dogfolk** Barkbite is the hetman of the dogfolk. The **lizardfolk** Hssssdk is the war leader of the lizardfolk mercenaries and does not carry a javelin.

Crude maps of the dungeon complex known to the beastfolk are rolled up on a desk against the southern wall (see **player handout 7**). The maps depict portions of the Levels 1, 2, 3, and 4, but no secret areas or sublevels (such as room complexes 2-17A-I, 2-23A-I, 2-31A-J, or Level 3A).

Treasure. A locked case requires a successful DC 15 Dexterity check with thieves' tools to open. The case contains 4,000 cp and 2,000 gp, organized into small bags of 100 coins each.

AREA 3-31 – BEAM OF BLASTING LIGHT

This room is a large dome, 50 feet in diameter and 40 feet from floor to peak. A shaft of light from the apex of the dome hits the floor in a 10-foot circle at the northern end of the room. A faint sizzle can be heard from where the light strikes the floor. A tribal warrior lies chained, spread-eagle, and face up, in the middle of



the floor. Three young, hyena-headed humanoids stand nearby, watching the beam of light expectedly.

The man on the floor is a tribal warrior named Holoste. Treat him as a **cult fanatic** with the following changes:

- His alignment is lawful evil.
- He carries no weapons or armor (AC 12).
- He speaks Modern Thracian and Tribal Thracian.
- In his Spellcasting trait, replace *command* and *shield of faith* with *cure wounds* and *protection from evil and good*, and *spiritual weapon* with *find traps*.

Holoste is a follower of The Dark One whose group was captured by a lizardfolk patrol in area 2-7.

The shaft of light from the dome moves down the wall and across the floor at a rate of 5 feet every 10 minutes. A creature that starts its turn inside the shaft is burnt by the magical light, taking 28 (8d6) fire damage, or half as much damage on a successful DC 18 Constitution saving throw. In 30 minutes, the light will fall on Holoste. Three noncombatant gnoll cubs (from area 3-34) excitedly wait for Holoste to die.

AREA 3-32 – AN...EMPTY ROOM

This 15-by-50-foot room seems to contain no way out save the way you entered. Unadorned marble panels highlight the east, west, and southern walls. A pair of giant, glowing, amber-colored eyes stare at you balefully from the northern wall.

Detecting any of the secret doors requires a successful DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check. Because all the doors are hidden in a similar manner, once a character has discovered one of the secret doors in this area, they have advantage on checks made to discover any others.

The eyes on the wall radiate a definite feeling of evil, chilling one's very soul. A creature that spends more than 30 seconds in the room must make a DC 18 Wisdom saving throw. Creatures immune to the charmed condition automatically succeed on the save. On a failed save, the creature is paralyzed for 10 minutes. On a success, the creature is immune to the effect until they leave and then reenter the room.

AREA 3-33 – HALL OF HARROWING HANDS

A 10-by-15-foot landing sits at the top of a 10-foot-wide staircase descending further underground.

If the characters step onto the stairs, read or paraphrase the following:

As you step onto the stairs, the walls sprout hands on disturbingly long arms, which reach out from both sides of the hall and attempt to touch you.

A total of 70 **harrowing hands** (see appendix B) reach from the eastern and western walls along the top 20 feet of the stairway. The hands are the same temperature as the surrounding rock walls but are soft like flesh. The hands merely brush creatures that pass by them and are harmless unless they are attacked. The arms can reach the center of the stairway. If provoked, 2d4 hands attack each creature on the stairs. The hands remain in this agitated state for the next 2 hours.

The steps lead down to Level 4. A character who inspects the walls at the bottom of the steps and makes a successful DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check discovers a secret door. If opened, the door opens onto another set of steps leading down to area 4-22.

AREA 3-34 – HABITAT OF GNOLL FEMALES AND CUBS

Whatever purpose this 30-foot-square room once served, it has since been turned into a gnoll den. Refuse lies everywhere, haphazardly arranged into piles that apparently serve as bedding. Countless gnoll pups run about the room playing, fighting, and crying. A dozen or more adult gnolls oversee the young.

Twenty unarmed female **gnolls** and 35 noncombatant cubs occupy the room. The cubs range in age from a few weeks to nearly a year old. The adult gnolls don't attack unless their pups are threatened. There are double doors in the western and southern walls of this room.

AREA 3-35 – THE INNER HABITAT

This 20-by-30-foot room appears to be the living area for a group of gnolls. Various pieces of improvised furniture, including cushions, bedding, and tables, are scattered haphazardly around the room. A group of adult gnolls and a few children socialize amongst the squalor.

These are quarters of six older **gnoll** matrons, whose wisdom rules this small tribe. As the males of the tribe know only how to bully and fight, the females control the society, allowing the males to think they are the ones making the important decisions. The matrons are unarmed but can still bite. There are four young, noncombatant cubs under their care.

Discovering the secret door on the western wall requires a successful DC 16 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check.

Treasure. One of the gnoll matrons sits on a box in the northeast corner of the room. The box contains 1,000 gp, a piece of turquoise (worth 50 gp), and four pieces of amber (worth 100 gp each).

AREA 3-36 – TEMPLE OF TELEPORTATION

This T-shaped room appears to have once been a great temple. The upper reaches of the walls are decorated with friezes of titanic battles between beast-headed humanoids and heroic gods and goddesses. Heaps of what appear to be the remains of statues dominate the northern and southern ends of the room. In the northeast portion of the room, a slightly raised, 10-foot-square area has a different appearance than the rest of the chamber's floor. Several baskets sit around this raised area. Angry snorts reverberate throughout the hall as you take in the scene.

Four **minotaurs** guard this area. The 10-foot-square raised section of floor (depicted on the map) is the third teleportation pad on this level. A creature that steps onto the pad teleports to the similar pad in area 3-1. The baskets near the edge of the pad contain small glass marbles. A creature carrying one of these marbles when it steps onto the pad teleports to area 2-23 instead of area 3-1. For safety's sake, none of the troops garrisoned on Level 1 or Level 2 carry such marbles.

AREA 3-37 – CONNECTING HALL

This door opens into a 10-by-45-foot corridor running east to west. Opposite the door, three more doors, roughly equidistant from each other, stand in the southern wall.

This hall connects the three gnoll warrior barracks (areas 3-38 through 3-40). When the characters arrive, there is a 50 percent chance that a single **gnoll** guard is on duty. The guard is armed with a light crossbow (+3 to hit, range 80/320, 1d8 + 1 piercing damage) instead of a longbow, and a morningstar (+4 to hit, 1d8 + 2 piercing damage) instead of a spear.

AREA 3-38 THROUGH 3-40 – THE BARRACKS OF THE GNOLL GUARDS

Makeshift beds of leaves, tree branches, and discarded scraps of cloth fill this room. Several creatures sleep on the squalid bedding, while others interact noisily, seemingly unconcerned with disrupting their brethren's rest.

The gnolls on this level usually come here when off duty to find a place to sleep. There are 1d6 + 5 **gnolls** in each of these rooms at any given time. Patrols leave and return so frequently that one can never be certain where a specific gnoll will be at a given time.

Unless alerted to intruders, at least 60 percent of each room's occupants are asleep, while the rest pass the time eating or gambling. A character that searches the bedding in the southeast corner of area 3-40 discovers a 5-foot-square trapdoor in the floor. The trapdoor opens into a 5-foot-square shaft with rungs set into the stone. The shaft descends 70 feet into area 4-21.

Treasure. Each gnoll carries 1d12 sp and 1d8 gp.

CHAPTER NINE

LEVEL 4

GENERAL FEATURES

Level Four is depicted on **Maps 13** and **14**.

Ceilings and Walls. The ceilings of Level 4 are 20 feet high unless otherwise specified in the room description. The ceilings and walls are smooth, worked stone carved out of the bedrock and require a successful DC 18 Strength (Athletics) check to climb.

Doors. Unless otherwise specified, doors are made of wood reinforced with iron bands (AC 17, 27 hp, immunity to piercing, poison, and psychic damage) and are unlocked. Locked doors require a successful DC 15 Dexterity check with thieves' tools to open.

Illumination. This far underground, all areas are in darkness unless a source of illumination is specified in the room's description.

Level Connections. There are three entrances to this level from above. These include:

- The stairs from area 3-23 lead to area 4-1.
- The stairs from area 3-33 lead to area 4-22.
- The shaft in area 3-40 descends to area 4-21.

WANDERING MONSTERS

Every 10 minutes the characters wander this level (except for area 4-23), there is a 1 in 6 chance of a wandering encounter. Roll 1d10 and consult the table below.

GM Note. There is no chance of a wandering monster in area 4-23, but an encounter just outside of that area should be rolled on the Level 3: The Gardens Wandering Monster table.

d10	Encounter
1	Gnoll patrol E
2	Lizardfolk patrol C
3	Human slaves
4	Minotaur king and his entourage
5	Minotaur guards
6	Hamadryad
7	Leaders of the beastfolk
8	Lizardfolk patrol C
9	Clerical minotaur cow
10	Random encounter from Level 3: The Gardens (reroll on Level 3: The Gardens Wandering Monsters table)

LEVEL 4 WANDERING MONSTER DESCRIPTIONS

Clerical Minotaur Cow. Bova, Minotaur Cleric (see appendix C and area 4-17), explores the dungeons.

Gnoll Patrol E. A party of eight **gnolls** patrol the area for intruders or escaped slaves. See the Gnoll Patrol Tables in the Level 1 Wandering Monsters section.

Hamadryad. Randomly select one of the **hamadryads** from areas 3-3 through 3-12 (roll 1d10) and then roll 1d20 on the Hamadryad Purpose Table to explain why they are encountered on this level.

Human Slaves. A troupe of eight **commoners** scrub walls, water trees, or trim shrubbery. They join the characters if freed, but the first time they encounter a beastfolk commander (of any race), they must succeed on a Wisdom saving throw contested by the commander's Charisma (Intimidation) check or immediately change sides and fall under the commander's sway. The slaves speak Tribal Thracian and some Gnoll.

Leaders of the Beastfolk. See area 3-30B for a description of this group.

Lizardfolk Patrol C. A patrol of six **lizardfolk** wanders this level. There is a 50 percent chance a special patrol member accompanies them (see the Lizardfolk Patrol Tables in the Level 2 Wandering Monsters section).

Minotaur Guards. A pair of **minotaurs** patrol the area looking for anyone or anything that seems out of place.

Minotaur King and His Entourage. This group is fully described in area 3-19. There is an additional 45 percent chance that the king is accompanied by a second **gnoll** patrol (see the Gnoll Patrol Tables in the Level 1 Wandering Monsters section). If encountered multiple times, keep in mind that the king's grandmother, Bova (see appendix C and area 4-17), might cast *cure wounds* to heal any wounds the king has suffered.

HAMADRYAD PURPOSE TABLE

If a hamadryad is indicated as a Wandering Monster on this level, roll 1d20 and consult the following table to determine the reason for the encounter.

d20	Reason For Being in The Dungeon
1-8	The hamadryad is a captive escorted by two **gnolls**. The gnolls do not carry shields (AC 13), spears, or longbows. They are instead armed with longswords, which they wield with two hands (+4 to hit, 1d10 + 2 slashing damage).
9-12	The hamadryad is attempting to escape captivity. There is a 50 percent chance that 1d4 **gnolls** pursue her.
13-14	The hamadryad now serves the minotaur king and leads the adventurers into a trap.
15-16	The hamadryad is dying (80 percent chance) or is already dead (20 percent chance). There is a 60 percent chance that a gnoll patrol stands over her body. Determine the gnoll patrol randomly by using the Gnoll Patrol Tables from the Level 1 Wandering Monsters section.
17-19	The hamadryad is hiding and attempts to remain hidden, even from the adventurers.
20	The hamadryad is insane and allowed to freely wander about. She bears the marks of torture; her face is marred by scars.

AREA 4-1 – THE MANTICORES

This room appears to have once been a banquet hall. The ceiling is 30 feet high, and the walls are decorated with flaking murals of sumptuous banquets and expansive gardens. Several rotting wood couches are strewn about the room, along with shattered marble slabs that might once have served as tables. Six ceramic urns stand against the north wall.

Two **manticores** hide in this chamber, tail spikes at the ready. They ambush creatures that enter the room via the stairs without speaking a valid passphrase (see area 3-23 for the current proper passphrase).

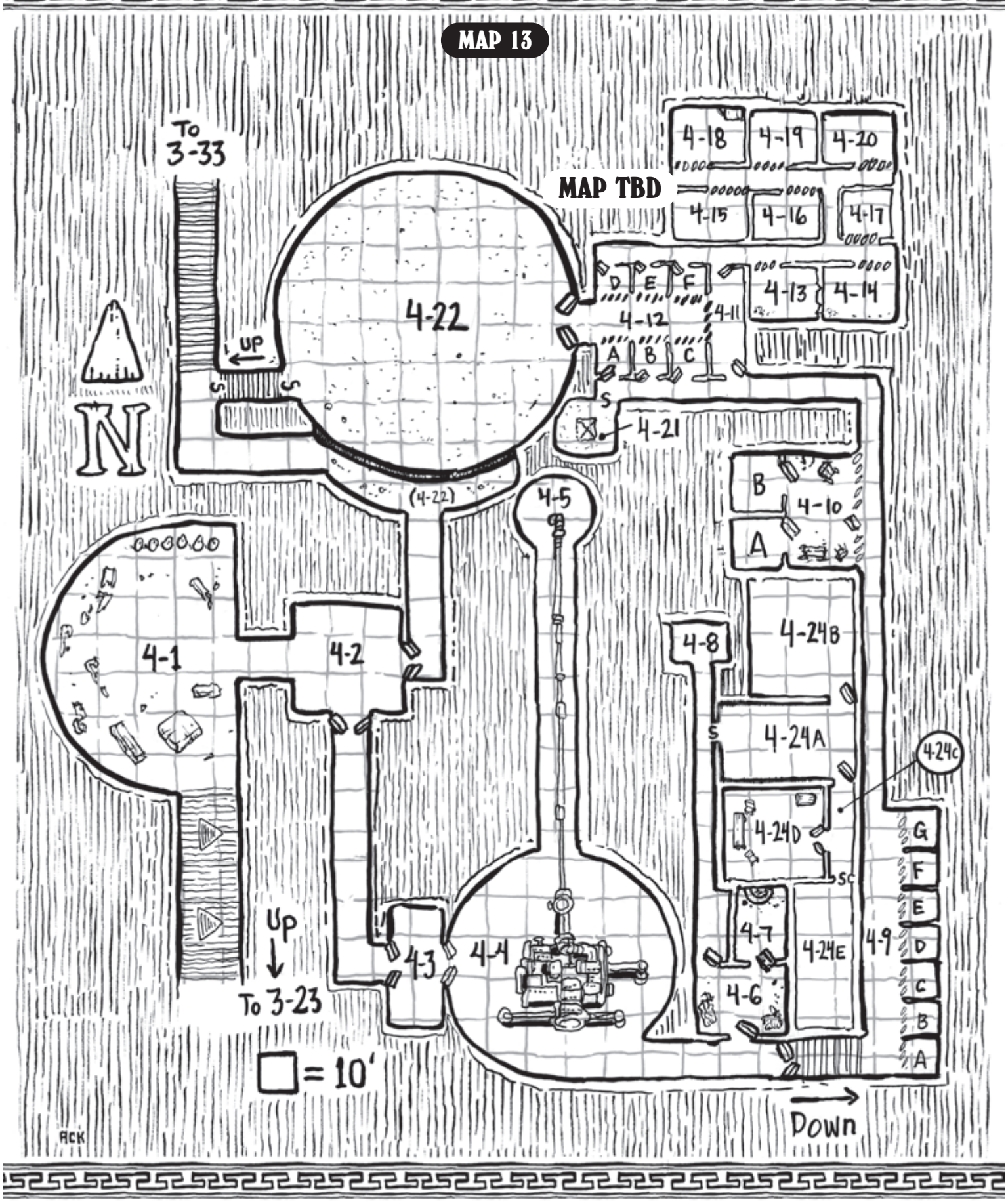
Treasure. The urns against the north wall each contain 660 gp. The first urn also holds a *potion of mind control* (hill giant) (see appendix D). The fifth urn also contains a *potion of polymorph* (see appendix D), and the sixth urn also holds a sentient magic item known as the *Dark Blue Blade* (see appendix D).

AREA 4-2 – A VACANT CHAMBER

GM Note. The doors on the northern and eastern walls are locked and require a successful DC 15 Dexterity check with thieves' tools to open.

The walls of this 30-foot-square room are carved with bas-relief friezes of humans fighting beasts of all sorts.

Development. If the characters enter this room from the south or east, there is a 25 percent chance that 1d2 **manticores** from area 4-1 are here when they arrive, unless the party has already dealt with them.


MAP 13
MAP TBD
To 3-33
4-18
4-19
4-20
4-15
4-16
4-17
4-22
4-12
4-11
4-13
4-14
4-21
4-5
4-10
4-1
4-2
4-8
4-24B
4-24A
4-24C
4-24D
4-7
4-24E
4-9
4-3
4-4
4-6
UP
To 3-23
= 10'
Down
RCK

AREA 4-3 – A LIZARDFOLK GUARDPOST

GM Note. Both sets of heavy oak doors leading into this room are barred from the inside. The doors have AC 15, 54 hp, and immunity to piercing, poison, and psychic damage. The doors must be broken down unless the characters find a sneaky way in.

This 30-by-15-foot room serves as a guard post. A second set of heavy oak doors, opposite the ones you entered through, are barred from this side.

Four **lizardfolk** guards are stationed here. Instead of javelins, the lizardfolk each carry four darts (+4 to hit, range 20/60 ft., 1d4 + 2 piercing damage).

Development. If the characters spent more than a minute or two forcing their way into the room, an additional eight lizardfolk from area 4-4 are here, waiting to do battle.

AREA 4-4 – THE BILIOUS BOILER ROOM

Smoke and steam fill this 60-foot-diameter room. A massive bronze machine dominates the center of the space. A large pipe extending from the contraption heads out of the room and down a corridor to the north. A dozen humans tend the machine, working bellows and feeding a fire, while several armed lizardfolk look on.

The enormous machine is a boiler that provides the hot water for the various pools and basins on this level of the palace. It is a huge bronze device heated by wood placed in a firebox beneath it. The boiler fills the room with smoke and steam, making the entire chamber lightly obscured.

The boiler has AC 17 and is immune to fire, necrotic, poison, and psychic damage. If the boiler takes 25 damage or more, it ruptures 1d6 rounds later. When the boiler ruptures, scalding water sprays from the contraption for the next 2 rounds. A creature within 10 feet of the boiler when it ruptures or that starts its turn in that area takes 4 (1d8) fire damage.

A total of 12 male humans tend to the boiler (treat them as unarmed **commoners** that speak Tribal Thracian and some Gnoll). Ten of the humans work the bellows, while the remaining two feed wood into the firebox. The humans are guarded by 10 **lizardfolk**, each of which carry four darts

instead of a javelin (+4 to hit, range 20/60 ft., 1d4 + 2 piercing damage). Pipes from the boiler lead up to the pools and are controlled by two large valves.

Development. Even if the lizardfolk are drawn to combat elsewhere, at least two remain here to prevent the humans from escaping.

AREA 4-5 – THE GUARD AT THE PIPE

Following the water pipe down a long corridor, you find that it ends in a 20-foot-diameter room, where it disappears into the ground. A lone lizardfolk, possibly a guard or plumbing inspector, is the only occupant of this steamy chamber.

A single **lizardfolk** guards the pipe against sabotage and inspects it for possible leaks. At this distance, the smoke from area 4-4 has largely dissipated, but the air remains steamy. Fortunately, the lizardfolk enjoys the humidity. Instead of a javelin, the lizardfolk guard carries four darts (+4 to hit, range 20/60 ft., 1d4 + 2 piercing damage).

AREA 4-6 – BARRACKS OF THE LIZARDFOLK MERCENARIES

This room appears to be a barracks. Several lizardfolk lounge around the room, devouring disgusting foodstuffs or simply relaxing. Two additional doors can be seen on the far northern wall.

There are 3d4 **lizardfolk** in this room at any time. If surprised, it takes them a full round to arm themselves. The lizardfolk in this room do not carry javelins and have AC 13 until they can retrieve their shields.

AREA 4-7 – SHRINE OF THE ANCIENT ONES AND THE TREASURE VAULT

This shrine is 15 feet wide and 20 feet long. It contains a simple stone carving of a lizardfolk with mismatched eyes sitting atop a short marble pillar. Several rolls of what appear to be parchment have been draped over the statue's head. In front of this makeshift altar sits a small serving tray. Atop the tray are two vials and what looks like a rolled-up sheet of reptile hide.

Two **lizardfolk** protect the shrine. Instead of javelins, they each carry four darts (+4 to hit, range 20/60 ft., 1d4 + 2 piercing damage). Both lizardfolk know one of the potions on the tray is a *potion of mind control* (human) (see appendix D) and scramble to drink it if humans attack them. They don't know what the other potion does (see Treasure) but regard the rolled-up reptile hide as a great artifact, even though they don't know what it is.

The lizardfolk mercenaries use this chamber to worship their ancient ancestors. A character who makes a successful DC 12 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Medicine) check recognizes that the "parchment" draped over the statue are actually strips of flayed human skin: offerings to the revered ancestor depicted by the statue.

Over the centuries, the lizardfolk have discovered various treasures related to the ancient reptilefolk culture that once existed. A character who makes a successful DC 12 Intelligence (Nature) check identifies the hide on the tray as having once belonged to an ancient, tough-skinned reptile (a dinosaur). The hide is protected by a powerful magical effect: the first non-lizardfolk to unfurl the hide must succeed on a DC 17 Wisdom saving throw or be magically polymorphed into a small, extinct reptile (treat as a **lizard**).

The hide contains a map annotated in an unknown, dead language. A *comprehend languages* spell deciphers the writing. The map explains how to reach the grand temple of the reptile race. The route starts in area 2-22, leads to area 2-31,

and reveals the secret door from that room to the rest of the complex (areas 2-31A-J) (see **player handout 8**).

The statue's mismatched eyes are gemstones (see Treasure). If the characters steal any of the gems, every lizardfolk mercenary deserts their post and begins to hunt the thieves. If the lizardfolk do not recover the gems within a few hours, they use the pool in area 3-24 to locate the gems and teleport to the gems' current location. The initial group consists of 4d6 + 1 lizardfolk, and subsequent groups continue to arrive every 40 minutes until a total of 60 lizardfolk have died or the gemstones have been returned.

Treasure. The left eye is a peridot (worth 1,000 gp) and the right eye is a sapphire (worth 5,000 gp). A chip of amber (worth 10 gp) and a jade stone (worth 500 gp) also decorate the statue. The two potions on the tray are a *potion of invisibility* and a *potion of mind control* (human) (see appendix D).

AREA 4-8 – GREEN SLIME GARDEROBE

Approximately 30 feet before this hallway opens into a room at the far end, the walls, floor, and ceiling begin to drip with a viscous green substance. The slime continues into the room beyond, where you see what appears to be a closed door set into the north wall.

The walls of the hallway before the green slime begins are plastered over. In recent years, however, a large chunk of the plaster has fallen away, revealing the stone wall underneath for the first time in centuries. A character who examines the exposed wall and makes a successful DC 21 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check discovers a secret door. The door leads to area 4-24A.

The greenish slime is unpleasant but harmless. The room at the end of the corridor once served as a privy. Over the centuries, the slime here grew in response to the incredible amount of "nutrients" available to it.

There is no door in the room at the end of the hallway; it just looks like the outline of one. Characters within 30 feet of the north wall can confirm this fact by making a successful DC 21 Wisdom (Perception) check.

AREA 4-9 – THE CELLS OF THE TRIBAL WARRIORS

Numerous tribal warriors are imprisoned in these 10-by-10-foot cells, presumably held captive by the various beastfolk tribes.

At night, the cells contain the prisoners listed on the table below. During the daylight hours, only the 1d2 oldest prisoners are in each cell. The others are escorted to their various jobs around the palace, up through area 4-4, over to the stairs in area 3-23, and into the throne room in area 3-19. Older prisoners, useless to their masters, are left behind to take care of the cells. Treat all the prisoners as non-combatant, unarmed **commoners** that speak Tribal Thracian and some Gnoll.

Cell	Prisoners
A	Three men, two women
B	Two old women, one man, one girl
C	Three men, one woman, one boy
D	Three old women, one man
E	Two men, two women, one old man
F	Three women, one man, one old woman, one boy
G	Two women, one old man, one boy, one girl

AREA 4-10 – THE TORTURE CHAMBER

This 20-by-30-foot room is filled with all manner of archaic torture devices. None of the devices are complex in design, but

they are likely quite effective despite their relative simplicity. Two heavy, reinforced doors stand in the back wall of the room.

This room is run by a **dogfolk** named Fangfriend and three **gnolls** armed with halberds instead of spears and longbows (+4 to hit, reach 10 ft., 1d10 + 2 slashing damage). They know about the treasure secreted away in area 4-21. Characters who threaten their lives can bully the beastfolk into revealing the location of the treasure by making a successful DC 10 Charisma (Intimidation) check.

This area is rarely used, but captured adventurers might be brought here and held captive in the cell in area A. The cell's door is solid oak (AC 15, 27 hp, immunity to piercing, poison, and psychic damage). While locked, the door requires a successful DC 15 Dexterity check with thieves' tools to open. Meanwhile, the characters' possessions are locked in area B, except for items of obvious value, which the gnolls and dogfolk in charge of this area deliver to area 4-21.

Developments. Characters imprisoned here are mistreated by their captors. Every 10 minutes a character spends in the room, there is a 40 percent chance they are abused to the point that they must succeed on a DC 15 Constitution saving throw or suffer a level of exhaustion. The DC of this save increases by 2 for every successive save that must be made.

AREA 4-11 – AN ABANDONED GUARD ROOM

This empty guard room watches over the prison cells to the west. A row of levers is mounted on the walls directly north and south of the barred gate overlooking the cells. Only one lever, the one furthest to the north, is currently in the "down" position.

On the western wall, just south of the bars, is a series of three levers in the "up" position. Pulling down on any of them raises the bars of one of the southern cells in area 4-12. From south to north, the southern levers operate cells A, B, and C. Similarly, there are four more levers in the wall north of the bars. The lever closest to the bars opens the doors into area 4-22. The remaining three levers, from south to north, operate cells F, E, and D respectively. Only the northernmost lever is in the "down" position; from this room, it is clear the gate for cell D in area 4-12 is already up.

Characters who try to bend the bars or lift the gates without using the levers must succeed on a DC 19 Strength (Athletics) check to do so.

AREA 4-12 – GLADIATORIAL CELLS

These 10-foot-square cells are reminiscent of prison cells, with barred doors that face each other across a central corridor. Each cell, however, also has a normal door, allowing the occupant to exit through the back wall. Several tiny vermin, uninterested in your presence, scurry around the straw-lined floors of these cells.

These cells were used to hold combatants in preparation for the ancient gladiatorial contests once held in area 4-22. Several **rats** and **spiders** explore each cell, but they ignore the adventurers unless provoked. The barred doors of each cell are down except for cell D, which is up. The levers in area 4-11 open and close the cell gates, as well as the double doors leading to area 4-22.

AREA 4-13 – ANCIENT ANIMAL HOLDING CELL

This room appears to have once served as a cage for a large animal, but the cell is now empty.

This room was once used to keep animals and monsters for gladiatorial combat.

AREA 4-14 – MINOTAUR LAIR I

This room is reminiscent of a large cage or prison cell, as the now-open door consists of several vertical bars spaced several inches apart.

A **minotaur** cow and her two calves (treat as unarmed **commoners**) occupy this cell. The mother protects her calves, both only about a week old, if they are threatened. Instead of a greataxe, she wields a mace (+6 to hit, 2d6 + 4 bludgeoning damage).

Treasure. A wooden chest against the southern wall holds 600 gp.

AREAS 4-15 AND 4-16 – ANCIENT ANIMAL HOLDING CELLS

This room looks like it may once have served as a cage for a large animal, but the cell is now empty.

These rooms were once used to keep animals and monsters for gladiatorial combat.

ACK

AREA 4-17 – MINOTAUR LAIR II

This cell houses a single minotaur. The creature appears quite old, and it is unclear if it is aware of your presence.

This cell serves as the home for **Bova, Minotaur Cleric** (see appendix C). Bova is the elderly grandmother of the minotaur king and is partially blind. She does not initiate combat and hesitates to defend herself, even if attacked.

AREA 4-18 – THE TREASURE TROVE OF THE MINOTAUR KING

The pungent smell of sweaty fur permeates this 15-by-25-foot cell. Inside, a minotaur and a dogfolk stand watch over a stone box. Near where the walls meet the ceiling, a recessed channel makes its way around the room's perimeter, creating a "shelf" just below the ceiling.

A **minotaur** named Thundahuuf and a **dogfolk wizard** (see appendix B) named Woofworth guard the minotaur king's treasure in this chamber. Woofworth has *magic missile* prepared in place of *sleep*.

An invisible box sits on the seemingly empty shelf in the southeast corner of the room. Finding the box requires a successful DC 30 Wisdom (Perception) check. Not even the minotaur king and his minions are aware of its presence. Inside the box are a glowing, green glass globe and a strange brass box with a hand pointing upward on its top and a crank on its side. The glass globe is the powering element for the teleportation pad in area 3-36. If the globe is broken or removed from the palace, the glow fades and the teleporter ceases to function, neither sending nor receiving.

The brass box is a summoning agent for the elevator basket that lowers from area 3A-9. To operate the box, a creature must point the hand upward and turn the crank, generating a magical force that causes the basket to descend to the floor of Level 3. The box only works on Level 3, and only outside the palace. It takes approximately 10 minutes for the basket to fully descend, and at least 1 minute before it emerges from the mists that blanket the ceiling of the cavern. These two items were hidden here by the last remaining humans in the palace when the beastfolk took over 1,100 years ago.

Treasure. The stone box contains 2,000 sp and 5,000 gp. Beneath the coins is a locked iron box of ornate design studded with four diamonds (worth 4,000 gp). Picking the lock of the iron box requires a successful DC 15 Dexterity check with thieves' tools. Opening the box releases a **disembodied mouth** (see appendix B) like the one that guards the chests in area 2-9. The iron box contains a longsword sheath formed of thin plates of citrine (worth 1,700 gp), a set of gold, silver, and pink coral beads (worth 2,900 gp), a *figurine of wondrous power* (marble elephant), and a desiccated, severed finger still wearing a *ring of contrariness* (see appendix D).

AREAS 4-19 AND 4-20 – ANCIENT ANIMAL HOLDING CELLS

This room looks like it may once have served as a cage for a large animal, but the cell is now empty.

These rooms were once used to keep animals and monsters for gladiatorial combat.

AREA 4-21 – TORTURERS' TREASURE

This small, roughly carved room features a chimney shaft in its 6-foot-high ceiling.

The chimney is large enough for a Medium or smaller creature to navigate. It leads up to area 3-40. A character who makes a successful DC 20 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check discovers a loose floor tile. Lifting the tile reveals a patch of earth that has recently been disturbed.

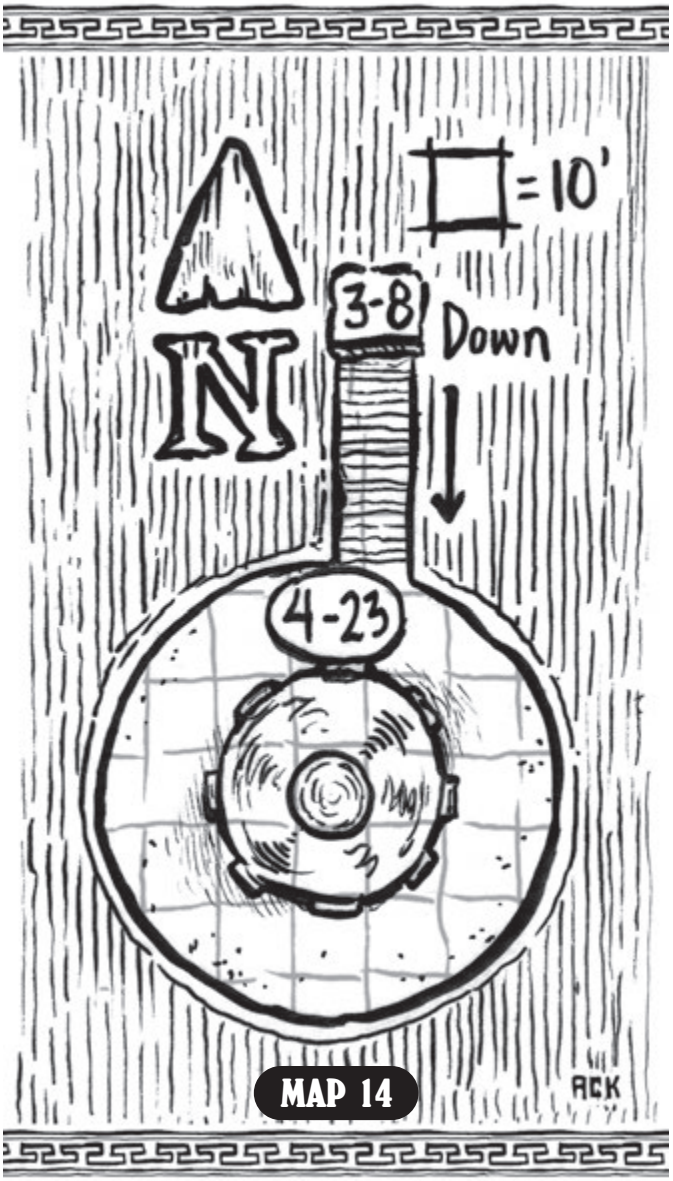
Treasure. Buried in the dirt beneath the floor tile is the treasure the torturers in area 4-10 have extorted from their victims. The treasure consists of 200 sp, a silver amulet (worth 50 gp), and a woven mithral cloak studded with bloodstones (worth 2,300 gp).

AREA 4-22 – AN ANCIENT ARENA

This 80-foot-diameter chamber has a 40-foot-high ceiling and a floor covered in sand. To the south, a balcony of box seats overlooks the central area, 20 feet above floor level.

The balcony once housed ornate box seats separated by elegant draperies. All that remains now are a few shattered statues and some shreds of faded fabric. When the characters arrive, there is a 25 percent chance that a band of six **lizardfolk** are here practicing with longswords. Instead of heavy clubs or javelins, the lizardfolk are armed only with longswords (+2 to hit, 1d8 + 2 slashing damage). The lizardfolk are not yet proficient with longswords, hence their lower attack bonus.

A character who searches the walls of the arena and makes a successful DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check discovers a secret door. If opened, the door reveals a set of steps that lead to a L-shaped hallway that connects the area's balcony with a stairwell to area 3-33.



AREA 4-23 – THE LOST ESCAPE TUBES

GM Note. This area is depicted on **Map 14**.

The stairs descend to a 60-foot-diameter room with a 30-foot-high ceiling. Tree roots reach down through small cracks in the ceiling. In the center of the room sits a 30-foot-diameter dome of polished bronze. Rising from the center of the dome is a 10-foot-diameter column of transparent glass. The column is filled with gurgling water that flows upward. Located at eight equally spaced positions about the circumference of the dome are openings with hinged doors.

Knowledge of this chamber, as well as the device it contains, was lost in the beastfolk coup over 1,100 years ago. Located under the roots of the tree in area 3-8 is a rusted bronze trap door covered by several inches of sod and dirt. A successful Intelligence (Investigation or Nature) or Wisdom (Perception or Survival) against DC 14 performed in that area reveals something hard hidden below the roots and earth. If the dirt is moved, a 5-foot-square door covered in verdigris is revealed. A successful DC 14 Strength (Athletics) check allows this hatch to be pried open to reveal a 10-foot drop into a 10-foot-square room with stairs to the south leading down into this room.

Opening any of the hinged doors around the bronze dome reveals an enclosed space large enough to fit a single Medium or smaller creature. A character that enters the space and closes the hatch finds themselves trapped inside a sealed, can-like container. The can is then released into the rising water column and carried up to area 2-10, where it begins floating downstream. A can that doesn't become stuck in the spiderweb at area 2-8 eventually lodges beneath the bridge in area 2-1. Once sealed, a can must be forced open (AC 20, 27 hp, damage threshold 15, immunity to necrotic, poison, and psychic damage).

AREA 4-24 – THE MYSTERIOUS (NO LONGER) MISSING CHAMBER

Many years ago, an architect working on the dungeon level of Agamemnos's palace found a way to engineer a hidden space for herself in an area of the dungeon that would have otherwise gone unused. Unfortunately, the architect passed away (through an accident of her own making) before her work was finished. Since the secret door leading to the area was of such high quality, the architect's "secret apartment" remained hidden and was eventually plastered over. Since then, a large chunk of the plaster has fallen away, revealing the hidden space for the first time in centuries. The secret door now requires a successful DC 21 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check to discover.

Repairing the plaster to hide the secret door again requires an hour of work and a successful DC 15 Dexterity check with mason's tools.

AREA 4-24A – THE HIDDEN CHAMBER

A musty smell hits your nostrils the moment you expose them to this dark chamber. Behind the secret door lies an approximately 40-foot-long, 20-foot-wide chamber, with two exits at the far eastern end. A large stone block, maybe 5 feet high and 10 feet wide, is wedged into the southeastern exit. Across from it is the rough outline of a door in the northern wall.

THE STRANGE CASE OF AREA 102

In the original *Caverns of Thracia*, areas 4-7 through 4-10 were originally numbered as areas 100, 101, 103, and 104. There was no area numbered 102 on the original map. In the text of the adventure, however, there *was* an area 102 with the following description:

"Look as you might, you will not find this room on the map. It never was there and exists only in the mind of the designer, who refuses to admit that she may have made an oversight with numbering her creation and doesn't feel like sticking the number '102' somewhere on the map and letting it go at that."

If you look at the map for Level 4 (**Map 13**), you will notice there is a perfect spot in the middle of areas 4-7 through 4-10 (the original areas 100, 101, 103, and 104) to fit the "missing 102." So, we did. Room complex 4-24 was added specifically for this new version of *Caverns of Thracia*. We hope you enjoy it!

The walls of this chamber are roughly finished stone devoid of artwork or other decoration. A heavy stone door in the north wall opens into area 4-24B. Pushing open the door requires a successful DC 14 Strength (Athletics) check. The door can also be destroyed (AC 17, 27 hp, immunity to piercing, poison, and psychic damage).

The exit in the southern wall opens into area 4-24C. Currently, however, the exit is partially blocked by a massive stone block. The block weighs over a ton and was originally intended as part of an elaborate trap designed by the architect who, unfortunately, met her fate during its construction. The skeletal remains of two arms sticking out from underneath the block, a smashed block and tackle kit, and several discarded mason's tools serve as clues to what exactly happened here.

Medium creatures can squeeze through the space between the block and the top of the exit. Smaller creatures can easily climb through the space.

Treasure. An incomplete set of mason's tools is scattered on the floor near the entrance to area 4-24C. Spending 5 gp to replace the missing components completes the set of tools.

AREA 4-24B – THE BIG MUCKETY-MUCK

Opening the stone door to this chamber releases a wave of dark, murky water. Although the volume of water seems relatively small, it quickly spills into your area, flooding the room to the depth of your ankles. The smell of the chamber beyond the door is almost too much to bear.

The floor in this room is covered in disgusting brown slime to a depth of about 6 inches, making the entire floor difficult terrain. A creature that enters the chamber must make a DC 16 Constitution saving throw. On a failed save, the creature is poisoned until they leave the room for at least 5 minutes.

Due to a small crack in the plumbing from the garderobe in area 4-8 (and the fact that the stone door leading to this chamber fits the entrance so perfectly), water has been accumulating in this chamber for several years. Living among the muck is a **black pudding**. The pudding attempts to leave the chamber as soon as the door opens and immediately attacks any creatures it encounters. The room contains nothing else of interest.

AREA 4-24C – THE ONCE-TRAPPED HALLWAY

Two exits are apparent at the end of this 30-foot-long stone corridor: a single, iron-banded wooden door in the western wall and a second door, almost camouflaged by the surrounding stone, partially ajar in the southern wall.

When closed, the secret door to area 4-24E requires a successful DC 16 Wisdom (Perception) or Intelligence (Investigation) check to discover.

AREA 4-24D – THE STILL-TRAPPED ROOM

This 30-foot-square room appears to be an office. It contains a desk, two chairs, and a large chest. Surprisingly, everything seems to be in good condition, as if the room was only recently furnished. The air is noticeably less musty than the surrounding areas, and the absence of dust is quite apparent.

This room is an elaborate trap. While the door to this room is closed (as it has been for many centuries now), the inside of this room goes into stasis, which explains the lack of musty smell and dust. Creatures inside the room while the door is closed have no need to eat or sleep and do not age or feel the passage of time. Once the door to the room is opened, the stasis effect ends. All four pieces of furniture mentioned in the room's description are **mimics** that attack as soon as any of them are touched.

Developments. If the characters close the door to the room while they are inside, the GM has several options. If there are characters both inside and outside the room, those inside the room do not perceive any time pass between the door closing and it being reopened by someone on the outside. If a guard is stationed outside the room while the remaining characters take a long rest inside, when the guard finally checks in on the

other characters (even 8 hours later), those inside the room gain none of the benefits of the rest, as no time has actually passed for them since the door was last closed. If all characters enter the room and close the door, the GM has at least four options, and is encouraged to select the option that suits the campaign (or create another option):

No effect. The room's magic has worn off after maintaining the effect for hundreds of years. It is now just an ordinary room.

End of the game. The characters become trapped in stasis forever. This is the least fun option.

Trapped! Characters become trapped in stasis until someone (consult the Wandering Monsters section) eventually wanders into this hidden complex and opens the door. If a combat was taking place when the room went into stasis, new visitors are added to the initiative, as normal. Once the characters leave the room and learn the current date and time, they discover they have several lost days (or longer) of unaccounted time.

Trapped! The characters become trapped in stasis. A significant amount of time (years? centuries? millennia?) passes before the room is rediscovered or the magic sustaining it finally fails. The characters return to a world they don't recognize, perhaps a futuristic world or post-apocalyptic setting. If the characters wish to return to their own time, they must find some way to do so, possibly by restoring the magic behind doors 2 or 4 in area 2-31A or through the use of a *limited wish* spell (see appendix D).

AREA 4-24E – THE PRIVATE SANCTUM

This 40-foot-deep, 20-foot-wide room looks to have once served as someone's private chamber before being left to rot for centuries. The remains of a bed, nightstand, desk, wardrobe, and chairs are now nothing more than piles of decayed wood, with disintegrating remnants of cloth or paper buried within them. A long-deceased, unmoving body rests on the remains of the bed.

The body on the bed is a **specter**, the restless spirit of the architect who created this complex and whose bones now lie crushed beneath the fallen stone in area 4-24C. The specter attacks as soon as the characters enter the room.

Most of the architect's personal items have disintegrated over time, but a few items of interest remain. In addition to the items described in Treasure, there is a collection of dry, brittle papers atop the remains of the desk. The papers are written in Ancient Thracian and include:

- A blueprint-like diagram of the area 4-24 complex, including room dimensions, door requirements, and the specifics on the trap in area 4-24C. This document crumbles to dust when touched.
- A rough map of the region around Thracia, depicting several landmarks and small settlements in the area.
- Notes on the teleportation system within the caverns and how it works (essentially identical to the gold-sealed scroll in area 2-23H but without the maintenance log; see **player handout 6**).
- Some notes (nothing technical or arcane; purely musings) on expanding the scope of a similar teleportation system to allow travel between Thracia and the settlements in the surrounding region. From what is left of the notes, it is difficult to tell if such a system was actually constructed, in the planning stages, or purely rumination.

Treasure. A *reusable candle* (see appendix D) lies among the debris of the nightstand and requires a successful DC 12 Wisdom (Perception) check to find. Buried in the remains of the desk is a locked metal box that requires a successful DC 15 Dexterity check with thieves' tools to open. The box contains a *helm of comprehending languages*, a *spell scroll* of *dark* (see appendix D), and a spellbook containing the following spells: *comprehend languages*, *hold portal*, *hypnotism*, *invisibility 10-foot radius*, *pyrotechnics*, *sticks to snakes*, *protection from normal missiles*, *tongues*, *transmute rock*, *stone to flesh*, and *limited wish* (see appendix D for descriptions of all spells except *comprehend languages* and *tongues*).

APPENDIX A
CHARACTERS

PRE-GENERATED CHARACTERS

The following pre-generated 1st-level characters can be used as player characters or by the GM as NPCs. Armor Class and hit points have already been adjusted for Dexterity and Constitution. These characters can have their levels increased by adding a suitable archetype (primal path for a barbarian, bard college for a bard, etc.) and rolling the extra Hit Dice plus adding any Constitution bonuses for each level above 1st.

Name	BAGGI PANZ	CHAD STRING-PLUCKER	CYNTHIA THE DEVOUT	DELAUST MOON-WHISPER	EFFIE UNGART	HESKAN THE QUIET
Sex	Female	Male	Female	Male	Female	Male
Race	Half-orc	Human	High elf	High elf	Hill dwarf	Dragonborn
Level (HD)	1 (1d12)	1 (1d8)	1 (1d8)	1 (1d8)	1 (1d10)	1 (1d8)
Class	Barbarian	Bard	Cleric	Druid	Fighter	Monk
Background	Charlatan	Entertainer	Noble	Urchin	Soldier	Guild artisan
Alignment	Chaotic Neutral	Chaotic Good	Lawful Neutral	Neutral	Lawful Neutral	Lawful Good
AC	13	12	13	14	16	13
Initiative	+1	+1	+0	+1	+1	+2
Speed	30 ft.	30 ft.	30 ft.	30 ft.	25 ft.	30 ft.
Prof. Bonus	+2	+2	+2	+2	+2	+2
Hit Points	14	8	9	9	14	9
Strength	17 (+3)	9 (-1)	13 (+1)	8 (-1)	15 (+2)	16 (+3)
Dexterity	13 (+1)	13 (+1)	10 (+0)	12 (+1)	13 (+1)	15 (+2)
Constitution	15 (+2)	11 (+0)	12 (+1)	13 (+1)	16 (+3)	12 (+1)
Intelligence	10 (+0)	15 (+2)	11 (+0)	13 (+1)	10 (+0)	8 (-1)

Wisdom	12 (+1)	14 (+2)	15 (+2)	15 (+2)	13 (+1)	13 (+1)
Charisma	8 (-1)	16 (+3)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	8 (-1)	11 (+0)
Skills & Proficiencies	Athletics +5 Deception +1 Intimidation +1 Perception +3 Sleight of Hand +3 Disguise kit +2 Forgery kit +2 Mason's tools +2	Acrobatics +3 History +4 Performance +5 Persuasion +5 Sleight of Hand +3 Disguise kit +2 Musical instrment (dulcimer) +2 Musical instrument (lute) +2 Musical instrument (lyre) +2 Musical instrment (viol) +2	History +2 Medicine +4 Perception +4 Persuasion +4 Religion +2 Playing cards +2	Nature +3 Perception +4 Sleight of Hand +3 Stealth +3 Survival +4 Disguise kit +2 Herbalism kit +2 Thieves' tools +2	Acrobatics +3 Athletics +4 Intimidation +1 Perception +3 Dice set +2 Vehicles (land) +2	Acrobatics +4 Athletics +5 Insight +3 Persuasion +2 Cartographer's tools +2 Musical instrument (drum) +2
Armor	None	Leather	Leather	Leather	Chain mail	None
Shield	None	None	Shield	Shield	None	None
Weapons	Greataxe, handaxes (2), javelins (4)	Dagger, rapier	Light crossbow, mace	Scimitar	Dagger (2), light cross-bow, longsword	Darts (10), shortsword
Special Items	Disguise kit, explorer's pack	Entertainer's pack, lute, lyre	Holy symbol, priest's pack	Druidic focus, explorer's pack	Dice set, dungeoneer's pack	Holy symbol,priest's pack, tinker's tools
Coins	15 gp	15 gp	25 gp	10 gp	10 gp	15 gp

Name	MOLLIVER THE TRUE	MARK MIWERDS	NEDDA TEALEAF	SAMUEL IRONFIST	TINTED SORROW	ZOOK OSHA
Sex	Female	Male	Female	Male	Female	Male
Race	Human	Half-elf	Lightfoot halfling	Hill dwarf	Tiefling	Rock gnome
Level (HD)	1 (1d10)	1 (1d10)	1 (1d8)	1 (1d6)	1 (1d8)	1 (1d6)
Class	Paladin	Ranger	Rogue	Sorcerer	Warlock	Wizard
Background	Folk hero	Acolyte	Criminal	Hermit	Outlander	Sage
Alignment	Lawful Good	Neutral Good	Chaotic Neutral	Chaotic Good	Neutral	Chaotic Good
AC	18	14	14	11	11	12

Initiative	+1	+3	+3	+1	+0	+2
Speed	30 ft.	30 ft.	25 ft.	25 ft.	30 ft.	25 ft.
Prof. Bonus	+2	+2	+2	+2	+2	+2
Hit Points	10	12	8	7	9	7
Strength	16 (+3)	10 (+0)	8 (-1)	10 (+0)	8 (-1)	8 (-1)
Dexterity	13 (+1)	16 (+3)	17 (+3)	12 (+1)	10 (+0)	14 (+2)
Constitution	11 (+0)	14 (+2)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	12 (+1)	13 (+1)
Intelligence	8 (-1)	12 (+1)	12 (+1)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	17 (+3)
Wisdom	15 (+2)	13 (+1)	13 (+1)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	13 (+1)
Charisma	14 (+2)	11 (+0)	15 (+2)	15 (+2)	17 (+3)	10 (+0)
Skills & Proficiencies	Animal Handling +4 Insight +4 Religion +1 Survival +4 Tinker's tools +2 Vehicles (land) +2	Animal Handling +3 Insight +3 Nature +3 Religion +3 Stealth +5 Survival +3	Deception +4 Insight +3 Investigation +3 Perception +3 Sleight of Hand +5 Stealth +7 Dragonchess set +2 Thieves' tools +4	Arcana +4 Intimidation +4 Medicine +4 Religion +4 Herbalism kit +2 Smith's tools +2	Athletics +1 Intimidation +5 Religion +4 Survival +4 Musical instrument (shawm) +2	Arcana +5 History +5 Investigation +5 Religion +5 Tinker's tools +2
Armor	Chain mail	Leather	Leather	None	Leather	None
Shield	Shield	None	None	None	None	None
Weapons	Javelins (5), longsword	Longbow, shortswords (2)	Daggers (2), rapiers, shortbow	Daggers (2), light crossbow	Daggers (2), handaxe, light crossbow	Daggers (2)
Special Items	Holy symbol, priest's pack, tinker's tools	Explorer's pack	Burglar's pack, thieves' tools	Arcane focus, dungeoneer's pack, herbalism kit	Component pouch, scholar's pack	Arcane focus, scholar's pack, spellbook
Coins	10 gp	15 gp	15 gp	5 gp	10 gp	10 gp

APPENDIX B
NEW MONSTERS

ADEPT OF THE DARK ONE

An adept of The Dark One is a novice member of the clergy in the cult of Thanatos. They typically serve as assistants to vicars or priests and rank only slightly higher than acolytes of the faith.

ADEPT OF THE DARK ONE

Medium Humanoid (Human), Lawful Evil

Armor Class: 13 (leather armor, shield)

Hit Points: 13 (3d8)

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	14 (+2)	11 (+0)

Saving Throws: Wis +4, Cha +2

Skills: Medicine +4, Religion +2

Senses: passive Perception 12

Languages: Modern Thracian, Tribal Thracian

Challenge: 1/2 (100 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +2

ACTIONS

Mace: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +2 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 3 (1d6) bludgeoning damage.

Chilling Grasp: *Ranged Spell Attack:* +4 to hit, range 120 ft., one target. *Hit:* 4 (1d8) necrotic damage and the target can't regain hit points until the start of its next turn.

Control Undead (1/Short or Long Rest): The adept attempts to take control of undead creatures within 30 feet of them. Each undead that can hear or see the adept in that range must make a DC 12 Wisdom saving throw. Undead creatures with 5 Hit Dice or more have advantage on this saving throw. On a failed save, the target is under the adept's control for 24 hours or until the adept or one of their companions does anything harmful to it. On each of the adept's turns, they can use a bonus action to mentally command any undead under their control within 60 feet of them. If the adept controls multiple creatures, they can command any or all of them at the same time, issuing the same command to each one. While under their control, the undead obey their commands and, if given an order, continue to follow it until the task is complete. The

adept can control up to a maximum of 12 Hit Dice worth of undead creatures at any one time.

Necrotic Flame: The adept selects a target it can see within 60 feet. The target must make a successful DC 12 Dexterity saving throw or take 4 (1d8) necrotic damage. The target gains no benefit from cover for this saving throw.

Spellcasting: The adept casts one of the following spells, using Wisdom as the spellcasting ability (spell save DC 12):

At will: *light*, *thaumaturgy*

1/day: *bane, false life*, *inflict wounds*

This person is clad in a combination of leather armor and ornate robes. They carry a shield emblazoned with sacred imagery matching that of their robes, implying their membership in a religious order or cult of some kind.

ANIMATED BRONZE STATUE

Long ago, a bronze statue of Thanatos in his form as the Incarnation of Death (a tall, gaunt, male human) was magically animated and assigned the task of guarding Level 3A from intruders. Interpreting "intruders" in the most generic sense, the animated bronze statue has wandered the rooms and hallways of that level ever since, attacking any living creature it encounters.

ANIMATED BRONZE STATUE

Large Construct, Unaligned

Armor Class: 17 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 52 (8d10 + 8)

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	11 (+0)	13 (+1)	1 (–5)	3 (–4)	1 (–5)

Damage Immunities: poison, psychic

Condition Immunities: blinded, charmed, deafened, exhaustion, frightened, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned

Senses: blindsight 60 ft. (blind beyond this radius), passive Perception 6

Languages: —

Challenge: 2 (450 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +2

Antimagic Susceptibility: The statue is incapacitated while in an *antimagic field*. If targeted by *dispel magic*, the statue must succeed on a Constitution saving throw against the caster's spell save DC or fall unconscious for 1 minute.

False Appearance: While the statue remains motionless, it is indistinguishable from a normal statue.

ACTIONS

Multiattack: The statue makes two Slam attacks and uses its Paralysis Beam.

Slam: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) bludgeoning damage.

Paralysis Beam: The statue fires a beam of magical light from its eyes at a creature it can see within 60 feet of it. The target must succeed on a DC 13 Constitution saving throw or be paralyzed for 1 minute. The target can repeat the saving throw at the end of each of its turns, ending the effect on itself on a success.

This eight–foot–tall creature resembles a gaunt man in robes but appears to be comprised entirely of bronze.

ANIMATED STONE STATUE

This animated stone statue wanders the caverns looking to destroy any living creature it encounters. Unfortunately for the other denizens of the caverns, even after being destroyed it has the tendency to come back.

ANIMATED STONE STATUE

Large Construct, Unaligned

Armor Class: 17 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 52 (8d10 + 8)

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	11 (+0)	13 (+1)	1 (–5)	3 (–4)	1 (–5)

Damage Immunities: poison, psychic

Condition Immunities: blinded, charmed, deafened, exhaustion, frightened, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned

Senses: blindsight 60 ft. (blind beyond this radius), passive Perception 6

Languages: —

Challenge: 2 (450 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +2

Antimagic Susceptibility: The statue is incapacitated while in an *antimagic field*. If targeted by *dispel magic*, the statue must succeed on a Constitution saving throw against the caster's spell save DC or fall unconscious for 1 minute.

False Appearance: While the statue remains motionless, it is indistinguishable from a normal statue.

Slow Regeneration: When reduced to 0 hit points, the statue begins to rebuild itself by incorporating stone from the surrounding walls and floor into its body. After 30 minutes of contact with earth or stone, the statue is restored to its hit point maximum and begins to stalk the caverns once more. The regeneration doesn't function if the statue's head is placed on a surface consisting of something other than stone or earth (such as inside a wooden chest or leather sack). The statue's head weighs approximately 20 pounds.

ACTIONS

Multiattack: The statue makes two Slam attacks.

Slam: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) bludgeoning damage.

Teleport (Recharge 6): The statue teleports, along with anything it is wearing or carrying, to any unoccupied space within the caverns.

This large humanoid statue seems to be an amalgamation of stones of various types and sizes, all somehow fitted perfectly together.

ARMORED TRIBAL GUARD

The armored tribal guards are the higher–ranking warriors within the human society that populates the upper levels of the caverns. The plate armor these guards wear is a testament to their social status, as other warriors only wear such expensive armor when participating in religious ceremonies.

ARMORED TRIBAL GUARD

Medium Humanoid (Human), Typically Neutral

Armor Class: 18 (plate armor)

Hit Points: 22 (4d8 + 4)

Speed: 20 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
12 (+1)	13 (+1)	12 (+1)	10 (+0)	11 (+0)	10 (–0)

Saving Throws: Str +3, Con +3

Skills: Acrobatics +3, Athletics +3

Senses: passive Perception 10

Languages: Tribal Thracian

Challenge: 2 (450 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +2

Action Surge (1/Short or Long Rest): On their turn, the guard can take one additional action on top of their regular action and a possible bonus action.

Great Weapon Fighting: When the guard rolls a 1 or 2 on a damage die for an attack with a melee weapon wielded with two hands, they can reroll the die and must use the new roll.

Second Wind (1/Short or Long Rest): The guard can use a bonus action on their turn to regain 7 (1d10 + 2) hit points.

ACTIONS

Longsword: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d8 + 1) slashing damage, or 6 (1d10 + 1) slashing damage if used with two hands.

Spear: *Melee or Ranged Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft. or range 20/60 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d6 + 3) piercing damage, or 7 (1d8 + 3) piercing damage if used with two hands to make a melee attack.

This human warrior wears a full set of plate armor and carries a spear and longsword. The top of their helm sports a colorful, ornamental plume, likely from some exotic bird.

AVATAR OF TRITON

Huge Celestial, Neutral

Armor Class: 22 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 210 (20d12 + 80)

Speed: 40 ft., swim 60 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
22 (+6)	16 (+3)	18 (+4)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	14 (–2)

Damage Resistances: acid; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing that is nonmagical

Damage Immunities: poison

Condition Immunities: exhaustion, poisoned

Senses: darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 12

Languages: Aquan

Challenge: 13 (10,000 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +5

Improved Critical: The avatar scores a critical hit with its attacks on a 19–20.

Legendary Resistance (3/Day): If the avatar fails a saving throw, it can choose to succeed instead.

ACTIONS

Multiattack: The avatar makes four attacks: one with its Great Trident, two with its Claw, and one with its Tail. In place of its Great Trident attack, it can use Bolt from the Blue or Spellcasting.

Great Trident: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +11 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 19 (3d8 + 6) piercing damage. On a critical hit, a Large or smaller creature is also skewered. While the target is skewered, it is restrained, and the avatar can't make Great Trident attacks. On its turn, the target can use its action to attempt a DC 16 Strength (Athletics) check, freeing itself on a success.

Claw: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +11 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 11 (1d10 + 6) slashing damage. The target is grappled (escape DC 16) if it is a Huge or smaller creature and the avatar doesn't have two other creatures grappled.

Tail: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +11 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 13 (2d6 + 6) bludgeoning damage. If the target is a Large or smaller creature, it must make a DC 16 Strength saving throw. On a failed save, the target is pushed 10 feet directly away from the avatar and knocked prone.

Bolt from the Blue (Recharge 5–6): The avatar fires an azure bolt of raw magic and elemental water in a 100–foot line that is 5 feet wide. Each creature in that line must make a DC 16 Dexterity saving throw. On a failed save, the target takes 27 (5d10) force damage and is knocked prone. On a success, the target takes half as much damage and isn't knocked prone.

Spellcasting: The avatar casts one of the following spells requiring no material components, using Wisdom as its spellcasting ability (spell save DC 15):

At will: *bless, command, water breathing*

3/day each: *darkness, hold person*

1/day each: *augury, bestow curse, hypnotic pattern*

LEGENDARY ACTIONS

The avatar can take 3 legendary actions, choosing from the options below. Only one legendary action can be used at a time and only at the end of another creature's turn. The avatar regains spent legendary actions at the start of its turn.

Move: The avatar moves up to half its speed without provoking opportunity attacks.

Tail Slap: The avatar makes a Tail attack.

Spellcasting (Costs 2 Actions): The avatar casts a spell.

BORDER TREE

The shaman G'ruk created these trees to act as a natural fence to keep unwanted intruders away from the palace on Level 3. The trees allow cows, gnolls, lizardfolk, and minotaurs to pass by but attack any other creatures that approach them, lowering a network of thorny branches to act as a barrier. They might allow dogfolk and humans to pass as well, provided they are accompanied by a gnoll, lizardfolk, or minotaur escort.

BORDER TREE

Gargantuan Plant, Unaligned

Armor Class: 14 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 63 (6d20)

Speed: 0 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
19 (+4)	1 (–5)	11 (+0)	1 (–5)	10 (+0)	1 (–5)

Damage Resistances: fire; bludgeoning, piercing

Damage Immunities: psychic

Condition Immunities: blinded, charmed, deafened, frightened, grappled, prone

Senses: blindsight 60 ft. (blind beyond this radius), passive Perception 10

Languages: —

Challenge: 3 (700 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +2

False Appearance: While the tree remains motionless, it is indistinguishable from a normal tree.

Healing Sap: If the sap from a living or recently slain border tree is applied to the open wounds of another creature, that creature regains 4 (1d8) hit points. Once the sap has been applied to a creature, that creature can't gain the benefits of Healing Sap for 24 hours.

ACTIONS

Multiattack: The tree makes three Thorn Branch attacks.

Thorn Branch: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 50 ft., one target. *Hit:* 8 (1d8 + 4) piercing damage.

Tree Wrap: The tree defends its trunk by densely wrapping its branches around itself, gaining 20 temporary hit points.

As you approach the row of trees, dozens of thick, knobbed branches covered in needle–like thorns descend from the canopy overhead, blocking the way before you.

CADAVER CRAWLER

This enormous, caterpillar–like scavenger is approximately 9 feet long, 3 feet tall, and has eight tentacles below its two large, bulbous eyes. It can travel equally well on floors, walls, or ceilings, and the touch of its tentacles can paralyze those it encounters.

CADAVER CRAWLER

Large Monstrosity, Unaligned

Armor Class: 13 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 25 (3d10 + 9)

Speed: 30 ft., climb 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
15 (+2)	12 (+1)	17 (+3)	1 (–5)	13 (+1)	4 (–3)

Skills: Perception +3

Senses: darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 13

Languages: —

Challenge: 1 (200 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +2

Keen Smell: The cadaver crawler has advantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on smell.

Spider Climb: The cadaver crawler can climb difficult surfaces, including upside down on ceilings, without needing to make an ability check.

ACTIONS

Multiattack: The cadaver crawler makes one Tentacles attack and one Bite attack.

Tentacles: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 4 (1d4 + 2) poison damage, and the target must succeed on a DC 13 Constitution saving throw or become poisoned for 1 minute. While poisoned in this way, the target is paralyzed. The target can repeat the saving throw at the end of each of its turns, ending the poison on itself on a success.

Bite: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 7 (2d4 + 2) piercing damage.

This enormous, caterpillar–like creature boasts two large eyes and an array of tentacles where its mouth should be.

CARYATID COLUMN

These magical columns carved to depict the female humanoid form were created to serve as stealthy guards. Discerning the actual nature of these marble or alabaster structural supports is nearly impossible until they move.

Similar columns depicting male humanoids are rarer and are known as telamon columns. They share the same stats as caryatid columns.

CARYATID COLUMN

Medium Construct, Unaligned

Armor Class: 15 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 22 (4d8 + 4)

Speed: 20 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	12 (+1)	13 (+1)	3 (–4)	11 (+0)	8 (–1)

Damage Resistances: bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing that is nonmagical

Damage Immunities: poison, psychic

Condition Immunities: blinded, charmed, deafened, frightened, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned

Senses: darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 10

Languages: —

Challenge: 1 (200 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +2

False Appearance: While the column remains motionless, it is indistinguishable from an inanimate statue.

Innate Resistance: The column makes all saving throws with advantage.

Stony Body: When a nonmagical weapon hits the column, roll a d4. On a 1, the weapon breaks, rendering it useless.

Unusual Nature. The column doesn't require air, drink, food or sleep.

ACTIONS

Longsword: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 7 (1d8 + 3) slashing damage, or 8 (1d10 + 3) slashing damage if used with two hands.

This stone column transforms into a fleshy female humanoid with fair, porcelain–like skin. With surprising agility, the statue advances, brandishing a slim, previously hidden sword. Although its large eyes are emotionless, grim determination is etched on her smooth facial features.

CEREMONIAL GUARD

These guards wear plate armor only when participating in specific religious ceremonies. As a result, they sacrifice some of their speed in exchange for a more impressive display during these ceremonies.

CEREMONIAL GUARD

Medium Humanoid (Any), Typically Neutral

Armor Class: 18 (plate)

Hit Points: 11 (2d8 + 2)

Speed: 20 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
13 (+1)	12 (+1)	12 (+1)	10 (+0)	11 (+0)	10 (+0)

Skills: Perception +2

Senses: passive Perception 12

Languages: any one language

Challenge: 1/2 (100 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +2

ACTIONS

Longsword: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d8 + 1) slashing damage, or 6 (1d10 + 1) slashing damage if used with two hands.

Spear: *Melee or Ranged Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft. or range 20/60 ft., one target. *Hit:* 4 (1d6 + 1) piercing damage, or 5 (1d8 + 1) piercing damage if used with two hands to make a melee attack.

This humanoid warrior wears a full set of ornamental plate armor, seemingly intended more for show than function, and is armed with both a spear and a longsword. Their helm completely conceals their face, enclosing their entire head.

DISEMBODIED MOUTH

Disembodied mouths are aberrations created to guard items of special importance and discourage thieves. If the item they were created to guard is stolen, the disembodied mouth pursues the thief and attacks several times before disappearing. After a short period, the mouth reappears, seemingly stronger than before. This pattern continues until the mouth is destroyed, the thief is killed, or the item in question is abandoned.

DISEMBODIED MOUTH

Tiny Aberration, Typically Chaotic Evil

Armor Class: 16 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 10 (3d4 + 3)

Speed: 0 ft., fly 60 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	13 (+1)	12 (+1)	10 (+0)	15 (+2)	12 (+1)

Condition Immunities: blinded, charmed, prone, unconscious

Skills: Perception +4, Stealth +3, Survival +4

Senses: blindsight 60 ft. (blind beyond this radius), passive Perception 14

Languages: —

Challenge: 1/2 (100 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +2

Absence Makes the Heart Grow Stronger: At the end of the mouth's third turn in any encounter, it disappears for (1d6 + 4) × 10 minutes. After this time, the mouth regains all hit points and reappears in an unoccupied space within 30 feet of any creature holding or carrying the item it was set to guard. Each time the mouth reappears, its hit point maximum increases by 2, and it gains a +1 bonus to damage rolls with its bite. The mouth continues this pattern until it is destroyed or the item it was set to guard is discarded.

Invisible: The mouth is naturally invisible. When it makes a Bite attack, the mouth becomes visible until the start of its next turn.

Magic Susceptibility: If targeted by a *dispel magic* spell cast at 5th level or higher, the mouth is instantly destroyed.

ACTIONS

Bite: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 4 (1d4 + 2) piercing damage.

A wide, disembodied, humanoid mouth appears in the air before you, rushing forward as it prepares to bite.

DOGFOLK

At first glance, dogfolk resemble well–manicured gnolls due to their similar canine features. However, dogfolk are an entirely separate race of beastfolk. They act as guides and overseers for the rapacious gnolls of the caverns and are rarely seen outside the palace level or its dungeon complex. Pack creatures by nature, dogfolk consider themselves a single race, regardless of the disparity in their relative height, weight, and appearance. There are dogfolk that bear a resemblance to nearly every type of domesticated dog.

DOGFOLK

Medium Humanoid (Dogfolk), Any Alignment

Armor Class: 13 (hide armor)

Hit Points: 22 (5d8)

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
13 (+4)	12 (+1)	11 (+0)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	9 (–1)

Skills: Perception +2

Senses: passive Perception 12

Languages: Gnoll

Challenge: 1/2 (100 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +2

Keen Hearing and Smell: The dogfolk has advantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on hearing or smell.

Pack Tactics: The dogfolk has advantage on an attack roll against a creature if at least one of the dogfolk's allies is within 5 feet of the creature and the ally isn't incapacitated.

ACTIONS

Bite: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 3 (1d4 + 1) piercing damage.

Longsword: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d8 + 1) slashing damage, or 6 (1d10 + 1) slashing damage if used with two hands.

This canine–featured humanoid wears hide armor and brandishes a longsword. Its facial features more closely resemble those of a domesticated dog than those of a wolf or fox.

DOGFOLK WIZARD

The dogfolk wizard is an arcane spellcaster. Extremely rare among dogfolk, they are afforded a modicum of respect based purely on the abilities they wield. Although more powerful dogfolk wizards exist, it is practically unheard of to encounter one with access to spells of 4th level or higher.

DOGFOLK WIZARD

Medium humanoid (dogfolk), any alignment

Armor Class: 15 (chain shirt)

Hit Points: 49 (9d8 + 9)

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	14 (+2)	13 (+1)	16 (+3)	11 (+0)	9 (–1)

Saving Throws: Int +5, Wis +2

Skills: Arcana +5, History +5

Senses: passive Perception 10

Languages: Gnoll, Tribal Thracian

Challenge: 2 (450 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +2

Special Equipment: The dogfolk carries two daggers.

Keen Hearing and Smell: The dogfolk has advantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on hearing or smell.

Pack Tactics: The dogfolk has advantage on an attack roll against a creature if at least one of the dogfolk's allies is within 5 feet of the creature and the ally isn't incapacitated.

ACTIONS

Multiattack: The dogfolk wizard makes two attacks: one with its Bite and one with its Dagger.

Bite: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 5 (1d4 + 3) piercing damage.

Dagger: *Melee or Ranged Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft. or range 20/60 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d4 + 3) piercing damage.

Spellcasting: The dogfolk casts one of the following spells, using Intelligence as its spellcasting ability (spell save DC 13):

At will: *friends*, *light*, *prestidigitation*

2/day: *charm person*, *hold portal* (see appendix D), *sleep*

1/day: *phantasmal force*, *pyrotechnics* (see appendix D), *web*

The face and ears of this humanoid resemble those of a domesticated dog. They wear a chain shirt covered by long, loose–fitting robes, apparently to allow it as much freedom of movement as possible.

ELDER ELEMENTAL

Elder elementals are huge incarnations of pure elemental might that can assume a roughly humanoid form. Although their shapes vary, each is approximately 15 feet tall. Elder elementals are almost always encountered on their native elemental plane. If forced from the comforting confines of its home, an elder elemental seeks to meld with a large, nearby source of its composite element.

Only powerful magic can summon an elder elemental. Wizards sometimes call them to do their bidding, but more commonly druids summon elder elementals to shift the natural balance back to neutral or to combat some devastating threat. However, controlling these powerful planar beings for more than a few minutes is difficult and even dangerous.

ELDER FIRE ELEMENTAL

Huge Elemental, Neutral

Armor Class: 17 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 253 (22d12 + 110)

Speed: 40 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	18 (+4)	20 (+5)	8 (–1)	12 (+1)	9 (–1)

Damage Resistances: bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing that is nonmagical

Damage Immunities: fire, poison

Condition Immunities: exhaustion, grappled, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned, prone, restrained, unconscious

Senses: darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 11

Languages: Ignan

Challenge: 13 (10,000 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +5

Fire Form: The elemental can move through a space as narrow as 1 inch wide without squeezing. A creature that touches the elemental or hits it with a melee attack while within 5 feet of it takes 11 (2d10) fire damage. In addition, the elemental can enter a hostile creature's space and stop there. The first time it enters a creature's space on a turn, that creature takes 11 (2d10) fire damage and catches fire; until someone takes an action to douse the fire, the creature takes 5 (1d10) fire damage at the start of each of its turns.

Illumination: The elemental sheds bright light in a 60–foot radius and dim light in an additional 60 feet.

Water Susceptibility: For every 10 feet the elemental moves in water, or for every 5 gallons of water splashed on it, it takes 1 cold damage.

ACTIONS

Multiattack: The elemental makes three Touch attacks.

Touch: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +9 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 17 (3d8 + 4) fire damage. If the target is a creature or a flammable object, it ignites. Until a creature takes an action to douse the fire, the target takes 5 (1d10) fire damage at the start of each of its turns.

Fire Burst (Recharge 5–6): The elemental hurls a globe of fire that explodes at a point it can see within 60 feet of it. Each creature in a 20–foot–radius sphere centered on that point must make a DC 18 Dexterity saving throw. On a failed save, the target takes 28 (8d6) fire damage and catches fire. Until a creature takes an action to douse the fire, the target takes 5 (1d10) fire damage at the start of each of its turns. On a successful save, the target takes half as much damage and doesn't catch fire.

The roaring column of flame takes on a vaguely humanoid shape as it towers over your insignificant band. Almost gleefully, it dances about with the angry crackle of its eager flames.

ELDER WATER ELEMENTAL

Huge Elemental, Neutral

Armor Class: 17 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 253 (22d12 + 110)

Speed: 30 ft., swim 60 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
20 (+5)	16 (+3)	20 (+5)	8 (–1)	12 (+1)	9 (–1)

Damage Resistances: acid; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing that is nonmagical

Damage Immunities: poison

Condition Immunities: exhaustion, grappled, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned, prone, restrained, unconscious

Senses: darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 11

Languages: Aquan

Challenge: 13 (10,000 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +5

Water Form: The elemental can enter a hostile creature's space and stop there. It can move through a space as narrow as 1 inch wide without squeezing.

Freeze: If the elder elemental takes cold damage, it partially freezes; its speed is reduced by 20 feet until the end of its next turn.

ACTIONS

Multiattack: The elemental makes three Slam attacks.

Slam: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +10 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 18 (3d8 + 5) bludgeoning damage. If the target is a creature, it must succeed on a DC 18 Strength saving throw or be knocked prone.

Whelm (Recharge 4–6): Each creature in the elemental's space must make a DC 18 Strength saving throw. On a failure, a target takes 23 (4d8 + 5) bludgeoning damage. If it is Huge or smaller, it is also grappled (escape DC 18). Until this grapple ends, the target is restrained and unable to breathe unless it can breathe water. If the saving throw is successful, the target is pushed out of the elemental's space.

The elemental can grapple one Huge creature, up to two Large creatures, or up to four Medium or smaller creatures at one time. At the start of each of the elemental's turns, each target grappled by it takes 23 (4d8 + 5) bludgeoning damage. A creature within 5 feet of the elemental can pull a creature or object out of it by taking an action to make a successful DC 20 Strength check.

A frothy wall of water sloshes up and spills over the corridor. It forms vaguely humanoid arms and an ever–shifting vortex of a face, at times depicting dark eyes and a wide mouth and at other times, a blank sheet of water.

ELITE LIZARDFOLK

Its unknown if these lizardfolk specimens randomly occur, or are the result of intense years of training and conditioning, elite lizardfolk are specialized shock troops for leaders and larger communities. As such, these lizardfolk often have upgraded armor and weapons available for use. Some even employ advanced tactics to get an advantage on the battlefield.

ELITE LIZARDFOLK

Medium Humanoid (Lizardfolk), Typically Neutral

Armor Class: 16 (natural armor, shield)

Hit Points: 37 (5d8 + 15)

Speed: 30 ft., swim 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	13 (+1)	16 (+3)	8 (–1)	12 (+1)	7 (–2)

Skills: Perception +3, Stealth +3, Survival +3

Senses: passive Perception 13

Languages: Draconic

Challenge: 1 (200 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +2

Hold Breath: The lizardfolk can hold its breath for 15 minutes.

Coordinated Shot: The lizardfolk has advantage on a ranged attack roll against a creature if at least one of the lizardfolk's allies is within 5 feet of the target and the ally isn't incapacitated.

ACTIONS

Multiattack: The lizardfolk makes one Bite attack and one attack with its Heavy Mace or Spiked Shield.

Bite: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d6 + 3) piercing damage.

Heavy Mace: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 7 (1d8 + 3) bludgeoning damage.

Heavy Crossbow: *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, range 100/400 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d10 + 1) piercing damage.

Spiked Shield: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d6 + 3) piercing damage.

This muscular lizardfolk carries a massive wooden mace with a stone head and a turtle–shell shield augmented with wicked spikes. A heavy crossbow is slung over its back.

GIANT ALLIGATOR SNAPPING TURTLE

Giant alligator snapping turtles have a stout, heavy head, and a thick shell adorned with three dorsal ridges of large scales. These scales give it the appearance of a dinosaur, or other extinct beast. These giant beasts easily reach lengths of 15 feet or more. Its hide and shell are often black to brown in color, but older specimens are covered with algal growth, granting a deep green shade. These freshwater denizens are classic lie–in–wait predators, either hiding in the mud, or just below the surface of the water.

GIANT ALLIGATOR SNAPPING TURTLE

Huge Beast, Unaligned

Armor Class: 17 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 126 (12d12 + 48)

Speed: 20 ft., swim 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
22 (+6)	11 (+0)	19 (+4)	2 (–4)	12 (+1)	5 (–3)

Skills: Perception +4, Stealth +3

Senses: darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 14

Languages: —

Challenge: 5 (1,800 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +3

Amphibious: The turtle can breathe air and water.

Aquatic Camouflage: The turtle has advantage on Dexterity (Stealth) checks to hide in aquatic terrain.

Keen Smell: The turtle has advantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on smell.

Sure–Footed: The turtle has advantage on Strength and Dexterity saving throws made against effects that would knock it prone.

Surprise Attack: If the turtle surprises a creature and hits it with an attack during the first round of combat, the target takes an additional 14 (4d6) damage from the attack.

ACTIONS

Bite: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +9 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 27 (6d6 + 6) piercing damage, and the target is grappled (escape DC 16). Until this grapple ends, the turtle can bite only the grappled creature and has advantage on attack rolls to do so.

A reptilian head with a beak–like mouth erupts from the mud, vigorously snapping at its stunned prey. The massive turtle's dark shell sports numerous triangular plates covered with muck and algal growth.

GIANT WOLVERINE

Similar in appearance to a regular wolverine except in size, this oversized member of the weasel family can exude a sickening musk to mark its territory or deter other predators.

GIANT WOLVERINE

Large Beast, Unaligned

Armor Class: 13

Hit Points: 26 (4d10 + 4)

Speed: 40 ft., burrow 10 ft., climb 10 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
15 (+2)	16 (+3)	13 (+1)	4 (–3)	16 (+3)	5 (–3)

Skills: Perception +5

Damage Resistances: cold

Senses: darkvision 30 ft., passive Perception 15

Languages: —

Challenge: 1 (200 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +2

Keen Smell: The wolverine has advantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on smell.

ACTIONS

Multiattack: The wolverine makes three attacks: one with its Bite and two with its Claws. In place of its Bite, the wolverine can use Musk.

Bite: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 6 (1d6 + 3) piercing damage.

Claws: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d4 + 3) slashing damage.

Musk: The wolverine releases a spray of musk in a 15–foot cone. Each creature in that area is covered in musk. While covered in musk, the target has disadvantage on Dexterity (Stealth) checks it makes to hide from creatures that can smell. The musk lasts until the target finishes a short or long rest, takes 5 minutes to wash itself with soap and water, or is targeted by several *prestidigitation* cantrips. The target must also succeed on a DC 13 Constitution saving throw or become poisoned for 1 minute. If the saving throw fails by 5 more, the target is blinded while it is poisoned.

This brownish–black, weasel–like creature sports dagger–sized claws and strikingly large canines.

GOLDEN LIZARD

These rare creatures serve fey as companions or guardians. Although not particularly intelligent, their long lifespans and tendency to imprint upon their owners make them fine pets. The luster of their yellow scales diminishes significantly in their later years.

GOLDEN LIZARD

Huge Beast, Unaligned

Armor Class: 15 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 97 (15d12)

Speed: 30 ft., climb 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
15 (+2)	12 (+1)	10 (+0)	2 (–4)	10 (+0)	5 (–3)

Senses: darkvision 30 ft., passive Perception 10

Languages: —

Challenge: 5 (1,800 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +3

ACTIONS

Multiattack: The lizard makes one Bite attack and two Claw attacks.

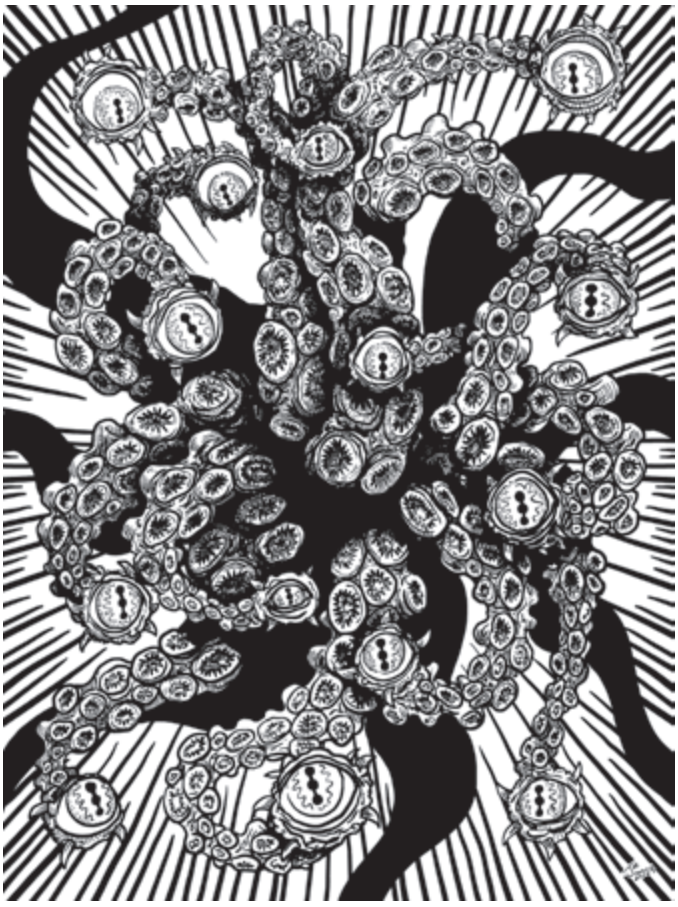
Bite: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 15 (2d12 + 2) piercing damage.

Claw: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 7 (1d10 + 2) slashing damage.

This enormous reptile has shiny, golden scales and fierce–looking claws.

GRASPING GUARDIAN

This octopus–like creature has a central body with a single eye and six 50–foot–long armored tentacles, each with an additional eye on its end. Although they can lie dormant for long periods of time, they revive when their tremorsense detects creatures nearby. Although capable of breathing air, grasping guardians tend to keep their bodies submerged in water and prefer to explore the open–air environment with their tentacles. The grasping guardian can regenerate injured tentacles, growing new ones when a tentacle is severed or destroyed.



GRASPING GUARDIAN

Gargantuan Beast, Unaligned

Armor Class: 16 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 75 (6d20 + 12)

Speed: 30 ft., climb 30 ft., swim 40 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
19 (+4)	15 (+2)	14 (+2)	2 (–4)	12 (+1)	13 (+1)

Skills: Perception +4, Stealth +5

Condition Immunities: prone

Senses: darkvision 60 ft., tremorsense 60 ft., passive Perception 14

Languages: —

Challenge: 7 (2,900 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +3

Amphibious: The guardian can breathe air and water.

Protected Senses: The guardian sees through seven eyes; one located on the end of each of its tentacles and one on its central body. When subjected to an effect that would blind it, only one of the guardian's eyes is blinded. The guardian itself can't be blinded unless all seven of its eyes are blinded.

Siege Monster: The guardian deals double damage to objects and structures.

Tentacles: The guardian has six tentacles. Whenever the guardian takes 25 damage or more on a single turn, one of its tentacles is destroyed. The guardian regrows all destroyed tentacles when it finishes a short or long rest.

ACTIONS

Multiattack: The guardian makes as many Tentacle attacks as it has tentacles.

Tentacle: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 45 ft., one target. *Hit:* 8 (1d8 + 4) bludgeoning damage. If the target is a creature, the guardian pulls the creature up to 20 feet straight towards it and the target is grappled (escape DC 14). Until this grapple ends, the target is restrained. The guardian has up to six tentacles, each of which can grapple one target.

Several massive tentacles, each covered with hundreds of tiny suction cups and bearing an eyeball at its end, reach menacingly in your direction from some distant source.

HAMADRYAD

Hamadryads are fey spirits magically bound to trees. While travelers have long referred to all such tree spirits as "dryads," the wisest sages understand that dryads are bound specifically to oak trees. Spirits of other trees exist, differing in name, form, and abilities. Like their oak–dwelling sisters, other types of hamadryads are tree–bound, reclusive, and wield powerful woodland magic.

CARYATID

A caryatid hamadryad is bound to a majestic walnut tree. Travelers sometimes stumble upon a grove of walnut trees, out of place among the other trees in the forest. The atmosphere of the grove is hushed, as if the woods themselves offer respect to these trees—and the spirits within them. Appearing as berobed figures wearing crowns of walnuts, caryatids are soft–spoken, weighing each word carefully before they speak.

The meat of a walnut resembles a brain—a symbol, perhaps, of the caryatid's wisdom. If approached with respect, caryatids may share what they know with travelers, answering questions in exchange for planting seedlings to expand their grove.

The heartwood of a caryatid's tree can be used to craft a *repellant staff*.

NEW MAGIC ITEM

REPELLANT STAFF

Weapon (quarterstaff), uncommon (requires attunement)

You gain a +1 bonus to attack and damage rolls made with this magic weapon. While you hold the staff, insects and insect swarms make attack rolls against you with disadvantage.

CARYATID

Medium Fey, Neutral

Armor Class: 11 (16 with *barkskin*)

Hit Points: 22 (5d8)

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	12 (+1)	11 (+0)	18 (+4)	17 (+3)	18 (+4)

Skills: Perception +5, Stealth +5

Damage Immunities: poison

Condition Immunities: poisoned

Senses: darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 15

Languages: Common, Elvish, Sylvan

Challenge: 1 (200 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +2

Magic Resistance: The caryatid has advantage on saving throws against spells and other magical effects.

Speak with Beasts and Plants: The caryatid can communicate with beasts and plants as if they shared a language.

Tree Stride: Once on her turn, the caryatid can use 10 feet of her movement to step magically into one living tree within her reach and emerge from a second living tree within 60 feet of the first tree, appearing in an unoccupied space within 5 feet of the second tree. Both trees must be Large or bigger.

ACTIONS

Club: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +2 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 2 (1d4) bludgeoning damage, and the target must succeed on a DC 10 Constitution saving throw or take 7 (2d6) poison damage.

Poisoned Walnut: *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, range 20/60 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) bludgeoning damage plus 6 (1d12) poison damage.

Fey Insight: The caryatid studies one humanoid or beast she can see within 30 feet of her. The target must make a DC 14 Intelligence saving throw. On a failure, the caryatid fully understands the target's actions and motivations. The target makes attack rolls against the caryatid with disadvantage, and the caryatid makes attack rolls against the target with advantage. The effect lasts for 12 hours or until the caryatid dies, is on a different plane of existence from the target, or ends the effect as a bonus action. The caryatid can understand no more than one humanoid and up to three beasts at one time.

Thunder Blast (1/Day): The caryatid produces a 15–foot cone of cacophonous thunder. Each creature in the area must make a DC 14 Constitution saving throw. On a failed save, the creature takes 9 (2d8) thunder damage and is pushed up to 10 feet directly away from the caryatid. On a successful save, the creature takes half as much damage and isn't pushed.

Spellcasting: The caryatid casts one of the following spells, using Charisma as its spellcasting ability (spell save DC 14):

At will: *druidcraft, entangle*

1/day each: *barkskin, commune with nature, protection from poison*

Wrapped in a shawl of rustling leaves, an elven maiden steps from behind a tree. Situated in her dark brown tresses is a crown of walnuts.

HARROWING HAND

These disturbing aberrations appear as humanoid hands extending out of a stone wall on awkwardly long arms. The hands seek to touch anything that passes by them. They do not harm creatures they touch unless attacked, in which case, they whip into a frenzy and attack anything within reach for the next two hours before calming down once again.

HARROWING HAND

Tiny Aberration, Chaotic Evil

Armor Class: 12

Hit Points: 2 (1d4)

Speed: 0 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
13 (+1)	14 (+2)	10 (+0)	5 (–3)	11 (+0)	4 (–3)

Damage Immunities: fire, poison

Condition Immunities: blinded, charmed, exhaustion, poisoned, prone

Senses: blindsight 30 ft. (blind beyond this distance), passive Perception 10

Languages: —

Challenge: 0 (10 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +2

Frozen By Fire: Whenever the hand is subjected to fire damage, it takes no damage but is paralyzed until the end of its next turn.

ACTIONS

Slam: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 3 (1d4 + 1) bludgeoning damage.

A hand reaches out of the stone wall, extending from the surface on a disturbingly long arm.

LION MAN

Animated statues such as the one known as the "lion man" were crafted by powerful magic to guard over specific items or areas. The fact that they are constructs means they don't need to eat or sleep and can be put in position to watch over an area for centuries without interruption.

LION MAN

Large Construct, Unaligned

Armor Class: 16 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 32 (5d10 + 5)

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
17 (+3)	11 (+0)	13 (+1)	1 (–5)	3 (–4)	1 (–5)

Damage Immunities: poison, psychic

Condition Immunities: blinded, charmed, deafened, exhaustion, frightened, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned

Senses: blindsight 60 ft. (blind beyond this radius), darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 6

Languages: —

Challenge: 1 (200 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +2

Antimagic Susceptibility: The statue is incapacitated while in an *antimagic field*. If targeted by *dispel magic*, the statue must succeed on a Constitution saving throw against the caster's spell save DC or fall unconscious for 1 minute.

False Appearance: While the statue remains motionless, it is indistinguishable from a normal statue.

Unusual Nature. The Lion Man doesn't require air, drink, food or sleep.

ACTIONS

Mace: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 10 (2d6 + 3) bludgeoning damage.

This 9–foot–tall statue depicts a humanoid figure with a lion's head. Its eyes give off an eerie orange glow.

LIVING DOOR

The living door can make itself appear as a stone door on both sides or as a stone door on one side and a stone wall on the other. Living doors like to find passageways in old, damp dungeons and caves, stretch their bodies across the passage like a spider's web, and await their prey. Living doors have a very slow metabolism and can wait in the same spot for centuries without needing to feed.

LIVING DOOR

Medium Monstrosity, Typically Chaotic Evil

Armor Class: 19 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 26 (4d8 + 8)

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
17 (+3)	12 (+1)	15 (+2)	5 (–3)	13 (+1)	8 (–1)

Skills: Stealth +5

Damage Immunities: cold

Condition Immunities: prone

Senses: blindsight 30 ft., tremorsense 60 ft., passive Perception 11

Languages: —

Challenge: 2 (450 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +2

False Appearance: While the door remains motionless, it is indistinguishable from an ordinary wall or door.

You Brought It on Yourself: When a creature touches the door (to see if it is locked, for example), they are subjected to the effects of the door's Life Drain attack, as if the door had made a successful attack roll against the creature.

ACTIONS

Life Drain: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 6 (1d6 + 3) necrotic damage. The target must succeed on a DC 13 Constitution saving throw or its hit point maximum is reduced by an amount equal to the damage taken. This reduction lasts until the target finishes a long rest. The target dies if this effect reduces its hit point maximum to 0.

Frosty Vapor Cloud (Recharge 5–6): The door spews forth a cloud of frost in a 10–foot cube. The cloud travels 10 feet away from the door at the start of each of the door's turns. The cloud completely dissipates once it travels 40 feet away from the door. The cloud's area is heavily obscured. Even creatures with darkvision can't see inside the cloud. In addition, a creature that starts its turn in the cloud must succeed on a DC 13 Wisdom saving throw or become charmed for 1 minute. While charmed by the door, the target is incapacitated. If the charmed target is more than 5 feet away from the door, it must move on its turn toward the door by the most direct route. It doesn't avoid opportunity attacks but does avoid damaging terrain, such as lava or a pit. A charmed target that starts its turn within 5 feet of the door touches the door, subjecting it to the door's You Brought It on Yourself trait. The charmed condition ends early if the target takes damage.

There is a single stone door before you. You feel a chill as you approach, as if the room on the other side of the door were significantly colder than the area you are currently in.

LIZARDFOLK SKELETON

These animated skeletons were created from the long–dead remains of lizardfolk, probably only because their creator discovered the site of a battle where lizardfolk remains were plentiful.

LIZARDFOLK SKELETON

Medium Undead, Lawful Evil

Armor Class: 11 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 26 (4d8 + 8)

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
15 (+2)	10 (+0)	15 (+2)	6 (–2)	8 (–1)	5 (–3)

Damage Vulnerabilities: bludgeoning

Damage Immunities: poison

Condition Immunities: exhaustion, poisoned

Senses: darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 9

Languages: understands Draconic but can't speak

Challenge: 1/4 (50 XP) **Proficiency Bonus**: +2

Unusual Nature. The lizardfolk skeleton doesn't require air, drink, food or sleep.

ACTIONS

Bite: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) piercing damage.

Heavy Club: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) bludgeoning damage.

Javelin: *Melee or Ranged Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft. or range 30/120 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) piercing damage.

Although roughly humanoid in appearance, the animated skeleton before you was obviously crafted from the bones of some nonhuman, as evidenced by its large teeth, claws, and tail.

MINOTAUR ENCHANTER

Rarely, a minotaur chooses to study magic, although they seldom become extremely proficient at it.

MINOTAUR ENCHANTER

Large Monstrosity, Typically Chaotic Evil

Armor Class: 14 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 93 (11d10 + 33)

Speed: 40 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	11 (+0)	16 (+3)	14 (+2)	20 (+5)	9 (–1)

Saving Throws: Int +4, Wis +7

Skills: Arcana +4, Medicine +7, Perception +9

Senses: darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 19

Languages: Abyssal

Challenge: 3 (700 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +2

Labyrinthine Recall: The minotaur can perfectly recall any path it has traveled.

ACTIONS

Gore: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 13 (2d8 + 4) piercing damage.

Hypnotic Gaze: The minotaur focuses its gaze on one creature it can see within 5 feet of it. If the target can see the minotaur, it must succeed on a DC 12 Wisdom saving throw or be charmed until the end of the minotaur's next turn. While charmed, the target is incapacitated, and its speed drops to 0. On subsequent turns, the minotaur can use its action to extend the duration until the end of its next turn. The effect ends if the minotaur is ever more than 5 feet away from the target, if the target can't see the minotaur, or if the target takes damage. If a creature's saving throw is successful or the effect ends for it, the creature is immune to the minotaur's Hypnotic Gaze for the next 24 hours.

Spellcasting: The minotaur casts one of the following spells, using Intelligence as its spellcasting ability (spell save DC 12):

At will: *dark* (see appendix D), *mage hand*, *mending*

1/day each: *charm person*, *hypnotism* (see appendix D), *unseen servant*

This minotaur appears different from those you have encountered before. Most notably, she carries no weapon, and her robes are like those typically worn by a spellcaster.

MINOTAUR LIZARD

The origin of these strange, amalgamated creatures has been lost to history, but no doubt they are the result of some dark, magical experiment. Minotaur lizards tend to be found guarding specific items or locations, implying that they may have been created specifically for that purpose.

MINOTAUR LIZARD

Large monstrosity, neutral evil

Armor Class: 16 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 102 (12d10 + 36)

Speed: 40 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	11 (+0)	16 (+3)	7 (–2)	16 (+3)	9 (–1)

Skills: Athletics +7, Perception +6, Stealth +3, Survival +6

Senses: darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 16

Languages: Abyssal, Draconic

Challenge: 7 (2,900 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +3

Hold Breath: The minotaur lizard can hold its breath for 15 minutes.

Labyrinthine Recall: The minotaur lizard can perfectly recall any path it has traveled.

Reckless: At the start of its turn, the minotaur lizard can gain advantage on all melee weapon attack rolls it makes during that turn, but attack rolls against it have advantage until the start of its next turn.

ACTIONS

Multiattack: The minotaur lizard makes one Bite attack and two Claw attacks.

Bite: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 22 (4d8 + 4) piercing damage.

Claw: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 13 (2d8 + 4) slashing damage.

This bizarre monstrosity walks upright like a humanoid but has the head of a cow. Its maw is filled with sharp teeth more akin to those of a reptile than a bovine. Its body is covered with a patchwork of golden scales and tufts of black, brown, and white hair.

NAIAD

Small Fey, Typically Chaotic Good

Armor Class: 12

Hit Points: 10 (3d6)

Speed: 20 ft., swim 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
7 (–2)	15 (+2)	10 (+0)	13 (+1)	14 (+2)	18 (+4)

Skills: Animal Handling +4, Persuasion +6

Damage Immunities: poison

Condition Immunities: charmed, paralyzed, poisoned

Senses: darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 12

Languages: Aquan, Elvish, Sylvan

Challenge: 1/2 (100 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +2

Amphibious: The naiad can breathe air and water.

Magic Resistance: The naiad has advantage on saving throws against spells and other magical effects.

ACTIONS

Dagger: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 4 (1d4 + 2) piercing damage.

Fey Charm (3/Day): The naiad targets one humanoid that she can see within 30 feet of her. If the target can see the naiad, it must succeed on a DC 14 Wisdom saving throw or be magically charmed by the naiad. If the target or its allies are currently fighting the naiad or her allies, the target makes the saving throw with advantage.

Each time the naiad or its allies do anything harmful to the target, it can repeat the saving throw, ending the effect on itself on a success. Otherwise, the effect lasts 24 hours or until the naiad dies, is on a different plane of existence from the target, or ends the effect as a bonus action. If a target's saving throw is successful, the target is immune to this naiad's Fey Charm for the next 24 hours. When the effect ends, the target knows it was charmed by the naiad.

The naiad can have no more than one humanoid charmed at a time.

Water's Embrace: The naiad commands one creature charmed by her to drown itself. If the target can hear the naiad, it must make a DC 14 Wisdom saving throw. On a success, the charm effect ends. On a failure, the target must move on its turn toward the nearest body of water. When it enters water, the target forgoes holding its breath and begins to drown at the end of its turn. A drowning creature can survive a number of its turns equal to its Constitution modifier (minimum 1). At the start of its next turn, a drowning creature drops to 0 hit points and is dying. The target can't be stabilized or regain hit points until it can breathe again. While drowning, the target can repeat the Wisdom saving throw at the end of each of its turns, ending the charmed condition on a success.

A child-like creature with fey features pops her head above the placid surface of the pool. She has green, plant-like fronds for hair, and a bright-pink lotus flower adorns her brow. She beams with a wide, inviting smile.

NAIAD SHELLSINGER

Small Fey, Typically Chaotic Good

Armor Class: 14

Hit Points: 27 (6d6 + 6)

Speed: 20 ft., swim 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
7 (–2)	18 (+4)	12 (+1)	13 (+1)	14 (+2)	18 (+4)

Skills: Animal Handling +4, Persuasion +6

Damage Immunities: poison

Condition Immunities: charmed, paralyzed, poisoned

Senses: darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 12

Languages: Aquan, Elvish, Sylvan

Challenge: 2 (450 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +2

Amphibious: The naiad can breathe air and water.

Magic Resistance: The naiad has advantage on saving throws against spells and other magical effects.

ACTIONS

Dagger: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d4 + 4) piercing damage.

Fey Charm (3/Day): The naiad targets one humanoid that she can see within 30 feet of her. If the target can see the naiad, it must succeed on a DC 14 Wisdom saving throw or be magically charmed by the naiad. If the target or its allies are currently fighting the naiad or her allies, the target makes the saving throw with advantage.

Each time the naiad or its allies do anything harmful to the target, it can repeat the saving throw, ending the effect on itself on a success. Otherwise, the effect lasts 24 hours or until the naiad dies, is on a different plane of existence from the target, or ends the effect as a bonus action. If a target's saving throw is successful, the target is immune to this naiad's Fey Charm for the next 24 hours. When the effect ends, the target knows it was charmed by the naiad. The naiad can have no more than one humanoid charmed at a time.

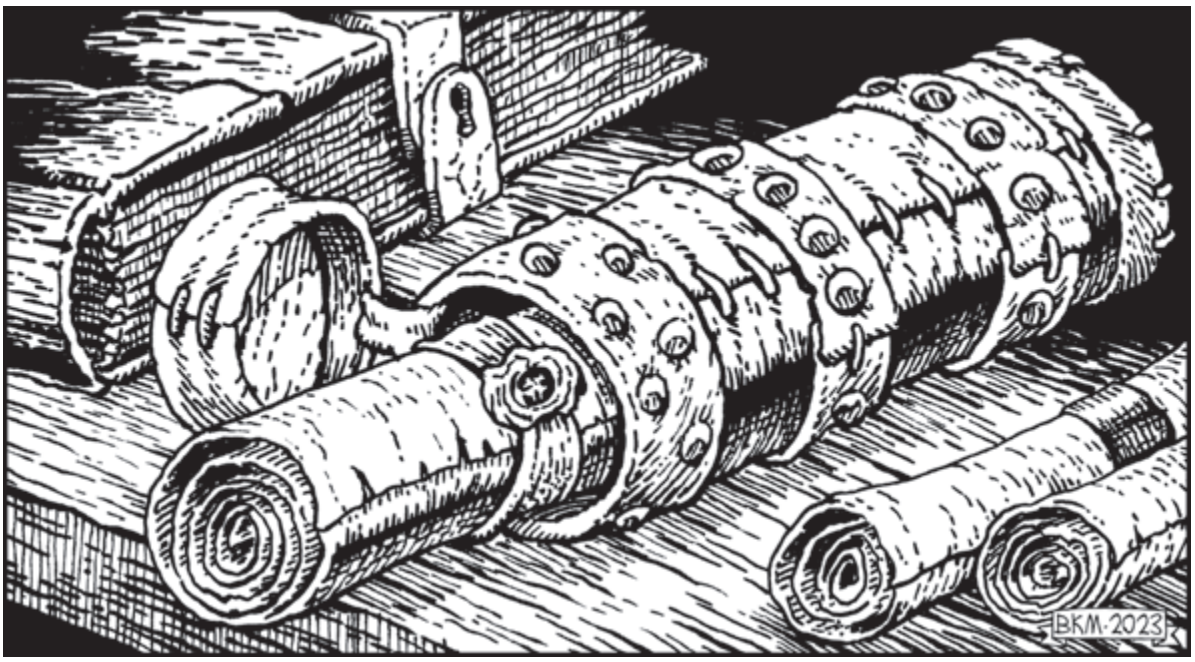
Song of Healing (1/Day): The naiad sings a melody to heal its allies. Up to six creatures within 60 feet of the naiad that can hear him magically regain 11 (2d6 + 4) hit points.

Song of Soothing (1/Day): The naiad sings a melody that calms hostile creatures. Up to six creatures within 60 feet of the shellsinger that can hear him must make a DC 14 Wisdom saving throw. On a failed save, the target has disadvantage on attack rolls until the end of its next turn.

Song of Summoning (1/Day): The naiad sings a melody to summon fish allies. The naiad magically calls 1 or 2 **reef sharks** or 1 **swarm of quippers**, provided the naiad is in a body of water. The called creatures arrive in 1d4 rounds, acting as allies of the naiad and obeying his spoken commands. The beasts remain for 1 hour, until the naiad dies, or until the naiad dismisses them as a bonus action.

Water's Embrace: The naiad commands one creature drowned by him to drown itself. If the target can hear the naiad, it must make a DC 14 Wisdom saving throw. On a success, the charm effect ends. On a failure, the target must move on its turn toward the nearest body of water. When it enters water, the target forgoes holding its breath and begins to drown at the end of its turn. A drowning creature can survive a number of its turns equal to its Constitution modifier (minimum 1). At the start of its next turn, a drowning creature drops to 0 hit points and is dying. The target can't be stabilized or regain hit points until it can breathe again. While drowning, the target can repeat the Wisdom saving throw at the end of each of its turns, ending the charmed condition on a success.

A diminutive elven form lounges on the rocky shore, eyes shut peacefully as he concentrates on his song. His sweet, melodic voice incites a school of fish to churn the shallow water at his webbed feet.



ORACULAR SKULL

Oracular skulls are a form of undead created by the religious followers of Thanatos. The skulls serve as sentries, oracles, and even "recruiters," branding those who seek their wisdom as followers of The Dark One.

ORACULAR SKULL

Tiny Undead, Chaotic Evil

Armor Class: 18 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 36 (8d4 + 16)

Speed: 0 ft., fly 60 ft. (hover)

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
1 (–5)	17 (+03	14 (+2)	16 (+3)	14 (+2)	13 (+1)

Skills: Arcana +5, History +5, Insight +4, Perception +4

Damage Resistances: lightning, necrotic; piercing

Damage Immunities: cold, fire, force, poison

Condition Immunities: charmed, frightened, paralyzed, poisoned, prone

Senses: darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 14

Languages: all languages known by creatures within 60 ft.

Challenge: 4 (1,100 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +2

Prophesy: The skull truthfully answers any yes–or–no style question put to it. An individual creature can only ever ask the skull a single question. Once the skull answers a creature's question, the creature becomes cursed and a white, skull–shaped blemish appears on the back of the creature's right hand. Creatures with this mark are recognized (perhaps incorrectly) as worshippers of The Dark One. If both a *remove*

curse spell and a *cure wounds* spell cast at 4th level or higher are cast on the creature, the curse ends and the blemish disappears. Otherwise, the curse is permanent.

Turn Resistance: The skull has advantage on saving throws against any effect that turns undead.

Unusual Nature: The oracular skull doesn't require air, drink, food, or sleep.

ACTIONS

Glowing Arrow: The skull fires up to two magical glowing arrows. Each arrow hits a creature the skull can see within 150 feet of it. An arrow deals 4 (1d6 + 1) force damage to its target. The arrows can hit one creature or several.

A green–glowing humanoid skull with ram's horns floats in the air, regarding you with what appear to be living, human eyes.

PATRIARCH OF THE DARK ONE

Patriarchs (and matriarchs) of The Dark One are the leaders of the religious cult of Thanatos within Thracia, presiding over nearly all religious ceremonies.

PATRIARCH OF THE DARK ONE

Medium Humanoid (Human), Lawful Evil

Armor Class: 16 (chain mail)

Hit Points: 44 (8d8 + 8)

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
13 (+1)	12 (+1)	12 (+1)	14 (+2)	18 (+4)	14 (+2)

Saving Throws: Wis +7, Cha +5

Skills: Intimidation +5, Performance +5, Persuasion +5, Religion +5

Senses: passive Perception 14

Languages: Modern Thracian, Tribal Thracian

Challenge: 5 (1,800 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +3

Divine Strike: Once per turn, the patriarch can deal an extra 4 (1d8) necrotic damage to a creature they hit with a weapon attack.

Inescapable Destruction: Necrotic damage dealt by the patriarch's spells ignores resistance to necrotic damage.

ACTIONS

Warhammer: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 5 (1d8 + 1) bludgeoning damage, or 6 (1d10 + 1) bludgeoning damage if used with two hands.

Chilling Grasp: *Ranged Spell Attack:* +7 to hit, range 120 ft., one target. *Hit:* 9 (2d8) necrotic damage and the target is grappled (escape DC 15). While grappled, the target takes an additional 4 (1d8) necrotic damage at the start of the target's turn, and can't regain hit points.

Control Undead (2/Short or Long Rest): The patriarch attempts to take control of undead creatures within 30 feet of them. Each undead that can hear or see the patriarch in that range must make a DC 15 Wisdom saving throw. Undead creatures with 5 Hit Dice or more have advantage on this saving throw. On a failed save, the target is under the patriarch's control for 24 hours or until the patriarch or one of their companions does anything harmful to it. On each of the patriarch's turns, they can use a bonus action to mentally command any undead under their control within 60 feet of them. If the patriarch controls multiple creatures, they can command any

or all of them at the same time, issuing the same command to each one. While under their control, the undead obey their commands and, if given an order, continue to follow it until the task is complete. The patriarch can control up to a maximum of 12 Hit Dice worth of undead creatures at any one time.

Guiding Bolt (2/day): *Ranged Spell Attack:* +7 to hit, range 120 ft., one target. *Hit:* 14 (4d6) radiant damage. The next attack against this target before the patriarch's next turn is at advantage due to a mystical dim radiance on the target.

Spellcasting: The patriarch casts one of the following spells, using Wisdom as their spellcasting ability (spell save DC 15):

At will: *guidance*, *light*, *thaumaturgy*

3/day each: *false life*, *protection from evil and good*, *shield of faith*

2/day each: *blindness/deafness*, *hold person*

1/day each: *animate dead*, *death ward, speak with dead*, *sticks to snakes* (see appendix D)

This male human wears a set of exquisite robes over a suit of chain mail armor and carries a warhammer by his side. The way he carries himself, as well as the adornments on his robes, implies he is some sort of spiritual leader

SKELETAL CYCLOPS

The bones of this one-eyed giant have been animated to create a fearsome guardian.

SKELETAL CYCLOPS

Huge Undead, Chaotic Evil

Armor Class: 16 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 138 (12d12 + 60)

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
22 (+6)	14 (+2)	20 (+5)	8 (–1)	6 (–2)	10 (+0)

Damage Resistances: piercing and slashing

Damage Vulnerabilities: bludgeoning

Damage Immunities: poison

Condition Immunities: exhaustion, poisoned

Senses: darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 8

Languages: understands Giant but can't speak

Challenge: 6 (2,300 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +3

Poor Depth Perception: The cyclops has disadvantage on any attack roll against a target more than 30 feet away.

Unusual Nature: The skeletal cyclops doesn't require air, food, drink or sleep.

ACTIONS

Multiattack: The cyclops makes two Greatclub attacks.

Greatclub: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +9 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 19 (3d8 + 6) bludgeoning damage.

A 20–foot–tall skeletal giant lumbers into the room dragging a metal–shod greatclub behind it. A single eye socket is centered in its bleached skull. Hovering inside the socket is a massive ruby with a hellish glow.

SKELETAL COMMANDER

Skeletal commanders look like typical animated skeletons but possess additional abilities and greater intelligence than their undead cousins.

SKELETAL COMMANDER

Medium Undead, Lawful Evil

Armor Class: 13 (armor scraps)

Hit Points: 26 (4d8 + 8)

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	14 (+2)	15 (+2)	12 (+1)	10 (+0)	14 (+2)

Damage Vulnerabilities: bludgeoning

Damage Immunities: poison

Condition Immunities: exhaustion, poisoned

Senses: darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 10

Languages: Ancient Thracian

Challenge: 1/2 (100 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +2

Command Undead: An undead creature with an Intelligence score of 10 or less that is not controlled by another creature follows the commander's spoken commands.

Innate Spellcasting: The commander can cast *animate dead* at will without material components, using Charisma as its spellcasting ability.

Transfer Consciousness: When the commander is destroyed, it attempts to transfer its spirit into the corpse of a Medium humanoid within 200 feet of it. The commander makes a DC 8 Charisma check. On a success, the corpse rises as a **skeleton** or **zombie** with the ability scores, languages, and traits of the commander at the start of the commander's next turn.

Turn Resistance: The commander has advantage on saving throws against any effect that turns undead.

Unusual Nature: The skeletal commander doesn't require air, food, drink or sleep.

ACTIONS

Multiattack: The skeletal commander makes two Shortsword or two Shortbow attacks.

Shortsword: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) piercing damage.

Shortbow: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, range 80/320 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) piercing damage.

This skeletal warrior wears scraps of armor and wields a bent and rusty blade. But unlike most undead you've encountered, a glimmer of intelligence burns in its otherwise dark eye sockets.

SOULLESS

Lizardfolk that fail and die at a ritualistic rite of passage can never truly rest. Their souls are torn asunder from their partially skeletal body, and linger as undead monstrosities.

SOULLESS

Medium Undead, Typically Chaotic Evil

Armor Class: 14 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 37 (5d8 +15)

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	14 (+2)	17 (+3)	8 (–1)	6 (–2)	10 (+0)

Damage Resistances: bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing that is nonmagical

Damage Immunities: poison

Condition Immunities: exhaustion, poisoned

Senses: darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 8

Languages: understands Draconic but can't speak

Challenge: 2 (450 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +2

Unusual Nature: The soulless doesn't require air, food, drink or sleep.

ACTIONS

Multiattack: The soulless makes two Claw attacks and one Bite attack.

Bite: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 8 (2d4 + 3) piercing damage.

Claw: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d4 + 3) slashing damage. If the target is a non–undead, non–construct creature, it must make a successful DC 13 Wisdom saving throw or become cursed with the Curse of the Thracian Mud. While cursed, the target's mouth, throat, and lungs fill with thick swamp mud, causing them to suffocate. A suffocating target can survive a number of rounds equal to its Constitution modifier (minimum 1). At the start of the next turn, the target drops to 0 hit points and is dying. The target can't be stabilized or regain hit points until it can breathe again. The target can repeat the saving throw at the end of each of its turns, ending the curse on itself with a success.

A lizardfolk cursed in a state of undeath pulls itself out of the mud and muck. Its upper torso is made of bleached bones, while its lower half is covered with decaying flesh, no doubt preserved by the horrid mud it resides in.

VICAR OF THE DARK ONE

Vicars of The Dark One are religious leaders within the cult of Thanatos. They serve one specific church or parish and are usually supported by the larger overall organization of their faith.

VICAR OF THE DARK ONE

Medium Humanoid (Human), Typically Lawful Evil

Armor Class: 13 (leather armor)

Hit Points: 33 (6d8 + 6)

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
13 (1)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)	10 (+0)	13 (+1)	14 (+2)

Saving Throws: Wis +3, Cha +4

Skills: Deception +4, Persuasion +4, Religion +2

Senses: passive Perception 11

Languages: Modern Thracian, Tribal Thracian

Challenge: 2 (450 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +2

Dark Devotion: The vicar has advantage on saving throws against being charmed or frightened.

ACTIONS

Multiattack: The vicar makes two Warhammer attacks.

Warhammer: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 5 (1d8 + 1) bludgeoning damage, or 6 (1d10 + 1) bludgeoning damage if used with two hands.

Control Undead (1/Short or Long Rest): The vicar attempts to take control of undead creatures within 30 feet of them. Each undead that can hear or see the adept in that range must make a DC 11 Wisdom saving throw. Undead creatures with 5 Hit Dice or more have advantage on this saving throw. On a failed save, the target is under the vicar's control for 24 hours or until the vicar or one of their companions does anything harmful to it. On each of the vicar's turns, they can use a bonus action to mentally command any undead under their control within 60 feet of them. If the vicar controls multiple creatures, they can command any or all of them at the same time, issuing the same command to each one. While under their control, the undead obey their commands and, if given an order, continue to follow it until the task is complete. The vicar can control up to a maximum of 12 Hit Dice worth of undead creatures at any one time.

Necrotic Flame: A black mote of foul necrotic energy descends on a target the vicar can see within 60 feet. The target must make a successful DC 11 Dexterity saving throw, or take 4 (1d8) necrotic damage. The target can't gain the benefits of cover for this saving throw.

Spiritual Warhammer: *Ranged Spell Attack:* +3 to hit, range 60 ft., reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 8 (1d8 + 3) force damage.

Spellcasting: The vicar casts one of the following spells, using Wisdom as their spellcasting ability (spell save DC 11):

At will: *light*, *mending*, *thaumaturgy*

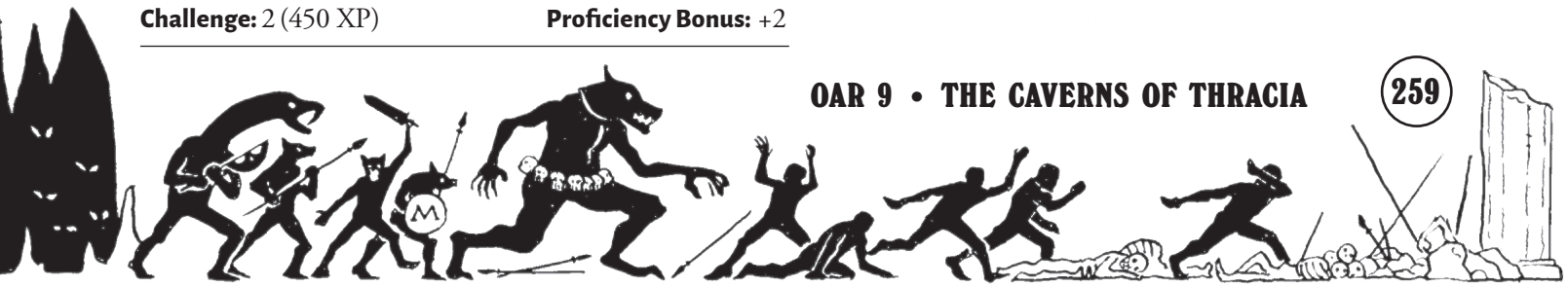
2/day each: *false life*, *inflict wounds, shield of faith*

1/day each: *blindness/deafness*, *hold person*, *ray of enfeeblement*

BONUS ACTIONS

Move Spiritual Warhammer: The vicar may move the *spiritual warhammer* up to 20 feet.

This person is clad in a combination of leather armor and ornate robes decorated with sacred imagery, implying their membership in a religious order or cult of some kind.



WAR BEAR

War bears are brown bears (such as grizzlies or Kodiaks) that the gnolls of the caverns have trained specifically for combat. They are typically found in the company of gnoll handlers but can be left on their own to guard areas, as they are trained to attack any creature other than a beastfolk that wanders by.

WAR BEAR

Large Beast, Unaligned

Armor Class: 13 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 42 (5d10 + 15)

Speed: 40 ft., climb 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
19 (+4)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)	2 (–4)	13 (+1)	7 (–2)

Skills: Perception +3

Senses: passive Perception 13

Languages: —

Challenge: 3 (700 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +2

Hug: If the bear scores a critical hit with its claws, the target takes an extra 8 (1d8 + 4) bludgeoning damage.

Keen Smell: The bear has advantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on smell.

ACTIONS

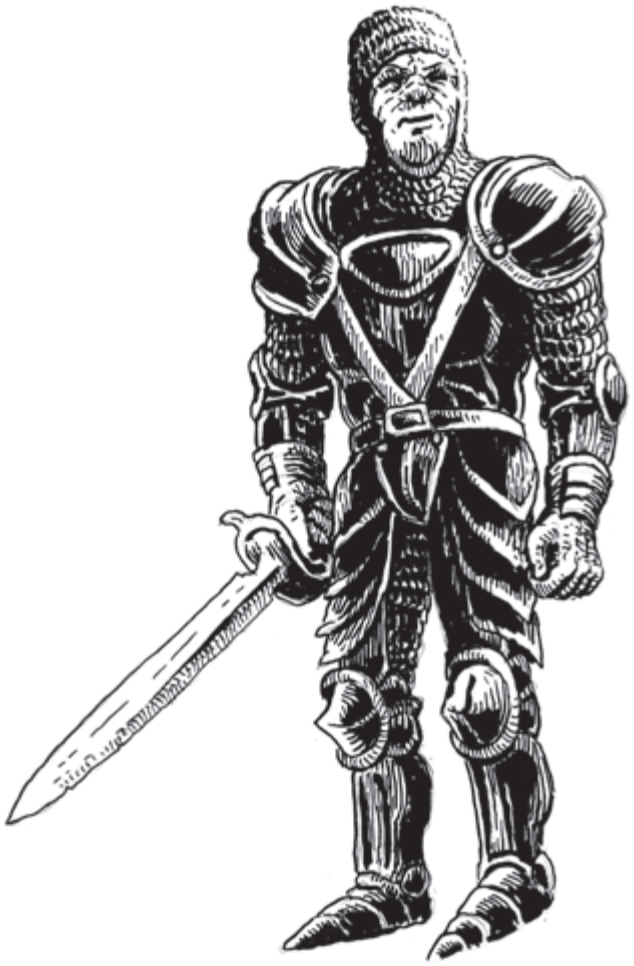
Multiattack: The bear makes two attacks: one with its Bite and one with its Claws.

Bite: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 8 (1d8 + 4) piercing damage.

Claws: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 11 (2d6 + 4) piercing damage.

This extremely large bear has a coat of brown fur and sports a muscular hump between its shoulders.

APPENDIX C
NPCS



ANTEUS

Anteus was a soldier in King Agamemnos's King's Guard, but powerful magic has kept him clinging to life for nearly 1,100 years. His vocal cords have atrophied, stripping him of the ability to speak, but he can understand Ancient Thracian and might be able to comprehend Tribal Thracian or Modern Thracian, as they are derivative languages. He assists anyone he encounters in the caverns, so long as they are not allied with the beastfolk.

ANTEUS

Medium Humanoid (Human), Lawful Neutral

Armor Class: 21 (*+1 plate armor*; shield)

Hit Points: 45 (7d8 + 14)

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
15 (+2)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	11 (+0)	11 (+0)	15 (+2)

Saving Throws: Con +4, Wis +2

Senses: passive Perception 10

Languages: understands Ancient Thracian but can't speak

Challenge: 3 (700 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +2

Special Equipment: Anteus wears a custom suit of *+1 plate armor*.

Brave: Anteus has advantage on saving throws against being frightened.

ACTIONS

Multiattack: Anteus makes two Greatsword attacks.

Greatsword: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 11 (2d6 + 2) slashing damage.

Leadership (Recharges after a Short or Long Rest): For 1 minute, Anteus can utter a special command or warning whenever a non–hostile creature he can see within 30 feet makes an attack roll or a saving throw. The creature can add a d4 to its roll provided it can hear and understand Anteus. A creature can benefit from only one Leadership die at a time. This effect ends if Anteus is incapacitated. Anteus can't use this action until his vocal cords are restored.

REACTIONS

Parry: Anteus adds 2 to his AC against one melee attack that would hit him. To do so, Anteus must see his attacker and be wielding a melee weapon.

This 6–foot–tall, male human warrior is clad in antiquated plate armor and carries a broadsword. He stands at the ready, despite having seen better days.

BOVA, MINOTAUR CLERIC

Bova is a cleric and the grandmother of Stronghoen, the minotaur king. She is uncommonly intelligent for a minotaur and speaks three languages, allowing her to communicate with nearly all residents of the caverns. She is partially blind, but her labyrinthine recall and familiarity with the lower levels of the caverns allows her to easily find her way around. Well past her childbearing years, Bova enjoys a life of little responsibility and is content to counsel her grandson on the occasions he seeks her advice (or healing). Bova is non–aggressive and would rather have long conversations about the outside world with unexpected visitors than engage in combat.

BOVA, MINOTAUR CLERIC

Large Monstrosity, Chaotic Neutral

Armor Class: 14 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 67 (9d10 + 18)

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	11 (+0)	14 (+2)	13 (+1)	16 (+3)	9 (–1)

Saving Throws: Wis +5, Cha +1

Skills: Perception +7 (but see Partial Blindness)

Senses: darkvision 30 ft., passive Perception 17

Languages: Abyssal, Gnoll, Tribal Thracian

Challenge: 2 (450 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +2

Charge: If Bova moves at least 10 feet straight toward a target and then hits with a Gore attack on the same turn, the target takes an extra 9 (2d8) piercing damage. If the target is a creature, it must succeed on a DC 13 Strength saving throw or be pushed up to 10 feet away and knocked prone.

Labyrinthine Recall: Bova can perfectly recall any path she has traveled. She has traveled Levels 3 and 4 of the caverns quite extensively.

Partial Blindness: Bova has disadvantage on attack rolls, as well as on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on sight.

ACTIONS

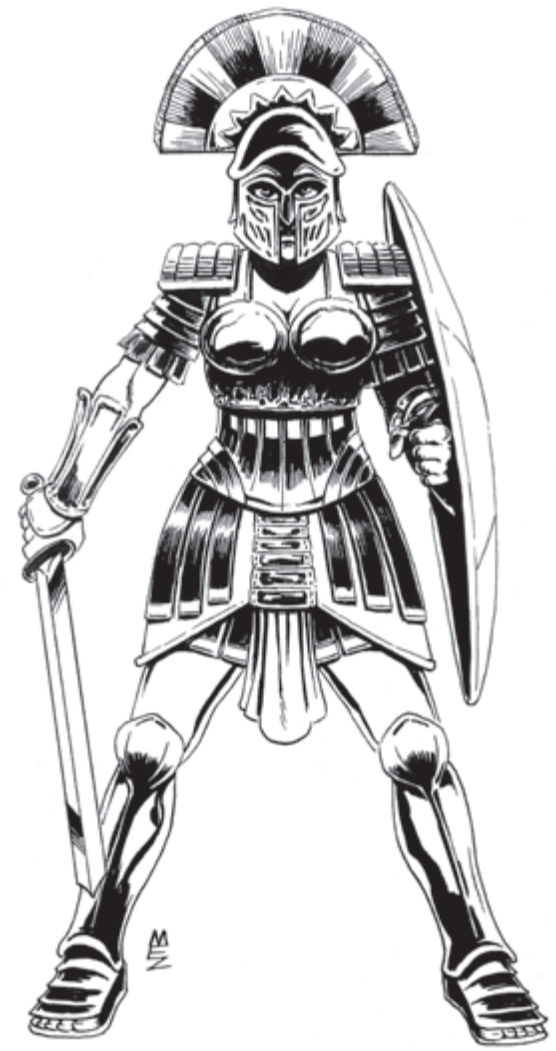
Gore: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 12 (2d8 + 3) piercing damage.

Spellcasting: Bova casts one of the following spells, using Wisdom as her spellcasting ability (spell save DC 13):

At will: *guidance*, *light*, *mending*

1/day each: *bless*, *cure wounds*, *detect magic*

This elderly minotaur wields no weapons but wears a holy symbol around her neck and dresses in garb reminiscent of a religious order. Her eyes have a partially opaque, milky appearance.



EPICASTE

Epicaste was a fighter in the service of King Agamemnos but has been frozen in suspended animation by powerful magic for nearly 1,100 years. The last thing she remembers is descending to area 2–13 via the trap door in area 2–15 with three other soldiers. Epicaste and her group were investigating hiding places where the beastfolk could be headquartered, as there were rumors circulating of a planned uprising. Unless convinced that over a millennium has passed since she fell into stasis, she is adamant only a few hours have passed since she lost consciousness. Epicaste knows her way through the northern part of the Level 2 (areas 2–7, 2–14 through 2–16, and 2–20 through 2–25), areas 1–1 through 1–8 of Level 1, the north wing of the palace on Level 3, and all of the dungeon on Level 4. She is unfamiliar with the dungeon's present occupants and does not know the location of any secret doors.

EPICASTE

Medium Humanoid (Human), Lawful Good

Armor Class: 21 (*+1 plate armor*, shield)

Hit Points: 30 (4d8 + 12)

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
15 (+2)	17 (+3)	16 (+3)	14 (+2)	10 (+0)	13 (+1)

Saving Throws: Str +4, Con +5

Senses: passive Perception 10

Languages: Ancient Thracian and some Gnoll

Challenge: 2 (450 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +2

Special Equipment: Epicaste wears a custom suit of *+1 plate armor*.

Dueling: When wielding a melee weapon in one hand and no other weapons, Epicaste gains a +2 bonus to damage rolls with that weapon (included in her attacks).

Improved Critical: Epicaste's weapons attacks score a critical hit on a roll of 19 or 20.

ACTIONS

Longsword: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 8 (1d8 + 4) slashing damage, or 7 (1d10 + 2) slashing damage if used with two hands.

BONUS ACTIONS

Action Surge (1/Short or Long Rest): On her turn, Epicaste can take one additional action on top of her regular action and a possible bonus action.

Second Wind (1/Short or Long Rest): Epicaste can use a bonus action on her turn to regain 9 (1d10 + 4) hit points.

This female human warrior is clad in form–fitting plate armor with a plumed helm and carries a longsword and shield. She seems to have just awakened from a long slumber. A thin layer of frost still melts and drips from her armor.

GRASSUS, STOREROOM CLERK

Grassus is a male human, roughly 40–50 years in age, who serves as the clerk in charge of the minotaur king's food stores. He prefers his position with the beastfolk to any possibility of freedom. Given the chance, he betrays intruders to his masters.

GRASSUS, STOREROOM CLERK

Medium Humanoid (Human), Lawful Evil

Armor Class: 11

Hit Points: 6 (1d8 + 2)

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
13 (+1)	12 (+1)	14 (+2)	13 (+1)	16 (+3)	15 (+2)

Skills: Deception +4

Senses: passive Perception 13

Languages: Abyssal, Gnoll, Tribal Thracian, can read Modern Thracian but can't speak it

Challenge: 0 (10 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +2

ACTIONS

Dagger: *Melee or Ranged Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft. or range 20/60 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 3 (1d4 + 1) piercing damage.

This middle-aged male human is quite unassuming in appearance. Although better dressed than most slaves, he is not outfitted as an adventurer of any sort.

GRASTIC HAMMERCLAY, THE OLD MAN OF THE BRIDGE

Grastic Hammerclay is a deep gnome (svirfneblin) whose people drove him away because of his unusual size. He is severely disturbed and intensely paranoid. The tribal warriors who worship The Dark One know Grastic as "The Old Man of the Bridge" and avoid him whenever possible. Grastic has managed to eke out an existence for himself in the caverns by snaring stirges and crayfish. He has studied magic in the past and is a practiced illusionist.

GRASTIC HAMMERCLAY, THE OLD MAN OF THE BRIDGE

Large Humanoid (Gnome), Neutral

Armor Class: 15 (chain shirt)

Hit Points: 52 (7d10 + 14)

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
15 (+2)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	8 (–1)	9 (–1)

Saving Throws: Int +4, Wis +1

Skills: Arcana +4, Investigation +4, Perception +1, Stealth +4, Survival +1

Senses: darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 11

Languages: Gnomish, Terran, Undercommon

Challenge: 2 (450 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +2

Special Equipment: Grastic has 221 cp, 68 sp, 89 gp, a small chrysoprase (worth 30 gp), and a rusty iron key that he keeps in a sack. The key is a master key that unlocks the cells in areas 4–9 and 4–10.

Gnome Cunning: Grastic has advantage on Intelligence, Wisdom, and Charisma saving throws against spells and other magical effects.

Improved Minor Illusion: When he casts the *minor illusion* cantrip, Grastic can create both a sound and an image with a single casting of the spell.

Innate Spellcasting: Grastic can cast one of the following spells, requiring no material components and using Intelligence as his spellcasting ability (spell save DC 12):

At will: *nondetection* (self only)

1/day each: *blindness/deafness*, *blur*, *disguise self*

Stone Camouflage: Grastic has advantage on Dexterity (Stealth) checks made to hide in rocky terrain.

ACTIONS

Club: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 7 (2d4 + 2) bludgeoning damage.

Spear: *Melee or Ranged Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft. or range 20/60 ft., one target. *Hit:* 9 (2d6 + 2) piercing damage, or 11 (2d8 + 2) piercing damage if used with two hands to make a melee attack.

Dazzling Spray (2/day): A dazzling array of colors and flashing lights emits from your fingers in a 15–foot cone. 33 (6d10) hit points of creatures that can see in the area of effect are blinded for 1 round. Start with the lowest hit point total, and proceed in ascending order, deducing hit points from the available pool. A creature's hit points must be equal to or less than the remaining total to be affected.

Spellcasting: Grastic casts one of the following spells, using Intelligence as his spellcasting ability (spell save DC 12):

At will: *dark* (see appendix D), *mage hand*, *mending*, *minor illusion*, *prestidigitation*

2/day each: *hypnotism* (see appendix D), *silent image*

1/day each: *invisibility*, *mirror image*, *phantasmal force*

This gray–skinned humanoid resembles a short stone giant. Although armed with a club and a spear, he seems more preoccupied with his own thoughts than with hunting or acting as a sentry.

G'RUK THE FISH–FINDER, LIZARDFOLK SHAMAN

G'ruk the Fish–finder is a lizardfolk shaman who serves as both the spiritual and military leader of the lizardfolk in the caverns, although he still owes allegiance to the minotaur king. He has recently learned of a legend featuring the phrase "cast the blood of man upon the troubled waters," which he (incorrectly) interprets as a demand for human blood to be sacrificed to gain safe access to a treasure–filled room in the caverns (area 2–9). He has been looking for a living human to test the legend for some time, but the other lizardfolk usually bring back only pieces of the tribal warriors they defeat. The secret door northeast of area 2–7 leads to G'Ruk's secret lair in area 2–31H. As a last resort, G'ruk may throw his pouch of poison dust to escape hostile adventurers. G'ruk has learned to cast the *fear* spell, which is not normally considered a druid spell, due to the esoteric connection to nature that is part of lizardfolk spirituality.

G'RUK THE FISH–FINDER, LIZARDFOLK SHAMAN

Medium Humanoid (Lizardfolk, Shapechanger), Neutral

Armor Class: 15 (natural armor, shield)

Hit Points: 27 (5d8 + 5)

Speed: 30 ft., swim 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
15 (+2)	10 (+0)	13 (+1)	10 (+0)	15 (+2)	8 (–1)

Skills: Perception +4, Stealth +4, Survival +6

Senses: passive Perception 14

Languages: Abyssal, Draconic, Gnoll

Challenge: 2 (450 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +2

Special Equipment: G'ruk carries a satchel that contains 18 gp and a *potion of mind control* (undead) (see appendix D), as well as four "sacred" rocks, a mummified human hand, six teeth from various creatures, a set of 20 divining sticks, six strips of dried human flesh, and a human jawbone (all useless). The satchel also contains four pouches filled with various powders. The contents of the four pouches are alum, dust, sand, and poison dust (see sidebar).

Hold Breath: G'ruk can hold his breath for 15 minutes.

Inspire Battle Frenzy: As a bonus action, G'ruk can attempt to whip other lizardfolk into a battle frenzy. G'ruk makes a DC 8 Charisma check. On a success, he grants each lizardfolk within 60 feet that can see or hear him a +1 bonus to attack rolls for 1 minute.

ACTIONS

Multiattack (Lizardfolk Form Only): G'ruk makes two attacks: two with his Mace or one with his Bite and one with his Claws or Mace.

Bite: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) piercing damage, or 7 (1d10 + 2) piercing damage in crocodile form. If G'ruk is in crocodile form and the target is a Large or smaller creature, the target is grappled (escape DC 12). Until this grapple ends, the target is restrained, and G'ruk can't bite another target. If G'ruk reverts to his true form, the grapple ends.

Claws (Lizardfolk Form Only): *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 4 (1d4 + 2) slashing damage.

Mace: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) bludgeoning damage.

Fiery Mote: *Ranged Spell Attack:* +4 to hit, range 30 ft., one target. *Hit:* 9 (2d8) fire damage.

Thorn Whip: *Melee Spell Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 30 ft., one target. *Hit:* 7 (2d6) piercing damage. If the target is Large or smaller, G'ruk can pull the target 10 feet closer.

Change Shape (1/Short or Long Rest): G'ruk magically polymorphs into a Large **crocodile**, remaining in that form for up to 1 hour. He can revert to his true form as a bonus action. His statistics, other than his size, are the same in each form. Any equipment he is wearing or carrying isn't transformed. G'ruk reverts to his true form if he dies.

Spellcasting (Lizardfolk Form Only): G'ruk casts one of the following spells using Wisdom as the spellcasting ability (spell save DC 12):

At will: *druidcraft*

2/day each: *cure wounds*, *inflict wounds*

1/day: *conjure animals* (reptiles only), *fear, heat metal*, *spike growth*

Poison Dust

Mixing the poison dust with water generates up to five doses of basic poison. As an action, a creature can throw the pouch of poison at a point it can see within 20 feet. Upon impact, the pouch bursts and creates a cloud of poison dust in a 10-foot radius. Each creature caught in the dust when the pouch explodes takes 9 (2d8) poison damage, or half as much damage with a successful DC 14 Constitution saving throw.

This reptilian humanoid carries both a shield and a mace to supplement its naturally large claws and needle–like teeth. On his head and shoulders, he wears a mantle comprised of several amulets on a chain, numerous long and colorful feathers, and a pair of what appear to be ram's horns.

ADJUSTMENTS FOR OPPONENTS

Opponent's Level	Guardian Fighter Level	Guardian Adjustments	Challenge
1-2	4	None	**2** (450 XP)
3	5	hp: 32, Proficiency Bonus: +3, Multiattack (two attacks)	**3** (700 XP)
4	6	hp: 45, Str: 18, Con: 14	**3** (700 XP)
5	7	hp: 52, Remarkable Athlete	**3** (700 XP)
6	8	hp: 60, Str: 19, Con: 15	**4** (1,100 XP)
7	9	hp: 67, Proficiency Bonus: +4, Indomitable (one use)	**4** (1,100 XP)
8	10	hp: 75, Defense Fighting Style (AC 21)	**5** (1,800 XP)
9	11	hp: 82, Multiattack (three attacks)	**5** (1,800 XP)
10	12	hp: 102, Str: 20, Con: 16	**6** (2,300 XP)
11	13	hp: 110, Proficiency Bonus: +5, Indomitable (two uses)	**7** (2,900 XP)
12	14	hp: 133, Con: 18	**8** (3,900 XP)
13	15	hp: 142, Superior Critical (18-20)	**8** (3,900 XP)
14	16	hp: 168, Con: 20	**9** (5,000 XP)
15	17	hp: 178, Proficiency Bonus: +6, Action Surge (two uses), Indomitable (three uses)	**9** (5,000 XP)
16	18	hp: 189, Survivor (10 hp/round)	**9** (5,000 XP)
17	19	hp: 199, Wis: 13	**10** (5,900 XP)
18+	20	hp: 210, Multiattack (four attacks)	**11** (7,200 XP)

GUARDIAN

At first glance, and even while trading blows with him, it is difficult to determine if the guardian is some sort of undead creature, a construct, or just a well–trained fighting man in armor. The guardian never speaks but issues a telepathic challenge to those wishing to pass by him. One must defeat the guardian in one–on–one combat in order to pass.

GUARDIAN

Medium Construct, Lawful Neutral

Armor Class: 20 (plate armor, shield)

Hit Points: 27 (5d8 + 5)

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
17 (+3)	10 (+0)	13 (+1)	10 (+0)	11 (+0)	10 (+0)

Saving Throws: Str +5, Con +3

Skills: Athletics +5, Perception +2

Senses: darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 12

Languages: all, telepathy 60 ft.

Challenge: 2 (450 XP) and see table above

Proficiency Bonus: See table above

Awareness: The guardian can't be surprised.

Chosen Opponent: At the start of each encounter, the guardian demands that his opponents select a champion to face him. If no champion is chosen, the first creature to attack or deal damage to the guardian becomes his chosen opponent. At that point, the guardian becomes immune to all damage or effects from other creatures, which pass through his form as if he were immaterial smoke. For the duration of the encounter, the same is true for the chosen opponent. (A spell cast on the chosen opponent by one of their companions, for example, has no effect.) The creature remains the guardian's chosen

opponent until the guardian or the chosen opponent dies. If the guardian is victorious, it magically regains hit points equal to half the damage it has taken and makes the challenge again.

Dueling: When wielding a melee weapon in one hand and no other weapons, the guardian gains a +2 bonus to damage rolls with that weapon (included in his attacks).

Improved Critical: The guardian's weapon attacks score a critical hit on a roll of 19 or 20.

Reset: If all other creatures leave the guardian's presence between challenges, the guardian gains the benefits of a long rest. It is restored to its hit point maximum and regains all expended uses of its traits.

Rise to Meet the Challenge: The guardian's traits can change based on the skill level of his chosen opponent. See the Adjustments for Opponents table.

ACTIONS

Longsword: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 9 (1d8 + 5) slashing damage, or 8 (1d10 + 3) slashing damage if used with two hands.

BONUS ACTIONS

Action Surge (1/Short or Long Rest): On his turn, the guardian can take one additional action on top of his regular action and a possible bonus action.

Second Wind (1/Short or Long Rest): The guardian can use a bonus action on his turn to regain hit points equal to 1d10 + his challenge rating.

This fighter is clad from head to toe in finely crafted plate armor. He carries a shield and a longsword. His face is hidden behind his armor's visor. You hear his words in your mind, without him uttering a sound. "I am the guardian. To pass me, I must be defeated and destroyed. Choose your champion."

THE IMMORTAL KING

The king of an ancient race of intelligent lizardfolk has defeated death itself by becoming a lich. Above all else, the creature seeks to survive and would prefer not to place himself in any danger. That being said, he fights savagely if threatened and feels he can overcome his opponents.

THE IMMORTAL KING

Medium Undead, Neutral Evil

Armor Class: 17 (natural armor)

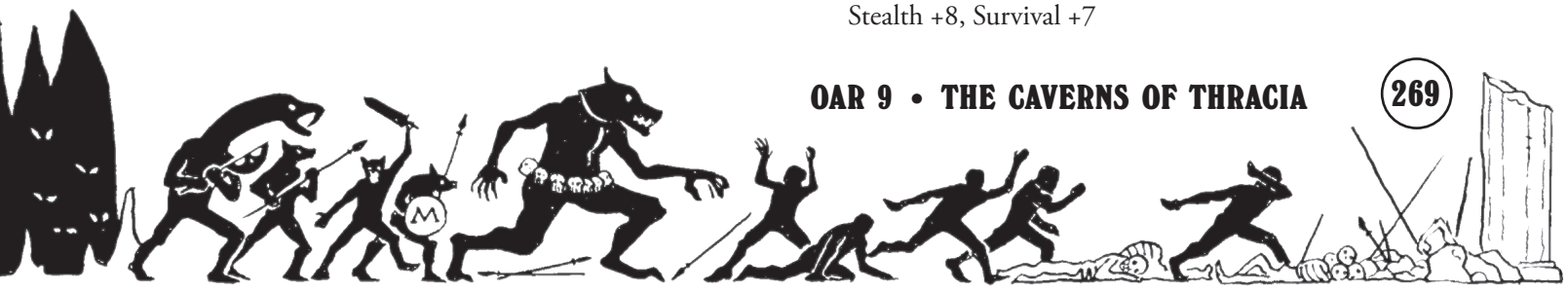
Hit Points: 120 (16d8 + 48)

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
15 (+2)	16 (+3)	16 (+3)	20 (+5)	15 (+2)	14 (+2)

Saving Throws: Con +8, Int +10, Wis +7

Skills: Arcana +15, History +10, Insight +7, Perception +7, Stealth +8, Survival +7



Damage Resistances: cold, lightning, necrotic

Damage Immunities: poison; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing that is nonmagical

Condition Immunities: charmed, exhaustion, frightened, paralyzed, poisoned

Senses: darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 17

Languages: Ancient Thracian, Modern Thracian, Draconic

Challenge: 14 (11,500 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +5

Legendary Resistance (3/Day): If The Immortal King fails a saving throw, he can choose to succeed instead.

Rejuvenation: If The Immortal King has a phylactery, he gains a new body in 1d10 days after his destruction, regaining all his hit points and becoming active again. The new body appears within 5 feet of the phylactery.

Turn Resistance: The Immortal King has advantage on saving throws against any effect that turns undead.

ACTIONS

Multiattack: The Immortal King makes one Bite attack and one Claw or Paralyzing Touch attack. It can replace one of its Claws attacks with Arcane Bolts, Frost Ray, or use of Spellcasting.

Bite: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +8 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d6 + 3) piercing damage.

Claw: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +8 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d4 + 3) slashing damage.

Paralyzing Touch: *Melee Spell Attack:* +8 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 10 (3d6) cold damage. The target must succeed on a DC 17 Constitution saving throw or be paralyzed for 1 minute. The target can repeat the saving throw at the end of each of its turns, ending the effect on itself on a success.

Arcane Bolts (3/day): The Immortal King creates four glowing bolts of arcane energy. Each hits a target he can see within 120 feet, causing 3 (1d4 +1) force damage. The bolts can target the same creature or several creatures.

Frost Ray: *Ranged Spell Attack:* +10 to hit, range 60 feet, one target. *Hit:* 13 (3d8) cold damage and the target's speed is reduced by 10 feet until the start of its next turn.

Spellcasting: The Immortal King casts one of the following spells using Intelligence as the spellcasting ability (spell save DC 18):

At will: *hold portal* (see appendix D), *mage hand*, *light*, *mending*, *prestidigitation,*

3/day each: *charm person*, *protection from evil and good*

2/day each: *detect thoughts*, *dispel magic*, *fear*, *fireball, haste*, *invisibility*, *levitate*, slow, *web*

1/day each: *circle of death, cloudkill, confusion*, *conjure elemental, delayed blast fireball, globe of invulnerability, polymorph, teleport*

LEGENDARY ACTIONS

The Immortal King can take 3 legendary actions, choosing from the options below. Only one legendary action can be used at a time and only at the end of another creature's turn. The Immortal King regains spent legendary actions at the start of his turn.

Frost Ray: The Immortal King uses Frost Ray.

The Lich's Phylactery: The Gift that Keeps on Giving

Whether or not The Immortal King has a phylactery it is not mentioned within the adventure. If, as GM, you would like to continue using him after the party defeats him the first time, feel free to have his phylactery somewhere so the characters may encounter him again. Some suggestions for using the phylactery are:

- It was discovered and carried off by one of the other cavern denizens as an interesting trinket. It now rests somewhere deeper within the caverns.
- It was hidden in the (now ruined) city, so that when the characters eventually exit the caverns, they find The Immortal King waiting for them on the surface.
- It could come up in a later adventure, once the characters believe the repercussions of this adventure have been left far behind them. Maybe it was purposely hidden somewhere far away for the lich's own protection. Perhaps it has fallen into the hands of a traveling merchant or trader, or a secret cult that reveres it as an unholy artifact.

The phylactery itself seems rather unremarkable at first: a small box woven from dried grass and thin branches on a necklace of woven vines. A single thread of silver is woven among the plant material used to form the box. The box itself contains an assortment of pretty (but worthless) water-worn pebbles, one for each soul fed to the phylactery.

Paralyzing Touch (Costs 2 Actions): The Immortal King makes a Paralyzing Touch attack.

Frightening Gaze (Costs 2 Actions): The Immortal King fixes his gaze on one creature he can see within 10 feet of him. The target must succeed on a DC 17 Wisdom saving throw against magic or become frightened for 1 minute. The frightened target can repeat the saving throw at the end of each of its turns, ending the effect on itself on a success. If the target's saving throw is successful or the effect ends for it, the target is immune to The Immortal King's gaze for the next 24 hours.

Disrupt Life (Costs 3 Actions): Each non–undead creature within 20 feet of The Immortal King must make a DC 17 Constitution saving throw against this magic, taking 21 (6d6) necrotic damage on a failed save, or half as much damage on a successful one.

This desiccated, mummified, corpse of what appears to be a cross between a lizardfolk and a gargoyle stands nearly 10 feet tall. Vestigial parchment–thin, bat–like wings spring from its scaly, withered back. Its eyes glow malevolently.

THE INCARNATION OF DEATH

The Incarnation of Death is a minor physical manifestation of Thanatos, the god of death. Normally, only creatures standing on the threshold of death can see the Incarnation.

THE INCARNATION OF DEATH

Medium Celestial, Lawful Evil

Armor Class: 16 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 30 (4d8 + 12)

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
6 (–2)	16 (+3)	16 (+3)	10 (+0)	14 (+2)	17 (+3)

Saving Throws: Wis +4, Cha +5

Damage Resistances: radiant

Damage Immunities: bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing that is nonmagical

Condition Immunities: charmed, exhaustion, frightened, paralyzed, poisoned, unconscious

Senses: passive Perception 12

Languages: all, telepathy 120 ft.

Challenge: 3 (700 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +3

Invisibility: The Incarnation is naturally invisible. Creatures with 3 hit points or fewer, or creatures that can see invisible creatures, can see the Incarnation normally.

Magic Resistance: The Incarnation has advantage on saving throws against spells and other magical effects.

Soul Snatcher: A creature that willingly embraces the Incarnation immediately dies (no saving throw allowed). Constructs and undead are not affected by this trait. If a living creature dies within 30 feet of the Incarnation, the Incarnation snatches the creature's soul. Until the Incarnation dies, a creature whose soul has been snatched can't be restored to life by any means short of a *wish* spell or similar powerful magic.

Weaken Morale: Creatures that can see the Incarnation suffer a –2 penalty to saving throws

ACTIONS

Life Drain: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 16 (3d8 + 3) necrotic damage. The target must succeed on a DC 13 Constitution saving throw or its hit point maximum is reduced by an amount equal to the damage taken. This reduction lasts until the target finishes a long rest. The target dies if this effect reduces its hit point maximum to 0.

A tall, gaunt man in flowing black robes appears before you. He has a darkly beautiful face but appears morbidly sad. He gestures to members of your party, seeming offering you the opportunity to step forward into his embrace.

MACREUS, CLERIC OF THANATOS

Macreus was a priest of Thanatos placed into suspended animation by his followers 150 years after the downfall of King Agamemnos (see A Short History), at a time when the worship of death had waned. Macreus's followers intended to revive him when the worship of death once again became popular. Unfortunately, Macreus was forgotten about and left in magical stasis for 950 years.

MACREUS, CLERIC OF THANATOS

Medium Humanoid (Human), Lawful Evil

Armor Class: 16 (chain mail)

Hit Points: 27 (5d8 + 5)

Speed: 20 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	10 (+0)	12 (+1)	13 (+1)	16 (+3)	13 (+1)

Saving Throws: Wis +5, Cha +3

Skills: Medicine +5, Persuasion +3, Religion +3

Senses: passive Perception 13

Languages: Ancient Thracian, Modern Thracian

Challenge: 2 (450 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +2

Special Equipment: Macreus has a single use of *dust of confusion* (see appendix D) in his belt pouch.

Divine Eminence: As a bonus action, Macreus can expend a spell slot to cause his melee weapon attacks to magically deal an extra 10 (3d6) necrotic damage to a target on a hit. This benefit lasts until the end of his turn. If Macreus expends a spell slot of 2nd or higher, the extra damage increases by 3 (1d6) for each level above 1st.

ACTIONS

Mace: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +2 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 3 (1d6) bludgeoning damage.

Control Undead (1/Short or Long Rest): Macreus attempts to take control of undead creatures within 30 feet of him. Each undead that can hear or see Macreus in that range must make a DC 13 Wisdom saving throw. Undead creatures with 5 Hit Dice or more have advantage on this saving throw. On a failed save, the target is under Macreus's control for 24 hours or until Macreus or one of his companions does anything harmful to it. On each of Macreus's turns, he can use a bonus action to mentally command any undead under his control within 60 feet of him. If Macreus controls multiple creatures, he can command any or all of them at the same time, issuing the same command to each one. While under his control, the undead obey Macreus's commands and, if given an order, continue to follow it until the task is complete. Macreus can control up to a maximum of 12 Hit Dice worth of undead creatures at any one time.

Ray of Sickness: *Ranged Spell Attack:* +5 to hit, range 60 feet, one target. *Hit:* 9 (2d8) poison damage and the target must make a DC 13 Constitution saving throw. On a failed save, the target is poisoned until the end of its next turn.

Sacred Flame: A flame–like radiance descends on a target that can be seen within 60 feet. The target must make a successful DC 13 Dexterity saving throw or take 9 (2d8) radiant damage. The target gains no benefit from cover on this saving throw.

Spellcasting: Macreus casts one of the following spells, using Wisdom as the spellcasting ability (spell save DC 13):

At will: *dark* (see appendix D), *thaumaturgy*

2/day each: *false life*, *protection from evil and good*, *sanctuary*

1/day each: *animate dead, blindness/deafness*, *dispel magic, hold person*, *silence*, *speak with dead, spiritual weapon*

This seemingly middle–aged male human has a mane of unkempt black hair and a substantial beard, with tufts of gray apparent in both. His chain mail armor is covered by loose, priestly robes. He carries a simple mace for protection.

STONE KING

The Stone King is one of many animated statues used as guards throughout the upper floors of the caverns. The Stone King's focus is the protection of the gemstone collection used as the eyes of the various statues in the Hall of Ancient Statuary (area 2–18) on Level 2.

STONE KING

Large Construct, Neutral

Armor Class: 18 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 93 (11d10 + 33)

Speed: 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	13 (+1)	16 (+3)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)

Skills: Perception +6, Stealth +4

Damage Resistances: slashing

Damage Immunities: fire; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical weapons that aren't adamantine

Condition Immunities: blinded, charmed, deafened, frightened, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned, prone, stunned

Senses: blindsight 120 ft. (blind beyond this radius), passive Perception 16

Languages: understands the languages of its creator but can't speak

Challenge: 7 (2,900 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +3

Special Equipment: The Stone King has three large, violet alexandrite gems (worth 500 gp each) mounted in its crown.

False Appearance: While the Stone King remains motionless, it is indistinguishable from a normal statue.

The Stone King's Lair Actions

While it is in area 2-18 or area 2-19, the Stone King can take lair actions. On initiative count 20 (losing initiative ties), the Stone King causes one of the following effects; the Stone King can't use the same effect two rounds in a row:

- The Stone King causes the trap door in front of the stairs in area 2-19 to drop away, revealing a 10-foot-square, 20-foot-deep pit. A creature standing in that area when the trap door opens can make a DC 15 Dexterity saving throw. On a successful save, the creature can use its reaction to jump to an unoccupied space within 5 feet of it. A creature that fails to jump clear plummets into the pit, taking 7 (2d6) bludgeoning damage from the fall and landing prone. Once the Stone King has used this lair action, it can't do so again until the trap resets until 1 hour.
- The violet fire on the walls of area 2-19 flares with unholy light. Each creature within 10 feet of a wall must make a DC 15 Wisdom saving throw or be blinded until the end of its next turn.
- The Stone King focuses its magic on a gemstone pried from one of the statues in area 2-18. If the gemstone is within 60 feet of the Stone King, the gem bursts into violet flame and reappears, entirely unharmed, in its original setting. A creature holding or carrying the gem when it bursts into flame takes 21 (6d6) fire damage, or half as much damage on a successful DC 15 Dexterity saving throw.

Fire Absorption: Whenever the Stone King is subjected to fire damage, it takes no damage and regains a number of hit points equal to the fire damage dealt.

Gemstone Sense: The Stone King can magically sense the presence of any gemstone stolen from the Hall of Ancient Statuary (area 2–18), provided they are on the same plane of existence. It knows the general direction of the gemstones but not their exact locations.

Magic Resistance: The Stone King has advantage on saving throws against spells and other magical effects.

Unusual Nature. The Stone King doesn't require air, drink, food or sleep.

ACTIONS

Multiattack: The Stone King makes two Slam attacks. In place of one Slam attack, it can use Fire Blast if available.

Slam: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 11 (2d6 + 4) bludgeoning damage.

Fire Blast (Recharge 4–6): The Stone King spews forth a blast of fire from its eyes and mouth in a 20–foot cone. Each creature in the area must make a DC 15 Dexterity saving throw, taking 10 (3d6) fire damage on a failed save, or half as much damage on a successful one.

Carved from a single piece of jet or onyx, this 8–foot–tall statue depicts a human man with a regal bearing. Orange flames flicker from the statue's eyes and mouth, and the black crown upon its head is set with three large, violet gems.

STRONGHOEN, THE MINOTAUR KING

Stronghoen, the minotaur king of the beastfolk, is the descendant of a long line of uncharacteristically intelligent offspring. It is believed Stonghoen's ancestors underwent some sort of magical alteration that granted them an unusual aptitude for spellcasting.

STRONGHOEN, THE MINOTAUR KING

Large Monstrosity, Neutral Evil

Armor Class: 14 (natural armor)

Hit Points: 127 (15d10 + 45)

Speed: 40 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	11 (+0)	16 (+3)	13 (+1)	16 (+3)	12 (+1)

Skills: Arcana +4, Insight +6, Perception +9

Senses: darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 19

Languages: Abyssal, Draconic, Gnoll, Tribal Thracian

Challenge: 5 (1,800 XP) **Proficiency Bonus:** +3

Charge: If Stronghoen moves at least 10 feet straight toward a target and then hits with a Gore attack on the same turn, the target takes an extra 9 (2d8) piercing damage. If the target is a creature, it must succeed on a DC 14 Strength saving throw or be pushed up to 10 feet away and knocked prone.

Labyrinthine Recall: Stronghoen can perfectly recall any path he has traveled. He has traveled Level 3 and Level 4 of the caverns quite extensively.

Reckless: At the start of his turn, Stronghoen can gain advantage on all melee weapon attack rolls he makes during that turn, but attack rolls against him have advantage until the start of his next turn.

ACTIONS

Battleaxe: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 13 (2d8 + 4) slashing damage, or 15 (2d10 + 4) slashing damage if used with two hands.

Gore: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 13 (2d8 + 4) piercing damage.

Hypnotic Gaze: Stronghoen focuses his gaze on one creature he can see within 5 feet of him. If the target can see Stronghoen, it must succeed on a DC 12 Wisdom saving throw or be charmed until the end of Stronghoen's next turn. While charmed, the target is incapacitated, and its speed drops to 0. On subsequent turns, Stronghoen can use his action to extend the duration until the end of his next turn. The effect ends if Stronghoen is ever more than 5 feet away from the target, if the target can't see Stronghoen, or if the target takes damage. If a creature's saving throw is successful or the effect ends for it, the creature is immune to Hypnotic Gaze for the next 24 hours.

Spellcasting: Stronghoen casts one of the following spells using Intelligence as its spellcasting ability (spell save DC 12):

At will: *dark* (see appendix D), *friends*, *message*, *shield, true strike*

2/day each: *arcane lock, charm person*, *invisibility, sleep*

1/day each: *fireball*, *haste*

REACTIONS

Instinctive Charm: When a creature Stronghoen can see within 30 feet makes an attack roll against him, Stronghoen uses his reaction to redirect the attack, provided that another creature is within the attack's range. The attacker must make a DC 12 Wisdom saving throw. Creatures that can't be charmed are immune to this effect. On a failed save, the triggering creature must target the creature that is closest to them, not including Stronghoen. If multiple creatures are closest, the attacker chooses which one to target. On a successful save, the attacker becomes immune to Stronghoen's Instinctive Charm for 24 hours.

LEGENDARY ACTIONS

Stronghoen can take 3 legendary actions, choosing from the options below. Only one legendary action option can be used at a time and only at the end of another creature's turn. Stronghoen regains spent legendary actions at the start of its turn.

Detect: Stronghoen makes a Wisdom (Perception) check.

Rampage (Costs 2 Actions): Stronghoen moves up to half his speed without provoking opportunity attacks. He then makes a Gore attack.

Spell (Costs 2 Actions): Stronghoen casts a spell.

This regal minotaur wields an enormous battleaxe, and a surprising spark of awareness glimmers in his eyes. Your intuition tells you this is more than just an unintelligent monster.

Stronghoen's Alternate Attacks

In the original *Caverns of Thracia*, rather than the Gore attack currently ascribed to minotaurs, Stronghoen had bite and butt attacks. If you are interested in restoring these options (or want to replace Stronghoen's Gore attack with them), you can give Stronghoen the following additional (or alternative) actions:

Bite: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 7 (1d6 + 4) piercing damage.

Butt: *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 11 (2d6 + 4) bludgeoning damage.

If you decide to replace Stronghoen's Gore attack with these actions, replace the word "gore" with "butt" in his Charge trait.

APPENDIX D

NEW DOMAINS, EQUIPMENT, SPELLS, AND MAGIC ITEMS

NEW DOMAIN

MORTALITY DOMAIN

Gods of death, dying, necrosis, and decay such as Anubis, Hades, Set, Thanatos, and his alter-ego The Dark One promote death as the natural end of all things and therefore the pinnacle of mortal achievement. Some followers of this domain live peaceful existences with simply no fear of their eventual death, seeing it only as another aspect of nature. Others, however, see adherence to this domain as a lifelong calling to deliver as many souls as possible to their final destination. Most deities and adherents of this domain have some aspect of neutrality or evil to their alignments, but this is not a requirement.

MORTALITY DOMAIN SPELLS

Cleric Level	Spells
1st	*false life, inflict wounds*
3rd	*blindness/deafness, ray of enfeeblement*
5th	*animate dead, speak with dead*
7th	*blight, death ward*
9th	*antilife shell, contagion*

BONUS PROFICIENCIES

At 1st level, you gain proficiency with martial weapons and heavy armor.

ENERVATING COMMAND

At 1st level, you gain the *chill touch* cantrip, if you don't already know it.

CHANNEL DIVINITY: CONTROL UNDEAD

As an action, you present your holy symbol and speak a prayer over undead creatures within 30 feet of you. Each undead in that area that can hear or see you must make a Wisdom saving throw. Undead creatures of 5 Hit Dice or more have advantage on the save. A creature that fails is under your control for 24 hours or until you or one of your companions does anything harmful to it. On each of your turns, you can use a bonus action to mentally command any undead under your control if they are within 60 feet of you. If you control multiple creatures, you can command any or all of them at the same time, issuing the same command to each one. While under your control, the undead obey your commands and, if given an order, continue to follow it until the task is complete. You can control a maximum of 12 HD worth of undead creatures at a time.

RENEWAL THROUGH DEATH

Starting at 6th level, when you are subjected to necrotic damage, you can use your reaction to take no damage and instead regain a number of hit points equal to half the necrotic damage dealt (rounded down).

DIVINE STRIKE

At 8th level, you gain the ability to infuse your weapon strikes with divine energy. Once on each of your turns when you hit a creature with a weapon attack, you can cause the attack to deal an extra 1d8 necrotic, poison, or psychic damage (your choice) to the target. When you reach 14th level, the extra damage increases to 2d8.

WITHER THE SOUL

At 17th level, when you would normally roll one or more dice to cause necrotic damage with a spell, you use the highest number possible for each die. For example, instead of inflicting 2d6 hit points of necrotic damage to a creature, you inflict 12. This ability does not function against constructs or undead. You also gain *finger of death* as an additional domain spell.

NEW EQUIPMENT

REPEATING BALLISTA

Large object

Armor Class: 15

Hit Points: 50

Damage Immunities: poison, psychic

A repeating ballista is a siege weapon that fires bolts at an incredible rate. While disassembled, the repeating ballista's component parts weigh 100 pounds. Once assembled, the ballista becomes a Large object and is too heavy to be moved by normal means.

Assembling or disassembling the repeating ballista takes 10 minutes of work. The first time a creature attempts to assemble or disassemble the ballista, that creature must make a DC 17 Intelligence check. On a failed check, the creature doesn't assemble or disassemble the ballista but can attempt the check again with another 10 minutes of work. Once a creature has successfully assembled or disassembled the ballista, the creature understands how the weapon works and doesn't need to make the check again.

The repeating ballista can be loaded with up to 36 bolts. It takes one action to load the ballista. While the ballista is both assembled and loaded, a creature within 5 feet of the ballista can use an action to make the following attack up to six times. The ballista can be fired at one target or several. Once a creature fires the ballista, the ballista can't be fired again until the start of that creature's next turn.

Bolt: *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, range 80/320 ft., one target. *Hit:* 4 (1d8) piercing damage.

MASTERWORK WEAPONS

A masterwork weapon is a finely crafted version of a normal weapon. A masterwork weapon grants its wielder a +1 bonus to attack rolls made with the weapon. The masterwork quality can't be added to a weapon after it is created; it must be crafted as such. The cost for a masterwork weapon or ten pieces of masterwork ammunition is 600 gp plus the normal cost of the weapon.

Masterwork ammunition is destroyed when used and cannot be recovered. The +1 bonus to attack rolls doesn't stack with any magical or masterwork bonuses of the ranged weapon used to fire it.

Magic weapons are considered to be of masterwork quality. The +1 bonus to attack rolls doesn't stack with any bonus granted by the weapon's magic.

SKYROCKETS

A skyrocket is a heavy parchment tube mounted on a short, thin stick. A wick-like fuse extends from one end of the tube. As an action, you can light the fuse, shooting the skyrocket up to 500 feet away, whereupon it explodes in a flash of bright, sparkling colors and a boom that can be heard up to 1 mile away. If you fire the skyrocket at a creature or object, make a ranged attack against the target, treating the skyrocket as an improvised weapon. On a hit, the target takes 1d6 fire damage and must make a DC 13 Dexterity saving throw. On a failed save, the target is blinded until the end of its next turn.

A typical skyrocket costs 2 gp. Rumors persist of skyrocket varieties that have enhanced effects, but of course, these cost more.

NEW SPELLS

There are several new spells introduced in *The Caverns of Thracia*. The following table summarizes what classes have access to each of the new spells, and full descriptions are presented following the table.

SPELL	CLASSES WITH ACCESS
Dark	bard, cleric, sorcerer, wizard
Hold Portal	cleric, sorcerer, wizard
Hypnotism	bard, sorcerer, warlock, wizard
Invisibility, 10-Foot Radius	bard, sorcerer, warlock, wizard
Limited Wish	sorcerer, wizard
Protection from Normal Missiles	sorcerer, Wizard
Pyrotechnics	bard, druid, sorcerer, warlock, wizard
Sticks to Snakes	cleric, druid
Stone to Flesh	sorcerer, warlock, wizard
Transmute Rock	druid, sorcerer, w izard

DARK

Evocation cantrip

Casting Time: 1 action

Range: Touch

Components: V, M (a pinch of ash or charcoal)

Duration: 1 hour

You touch one object that is no larger than 10 feet in any dimension. If you target an object worn or carried by an unwilling creature, that creature can make a Dexterity saving throw to avoid the effect. Until the spell ends, the object is engulfed in complete darkness in a 20-foot radius. Creatures with darkvision can see through the area of darkness normally. Completely covering the object with something opaque blocks the darkness. The spell ends if you cast it again or dismiss it as an action. If the *light* cantrip is cast on the object, the effects counteract each other and both spells end.

HOLD PORTAL

1st-level transmutation

Casting Time: 1 action

Range: 120 feet

Components: V, S, M (a few splinters of wood, flecks of stone, or filings of metal)

Duration: 1 minute

You magically bar one nonmagical door or gate up to 10 feet in height within range. The spell holds the portal fast as if it were locked or barred. The portal's lock can't be picked with thieves' tools, but a *dispel magic* or *knock* spell cast on the portal ends the spell. A creature can also break down the portal with a successful DC 22 Strength check.

At Higher Levels: When you cast this spell using a spell slot of 2nd level or higher, the duration of the spell increases by 1 minute for each slot level above 1st.

HYPNOTISM

1st-level enchantment

Casting Time: 1 action

Range: 30 feet

Components: V, S

Duration: Concentration, up to 1 minute

Your gestures and droning incantations incapacitate nearby creatures, causing them to stop and stare blankly at you. Roll 5d8; the total is how many hit points of creatures this spell can affect. Creatures within 20 feet of a point you choose within range are affected in ascending order of their current hit points (ignoring unconscious creatures).

Starting with the creature that has the lowest current hit points, each creature must make a Wisdom saving throw. If you and your companions are fighting the creature, the creature has advantage on the saving throw. Creatures that can't be charmed automatically succeed on the save. On a failed save, the creature is incapacitated until the spell ends or until you or your companions do anything harmful to it.

While a creature is incapacitated by the spell, you can use an action to make a single request of the creature, provided it can hear and understand you. The request must be limited to a sentence or two and must be worded in such a manner to make the course of action sound reasonable. The creature pursues the course of action to the best of its ability. The action can continue for the entire duration. If the action can be completed in a short time, the spell ends when the target finishes what it was asked to do.

At Higher Levels: When you cast this spell using a spell slot of 2nd level or higher, roll an additional 2d8 for each slot level above 1st.

INVISIBILITY, 10-FOOT RADIUS

3rd-level illusion

Casting Time: 1 action

Range: 60 feet

Components: V, S, M (an eyelash encased in a piece of amber)

Duration: Concentration, up to 1 hour

Choose one creature within range. That creature and all other creatures within 10 feet of it when you cast this spell become invisible. Anything the targets are wearing or carrying is invisible as long as it is on the target's person. The spell ends for all targets if the original target attacks or casts a spell. If a target moves beyond 10 feet of the original target, or if it attacks or casts a spell, the spell ends for that target.

LIMITED WISH

7th-level conjuration

Casting Time: 1 action

Range: Self

Components: V, M (the fused clavicle bones of a bird)

Duration: Instantaneous

This spell is similar to the *wish* spell except that it is limited in the effects it can produce. The spell can be used to duplicate any other spell of 6th level or lower. You don't need to meet any requirements in that spell, including costly components. The spell simply takes effect.

Alternately, you can create one of the following effects of your choice:

- You allow up to ten creatures that you can see to regain hit points equal to half their hit point maximum, and you end any effects on them described in the *greater restoration* spell.
- You grant up to five creatures that you can see resistance to a damage type you choose for 4 hours.
- You grant up to five creatures that you can see immunity to a single spell or other magical effect for 4 hours. For instance, you could make yourself and your companions immune to a lich's Life Drain attack.

- You can redo a single recent event by forcing a reroll of any roll made since the end of your last turn. Reality reshapes itself to accommodate the new result. For example, a *limited wish* spell could allow a reroll of an opponent's successful save, a foe's critical hit, or a friend's failed save. Unlike the *wish* spell, you don't have the ability to grant advantage or disadvantage on the reroll if it was not already applied to the original roll. You can choose whether to use the reroll or the original roll.

As with *wish*, the GM has great latitude in ruling on the outcome of the *limited wish*. The greater the wish, the greater the likelihood that something goes wrong. The spell might simply fail, or the effect you desire might only be partly achieved, or you might suffer some unforeseen consequence.

The stress of casting the spell to produce any effect other than duplicating another spell weakens you. After enduring that stress, each time you cast a spell until you finish a long rest, you take 1d8 necrotic damage per level of that spell. This damage can't be reduced or prevented in any way. In addition, your Strength drops to 3, if it isn't 3 or lower already, for 2d4 days. For each of those days that you spend resting and doing nothing more than light activity, your remaining recovery time decreases by 2 days.

PROTECTION FROM NORMAL MISSILES

3rd-level abjuration

Casting Time: 1 action

Range: 30 feet

Components: V, S, M (a pebble, sling bullet, ball bearing, or tiny moistened wad of paper tossed at the subject of the spell)

Duration: Concentration, up to 1 hour

One creature you choose within range gains immunity to bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing damage caused by small, nonmagical projectiles (such as arrows, bolts, darts, or sling bullets) for the duration. This spell offers no protection against magical ranged attacks (including nonmagical ammunition fired by a magical weapon) or larger projectiles such as a boulder hurled by a giant, a ballista bolt, a catapult stone, or other siege weapons.

PYROTECHNICS

2nd-level transmutation

Casting Time: 1 action

Range: 60 feet

Components: V, S, M (a source of nonmagical fire)

Duration: Instantaneous

You target a nonmagical flame that you can see within range, no larger than a 5-foot cube. You extinguish the fire in that area, and you create either fireworks or a smoke effect when you do so.

Fireworks. The targeted fire explodes with a dazzling array of flashing and fiery aerial fireworks. Each creature that can see within 30 feet of the target fire must succeed on a Constitution saving throw or become blinded until the end of your next turn.

Smoke. Thick black smoke spreads out from the target area in a 10-foot radius, spreading around corners. Each round on your turn, the radius of the smoke increases by 10 feet. The area of the smoke is heavily obscured. The smoke persists for 1 minute or until dispersed by a wind of moderate or greater speed (at least 10 miles per hour).

STICKS TO SNAKES

3rd-level transmutation

Casting Time: 1 action

Range: 120 feet

Components: V, S, M (one stick, such as an unlit torch, for each snake created)

Duration: Concentration, up to 10 minutes

You transform up to eight nonmagical sticks (at least 1 foot long with a diameter of at least 1/2 inch) into **poisonous snakes** (with maximum hit points). For each stick you transform, roll a d20. On a 10 or higher, that stick transforms into a **constrictor snake** (also with maximum hit points) instead. A snake transforms back into a mundane stick when it drops to 0 hit points or when the spell ends.

The snakes are friendly to you and your companions. Roll initiative for the snakes as a group, which have their own turns. They obey any verbal commands that you issue them (no action required by you). If you don't issue any commands to them, they defend themselves from hostile creatures, but otherwise take no actions.

At Higher Levels: When you cast this spell using a spell slot higher of 4th level or higher, you create two additional snakes for each slot above 3rd level.

STONE TO FLESH

6th-level transmutation

Casting Time: 1 action

Range: 60 feet

Components: V, S, M (a pinch of clay and a drop of blood or a scrap of meat)

Duration: Instantaneous

You magically return one petrified creature within range to its original form, ending the petrified condition on that creature. Alternatively, you transform a 5-foot cube of stone into soft, nonmagical flesh and muscle. The cube of flesh has AC 13, 18 hit points, and immunity to poison and psychic damage.

TRANSMUTE ROCK

5th-level transmutation

Casting Time: 1 minute

Range: 120 feet

Components: V, S, M (a bit of clay and water)

Duration: Until dispelled

You select an area of stone or mud that you can see within a 40-foot cube within range and choose one of the following effects.

Transmute Rock to Mud. Nonmagical rock of any sort in the area becomes an equal amount of thick, flowing mud that remains for the spell's duration.

If you cast the spell on an area of ground, it becomes muddy enough that creatures can sink into it. Each foot that a creature moves through the mud costs 4 feet of movement, and any creature on the ground when you cast the spell must make a successful Strength saving throw. A creature must also make this save the first time it enters the area on a turn or ends its turn there. On a failed save, the creature sinks into the mud and is restrained as long as it remains in the mud or until it breaks free.

A creature restrained by the mud can use an action to make a Strength check against your spell save DC. If it succeeds, it is no longer restrained.

If you cast this spell on a ceiling, the mud falls. Each creature under the mud when it falls must make a Dexterity saving throw, taking 4d8 bludgeoning damage on a failed save, or half as much damage on a successful one.

Transmute Mud to Rock. Nonmagical mud or quicksand in the area no deeper than 10 feet transforms into soft stone for the spell's duration. Each creature in the mud when it transforms must make a Dexterity saving throw. On a successful save, a creature is shunted safely to the surface in an unoccupied space. On a failed save, a creature becomes restrained in the rock. A restrained creature or another creature within reach can use an action to make a Strength check against your spell save DC. On a success, the creature is no longer restrained. A creature can also be freed by destroying the stone restraining it. Each 5-foot cube of stone has AC 15, 25 hit points, and immunity to poison and psychic damage.

NEW MAGIC ITEMS

CURSED WEAPON, -1, -2, OR -3

Weapon (any), rare (-1), very rare (-2), or legendary (-3) (requires attunement)

You have a penalty to attack and damage rolls made with this cursed weapon. The penalty is determined by the weapon's rarity.

Curse. This weapon is cursed and becoming attuned to it extends the curse to you. As long as you remain cursed, you are unwilling to part with this weapon, keeping it within reach at all times. It becomes your preferred weapon until such time as the curse is broken by a *remove curse* spell.

DARK BLUE BLADE

Weapon (longsword), legendary (requires attunement by a chaotic creature)

This sentient longsword is a consistent gunmetal blue in color, from its blade to its hilt. Its origins have been lost over time, but legends speak of a mysterious blue metal sword borne in battle by northern barbarians for generations until it was lost long ago in battle.

You gain a +2 bonus to attack and damage rolls made with this magic weapon. When you hit a lawful creature with it, that creature takes an extra 2d6 necrotic damage.

Sentience. The *Dark Blue Blade* is a sentient chaotic evil weapon with an Intelligence of 11, a Wisdom of 14, and a Charisma of 13. It has hearing and normal vision out to a range of 30 feet.

The weapon communicates by transmitting emotions, sending a tingling sensation not unlike an electrical shock through the wielder's hand when it wants to communicate something it has sensed. It can communicate more explicitly through visions or dreams when the wielder is either asleep or in a trance.

Personality. The *Dark Blue Blade's* purpose is to escape the caverns and cause as much death and mayhem as possible in the outside world. It has been stuck in the caverns for centuries and desperately seeks a change of scenery and the opportunity to catch up on all the mischief it has missed while trapped in an urn.

DINING TABLE

Wondrous item, uncommon

This table is 3-feet square, 2-1/2-feet tall, and weighs 25 pounds. The table can magically conjure enough food to feed up to eight Medium creatures each day. The food is always different from the previous day and is always rich and tasty. The table is extremely delicate and if dropped will splinter and crack. While damaged, there is a 25 percent chance each day that the table still functions but the food it produces is foul in taste or appearance. A creature that consumes the foul food must make a DC 15 Constitution saving throw or become poisoned for 24 hours.

DUST OF CONFUSION

Wondrous item, uncommon

Found in a small pouch containing enough dust for a single use, this substance resembles a fine, multi-colored glitter. When you use an action to throw the dust in the air, you and each creature within 10 feet of you must succeed on a DC 15 Wisdom saving throw or become affected as if by the *confusion* spell for 1 minute. An affected target can repeat the saving throw at the end of each of its turns, ending the effect on itself on a success.

EYE BALL

Wondrous item, rare (requires attunement)

This glass sphere is an exact replica of a human eye. If you use the *eye ball* to replace a real eye that has been lost or removed, you gain darkvision out to a range of 60 feet. The *eye ball* cannot be removed except by the wearer.

The *eye ball* has 3 charges, and it regains all expended charges daily at dawn. You can use an action to speak the item's command word and expend 1 charge. When you do so, you can see into and through solid matter for 1 minute. This vision has a range of 30 feet. To you, solid objects within that range appear transparent and don't prevent light from passing through them. The vision can penetrate 1 foot of stone, 1 inch of common metal, or up to 3 feet of wood or dirt. Thicker substances block the vision, as does a thin sheet of lead.

EARTHSHAKER

Weapon (trident), legendary (requires attunement by an evil creature)

This trident has a gnarled driftwood shaft and a three-pronged coral head. You gain a +2 bonus to attack and damage rolls made with this magic weapon, and you score a critical hit with the weapon on a 19-20. As a bonus action, you can command the trident to shed bright light in a 40-foot radius and dim light for an additional 40 feet. You can use another bonus action to extinguish the light.

You also gain the following benefits.

Detect Gems and Gold. As an action, you can magically sense the location of gems and gold within 1,000 feet of you. If the treasure is in motion, you know the direction of its movement. The effect is blocked if any thickness of lead, even a thin sheet, blocks a direct path between you and the treasure. You can use this property three times, regaining any expended uses after 24 hours.

Hunter's Mark. You can cast *hunter's mark* at will.

Shake the Earth. You can cast *earthquake*. Once *Earthshaker* has been used to cast this spell, it can't do so again for 30 days.

Weapon Breaker. When you score a critical hit with *Earthshaker*, the trident permanently destroys one nonmagical melee weapon wielded by the target. If the target isn't wielding a melee weapon, you instead deal an extra 2d6 piercing damage.

Sentience. Earthshaker is a lawful neutral trident with an Intelligence of 14, a Wisdom of 13, and a Charisma of 12.

The weapon has hearing out to 30 feet, understands Common, and can communicate with its wielder via empathy.

Personality. *Earthshaker's* special purpose is to enforce the law and punish would-be thieves. If the weapon observes an act of thievery, it urges its wielder to cast *hunter's mark* and attack the thief without quarter.

GEM OF RESISTANCE

Wondrous item, uncommon (requires attunement)

While this diamond is on your person, you gain a +1 bonus to saving throws.

LUCK CHARM

Wondrous item, uncommon (requires attunement)

When you would make an attack roll, ability check, or saving throw, you can call upon the good fortune imbued in this small charm to gain advantage on the roll. Once used, the charm can't be used again until the next dawn.

MINIATURE WAND OF THE DEMON PRINCE ORCUS

Wand, legendary (requires attunement by an evil spellcaster)

This skull-headed obsidian wand resembles a miniature version of the wand commonly depicted as wielded by the demon Orcus. While holding this wand, you gain a +3 bonus to spell attack rolls.

The wand has 3 charges, and it regains 1d3 charges daily at dawn. You can use an action to expend 1 charge from the wand and attempt to take control of undead creatures within 30 feet of you. Each undead that can hear or see you in that range must make a DC 13 Wisdom saving throw. Undead creatures with 5 Hit Dice or more have advantage on this saving throw. On a failed save, the target is under your control for 24 hours or until you or one of your companions does anything harmful to it. On each of your turns, you can use a bonus action to mentally command any undead under your control within 60 feet of you. If you control multiple creatures, you can command any or all of them at the same time, issuing the same command to each one. While under your control, the undead obey your commands and, if given an order, continue to follow it until the task is complete. You can control up to a maximum of 12 Hit Dice worth of undead creatures at any one time.

POTION OF LEVITATION

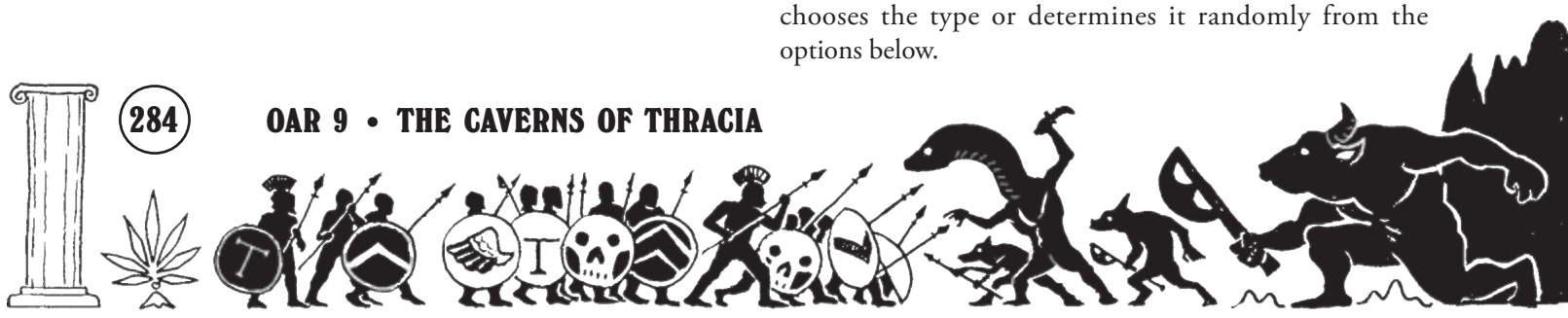
Potion, rare

When you drink this potion, you gain the effects of the *levitate* spell for 10 minutes (no concentration required). The potion's light blue fluid is carbonated and seems to be light and airy.

POTION OF MIND CONTROL

Potion, rarity varies

This potion comes in several varieties. When you drink the potion, you gain the benefit of a spell that allows you to impose your will on a specific type of creature. The GM chooses the type or determines it randomly from the options below.



POTION OF...	SPELL	SAVE DC	RARITY
Dragon Control *	dominate monster	DC 15	Very rare
Giant Control **	dominate monster	DC 15	Very rare
Human Control	dominate person	DC 14	Rare
Undead Control	animate dead ***	DC 13	Uncommon

* There are multiple types of this potion, one for every type of dragon (black, blue, green, etc.).

** There are multiple types of this potion, one for every type of giant (hill, fire, frost, stone, etc.).

*** This potion does not allow you to animate undead creatures, but does allow you to control up to four skeletons or zombies not already controlled by another creature. The effect lasts 24 hours, as per the *animate dead* spell.

POTION OF POLYMORPH

Potion, very rare

This potion changes color and consistency at a whim. It can be a light and airy purple liquid one moment and a viscid brown concoction the next. After drinking this potion, for the next minute you can use an action to magically polymorph into a beast with a challenge rating equal to or less than your level. If you choose not to transform, roll 1d100 at the end of each of your turns. On a 50 or higher, you unwillingly transform into a beast determined by the GM. In either case, the transformation lasts for 1 hour or until you use an action to return to your original form.

REUSABLE CANDLE

Wondrous item, common

Once lit, this wax candle sheds light like a normal candle, except that it creates no heat and doesn't use oxygen. The candle can be covered or hidden, but it continues burning indefinitely until a creature touching the candle chooses to extinguish it. When discovered, the candle can be lit a maximum of 1d6 + 4 times before it is entirely consumed.

RING OF CONTRARINESS

Ring, very rare (requires attunement)

Once you put on this ring and attune to it, you believe it to be a *ring of protection* and refuse to remove it.

Curse. The ring causes you to do the exact opposite of whatever is requested of you, to the best of your ability.

RING OF PROTECTION FROM TURNING

Ring, rare

An undead creature wearing this ring is immune to effects that turn undead. In addition, the undead can use a bonus action to choose a creature it can see within 60 feet of it. If that creature is concentrating on a *protection from evil and good* spell, it must make a DC 13 Constitution saving throw. On a failed save, the creature loses concentration on that spell.

If the undead creature wearing the ring drops to 0 hit points, the ring turns to dust. The ring has no effect on non-undead creatures that wear it.

THIRSTER

Weapon (longsword), legendary (requires attunement by an evil creature)

Thirster is a chaotic evil longsword once owned by a corrupt and evil king of ancient Thracia. Its blade is black with mottled, deep-red spots that look like stains or pits at first glance.

When you hit with an attack using this magic sword, the target takes an extra 2d6 necrotic damage and must make a DC 13 Constitution saving throw. Undead and constructs automatically succeed on the save. On a failed save, the target's hit point maximum is reduced by an amount equal to the necrotic damage taken. This reduction lasts until the target finishes a long rest. The target dies if this effect reduces its hit point maximum to 0.

The sword has 3 charges, and it regains 1d3 charges daily at dawn. While holding the blade, you can use an action to expend 1 or more of the sword's charges to create the following effects.

Detect Thoughts. You expend 2 charges to cast the *detect thoughts* spell (save DC 13).

Supernatural Awareness. You expend 1 charge, and the sword alerts you to the presence of any gems within 60 feet of you, any good-aligned creatures within 20 feet of you, and any secret doors or sloping passages within 10 feet of you.

Sentience. *Thirster* is a sentient chaotic evil weapon with an Intelligence of 12, a Wisdom of 10, and a Charisma of 14. It has hearing and normal vision out to a range of 60 feet.

The weapon communicates telepathically with its wielder and can speak, read, and understand Draconic and Giant.

Personality. *Thirster* has a phobia of undead creatures and passes its fear onto its owner. If you start your turn and can see an undead creature, you must succeed on a DC 14 Charisma saving throw or suffer one of the following effects (50 percent chance of either):

- You become frightened.
- You fight recklessly. You gain advantage on all melee weapon attack rolls but all attack rolls against you have advantage.

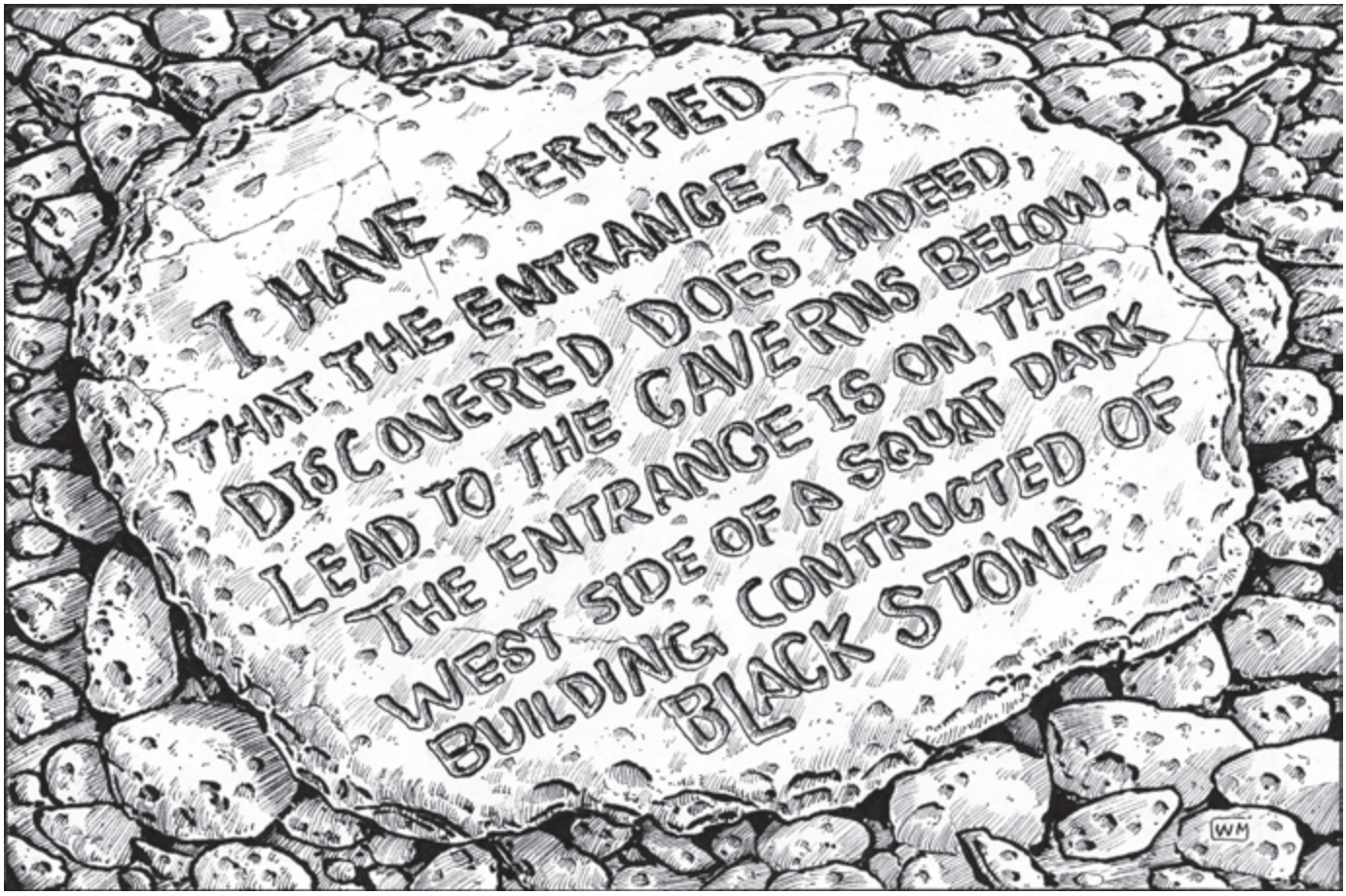
When you end your turn and no undead creature is within your line of sight, you can repeat the saving throw, ending the effect on a success.

WAND OF LIGHT

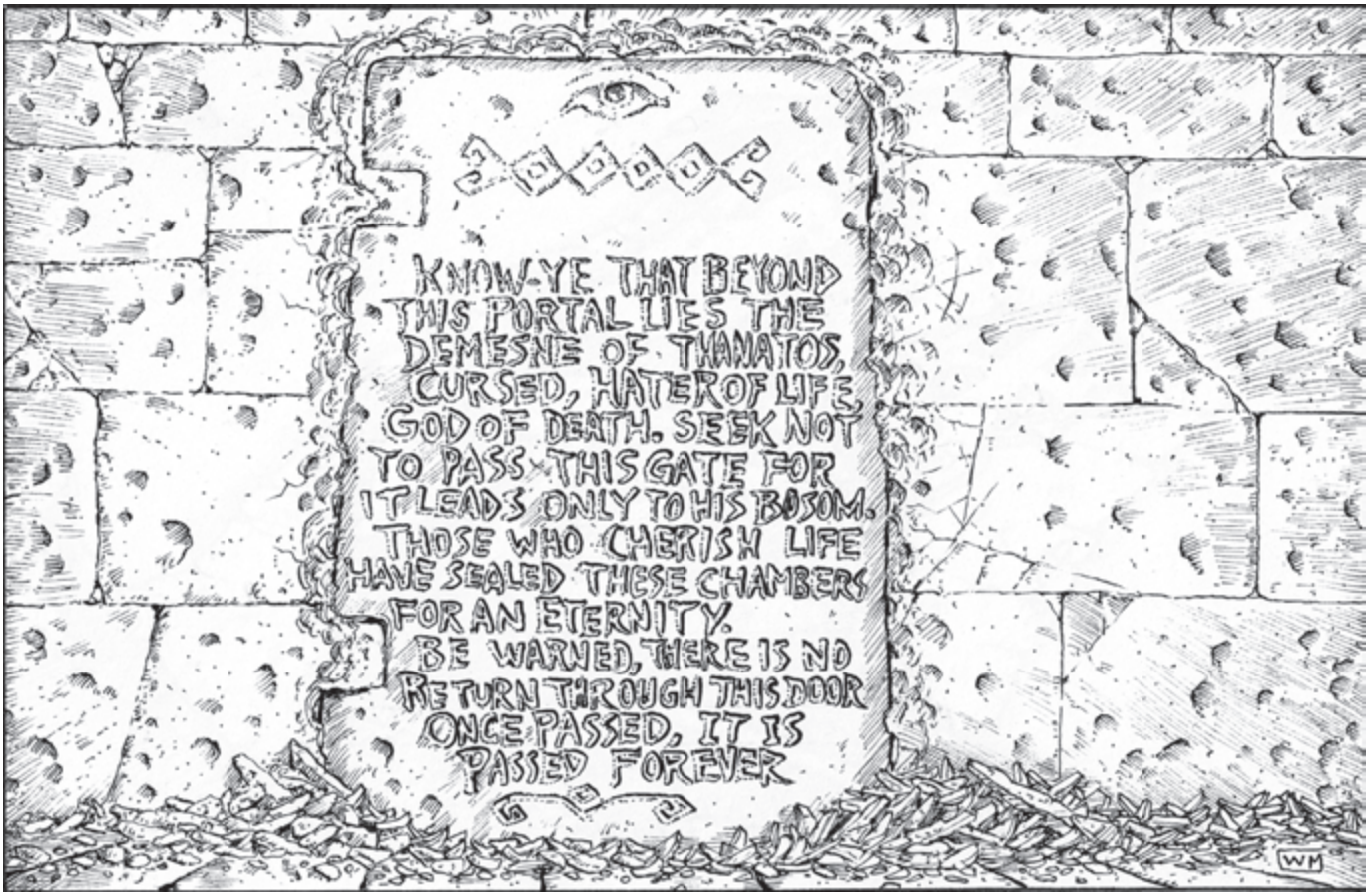
Wand, common

This wand is a simple wooden stick with a glowing rock lashed to the end with a section of vine or leather cord. The rock has been the target of a *continual flame* spell.

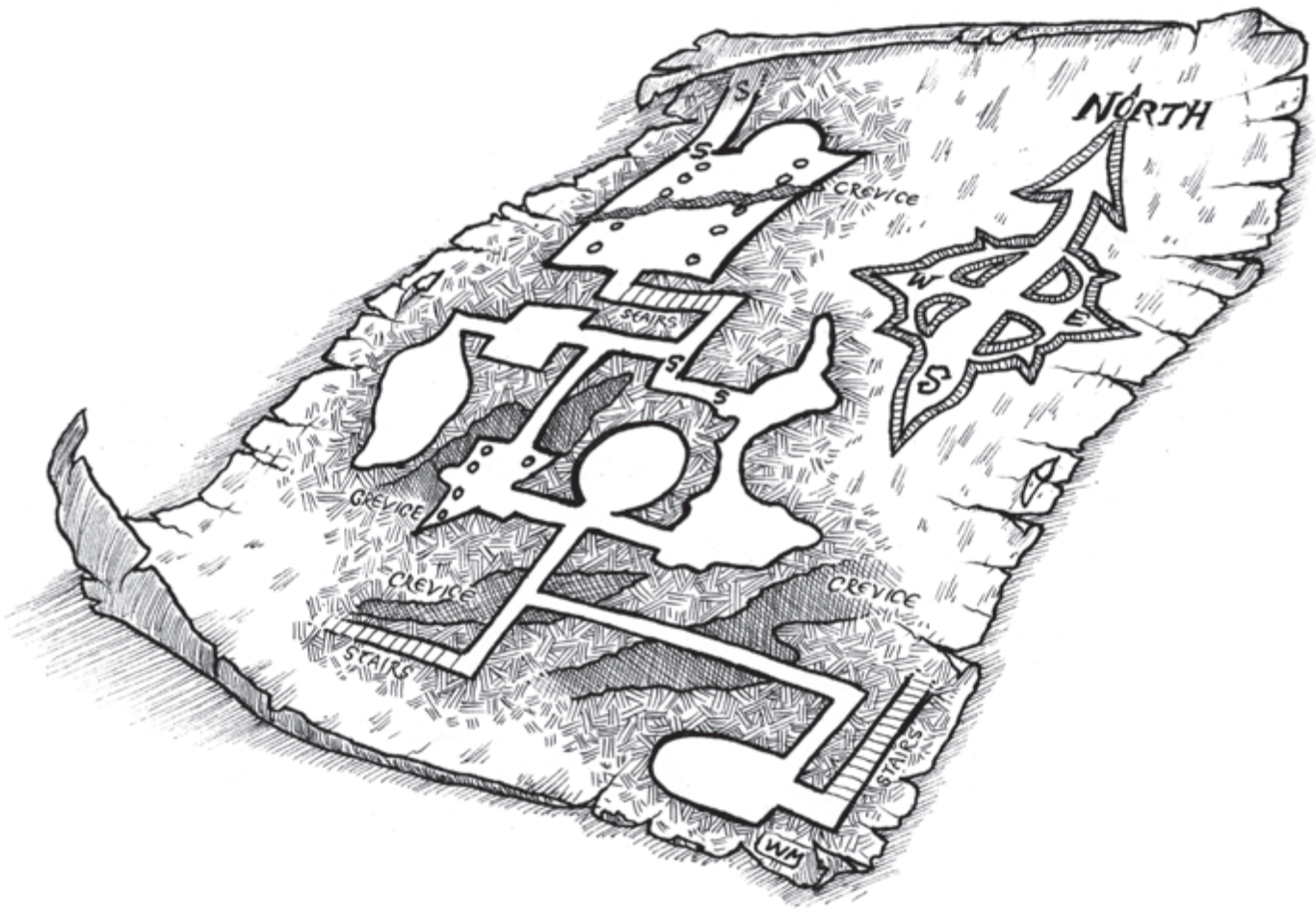
APPENDIX E
PLAYER HANDOUTS



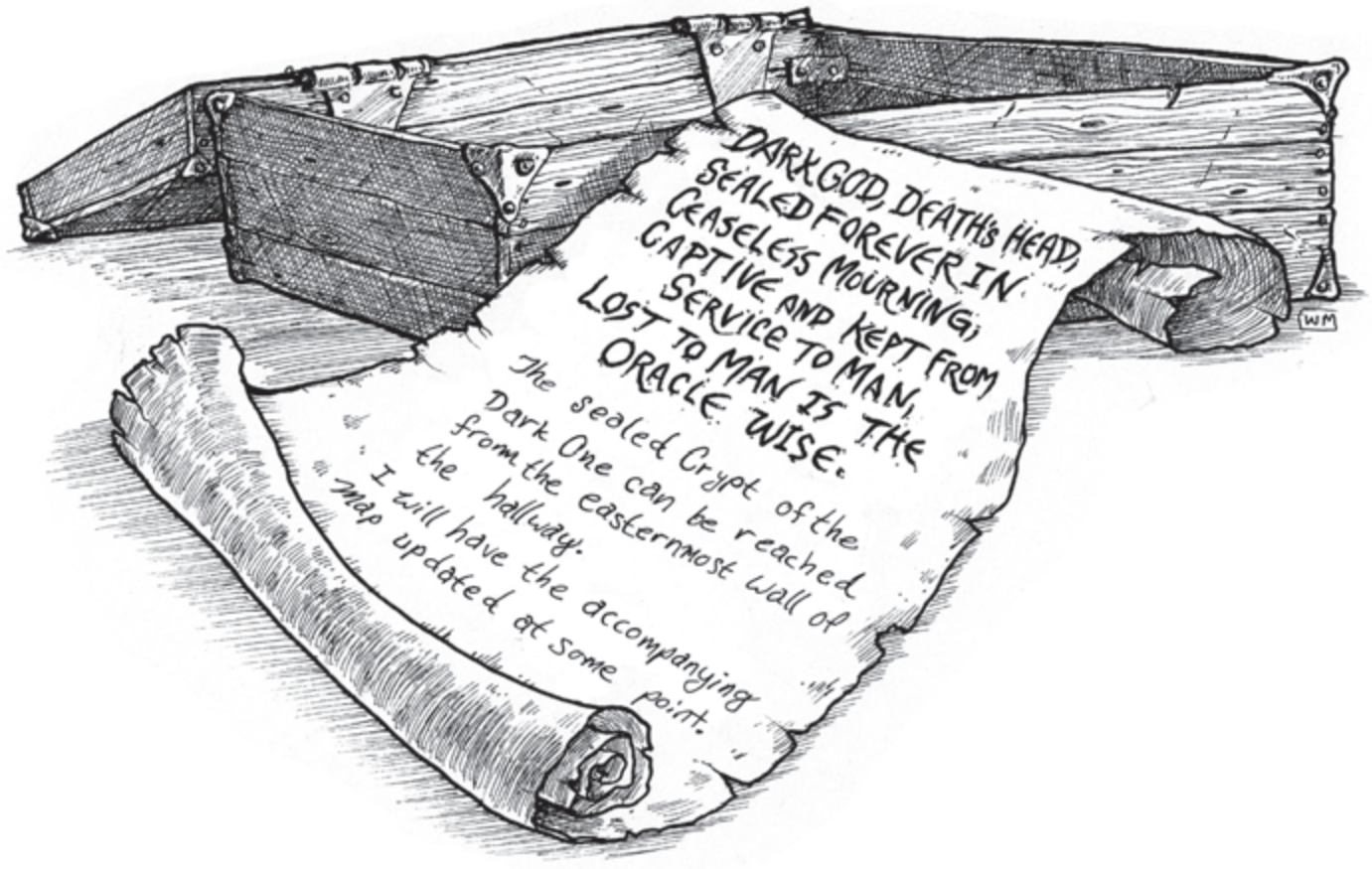
PLAYER HANDOUT #1



PLAYER HANDOUT #2

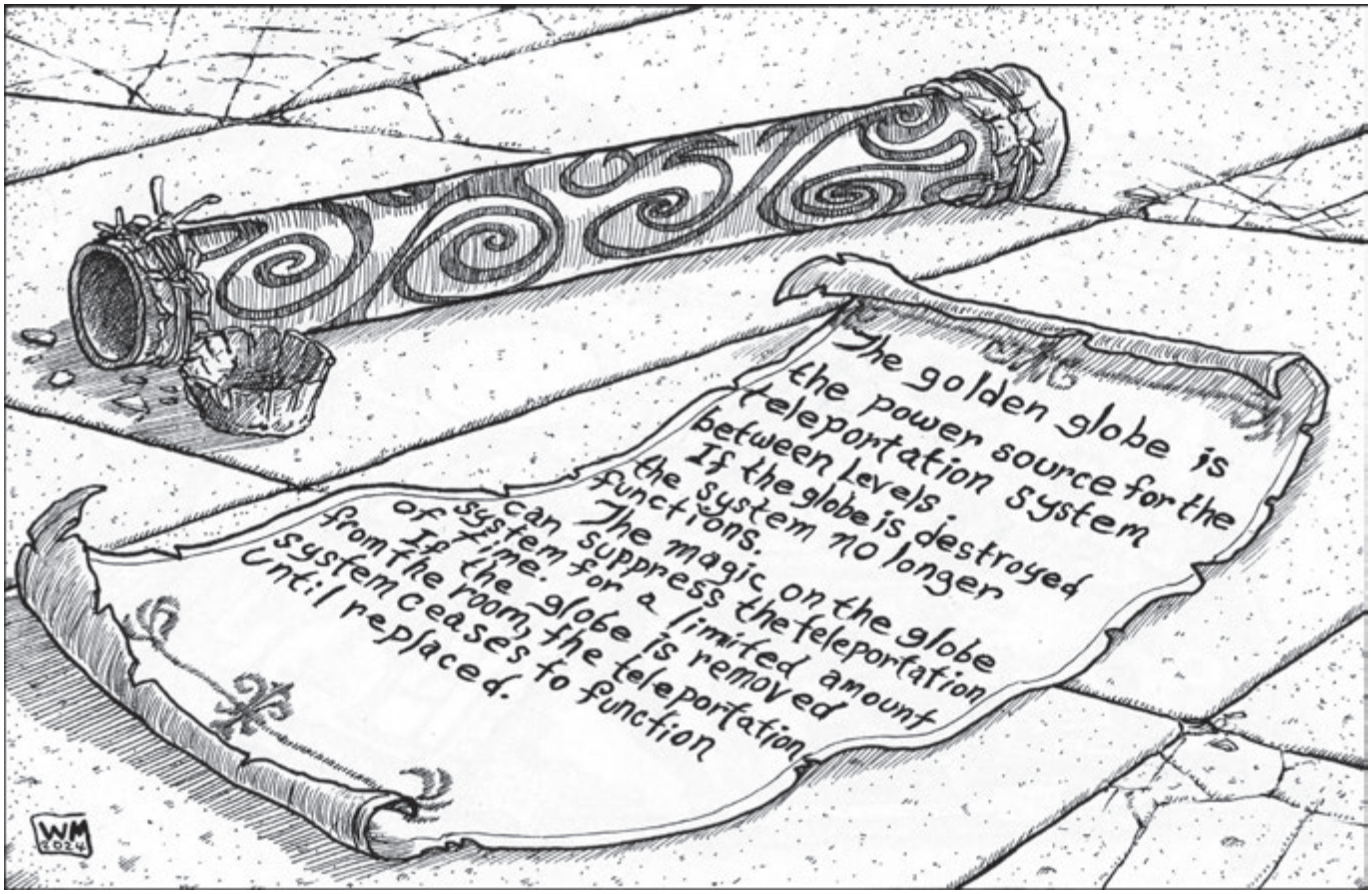


PLAYER HANDOUT #3

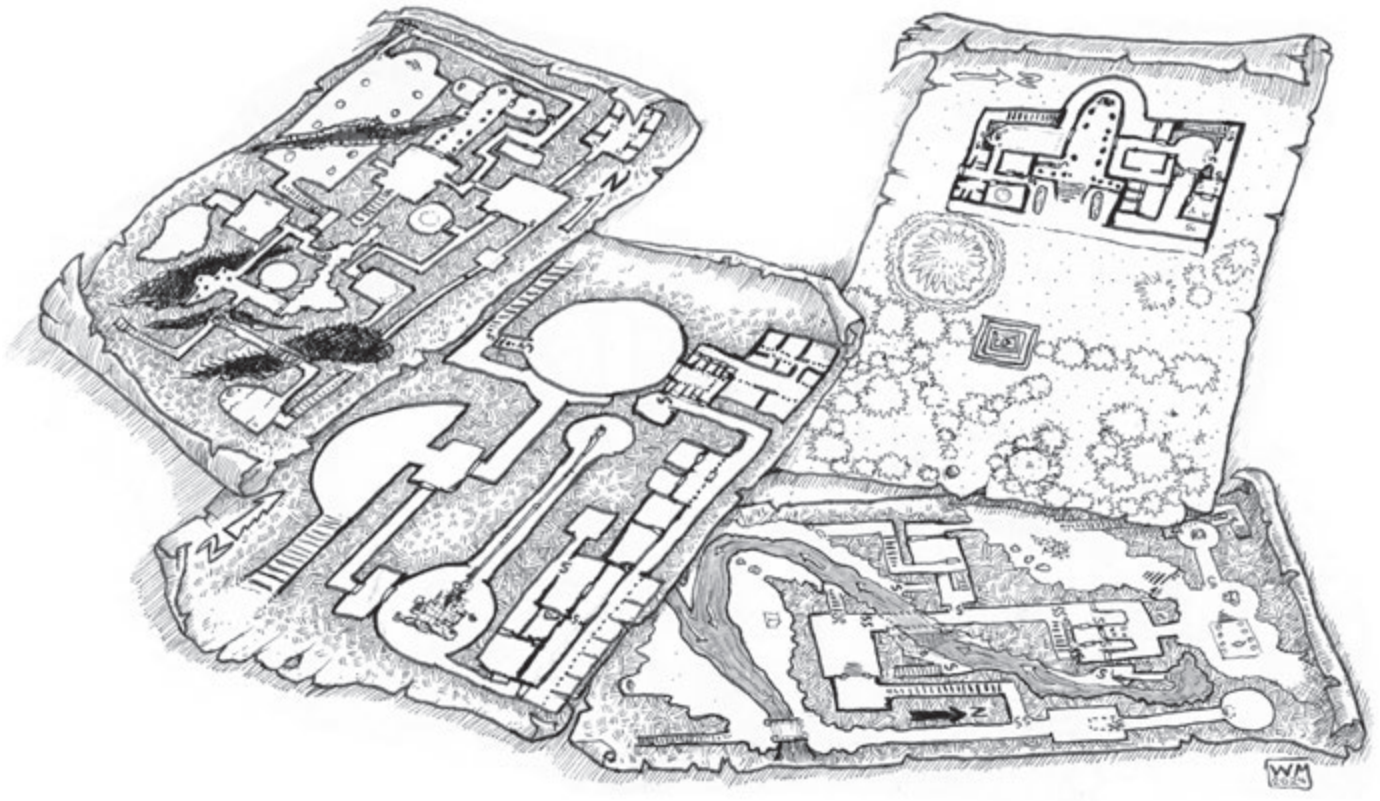


PLAYER HANDOUT #4

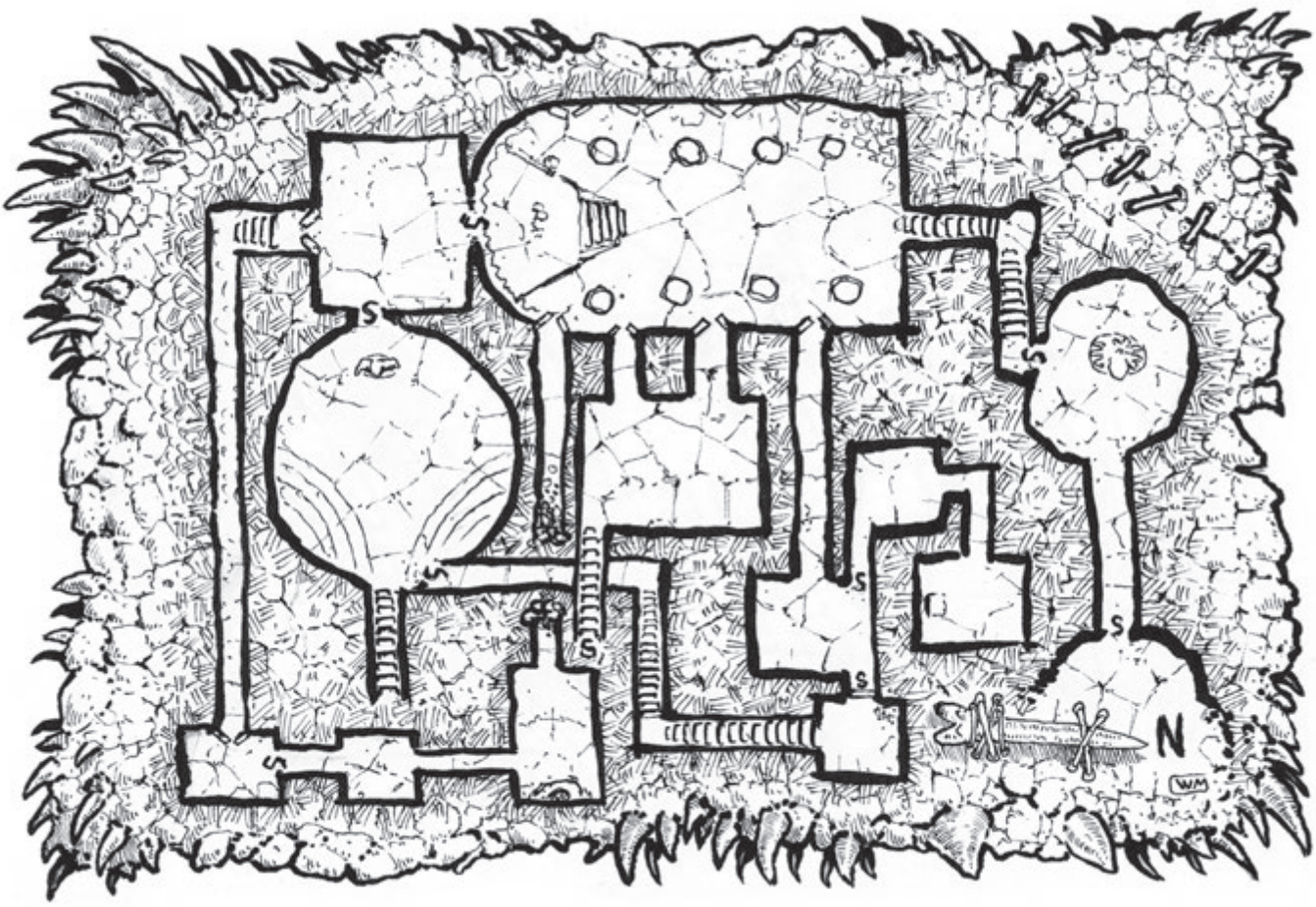
PLAYER HANDOUT #5



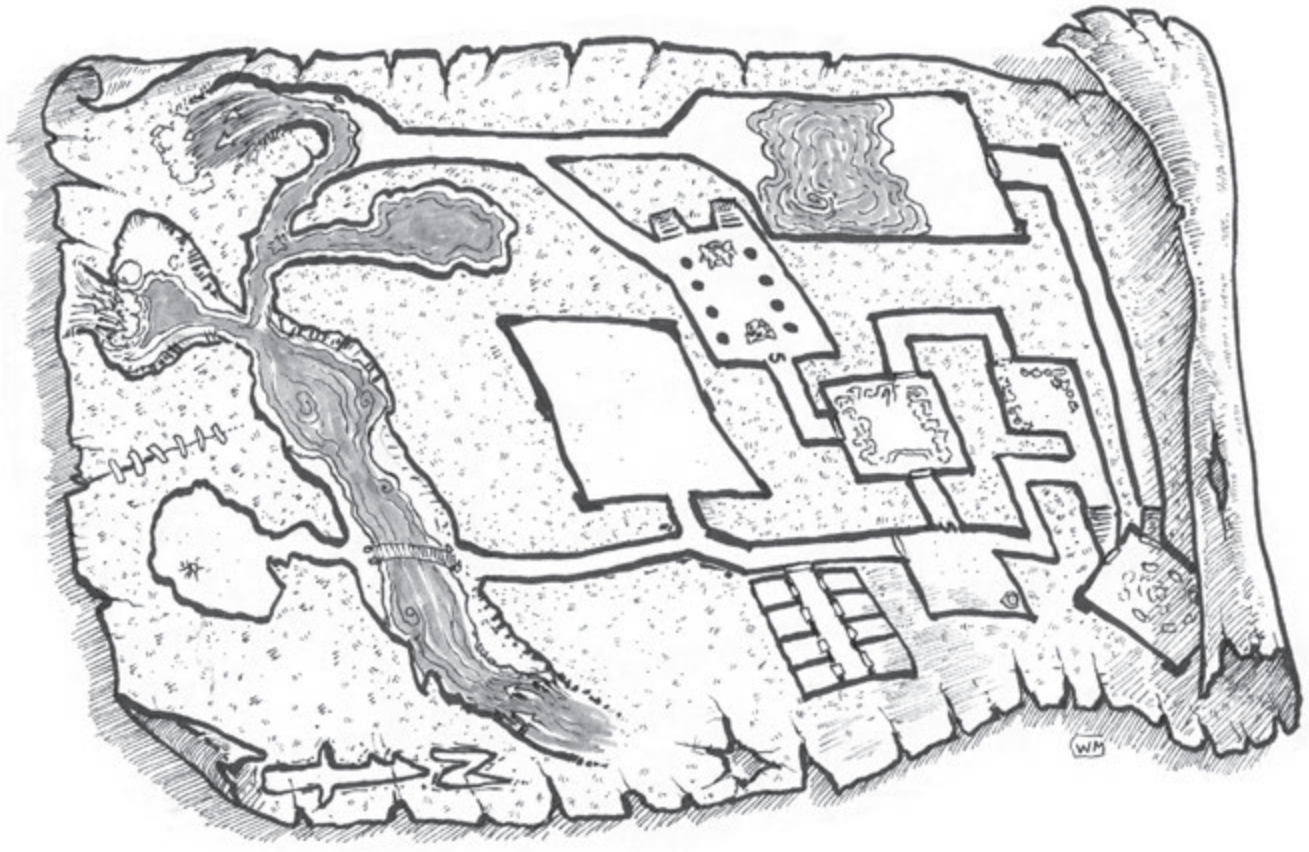
PLAYER HANDOUT #6



PLAYER HANDOUT #7



PLAYER HANDOUT #8



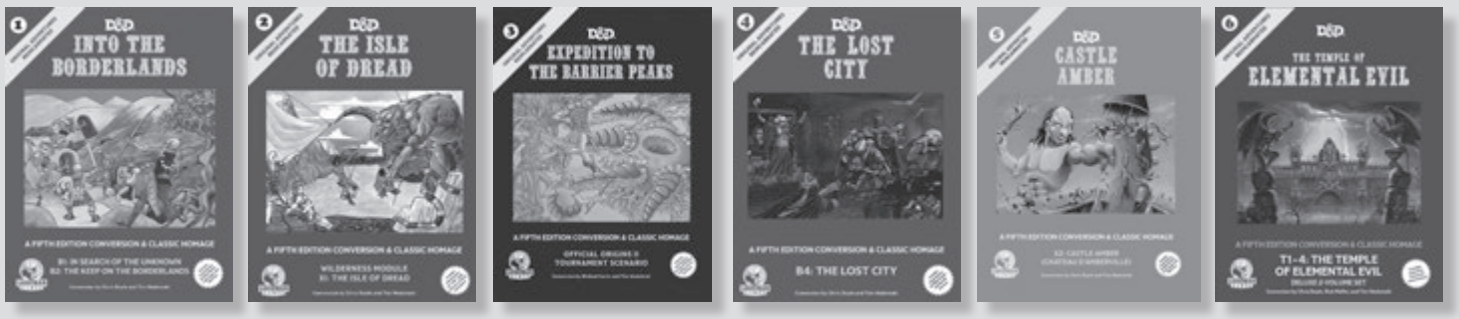
PLAYER HANDOUT #9

Fifth Edition Fantasy

Stand-alone, world-neutral adventure modules compatible with 5E. All print editions also include a code for free PDF edition. Look for them at your local game store or **www.goodman-games.com**!

OAR

Original Adventures Reincarnated are an homage to the origins of our hobby! Each volume contains high-quality scans from multiple printings of the original first edition adventure modules, plus commentary by gaming legends. Full fifth edition conversions are included, as well as brand new adventure material that adds new encounters and expands the original encounters.



A MEGADUNGEON FOR CHARACTER LEVELS 1-10

A Thousand-Year-Old Dungeon Mystery Waiting To Be Solved!

The end of one empire sees the birth of a new one deep within the earth. Born in the forgotten chambers and caverns of age-lost Thracia rises a formidable foe: the Minotaur King, along with his host of dogfolk, gnolls, lizardfolk and others.

Some say even Death itself lingers in the Caverns of Thracia, ready to claim any who stumble upon its unholy chapel. The secrets of Thracia are manifold, its treasures thrice that.

Do you have the mettle to survive... the Caverns of Thracia?

***The Caverns of Thracia* is a complete mega-dungeon setting that supports a full-year campaign!**

- **Takes characters from levels 1 through 10**
- **6 vast dungeon levels**
- **150+ detailed encounter areas**
- **45+ fully-developed new monsters and NPCs**
- **35+ new magic items and spells, plus one new divine domain**
- **Plenty of opportunities for combat, exploration, and social interaction with interesting NPCs**
- **Tribute essays from professional RPG designers**
- **A full reprint of the original The Caverns of Thracia by Jennell Jaquays**

THE CAVERNS OF THRACIA

Sustainability in Book Publishing

Goodman Games is committed to sustainability in our printing, publishing, and shipping. Scan the QR code to learn more!

GOODMAN GAMES

$59.99 GMG50009

ISBN 9781961756472

55999 >

9 781961 756472

FIRST PRINTING

OAR

Original Adventures Reincarnated